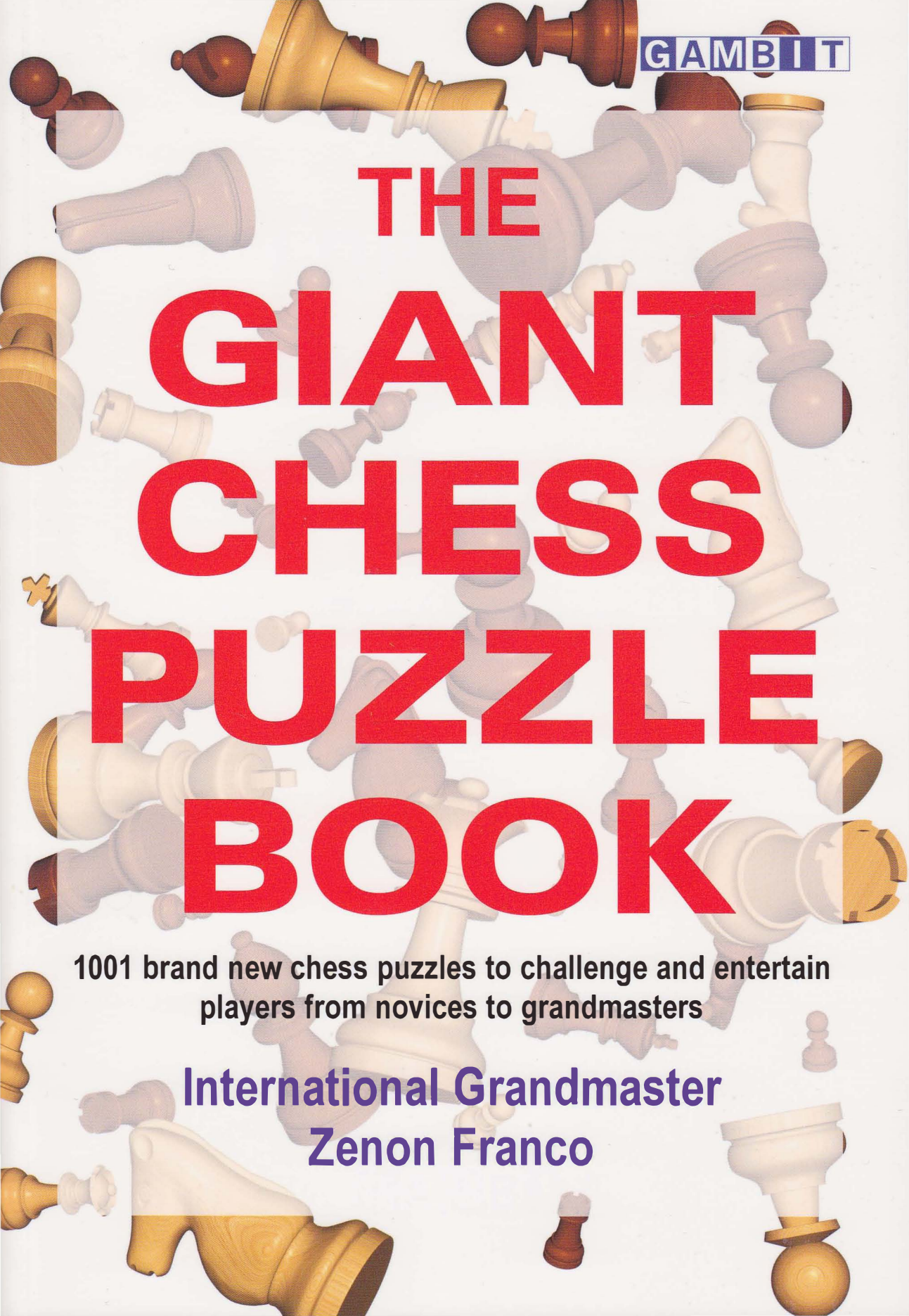

GAMBIT
THE
GIANT
CHESS
PUZZLE
BOOK
1001 brand new chess puzzles to challenge and entertain players from novices to grandmasters
International Grandmaster
Zenon Franco

The Giant Chess Puzzle Book

Zenón Franco

Translated by Phil Adams

GAMBIT

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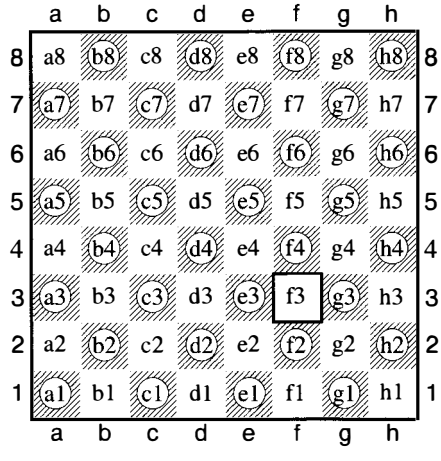
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Symbols and Notation

x	capture
+	check
++	double check
#	checkmate
!!	brilliant move
!	good move
!?	interesting move
?!	dubious move
?	bad move
??	blunder
Ch	championship

♔	king
♕	queen
♖	rook
♗	bishop
♘	knight

Algebraic Notation



Moves are shown by giving the piece symbol followed by the destination square. For instance, if a knight moves to the square marked in the diagram, this is written as ♘f3 in algebraic notation. If two pieces of the same type can move to the same square, more information is given. For instance, if there are knights on g1 and e5, then the one on e5 moving to f3 is written as ♘ef3.

For pawn moves, only the arrival square is given (for example, e4 means that a pawn moves to the e4-square). For pawn captures, the file the pawn is leaving is also given. Thus exf4 means that a pawn on the e-file makes a capture that brings it to the f4-square.

Introduction

Solving chess puzzles is one of the most enjoyable exercises available; no chess-player can resist trying to find the answers. Thus when my editor Graham Burgess put forward the idea of creating a huge book of puzzles, similar to John Emms's *The Ultimate Chess Puzzle Book*, I was immediately filled with enthusiasm.

I have to acknowledge that once this initial feeling of pleasure had passed, the task of finding 1001 original puzzles (original in the sense that they have never appeared in similar books or other collections of chess puzzles) appeared to me to be a very complicated task, and the four-figure number was rather daunting. But it didn't turn out that way: the process of research and selection took some time, but it was not as immense as I had feared, partly because I found the task so enjoyable.

In order to exclude any very familiar puzzles, I decided that most of them would have to come from two main sources: either tournaments played in the last two years, or else games of my own, or with which I was familiar because I had observed them, or which had made an impression on me. Nevertheless, the book to some extent took on a life of its own, and sometimes seemed to be taking its own decisions. This is particularly relevant in Chapter 7, which features a wholly different source of top-quality examples that will be unfamiliar to most readers.

The games are mainly taken from Mega Database 2009 and the last few years' editions of *The Week in Chess* and *Chess Today*. The analysis was done with the aid of Fritz 11 and Rybka 3.

The Structure of this Book

Now for a brief description of the chapters:

The first chapter deals with the main tactical ideas, as in the above-mentioned book by Emms, together with some additions and my own personal take on how best to present and explain these basic ideas.

Chapter 2 contains 120 puzzles, the majority of them highly suitable for novices, or as warm-up exercises for club players; the first 60 are supplied with hints to help you find the solution, but for the remaining 60 you receive no help.

Chapter 3 is called 'On the Attack' and consists of 100 puzzles, from level 1 to 4 (on a scale where 1 is easiest and 5 most difficult), and the theme is attacking play. There are hints for the first 50.

Chapter 4 is the biggest one, comprising 200 puzzles of levels 1 to 4; for the first 100 I have included hints.

Chapter 5 provides the first of three batches of test positions (Chapters 8 and 10 are the other two). Points are awarded for correct answers, which you can translate into a very approximate evaluation of your Elo rating. It consists of five tests with 16 puzzles in each, i.e. 80 in each of the three chapters, making 240 test positions in total.

Chapter 6 is called 'Defence and Counterattack'. This aspect of our play is unjustly neglected; every player knows that there is just as much pleasure, or more, to be gained from saving a half-point after a successful defence (especially if one has been made to suffer) as from conducting a successful attack. There are 90 such puzzles, with hints for 40 of them.

Chapter 7 is entitled 'Mundo Latino' and is one part of the book which, as I mentioned earlier, took on a life of its own. It comprises 90 puzzles, including 40 with hints; these puzzles are taken from games by Latin players, both European and American, although the majority are from tournaments in Argentina, where there was a great deal of chess activity from the early decades of the 20th century right up to the 1980s. This chapter unexpectedly overflowed into many of the others,

since I found such an abundance of good and little-known material. There are clear reasons for the prevalence of such good examples; there were frequent visits and tournament appearances by the world's best players to Argentina, principally to Buenos Aires and Mar del Plata. These visits included World Champions such as Lasker, Capablanca, Alekhine, Smyslov, Petrosian, Fischer, Spassky and Karpov, together with such outstanding figures as Keres, Bronstein, Korchnoi, Larsen, Reshevsky, Stein, Polugaevsky, Olafsson, and many others. Furthermore, in 1939 the chess Olympiad was being held in Buenos Aires when the Second World War broke out, leading to many masters staying on and making their lives in Argentina, thus raising the already good local standard of chess even higher. To quote just one example: it will probably surprise you to learn that, according to *chessmetrics.com*, the Argentinean player Julio Bolbochán was the 13th strongest player in the world at several times between 1951 and 1955.

Chapter 9 is called 'The World of Endgames' and is made up of 90 endgame puzzles, of levels 1 to 4; the first 40 of these feature hints.

Chapter 11 is the last and the most difficult, comprising 81 puzzles of level 5 and beyond, which even grandmasters will find challenging. The first 30 include hints.

Finally I must thank all my friends, and friends of friends, who suggested material, including Sergio Estremera, Reinaldo Vera, Manel García, Luis Scalise, and many others.

Ponteareas, January 2010

Dedicated to:
"La capital de un imperio que nunca existió"

1 The Most Important Tactical Themes

The learning process in chess is not a rapid one. When we begin to play and we look at games played by masters, the combinations seem almost magical to us. Everything comes as a surprise, based on reasons we are unable to understand, apparently inexplicable, and yet, in master games, it all works!

When we have progressed a little, we see it is not like that; there are in fact reasons for a combination to work and, together with other knowledge, we gradually learn to recognize the features of a position which is ripe for a combination. Nevertheless – and this is one of the great virtues of our game – the fascination evoked by a beautiful combination remains the same throughout our lives.

In this first chapter we shall review the main tactical themes, which will help us get our bearings, because the majority of tactical motifs, in one form or another, come up again and again. We should not forget, however, that often these motifs do not occur in a simple form, but are often combined with others.

Tactical Weakness

One basic concept that we must learn to recognize is that of a tactical weakness, since this is the basis of most combinations.

We can define a tactical weakness as any piece, or collection of pieces, which facilitates a combination; we can say that this is a prerequisite for the tactical motifs to work.

One obvious example would be an undefended (a.k.a. loose) piece. Others might be: having the queen and the king in a position to be forked, having a weak back rank, or having a poorly defended king.

A tactical weakness does not always lose the game, or cause irreparable damage, but it is a defect in the position which deserves to be taken into account.

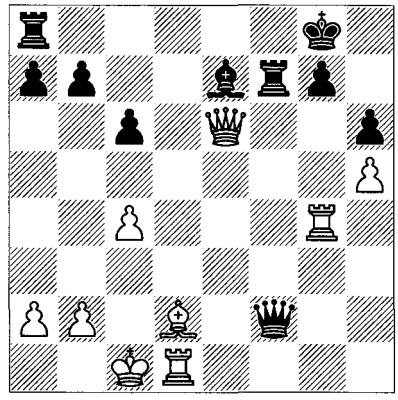
Other preconditions for a combination to work might include positive elements in one's own position, such as having very active pieces, or outnumbering the enemy in a particular sector of the board, or having a pawn close to the queening square.

Double or Multiple Attack (Fork)

A double attack occurs when a piece attacks two enemy pieces simultaneously; if it attacks more than two pieces, it is called a multiple attack.

One of the ingredients of a double or multiple attack may also be a threat of mate, which is an attack of equal or greater force.

W

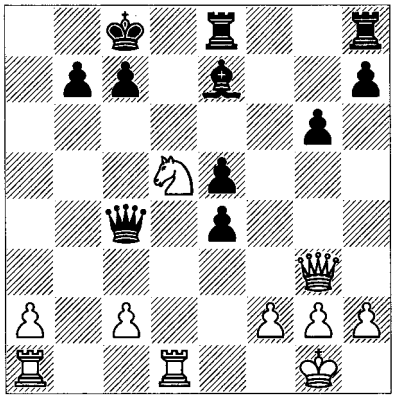


Leko – Topalov
Amber Blindfold, Nice 2009

The f7-rook is pinned, which means that it can't move; it would be advantageous to attack it a second time, but then Black in turn would defend it a second time. However, White can create a double attack, on the f7-rook and the black queen, so that there is no time for Black to defend the rook.

24 ♖f4! 1-0

Let's look at another example.

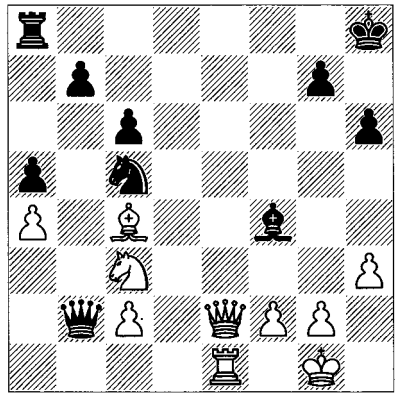


Vachier-Lagrave – Landenbergue
Mulhouse 2009

An initial glance at the position shows us that the black king is lacking an important defender, i.e. the a7-pawn, leaving the a-file open. This does not seem serious though, since White can't play 20 ♕a3, and even if White could somehow bring his queen to a5, Black could just reply ...♔b8 without any problems. It is possible that at some point during our glance we 'see the light': White does indeed have a way to play ♕a3, and at the same time carry out a decisive double attack.

There followed **20 ♘xe7+!** and Black resigned, since 20...♖xe7 loses to the double attack 21 ♕a3!.

Finally, let us see a rather more complex example:



Motylev – Emelin
European Ch, Budva 2009

An undefended piece is always worthy of attention. Here Black's knight is unprotected, but one could argue that this is not serious, because the c3-knight is also attacked.

However, White carried out a double attack, not only threatening the loose knight (no surprise there), but also containing a more hidden threat against the black king.

22 ♕h5!

This move provoked Black's resignation. The attack on the c5-knight is not so important, because if 23 ♕xc5 then 23...♕xc3; however, the second threat (23 ♖e8+) is much more serious, since it leads to mate: 23...♖xe8 24 ♕xe8+ ♔h7, and now there is a typical mating manoeuvre: 25 ♗g8+ ♔h8 26 ♗f7+ ♔h7 27 ♕g8#.

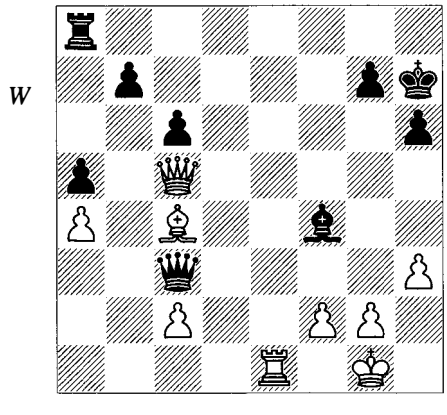
However, after the defence 22...♔h7, 23 ♖e8? fails to 23...♖xe8 24 ♕xe8 ♕a1+! (so that the white bishop can't help the queen) 25 ♗f1 ♕xc3, and it is Black who wins.

This defence, 22...♔h7, brings us to the next tactical motif, the discovered check.

Discovered Check, Discovered Attack and Double Check

A *discovered check* occurs when a piece moves off a line to reveal an attack by a second piece standing to its rear, which now checks the enemy king.

It is also possible to carry out the same manoeuvre in order to attack some other enemy piece; in this case we call it a *discovered attack.*

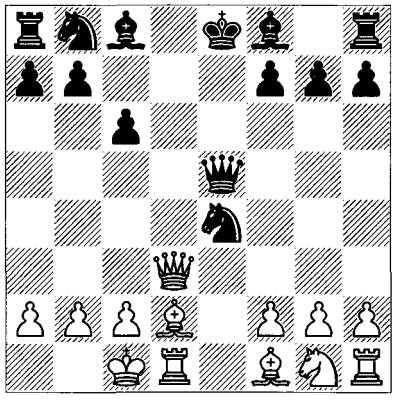


This position could be reached from the previous diagram, after the moves 22 ♕h5 ♔h7 23 ♕xc5! ♕xc3.

Here White wins by giving a check which is simultaneously a discovered attack with 24 ♗d3+, or 24 ♗g8+, winning the black queen.

Let's examine a classic example which is slightly more complicated:

W



Réti – Tartakower
Vienna 1910

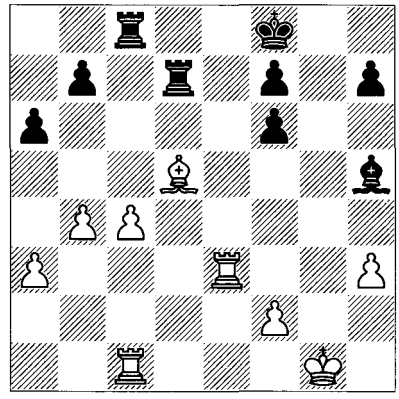
The situation of the black king, in the centre and with the central files open, is definitely a serious tactical weakness. White exploits this in a spectacular manner by setting up a decisive discovered check: **9 ♕d8+!! ♔xd8 10 ♗g5++** and in view of the imminent mate, Black resigned; if 10...♔c7 then 11 ♗d8# and 10...♔e8 is met by 11 ♖d8#. Indeed, this was not only a discovered check, but a *double check*, as the bishop also gave check itself in addition to uncovering a check by the rook. A double check is a very powerful and forcing attacking device, since the only way to reply is with a king move.

The Pin

In Leko-Topalov above, we saw a demonstration of the dangers that can result from having a piece pinned. In general, a pin occurs when a piece attacks an enemy piece along a line, and if the attacked piece were to move away, then a second piece, of greater value, would be exposed to attack along the same line. The following diagram shows a typical case.

The d5-bishop appears to be solidly defended by the c4-pawn. This would indeed be the case were it not for the rook on c1, but the undefended state of this rook allows **27...♖xd5!** and Black wins a piece.

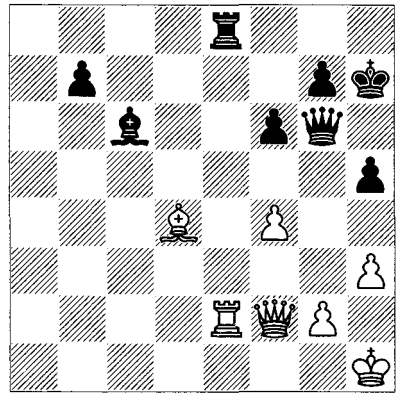
B



Dorić – Bocharov
European Ch, Budva 2009

Let's look at a slightly more complex example.

B



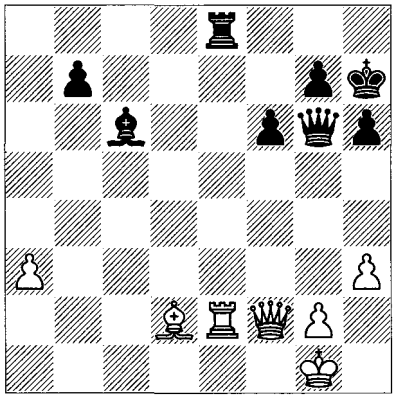
Kotov – Botvinnik
USSR Ch, Leningrad 1939

It would be a difficult task for Black to exploit his extra pawn, but the job can be completely simplified by forcing the white queen to be pinned along the long diagonal, with **37...♕xg2+! 38 ♕xg2 ♖xe2**, and Black gains a decisive material advantage.

It is noteworthy that seven years later, Kotov himself carried out a very similar combination (*see diagram overleaf*).

Here too Black forces the white queen into a pin (thus leaving the e2-rook undefended), this time not on the long diagonal but vertically. With **39...♗xg2!** Kotov won another pawn, as after 40 ♕xg2 ♖xe2, White loses the exchange. After **40 ♖xe8 ♗e4+ 41 ♔h2 ♕xe8** Black won quickly.

B

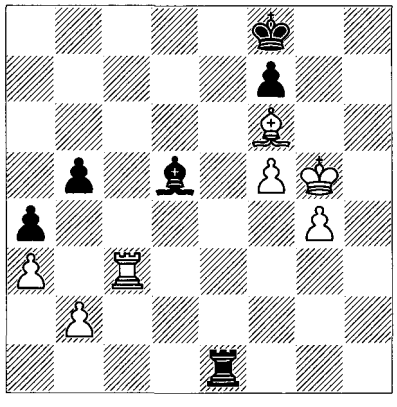


Guimard – Kotov
Staunton Memorial, Groningen 1946

The Skewer

A skewer is similar to a pin; it occurs when an enemy piece is attacked along a line, and if the attacked piece moves out of the way then a piece situated behind the attacked piece is lost, or, as in the cases that we shall examine, there is even greater damage.

W

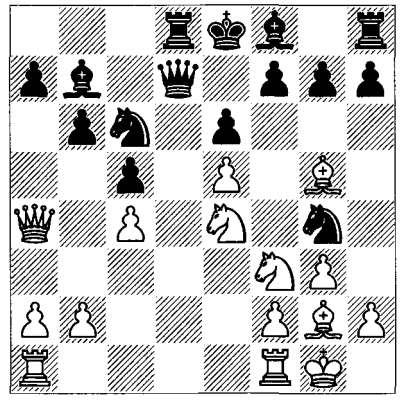


Fischer – Forintos
Monte Carlo 1967

In this case White creates a skewer position; the direct 46 ♖c8+ ♖e8 47 ♗g7+ ♔e7 achieves nothing, but Black's position is so precarious, and the f6-bishop is so strong, that there has to be 'something' in the position, and Fischer reveals what it is in just two moves: **46 ♖h3!** threatens mate on h8, the sidestep **46...♔e8** is forced, and now comes **47 ♖d3!**, and the d5-bishop can't move on account of the mate on d8.

Let's look at another, more spectacular, example.

B



Shirov – Bareev
Novgorod 1994

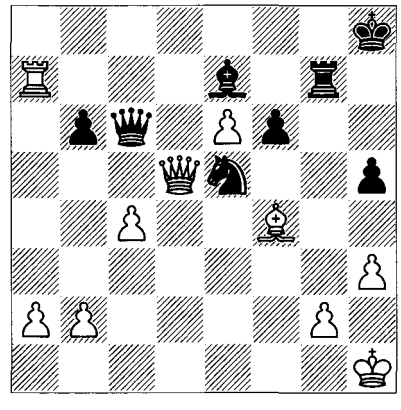
Black now played **14...♘cxe5?** ignoring the threat of 15 ♗xd8, since the white queen is attacked, and if 15 ♕xd7+ then 15...♖xd7, with an extra pawn. However, with **15 ♖ad1!** White gains a decisive material advantage, since the pinned black queen can't move aside and if 15...♕xa4 then 16 ♖xd8#.

Destroying the Defence (Removing the Guard)

Let's suppose that an enemy piece is attacked, and defended by only one other piece. If the defending piece can be dislodged or captured, the first piece is left undefended.

Let's look at an example:

W

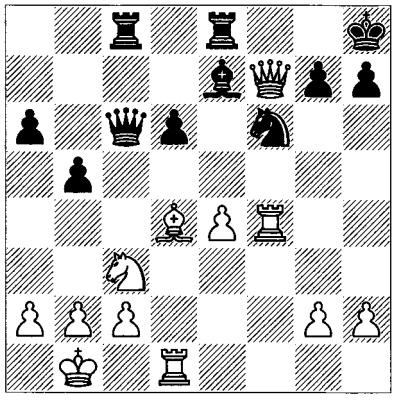


Siugirov – Cheparinov
European Ch, Budva 2009

Here White has three pawns for the piece, which is reasonable material compensation, but in addition his pieces are very active. In particular, the e7-bishop is defended only by the rook.

White played **33 ♗h6!**, when the rook can't go to h7 on account of 34 ♖a8+ and mate. Thus the rook's defence of the bishop breaks down, and material losses are unavoidable.

When it is the king's defenders that are under attack, the damage caused can be much greater; let's look at an example.



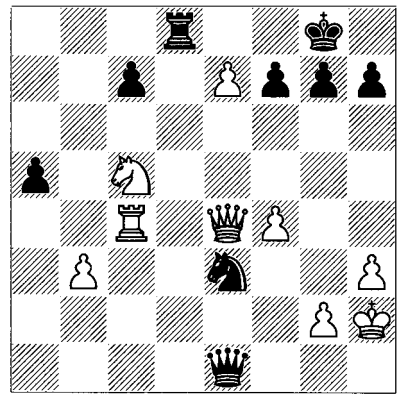
Kramnik – Radjabov
Amber Blindfold, Nice 2009

White can 'physically' destroy the defences of the black king, leaving the position wide open: **25 ♗xf6! ♗xf6 26 ♖xf6!** and Black resigned, since after 26...gxf6 27 ♕xf6+ ♔g8 White can bring the other rook decisively into the attack with 28 ♖d3.

Let's look finally at a slightly different case of destruction of the defender (*see following diagram*).

Black has two pieces in the attack, but on their own they can't achieve anything (e.g., 31...♘f1+ 32 ♔g1), so the passive move 31...♖e8 might appear necessary, to blockade the strong white pawn on e7.

But let's not give up on Black's active ideas. How can the rook be included in the attack? There is no direct way, but perhaps after delving deeper into the position we might notice that, if only the h-file were open, Black could play 31...♕h4+ and 32...♖d1+, mating. From there it is an easy step to the solution... **31...♘g4+!** and in view of the forced mate White resigned.

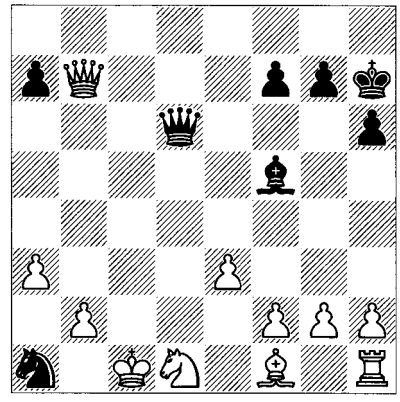


Nikolić – Hübner
World Cup, Barcelona 1989

Deflection (Overworked Piece)

When a piece is performing an important defensive task, forcing it to leave its square or a particular line can have a huge effect. If the defensive task also involves the king, the damage can be even greater, even irreparable.

Let's look at one of the most well-known and brilliant examples.



Vaganian – Planinc
Hastings 1974/5

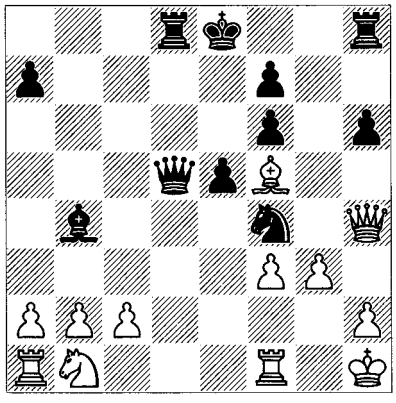
White is a rook up, so Black needs to achieve something significant, and quickly. The white king is uncomfortable, but there is nothing immediate; if 22...♕c5+ then 23 ♘c3, while the knight check on b3 is defended by the white queen on b7. Perhaps at this moment we notice that if the white queen were not defending b3, then ...♘b3# would be mate, at which point

anyone with any chess training sees the brilliant solution that the Slovenian grandmaster had conceived several moves earlier:

22...♕c7+!! 0-1

Let's look at another, more recent, example:

B



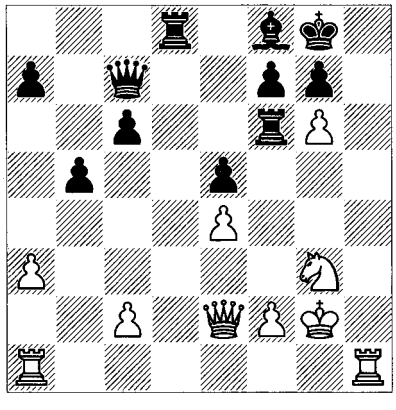
Petović – Chudinovskikh
European Ch, Budva 2009

The f1-rook is fulfilling the vital role of defending the back rank. If this rook could be distracted from this task, the black rook could give a deadly check on d1; this is achieved by means of the spectacular **20...♕xf3+! 0-1**.

Attraction (Decoy)

This tactical theme has similarities to the previous one. The difference is that here an enemy piece is forced to move to a square where it stands worse.

W



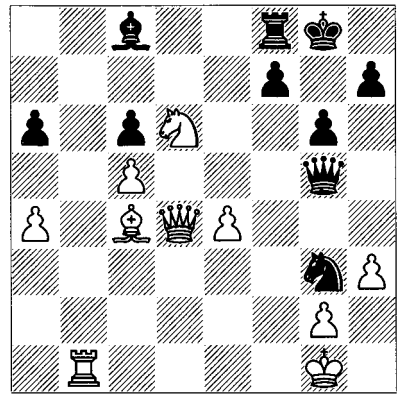
Mamedov – V. Popov
European Ch, Budva 2009

White has the open h-file and a pawn wedge at g6, but he needs to exploit these factors quickly, because Black is threatening 29...♖xg6.

The direct 29 ♕h5, threatening mate, fails to 29...fxg6. This should set an alarm bell ringing in the brain and then, by thinking something like "if only I could play ♕h5 with a gain of tempo, mate could not be prevented" it becomes easier to find the move **29 ♖h8+! 1-0**. There would follow 29...♔xh8 30 ♕h5+ ♔g8 31 ♕h7#.

Let's look at a more complicated example.

W



Anand – Leko
Amber Blindfold, Nice 2009

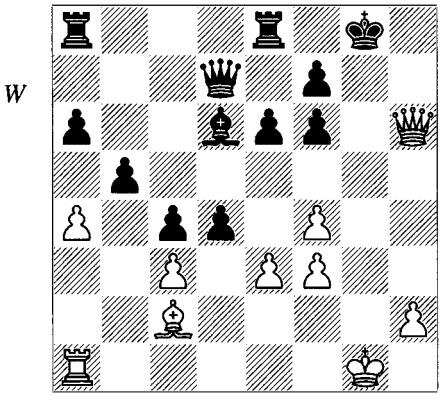
Here the process would be slightly different. Black has several tactical weaknesses, such as his somewhat exposed king, and another important detail is that his queen is undefended on g5. It is also important that the d6-knight is in such an active position. Thus White is able to set up a knight fork by means of two decoy sacrifices: **35 ♗xf7+!! ♖xf7 36 ♕h8+!**, and White gains a decisive material advantage following 36...♔xh8 37 ♘xf7+ and 38 ♘xg5.

If further proof were necessary that combinations repeat themselves, it is worth recalling that both in Petrosian-Simagin, Moscow Ch match (game 5) 1956, and also(!) in Petrosian-Spassky, World Ch match (game 10), Moscow 1966, Petrosian was able to carry out a very similar combination to the one in Anand-Leko.

Vacating a Line or a Square

This occurs when we move one of our own pieces away from a particular square so that

another piece can occupy it, with decisive effect.

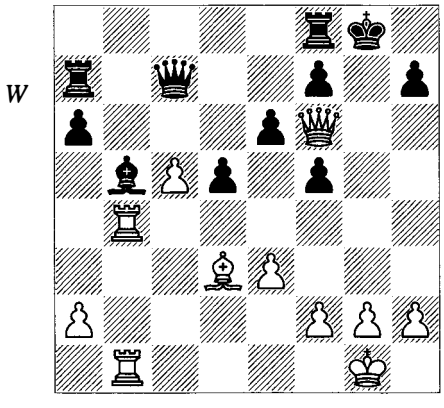


P. Cramling – Shen Yang
Women's Grand Prix, Istanbul 2009

There is nothing immediate with 26 ♗h7+ ♔h8, since none of the possible discoveries are decisive. 26 ♕h7+ ♔f8 achieves nothing either, because the black king can go to e7.

We must send reinforcements; the a1-rook needs to be included in the attack, and this can be done via the g-file: after **26 ♔h1!** the g1-square is vacated, and there is no satisfactory defence against 27 ♖g1#.

Let's look at a rather different example.



Hort – Portisch
Madrid 1973

White stands better; his pieces are more active than their black counterparts, but more importantly the black king is weak, and the white queen occupies a dominant position.

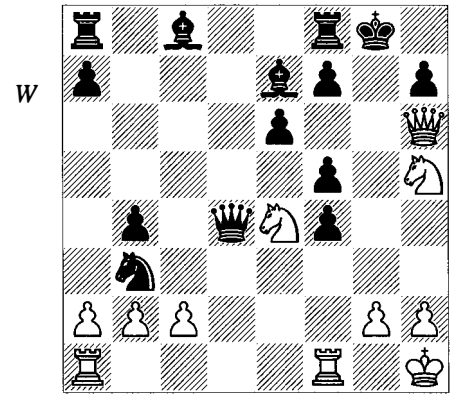
However, there is no apparent way of sending reinforcements in the manner of the previous example. The b4-rook would not immediately threaten anything serious by moving to h4, whilst the d3-bishop's diagonal is closed and in any case it is threatened with being exchanged.

The beautiful solution is not very obvious, and in fact it passed unnoticed by both grandmasters on the previous move. By means of a tactical manoeuvre, White succeeds in clearing the b1-h7 diagonal and bringing the power of both the queen and the bishop to bear on h7. We notice that another element is lacking, namely the ability to attack an undefended black piece at the same time. How can we arrange this?

30 ♖g4+!! fxg4 31 ♕g5+! ♔h8 and now the f8-rook is undefended, so that after **32 ♕h6** there is no defence against the twin threats of mate.

In-between Move (Zwischenzug)

An in-between move (we also use the German word *zwischenzug* for this) occurs when, during an apparently forced or logical sequence of moves, a player makes an unexpected move that breaks the natural flow and alters the situation to his advantage.



Fischer – Benko
Bled/Zagreb/Belgrade Candidates 1959

White can win the queen with 20 ♘hf6+ ♗xf6 21 ♘xf6+ ♕xf6 22 ♕xf6, but after 22...♘xa1 23 ♖xa1 ♗b7 the victory is a long way off, since Black has rook, bishop and a pawn for the queen (once the f4-pawn is captured), but with an in-between move the task becomes dramatically simplified:

20 ♖ad1!

The black queen does not have many squares from which it can defend g7.

20...♕e5

If 20...♕xb2 then 21 c3!, with mate in four.

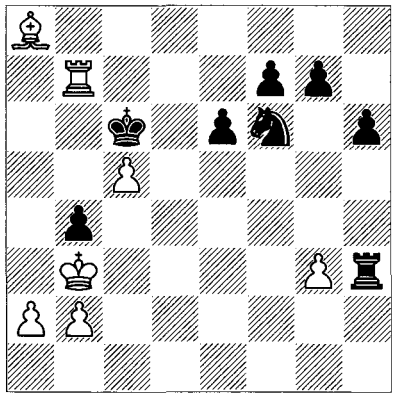
21 ♘ef6+ ♗xf6 22 ♘xf6+ ♕xf6 23 ♕xf6 ♘c5

Now comes a manoeuvre similar to the one employed by Hort in the previous example; the c5-knight is undefended, and with another in-between move, White manages to double the number of undefended pieces...

24 ♕g5+! ♔h8 25 ♕e7! ♗a6 26 ♕xc5 ♗xf1 27 ♖xf1 1-0

Let's look at another example by Fischer on a related theme.

W



Fischer – Petrosian
Bled 1961

The black king is in a very uncomfortable position, but the discovered check with 36 ♖xf7+ achieves nothing after 36...♔xc5. However, there is a preliminary move which prepares the discovery and destroys this defence.

36 ♔c4! 1-0

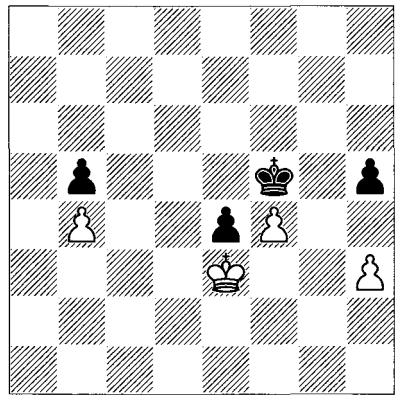
Mate is unavoidable.

Zugzwang

This German word refers to a situation in which any move worsens the position. *Zugzwang* is very common in endgames, where positions of *reciprocal zugzwang* can also occur, in which whoever has to move must worsen his position (*see next diagram*).

Black is able to deprive White of any useful moves by playing **46...h4!**. Now the white king

B

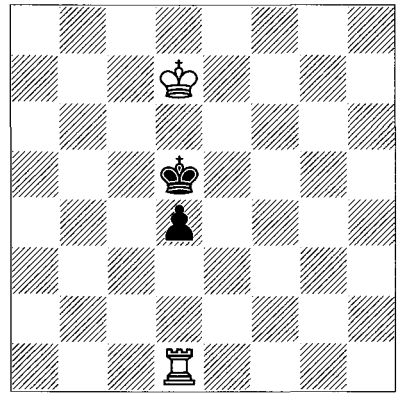


Bologan – Vachier-Lagrave
Mulhouse 2009

is forced to move, after which the f4-pawn is lost, and with it the game.

Let's look at a further example of reciprocal zugzwang.

B/W



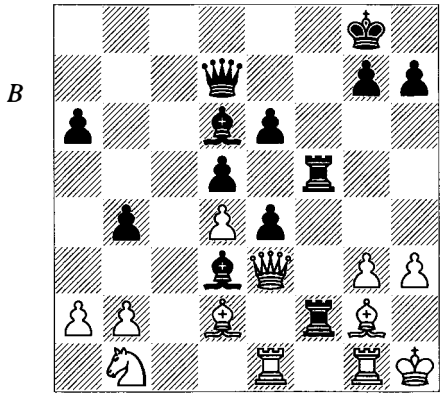
R. Réti (end of study)
Münchner Neueste Nachrichten, 1928

Black loses because he has to move and thus give way to the white king, which can then come to the aid of the rook: 1...♔e4 2 ♔c6! ♔e3 3 ♔c5 d3 4 ♔c4 d2 5 ♔c3 and White captures the black pawn. Similarly if 1...♔c4 then 2 ♔e6! d3 3 ♔e5 ♔c3 4 ♔e4 d2 5 ♔e3, and wins.

In contrast, if it were White's move the game would be a draw. For example, if 1 ♔c7 then 1...♔c5! (1...♔c4? loses to 2 ♔d6! d3 3 ♔e5 ♔c3 4 ♔e4, much as in the line we examined above) and White can make no progress, since his king can't join in the struggle against the

passed pawn; if 2 ♔d7 then 2...♔d5!. 1 ♖d2 is equally ineffective, since it allows Black to gain a saving tempo after 1...♔e4 2 ♔d6 ♔e3 3 ♖d1 d3 4 ♔c5 ♔e2, and White will have to give up his rook for the pawn.

Zugzwang usually arises in the endgame; positions of 'semi-zugzwang' occur occasionally in the middlegame, when one side has an overwhelming advantage in space. However, there is nothing to rival the 'Immortal Zugzwang Game':



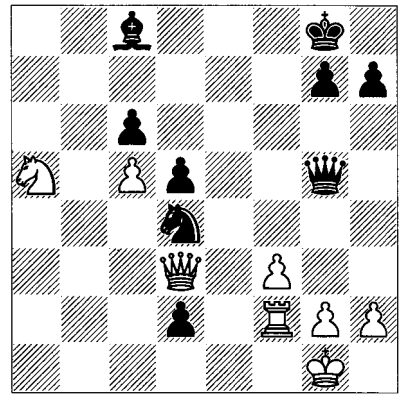
Sämisch – Nimzowitsch
Copenhagen 1923

Here Black played **25...h6!**, controlling the g5-square, and White resigned, because in a few moves he will be in zugzwang, with almost all the pieces still on the board!

Black has many waiting moves available, such as ...♔h7-g8, whereas once White has used up all his pawn moves he will lose material. If 26 a3 then 26...a5 and nothing is changed, whilst after 26 ♔h2 the g2-bishop is pinned and Black can win by 26...♖5f3. 26 g4 also loses, to 26...♖5f3 27 ♗xf3 ♖h2#; another possibility is 26 ♖c1, which loses the queen after 26...♖e2. Finally, 26 ♗c1 leaves the b1-knight undefended, and thus any and every move loses material.

Overload

A piece is overloaded when it has to defend two or more vital squares simultaneously.



Piris – Lipiniks (variation)
Asunción 2009

The white queen's most important task here is to prevent the d2-pawn from queening. White is the exchange up and even threatens 31 ♕xd4, because the queen would still be carrying out the task of defending the d1 point. Thus White's position does not seem so bad, yet in two moves everything becomes clear.

30...♗a6!!

The bishop is immune because the white queen has to prevent the pawn from queening. The pawn is also safe for now because 31 ♕xd2 loses to 31...♘xf3+!. If 31 ♕b1 Black could play 31...♕e3, winning. But what if White captures the knight?

31 ♕xd4

Now Black can exploit the overload on the queen by forcing it to defend another weakness, the back rank, specifically a1 and e1, with...

31...♕e5!!

This beautiful move is decisive; Black's threat is to mate with 32...♕e1+; if 32 ♕xe5 then 32...d1♕+, mating, while if 32 ♕xd2 then 32...♕a1+ is decisive.

For this combination to work, several other factors had to be present, such as a second overload: the f2-rook can't both defend the queen and prevent the fork on f3; another factor was the weakness of the back rank, decisively exploited by 30...♗a6!! controlling f1.

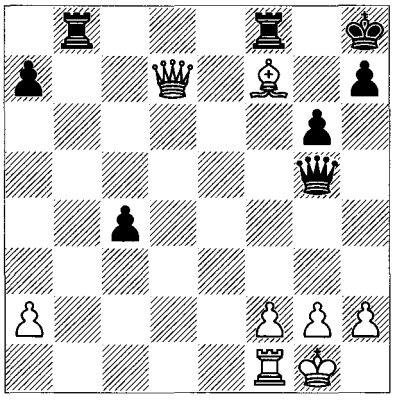
With this splendid example we conclude the introductory chapter, wishing the reader the best of luck in solving the next 1001 positions.

2 Elementary Puzzles

This first chapter of puzzles is the easiest; the solutions generally require calculating only two or three moves ahead. The puzzles gradually increase in difficulty, although without exceeding level 1 in complexity (on a scale of 1 to 5). The majority of them are based on winning material, along with some basic mating combinations and a few straightforward endgames.

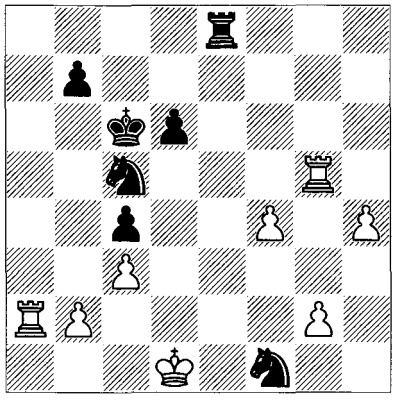
There are 120 puzzles, the first 60 with comments or hints to help you find the solution, while for the remaining 60 you are on your own.

1
W



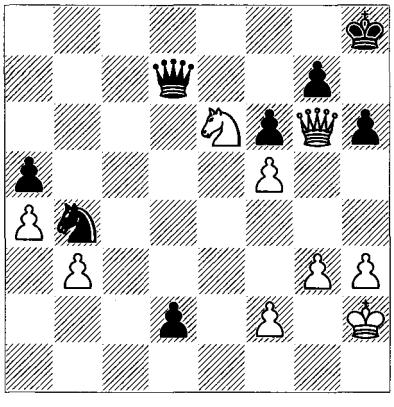
Black's king can hardly move; how can this be exploited?

3
B



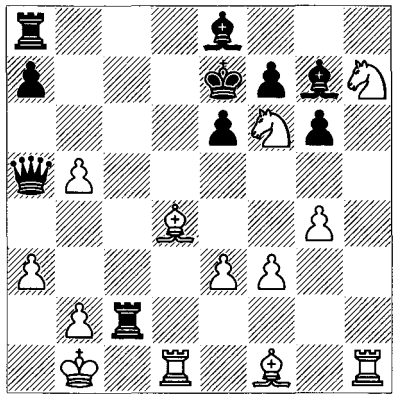
Here it is the white king that is being harried by several enemy pieces; how can Black mate quickly?

2
W



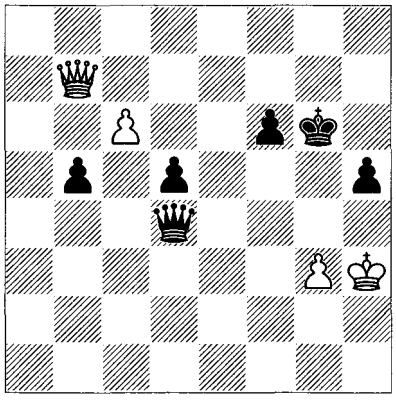
Black is threatening to queen, but White has the upper hand and can simultaneously create two winning threats. How?

4
W



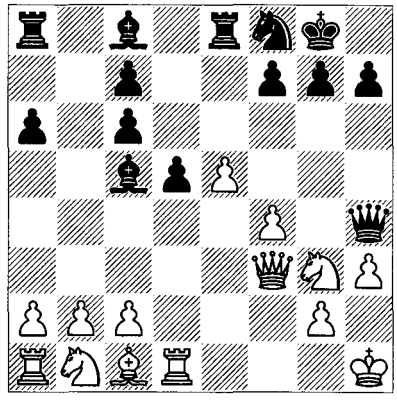
If 24 ♘g8+, the black king escapes via the d-file; how can the king's escape be cut off?

5
B



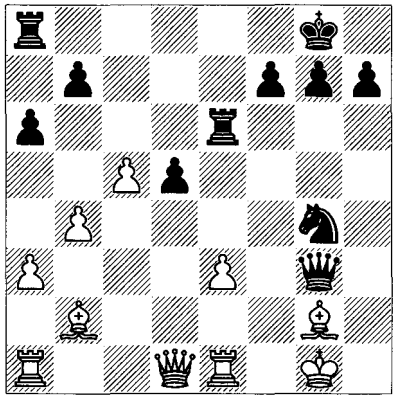
White is threatening to queen quickly. However, there is a weakness in his position that allows Black to win on the spot. How?

8
B



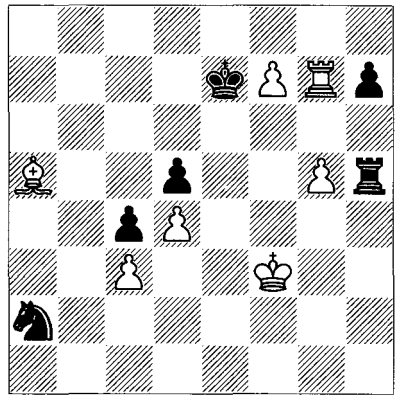
The white king can hardly move, but to take advantage of this Black needs to open some lines – how?

6
B



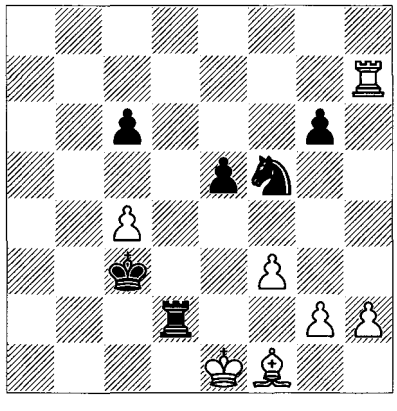
White has an extra piece, but his king is poorly defended. What is the quickest way for Black to mate?

9
W



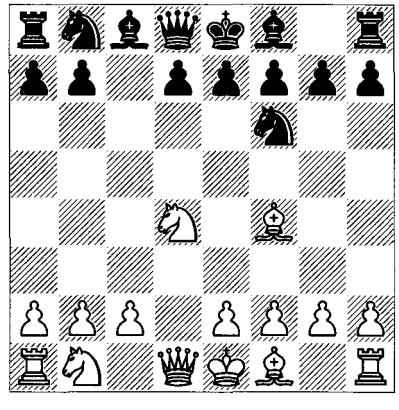
White has a passed pawn close to queening, but it requires support; how can this be arranged?

7
B



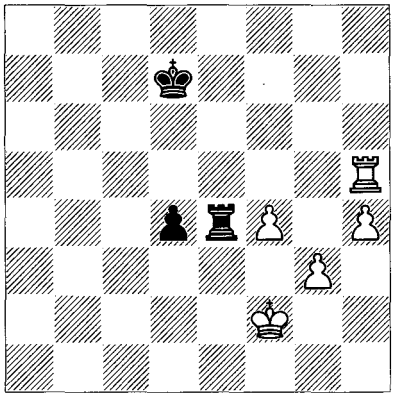
How should Black exploit the uncomfortable position of the white king?

10
B



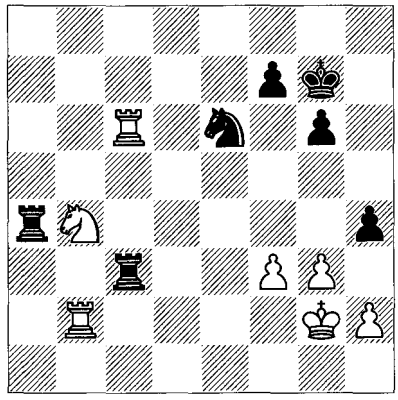
With 4...e5 Black could win a piece, were it not for 5 ♗xe5, but what if we take the calculation a move further?

11
W



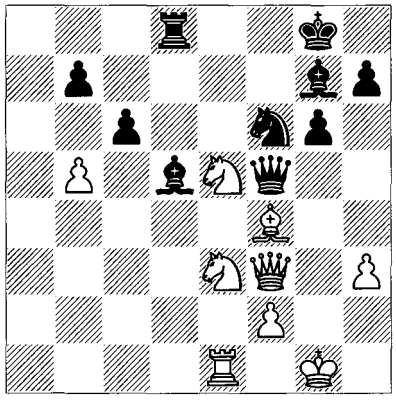
How can White conclude the game quickly, based on the fact that pawn endings with an extra pawn are nearly always won?

14
B



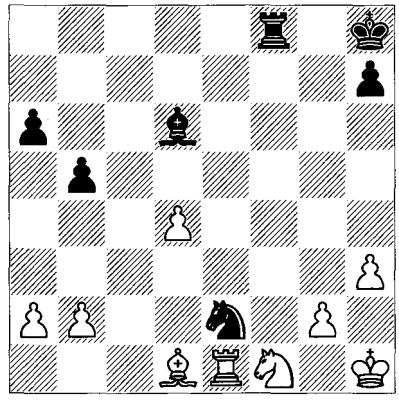
This puzzle is similar to number 12; how does Black win material?

12
B



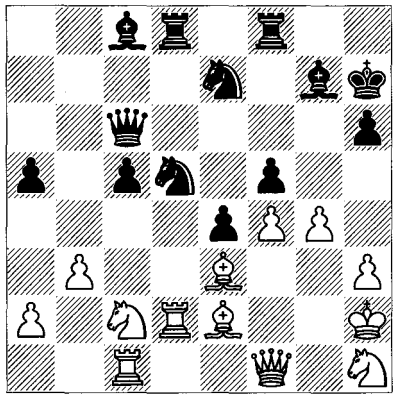
Both queens are attacked, but Black can win by eliminating a vital white defensive piece – how?

15
B



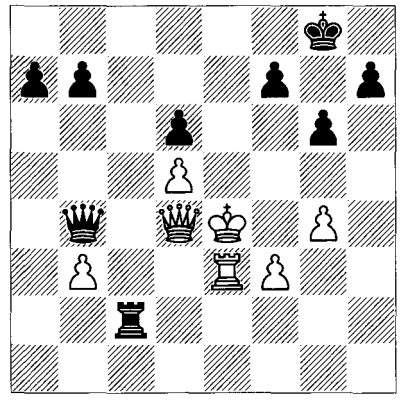
If the white rook were not defending the knight, both of White's minor pieces would be lost; make use of this fact!

13
B



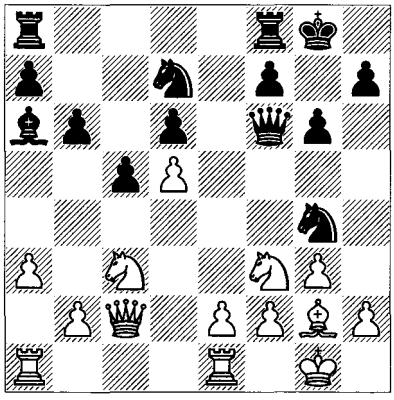
The white pieces are disorganized, but one of them is particularly vulnerable; can you highlight this by finding a winning move?

16
B



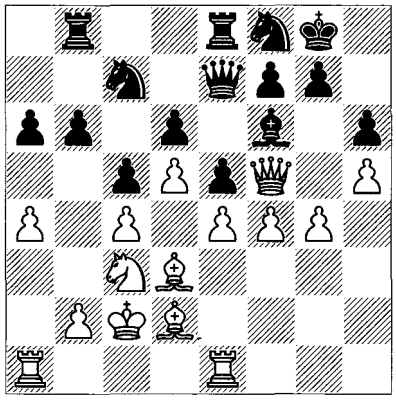
The white queen's defender is highly vulnerable, don't you think?

17
W



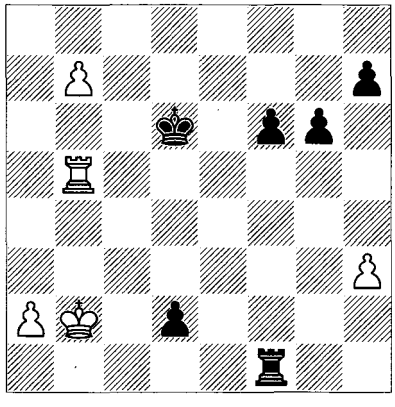
Is there an undefended black piece? And how about another one?

18
B



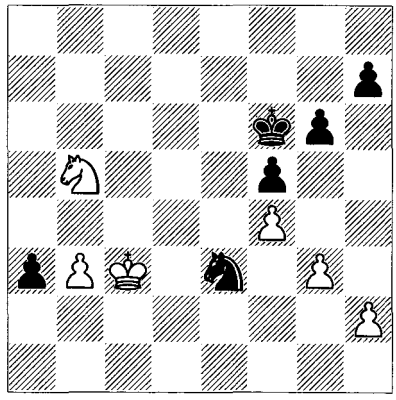
White's attacking force is small, and just as important as going forward is being able to retreat... What happens here?

19
B



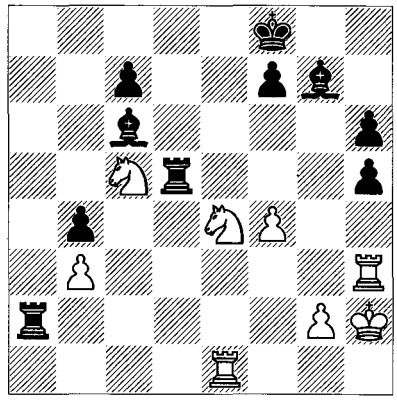
White threatens to win by queening with check. How can Black use this same idea to win the game himself?

20
B



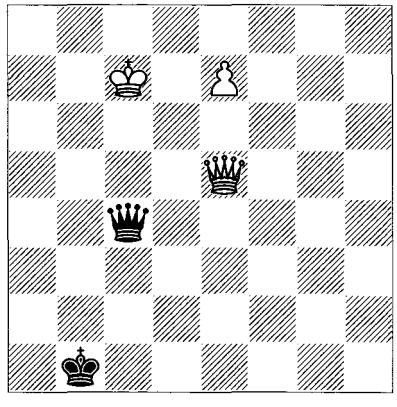
Here 61...a2 fails to 62 ♔b2; how can this defence be ruled out?

21
B



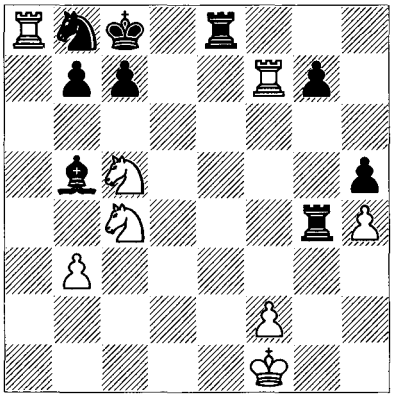
The concealed pressure of Black's c6-bishop against g2 can help Black win immediately. How?

22
W



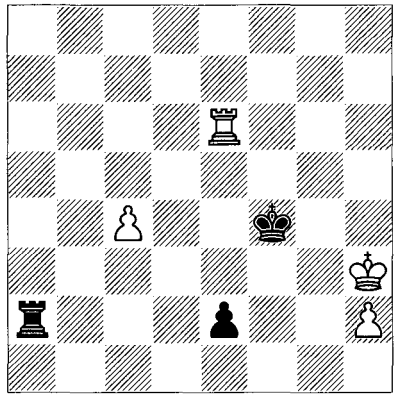
Black's defence is based on giving a barrage of checks. What is White's most accurate move to overcome this defence?

23
B



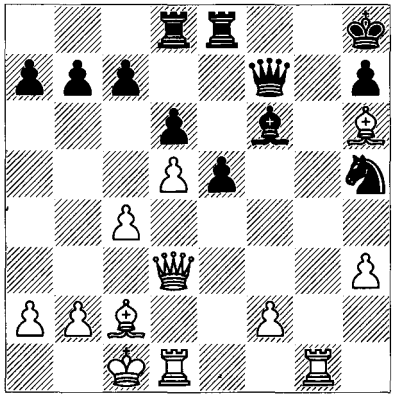
Here the f7-rook is undefended and Black can exploit this. How?

26
B



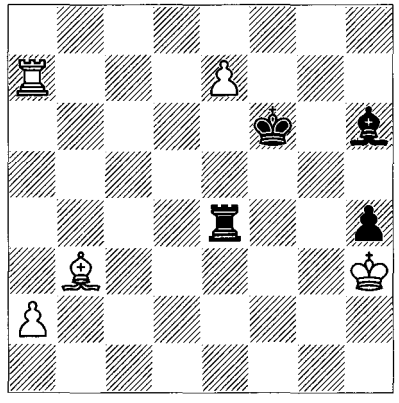
Here White's key defensive piece is his rook, which prevents the black pawn from queening. What can Black do about it?

24
W



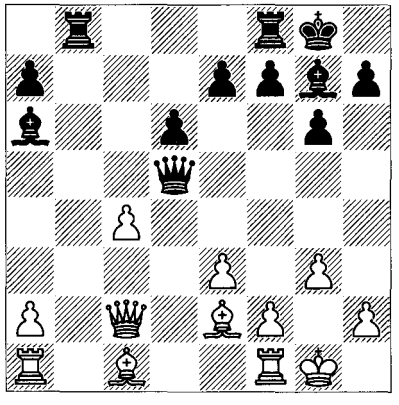
The only black piece parrying the deadly threat against h7 is the queen; how can this defence be eliminated?

27
W



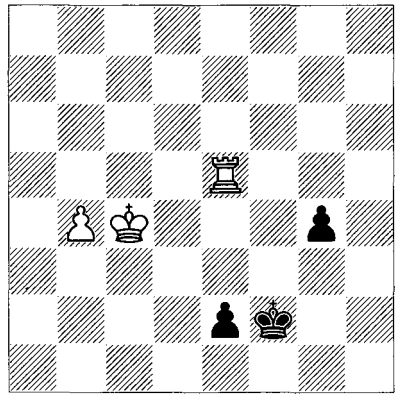
After the previous puzzle, this one is very easy, isn't it?

25
B



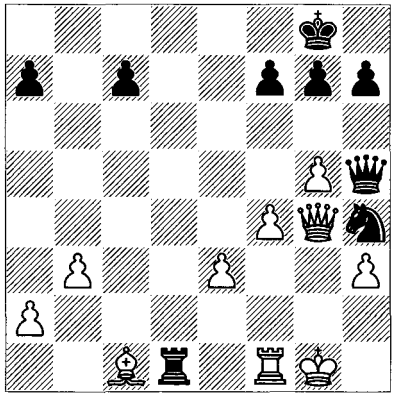
Decide how best to retreat the black queen, taking into account what White's next move will be.

28
W



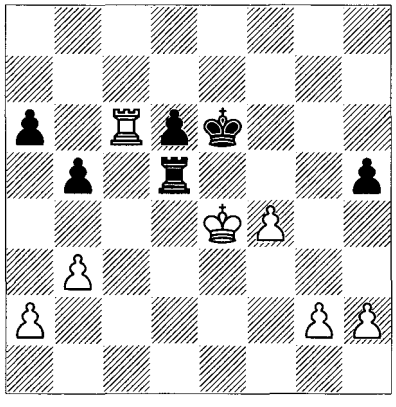
White contented himself with a draw by 64 b5?? e1♕ 65 ♖xe1 ½-½. What should he have played?

29
B



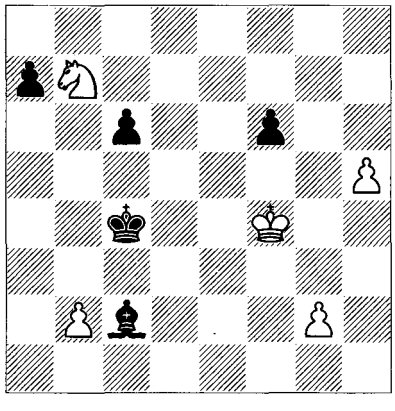
The white pieces appear to be well placed for defence, but Black has a manoeuvre to make the c1-bishop vulnerable. How?

30
W



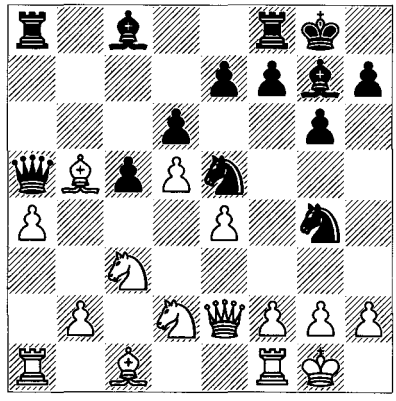
White can transform this rook ending into a winning pawn ending, thanks to his extra pawn. How?

31
W



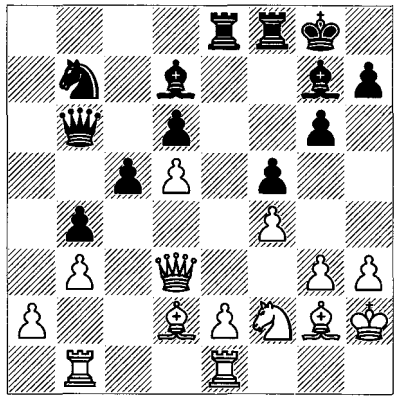
Here the c2-bishop is the only thing preventing the triumphal progress of White's h-pawn. How can it be neutralized?

32
W



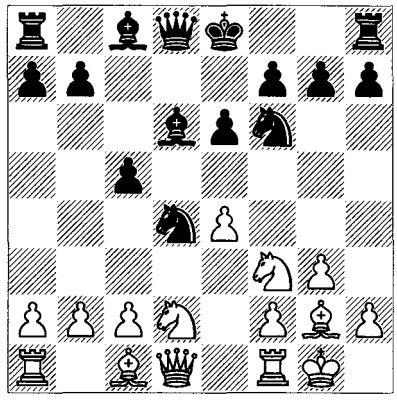
Black's minor pieces are active, but also... exposed.

33
B



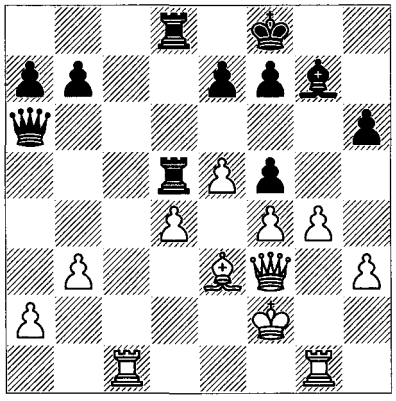
There is an undefended white piece, and to this we can add another advantage.

34
W



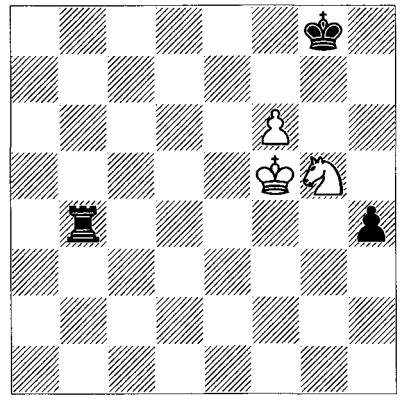
Is there some way of attacking two enemy pieces?

35
W



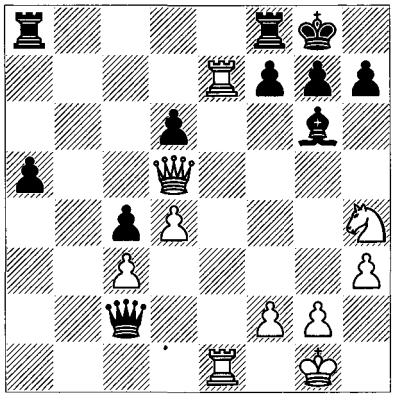
The black king is very cramped, but the d8-rook is standing guard...

38
B



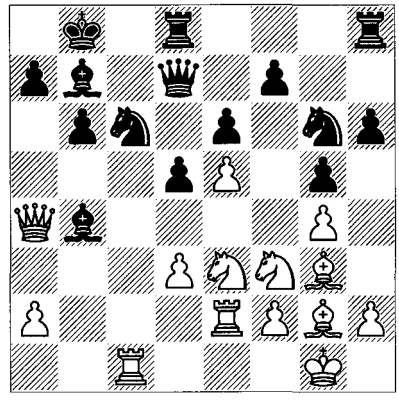
How can Black speed up the advance of the h-pawn?

36
W



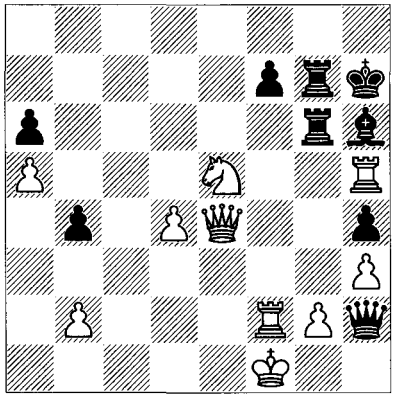
Here, as in the previous puzzle, Black's back rank is not well defended... How can this be demonstrated?

39
B



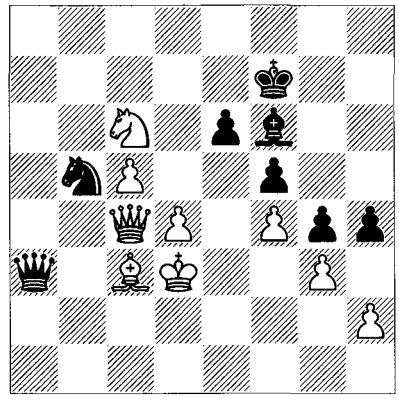
Loose pieces can bring serious problems, as here; how?

37
W



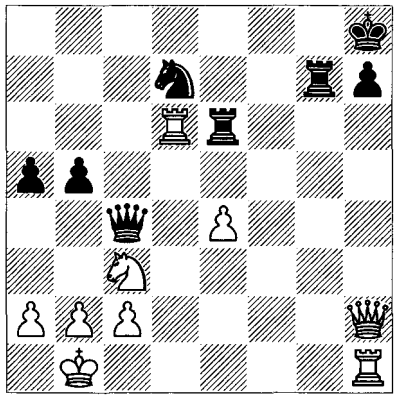
White has a winning advantage. What is the quickest way to conclude the game?

40
B



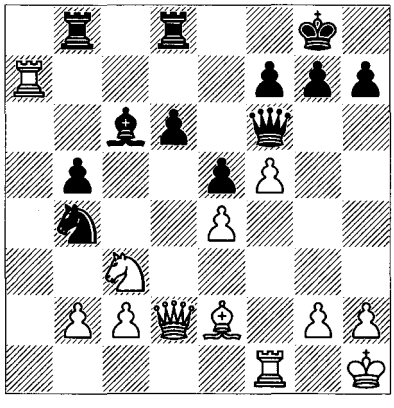
Once again there is an undefended piece; which is it?

41
W



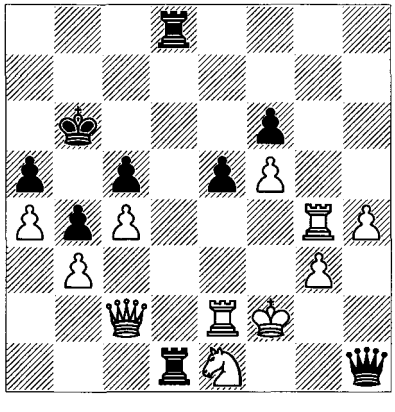
And here we can ask ourselves: what is defending the e6-rook?

42
W



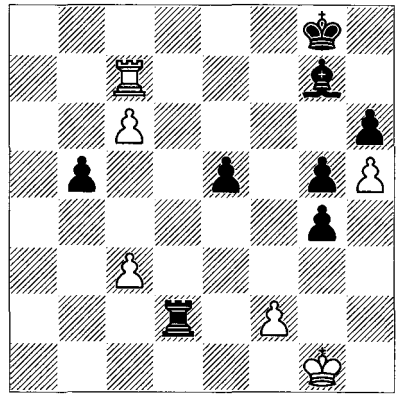
Black's knight has no safe move...

43
B



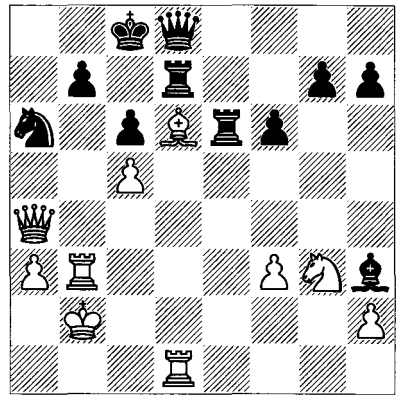
White is a piece up, but his position is very loose. What is defending the white queen?

44
W



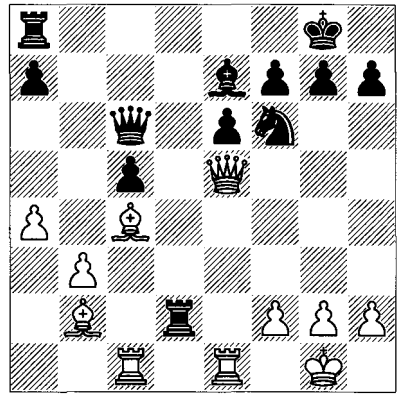
Here we have another passed pawn trying to queen...

45
W



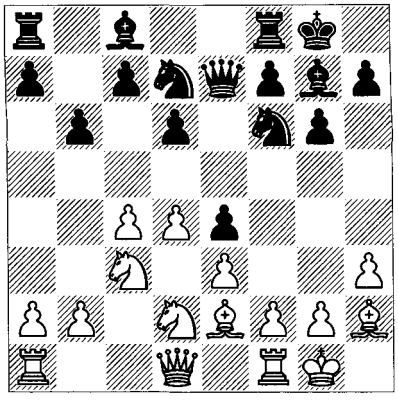
The black king is very cramped. How can this be exploited?

46
B



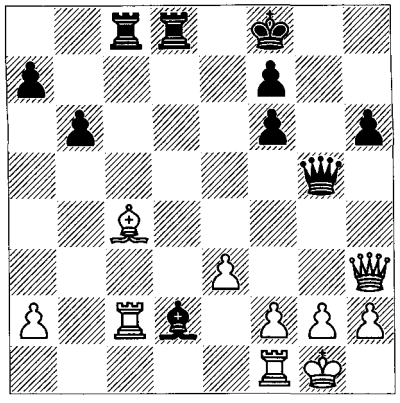
Black has an extra pawn, but the white pieces are active. How can Black win more material?

47
W



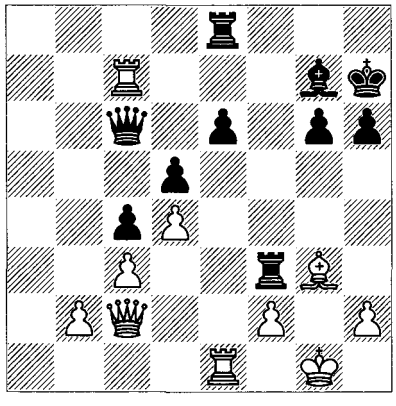
White played positionally with 12 b4. Can you find something better?

50
W



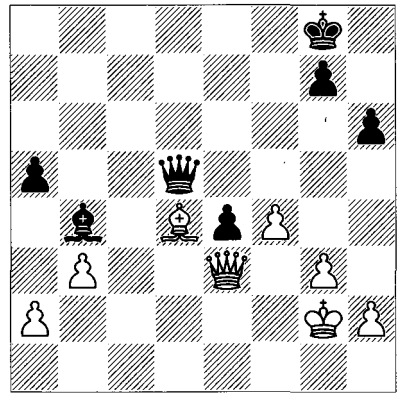
Black has one piece which is fatally overloaded. Which is it?

48
B



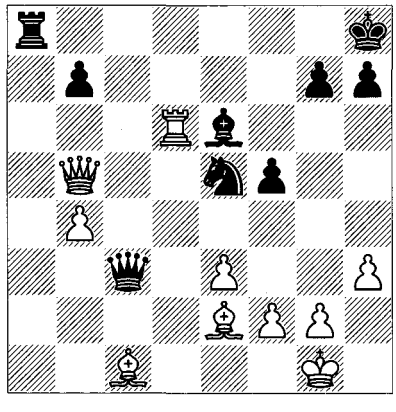
Black played 29...♕a6?, overlooking a much better move. Can you find it?

51
B



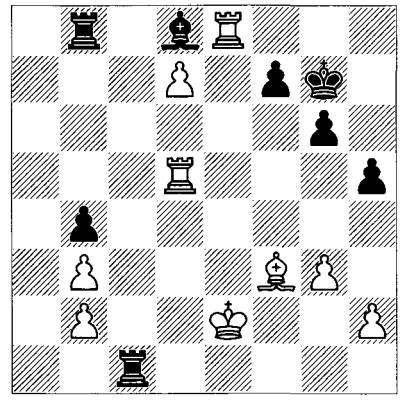
If only the e4-pawn could advance with discovered check!

49
W



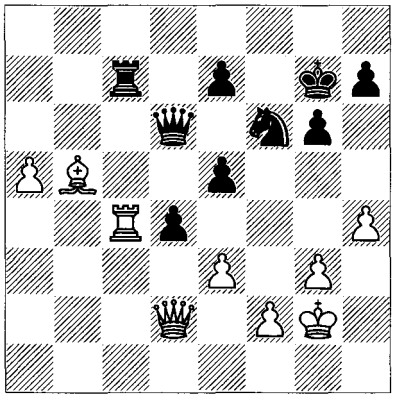
Both sides have loose pieces, but Black has an additional weakness.

52
W



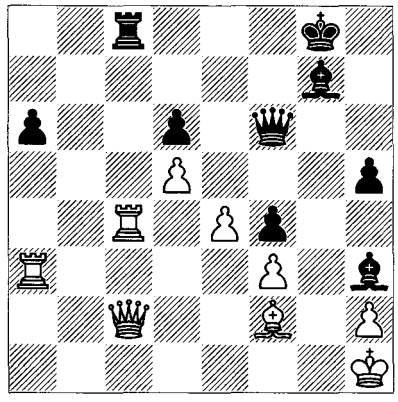
Here we have another passed pawn which is blocked at the moment...

53
B



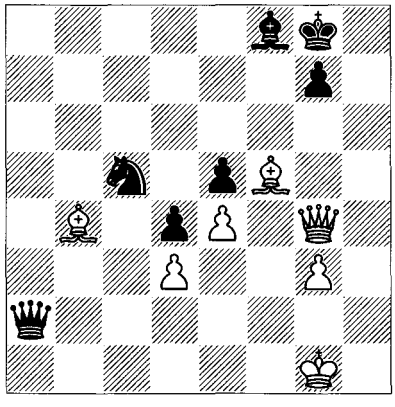
The white king is unwisely exposed to checks on the long diagonal. How can Black exploit this?

56
B



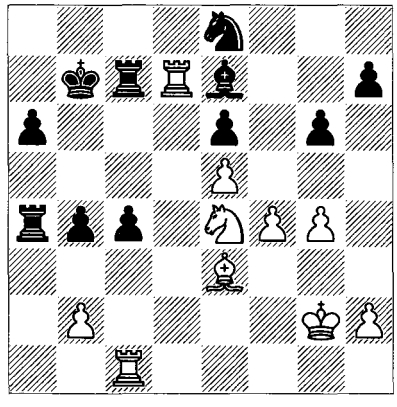
White has neglected his king and his back rank; how can Black take advantage?

54
W



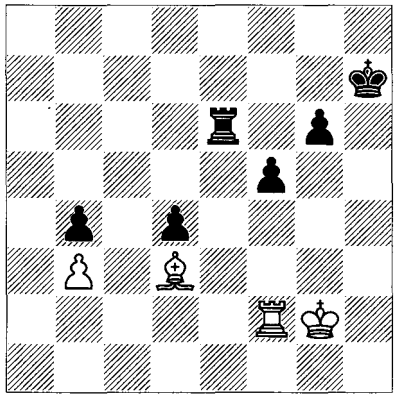
Black's queen is a long away from his king. How can White break through the black king's defences?

57
W



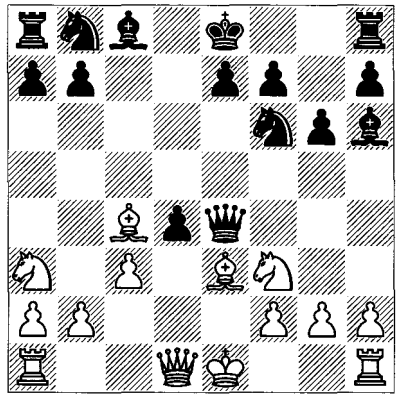
Here Black's tactical weakness is that his king and the undefended rook on a4 are in range of a knight fork.

55
W



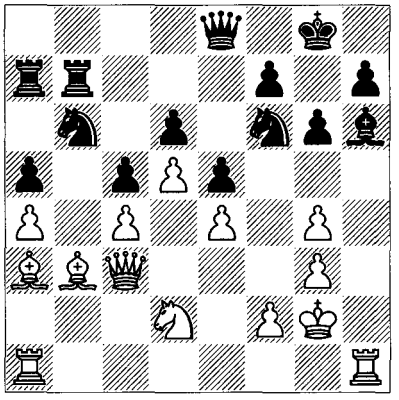
Black has three pawns for the bishop, but he also a serious tactical weakness. What is it, and how can White exploit it?

58
W



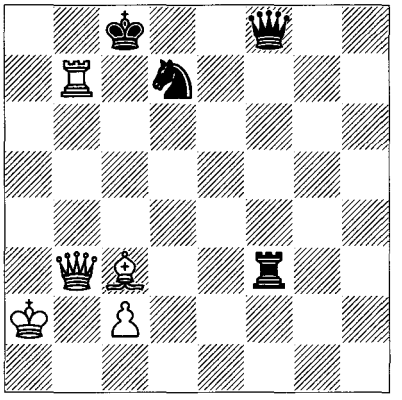
The h6-bishop is indirectly defended since the black queen pins the e3-bishop. How can White get out of this pin?

59
B



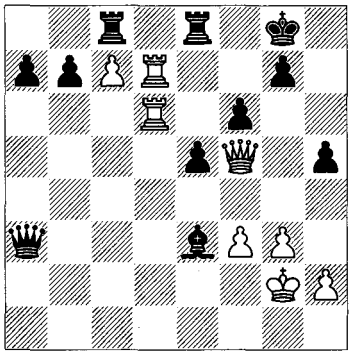
Here the overloaded piece is the white queen. How can Black demonstrate this?

60
W

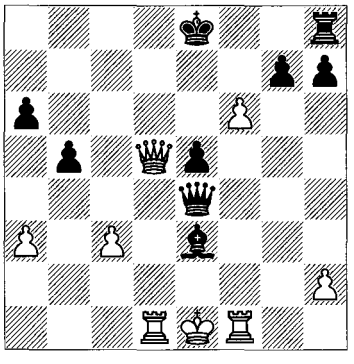


There are only a few pieces left, but it is always dangerous to have any vulnerable pieces. How can White show this?

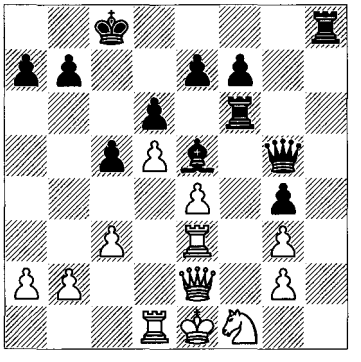
61
W



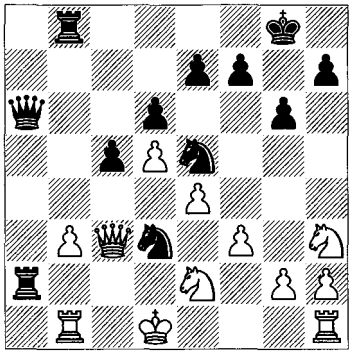
62
B



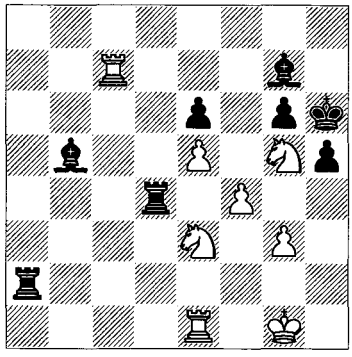
63
B



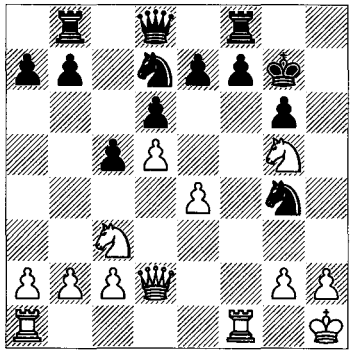
64
B



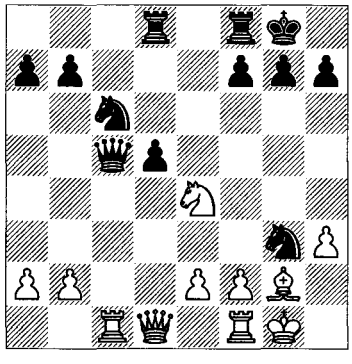
65
W



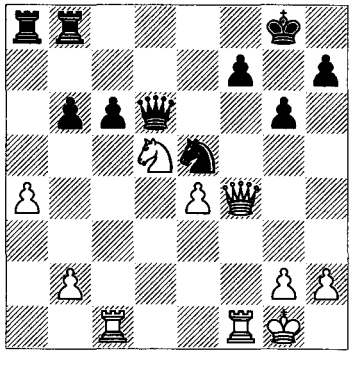
66
W



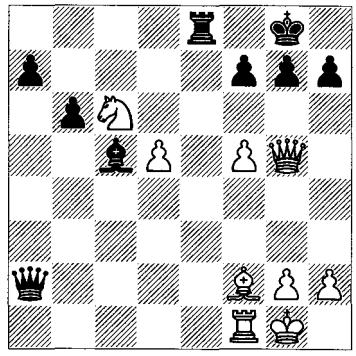
67
B



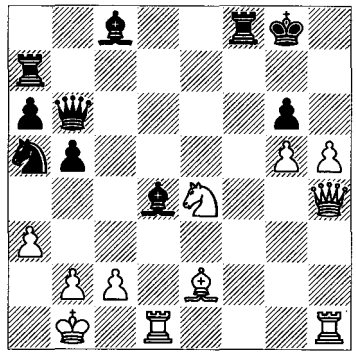
68
W



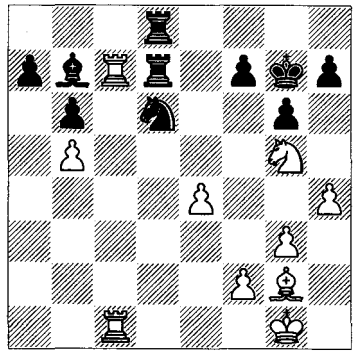
69
B



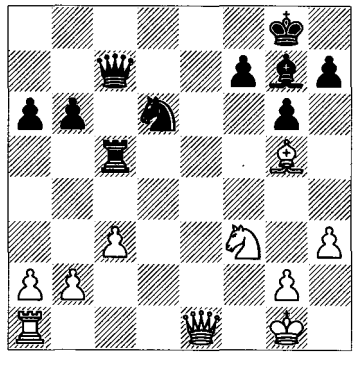
70
W



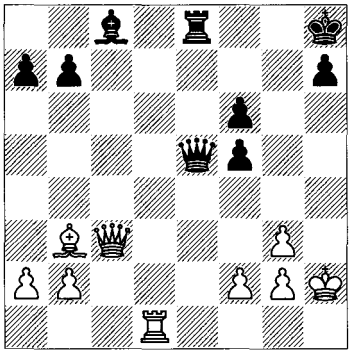
71
W



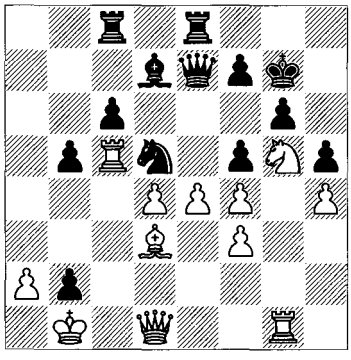
72
B



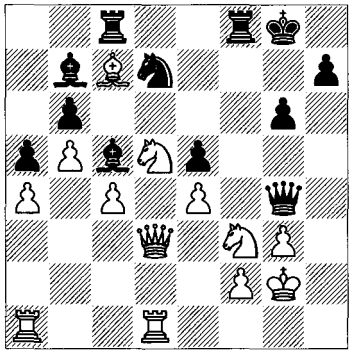
73
W



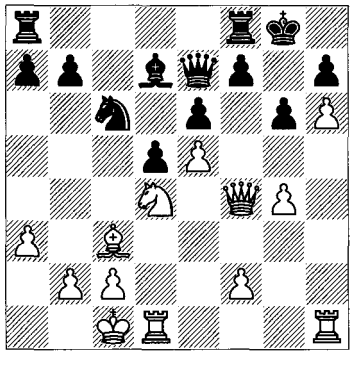
74
B



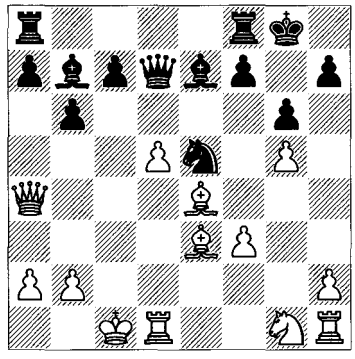
75
B



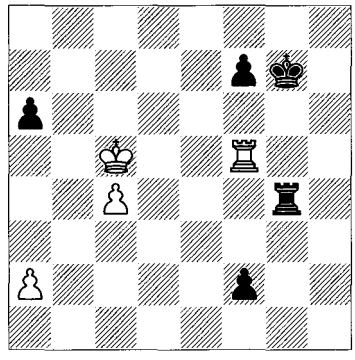
76
W



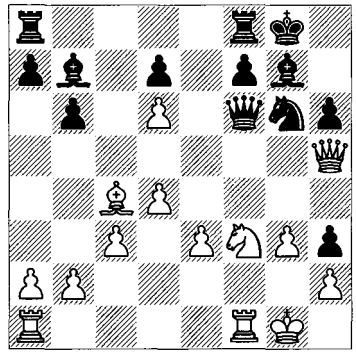
77
W



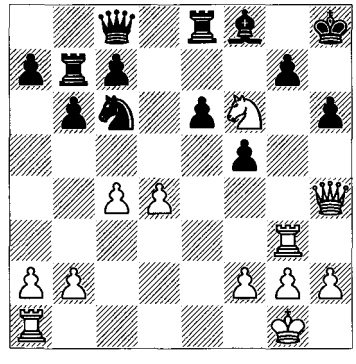
78
B



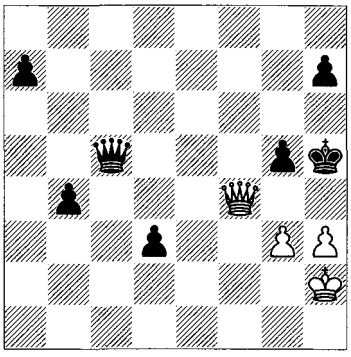
79
W



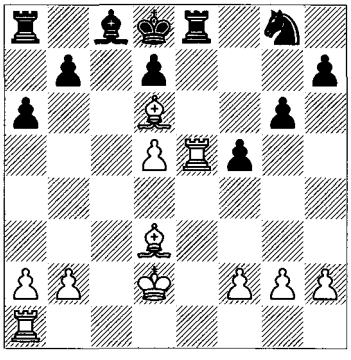
80
W



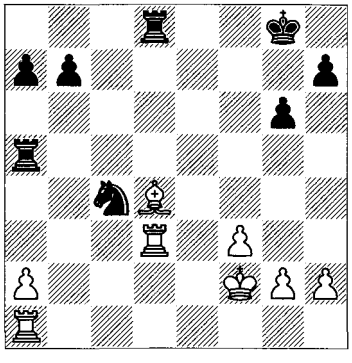
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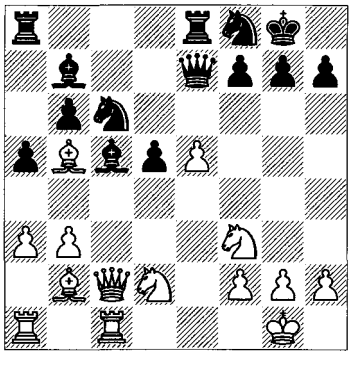
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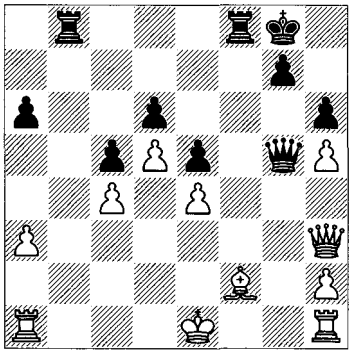
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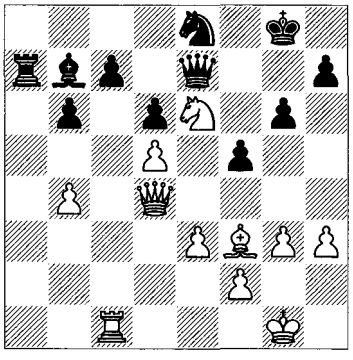
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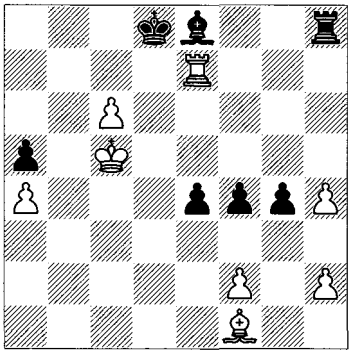
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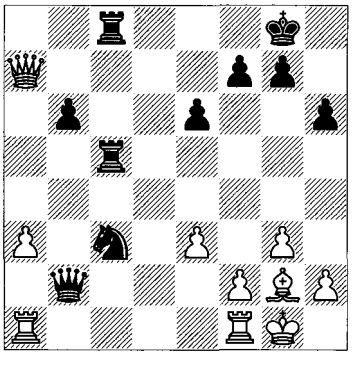
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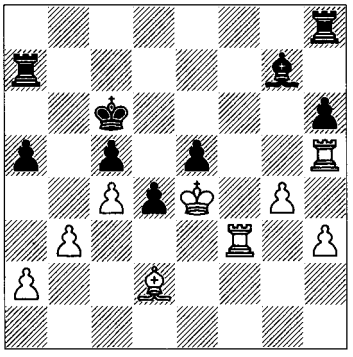
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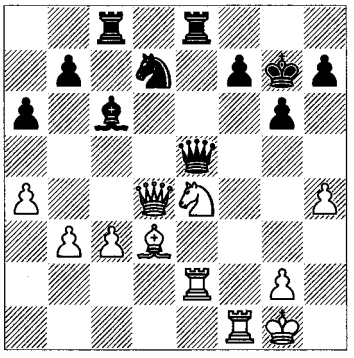
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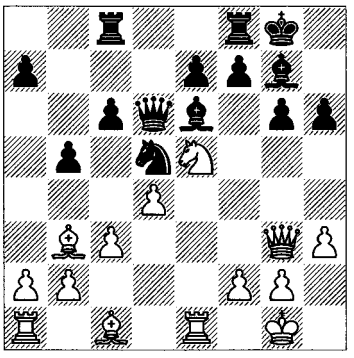
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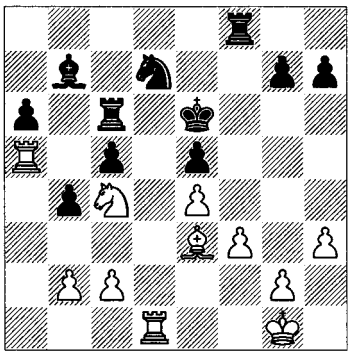
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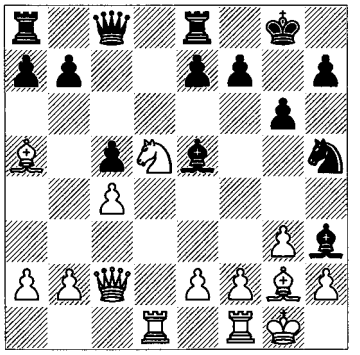
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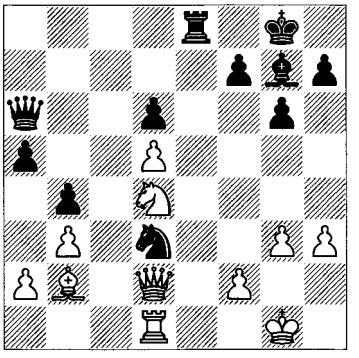
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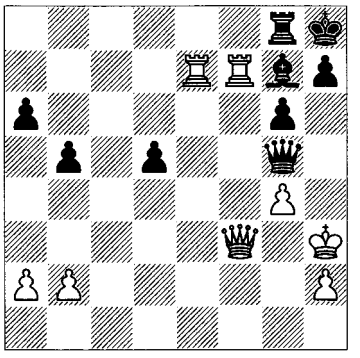
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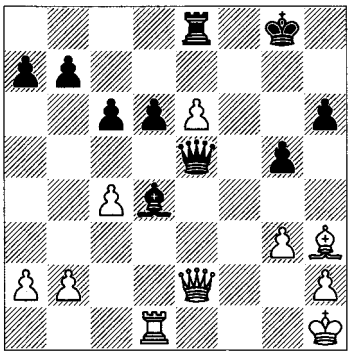
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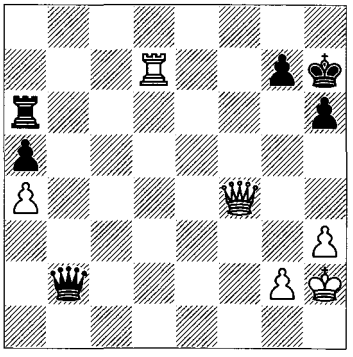
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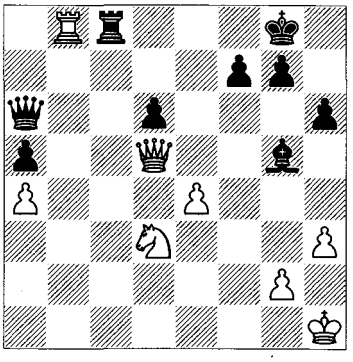
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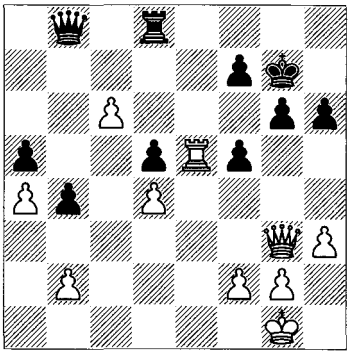
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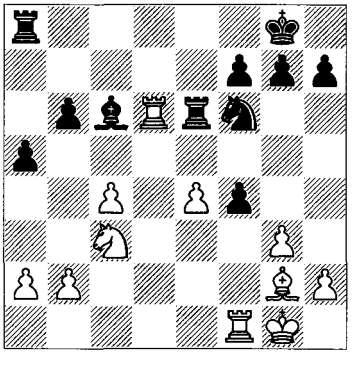
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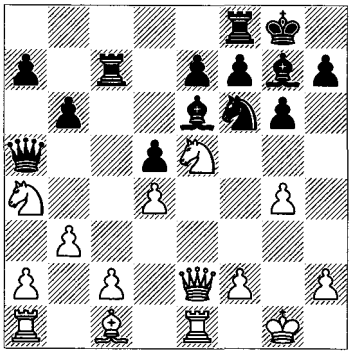
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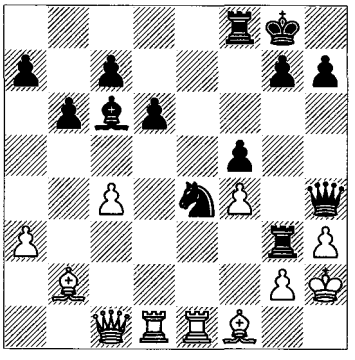
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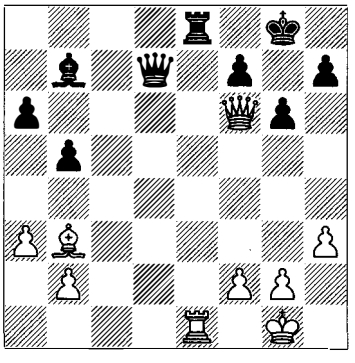
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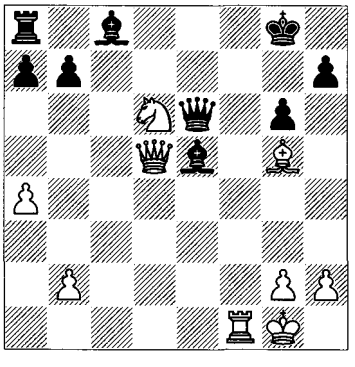
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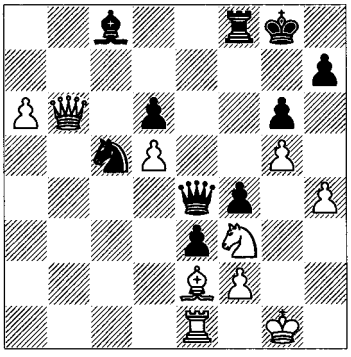
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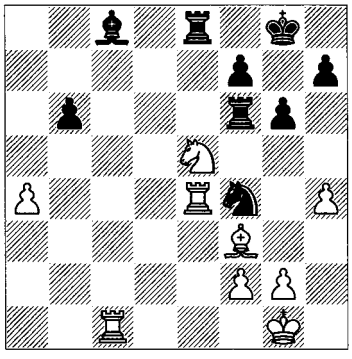
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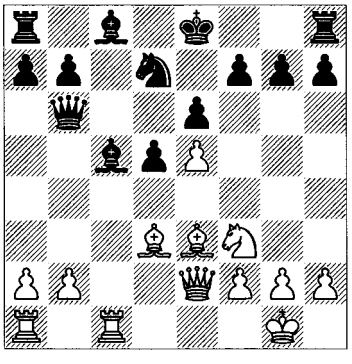
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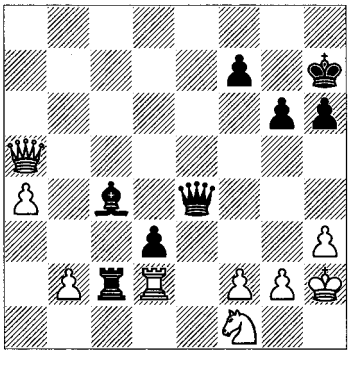
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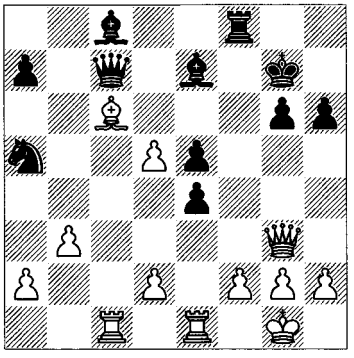
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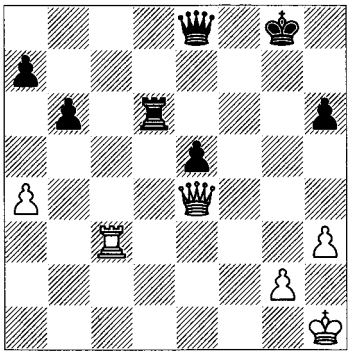
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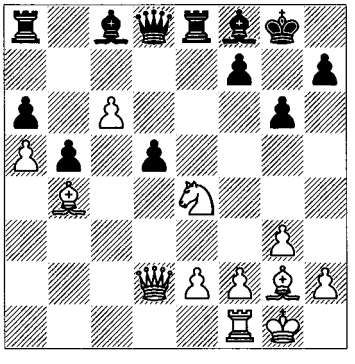
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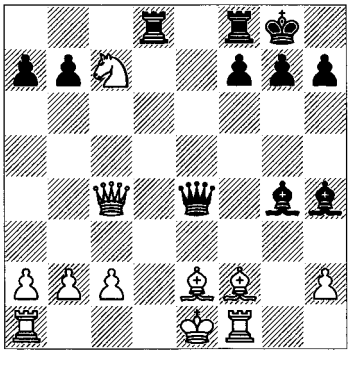
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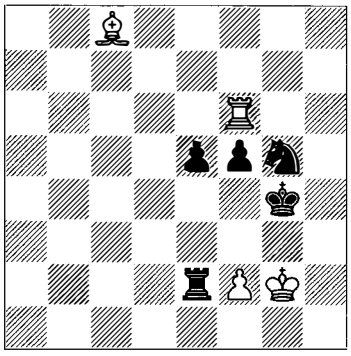
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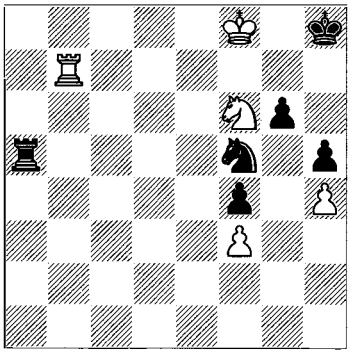
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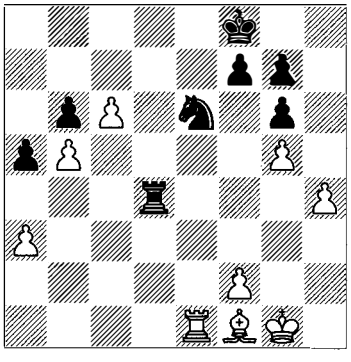
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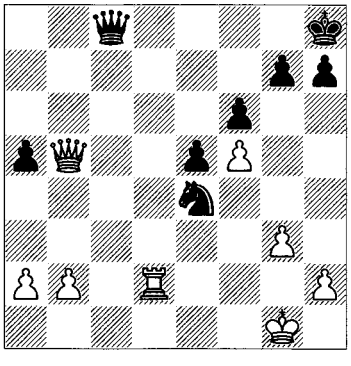
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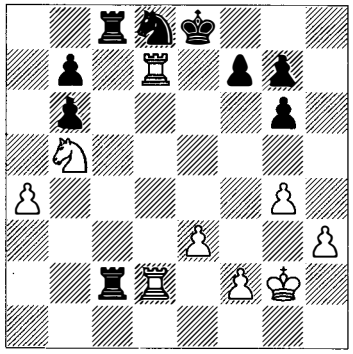
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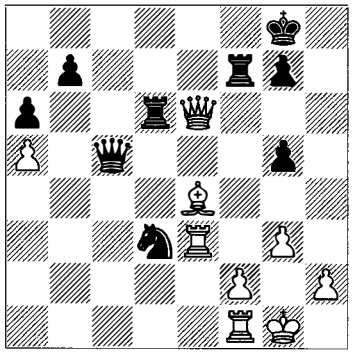
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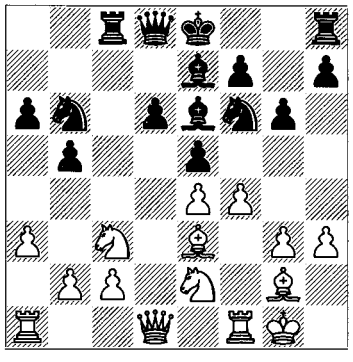
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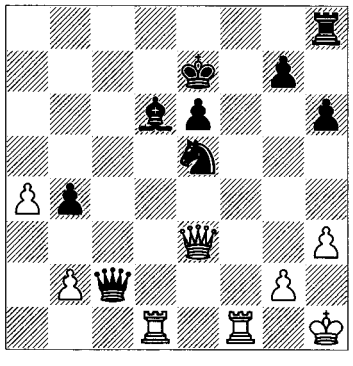
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Answers for Chapter 2

1) Iturrizaga – Kulakov
World Junior Ch, Gaziantep 2008
30 ♕d4+! 1-0
It is mate next move.

2) Čičak – Khruschov
Dresden Olympiad 2008
48 ♘f8! 1-0
There is no satisfactory defence against the twin threats to the queen and the king.

3) Sadvakasov – Molner
Philadelphia 2008
32...♘d3! 0-1
There is no reply to the threat of 33...♖e1+ and 34...♖c1#.

4) Vera – Gild. García
Matanzas 1992
24 ♗c5+! 1-0
And it is mate next move: 24...♖xc5 25 ♘g8#.

5) Janssen – Burmakin
Kavala 2008
57...♕g1! 0-1
The threat is 58...♕h1#, and 58 g4 fails to 58...hxg4+ 59 ♔h4 ♕g2.

6) De Ronde – Michel
Buenos Aires 1945
28...♕f2+ 0-1
It is mate after 29 ♔h1 ♖h6+ 30 ♗h3 ♖xh3#.

7) Pachman – Bielicki
Mar del Plata 1962
40...♘d4! 0-1
The threat of 41...♘c2# can only be prevented by giving up the bishop. 40...♘e3 41 ♗e2 ♘xg2+ 42 ♔f1 ♘f4 also works.

8) Ja. Bolbochán – Piazzini
Argentine Ch, Buenos Aires 1946
17...♗xh3! 0-1
This bishop is taboo, and now the threat is to give a devastating discovered check; here 18 ♕h5 fails to 18...♕xh5 19 ♘xh5 ♗g4.

9) D. Howell – Hebden
British Rapid Ch, Halifax 2008
58 ♗b6! 1-0
To be followed by 59 ♗c5+; 58 ♗c7! would also work.

10) García Vera – Grau
Rosario 1929
4...e5! 5 ♗e3
The point is that 5 ♗xe5 fails to 5...♕a5+ and 6...♕xe5.
5...exd4 6 ♗xd4 0-1

11) Lynch – Rauch
Buenos Aires 1945
59 ♖e5! (exchanging the rooks and simplifying the task) **59...♖xe5 60 fxe5 ♔e6 61 ♔e2 1-0**.

12) Eliskases – Ju. Bolbochán
Mar del Plata Zonal 1951
30...♕xe5! 0-1
Black wins a piece.

13) Cruz – Benko
Mar del Plata 1965
36...♘xe3!
This eliminates the defender of the d2-rook and thus wins material.

14) Palermo – Rossetto
Mar del Plata 1965
43...♖xb4! 0-1
Black wins a piece.

15) Balashov – Mecking
Hastings 1966/7
41...♗b4! 42 ♗xe2 (if 42 ♖xe2 White loses both his minor pieces) **42...♗xe1** and Black won with his material advantage.

16) Tan Lian Ann – Mecking
Manila Interzonal 1976
38...f5+! 0-1
Black wins the queen.

17) Franco – Sánchez Aller
Galician League 2007
16 ♕a4! 1-0
The queen attacks both the a6-bishop and the g4-knight, winning a piece.

18) Stamenković – Milos
São Paulo 2008
26...g6! 0-1
The white queen is trapped.

19) Bezemer – Landa
Vlissingen 2008
39...♖b1+! 40 ♔xb1 d1♕+ 0-1
If 41 ♔b2 then 41...♕e2+ and 42...♕xb5.

20) R. Schmidt – Ilinčić
Timisoara 2008
61...♘d1+! 0-1
The pawn queens.

21) Cebalo – Almasi
Reggio Emilia 2008/9
42...♖xc5! 0-1
If 43 ♘xc5 then 43...♖xg2+ 44 ♔h1 ♖e2+.

22) G. Jones – S. Grover
Hastings Masters 2008/9
84 ♔b6! 1-0
Now the only check, 84...♕b4+, fails to 85 ♕b5, exchanging the queens.

23) Suarez Real – Naiditsch
León (rapid) 2008
30...♖xc4! 0-1
Black wins a piece after 31 bxc4 ♗xc4+ 32 ♔g2 ♗xf7.

24) Maderna – Villegas
Mar del Plata 1943
23 ♗g7+! (cutting off the black queen from the defence of h7) **23...♕xg7 24 ♖xg7 1-0**.

25) Saadi – Fischer
Mar del Plata 1960
17...♕b7! (preventing the only move for White that would not lose material, i.e. 18 ♖b1) **18 ♗a3 ♗xa1** and Black won.

26) Wang Li – Wang Hao
Chinese Team Ch, Wuxi 2008
56...♖a3+! 57 ♔g2 ♖e3! 0-1
Black's passed pawn wins.

27) Vokarev – Benza
Nezhmetdinov Memorial, Kazan 2008
The passed pawn queens after **53 ♖a6+! ♔g7** (if 53...♔xe7 then 54 ♖xh6) **54 ♖e6! 1-0**.

28) Wang Yue – L. Domínguez
Sofia 2009
White can win with the manoeuvre **64 ♔d3!** e1♕ 65 ♖xe1 ♔xe1 66 ♔e3! ♔f1 67 ♔f4.

29) I. Fernández – Mazzoleni
Villa Gesell 1971
Black wins material by cutting off the c1-bishop from its defender:
29...♘f3+! 30 ♔g2
Worse is 30 ♔f2? ♖xf1+ 31 ♔xf1 ♘h2+.
30...♘e1+ 31 ♖xe1
If the king moves then 31...♕xg4(+) and 32...♖xc1.
31...♕xg4+ 32 hxg4 ♖xe1 0-1

30) Gdanski – Dziuba
Najdorf Memorial, Warsaw 2008
44 f5+! 1-0
The pawn ending is an easy win after the forced continuation 44...♖xf5 45 ♖xd6+ ♔xd6 46 ♔xf5.

31) Chirila – Ilinčić
Timisoara 2008
The white knight blocks the bishop and the pawn queens after **53 ♘d6+! ♔d5 54 ♘f5 1-0**. If 54...♔e6 then 55 ♘d4+.

32) Matamoros – Sánchez Sotomayor
Seville 2007
White won material with **14 f4!**, as 14...♘d7 is met by 15 ♕xg4.

33) R. Molina – Valerga
Villa Martelli 2008
26...c4! 27 ♕f3
If 27 bxc4 then 27...♕xf2, but now the passed pawn wins material by force.
27...c3 28 ♗c1 c2 0-1

34) Belezky – Suriol
Seville 2008
9 e5! 1-0
After 9...♘xf3+ 10 ♘xf3 the e5-pawn is still defended and White wins a piece.

35) Timoshenko – C. Foisor
Cappelle la Grande 2008
25 ♕xd5! 1-0
White wins a rook since if 25...♖xd5 then 26 ♖c8+ mates.

36) Fressinet – Macieja
European Ch, Plovdiv 2008
24 ♕xa8! 1-0
The queen is taboo, since 24...♖xa8 allows 25 ♖e8+ ♖xe8 26 ♖xe8#.

37) Agrest – Ax. Smith
Malmö 2008
42 ♖xh6+! ♔xh6 43 ♕xh4# (1-0)

38) Navara – Kramnik
Rapid match (game 2), Prague 2008
61...♖b5+ 62 ♔g6 ♖xg5+! 0-1
The black pawn queens.

39) Berczes – P. Prohaszka
Budapest 2008
20...♘d4! 0-1
Winning the exchange, since 21 ♕xd7? fails to 21...♘xe2+.

40) Sulashvili – Svetushkin
Kavala 2008
54...♘xc3! 0-1
55 ♕xc3 is met by 55...♕a6+ and 56...♕xc6.

41) Baramidze – Enchev
World Junior Ch, Gaziantep 2008
30 b3! (deflecting the queen and winning the exchange) **30...♕xc3 31 ♖xe6 ♘f6 32 ♕e5 1-0**.

42) Palac – Mogranzini
Trieste 2008
28 ♘d1! 1-0
The b4-knight is lost. 28 ♘bl has a similar idea, but is less accurate.

43) Grecescu – Nevednichy
Romanian League, Eforie Nord 2008
92...♖xe1! 93 ♖g6
93 ♖xel loses to 93...♕h2+.
93...♖f1+ 0-1
94 ♔e3 ♕f3#.

44) Akopian – G. Georgadze
Spanish Team Ch, Cala Mayor 2008
34 ♖xg7+! 1-0
The pawn queens after 34...♔xg7 35 c7. Note that 34 ♖b7? ♖c2 35 c7 ♖xc3 does not win.

45) Córdova – Shulman
Mérida 2008
37 ♕xa6! 1-0
Now 37...bxa6 loses to 38 ♖b8#.

46) R. Leyva – Franco
Capablanca Memorial, Cienfuegos 1997
20...♖xf2! 21 ♗f1 (not 21 ♔xf2? ♘g4+) **21...h6** and Black won.

47) R. Szmetan – Nakamura
Buenos Aires 2003
Instead of **12 b4?** White could win a pawn with **12 ♘dxe4!** (or **12 ♘cxe4!**) 12...♘xe4 13 ♘xe4, since 13...♕xe4? is met by 14 ♗f3.

48) Vallejo – Herraiz
Spanish Ch, León 2006
Instead of **29...♕a6?** Black could continue **29...♖xg3+!**, winning on the spot.

49) M. Bach – H. Schulz
Hamburg 2007
28 ♖xe6! h6
After 28...♕xc1+ 29 ♗fl there is no satisfactory defence against the double threat of 30 ♖xe5 and 30 ♖e8+, mating; e.g., 29...♘g6 30 ♖e8+, or 29...♘c6 30 ♕xb7.
29 ♕xe5 ♕xc1+ 30 ♔h2 1-0

50) Tregubov – Drozdovsky
Odessa 2008
21 ♖xd2! (winning a piece) **21...♖xd2 22 ♕xc8+** and White won.

51) Fedorchuk – A. Kovaliov
Conegliano 2008
47...♗d2! 0-1
If 48 ♕g1 then 48...e3+ and 49...♕xd4 wins.

52) Nisipeanu – Van Wely
Foros 2008
38 ♖b5! (eliminating the defender of the piece blocking the passed pawn's advance) **38...♖xb5 39 ♖xd8 ♖c2+ 40 ♔d3 ♖xb2 41 ♖c8** (and the pawn queens) **41...♖xb3+ 42 ♔c4 1-0**.

53) V. Elianov – Evdokimov
Elsinore 2008
33...♖xc4! (**33...♕d5+!** 34 ♔g1 ♖xc4 also works) **34 ♗xc4 ♕c6+ 35 ♔g1 ♕xc4 0-1**.

54) Joh. Gomez – Jay. Gonzales
Philippines Ch, Mandaluyong 2008
44 ♗xc5!
It is impossible to defend against the attack by White's two remaining pieces.
44...♕b1+ 45 ♔g2 ♕c2+ 46 ♔h3 ♗xc5
The resource 46...♕c1? fails to 47 ♗e6+ ♔h7 48 ♕h4+.

47 ♗e6+ ♔f8 48 ♕f5+ 1-0
It is mate: 48...♔e7 49 ♕f7+ ♔d6 50 ♕d7#.

55) González Vidal – Czakon
Barberá del Valles 2008
43 ♖xf5! 1-0
There is no prospect of defence with only two pawns for the bishop, but after 43...gxf5 44 ♗xf5+ ♖g6+ 45 ♔f3! ♔g7 45 ♗xg6 ♔xg6 46 ♔e4, White wins the pawn ending.

56) Ionescu – Oleksienko
Romanian League, Eforie Nord 2008
34...♖xc4!
First the white queen is deflected from the defence.
35 ♕xc4 ♕g5! 0-1
There is no good answer to the threat of 36...♕g2#.

57) F. Peralta – Steingrimsson
Dresden Olympiad 2008
31 ♖xe7! (eliminating both defenders of the c5-square) **31...♖xe7 32 ♘c5+ ♔c6 33 ♘xa4 ♔b5 34 ♘c5**, and White won.

58) Benjamin – Christiansen
Internet 2008
9 ♗d3! ♕xd3 (the queen can't stay on the e-file; if 9...♕e6 then 10 ♘xd4 ♕e5 11 ♘c4) **10 ♕xd3** and White won.

59) Inarkiev – Kasimdzhanov
FIDE Grand Prix, Elista 2008
40...♘bxd5! 41 cxd5 ♗xd2 42 ♕d3 (or 42 ♕xd2 ♖xb3) **42...♗g5** with an extra pawn.

60) Leko – Gashimov
FIDE Grand Prix, Elista 2008
52 ♖xd7! ♔xd7 53 ♕b7+ (the black rook is lost, with an easy win for White) **53...♔e6 54 ♕c6+ ♕d6 55 ♕xf3 ♕a6+ 56 ♔b1 ♕b6+ 57 ♗b2 1-0**.

61) Falcón – Montiel
Argentine Ch, Buenos Aires 1946
34 ♖xg7+! (this leads to a forced mate) **34...♔xg7 35 ♕xf6+ ♔g8 36 ♕g6+ ♔h8 37 ♕xh5+ ♔g7 38 ♖g6+ ♔f8 39 ♕h8+ 1-0**.

62) Grinberg – Franco
Buenos Aires 1975
38...♗d2++! (an unusual way to obstruct the protection of the white queen) **39 ♔xd2 ♕xd5+ 40 ♔c1 ♕b3 0-1**.

63) Franco – Casas
Mercedes 1975
29...♖xf1+! 0-1
Black wins material after 30 ♔xf1 ♖h1+ 31 ♔f2 ♕f6+!.

64) Stull – Franco
Haifa Olympiad 1976
23...♘f2+! 0-1
Winning a piece, and gaining a decisive attack after 24 ♘xf2 ♕xe2+ 25 ♔c1 ♕xf2.

65) Franco – Øgaard
Haifa Olympiad 1976
44 ♖xg7! 1-0
If 44...♔xg7 then 45 ♘xe6+ and 46 ♘xd4, winning.

66) Vera – Dür
World Junior Ch, Innsbruck 1977
19 ♖xf7+! ♖xf7 20 ♘e6+ 1-0

67) Nogueiras – Vera
Havana 1982
17...♕xc1! 0-1
18 ♕xc1 ♘xe2+ leaves Black with a great advantage in material.

68) Najdorf – Denker
Staunton Memorial, Groningen 1996
23 ♖xc6! 1-0
Winning the knight, since 23...♕xc6 fails to 24 ♘e7+.

69) Franco – Granda
Spanish Team Ch, Ponferrada 1997
36...♕xf2+! 0-1
37 ♖xf2 ♖e1#.

70) Vallejo – Romero
Spanish Ch, Linares 1998
28 ♖xd4! 1-0
If 28...♕xd4 then 29 ♘f6+ wins.

71) Franco – González Bernal
Llucmajor 2000
31 ♗h3! ♖xc7 32 ♖xc7 ♗xe4? (or 32...♗c8 33 ♘xf7! ♘xf7 34 ♗xc8) **33 ♘e6+ 1-0**.

72) A. Needleman – Franco
Mar del Plata 2001
26...♖xg5! 27 ♘xg5 ♕c5+ 28 ♕f2 ♕xg5 29 ♕xb6 ♗e5 and Black won.

73) Estremera – Geenen
Genoa 2004
42 ♖e1! 1-0
42...♕xe1 allows 43 ♕xf6#, while 42...♕xc3 is met by 43 ♖xe8+ ♔g7 44 bxc3.

74) Miladinović – Estremera
Genoa 2004
30...♕xc5! 31 exd5 (or 31 dxc5 ♘c3+) **31...♕xd5 32 ♗c2 c5** with a winning advantage.

75) Kroencke – Albers
Hamburg 2007
30...♖xc7! wins a piece, since if 31 ♘xc7 then 31...♗xe4 is deadly.

76) Atri – Albers
Hamburg 2007
22 ♘xc6! ♗xc6 (or 22...bxc6 23 ♗b4 c5 24 ♗xc5! ♕xc5? 25 ♕f6, winning on the spot) **23 ♗b4 1-0**.

77) Faika – Kroencke
Hamburg 2007
18 ♕xd7! ♘xd7 19 d6! (winning a piece) **19...cxd6 20 ♗xb7 1-0**.

78) Zierke – Pajeken
Hamburg 2007
53...♖g5! 0-1
After 54 ♖xg5+ ♔f6 the pawn queens.

79) Cámpora – Mena
Seville 2007
21 ♘h4! (winning material) **21...♕xd6 22 ♘xg6 1-0**.

80) Karpov – Stojanović
Valjevo 2007
24 ♕xh6+! gxh6 25 ♖g8# (1-0)

81) D. Adams – Churm
British League (4NCL) 2008/9
52 ♕f7+! ♔h6 53 ♕f6+ ♔h5 54 g4+ (mating) **1-0**.

82) Mirzoev – Redondo
Spain 2008
19 ♗c7+! ♔xc7 20 ♖xe8 and White wins. The simple 19 ♖ae1 is also decisive.

83) Ferrer García – Barriá
Seville 2008
29...♖ad5! 0-1
There is no answer to the pin.

84) S. Kasparov – Abatino
Cutro 2008
17 ♗xc6! ♗xc6 18 b4 wins a piece.

85) Babu – Abdulla
Mumbai 2008
25...♖xf2!
26 ♔xf2 ♖b2+ 27 ♔f1 ♕f4+ mates.

86) Timman – Guliev
Baku 2008
31 ♘xc7!
If 31...♘xc7, then 32 ♕xb6 wins.

87) Navara – Kramnik
Rapid match (game 8), Prague 2008
41 c7+! (and the pawn queens) **1-0**.

88) Liascovich – Ricardi
Argentine Ch, Mendoza 2008
23...♘e2+ 24 ♔h1 ♘c1! (cutting off the a1-rook from its defender and thus winning the exchange) **25 ♗b7 ♕xa1 0-1**.

89) Mahía – Salguero
Argentine Ch, Mendoza 2008
46 ♗xh6! ♗xh6 47 ♖f6+ ♔b7 48 ♖hxh6 (with a won ending, but the struggle comes to a quick end after a crude blunder by Black) **48...♖aa8? 49 ♖f7+ ♔b8 50 ♖xh8# (1-0)**.

90) Cherin – Tomio
Conegliano 2008
28 ♖xf7+! ♔g8 (28...♔xf7 29 ♘d6+) **29 ♖xd7 ♗xe4 30 ♖xe4 1-0**.

91) Luch – Bozzali
Conegliano 2008
16 ♘xg6! (winning a pawn, and then another) **16...♕xg3 17 fxg3 fxg6 18 ♖xe6 ♔h7 19 ♗xd5 cxd5 20 ♖xe7** with two extra pawns.

92) Rombaldoni – Scalcione
Conegliano 2008
27 ♖xd7! ♔xd7 28 ♘xe5+ 1-0

93) Zablotsky – Gubazhdullin
Nezhmetdinov Memorial, Kazan 2008
16 ♘xe7+! ♖xe7 17 ♖d8+ ♕xd8 18 ♗xd8 1-0

94) Arsović – Markus
Serbia Cup, Zlatibor 2008
25...♘xb2 26 ♕xb2 ♖e4! wins material.

95) E. Berg – P. Carlsson
Swedish Ch, Växjö 2008
33 ♖xg7! ♖xg7 (33...♕h6+ 34 ♔g3 ♕xg7 35 ♖xg7 ♔xg7 loses to 36 ♕c3+ ♔f7 37 ♕c7+ ♔f8 38 ♕xh7) **34 ♖e8+** (followed by 35 ♕c3+) **1-0**.

96) Jay. Gonzales – Sadorra
Philippines Ch, Mandaluyong 2008
26 ♕d3! with a winning position after this double attack.

97) Baklan – Striković
Benasque 2008
51 ♕e4+! ♖g6
If 51...♔g8 then 52 ♕c4+ is one way to win.
52 ♖d6 1-0
After 52...♕xg2+ 53 ♕xg2 ♖xd6 54 ♕c2+ ♔g8 55 ♕c8+ ♔f7 56 ♕f5+ ♖f6 57 ♕xa5 further resistance is impossible.

98) Willemze – Krivoruchko
Greek Team Ch, Kallithea 2008
47 ♕b5! (deflecting Black's queen away from the rook) **47...♖xb8** (if 47...♕xb5 then 48 ♖xc8+ ♔h7 49 axb5 wins) **48 ♕xa6 1-0**.

99) Ivanisević – Managadze
Greek Team Ch, Kallithea 2008
33 ♖xd5! ♕b6
The pawn is unstoppable after 33...♕xg3 34 fxg3 ♖xd5 (34...♖c8 35 ♖c5 is hopeless) 35 c7.
34 ♕e5+ 1-0

100) Miroshnichenko – Harikrishna
Greek Team Ch, Kallithea 2008
20 ♖xc6! ♖xc6 21 e5 (regaining the sacrificed material with interest) **21...♖ac8 22 ♗xc6 ♖xc6 23 exf6**.

101) F. Ladrón de Guevara – Salgado
Padrón 2008
17...♖xc2! (exploiting the overloaded white queen) **18 ♕f1 ♘xg4 0-1**.

102) A. Graf – Meijers
Kavala 2008
32...♖xh3+! 0-1
33 gxh3 ♕g3+ 34 ♔h1 ♘f2#.

103) Pozin – Simacek
Olomouc 2008
30 ♕xf7+! 1-0
30...♕xf7 31 ♖xe8+ ♔g7 32 ♗xf7.

104) Dziuba – Panocki
Najdorf Memorial, Warsaw 2008
26 ♘xc8! 1-0
26...♕xd5 27 ♘e7+.

105) Malakhov – Topalov
Villarrobledo (rapid) 2008
45...♗xa6! (the e2-bishop is overloaded) **46 ♘h2** (or 46 ♕b2 ♕f5 47 ♗xa6 ♕g4+ 48 ♔h2 ♕xf3 threatening both 49...♘xa6 and 49...exf2) **46...exf2+ 47 ♔xf2 ♕e3+ 48 ♔f1 ♕h3+ 0-1**.

106) Malakhov – Pérez Candelario
Villarrobledo (rapid) 2008
33 ♘g4! ♗xg4 (33...♖fe6 is answered by 34 ♖xf4 or 34 ♘f6+! ♔f8 35 ♖xf4) **34 ♖xe8+ 1-0**.

107) Kravtsiv – Stupak
World Junior Ch, Gaziantep 2008
17 ♖xc5! ♘xc5 18 ♕c2 gaining a decisive material advantage.

108) Zhigalko – Melkumian
World Junior Ch, Gaziantep 2008
40...♕e1! 41 ♖xc2
If 41 ♔g1? then amongst other things Black can win by 41...♕xf1+!.
41...♕xa5 42 ♖xc4 ♕e1 43 ♘e3 ♕xf2 44 ♘g4 ♕b6
Black's passed pawn makes much further resistance futile; the continuation was:
45 ♖f4 ♕b8 46 g3 ♕xb2+ 47 ♖f2 d2 48 ♘e3 ♕b3 0-1

109) Li Chao – Irwanto
Kuala Lumpur 2008
24 ♗e8! ♕d6
Black has to defend g6, since 24...♕d8 loses to 25 ♕xg6+ ♔h8 26 ♕xh6+ ♔g8 27 ♗g6; e.g., 27...♖f7 28 ♗xf7+ ♔xf7 29 ♕h7+ ♔f6 30 ♕xe4.
25 ♖xc8 and White is the exchange up.

110) N. Mitkov – R. Burnett
Internet 2008
38 ♖c7! 1-0
There is no defence for Black after 38...♖g6 (or 38...♖d7? 39 ♕g4+) 39 ♕b7.

111) Gulko – B. Smith
Internet 2008
25 c7! 1-0
Forcing Black to give up control of f6; if 25...♕xc7 then 26 ♘f6+.

112) Van Oosterom – Kasimdzhanov
Dutch Team Ch 2007/8
The king in the centre leads to White's defeat. There are several ways for Black to win, but the strongest move is the elegant **21...♖d4! 22 ♕xd4?** (a blunder, but 22 ♕b5 a6 was also losing) **22...♕xe2# (0-1)**.

113) Prohaszka – Nyzhnyk
European Under-16 Ch, Herceg Novi 2008
63...♖xf2+! (gaining a second extra pawn, with an easy win) **64 ♔xf2 ♘e4+ 65 ♔e3 ♘xf6**, and Black won.

114) Carlsen – Movsesian
European Clubs Cup, Kallithea 2008
76...♖a8+! 0-1
Black wins on the spot in the case of 77 ♔f7 ♘d6+, while 77 ♘e8 ♘d6 (or 77...♖xe8+ 78 ♔xe8 ♘d6+) 78 ♖e7 ♖xe8+ 79 ♖xe8 ♘xe8 80 ♔xe8 g5 81 hxg5 ♔g7 is also winning for Black.

115) B. Socko – Baburin
Dresden Olympiad 2008
39 ♖xe6! 1-0
The passed pawn queens after 39...fxe6 40 c7.

116) Navara – Kveinys
Dresden Olympiad 2008
35 ♕c6! (with a double attack on the queen and the knight) **1-0**.

117) T.L. Petrosian – Rødgaard
Dresden Olympiad 2008
39 ♖xd8+! 1-0

118) Papaioannou – Azarov
Dresden Olympiad 2008
32 ♗h7+! (winning the exchange) **32...♔xh7** (32...♔f8? 33 ♕e8#) **33 ♕xf7** and White won.

119) Parligras – A. Kovačević
Dresden Olympiad 2008
14 fxe5! ♘h5
Black loses after 14...dxe5 15 ♕xd8+ ♗xd8 16 ♖xf6 ♘c4 17 ♖f3 ♘xe3 18 ♖xe3 ♗b6 19 ♔f2; or 14...♘c4 15 exf6 ♘xe3 and now, for instance, 16 ♕d4 ♘xc2 17 fxe7.
15 exd6
and White won.

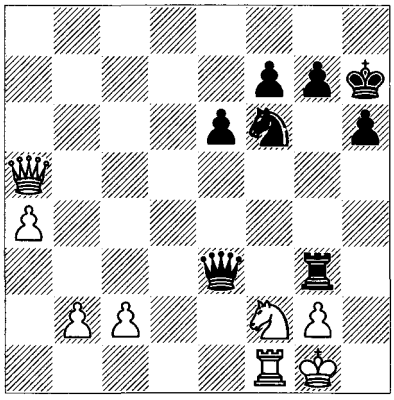
120) Geetha Narayanan – Stoček
Dresden Olympiad 2008
28 ♖xd6! ♔xd6 29 ♕d4+ ♔e7 30 ♕xb4+ ♔d7 31 ♕d4+ ♔c8 32 ♕xe5 with an extra pawn and a mating attack.

3 On the Attack

In this chapter we are going to study the attack on the king. There is not always a direct mating attack, but threats to the king always play a vital role in the solution.

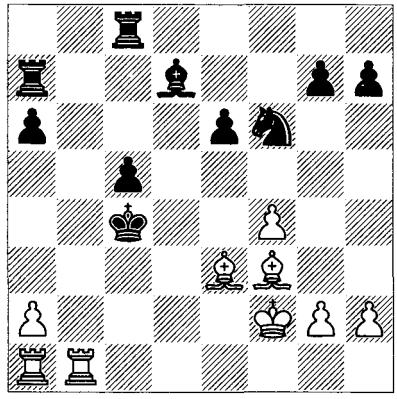
There are 100 puzzles in this chapter, the first 50 of which are supplied with hints. The puzzles are in increasing order of difficulty and complexity, ranging from level 1 (the same as the puzzles in the previous chapter) to level 4 (the most difficult level you will find in this book, with the exception of the final chapter and some of the test positions). In puzzle 171 (the first without a hint) we return to level 1.

121
B



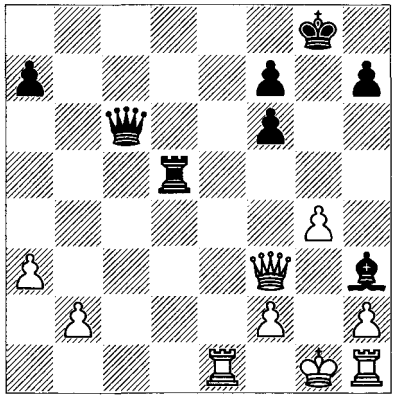
The white king is very weak; can you find the quickest win?

123
W



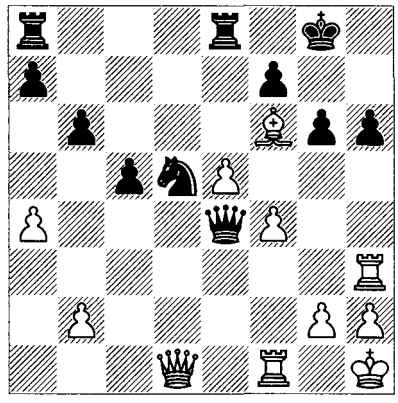
How can White mate the black king quickly, exploiting the fact that it can't retreat?

122
B



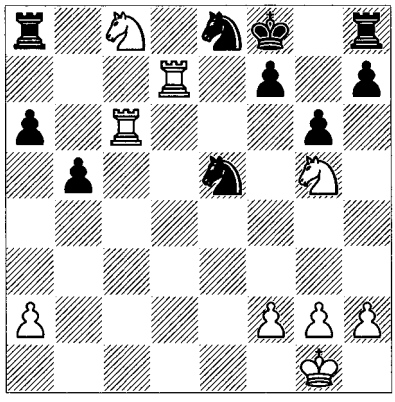
White's king is incarcerated and there are latent mating threats on g2 and the back rank. How can Black smash through?

124
W



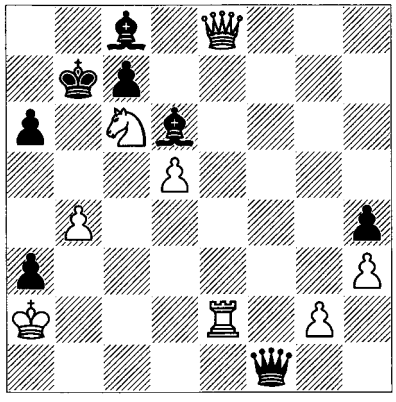
26 ♖xh6 would lead to mate, were it not for 26...♘xf6. Therefore...

125
W



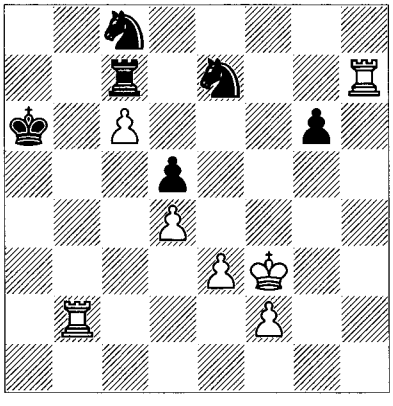
It is mate in three moves; how?

128
W



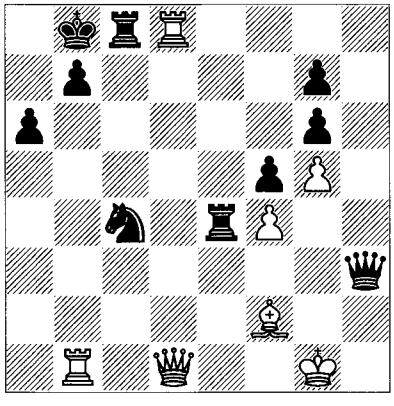
How can White mate in a few moves?

126
W



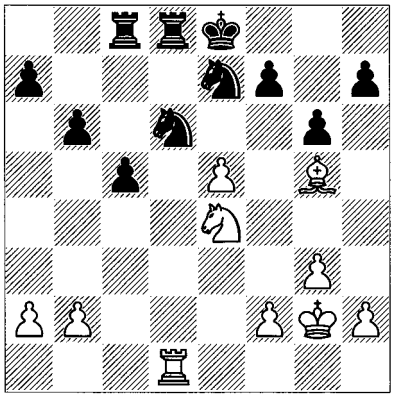
The black king is in a dangerous position; how can White exploit this?

129
W



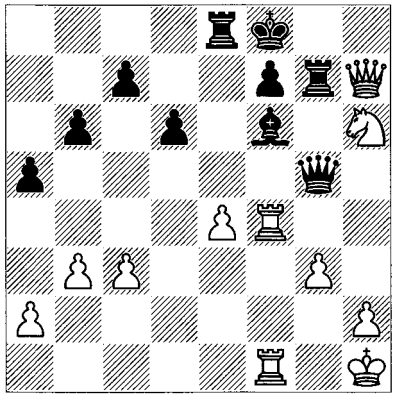
White has a forced mate. How?

127
W



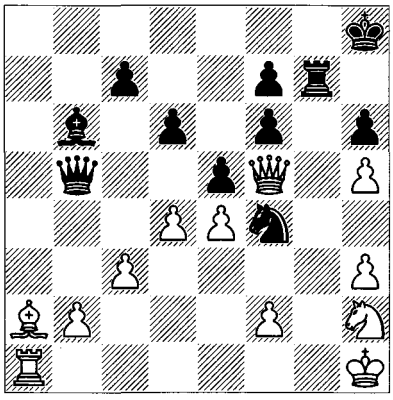
There is a way to bring the game to a swift end; what is it?

130
W



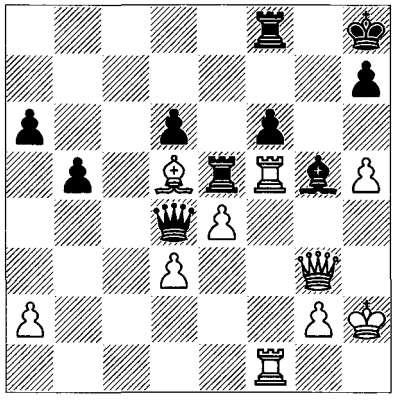
White gains a decisive material advantage, thanks to the precarious position of Black's king. How?

131
W



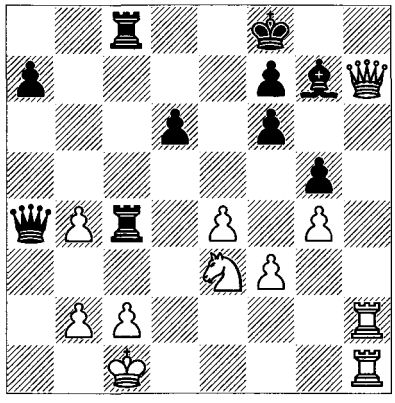
The black king is poorly defended, but how can White feed more pieces into the attack?

132
W



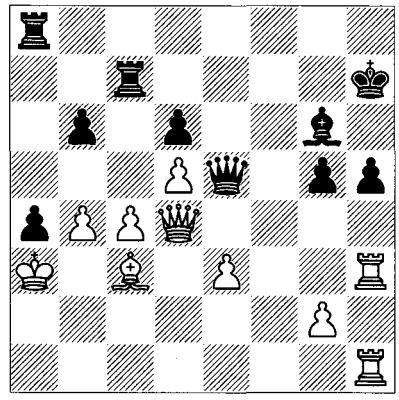
How can White break down the defences of the apparently safe black king?

133
W



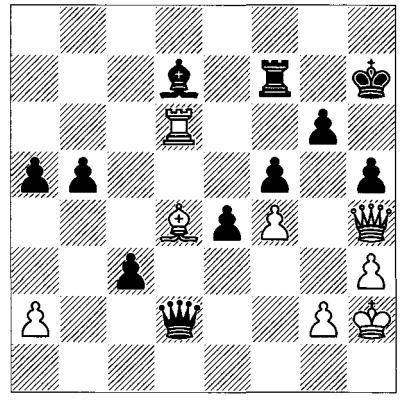
There are several ways to win, but only one killer blow – which is...?

134
W



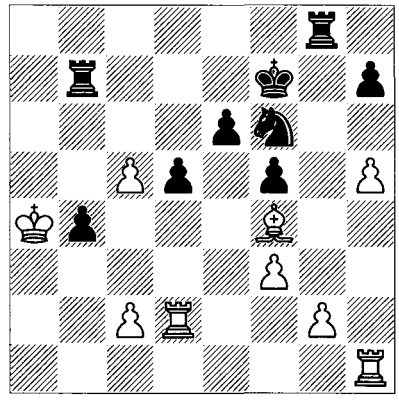
It is not easy to attack the black king just by manoeuvring, but there is a direct way of doing it; how?

135
W



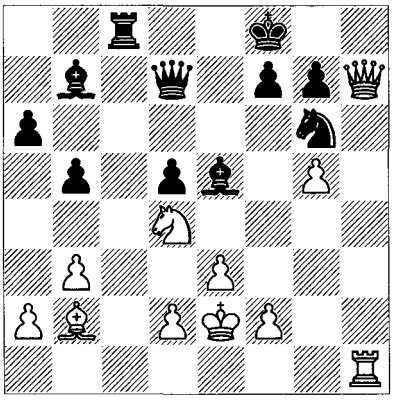
'Opposite-coloured bishops favour the attacker'. How can White demonstrate the power of his unopposed d4-bishop?

136
B



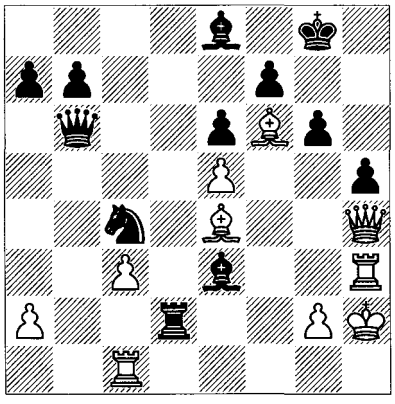
After 35...♖a8+ the white king easily escapes, but what if...

137
W



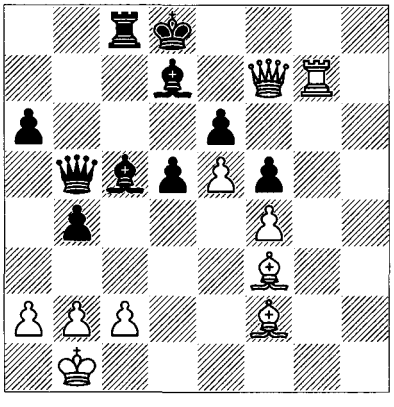
How can White cut off the black king's escape-route?

140
W



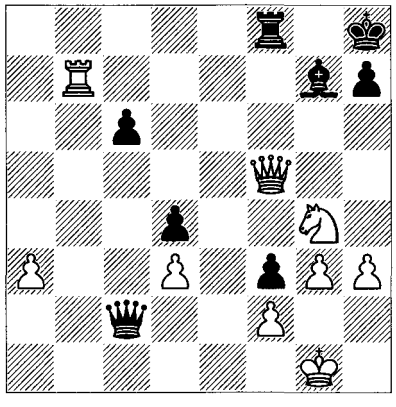
A bishop like the one on f6 arouses great hopes of an attack; how can White make use of it?

138
W



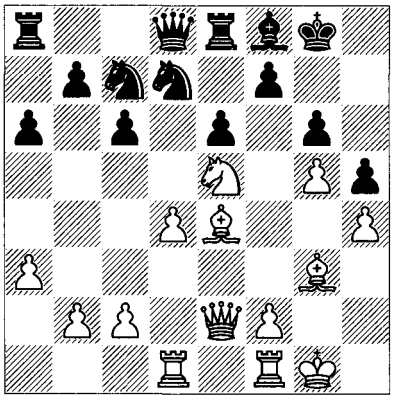
Exploit the overload on the black queen.

141
W



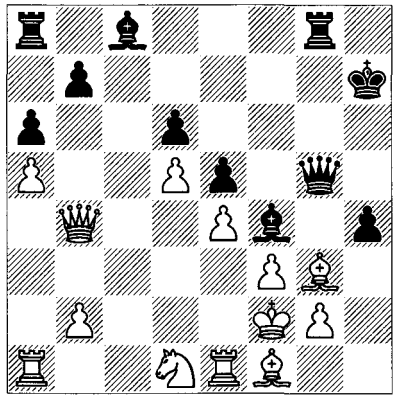
White played 40 ♖f7 and won the endgame; is there a quicker way?

139
W



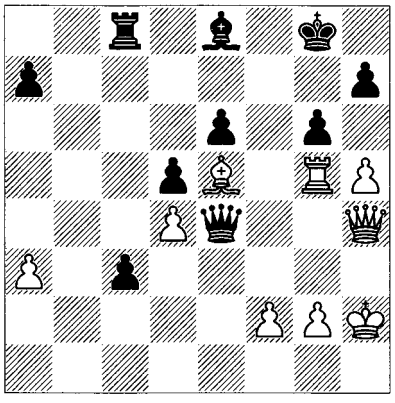
The move ...h5 didn't make Black's king's position any more secure; how can this move be exploited?

142
B



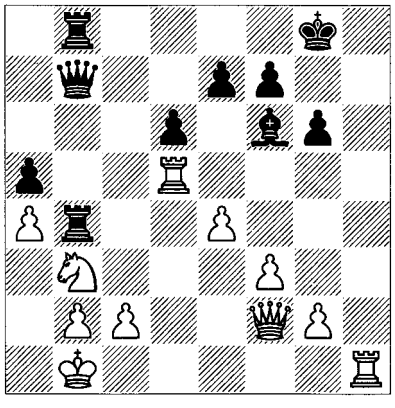
After 30...♗xg3+ 31 ♔e2 Black won the exchange, but not the game. Can you find something better?

143
W



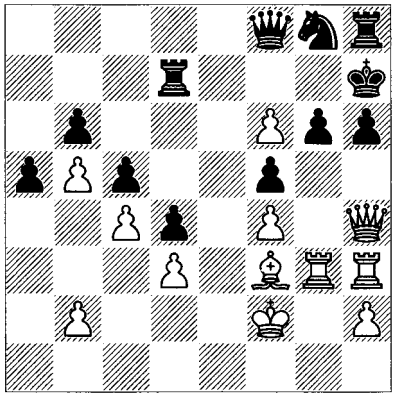
White played 43 ♖g4. Can you find a stronger continuation?

144
B



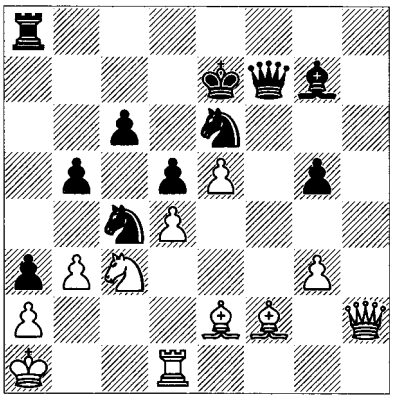
Black played 25...♖xa4 and the game ended in a draw; can you find something better?

145
W



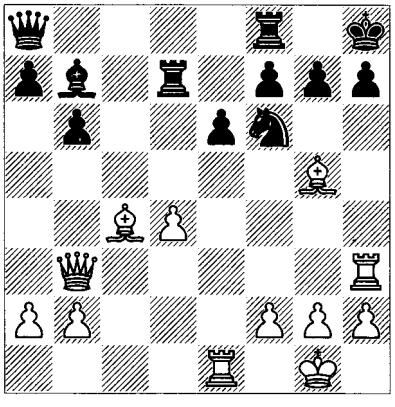
Play continued 43 ♗c6? ♖f7 44 ♗e8 ♖xf6 and Black won in the end. Can you find what White missed?

146
B



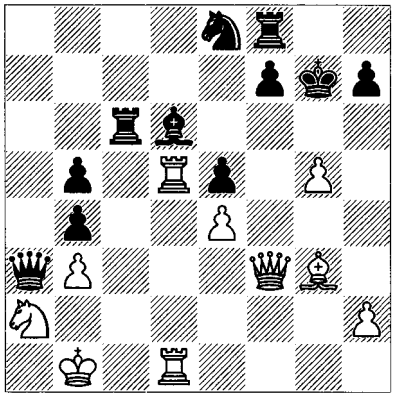
The white king is not as safe as it looks on the long diagonal. How did Black gain a decisive material advantage?

147
W



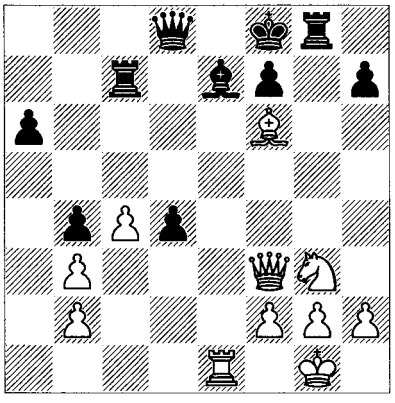
The black queen exerts pressure down the long diagonal but it is decentralized and the black king is poorly defended...

148
B



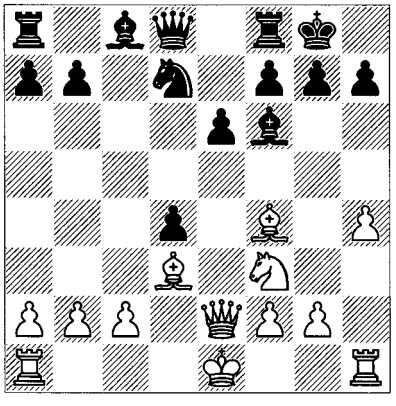
Although White's pieces are more active than Black's, his king is weaker and it is this that decides the struggle; how?

149
W



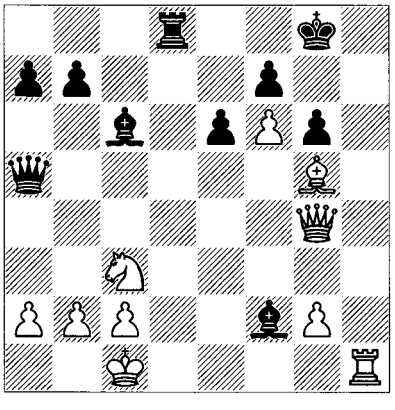
The black king is in a bad way; how should White coordinate his attack?

150
W



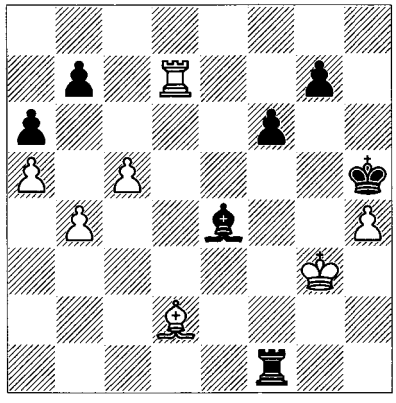
Why is the typical sacrifice 11 ♗xh7+ unsound here?

151
W



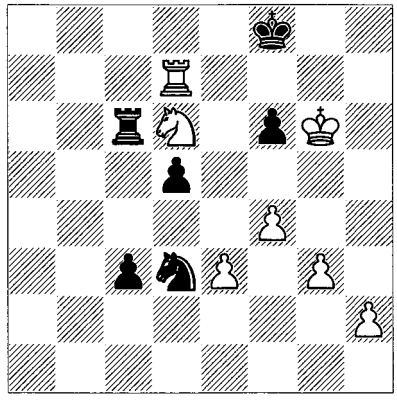
After 22 ♖d1? ♖xd1+ 23 ♘xd1 ♗c5 Black stood better. What was the winning line that White missed?

152
B



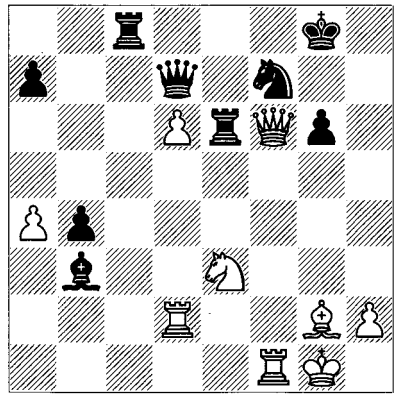
Even with limited material, king safety is very important. How can the unsafe position of White's king be demonstrated?

153
W



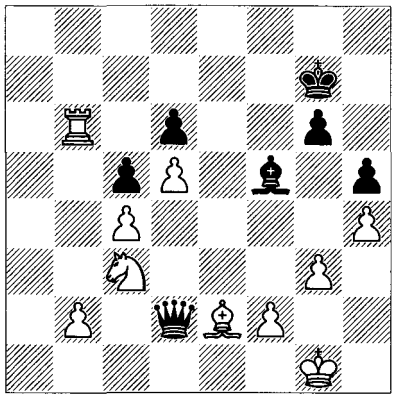
White played 39 ♔xf6, which is a good move, but not the best. What was a stronger continuation?

154
W



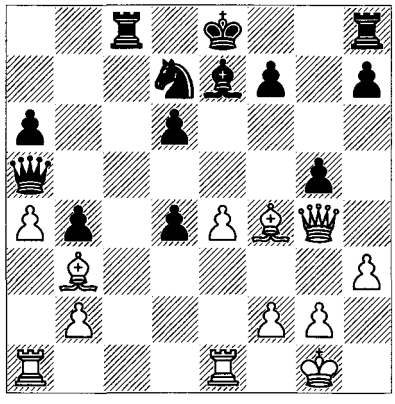
Almost all White's pieces are attacking, but he needs to find a way to break down the black king's defences. How?

155
B



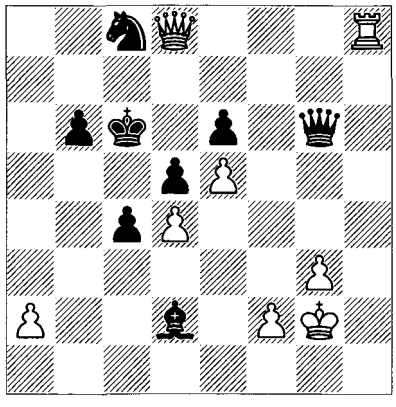
White could defend if he were allowed time to regroup. Find a quick way for Black to conclude matters.

156
W



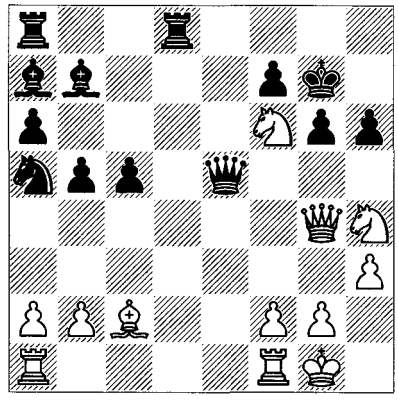
The black king is stuck in the centre, but energetic measures are required to exploit this. How?

157
W



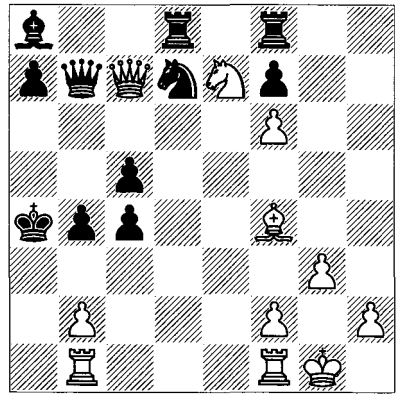
White opted for 36 ♕xc8+ ♔b5 37 ♕e8+ ♕xe8 38 ♖xe8 and won the endgame. Find a quicker win.

158
W



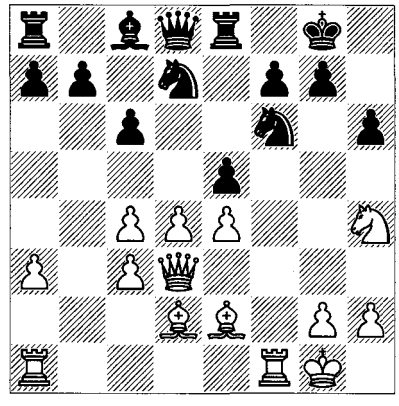
Black is threatening to play both 27...♕xf6 and 27...♕g5. Show that White's attack is far from over.

159
W



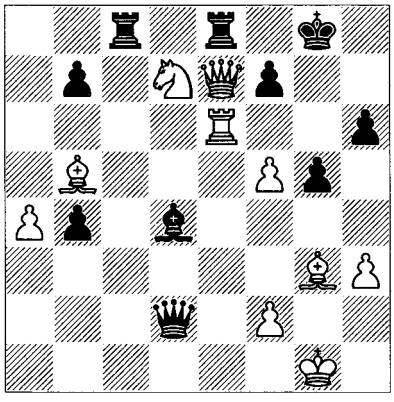
White played 26 ♖a1+? and after 26...♔b3 27 f3 ♕xc7 28 ♗xc7 ♘xf6 29 ♗xd8 ♖xd8 Black won. What did White miss?

160
W



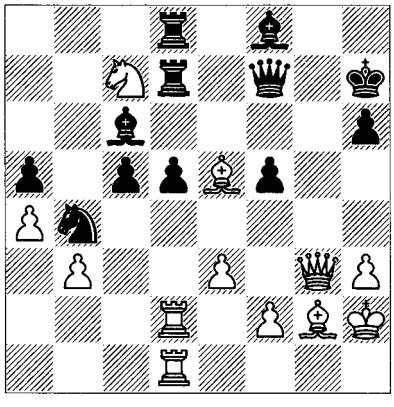
Show that White has a winning kingside attack based on his superior forces, the half-open f-file and the f5-square.

161
W



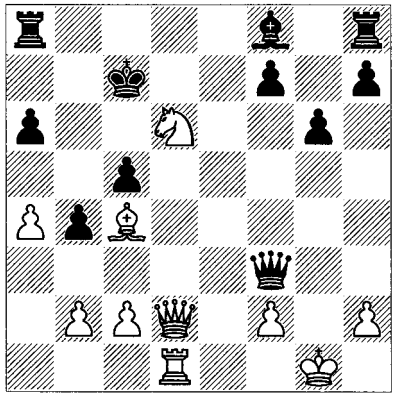
The accumulation of forces against Black's king's position indicates that White's attack is coming to a head; how?

162
B



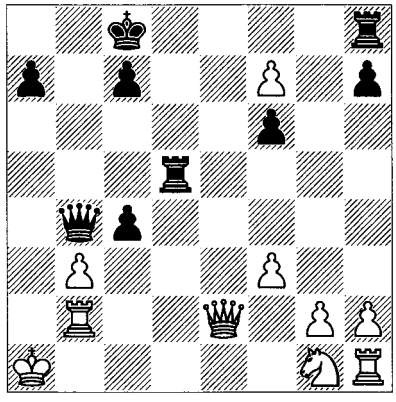
Black is under unpleasant pressure here, yet he has a way to move onto the offensive. How?

163
W



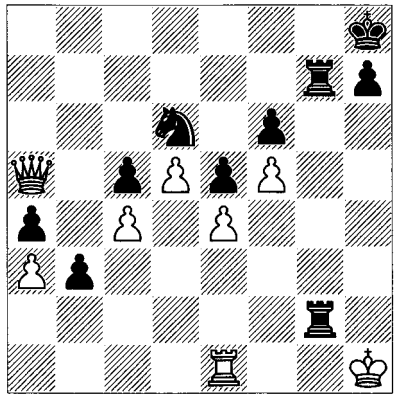
White gained only a slight advantage after 23 ♘e8+ ♔b6 24 ♕d7 ♕b7 25 a5+ ♔a7 26 ♕xb7+ ♔xb7. What did he overlook?

164
B



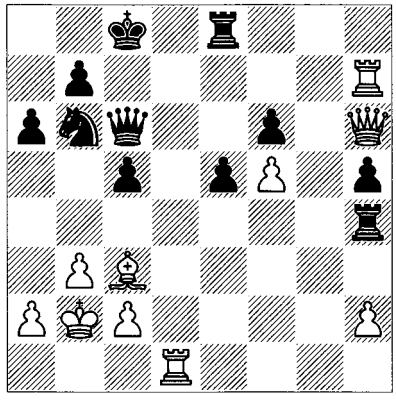
Black played 23...♕a3+? 24 ♔b1 c3 but his initiative then began to dissipate. How can Black's attack be improved?

165
B



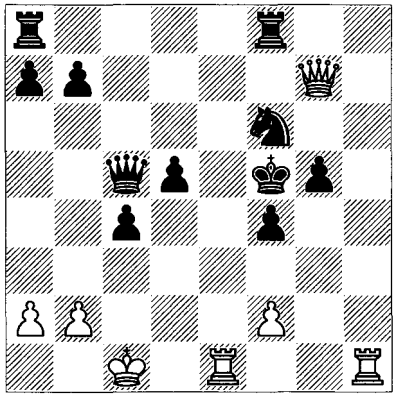
White has an active queen, but his king stands very badly; how does Black win?

166
W



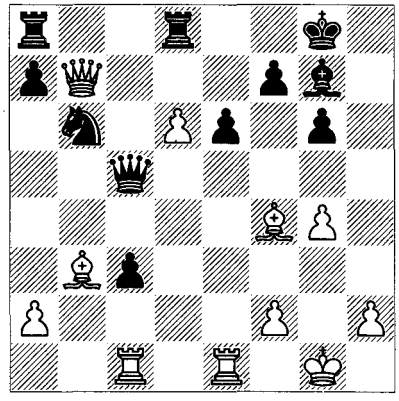
White dominates the centre and has active pieces. Can you find a way to eliminate one of the enemy's best defenders?

167
W



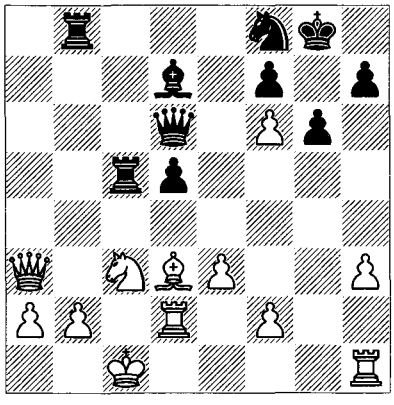
Here we have another king which has advanced rashly. What is the best way to attack it?

169
W



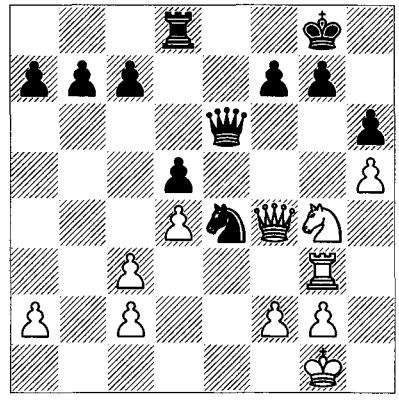
The safety of the black king is an illusion; how can this be demonstrated?

168
B



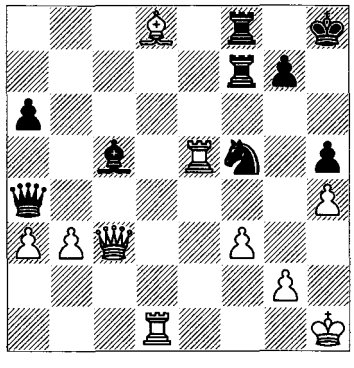
After 27...♖xc3+?! 28 ♕xc3 ♖c8 29 ♗c4 White was able to defend. Can you find a more promising line for Black?

170
W

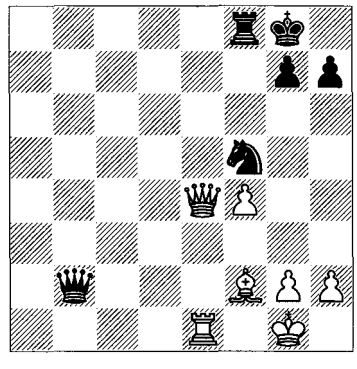


33 ♖e3 ♕d6 34 ♕f5 ♕d7 35 ♕f4 ♕d6 led to a repetition of moves. What opportunity did White miss?

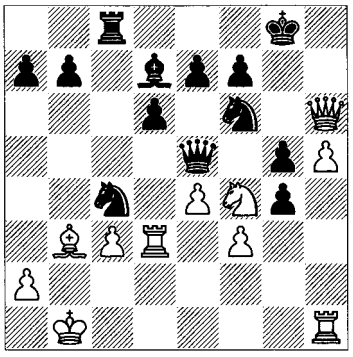
171
B



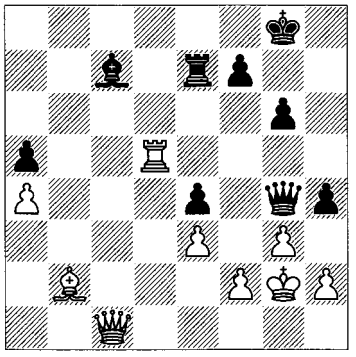
172
W



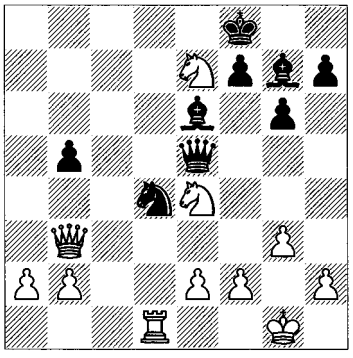
173
W



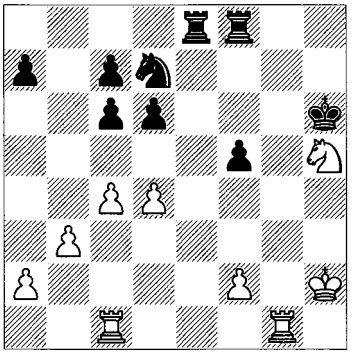
177
W



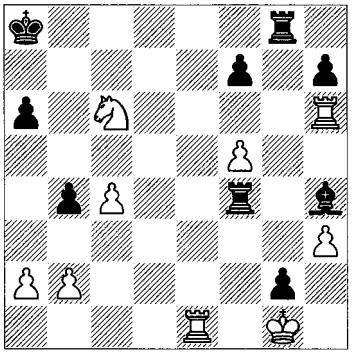
174
W



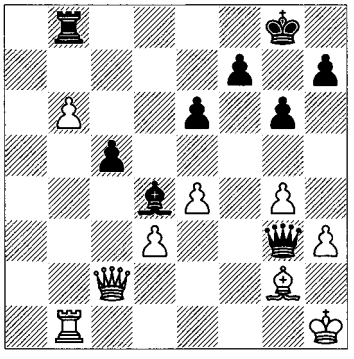
178
W



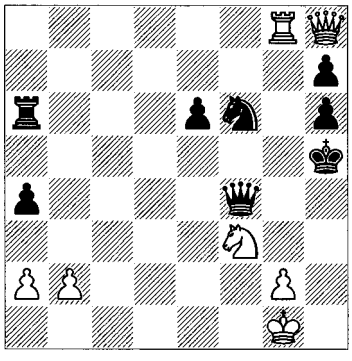
175
W



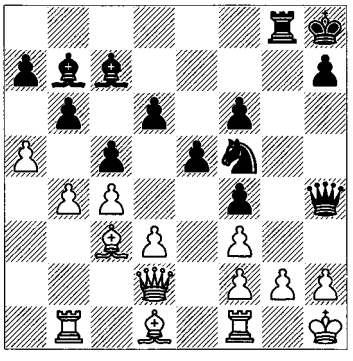
179
B



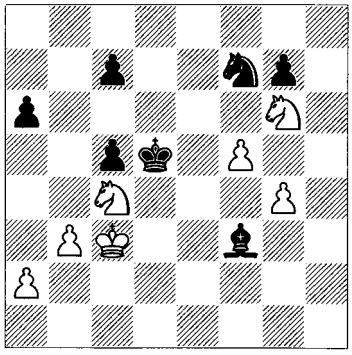
176
W



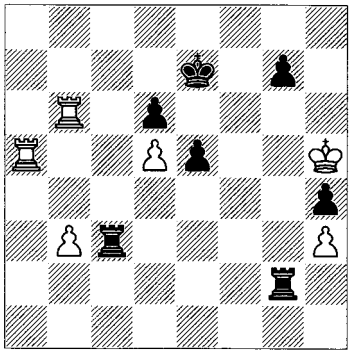
180
B



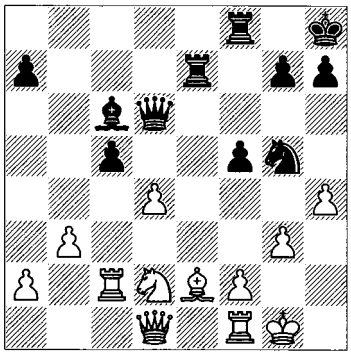
181
W



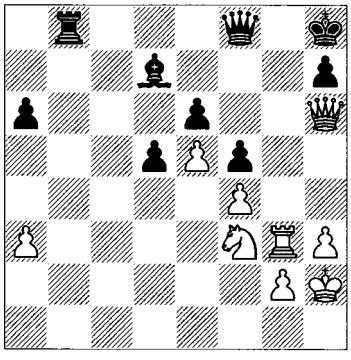
182
B



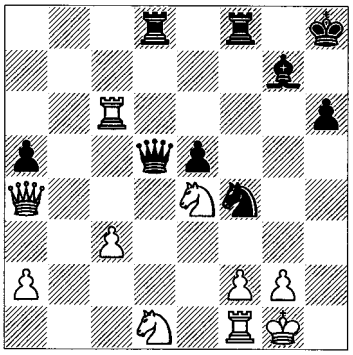
183
B



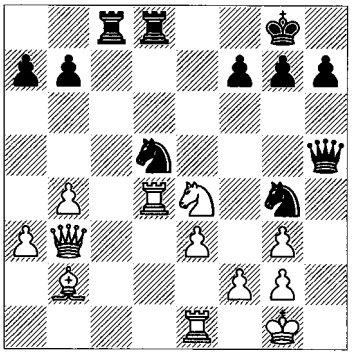
184
W



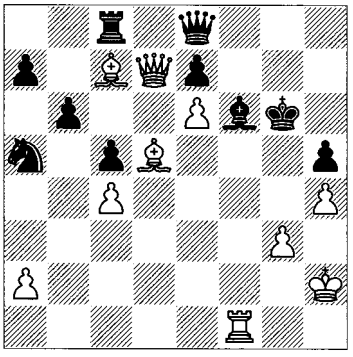
185
B



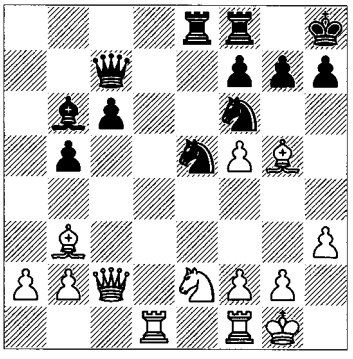
186
B



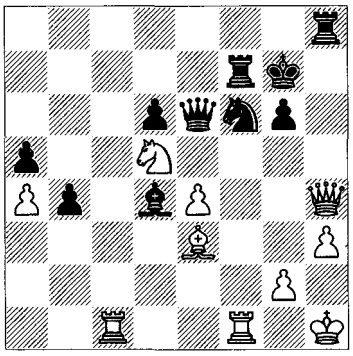
187
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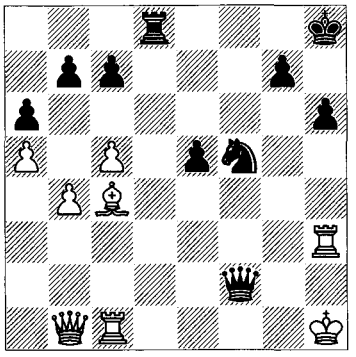
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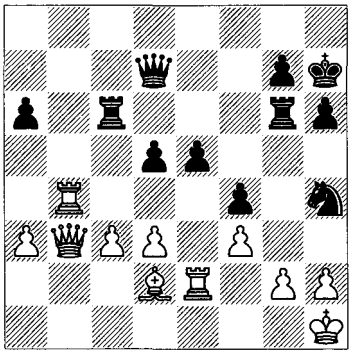
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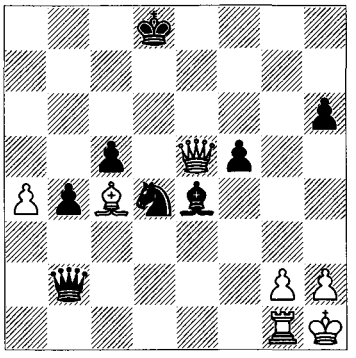
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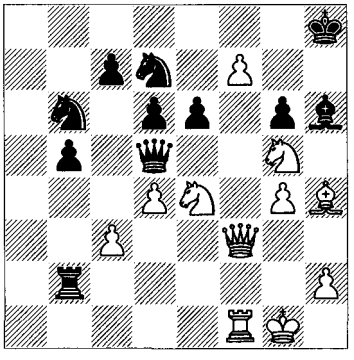
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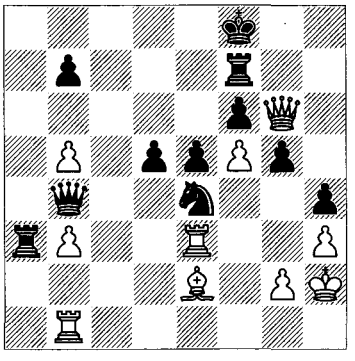
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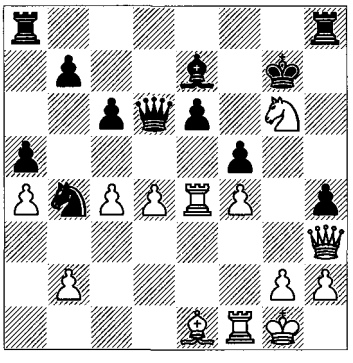
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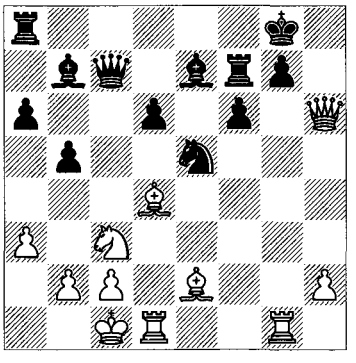
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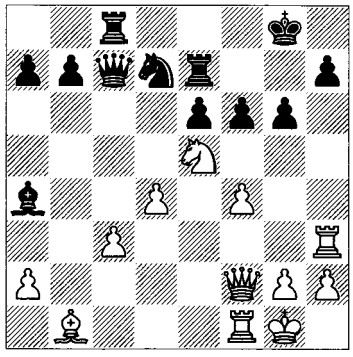
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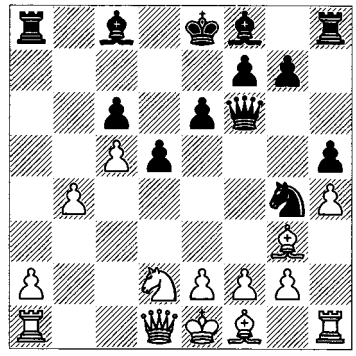
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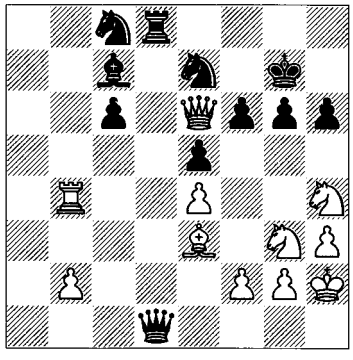
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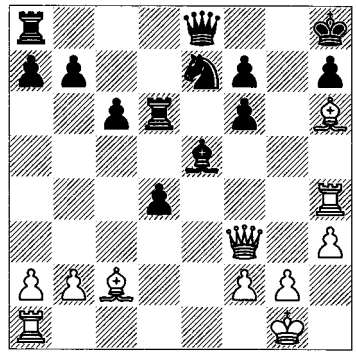
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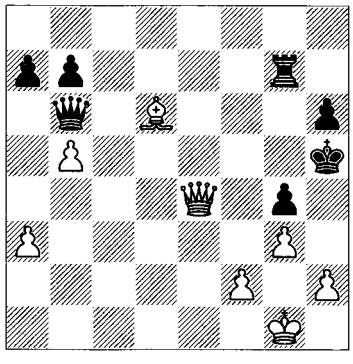
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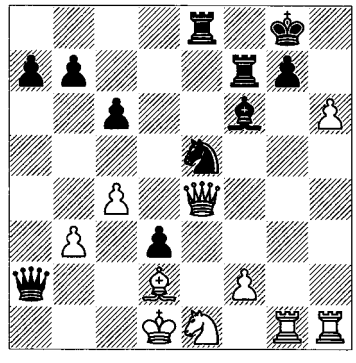
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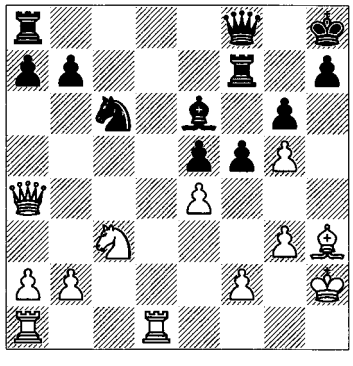
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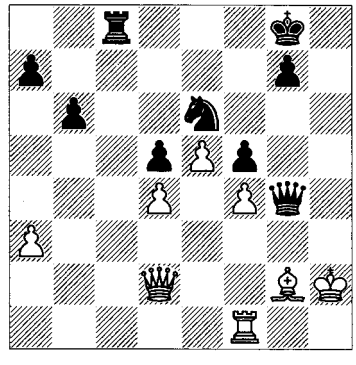
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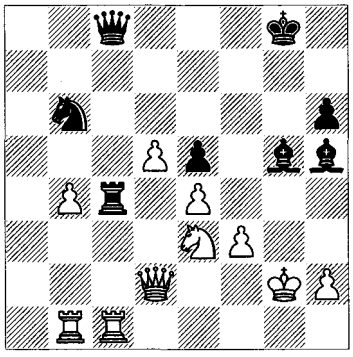
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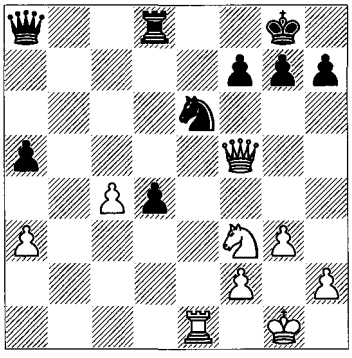
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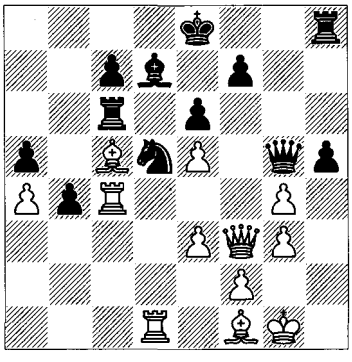
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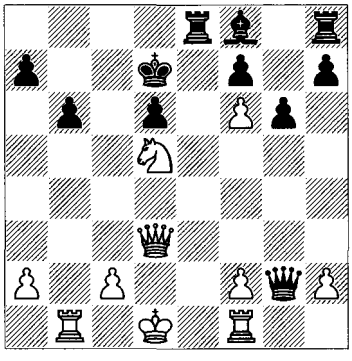
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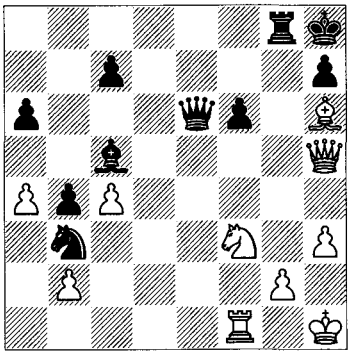
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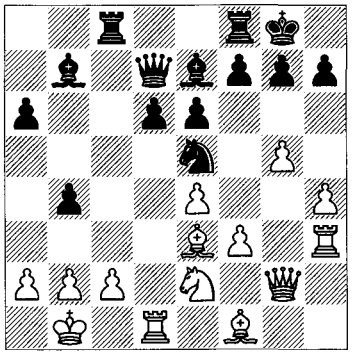
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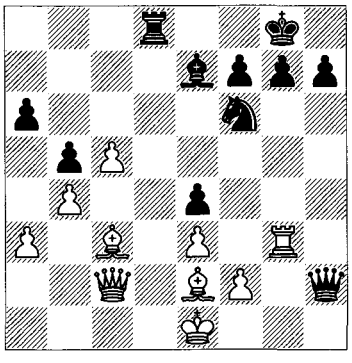
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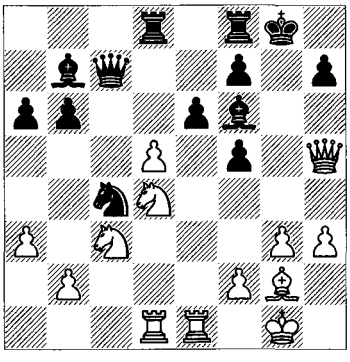
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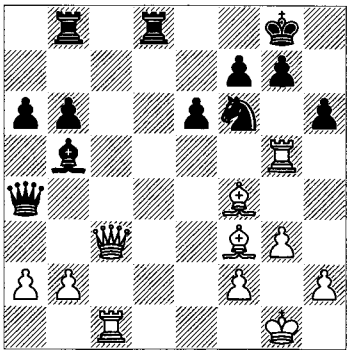
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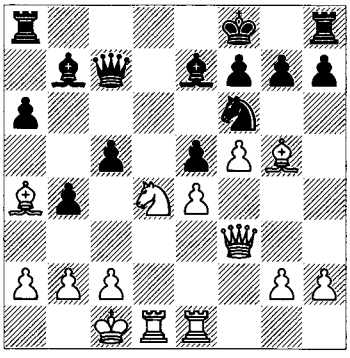
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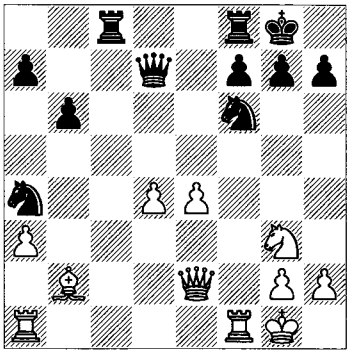
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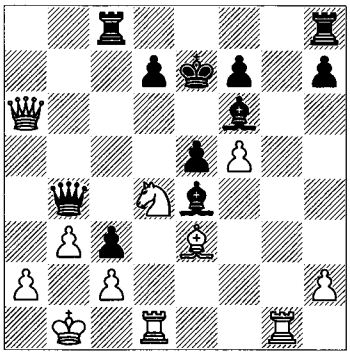
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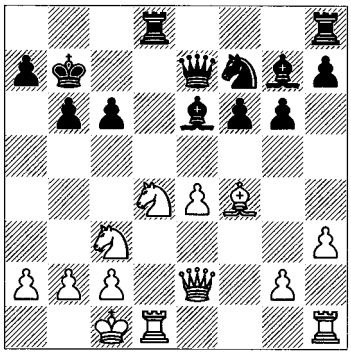
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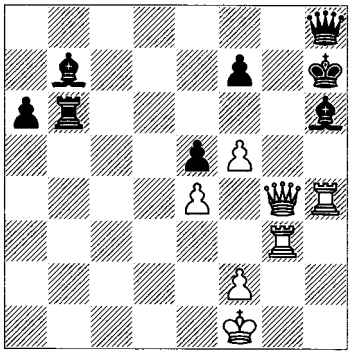
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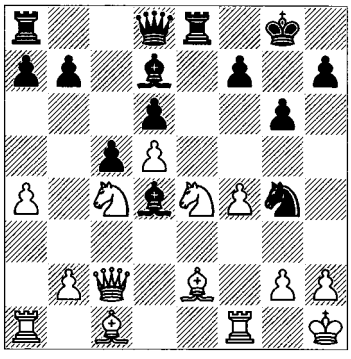
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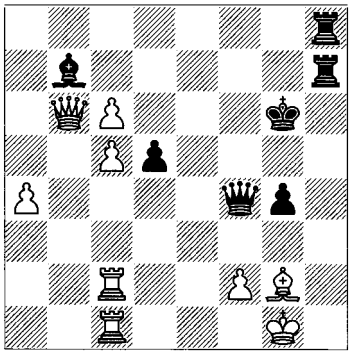
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219
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220
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Answers for Chapter 3

121) Rossetto – Ju. Bolbochán
Mar del Plata 1956
36...♕f3! 0-1

122) Wexler – Bazán
Mar del Plata 1960
25...♖d1! 0-1
25...♖e5! is also effective.

123) Szabo – Guimard
Mar del Plata 1962
26 ♖b3! 1-0
27 ♖c1+ follows.

124) Rombaldoni – Iturrizaga
World Junior Ch, Gaziantep 2008
26 ♕xd5! 1-0
26...♕xd5 27 ♖xh6 and mate.

125) An. Rodriguez – Contín
Buenos Aires 2008
30 ♖xf7+! 1-0
30...♘xf7 (30...♔g8 31 ♘e7#) 31 ♘e6+ ♔g8 32 ♘e7#.

126) Kramnik – Short
Dresden Olympiad 2008
47 ♖h1! 1-0
47...♘xc6 is forced, after which 48 ♖a1+ ♘a5 49 ♖ba2 wins.

127) Zhukova – Peptan
Dresden Women's Olympiad 2008
28 ♘f6+! 1-0
There follows 29 ♗h6#.

128) Nepomniashchy – Salgado
Pamplona 2008
45 ♕xc8+! 1-0
45...♔xc8 46 ♖e8+ ♔b7 (46...♔d7 47 ♖d8#) 47 ♖b8#.

129) Moskalenko – Panelo
Badalona 2008
37 ♖xb7+! ♔xb7 38 ♕d7+ ♖c7 39 ♕d5+! ♖c6 40 ♖d7+ 1-0
40...♔b8 41 ♗a7+ ♔a8 42 ♕xc6#.

130) Kurnosov – Agdestein
Tromsø 2008
37 ♖xf6! ♕xf6
It is mate after 37...♖xh7? 38 ♖xf7+ ♖xf7 39 ♖xf7#.
38 ♕h8+ ♔e7 39 ♕xe8+ 1-0
White remains a piece up.

131) Hirneise – T. Hansen
Budapest 2008
26 ♗xf7!
Bringing two fresh pieces into the attack and threatening 27 ♖a8+; another way is 26 ♕xf6.
26...♕c6
26...♖xf7 leads to mate after 27 ♖a8+ ♔g7 28 ♕g4+.
27 d5 1-0
After 27...♕b7 28 ♕xf6 ♔h7 29 ♘g4 the mate is delayed but is unavoidable.

132) Hou Yifan – T. Georgescu
World Junior Ch, Gaziantep 2008
28 ♕xg5! fxg5 29 ♖xf8+ ♔g7 30 ♖1f6! 1-0
The quickest way, preventing 30...♔h6 and threatening 31 h6#.

133) Safarli – Durarbeyli
World Junior Ch, Gaziantep 2008
26 ♕xg7+! 1-0
It is mate after 26...♔xg7 27 ♘f5+ ♔f8 28 ♖h8#.

134) Semcesen – Palac
Schwarzach 2008
36 ♖xh5+!
Not 36 ♕d2? ♕e4.
36...♗xh5
This loses decisive material, but there was nothing better. 36...♔g7 is met by 37 ♕d2, while if 36...♔g8 then amongst other things there is a win with 37 ♕xe5 dxe5 38 ♖h8+ and the a8-rook is lost.
37 ♕d3+ 1-0

135) Dumitrache – Baratosi
Romanian League, Eforie Nord 2008
38 ♖xg6! 1-0
Deciding the game, since it is mate after 38...♔xg6 39 ♕g5+ ♔h7 40 ♕xh5+ ♔g8 41 ♕h8#.

136) Valeanu – Bachmann
Bucharest 2008
35...b3! (eliminating the king's escape-route) **36 ♔a3 b2 0-1**.

137) Bischoff – Buhmann
Austrian Team Ch 2008/9

29 ♗a3+! ♗d6

Not 29...♔e8? 30 ♕g8+ mating.

30 ♗xd6+ ♕xd6 31 ♘f5!

There is no satisfactory defence to the threats of 32 ♘xd6 and 32 ♕h8+ followed by mate.

31...♘f4+ 32 ♔d1 1-0

138) Almasi – Babula
Dresden Olympiad 2008

35 ♗e2! 1-0

A possible continuation is 35...♕c6 (35...♕a4 36 ♗xc5 ♖xc5 37 ♕f8+ and 38 ♕xc5) 36 ♗xc5 with an extra piece for White and a winning advantage.

139) L.B. Hansen – Z. Rahman
Dresden Olympiad 2008

21 ♘xg6!

Black's exposed king can't be defended. **21 ♘xf7!** was also effective.

21...fxg6 22 ♗xg6 ♖e7 23 ♕xh5 ♖g7 24 ♖d3 ♘e8 25 ♖e1 ♖xg6 26 ♕xg6+

with a material advantage and the attack.

140) L. Vajda – Zagorskis
Dresden Olympiad 2008

31 ♕xh5! ♖xg2+ (31...gxh5 32 ♖xh5 leads to forced mate, after a few spite checks by Black) **32 ♗xg2 1-0**.

141) Bojković – Zhao Xue
Dresden Women's Olympiad 2008

40 ♕g5! leads to a quick mate: 40...♖g8 41 ♘e5.

142) Franco – Paunović
Zaragoza 1991

30...♗d2! wins more material; e.g., 31 ♕b6 (31 ♘c3? hxg3+! is worse) 31...♕xg3+ 32 ♔g1 ♕xe1.

143) Topalov – Ponomariov
León (rapid) 2003

43 ♖xg6+! ♗xg6 44 ♕f6 ♕xe5+ 45 dxe5 wins.

144) Sax – Gaponenko
Balatonlelle 2008

25...♗xb2! is devastating; e.g., 26 ♖xa5 (or 26 ♔xb2? ♖xb3+!; after 26 ♖b5 ♖xb5 27 axb5 ♗c3 28 ♕e3 ♕c7 followed by 29...a4, defence is practically impossible) 26...♗d4! followed by 27...♖xb3+ and a quick mate.

145) Amin – D. Boros
World Junior Ch, Gaziantep 2008

White overlooked a win by **43 ♕g5!** ♕xf6 (43...♕f7 44 ♖xh6+ ♘xh6 45 ♕xh6+ ♔g8 {45...♔xh6 46 ♖h3#} 46 ♖xg6+) 44 ♖xh6+! ♘xh6 45 ♕xf6.

146) Beikert – Vallejo
Bundesliga 2008/9

37...♘xe5! 38 ♗xb5?! (38 dxe5 ♗xe5 39 ♗e1 b4 is more stubborn, although ultimately insufficient) **38...♘g4 0-1**.

147) Timofeev – Svidler
Russian Ch, Moscow 2008

18 ♗xf6! gxf6

The g-file is now open and Black intends 19...♖g8, but... a tempo is an eternity in this position.

19 ♖xh7+! 1-0

White mates the black king, thanks to the opening of the g- and h-files; Svidler resigned in view of 19...♔xh7 20 ♕h3+ ♔g7 21 ♕g4+ ♔h8 22 ♖e3 ♗e4 23 ♖h3+ ♗h7 24 ♕h4.

148) Naiditsch – Dao Thien Hai
Beijing (rapid) 2008

31...♖c3!

Eliminating the last pawn defending White's king.

32 ♘xc3 ♕xb3+ 33 ♔a1 bxc3 34 ♕f2?!

After 34 ♖5d2 ♘c7 the black pieces reach the queenside surprisingly quickly: 35 ♖a2 ♖a8! 36 ♖dd2 ♖xa2+ 37 ♖xa2 ♘e6.

34...c2 0-1

149) L. Domínguez – Morozevich
Blitz World Ch, Almaty 2008

24 ♗e5!

Freeing the queen from the defence of the bishop, so as to be able to invade the kingside.

24...♖d7

24...♗d6 loses to 25 ♗xd6+ ♕xd6 26 ♕a8+ ♔g7 27 ♘f5+ ♔f6 28 ♕xg8 ♔xf5 29 ♕xh7+.

25 ♕h5!

Threatening 26 ♕xh7, 26 ♕h6+ and 26 ♘f5.

25...d3?!

More tenacious, although insufficient, is 25...♕b6 26 ♗f4! d3 27 ♗d2 ♕g6 28 ♕f3, followed by 29 ♘f5, with a decisive initiative.

26 ♕h6+! ♔e8 27 ♕xh7 ♖f8 28 ♘h5! ♕a5 29 ♘f6+ ♔d8 30 ♘xd7 ♔xd7 31 ♕xd3+ ♔c8 32 ♕f5+ 1-0

150) Charbonneau – H.A. Hussein
Dresden Olympiad 2008

White played **11 ♗xh7+? ♔xh7 12 ♘g5+ ♔g8 13 ♕h5** and now Black can defend with **13...♕a5+! 0-1** followed by 14...♕f5.

151) de la Riva – Ermenkov
Dresden Olympiad 2008

White wins by **22 ♗h6!**, threatening 23 ♗g7 and ♖h8#. Against the resource 22...♗xg2 23 ♕xg2 ♕f5 the prettiest line is 24 ♕xf2! (24 ♗g7 ♕f4+ 25 ♔b1 also wins) 24...♕xf2 25 ♗g7 with mate in three.

Less clear is 22 ♖h8+?! ♔xh8 23 ♕h3+ ♔g8 24 ♕h6 ♕xg5+! 25 ♕xg5 ♗d4, with advantage to White but nothing decisive.

152) Naiditsch – Nisipeanu
Dresden Olympiad 2008

51...f5! 0-1

The threat is 52...f4+ 53 ♗xf4 ♖f3+, winning the bishop. Now 52 ♖f7 unprotects the bishop, so Black has 52...♖f3+ and the next rook check wins the white bishop. If 52 ♗g5 instead, then 52...f4+! 53 ♗xf4 (53 ♔h2 ♖h1#) 53...♖f3+ wins as indicated.

153) Kramnik – Aronian
Rapid match (game 5), Erevan 2007

There was a forced mate with **39 ♖f7+!** ♔g8 40 ♖e7! ♖c8 41 ♖g7+ ♔f8 and now the key move is 42 ♔h7!, controlling g8, when there is no defence against the threat of ♖f7#. There is also the simple 42 ♘xc8.

154) Perelshteyn – Mikhalevski
Lubbock 2008

35 ♘g4!

With the inclusion of this fresh attacker, there is no defence for the black king.

35...♗c4

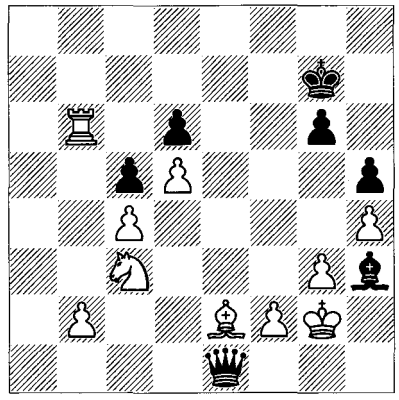
If 35...♖xd6 then 36 ♘h6+! wins: 36...♘xh6 (no better is 36...♔h7 37 ♘xf7 ♖xd2 38 ♕h4+ ♔g7 39 ♕h6+ ♔g8 40 ♕h8#, or 36...♔f8 37 ♕h8+ ♔e7 38 ♖e2+) 37 ♖xd6 with a decisive advantage for White.

36 ♕xf7+! ♕xf7 37 ♘h6+ ♔g7 38 ♘xf7 ♗xf1 39 d7 ♗a6 40 dxc8♕

with a winning advantage.

155) Hillarp Persson – Geetha Narayanan
Dresden Olympiad 2008

36...♕e1+! 37 ♔g2 ♗h3+! *(D)*



The bishop is taboo on account of the mate on h1, so the white king has to come out into the open and be exposed to danger.

38 ♔f3 ♗g4+ 39 ♔e3 ♕c1+! 40 ♔e4

Or 40 ♔d3 ♗f5+ 41 ♘e4 ♕b1+.

40...♕d2 41 ♗xg4 hxg4

Threatening 42...♕d4#.

42 ♘b5 ♕e2+

and mate in two.

0-1

156) Caruana – Korchnoi
Dresden Olympiad 2008

22 e5! ♔d8

Or:

a) 22...gxf4 23 exd6 is clearly hopeless for Black; e.g., 23...♔d8 24 dxe7+ ♔c7 25 ♕xf4+ ♔b7 26 ♕xd4.

b) 22...h5 23 ♗xf7+! ♔d8 (or 23...♔xf7 24 ♕xd7 and there is no defence; if 24...gxf4?! then 25 exd6) 24 exd6! ♗f6 25 ♕e6 gxf4 26 ♕e8+!.

23 exd6 ♗f6 24 ♗g3

Stranded in the centre, the black king can't survive in view of the wedge at d6 and the open lines.

24...h5 25 ♕e4 ♗e5 26 ♗xe5 ♖e8 27 ♕f5 ♘xe5 28 d7 1-0

157) Cheparinov – Pavasović
Dresden Olympiad 2008

The escape-route can be blocked with **36 a4!** ♕e4+ 37 ♔h2 and mate soon follows; e.g., 37...♘a7 38 ♕d6+ ♔b7 39 ♖b8+ ♔a6 40 ♕xb6#.

158) Lupulescu – Ki. Georgiev
Dresden Olympiad 2008

27 ♘f5+! ♔f8

27...♔xf6 is met by 28 ♕h4+ ♔e6 29 ♕e7+ ♔d5 30 ♖adl+.

28 ♕h4 h5

Or 28...gxf5 29 ♖ae1 ♗e4 30 ♗xe4 (or 30 ♕xh6+ first) 30...fxe4 31 ♖xe4 ♕g5 32 ♘h7+.

29 ♕g5 gxf5 30 ♖ae1 ♘c6 31 ♖xe5 ♘xe5 32 ♖e1 1-0

159) Franco – Korneev
Dos Hermanas 2003

After **26 b3+!!** there is no hiding place for the black king:

a) 26...cxb3? exposes Black to a decisive attack; e.g., 27 ♖a1+ ♔b5 28 ♖a5+ ♔c4 29 ♖c1+ ♔d4 30 ♗e3+ ♔d3 31 ♕d6+, and White wins.

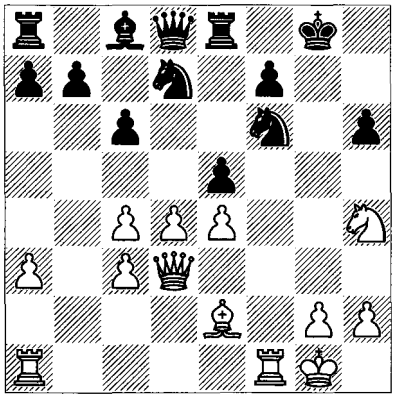
b) 26...♔b5 27 bxc4+ and now:

b1) 27...♔xc4 28 ♖fc1+ ♔b5 29 ♖xb4+! ♔xb4 (29...cxb4? 30 ♕c4+ ♔a5 31 ♖a1+ ♔b6 32 ♕xb4#) 30 ♖b1+ ♔a4 31 ♖xb7 ♗xb7 32 ♕xb7 with a decisive advantage.

b2) 27...♔a4 28 ♖a1+ and the king can't survive; e.g., 28...♔b3 29 ♖fb1+ ♔c2 30 ♖c1+ ♔b3 31 ♖ab1+ ♔a4 32 ♕xb7! ♗xb7 33 ♖c2 ♔a5 34 ♗c7+ and mate next move.

160) Ovod – Zhao Xue
Russian Women's Team Ch, Dagomys 2008

15 ♗xh6! gxh6 *(D)*



16 ♘f5!

Threatening mate with 17 ♕g3+.

16...♘f8

If 16...♔h7 then White wins with 17 ♕h3! ♘g8 18 ♘xh6! ♘xh6 19 ♖xf7+ ♔g8 20 ♕xh6 ♔xf7 21 ♖f1+ ♘f6 and it is mate after 22 ♕h7+ ♔f8 (22...♔e6 23 ♗g4+! ♘xg4 24 ♕f7+ ♔d6 25 c5#) 23 ♗h5 ♗e6 24 ♕h8+ ♔e7 25 ♕g7+ ♔d6 26 c5#.

17 ♕g3+ ♘g6 18 ♘xh6+ ♔g7 19 ♘xf7! ♘xe4

19...♔xf7 is answered by 20 ♗h5! ♖g8 21 dxe5.

20 ♕d3 ♕d7

20...♕h4 loses to 21 g3, regaining the piece and maintaining the attack.

21 ♕xe4 exd4 22 ♕d3! ♖e3 23 ♕d2! c5

Now White resumes the attack, and this time it can't be parried.

24 ♗h5! ♘h4 25 ♕f2 ♕e7 26 ♕f4! ♘f5 27 ♕g4+! ♔f8 28 ♘h6 1-0

161) D. Khamrakulov – Yuldachev
Uzbek Ch, Tashkent 2008

28 ♖g6+! fxg6 29 ♘f6+!

The correct order of moves. Not 29 ♗c4+? because of 29...♔h8!, winning.

29...♗xf6 30 ♗c4+! 1-0

White regains all the sacrificed material with interest after 30...♖xc4 31 ♕xe8+ ♔g7 32 ♕xg6+ ♔f8 33 ♕xf6+ ♔e8 34 ♕e6+ and ♕xc4.

162) Granda – Fedorchuk
Conegliano 2008

37...♗e7!

...♖g8 is coming, and the action of the rook combined with the c6-bishop will be very dangerous. Other black forces can also join in, as we shall see.

38 h4?!

White should try 38 f4 ♖g8 39 ♕f2, although 39...d4! leaves the c7-knight in surprisingly serious danger; e.g., 40 ♗xc6 (or 40 ♗f1 d3! with the idea of 41...♕h5 and ...♗h4) 40...♘xc6 41 exd4 ♘xe5 42 fxe5 ♖xc7 43 d5 ♗g5 with advantage to Black, but White can still fight.

38...♖g8 39 ♕h3 ♖g4! 0-1

If 40 ♗g3? then 40...♖xc7, while Black's initiative is overwhelming after 40 ♔g1 d4 41 f3 ♖xh4 42 ♕g3 ♖h5, or 42...♗g5.

163) Adhiban – Movsziszian
Sort 2008

23 ♘b5+! is decisive: 23...♔b6 (White's task is simpler after 23...axb5? 24 ♕d7+ ♔b6 25 ♕xb5+ ♔c7 26 ♕d7+ ♔b6, and now the key idea is 27 a5+! ♖xa5 28 ♕d8+ ♔c6 29 ♗d5+) 24 a5+! ♔xa5 25 ♖a1+ ♔b6 26 ♖xa6+!! ♔xa6

(after 26...♖xa6 27 ♕d8+ it is mate in three) 27 ♘d4+ ♔b6 28 ♘xf3, and wins.

164) Nolte – Laylo

Philippines Ch, Mandaluyong 2008

Black can exploit the weakness of White's back rank by **23...♖e5!** 24 ♕xc4 (24 bxc4? ♕a3+ 25 ♖a2? ♕c1#) 24...♕e1+ 25 ♖b1 (25 ♔a2? ♖a5+ is worse) 25...♖a5+ 26 ♔b2 ♕d2+ 27 ♕c2 ♖a2+ 28 ♔xa2 ♕xc2+ 29 ♖b2 ♕d1, followed by 30...♖f8 and ...♖xf7.

165) Yusupov – Wang Yue

Amsterdam 2008

Not 47...♖2g5?, which only draws after 48 ♕d8+ ♖g8 49 ♕xf6+ ♖8g7 50 ♕f8+ ♖g8 51 ♕f6+.

47...♖g8!!

Ruling out White's key defensive idea, and now there is no satisfactory defence against 48...♖2g5.

48 ♕a6 ♖2g5 49 ♖e2 ♘xe4! 0-1

166) Vila Gazquez – Krejci

European Under-18 Ch, Herceg Novi 2008

29 ♖h8!

The e8-rook is vital for the defence; with its exchange, the absence of the other rook on h4 means that White's attack is winning.

29...♖xh2 30 ♗a5

30 ♕xf6 ♕xf6 31 ♖xe8+ ♔c7 32 ♗xe5+ was also strong.

30...♘a4+?!

This loses, but there is no satisfactory defence against the threat of 31 ♗xb6.

31 bxa4 b6 32 ♖xe8+ ♕xe8 33 ♗c3 e4 34 ♕xf6 1-0

167) Aronian – Volokitin

European Clubs Cup, Kallithea 2008

28 ♖h5!! ♘xh5 29 ♖e5+

And White forces a speedy mate.

29...♔g4 30 ♕xg5+ ♔f3 31 ♕xh5+ ♔xf2

Or 31...♔g2 32 ♕g4+ ♔f1 33 ♕e2+ ♔g1 34 ♖g5+ ♔h1 35 ♕h5#.

32 ♕e2+ 1-0

168) Sashikiran – H. Leyva

Dresden Olympiad 2008

Black's idea was fine, but the correct move-order is **27...d4!** 28 exd4 (after 28 ♗xg6 hxg6 29 ♖xd4 ♕e5 30 ♖hd1 ♖bc8 the f6-pawn is lost, there is pressure on the white king and White has insufficient compensation for the piece) 28...♖xc3+ 29 ♕xc3 ♕d5, attacking the h1-rook, and threatening 30...♖c8.

169) Harikrishna – Svidler

Dresden Olympiad 2008

25 ♖xe6!! ♖ab8

Not 25...fxe6 26 ♗xe6+ ♔h8 27 ♕f3! ♗d4 28 ♕h3+ ♔g7 29 ♕h6+ ♔f6 30 ♗f5, with a decisive initiative.

26 ♕f3 ♘c4?! 27 ♖e7

With several threats, such as 28 ♖c7, 28 ♗e3, etc.

1-0

170) Skripchenko – Zatonskikh

Dresden Women's Olympiad 2008

White missed **33 ♘xh6+!**:

a) 33...♔f8 fails to 34 ♖g6 ♕d7 (or 34...♘f6 35 ♖xg7! ♔xg7 36 ♘f5+ and the black queen is lost) 35 ♖xg7! ♔xg7 36 ♘f5+ ♔f6 37 g4 with the threat of 38 ♕h6#, winning.

b) 33...♔h7 34 ♘xf7! ♘xg3 35 fxg3 ♕e1+ (35...♕d7 36 ♘xd8 ♕xd8 37 ♕f5+ ♔g8 38 g4 c6 39 g5 with a winning endgame) 36 ♔h2 ♖f8 37 ♕f5+ ♔g8 38 h6! ♖xf7 39 h7+ ♔h8 40 ♕xf7 ♔xh7 41 ♕h5+ ♔g8 42 ♕xd5+ ♔h7 43 ♕f5+ and White captures the c7-pawn with a decisive endgame advantage.

171) D.G. Petrosian – Arutinian

Armenian Team Ch, Erevan 2008

Black's material advantage is only temporary, but he can exploit the bad situation of the white king.

31...♘g3+! 32 ♔h2 ♕f4! 33 ♔h3

33 ♕xc5 loses to 33...♘e4+.

33...♘f5 34 ♕e1 ♗f2 0-1

35 ♕xf2 ♕xe5 gives Black an extra rook.

172) Cornette – Lazić

Mulhouse 2008

29 ♕d5+! 1-0

If 29...♔h8 then 30 ♕xf5, winning.

173) Smikovski – Tuzhik

Tomsk 2008

After any 'normal' move, the white queen would remain out of play, but now it can receive support:

23 ♘g6! ♘h7

After 23...fxg6 24 hxg6, mate is unavoidable.

24 ♘xe5 ♘xe5 25 ♗xf7+! 1-0

Strongest; the queen regains the piece and gets out of jail after 25...♘xf7 26 ♕g6+.

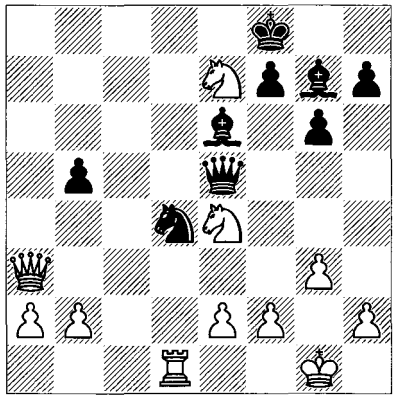
174) Zhumabaev – Nechepurenko

Tomsk 2008

There are three white pieces attacked, but the main element in the position is the weakness of the black king.

28 ♕a3! *(D)*

B



Threatening to mate or win a lot of material with the discovered check.

28...b4

After 28...♘xe2+ 29 ♔f1 ♗h3+ 30 ♔e1 there is no defence.

29 ♕xb4 ♔e8

Now if 29...♘xe2+ all three king moves are winning.

30 ♘g8 1-0

There is no defence; mate on e7 is threatened, and if 30...♗f8 (or 30...♘c6 31 ♕b7) then 31 ♘gf6+ wins.

175) Hector – E. Berg

Swedish Ch, Växjö 2008

40 ♖xh4!

Eliminating the dangers to his own king, while maintaining terrible threats against the black king.

40...♖xh4?

40...♖xf5 41 ♖xh7 ♖f4 42 b3 does not save the game either.

41 ♖e7 1-0

176) Kariakin – Short

Rapid match (game 1), Kiev 2008

37 ♕xf6! 1-0

37...♕xf6 38 g4#.

177) Bhat – Burmakin

Benasque 2008

33 ♕xc7! 1-0

If 33...♖xc7 then 34 ♖d8+ mates, while after 33...h3+ 34 ♔g1 the d1-square is covered.

178) Ubilava – N. Mamedov

Benasque 2008

26 ♖c3! ♖g8 27 ♘g3

and White won. 27 ♘g7! is quicker, with mate in four.

179) Meijers – Halkias

Kavala 2008

28...♖xb6!

The weakness of the back rank allows Black to win a pawn and bring a fresh piece into the attack. If the white rook moves aside, then 29...♖b2 is possible.

29 ♕d1

29 ♖xb6? allows a forced mate by 29...♕e1+ 30 ♔h2 ♗g1+ 31 ♔h1 ♗f2+.

29...♗e5 30 ♔g1 ♕h2+ 31 ♔f2 ♗d4+ 32 ♔f3 e5! 0-1

180) Kuhn – Motylev

Mainz (Chess960) 2008

21...♖xg2!

The white pieces are unable to come to the aid of the king, which will be mated.

22 ♔xg2 ♕g4+ 23 ♔h1 ♗xf3+ 24 ♗xf3 ♕xf3+ 25 ♔g1 ♘h4 0-1

181) Ju. Bolbochán – Rossetto

Argentine Ch match (game 5), Buenos Aires 1948

44 ♔d3! 1-0

There is no satisfactory defence against 45 ♘e7#.

182) Gorini – Ju. Bolbochán

Remedios de Escalada 1949

54...♖c8! (another incarcerated king) **55 ♖a7+ ♔f6 56 ♖xd6+ ♔f5 0-1**.

183) Rossetto – Najdorf

Mar del Plata 1955

28...♖e3!

The rook is taboo, while Black's threat is 29...♖xg3+.

29 ♔h2 f4! 30 f3 fxg3+ 31 ♔g2 ♕e6!

Black continues to play with great energy and the attack is unstoppable.

32 hxg5 ♖xe2+ 33 ♔xg3 ♕d6+ 34 f4 ♖g2+ 35 ♔h3 ♕e6+ 36 f5 ♖xf5 37 ♖e1 ♖f3++ 0-1

184) Bronstein – Marini
Mar del Plata 1960

40 ♘g5! 1-0

Threatening mate on h7, and if 40...♕g7 then the simple 41 ♕xg7+ ♔xg7 42 ♘xe6++ leads to a winning endgame. Even worse are 40...♕xh6 41 ♘f7# and 40...♕e7 41 ♘xh7 ♕xh7 42 ♕f6+.

185) Guimard – Najdorf
Mar del Plata 1962

31...♘e2+! (incarcerating the white king on the h-file) **32 ♔h2 ♖f4 0-1**.

186) Goldsztejn – Degraeve
La Fere 2008

23...♘dxe3!

23...♕h2+? 24 ♔f1 achieves nothing tangible and now if 24...♘dxe3+? 25 ♖xe3 ♖xd4 26 ♗xd4 ♖c1+ 27 ♔e2 Black even stands worse.

24 fxe3

Here 24 ♖xe3 ♖xd4! 25 ♗xd4? ♖c1+ leads to mate.

24...♕h2+ 25 ♔f1 ♕h1+ 26 ♔e2 ♕xg2+ 27 ♔d1 ♕xe4

with an attack and a material advantage.

187) Gozzoli – Meijers
La Fere 2008

35 ♗e4+!

Beginning a fierce attack.

35...♔g7 36 ♖xf6! ♔xf6 37 ♗e5+

37 ♕d5 was another way to win.

37...♔xe5 38 ♕d5+ ♔f6 39 ♕f5+ ♔g7 40 ♕g5+ 1-0

After 40...♔h8 41 ♕h6+ ♔g8 42 ♕h7+ White mates.

188) Staniszewski – A. Grigorian
Najdorf Memorial, Warsaw 2008

23...♘f3+!!

Decisively weakening White's castled position, after which the white king will be unable to survive the attack.

24 gxf3 ♖xe2! 25 ♕xe2 ♕g3+ 26 ♔h1 ♕xh3+ 27 ♔g1 ♗c7! 28 f4 ♘g4 0-1

189) Ab. Gupta – Caspi
World Junior Ch, Gaziantep 2008

38 ♕xh8+!

The only move, but it wins. If 38 ♕g5? then 38...♕xe4, while 38 ♘f4? is harmless after 38...♕e8 39 ♕g3 ♗xe3 and 40...♕e5.

38...♔xh8 39 ♗xd4 ♕xe4

Or 39...♔g7 40 ♘xf6.

40 ♖c8+ ♔g7 41 ♗xf6+ ♖xf6 42 ♖c7+ ♔h6 43 ♖h7+ ♔g5 44 ♘xf6 1-0

190) Ronchetti – Nguyen Ngoc Truong Son
World Junior Ch, Gaziantep 2008

31...♘xg2! 32 ♖xg2

Or 32 ♕d1 ♘e3 33 ♗xe3 ♕h3 34 ♖eb2 fxe3 and Black wins.

32...♖xg2 33 ♔xg2 ♖g6+ 34 ♔f2 ♕h3 35 ♗xf4 ♕g2+ 36 ♔e3 ♕g1+ 0-1

191) Can – León Hoyos
World Junior Ch, Gaziantep 2008

32 f8♕+!

The quickest, forcing mate.

32...♗xf8 33 ♕xf8+ ♘xf8 34 ♖xf8+ ♔g7 35 ♖f7+ 1-0

35...♔h8 36 ♖h7+ ♔g8 37 ♘f6+ ♔f8 38 ♖f7#.

192) Amin – Sengupta
World Junior Ch, Gaziantep 2008

25 ♘xe7!

Sacrificing an exchange in order to expose the black king even more.

25...fxe4

25...♕xe7 is met by 26 ♕xf5.

26 ♕g4+ ♔f7 27 ♕g6+ ♔xe7 28 ♕g7+ ♔e8 29 ♕xh8+ ♕f8 30 ♕xh4

and White won.

193) Brkić – Amin
World Junior Ch, Gaziantep 2008

47...♘g3+!

Black is a rook down, so he has to act very quickly. Not 47...♖d2? on account of 48 ♖g1!.

48 ♖xg3 ♖d2 0-1

194) Nedev – Stojcevski
Macedonian Team Ch, Struga 2008

44...♗xg2+! 45 ♖xg2 ♕a1+ 46 ♖g1 ♕xg1+! 0-1

The endgame is an easy win for Black after 47 ♔xg1 ♘f3+ and ...♘xe5.

195) Charbonneau – Kudrin
Internet 2008

47 ♖xe4!!

Eliminating a vital defender. 47 ♗h5? ♘d6 is better for Black.

47...♕xe4

If 47...dxe4 then 48 ♗c4 ♕e7 49 ♖d1! (the threat is 50 ♗xf7 and 51 ♖d8+, winning the black queen) 49...♖a8 and now 50 ♖d6! is an elegant way to bring the rook into play with decisive effect. A possible continuation is 50...♖c8 51 ♕h6+ ♔e8 (or 51...♔g8 52 ♖xf6) 52 ♗xf7+ ♕xf7 53 ♖xf6 ♕g8 54 ♖e6+ ♔d7 55 ♖g6.

48 ♗h5 ♖c7 49 ♕xf6+ ♔g8 50 ♕d8+ ♔g7 51 ♕xc7+ ♔h6 52 ♕d6+ 1-0

196) Erenburg – Sammour Hasbun
Internet 2008

22 ♖d3!!

Heading for h3.

22...♗f8

22...♗c8 gives up control of d5 and is punished by 23 ♘d5 ♕d7 24 ♗xe5 dxe5 (24...fxe5 25 ♖dg3 ♗f8 26 ♗d3 also wins) 25 ♗h5!, while 22...♘xd3+ 23 ♗xd3 leaves Black defenceless; e.g., 23...♗d8 24 ♕h7+ ♔f8 25 ♕h8+ ♔e7 26 ♗f5!.

23 ♖h3 ♖e7 24 ♕xf6

With the f-file now also open, the attack is easier.

24...♕d7 25 ♕h6 ♕f5 26 ♕h8+ ♔f7 27 ♖f1 1-0

197) Dudzinski – Mielczarski
Ustron 2008

24 ♘xg6!

A typical demolition of the castled position, followed by a swift invasion.

24...hxg6 25 ♕h4 ♘f8 26 ♕h8+ ♔f7 27 ♗xg6+! ♔xg6

27...♘xg6 28 ♖h7#.

28 ♕h5+ 1-0

28...♔g7 29 ♖g3+ leads to a quick mate.

198) L. Domínguez – Buhmann
Dresden Olympiad 2008

39 ♗xh6+!

Another way to win was **39 ♘hf5+!** gxf5 40 ♗xh6+ ♔xh6 41 ♕xf6+ ♔h7 42 exf5, bringing the b4-rook into play.

39...♔xh6 40 ♕xf6 ♔h7

Or 40...♖g8 41 ♘hf5+ ♔h7 (41...♘xf5 42 ♘xf5+ ♔h7 43 ♖b7 mates quickly, since the black queen has to stay on d1 to defend against ♕h4+) 42 ♕h4+.

41 ♖b7 ♖d7 42 ♘f3! 1-0

Threatening 43 ♘g5+ and mate in three, and if 42...♕c1 then 43 ♕f7+ ♔h6 44 ♘e2! ♕c5 45 ♕f8+ ♔h7 46 ♘g5#.

199) Navara – Gi. Hernández
Dresden Olympiad 2008

49 h3! ♕xb5

Or 49...gxh3 50 ♕f5+ ♖g5 51 g4+ ♔h4 52 ♗g3#, while 49...♕xd6 does not defend against the main threat of 50 ♕f5+ ♖g5 51 hxg4#.

50 ♗e5

Renewing the threat.

50...♖g5 51 hxg4+ ♖xg4 52 ♕f5+ ♖g5 53 ♕h3+ ♔g6 54 ♕e6+ ♔h5 55 ♕f7+ ♖g6 56 g4+! 1-0

200) Stefansson – A.R. Salem
Dresden Olympiad 2008

26...f4! 27 ♗xe6

If 27 g4 then 27...♕e7, followed by ...♕xg5, is good enough.

27...fxg3+ 28 ♔g1

28 ♔h3 is met by 28...♖xf2! (with the threat of 29...♖h2+ and ...♕f4#) 29 ♘d5 (or 29 ♗f5 gxf5, with a material advantage and the attack) 29...♖h2+ 30 ♔xg3 ♕f2+ 31 ♔g4 ♖h4#.

28...♖xf2 29 ♖d3 ♖h2 0-1

It is soon mate; e.g., 30 ♖f1 ♖h1+.

201) Bagheri – Stević
Dresden Olympiad 2008

12...♖a3!

With the threat of 13...♖xg3.

13 e3?!

13 ♘f3 ♕c3+ 14 ♘d2 ♕xb4 was better, but still unpleasant.

13...♘xe3! 14 fxe3 ♖xe3+ 15 ♗e2 ♗a6

with a material advantage and the attack.

202) Mamedyarov – Adly
Dresden Olympiad 2008

23 ♗xh7!

White opens the h-file and Black soon has to give up material to avoid mate.

23...♔xh7 24 ♗f8+ ♔g8 25 ♗xe7 f5

Worse is 25...♕xe7 26 ♕g4+ ♔f8 27 ♖h8#.

26 ♗xd6 ♗xd6 27 ♕xf5

and White won.

203) Bacrot – Leko
FIDE Grand Prix, Elista 2008

31 ♕h7+! 1-0

Black is mated after 31...♔xh7 (or 31...♔f8 32 ♗b4+) 32 hxg7+ ♔g8 33 ♖h8#.

204) Moskalenko – L. Rojas
Montcada i Reixac 2008

35...♔f7!

The c8-rook joins in the attack and there is no satisfactory defence.

36 ♖f2 ♖h8+ 37 ♔g1 ♖h4

Winning a pawn, and allowing the knight to assist in the attack.

38 ♕c2 ♘xf4 39 e6+ ♔xe6 40 ♕c6+ ♔e7 41 ♕c7+ ♔f6 42 ♖c2 ♘h3+ 43 ♔f1? ♕d1# (0-1)

205) S. Kovačević – Granda
Benasque 2008

48...♗xf3+! 49 ♔xf3

49 ♔f2 is likewise met by 49...♕h3.

49...♕h3+ 50 ♔e2 ♕xh2+ 51 ♔e1

Or 51 ♔f3 ♕xd2 52 ♘xc4 ♕f4+ 53 ♔g2 ♕xe4+ 54 ♔g3 ♘xc4.

51...♗h4+ 52 ♔d1 ♕g1+ 53 ♔e2 ♕f2+ 54 ♔d1 ♕f3+ 0-1

If 55 ♕e2 then 55...♖d4+.

206) Franco – Pogorelov
Albox (rapid) 2001

1 ♖xe6!

1 ♘e5? ♕b7 achieves nothing.

1...g6?

Weakening the king, after which the attack will be decisive. Instead, 1...fxe6 brings about an endgame: 2 ♕xe6+ ♔h8 3 ♘e5 h6 (3...♖f8 4 ♘f7+ ♖xf7 5 ♕xf7 is similar) 4 ♘f7+ ♔h7 5 ♘xd8 ♕xd8 6 ♕d5! (6 ♕f5+ ♔h8 7 ♔f1 is another favourable endgame) 6...♕b6 (6...♕xd5 is not playable: 7 cxd5 ♔g6 8 f4 ♔f6 9 ♔f2 ♔e7 10 ♔f3 ♔d6 11 ♔e4) 7 ♔g2, with an extra pawn and a great advantage. White's c-pawn is stronger than Black's d-pawn, and the white king is safer, as well as able to come into play.

2 ♕f6 fxe6 3 ♕xe6+

Even stronger is 3 ♘g5!.

3...♔g7

No better is 3...♔f8 4 ♘e5 ♕a7 5 ♕f6+ ♔e8 6 ♕h8+ ♔e7 7 ♕xh7+ or 3...♔h8 4 ♕f6+ ♔g8 5 ♘g5.

4 ♕e7+ ♔h6 5 ♘e5 ♖g8 6 ♘g4+ 1-0

207) Marin – A. Graf
Spanish Team Ch, Sanxenxo 2004

24 e4!

Opening the d-file, after which all the white pieces can join in the attack.

24...♘c3

If 24...hxg4 then 25 ♕d3 ♕xe5 (or 25...♖xc5 26 ♖xc5 ♘b6 27 ♖xc7 ♕h5 28 ♗g2, winning) 26 ♗d4!.

The retreat 24...♘b6 is refuted with 25 ♗xb6 ♖xc4 26 ♕d3 ♗xa4 27 ♗e3 ♕e7 28 ♕xc4 ♗xd1 29 ♕b5+! ♔f8 30 ♗c5.

25 ♖xd7!

Stripping the black king of all his armour.

25...♔xd7 26 ♕xf7+ ♔c8 27 ♗e3 ♕xe5

27...♕g8 loses to 28 ♕xg8+ ♖xg8 29 ♖xc6 hxg4 30 ♗c4 and the extra piece is decisive.

28 ♖xc6 hxg4 29 ♗f4 ♘e2+ 30 ♗xe2 ♕a1+ 31 ♖c1! 1-0

Avoiding the last trap: not 31 ♗f1? ♖h1+! with a draw.

208) Svidler – Vitiugov
Russian Ch, Moscow 2007

21 ♖xb6!

Queen and knight are a fearsome attacking force. The rook is sacrificed to weaken the defences.

21...♖e4

If 21...axb6 then 22 ♕b5+ ♔d8 23 ♕xb6+ ♔d7 24 ♕b7+ ♔e6 25 ♘f4+.

22 ♖b7+ ♔e6 23 f3 ♖d4 24 ♕xd4

24 ♘f4+! is faster: 24...♖xf4 25 ♕e3+ ♔d5 26 ♕b3+ ♔e5 27 ♖b5+ ♔xf6 28 ♕c3+ ♔e7 29 ♖e1+, mating quickly.

1-0

Although Black could struggle on for a few more moves, there is no hope after 24...♕xf1+ 25 ♔d2 ♗h6+ 26 f4! ♕g2+ 27 ♔c1 ♖e8 28 ♖e7+ ♖xe7 29 ♕e3+.

209) Sashikiran – Ponomariov
Zafra (rapid) 2007

28 ♖e1!

The queen is defending two key points, preventing the entry of the white queen on f7, while also controlling e5. Now it has to give up the defence of one of these squares.

28...♕xc4

28...♕c6 and 28...♕d6 are both met by 29 ♕f7! with the unstoppable threat of 30 ♗g7+ followed by ♖e8+.

If 28...♕d7 then the main idea is 29 ♘e5! fxe5 30 ♕xe5+ ♖g7 31 ♕f6! with threats of 32 ♖e8+ and 32 ♗xg7+, followed by ♖e8+.

29 ♘e5! 1-0

210) Santiago – Milos

Brazilian Ch, Rio de Janeiro 2007

18...♖xc2! 19 f4

19 ♔xc2 is met by 19...♕a4+ 20 ♔d2 ♘c4+ 21 ♔e1 ♘xe3.

19...♕a4 20 fxe5 ♖fc8

Threatening 21...♖xb2+.

21 ♖c1 dxe5

Now the e7-bishop comes into the game.

22 ♗g1 b3! 23 axb3

23 a3 fails to 23...♖xb2+!.

23...♖xc1+ 24 ♘xc1 ♗xe4+ 25 ♖d3 ♖xc1+! 0-1

If 26 ♔xc1 then 26...♕a1+.

211) Van Ketel – Sandipan

Leiden 2008

25...♘h5!

With a few accurate moves, Black succeeds in activating all his forces against the white king.

26 ♗xh5 ♕h1+! 27 ♔e2 ♕xh5+ 28 ♔e1 ♕h1+ 29 ♔e2 ♗h4! 30 ♖xg7+ ♔f8 31 ♖xh7

After 31 ♗d4, the simple 31...♕f3+ 32 ♔f1 ♖xd4 is good enough.

31...♕f3+ 32 ♔f1 ♖d1+ 33 ♗e1 ♕h1+ 34 ♔e2 ♕xe1# (0-1)

212) Valerga – Lemos

Argentine Ch, Mendoza 2008

21 ♘e4! ♗g7

White is better after 21...fxe4 22 ♗xe4 ♖fe8 23 ♕xh7+ ♔f8 24 ♘xe6+ ♖xe6 25 dxe6 ♖xd1 26 ♖xd1 ♗xe4 27 ♕xe4, with a material advantage and the initiative.

22 ♘g5 h6 23 dxe6 hxg5 24 e7 ♗xg2 25 ♕xg5

and White won. 25 exf8♕+ ♔xf8 26 ♘xf5 is even stronger.

213) Brenjo – Ivanisević

Zlatibor 2008

25 ♖xg7+!

The shortage of black defensive pieces, such as the queen, means that White has many attacking resources and will at least recover the sacrificed material.

25...♔xg7 26 ♗xh6+! ♔g8

More complicated, although equally advantageous for White, is 26...♔g6 27 ♕e5! ♔xh6 28 ♕xf6+ ♔h7 29 ♕xf7+ ♔h8 30 ♕f6+ ♔h7 31 b3!! (to force the queen away from the control of d7) 31...♕b4 (31...♕d4? 32 ♖c7+) 32 ♕f7+ ♔h8 33 ♕h5+ ♔g8 34 ♕g6+ ♔f8 35 ♕f6+ ♔g8 36 ♕xe6+ ♔f8 37 ♕f5+ ♔g7 (37...♔g8 38 ♗d5+) 38 ♖c7+ ♖d7 39 ♖xd7+ ♗xd7 40 ♕e5+ and the b8-rook is lost.

27 ♕xf6 ♕d4 28 ♕g5+ ♔h7 29 ♕h5

29 ♖c7 ♖d7 30 ♖xd7 ♗xd7 31 ♕h5 ♔g8 32 ♗f4, followed by 33 ♗e5, is quicker.

29...♔g8 30 ♖c7 ♗e8 31 ♖c4! 1-0

214) Fedorchuk – Guilleux

Paris 2008

17 ♘e6+!

Opening lines against the black king, to the benefit of White's very superior development.

17...fxe6 18 ♗xf6 gxf6

Or 18...♗xf6 19 ♖d7 ♕c8 20 ♕h5 ♕e8 21 ♕xe8+ ♖xe8 22 ♖xb7 ♖d8 23 fxe6.

19 ♖d7 ♕b6

If 19...♕c8 then 20 ♕h5 h6 21 ♕g6 regains the piece with a decisive advantage; for example, 21...♗c6 22 fxe6 ♕e8 23 ♕xe8+ ♖xe8 24 ♗xc6.

20 ♕h5 ♗c8?

Equally hopeless is 20...♖d8 21 ♕h6+ ♔f7 22 ♖xe7+! ♔xe7 23 ♕g7+ ♔d6 24 ♖d1+ ♗d5 25 fxe6, while 20...h6 21 ♕g6 ♖d8 22 ♖xe7! is similar to the game.

21 ♕h6+ ♔f7 22 ♖xe7+! 1-0

22...♔xe7 23 ♕g7+ ♔d8 24 ♖d1+.

215) Vera – García Martínez

Cuban Ch, Las Tunas 2001

20 ♖xf6!

The security of the black king vanishes with this typical exchange sacrifice.

20...♘xb2

20...gxf6 is met by 21 ♘h5! ♔h8 22 ♘xf6 ♕d6 (or 22...♕c6 23 ♖f1 with the idea of ♕h5) 23 e5 ♕c7 24 ♖c1! (not 24 ♕h5? ♕c2!) 24...♕xc1+ 25 ♗xc1 ♖xc1+ 26 ♔f2 with the ever-present threat of ♕h5.

21 ♘f5! ♕e8?!

Black could have avoided mate with 21...g6, although after 22 ♕xb2 gxf5 23 ♖xf5 ♖c2 24 ♕b4! White retains a valuable extra pawn.

22 ♖f1 ♘c4 23 ♕g4 g6 24 ♘h6+ ♔h8 25 ♘xf7+ ♔g7 26 ♘d6 1-0

216) S. Vega Gutiérrez – Bellón

León 2006

22 ♕xf6+!?

22 ♖g4!, setting up deadly threats on the fourth rank, is even stronger. Then 22...♕b7 23

♕xf6+! leads to a forced mate, which your analysis engine can show you, while 23 ♕a3+ followed by ♕d6 is a strong and more 'human' choice.

22...♔xf6 23 ♗g5+ ♔g7 24 ♗e7+ ♔h6 25 ♗xb4 exd4 26 ♖xd4

with a winning advantage that White converted in 53 moves.

217) Akopian – Kuzubov

Gibraltar 2007

18 ♘xc6!!

It is surprising that this sacrifice is so effective. White manages to strip the black king of his defences with a lightning attack, based on a few tactical points.

18...♔xc6

It is more tenacious to accept the loss of a pawn with 18...♖xd1+ 19 ♖xd1 ♕c5 20 ♘d4.

19 ♘d5!

The occupation of this square with gain of tempo is possible because the knight is immune from capture. The knight will have a decisive influence.

19...♕e8

Not 19...♗xd5? 20 exd5+ ♔d7 21 ♕b5+, mating.

20 ♕a6!

This is the second key move; the black king will be unable to find a way back to safety.

20...♗f8

Other unsuccessful defences are:

a) 20...♗h6 21 ♗xh6 ♘xh6 22 ♕xa7 ♗xd5 23 exd5+ ♖xd5 24 ♖xd5 ♔xd5 25 ♕xb6 and the black king is defenceless.

b) 20...♖xd5 21 exd5+ ♗xd5 22 ♖xd5! ♔xd5 23 ♖d1+ ♔e6 (23...♔c6 24 ♕a4+ ♔b7 25 ♖d7+) 24 ♕c4+! ♔e7 25 ♕b4+ ♔e6 26 ♕e4+ ♘e5 and here there are several ways to win, such as 27 ♕d5+ ♔e7 28 ♗xe5 fxe5 29 ♕d6+ ♔f7 30 ♖f1+ ♗f6 31 ♕xf6+ ♔g8 32 ♖d1.

21 ♕xa7 ♗c5 22 b4! ♕d7 23 ♕a6 1-0

218) Fluviá – J. García

Spanish Team Ch, Melilla 2008

40 f6!!

Clearing the f5-square!

40...♖xf6 41 ♖xh6+! ♖xh6 42 ♕f5+ ♖g6 43 ♖h3+ ♔g7?

43...♔g8 is better, although White is winning after 44 ♖xh8+ ♔xh8 45 ♕xe5+ ♔h7 46 ♕e7 ♗c6 47 ♕xf7+.

44 ♕xe5+ 1-0

219) A. Evdokimov – Volokitin

Aeroflot Open, Moscow 2008

17...♘xh2!

Black has already sacrificed a piece and now with this pseudo-sacrifice he decisively weakens the white king.

18 ♘g5

Obviously not 18 ♔xh2? ♕h4#. If 18 ♖d1 then 18...♕h4 19 g3 ♕h3 20 ♘g5 ♕xg3, while after 18 g3 ♘xf1 19 ♗xf1 ♗f5 20 ♗d3 ♗xe4+ 21 ♗xe4 f5! the black pieces decisively invade White's camp: 22 ♗f3 ♖e1+ 23 ♔h2 ♕f8!; this is the other strong way to bring the queen into play.

18...♘xf1 19 ♗xf1 ♖e1 20 ♘d2 ♕f8! 21 ♖a3 ♕h6+ 22 ♖h3

Or 22 ♘h3 ♗xh3 23 ♖xh3 ♕xf4, followed by ...♖ae8, with a material advantage and the initiative.

22...♗xh3 23 ♘xh3 ♕h5 24 ♔h2 ♕d1 0-1

220) Kramnik – Anand

Amber Rapid, Nice 2008

The tempting 42...♖h1+? 43 ♗xh1 ♕h2+ 44 ♔f1 ♕xh1+ 45 ♔e2 ♕e4+ 46 ♔d2 ♕d4+ 47 ♔e2 ♕e4+ only yields a draw.

42...♕f3!! 43 cxb7+ ♔f5!

Not 43...♔g5? 44 ♗xf3 gxf3 45 ♕d8+! ♖xd8 46 ♖c3! and White manages to draw; for example, 46...♖dh8 47 ♖xf3 ♖h1+ 48 ♔g2 ♖xc1 49 a5 ♖xc5 50 a6 ♖a5 51 ♖c3! ♖xa6 52 ♖c8.

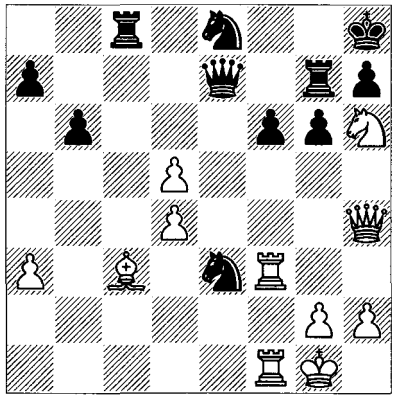
0-1

4 Intermediate and Complex Puzzles

This is the longest chapter, with 200 puzzles, with hints or other instructions for the first 90. For the remaining 110 you are just given the position and told who is to move, presenting you with the 'real-game' situation of simply deciding what you should play next. Choose carefully, as the result of the game may well be hanging in the balance.

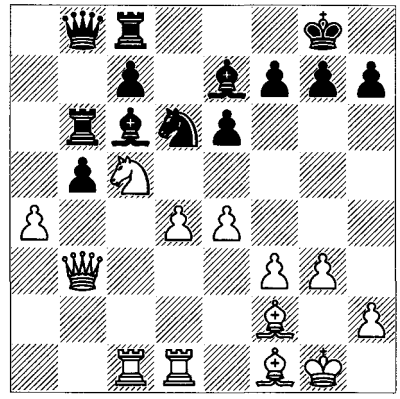
From 221 to 310 the puzzles increase in difficulty from level 1 to level 4. In puzzle 311 (the first without a hint) the level goes back down to level 1 and then begins to rise again, up to puzzle 420.

221
W



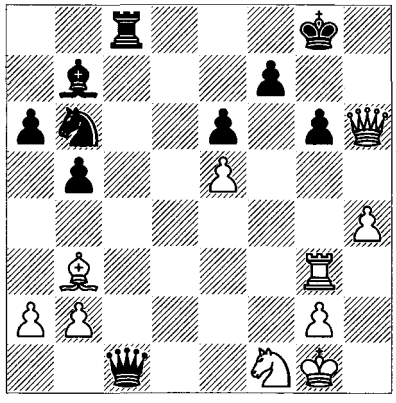
The e3-knight is lodged in White's camp, but what is protecting it?

223
W



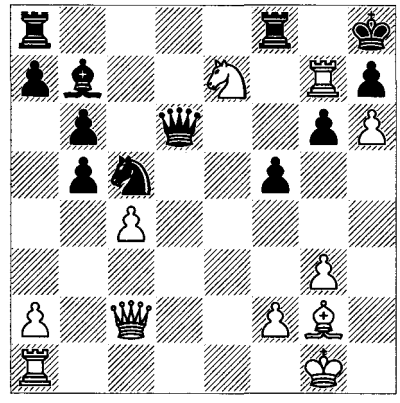
Black is short of space, and this can be exploited immediately.

222
W



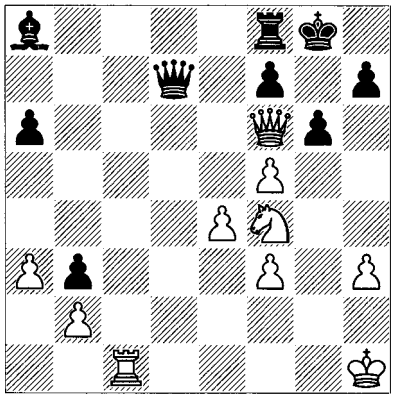
What is the quickest way to finish off the black king?

224
W



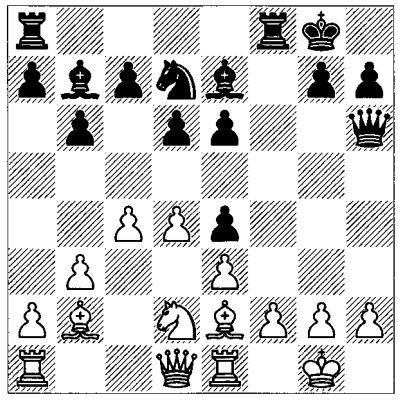
The black king is boxed in. How can this be used to force checkmate?

225
W



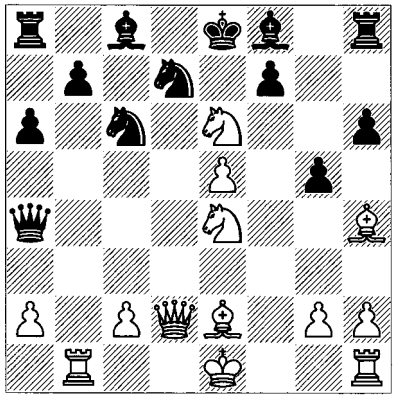
How can White take advantage of the dominant position of his queen?

228
B



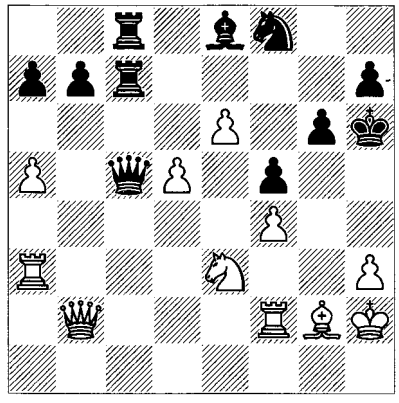
There is one particularly weak square in the white king's position... namely?

226
W



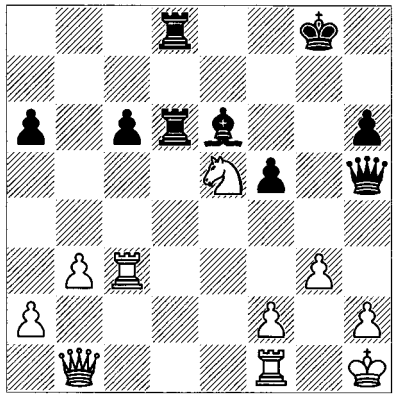
The black king is vulnerable to many different mating patterns. How can this best be demonstrated?

229
W



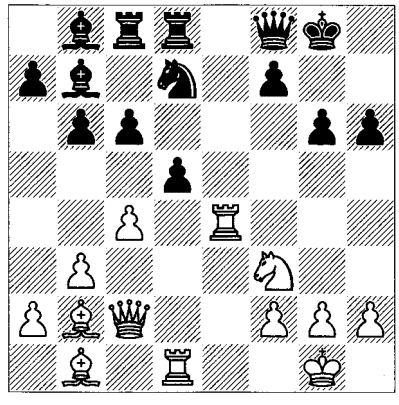
What is the quickest way to convert White's great advantage?

227
B



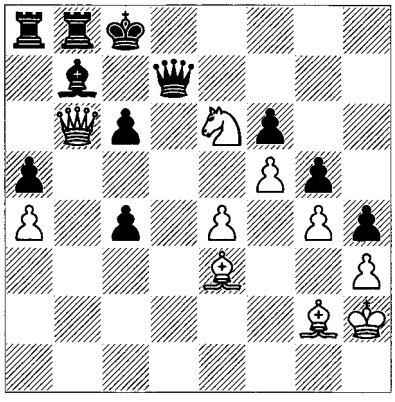
Here it is the white king whose position is fatally weak on the light squares. How can Black exploit this?

230
W



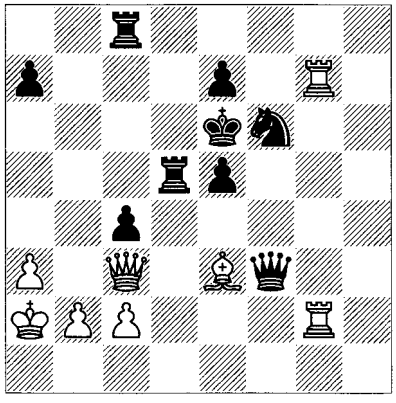
Black's kingside is weakened and White has two tremendous bishops aimed in that direction. How can White exploit this?

231
W



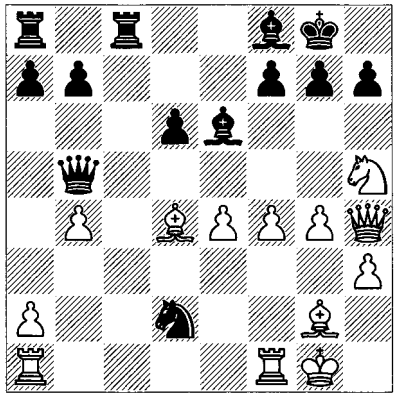
White is two exchanges down, but the black king is curiously hemmed in. How can White take advantage?

232
W



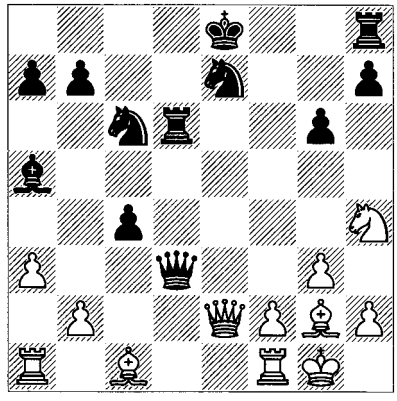
White wins material by making the black queen a tactical weakness.

233
W



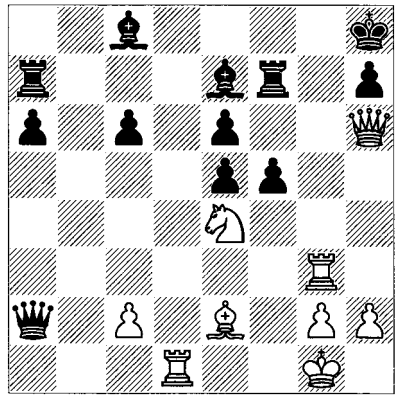
There are three white pieces attacking the black king, and very few defenders. How can White take advantage of this?

234
W



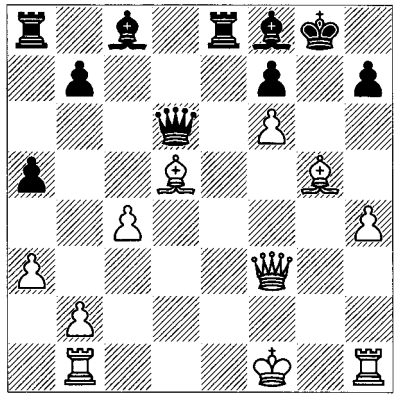
How can White exploit the fact that the black king is still in the centre?

235
W



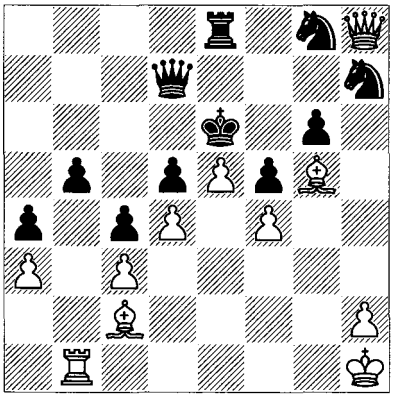
The way in which Black is defending the key invasion squares, such as f8, d8 and g7, seems artificial, don't you think?

236
W



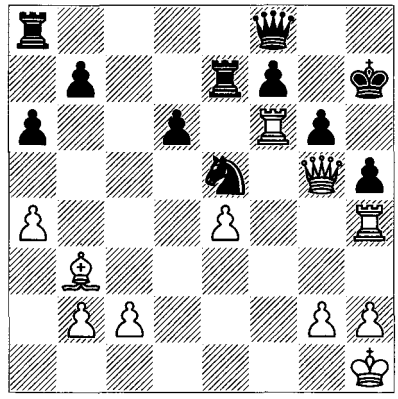
The white king lacks adequate shelter; prove that the black king is even worse off.

237
W



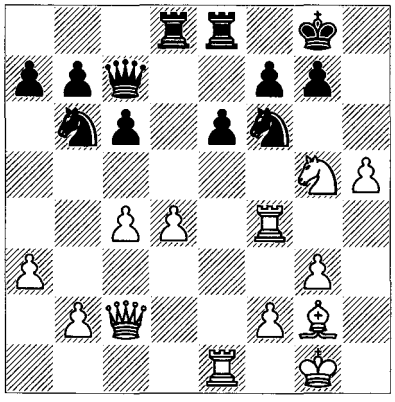
There is a black piece which is overloaded; which one is it?

240
W



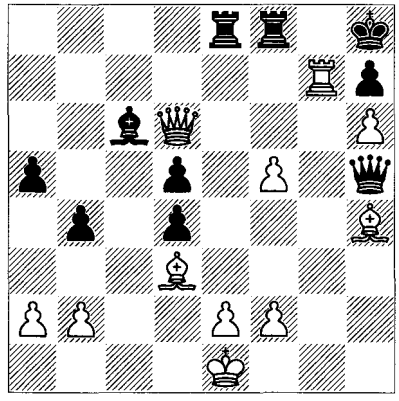
Something extra is needed to break down the black king's defences. How can White add another attacker?

238
W



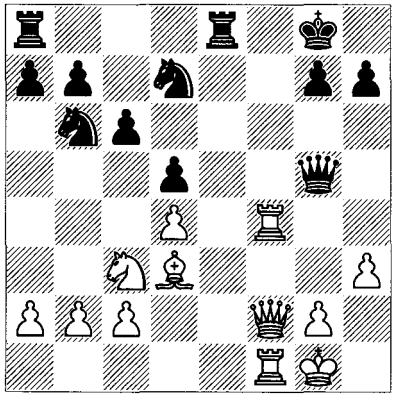
How can the inadequate defence of the black king be exploited?

241
W



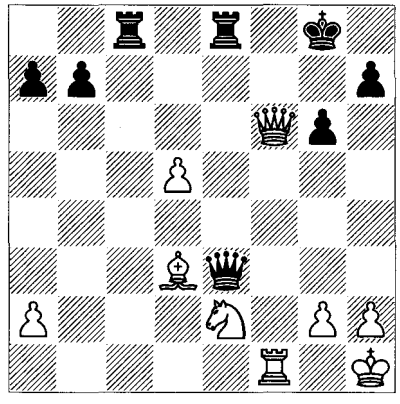
The black king has no moves – a motif with which we are now familiar. How can White exploit this?

239
W



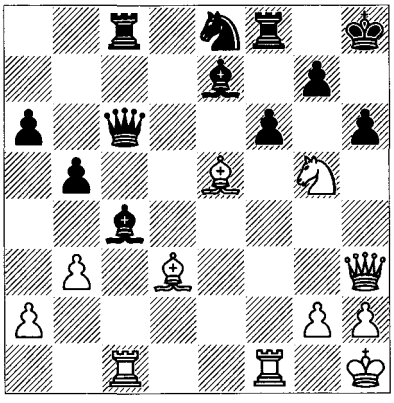
How can White make use of the tremendous force he has accumulated on the kingside?

242
W



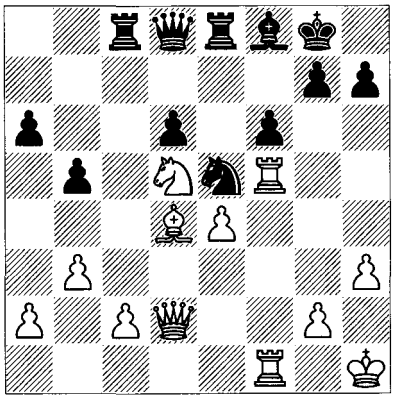
How can White demonstrate that the black king is poorly defended?

243
W



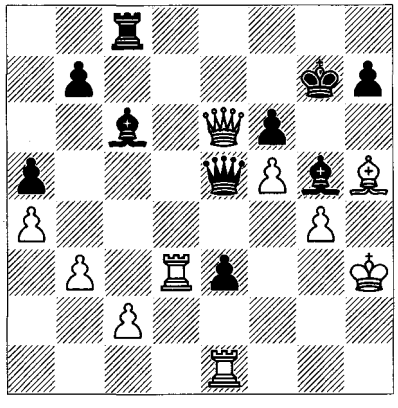
There are several tempting continuations for White, but only one of them wins on the spot. What is it?

244
W



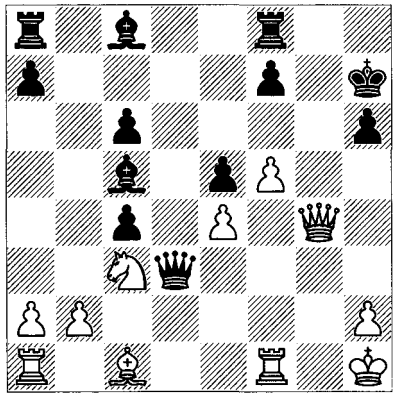
Once again there are many attacking pieces and few defenders. Demonstrate a way to win.

245
B



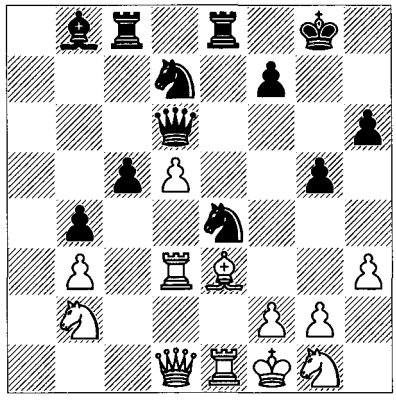
White is the exchange up and has many threats. What would you play here as Black to make sure your attack strikes first?

246
W



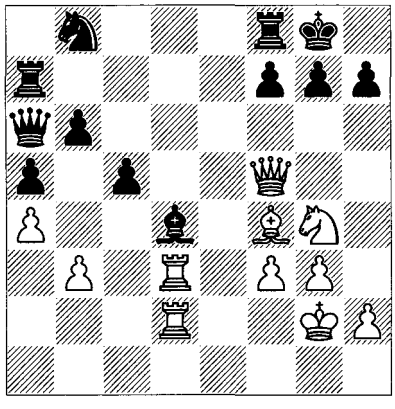
How can White forcefully occupy the g-file with a rook?

247
B



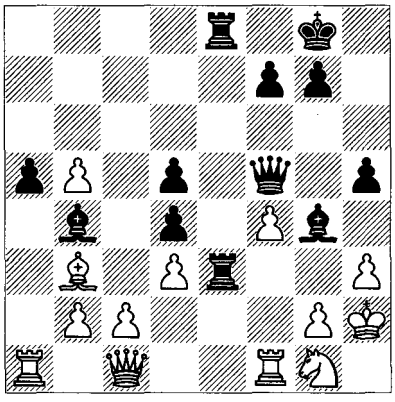
There are two tactical weaknesses in White's camp; what are they?

248
W



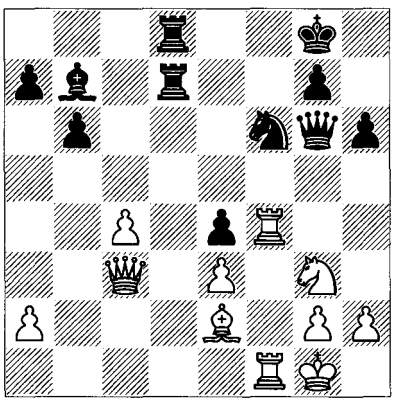
Speed is essential, before Black rallies his defence.

249
B



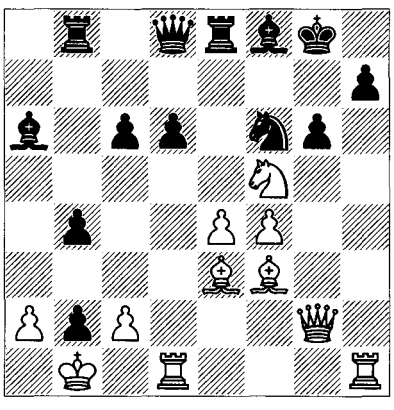
We have another poorly defended king; how can this be exploited?

250
W



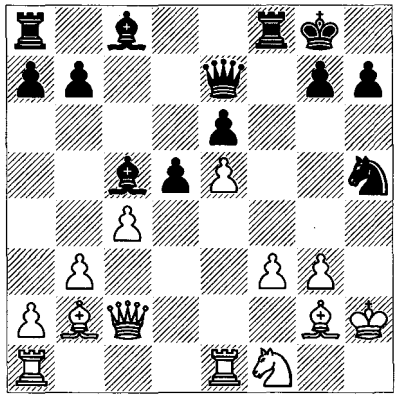
It is true that the black queen is defending the king, but can you demonstrate that this defence is inadequate?

251
W



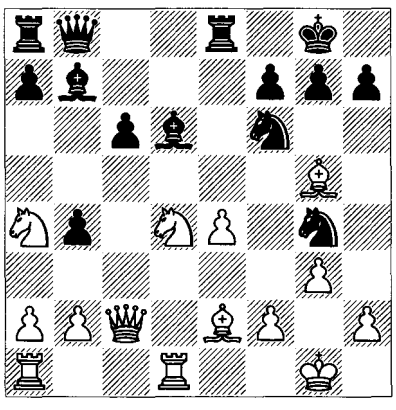
Black's kingside is only sparsely defended, and White has some half-open files... How can White exploit this?

252
B



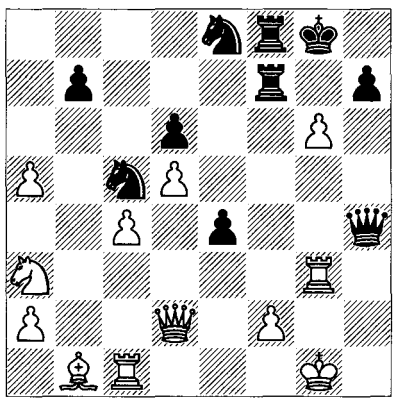
We have a powerful bishop on c5, and White's kingside is very weak. How can we take advantage of this?

253
B



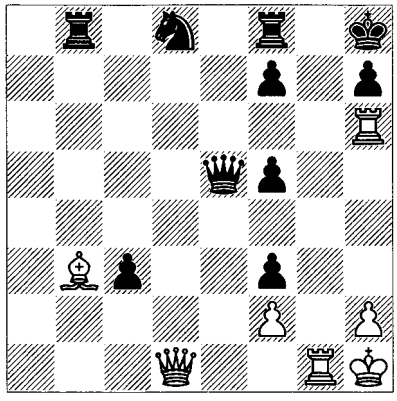
The g5-bishop is undefended and is a tactical weakness. How can this be demonstrated?

254
B



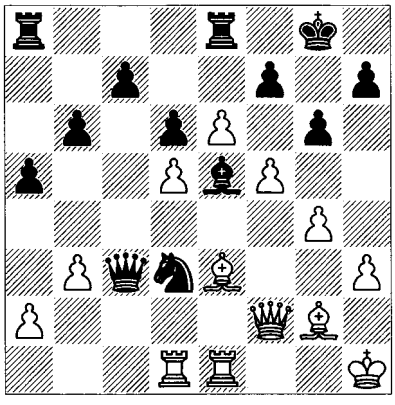
How can Black show that the white king is the weaker of the two? Must he attend to his own defence first?

255
W



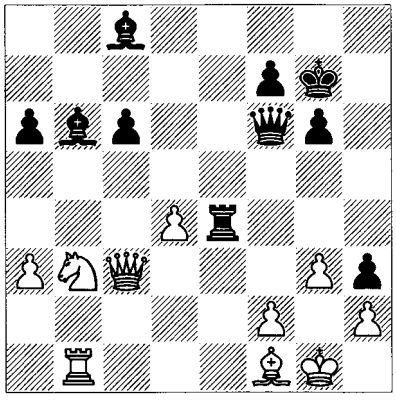
Black has three extra pawns, but this doesn't matter as White can create unstoppable threats to the black king.

256
W



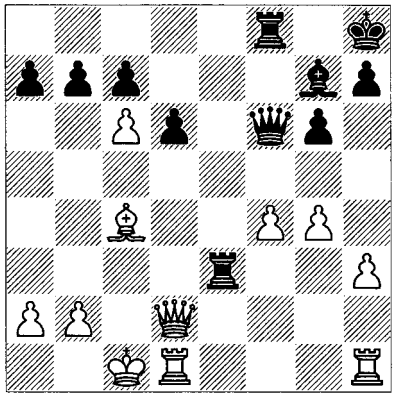
White played 28 ♖xd3? and after 28...♕xd3 29 f6 a4, Black gained counterplay. What better option did he have?

257
W



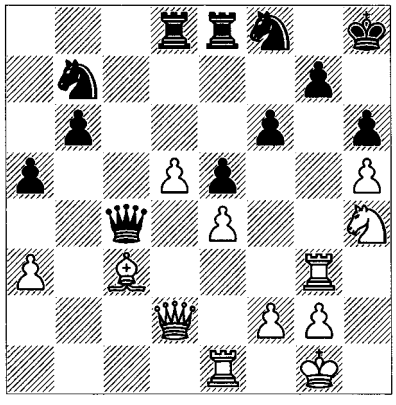
After 33 ♖d1 ♗e6 34 ♘c5 ♗xc5 35 ♕xc5 ♗d5 the game soon ended in a draw. What strong continuation did White miss?

258
W



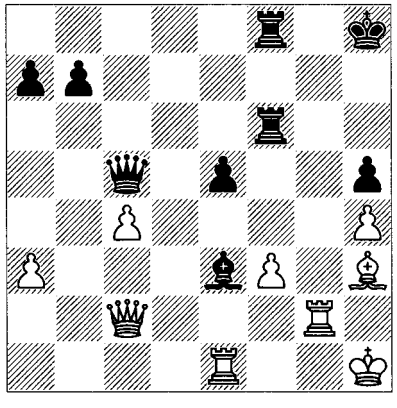
Now 20 ♖df1? ♖e4 21 ♗d3 ♖d4?! 22 g5?! ♕e6 23 ♔b1 ♕d5 24 ♖d1 ♖a4! left Black on top. How should White defend?

259
W



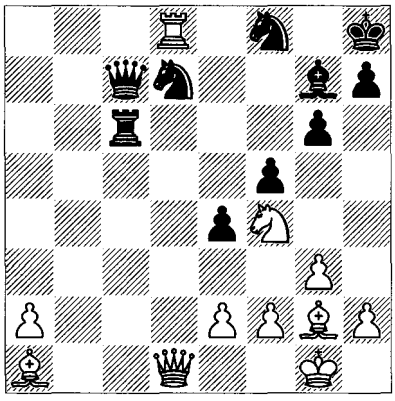
Black's queen is far from the kingside and the b7-knight needs a tempo to reach d6. How can White exploit these fleeting advantages?

260
B



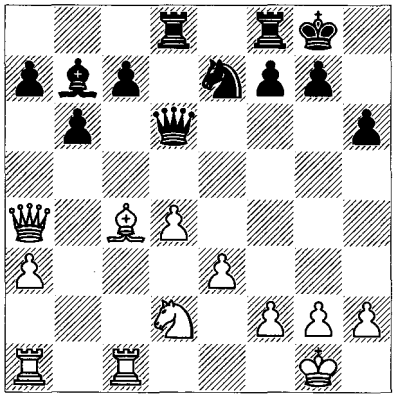
Now 38...♗f4? 39 ♕e4 ♕a5 40 ♖eg1 ♕c7 gave White the better prospects. What better continuation did Black miss?

261
W



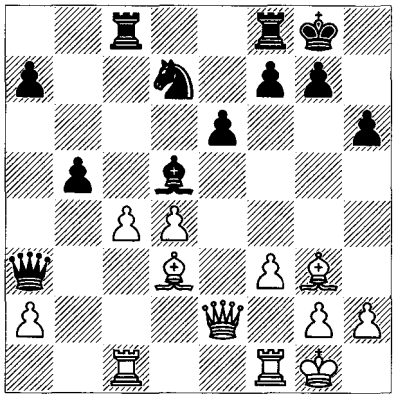
Here 33 ♗xg7+ ♔xg7 34 ♕d4+ left White only a little better. How could he have done far better?

262
W



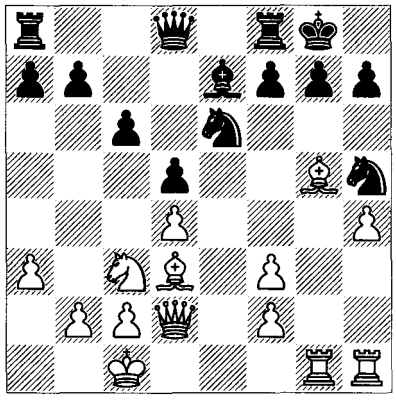
White played 21 ♕xa7? and after 21...♗xg2? 22 ♔xg2 ♕c6+ 23 e4 went on to win. How could Black have refuted 21 ♕xa7?

263
W



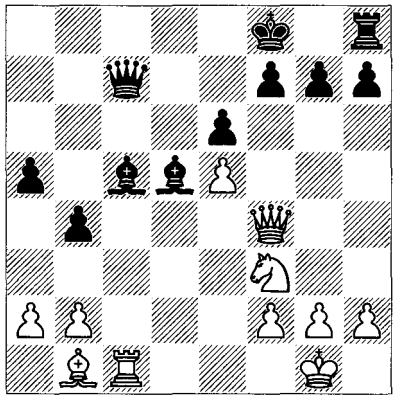
Black's defence is based on the pin on the c-file. How can White defend the c1-rook in an aggressive manner?

264
W



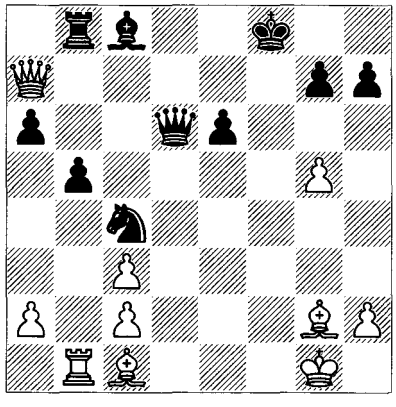
White has a lot of pieces aimed at the black king, and Black has a loose piece. How can White exploit these elements?

265
W



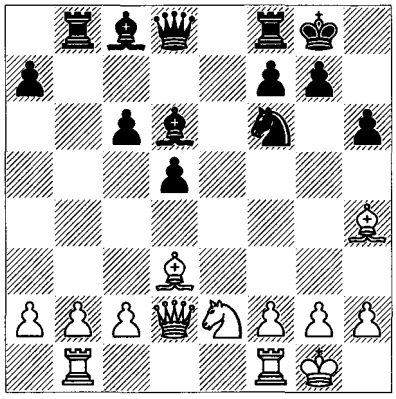
White's lead in development and the poor state of the black king allow White to deliver a devastating blow. What is it?

266
W



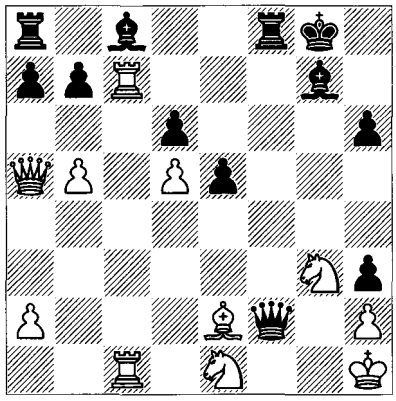
What is the quickest and most effective way for the white rook to come into play?

267
B



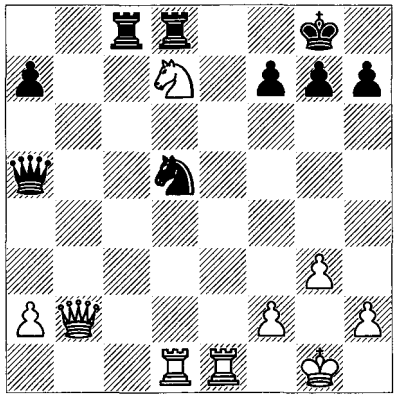
Pins generally exert unpleasant pressure, but can sometimes prove a liability for the pinning side...

268
B



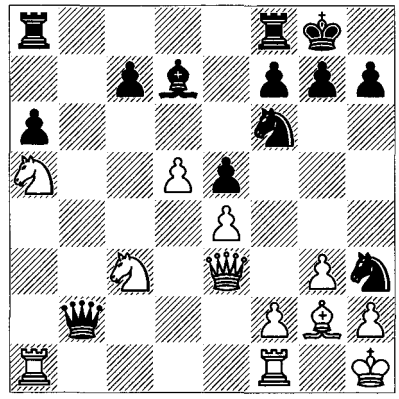
Black is a piece down, but the white king's defences do not appear to be very trustworthy. How can Black exploit this?

269
W



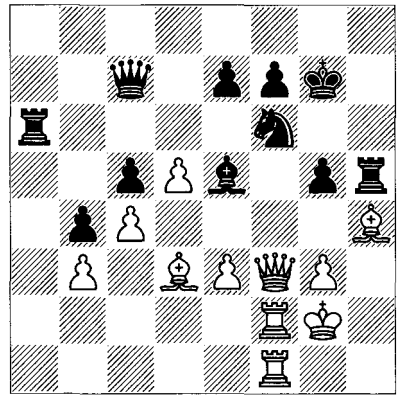
How can a pin and a back-rank mate be combined?

270
W



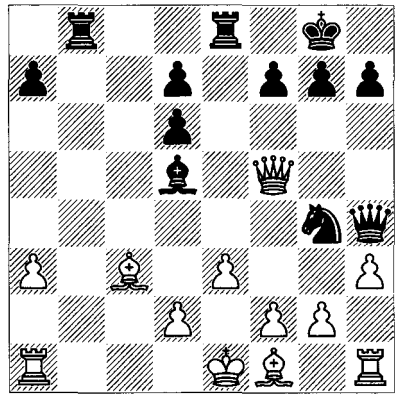
You might be wondering whether the black queen is in danger, so deep in White's camp. Can you prove it?

271
W



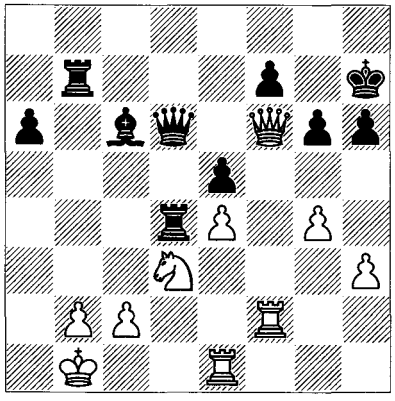
White appears to be losing material, and with it the game, but the opposite is the case. Why?

272
B



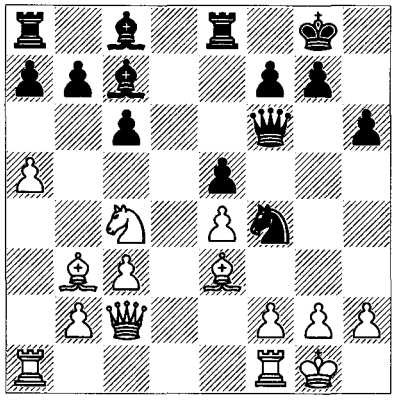
A king in the centre and facing open lines is not usually a good sign. How can Black demonstrate this?

273
B



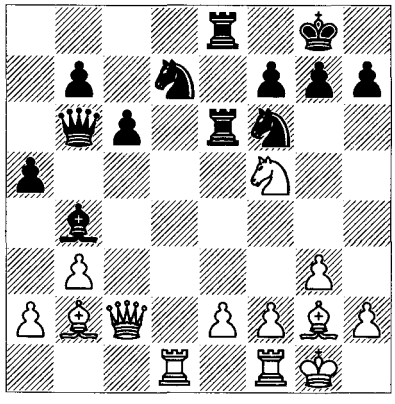
The endgame would not be pleasant for Black; what alternative is there?

274
B



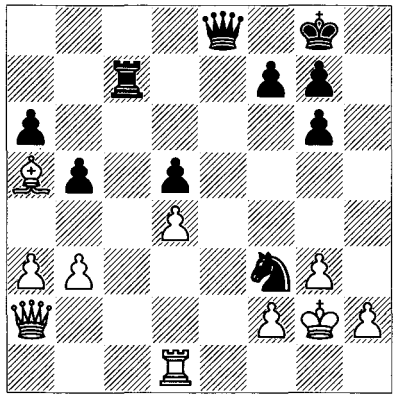
We have a typical winning combination here; are you familiar with it and/or can you work it out?

275
W



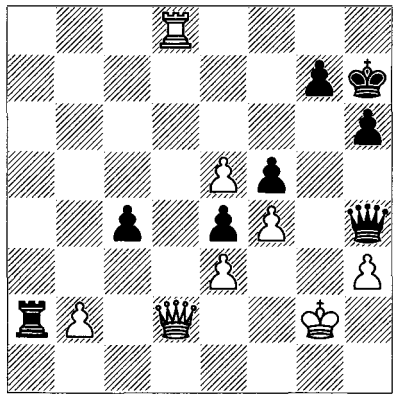
A knight on f5 combined with control of the long diagonal looks very promising. Turn this into something tangible.

276
B



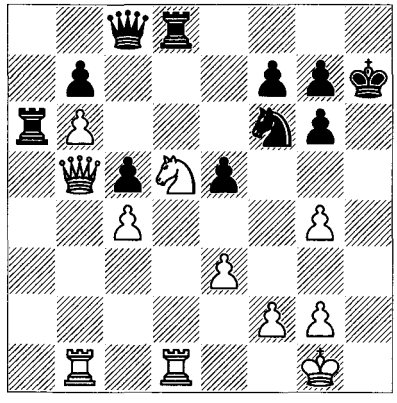
What does Black have that is better than 32...♖c6?! 33 ♕b1 ♘g5 34 ♕d3 ♕e6 35 ♗d2 ♕h3+ 36 ♔g1 ♘e4 37 ♗e1 here?

277
B



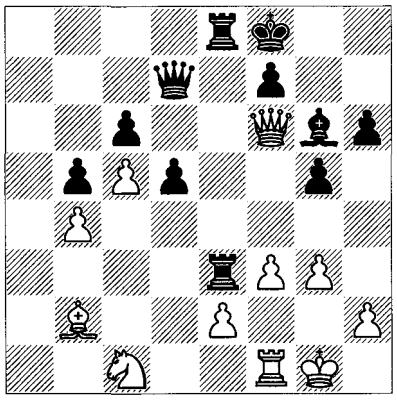
Which white piece is overloaded?

278
W



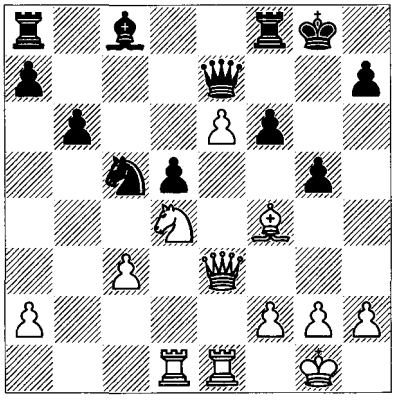
Another very advanced pawn, but it is not a passed pawn...

279
W



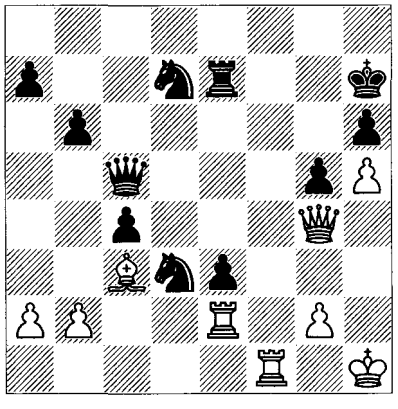
After 35 ♗d4 ♕e6 36 ♕g7+ ♔e7 37 ♕xh6 White won only a pawn. What stronger continuation was there?

280
W



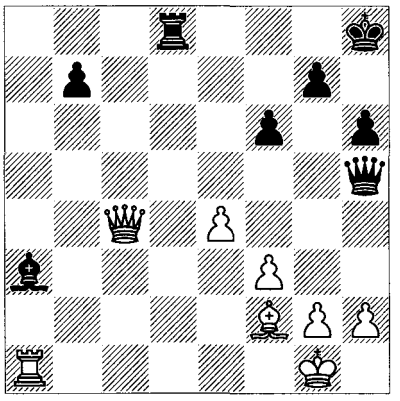
The e6-pawn is a powerful wedge and Black's king's position has been weakened. How can White take advantage?

281
W



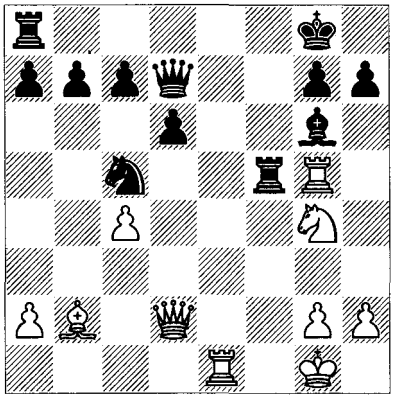
White played 44 ♕f5+ and after 44...♕xf5 45 ♖xf5 ♘f4 Black won. What opportunity did White miss?

282
W



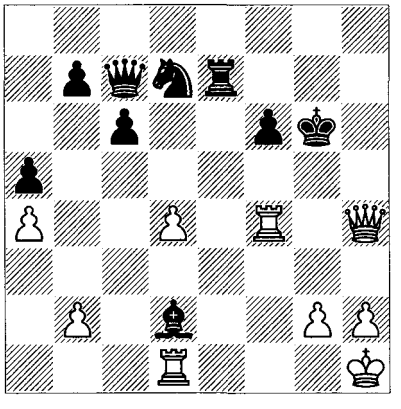
The game went 40 g4 ♕h3! and ended in a draw. How could White's play be improved?

283
W



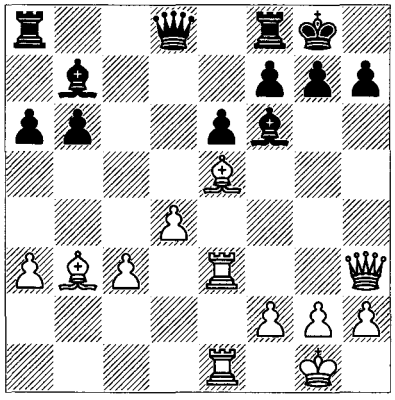
White has a strong bishop on b2 and a lot of pieces in attacking positions. How does White win?

284
W



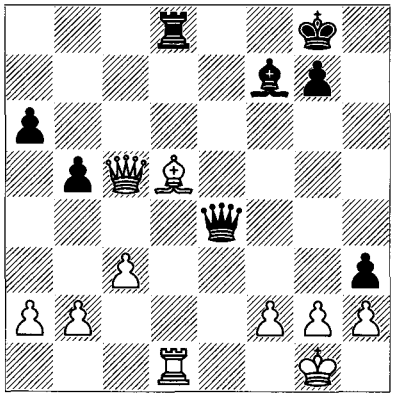
White has a material disadvantage, while in compensation the black king is weak. Show that the latter is more important.

285
W



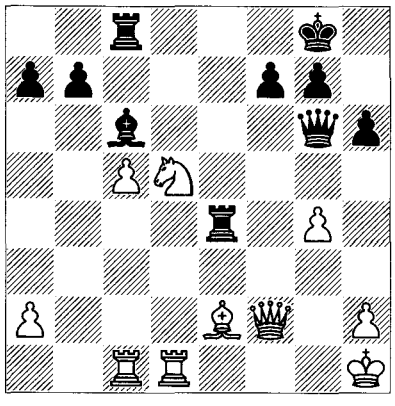
The game ended here, prematurely, in a draw. What was the great opportunity that White missed?

286
W



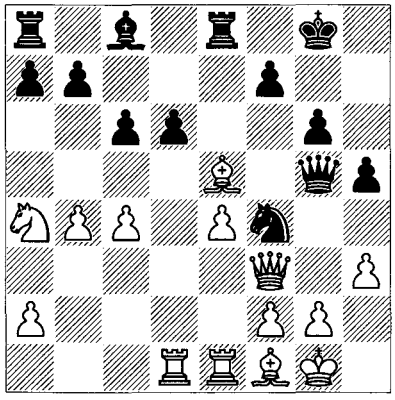
Now 24 f3 ♕e2 25 ♗xf7+ ♔xf7 26 ♕f5+ ♔e7 led to perpetual check. How could White have gained a huge advantage?

287
B



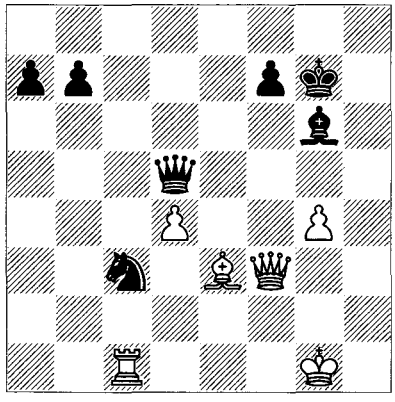
Black played 27...♖xe2 28 ♕xe2 ♖d8 29 ♔g1, which gave him no advantage. What stronger possibility did he miss?

288
B



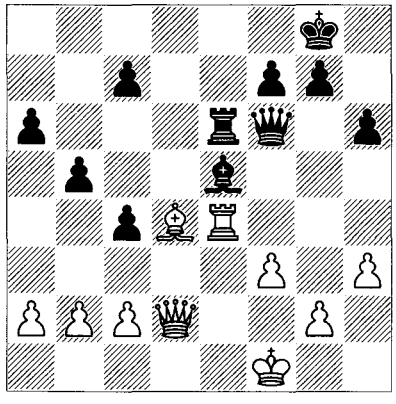
Is the zwischenzug 19...♘xh3+ sound?

289
W



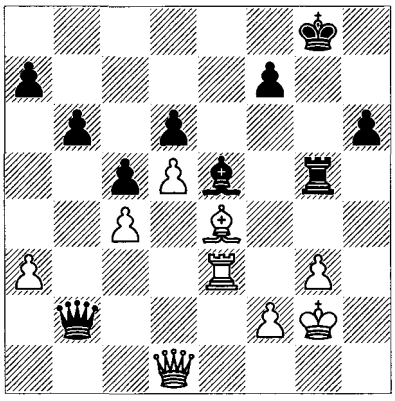
The ending after 42 ♕xd5 is a long way from being a white win. How can White reach a more favourable endgame?

290
W



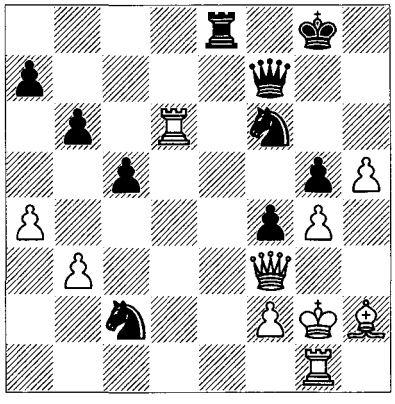
Evaluate 27 ♖xe5. Is it winning or losing, or does it lead to an ending where Black can draw with accurate defence?

291
B



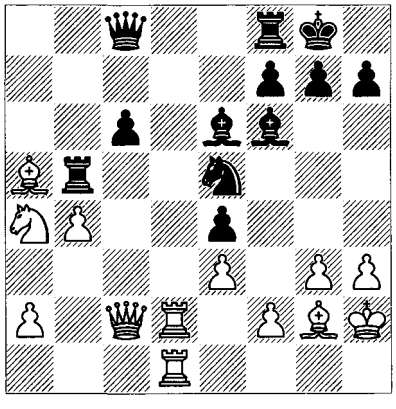
With 31...f5 32 ♗c2 f4 33 ♖f3, Black gained a slight advantage which gradually disappeared. What was a better way to play?

292
W



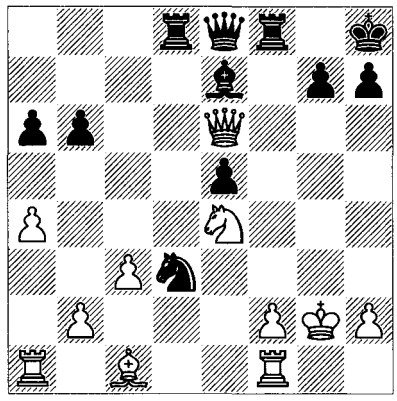
White played 34 ♔h1? and with 34...♘d4 Black gained an advantage. Find a better move for White.

293
W



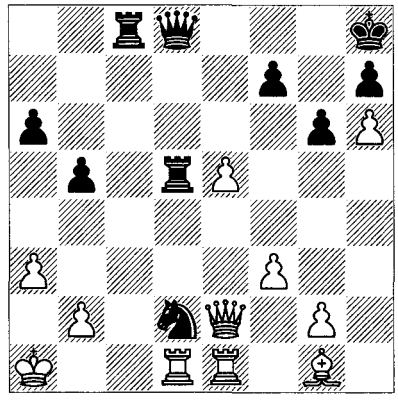
White has the advantage; is 27 ♕xe4 a way to crystallize it?

294
B



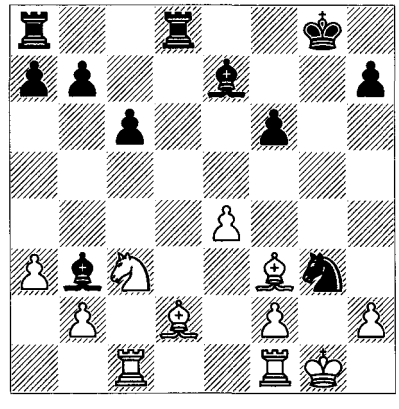
How is it possible to exploit the weakness of White's king?

295
B



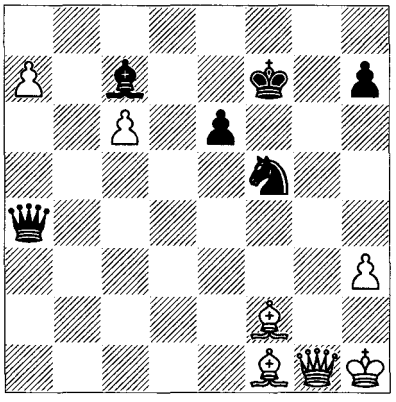
The game concluded in perpetual check after 31...♘b3+ 32 ♔b1 ♘d2+ 33 ♔a1 ♘b3+. How could Black's play be improved?

296
W



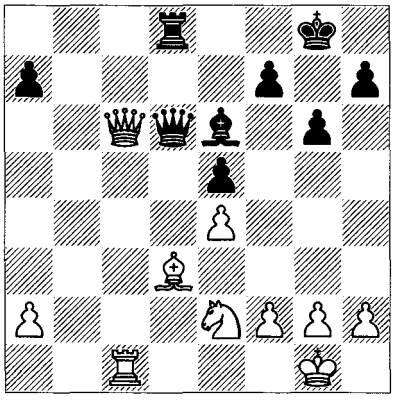
The game went 24 hxg3 ♖xd2 25 ♘e2 ♖ad8 and Black won in the end. How could White have defended better?

297
W



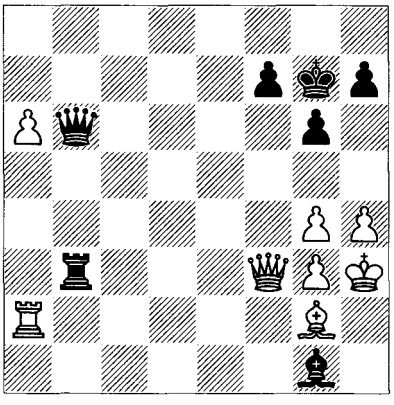
White has various moves that should lead to victory. Is 45 ♗g2 one of them?

300
B



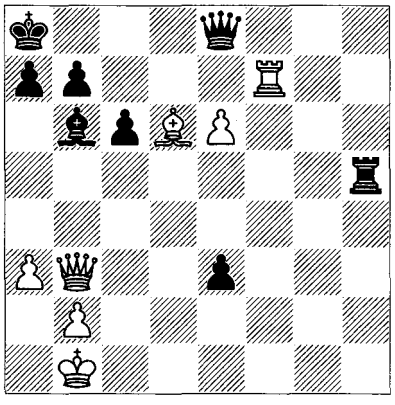
Is it better to take on d3 immediately or to exchange queens first?

298
W



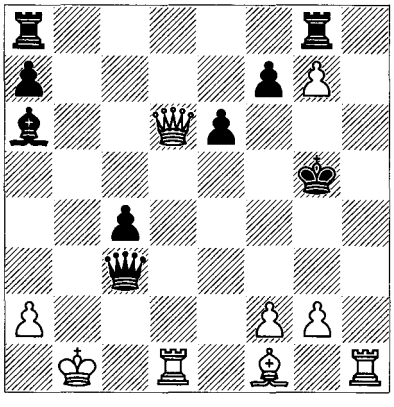
White played 51 a7 and after 51...♖xf3 a draw was agreed. How could White have won?

301
W



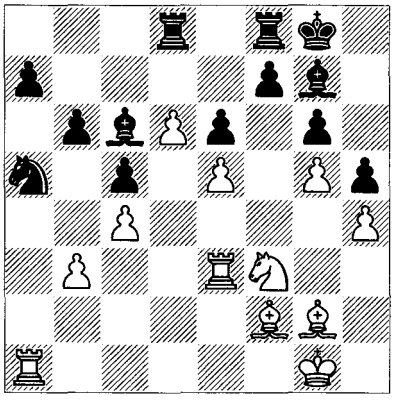
Here 45 e7 e2 46 ♖f8 e1♕+ 47 ♔a2 ♖h8 48 ♕f7 ♕xe7 49 ♗xe7 ♖xf8 only led to a draw. What should White have played?

299
W



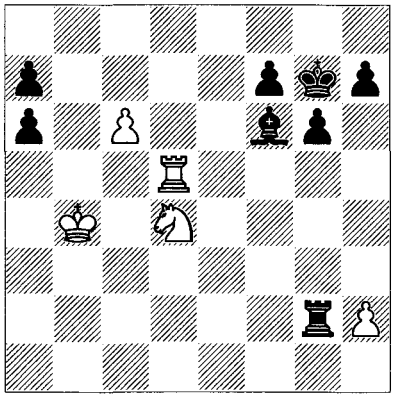
The white king is facing strong threats, but the black king is not as safe as it appears. How can White demonstrate this?

302
B



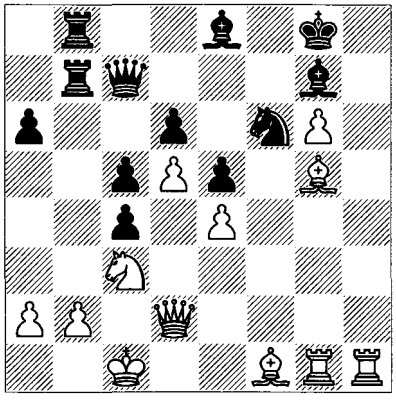
Black's position deteriorated rapidly after 36...♖d7 37 ♗e1! ♖b8 38 ♗xa5 bxa5 39 ♖xa5. How can Black defend better?

303
B



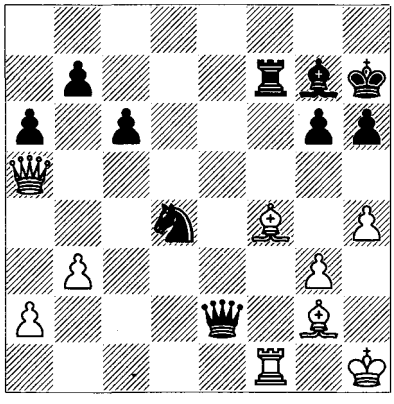
Black is four pawns up, but is not substantially better, since White's passed pawn is dangerous. How should Black defend?

304
W



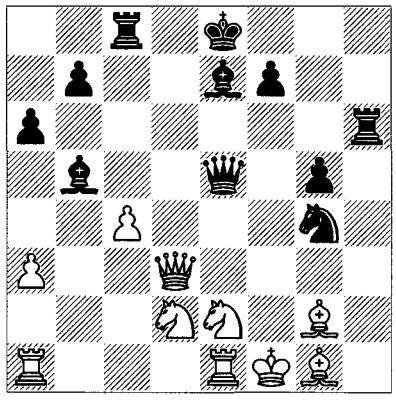
White is in the lead in the race to attack. What is the most effective continuation?

305
B



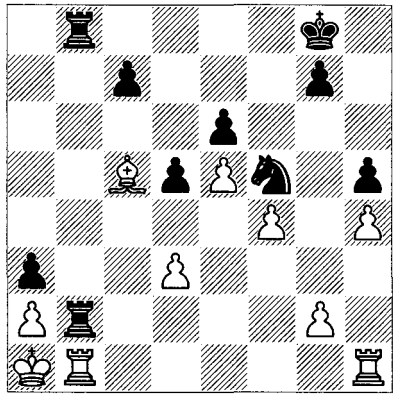
Black played 36...♘f5, but then his advantage started to dissipate. How could Black have played better?

306
B



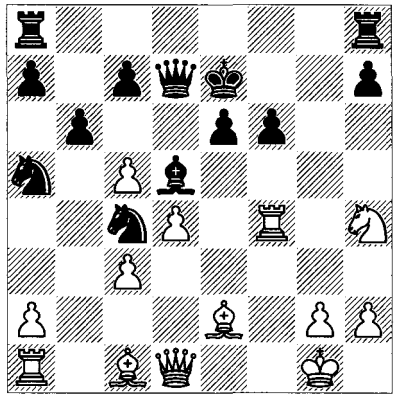
After 26...♖f6+ 27 ♗f3 ♖xc4 28 ♔g2! ♖cc6 29 ♕e4 the worst was behind White. What better line did Black have?

307
B



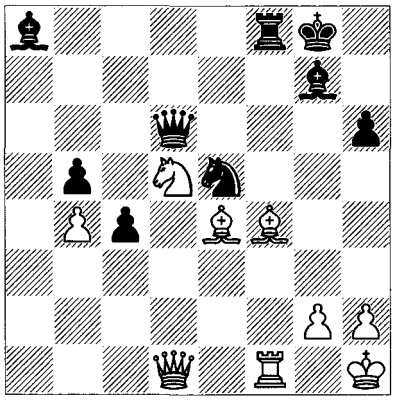
The position is a critical one, with the a3-pawn about to drop off. What trumps does Black have here?

308
W



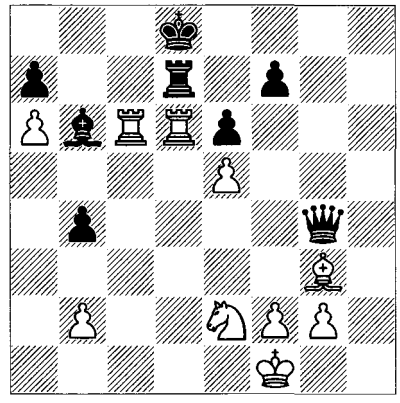
If Black can safely play 20...♖ag8, he will be on top. How can White create counterplay before Black secures his king?

309
B



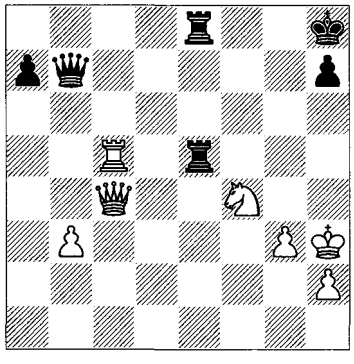
White has active pieces, but one great problem, which is...?

310
W

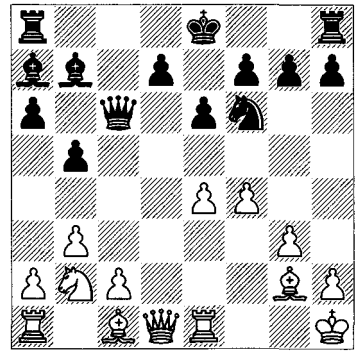


There are several unusual features in the position, but a vital one is not obvious – what is it, and how can it be exploited?

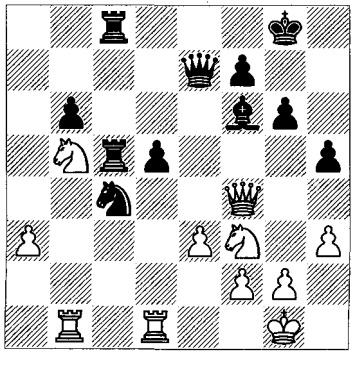
311
B



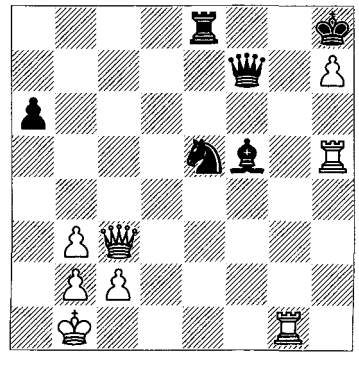
313
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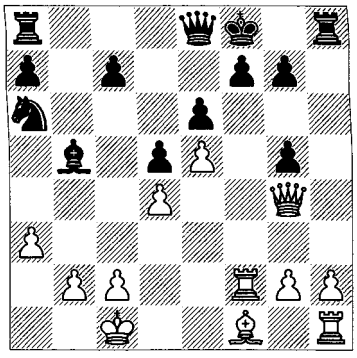
312
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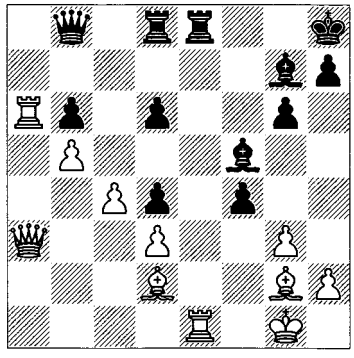
314
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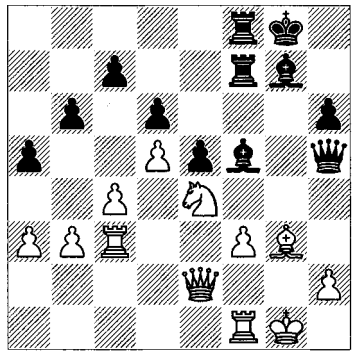
315
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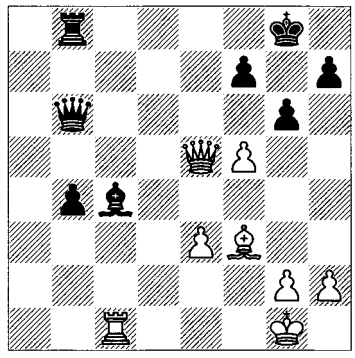
316
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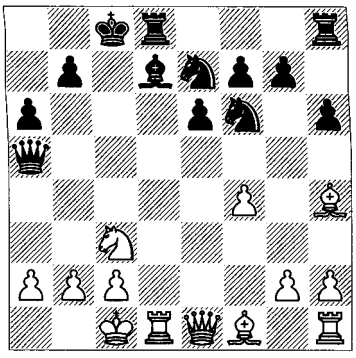
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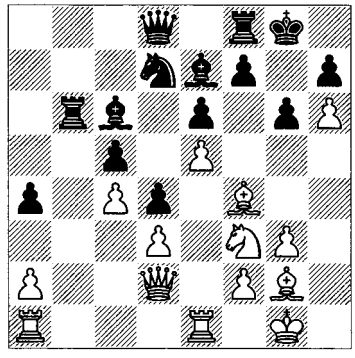
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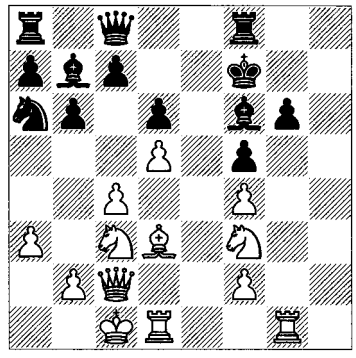
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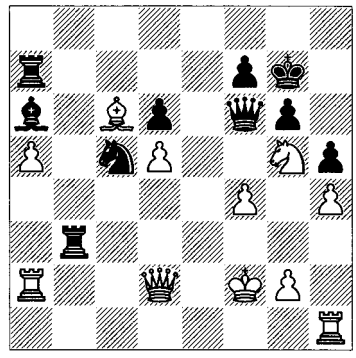
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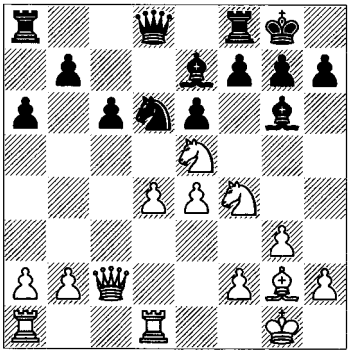
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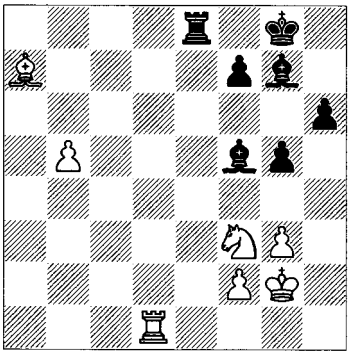
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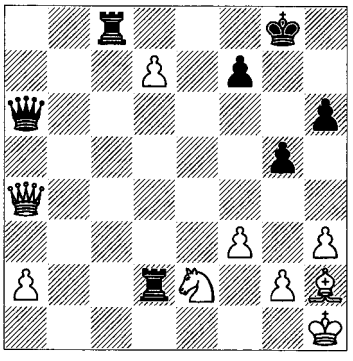
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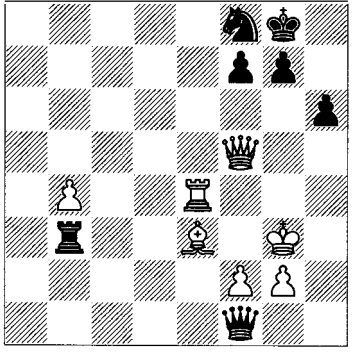
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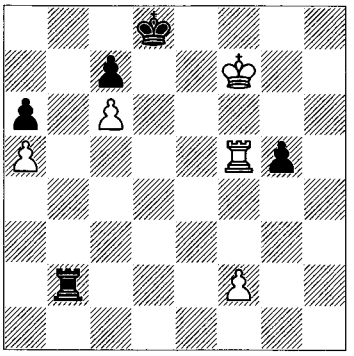
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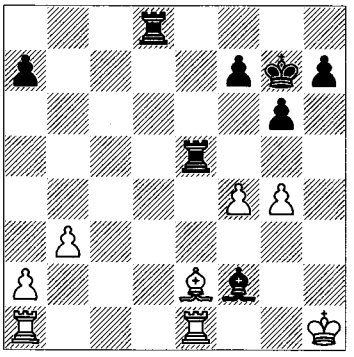
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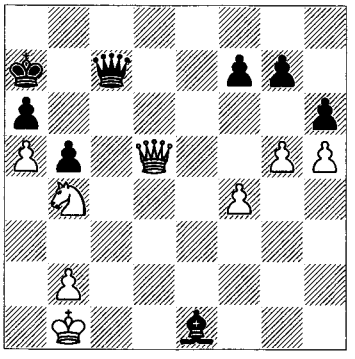
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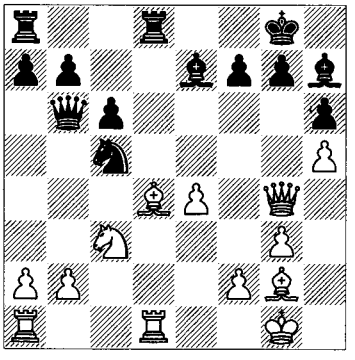
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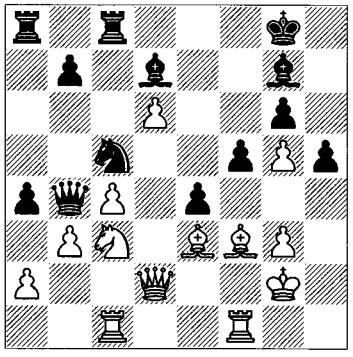
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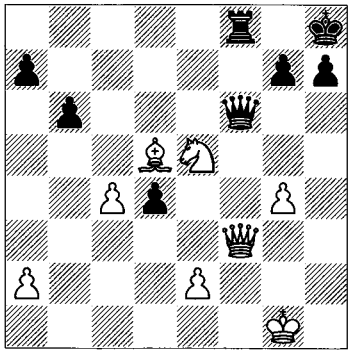
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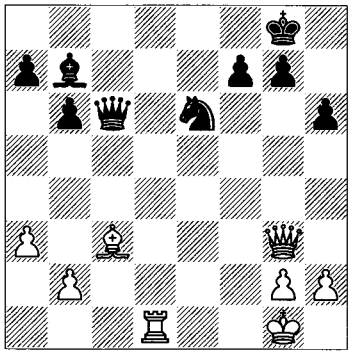
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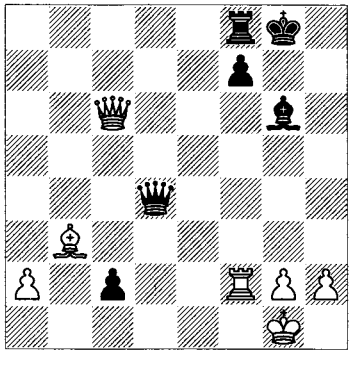
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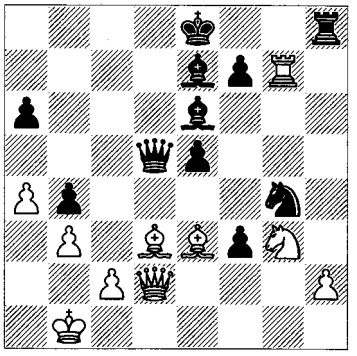
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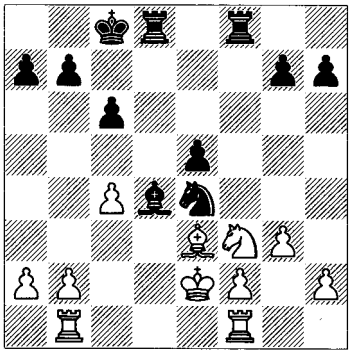
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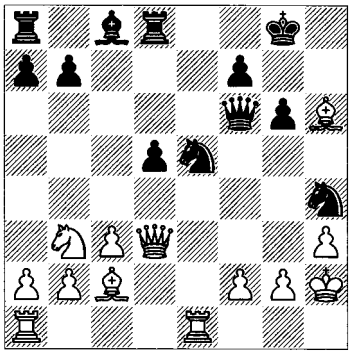
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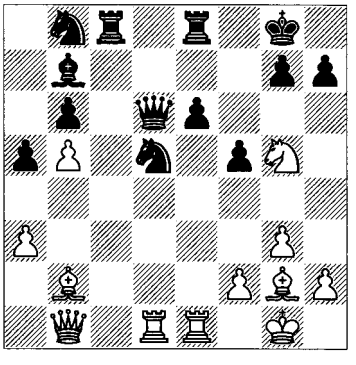
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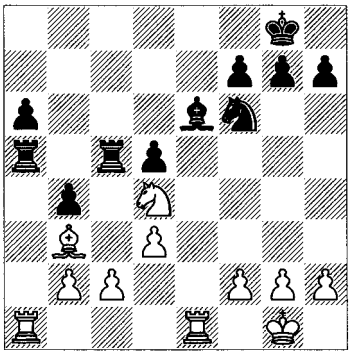
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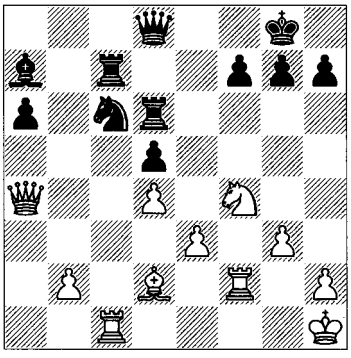
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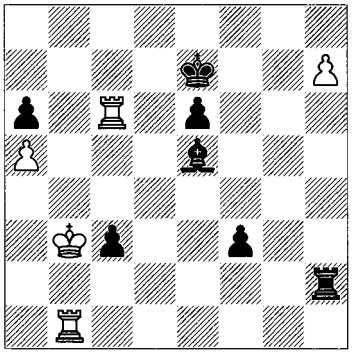
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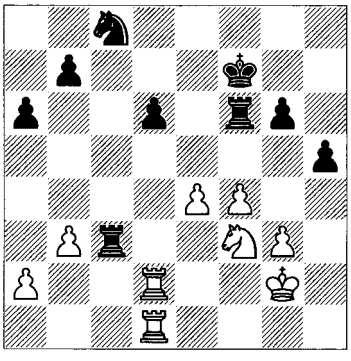
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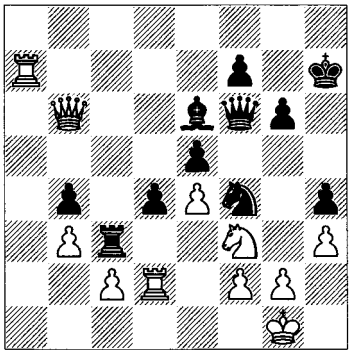
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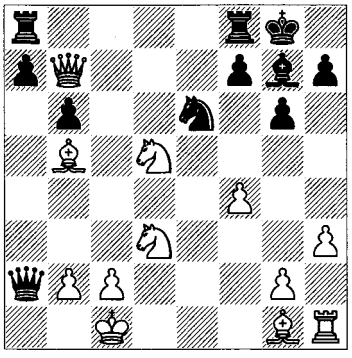
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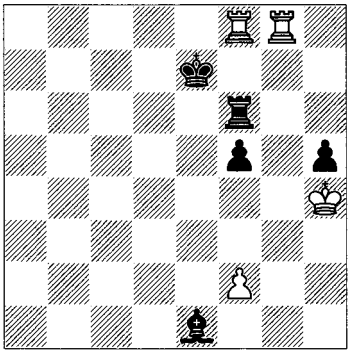
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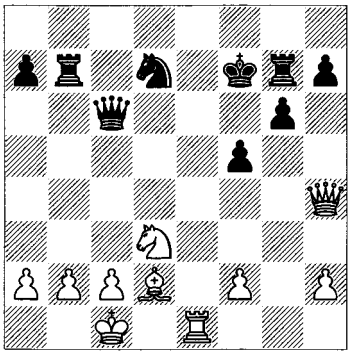
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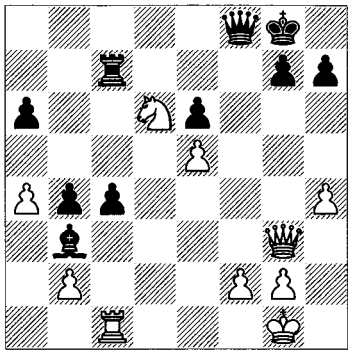
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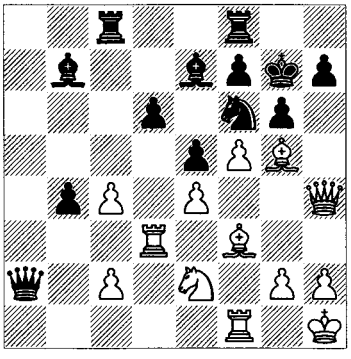
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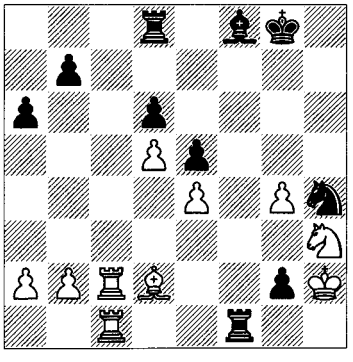
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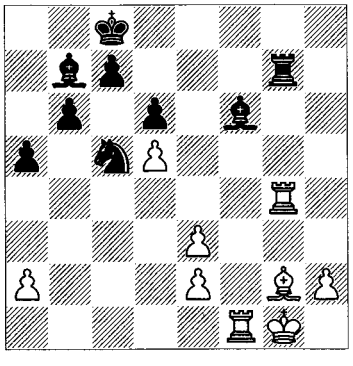
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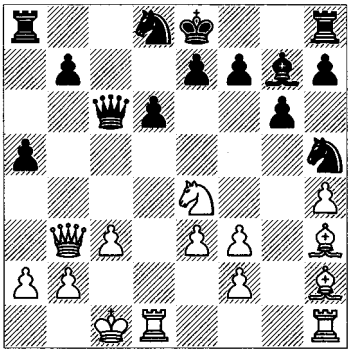
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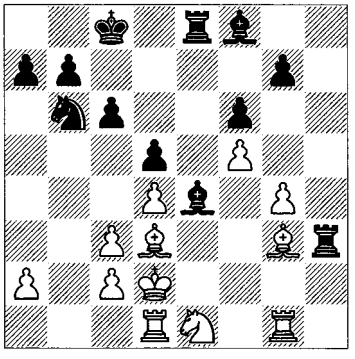
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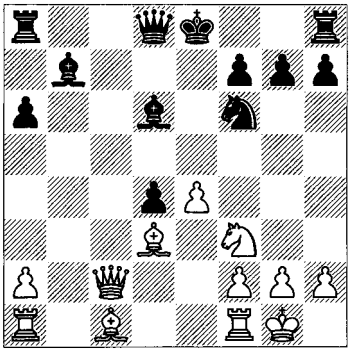
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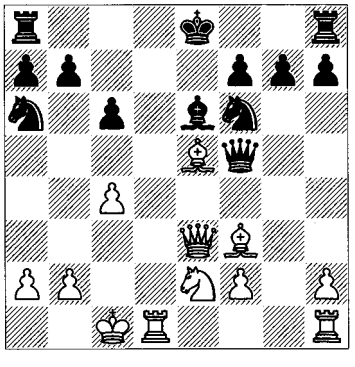
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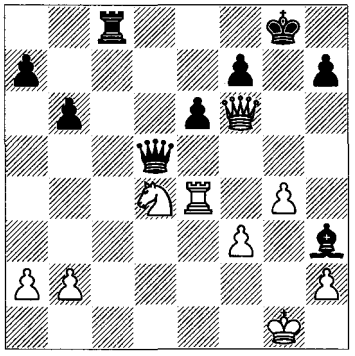
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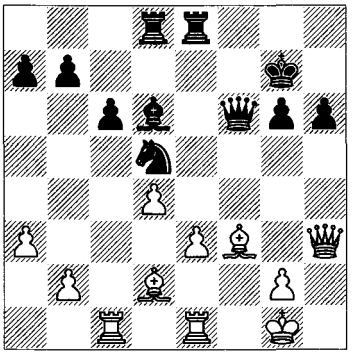
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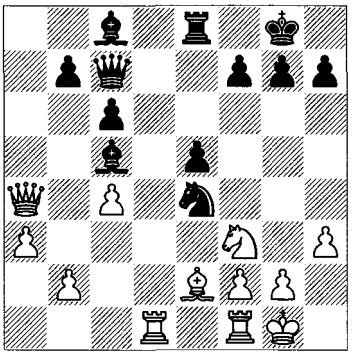
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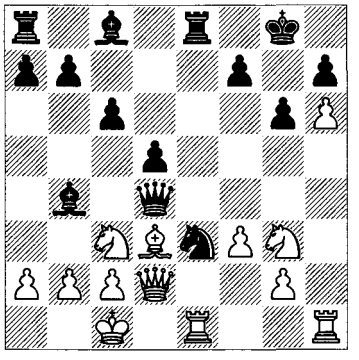
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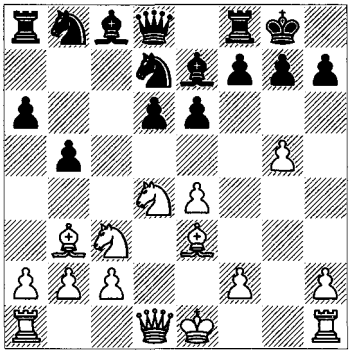
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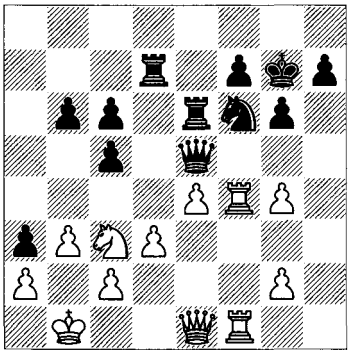
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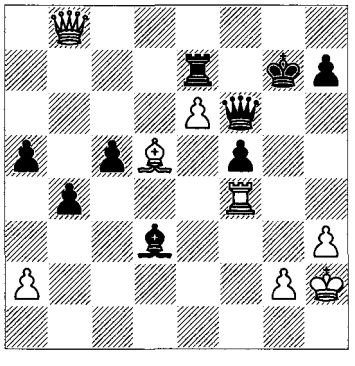
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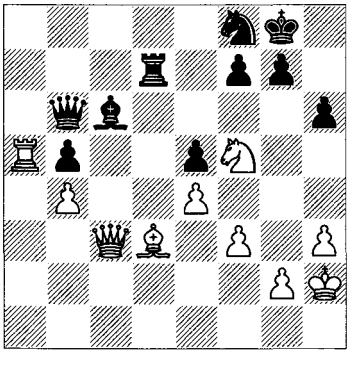
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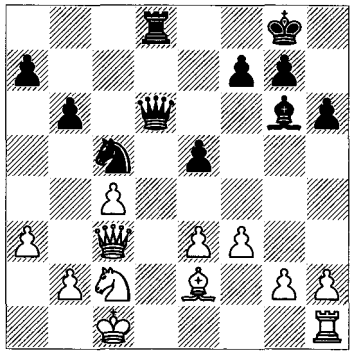
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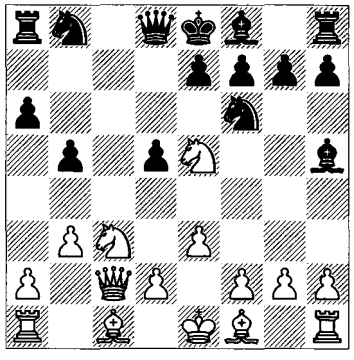
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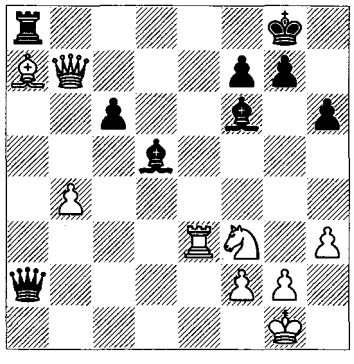
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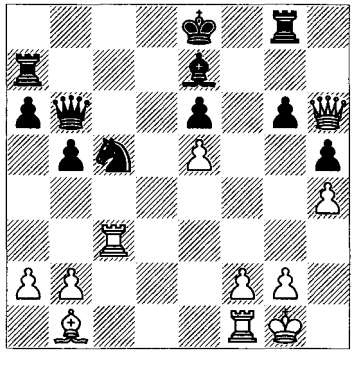
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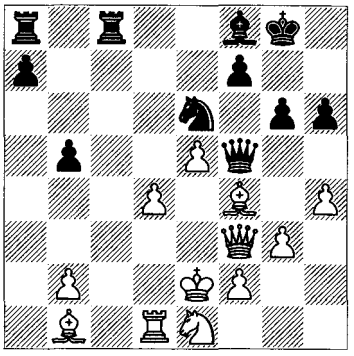
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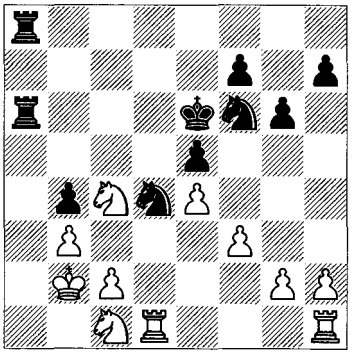
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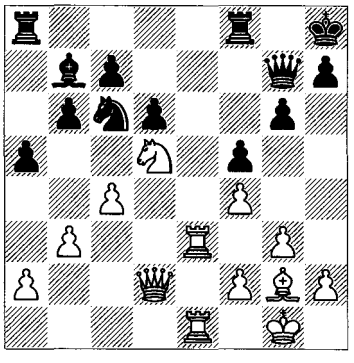
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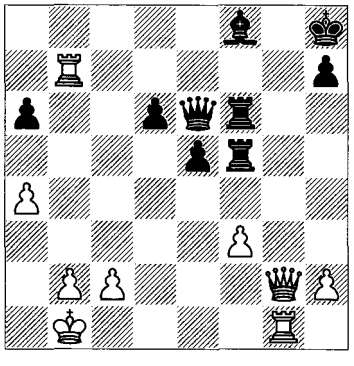
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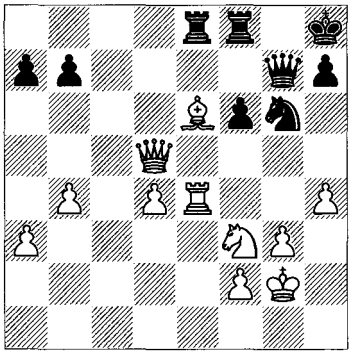
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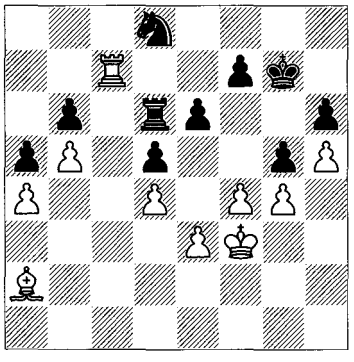
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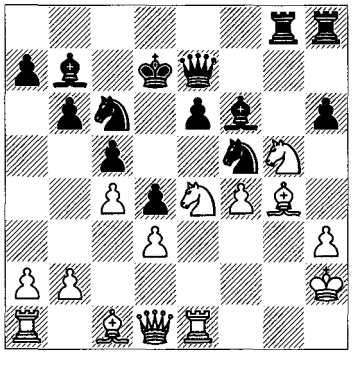
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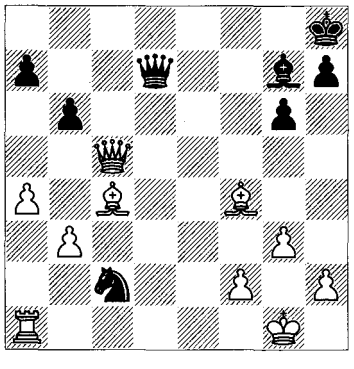
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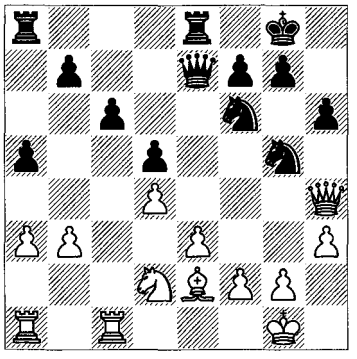
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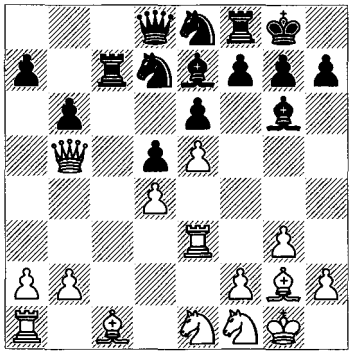
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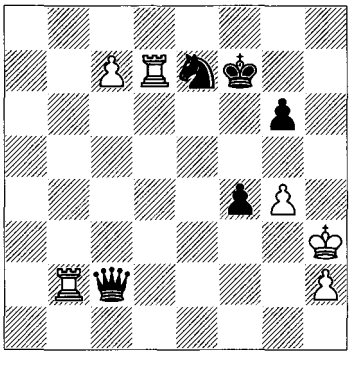
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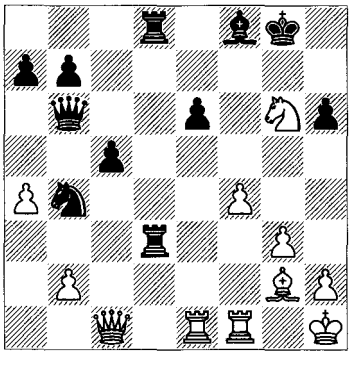
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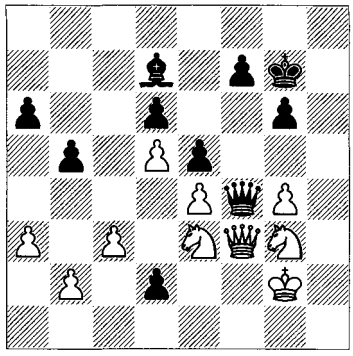
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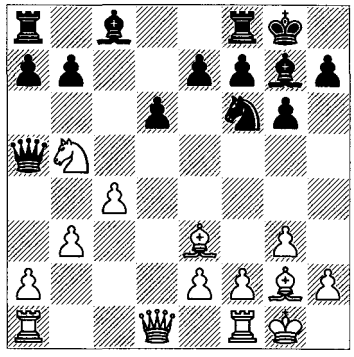
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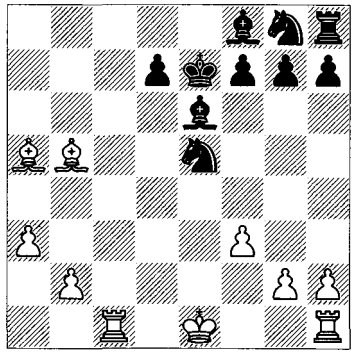
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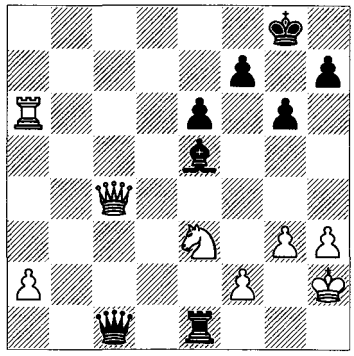
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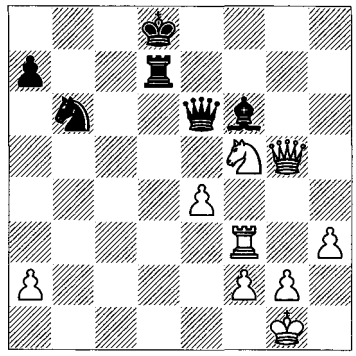
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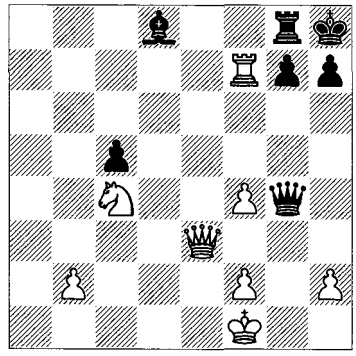
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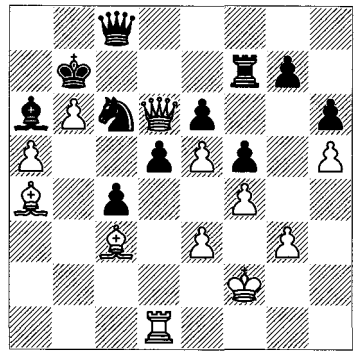
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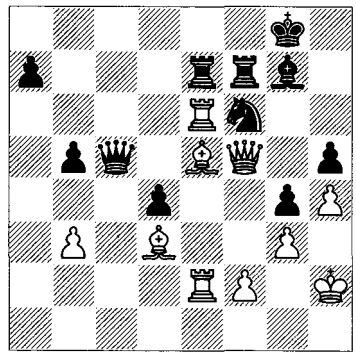
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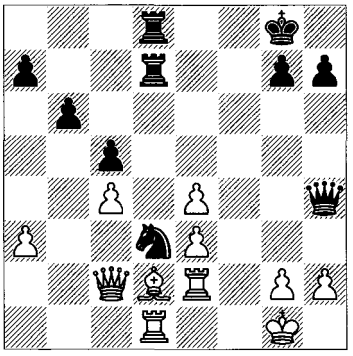
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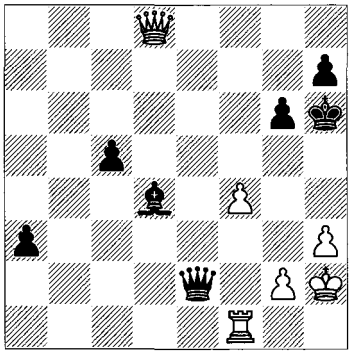
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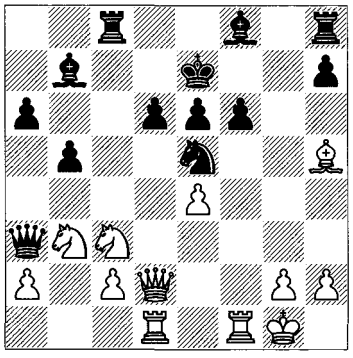
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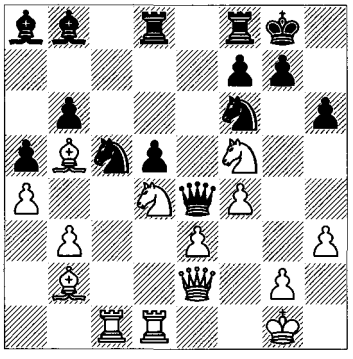
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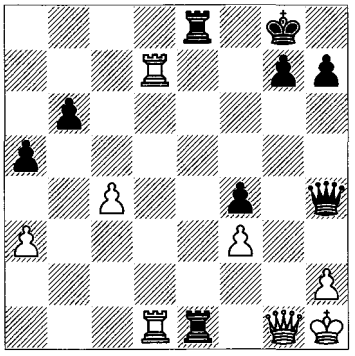
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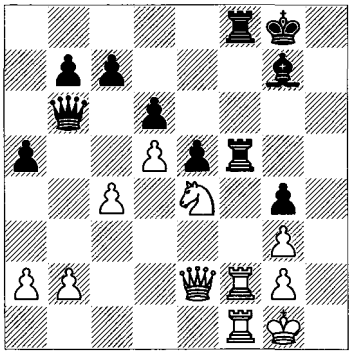
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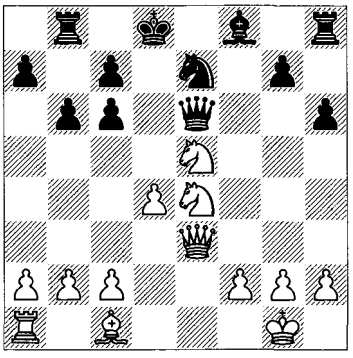
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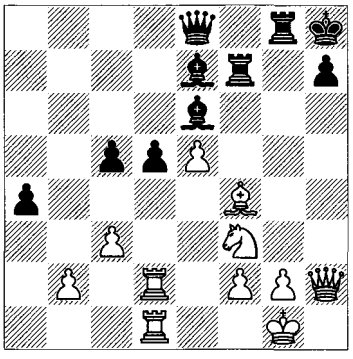
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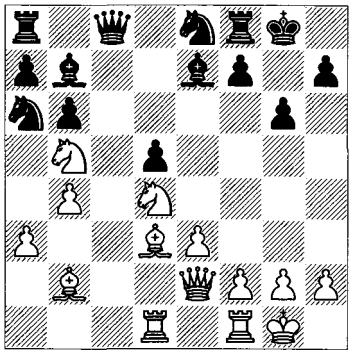
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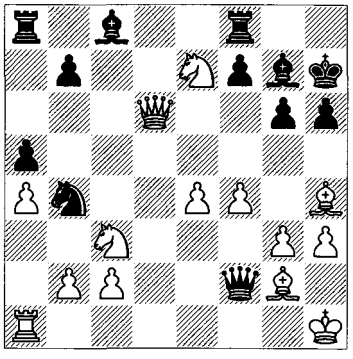
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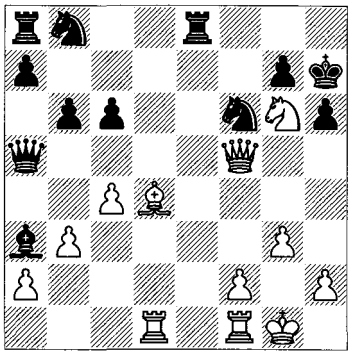
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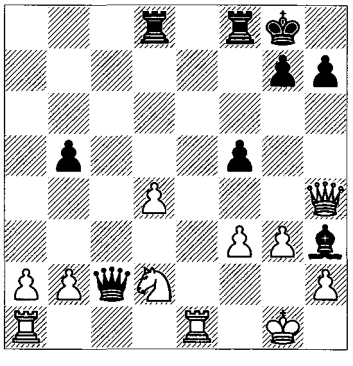
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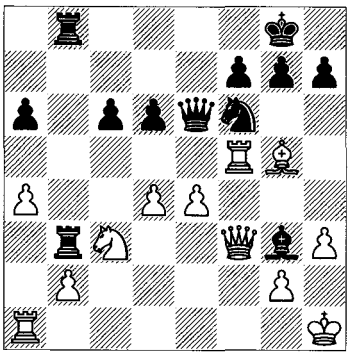
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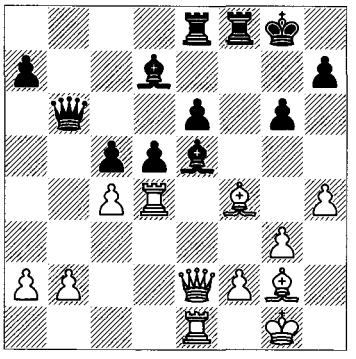
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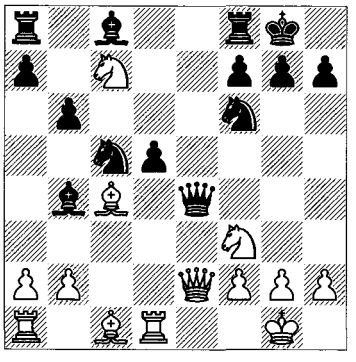
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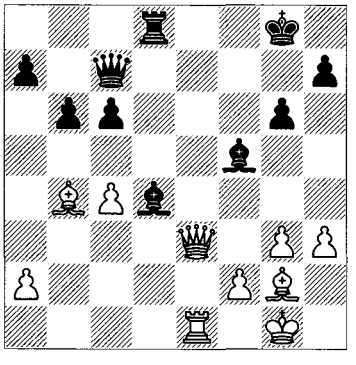
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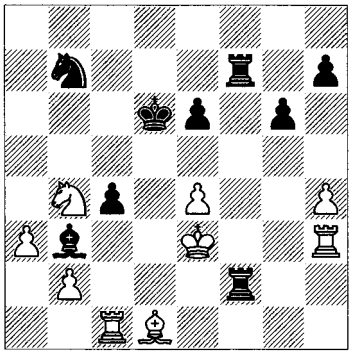
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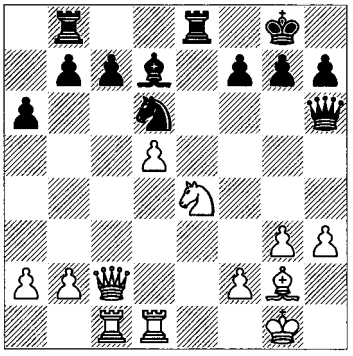
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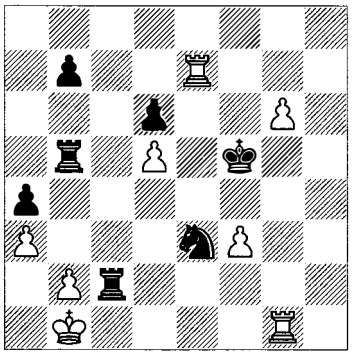
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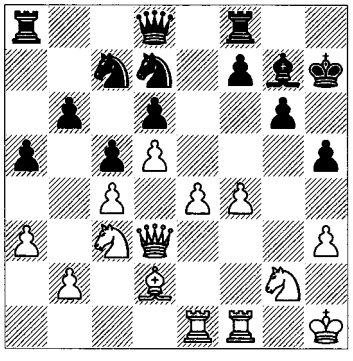
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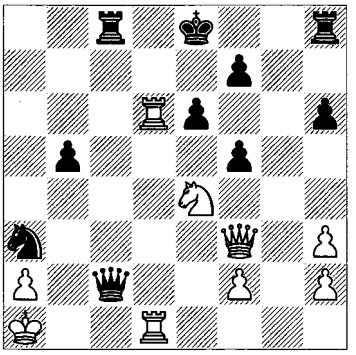
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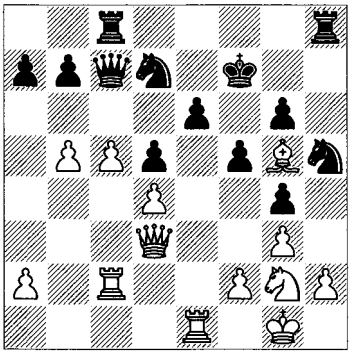
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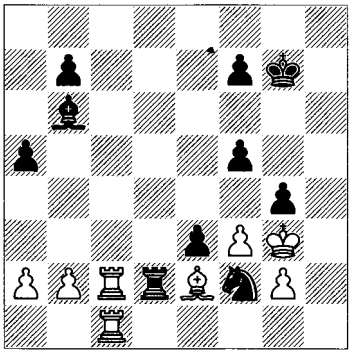
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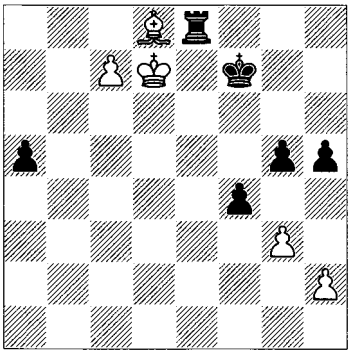
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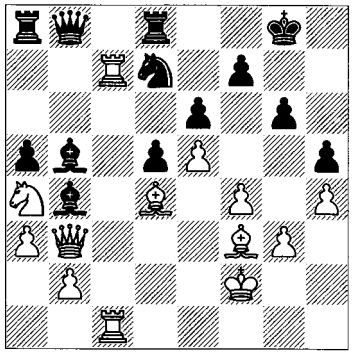
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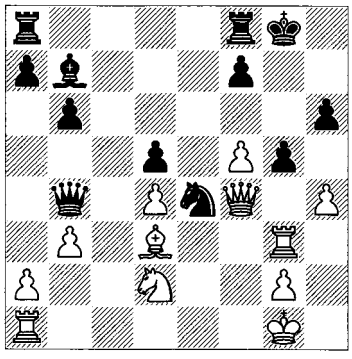
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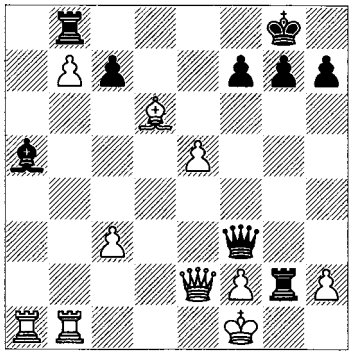
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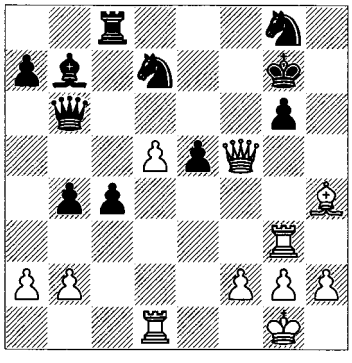
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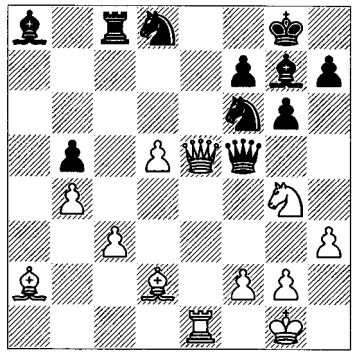
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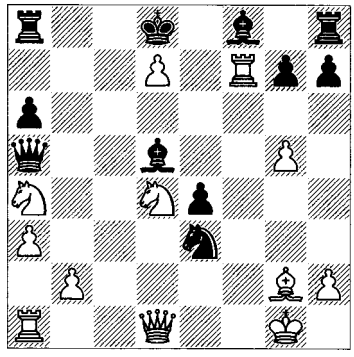
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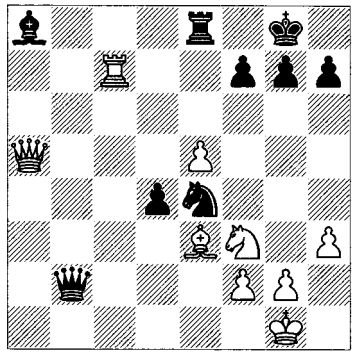
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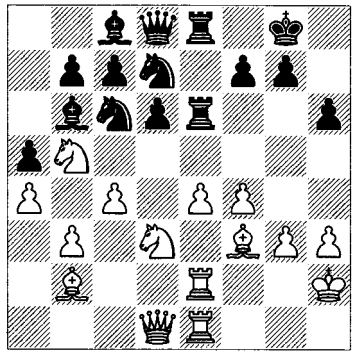
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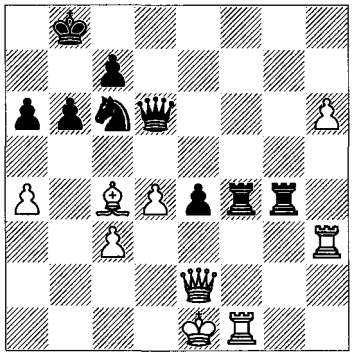
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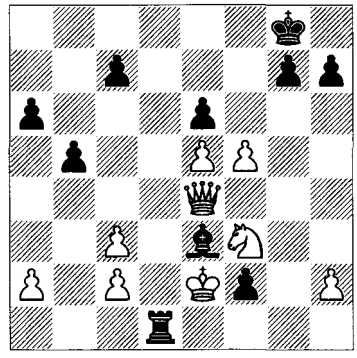
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419
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420
W



Answers for Chapter 4

221) Maderna – Dodero
Argentine Ch, Buenos Aires 1954
29 ♗b4! 1-0
The queen can't defend the knight.

222) Vera – Lesiège
Montreal 2003
28 ♖xg6+! 1-0
28...fxg6 29 ♗xe6#.

223) Ju. Bolbochán – Shocron
Mar del Plata 1953
32 a5 1-0
After 32...♖b7 33 ♘a6! Black loses not the exchange but a piece.

224) Ju. Bolbochán – Rocha
Rio Hondo Zonal 1966
29 ♖g8+! 1-0
White mates after 29...♖xg8 30 ♕c3+. 29 ♕c3 is also very strong, based on the same ideas, but 29...♖f6 prevents a checkmate any time soon.

225) Vera – Becerra
Capablanca Memorial, Cienfuegos 1996
37 ♘h5! 1-0
37...gxh5 allows 38 ♖g1#.

226) Radjabov – Anand
Blitz World Ch, Rishon Le Zion 2006
16 ♘f6+! 1-0
It is mate in two: 16...♘xf6 17 ♘c7+ ♔e7 18 ♕d6#.

227) Wiese – H.J. Schulz
Hamburg 2007
23...♖d1! 24 ♖c1 ♗d5+! 25 f3 (if 25 ♔g1 then 25...♕h3 wins) **25...♗xf3+ 26 ♔g1 ♖8d2 27 ♘xf3 ♕xf3 0-1.**

228) Deshmukh – B. Thipsay
Mumbai 2008
15...♖xf2! 16 ♔xf2
It is better to accept the loss of the pawn with 16 ♖f1, but White's position is difficult after 16...♖f5 17 ♖xf5 exf5 18 ♘f1 ♗g5.
16...♕xh2
Black's position is already winning, with the threat of 17...♖f8+.
17 ♖h1? ♗h4+ 0-1

229) Ju. Bolbochán – Dantas
Mar del Plata Zonal 1951
32 ♕f6! 1-0
There is no defence against the threat of 33 ♘xf5+ ♔h5 34 ♕g5#.

230) Franco – Alawieh
Seville 1992
21 ♖e6! (there is no satisfactory defence against 22 ♖xg6+) **21...d4 22 ♗xd4 ♘e5 23 ♘xe5 ♖xd4 24 ♖xd4 1-0**.

231) Vallejo – Gómez Esteban
Elgóibar 1997
37 ♕c5!
Threatening 38 ♕f8+ and mate. 37 e5 is also strong.
37...c3?
Also losing is 37...♗a6 38 e5 ♔b7 39 exf6.
38 ♕f8+ 1-0

232) Milos – Kudrin
Buenos Aires 2003
39 ♖xe7+! (preparing the discovered attack) **39...♔xe7 40 ♗c5+ ♖cxc5 41 ♕xf3 e4 42 ♖g7+ ♔e6 43 ♕h3+ ♖f5 44 ♖xa7** and White won.

233) Vallejo – Van der Stricht
French Team Ch, Mulhouse 2005
26 ♘f6+! gxf6 27 ♕xf6 1-0

234) Arencibia – Bruzón
Cuban Ch, Santa Clara 2005
19 ♗xc6+! 1-0
With this move White makes two enemy pieces loose and wins the game on the spot: 19...♖xc6 20 ♕e5, with a double attack.

235) Sammalvuo – Maki
Finnish Team Ch 2006/7
22 ♘f6! 1-0
White threatens 23 ♖g8# and if 22...♗xf6 then 23 ♕xf6+! ♖xf6 24 ♖d8+ mating.

236) Franco – Guerra Bastida
Galician League 2007
26 ♗xf7+!
26 ♖g1 is another way.

26...♔h8

26..♔xf7 is decisively met by 27 ♕h5+ ♔g8 28 f7+.

27 ♗xe8

and White won.

237) Estremera – J. Cisneros

Palma de Mallorca 2007

The overloaded piece is the black queen: **38 ♖xb5! ♕xb5 39 ♕xh7** (now the whole of Black's kingside is annihilated) **39...♘e7 40 ♗xe7 ♖xe7 41 ♕xg6+ ♔d7 42 ♗xf5+ ♔d8 43 ♕d6+ ♔e8 44 ♗g6+ ♔f8 45 ♕f6+ 1-0**.

238) Caruana – Majer

European Ch, Arvier 2007

35 ♖xf6!

Forcing an entry at h7, and taking advantage of the fact that the black queen is undefended. One loose piece can decide a game, especially if that piece is the queen.

35...gxf6 36 ♕h7+ ♔f8 37 ♘xe6+ ♖xe6 38 ♖xe6 fxe6 39 ♕xc7 1-0

239) Pruijssers – Kabos

Leiden 2008

22 ♗xh7+! 1-0

After 22...♔xh7 23 ♖h4+, forcing 23...♕xh4, White wins easily (if 23...♔g8? then 24 ♕f7#).

240) Critelli – Boulahfa

Leiden 2008

28 g4!

This little pawn move ends all resistance; the simple threat is 29 gxh5.

28...♘xg4 29 ♕xg4 ♔g7

29...♕h6 fails to 30 ♕d1 ♕g5 31 ♖hf4.

30 ♕f4 1-0

241) Stefanova – M. Gurevich

Gibraltar 2008

31 ♖g8+! 1-0

White forces mate after 31...♔xg8 (31...♖xg8 32 ♕f6+) 32 ♕g3+. **31 ♗f6!** was another way.

242) Topalov – Shirov

Morelia/Linares 2008

30 ♗xg6! hxg6 31 ♕xg6+ ♔h8 32 ♕f6+ ♔h7 33 ♕f7+ ♔h8 34 ♘f4! 1-0

Once the defenders have been destroyed, the inclusion of a fresh attacker terminates all resistance. After 34...♖g8, 35 ♕h5+ ♔g7 36 ♕g6+ leads to a quick mate.

243) Kleijn – Jaracz

Deizisau 2008

28 ♖xc4!

28 ♕f5 ♗xd3 is less conclusive; 28 bxc4 is the second best option, winning material after, e.g., 28...fxe5 29 ♖xf8+ ♗xf8 30 ♘f7+ ♔g8 31 ♘xe5.

28...bxc4 29 ♕f5! 1-0

It is mate in three.

244) Ponkratov – A.N. Panchenko

Nezhmetdinov Memorial, Kazan 2008

26 ♗b6!

Forcing the queen to move in range of a fork. Also good is **26 ♖xf6!** gxf6 27 ♗b6.

26...♕d7 27 ♖xf6 ♗e7 28 ♖6f5

Black's position is hopeless.

245) Gosić – Bogosavljević

Zlatibor 2008

46...♗g2+! and Black forces mate: **47 ♔xg2 ♖xc2+ 48 ♖e2 ♖xe2+ 49 ♔f1 ♖f2+ 50 ♔e1 ♕a1+ 0-1**.

246) Letelier – Najdorf

Buenos Aires 1964

18 ♗xh6! 1-0

This move, opening the h-file and preparing ♖g1, is absolutely crushing; e.g., 18...♔xh6 (if 18...♖g8 then 19 ♕h5) 19 ♕h4+ ♔g7 20 ♖g1+ and mate in two.

247) A. Rivera – Vallejo

Capablanca Memorial, Havana 1999

26...♕f6!

The double threat against b2 and g3 wins material.

27 ♖e2 ♘g3+ 28 ♔e1 ♘xe2 0-1

248) Estremera – Bruned

L'Estartit 2006

33 ♖xd4!

The clearest and most and convincing move; 33 ♘h6+ was another way.

33...cxd4 34 ♘f6+! gxf6 35 ♗h6 1-0

Mate is unavoidable.

249) Rodi – Milos

São Paulo 2008

27...♗xh3! 28 ♗xd5

28 ♘xh3 is met by 28..♖xh3+! 29 gxh3 ♖e2+.

28...♕xd5 29 ♘xh3 ♖e2 30 ♖g1 ♕xb5 0-1

Material is equal and there are no immediate threats, but White is lost. He is paralysed and will be unable to tolerate the rook on the seventh rank or defend his king against ...♕f5, followed by ...♖8e3. For instance, 31 c3 ♗d6 32 cxd4 ♕f5 33 ♔h1 ♖8e3 34 ♕f1 ♕d5 and now the prettiest finish comes after 35 ♘g5 ♕xg5! 36 fxg5 ♖h3+! 37 gxh3 ♖h2#.

250) Molchanova – Raeva

European Women's Ch, Plovdiv 2008

33 ♖xf6! gxf6 34 ♘h5

The natural 34 ♖xf6 ♕g5 35 ♘f5 is also very strong.

34...♖d6 35 ♘xf6+ ♖xf6 36 ♖xf6

Now White has a material advantage as well as an attack.

36...♕g5 37 h4! ♕g3 38 h5 ♖d6 39 ♖f4 ♗c8 40 ♕e5! ♕xe3+ 41 ♔h2 ♖e6 42 ♕f5 ♕c5 43 ♕f7+ ♔h8 44 ♕f8+ 1-0

251) A. Ivanov – L. Kaufman

USA Ch, Tulsa 2008

29 ♖xh7!

Opening more lines, even though the immediate cost is very high.

29...♘xh7

29...♔xh7 30 ♖h1+ ♘h5 31 ♗xh5 does not change the situation.

30 ♕xg6+ ♔h8 31 ♗d4+ ♖e5 32 fxe5 c5 33 ♗xb2 c4 34 ♖g1 1-0

252) Zablotsky – Ponfilenok

Nezhmetdinov Memorial, Kazan 2008

19...♘xg3! 20 ♘xg3

Black wins material in a similar way to the game after 20 ♔xg3 ♕g5+ 21 ♔h2 ♕h4+ 22 ♗h3 ♖xf3 23 ♕g2 ♖f2.

20...♕h4+ 21 ♗h3 ♖xf3 22 ♕g2 ♖f2 0-1

253) Lafuente – Shirov

León (rapid) 2008

17...♘xf2! 18 ♗xf6

Or 18 ♔xf2 ♘xe4+ 19 ♔f1 ♘xg5.

18...♘xd1 19 ♖xd1 gxf6 20 ♘f5 ♗f8

with a decisive advantage.

254) Zhou Yang Fan – Gordon

Hastings 2008/9

35...♖xf2!

Here it is essential to strike first. The timid 35...hxg6? loses the advantage after 36 ♕g5! ♕xg5 37 ♖xg5 ♖xf2 38 ♖xg6+ ♔f7 39 ♖g3, followed by 40 ♘b5.

36 gxh7++ ♔xh7 0-1

White resigned in view of 37 ♕xf2 ♖xf2 38 ♔xf2 ♕h2+ 39 ♖g2 ♕f4+ and 40...♕xc1.

255) Inarkiev – Shirov

Poikovsky 2009

31 ♕f1! is the only move, and wins due to the threat of 32 ♖xh7+ and 33 ♕h3#.

256) Marini – Ju. Bolbochán

Argentine Ch, Buenos Aires 1946

28 exf7+! ♔g7 (no better is 28...♔xf7 29 fxg6++ ♔xg6 30 ♗e4+) and now 29 fxe8♘+ ♖xe8 30 ♖xd3, winning a piece, is one way to win.

257) P. Martín – Ju. Bolbochán

Argentine Ch, Buenos Aires 1946

33 ♘d2!, hitting the rook and the b6-bishop, wins the exchange for insufficient compensation. White secures a decisive advantage after 33...♗xd4 34 ♘xe4 ♗xc3 35 ♘xf6 ♗xf6 36 ♖b6.

258) Marini – Gadía

Mar del Plata 1960

Black's pressure on the long diagonal is very strong, but a pawn on the seventh is not something to be spurned without a very clear reason, and after **20 cxb7!** ♖e4 21 ♗b3 ♖xf4 22 ♖hel White would have a reasonable position.

259) R. Sanguineti – Bielicki

Mar del Plata 1962

35 ♖xg7!

A devastating blow.

35...♔xg7 36 ♘f5+ ♔g8 37 ♕xh6 ♖d7 38 ♖e3!

Powerful reinforcements arrive.

38...♘h7

38...♖c8 39 ♖g3+ ♔f7 40 ♖g7+ ♔e8 41 ♕xf6 is winning; e.g., 41...♖xg7 (41...♕xc3 42 ♖e7+! ♔d8 43 ♖xd7++ ♔xd7 44 ♕e7#) 42 ♘xg7+ ♔d7 43 ♕f7+ ♔d6 44 ♘f5+ ♔c5 45 ♕xb7.

39 ♖g3+ ♘g5 40 ♕xf6 1-0

260) Behrensen – Cruz

Mar del Plata 1965

38...♖xf3! is devastating and the counterattack 39 ♕g6 is ineffective: 39...♖xh3+ 40 ♖h2

♖xh2+ 41 ♔xh2 ♕d4 (or 41...e4) 42 ♕xh5+ ♔g7. No better is 39 ♔h2 ♗f4+ or 39 ♗d7 ♕d4 40 ♕d1 ♕xd1 41 ♖xd1 ♖f1+ 42 ♖xf1 ♖xf1+ 43 ♔h2 ♗f4+ 44 ♔h3 ♖h1+, mating.

261) Matamoros – Pérez Candelario
Capablanca Memorial, Havana 2001

33 ♕xd7! wins, since 33...♕xd7? allows 34 ♖xf8#. If 33...♖c1+ then 34 ♗f1 ♖xf1+ 35 ♔xf1 ♕c1+ 36 ♔g2 ♕xa1 37 ♕f7! with a quick mate.

262) Gretarsson – R. Alonso
Capablanca Memorial, Havana 2002

21...♗c6! cuts off the queen's retreat and threatens 22...♖a8, winning material.

263) F. Peralta – Estremera
Las Palmas 2005

23 ♕e3! 1-0

Threatening both 24 ♗h7+ and 24 cxd5, against which there is no defence.

264) Motylev – Humpy Koneru
Wijk aan Zee 2006

16 ♗xe7! ♕xe7 17 ♕h6!

There is no satisfactory way to defend both g7 and h7.

17...f5

17...♘f6 loses to 18 ♖xg7+! ♘xg7 19 ♖g1.

18 ♕xh5 1-0

265) Estremera – Souleidis
Baleares Team Ch 2006

25 ♕e3! ♗xf3

After 25...♗xe3 26 ♖xc7 White wins a piece.

26 gxf3 ♗xe3 27 ♖xc7 1-0

266) Van der Weide – Kroencke
Hamburg 2007

21 ♗a3!! ♘xa3

Or 21...♕xa3 22 ♖f1+ ♔e8 23 ♕xg7 ♕c5+ 24 ♔h1 ♕e7 25 ♕g8+ ♔d7 26 ♖f7.

22 ♖f1+ ♔e8 23 ♕xg7 1-0

There is no defence against 24 ♕g8+ and 25 ♖f7(+), with an easy win.

267) Wilms – Atri
Hamburg 2007

14...♘e4! 15 ♗xd8

After 15 ♗xe4 ♕xh4 Black threatens mate and the bishop, and if 16 f4 then 16...♗c5+ wins.

15...♘xd2 16 ♗a5 ♘xf1 0-1

268) Quesada Aguilera – Cámpora
Seville 2007

30...♗g4!

Threatening 31...♗xe2, and 31 ♕d2 fails to 31...♗f3+!.

31 ♖xg7+

31 ♗xg4? ♕f1+ 32 ♘xf1 ♖xf1#.

31...♔xg7 32 ♖c7+?

Also hopeless is 32 ♕c7+ ♖f7 33 ♕c4 ♗xe2 34 ♕xe2 ♕xe2 35 ♘xe2 ♖f1+ 36 ♘g1 ♖af8, followed by 37...e4.

0-1

White resigned without waiting for 32...♔h8.

269) Aronian – Gelfand
FIDE Grand Prix, Sochi 2008

26 ♕e5! 1-0

If 26...♖xd7 White mates with 27 ♕e8+.

270) Therrien – Baburin
British League (4NCL) 2007/8

23 ♗xh3! ♗xh3 24 ♖fb1 ♕c2 25 ♖a2 1-0

271) Inumerable – Pasalić
Chicago 2008

32 ♕xh5!! gxh4

32...♘xh5 allows mate in four: 33 ♖xf7+ ♔h8 34 ♖f8+ ♔g7 35 ♖1f7+ ♔h6 36 ♖h7#.

33 ♕xh4

with a decisive advantage.

272) Flores – Felgaer
Argentine Ch, Mendoza 2008

19...♘xe3!

The white king is forced to take a walk.

20 dxe3 ♖xe3+ 21 ♔d2 ♖xc3! 22 ♕xd5

On 22 ♔xc3 there follows 22...♖b3+ 23 ♔c2 ♕d4.

22...♖c5 23 ♕d3 ♖b2+ 24 ♔d1 ♕a4+! 25 ♔e1 ♕a5+! 0-1

26 ♔d1 is met by 26...♖d5.

273) Genna – Inkiov
Conegliano 2008

40...♖xd3!

This exchange sacrifice leads to a winning attack; the white king is short of defenders.

41 cxd3 ♕xd3+ 42 ♔a1

42 ♖c2 ♗a4 is no better.

42...♕b5! 43 ♖fe2?!

After 43 ♔b1 ♗xe4+ 44 ♖xe4 ♕d3+ 45 ♖c2 ♕xe4 46 ♕xa6 ♖c7 47 ♕e2 the simplest is 47...♕xc2+ (47...♕h1+ is also good) 48 ♕xc2

♖xc2 49 ♔xc2 ♔g7, stopping White's b-pawn, with a winning pawn endgame.

43...♗xe4! 44 ♕d6 ♗d3 0-1

274) Inkiov – Jovanić
Conegliano 2008

18...♘xg2! 19 ♔xg2 ♗h3+! 20 ♔g3

20 ♔xh3 loses to 20...♕f3+ 21 ♔h4 ♗d8+.

20...♗d8! 21 f4

Now it is mate in three. If 21 ♗g5 the correct move is 21...hxg5!.

21...♕h4+ 22 ♔f3 ♕g4+ 0-1

275) Naumkin – Vezzosi
Conegliano 2008

20 ♘xg7! ♖xe2

20...♔xg7 is met by 21 ♖xd7.

21 ♕c1

21 ♕c4! ♖xb2 22 ♘xe8 also wins.

21...♖8e5 22 ♗xe5 ♖xe5 23 ♗h3! ♔xg7 24 ♗xd7 1-0

276) Papin – Deviatkin
Kavala 2008

As we have seen several times, queen and knight make a fearsome attacking team; after **32...♕e4!** Black is threatening to win with a double check or 33...♖c2. White is not saved by 33 ♗xc7 ♘h4++ 34 ♔f1 (or 34 ♔h3 f5 35 f4 ♕f3 followed by mate) 34...♕h1+ 35 ♔e2 ♕f3+ 36 ♔d2 (or 36 ♔e1 ♘g2+ 37 ♔f1 ♘e3+, mating) 36...♕xf2+ 37 ♔c3 ♕xa2 38 gxh4 ♕xa3.

277) Paunović – Topalov
Villarrobledo (rapid) 2008

44...c3! 0-1

278) Z.Rahman – Myo Zaw Min
Kuala Lumpur 2008

30 ♕xa6!

Inconclusive is 30 ♘xf6+?! gxf6 31 ♖xd8 ♕xd8 32 ♕xc5 ♕d3.

30...♖xd5

Or 30...bxa6 31 b7 ♕b8 32 ♘xf6+ gxf6 33 ♖xd8.

31 ♖xd5 1-0

279) Gajewski – Lenić
Dresden Olympiad 2008

35 ♕g7+! ♔e7 36 ♗f6+! ♔e6 37 ♗d4 wins material through the double threat of mate on f6 and capturing the rook.

280) D. Fridman – Suba
León (rapid) 2008

19 ♕g3! ♘xe6

Losing material, although there was scarcely anything better. After 19...♘e4 20 ♖xe4 dxe4 21 ♗d6 ♕e8 22 ♗xf8 ♔xf8 23 ♕h3 ♔g8 24 ♕f5 Black's position is untenable due to White's huge pawn on e6 and the many weaknesses in the black camp. If 19...♖d8? then 20 ♘c6.

20 ♗d6 ♕f7 21 ♗xf8 ♘xf8 22 h4 h6 23 hxg5 hxg5 24 f4 g4 25 f5

and White won a few moves later.

281) A. Hoffman – Timman
León (rapid) 2008

44 ♖xe3! is possible, creating unanswerable threats. The rook is taboo because Black would be mated (44...♕xe3? 45 ♕f5+ ♔g8 46 ♕g6+, etc., or 44...♖xe3? 45 ♕xd7+) and if 44...♘3e5 there are several ways to win, such as 45 ♖xe5 ♘xe5 46 ♕f5+ ♔g8 47 ♕f8+ ♔h7 48 ♖f6.

282) Ståhlberg – Lynch
Buenos Aires 1945

There is a win with **40 ♖xa3!** ♖d1+ 41 ♗e1 ♖xe1+ (41...♔h7 42 ♕b4 ♕g5 {42...♕h4 43 ♖e3} 43 ♔f1 with an extra piece) 42 ♔f2 ♕h4+ (if 42...♖b1 or 42...♖d1, then 43 ♖a8+ ♔h7 44 ♕g8+ ♔g6 45 ♕e8+ wins; for example, 45...♔g5 46 f4+ ♔g4 47 h3+ ♔h4 48 g3+) 43 g3 ♕xh2+ 44 ♔xe1 ♕xg3+ 45 ♔d2.

283) Harikrishna – Mamedyarov
Foros 2006

25 ♘h6+! gxh6 26 ♕d4

Threatening mate in two with 27 ♕h8+ and ♕g7#.

26...♘e6

26...♖e5 27 ♖gxe5 dxe5 28 ♕xe5 only delays the end.

27 ♕h8+

27 ♖xe6 hxg5 28 ♖e1 also wins; for example, 28...♖e5 29 ♖xe5 ♔f8 30 ♖e1 ♕f7 31 ♖f1 ♗f5 32 g4.

27...♔f7 28 ♖xf5+ ♗xf5 29 ♕f6+ ♔g8 30 ♕xf5 ♘f8 31 ♕d5+ ♕f7 32 ♖e7! 1-0

This ends all resistance; after 32...♕xd5 33 ♖g7+! ♔h8 34 cxd5 the discovery is deadly.

284) Elianov – Inarkiev
FIDE Grand Prix, Elista 2008

39 ♕g4+!

39 ♕g3+ ♔f7 40 ♕b3+ (not, of course, 40 ♖xd2? ♕xf4!) 40...♔f8 41 ♖h4 is also strong.

39...♔h7

Or 39...♔f7 40 ♕h5+ ♔g8 41 ♕g6+, transposing to the game. With 39...♔h6 we have a familiar situation of a king trapped on the edge of the board, allowing 40 ♖f5 ♗g5 41 h4 and if 41...♖h7?! then 42 ♖xg5! mates.

40 ♕h5+ ♔g8 41 ♕g6+ ♖g7

After 41...♔f8 42 ♖h4 ♖f7 it is finally possible to play 43 ♖xd2.

42 ♕e8+ ♘f8 43 ♖xf6 ♕e7 44 ♕xf8+ ♕xf8 45 ♖xf8+ ♔xf8 46 ♖xd2

with a winning endgame.

285) Ja. Bolbochán – P. Martín

Argentine Ch, Buenos Aires 1946

White gains a decisive advantage with **24 ♗c2!**:

a) 24...h6 25 ♖g3! ♗xe5 (if 25...♔h8 then 26 ♖xg7! wins: 26...♔xg7 27 ♕g3+ ♔h8 28 ♕d3 mating) 26 ♕xh6 f5 27 ♕xe6+ ♖f7 28 ♗b3!.

b) 24...g6 25 ♕h6! ♗xe5 26 ♖h3 ♖e8 (after 26...♗xh2+? Black loses more quickly: 27 ♖xh2 ♖e8 28 ♗xg6! fxg6 29 ♕xh7+ ♔f8 30 ♕xg6! ♗d5 31 ♖h7) 27 dxe5! opening the d-file, and postponing ♕xh7+ so that Black is unable to strengthen his defences by playing ...♕g5. Now the attack is irresistible; for example, 27...♕c7 28 ♕xh7+ ♔f8 29 ♗xg6!, with two extra pawns and a very strong attack.

286) Ja. Bolbochán – Rossetto

Argentine Ch, Buenos Aires 1946

White gains an overwhelming advantage with **24 ♕c8!!**, when Black has nothing better than 24...♕xg2+ 25 ♗xg2 ♖xc8, but after 26 ♗xh3 White is two pawns up in an ending and has a winning position.

287) Maderna – Marini

Argentine Ch, Buenos Aires 1946

With **27...♕e6!** Black attacks both of White's minor pieces and after 28 ♗f3 ♗xd5 29 ♖xd5 (or 29 ♔g1 ♖e5) 29...♕xd5 30 ♗xe4 ♕xe4+, Black is very close to winning.

288) Golombek – Ju. Bolbochán

Amsterdam Olympiad 1954

Yes, **19...♘xh3+** wins: **20 ♔h2** (20 ♔h1 loses to 20...♗g4!; e.g., 21 ♕e3 ♕xe3 22 fxe3 ♘f2+ 23 ♔g1 ♘xd1, followed by 24...♖xe4) **20...♕xe5+ 21 ♕g3 ♘xf2** and Black, two pawns up, won.

289) Franco – Larrosa

Galician League 2007

White wins by getting rid of the opposite-coloured bishops and also the knight, which might become a strong blockading piece:

42 ♖xc3! ♕xf3 43 ♗h6+ ♔xh6 44 ♖xf3

White's passed pawn is decisive, since the black king can't effectively join in the defence.

44...♔g5 45 d5 f5 46 d6 ♗e8 47 ♖xf5+ ♔xg4 48 ♖f8 ♗c6 49 ♔f2 1-0

290) Emma – Rossetto

Mar del Plata 1959

The third option is correct: with best play, Black is fighting (successfully) for a draw. However, after **27 ♖xe5! ♖xe5**, the game ended **28 f4?? ♖d5! 0-1**. White should play **28 ♕c3!**, when in the pawn ending after 28...b4! 29 ♗xe5 bxc3 30 ♗xf6 gxf6 31 b4 cxb3 32 axb3, Black's counterplay in lines like 32...f5 33 ♔e2 ♔g7 34 ♔d3 ♔f6 35 g3 f4 36 g4 ♔g5 37 ♔xc3 ♔h4 38 ♔d4 ♔xh3 39 ♔e4 ♔g3 40 b4 ♔f2 41 ♔xf4 ♔e2 is sufficient.

291) Rossetto – Franco

Mercedes 1975

31...♗xg3! leads to an ending a pawn up: 32 ♖xg3 ♖xg3+ 33 ♔xg3 ♕e5+! 34 ♔h3 (34 ♔f3? ♕h5+) 34...♕xe4.

292) Franco – Letelier

La Falda 1977

Instead of remaining with the h2-bishop 'dead', White can gain the advantage with **34 ♗xf4!** gxf4 35 ♕xf4, and after, e.g., 35...♖e6 36 ♖d8+ ♖e8 37 ♖xe8+ ♘xe8 38 ♕xf7+ ♔xf7 39 g5 he has a winning endgame.

293) Panno – Franco

Los Polvorines 1980

No, after **27 ♕xe4? ♗f5 28 ♕f4 g5 29 ♕d4 ♘f3+** Black has the advantage.

294) I. Ivanov – Vera

Capablanca Memorial, Cienfuegos 1980

25...♕h5! 26 f3

This prevents 26...♕f3+. If 26 ♗e3 there are several favourable moves, such as 26...♕f3+ 27 ♔g1 ♘c5!? (27...♕xe4 28 ♕xe7 ♘xb2 is also good), seeking to eliminate the e4-knight which

is preventing the transfer of Black's rooks to his third rank; e.g., 28 ♗xc5 ♗xc5 29 ♖ae1 ♖d6! 30 ♘xd6 ♗xf2+ 31 ♖xf2 ♕xf2+.

26...♘e1+ 27 ♔h1 ♘xf3 28 h3 ♖f5 0-1

295) Bruzón – Franco

Linares 2001

31...♖c2! gives Black a decisive advantage: 32 ♕e3 (or 32 ♔a2 ♖d3, with the idea of 33...♕d5+) 32...♘b3+ 33 ♕xb3 ♖xd1+ 34 ♖xd1 ♕xd1+ 35 ♔a2 ♖c1 and wins.

296) Barrero – Matamoros

Dos Hermanas 2001

24 ♖fd1! is a better defence. After 24...♗xd1 25 ♖xd1 White wins material, since the g3-knight has no good move: 25...♘xe4 26 ♘xe4 ♖d7 27 ♗e3 ♖xd1+ 28 ♗xd1.

297) Franco – Paunović

Orense 2005

No, after **45 ♗g2?** Black has **45...♕xa7!** and White loses his biggest trump, since 46 ♗xa7 ♘g3+ 47 ♔h2 ♘f1++ 48 ♔h1 ♘g3+ is a draw.

298) Illescas – Ibarra

Spanish Ch, Ceuta 2008

51 ♕f4! (threatening 52 a7) 51...♕a7 52 ♗d5! ♖b8 (or 52...♖b6 53 ♕xf7+! ♕xf7 54 ♗xf7 ♖f6 55 ♗d5 ♖f2 56 ♖xf2 ♗xf2 57 ♔g2 ♗c5 58 g5, followed by the transfer of the king to b7, winning the black bishop) 53 ♖c2! ♖f8 54 ♖c7.

299) Malakhatko – Pérez Felipe

La Laguna 2008

20 ♖d5+!! ♔g6

20...exd5 loses to 21 ♕h6+ ♔f5 22 ♖h5+ ♔e4 23 f3+ ♔d4 24 ♕f6+.

21 ♗d3+! 1-0

Winning the queen, since 21...cxd3 leads to mate after 22 ♕g3+ ♔f6 23 ♕g5#.

300) Van Wely – Shirov

Foros 2008

The game went **25...♕xc6? 26 ♖xc6 ♖xd3** and here by playing 27 f3! (instead of **27 f4?**) 27...♖a3 28 ♘c3 White would have been only slightly worse.

Instead, with **25...♕xd3!** Black threatens to capture the knight, as well as to play 26...♖c8. Black wins after, e.g., 26 ♘c3 (26 ♘g3 ♖c8) 26...♖c8 27 ♕b7 ♖xc3 28 ♕b8+ ♗c8!.

301) Bernasek – Talla

Brno 2008

White could have won with **45 ♖f8!** ♕xf8 46 ♗xf8 ♖e5 47 e7 e2 48 ♕g8! e1♕+ 49 ♔a2 a6 50 ♗g7+ ♔a7 51 ♗xe5 ♕xe5 52 e8♕.

302) Ju. Bolbochán – Lipiniks

Argentine Ch, Buenos Aires 1946

Black could have broken out by **36...♖xd6!**, after which the advantage lies with him; e.g., 37 ♗e1 ♖fd8! (37...♖d7 38 ♗xa5 bxa5 39 ♖xa5 ♖c8 and now 40 ♘e1! leaves the g7-bishop very passive – but not 40 ♖xc5? ♗f8 41 ♖a5 ♗b4, followed by 42...♗c5) 38 ♗xa5 (no better is 38 ♖xa5 ♖d3! 39 ♖xd3 ♖xd3 40 ♖xa7 ♗xf3 with a winning position) 38...♗xf3 39 ♗xf3 ♖d3 40 ♖xd3 ♖xd3 41 ♗e2 ♖e3 42 ♔f2 ♖xe5 and Black regains his piece and remains several pawns up.

303) Corte – Piazzini

Argentine Ch, Buenos Aires 1946

The game continued **32...♗xd4?** (this allows White to shield the c-pawn) **33 ♖xd4 ♖b2+** (or 33...♖c2 34 ♖c4) **34 ♔c5! ♖b8 35 c7 ♖c8 36 ♔c6 g5 37 ♔b7 ♖xc7+ 38 ♔xc7 1-0**. The black pawns are not dangerous.

Black should have played **32...♖b2+!**:

a) 33 ♘b3 a5+! 34 ♖xa5 puts the rook on the e1-a5 diagonal, which suits Black: 34...♖c2 35 ♔b5 (35 ♘c5? ♗c3+) 35...♗e5 and only Black can play for a win.

b) 33 ♔c5 ♗e7+ 34 ♔c4 ♖b4+ 35 ♔d3 ♖b8 36 ♖d7 ♔f6 37 c7 (37 ♖xa7?! ♗c5 38 ♖xa6 ♔e7) 37...♖c8 (intending 38...♗c5 and ...♗b6) 38 ♔c4 ♗d8!? (38...a5?! 39 ♔b5 a4 40 ♔c6) 39 ♖xd8 ♖xc7+ and Black's problems are over.

304) Pachman – Pilnik

Mar del Plata 1959

25 ♗xf6!

Eliminating the biggest obstacle to White's kingside attack.

25...♗xf6

After 25...♖xb2 the most elegant win is 26 ♕h6! ♗xh6+ 27 ♖xh6 ♕g7 28 ♗xg7 ♔xg7 29 ♖h7+ ♔f6 30 g7 ♗f7 31 g8♕ ♗xg8 32 ♖xg8.

26 ♗h3!

26 g7 ♗xg7 27 ♗h3 was another way.

26...♗d7

26...♖xb2 can be met by 27 ♗e6+ ♔f8 28 g7+! ♗xg7 29 ♖h8+ ♗xh8 30 ♖g8+ ♔e7 31 ♕g5+ ♗f6 32 ♖g7+, mating quickly.

27 ♕f2

There are other wins, such as 27 ♕h6 ♗xh3 28 g7 ♗xg7 29 ♖xh3.

27...♖f8 28 g7! ♗g5+

Or 28...♗xg7 29 ♖xg7+ ♔xg7 30 ♖g1+, mating quickly.

29 ♖xg5 ♖xf2 30 ♗e6+ 1-0

30...♗xe6 31 ♖h8+ ♔f7 32 g8♕+ followed by mate.

305) D. Byrne – Penrose

Mar del Plata 1962

Here **36...g5!** is very strong: 37 ♖e1 (37 hxg5 ♕h5+ 38 ♔g1 ♘e2+ 39 ♔f2 ♗d4+ 40 ♔e1 ♗c3+) 37...♕g4 38 ♗b8 (38 hxg5 ♖xf4! 39 gxf4 ♘f3! 40 ♗xf3 ♕h3+ 41 ♔g1 ♗d4+) 38...gxh4 39 ♖e4 ♖f1+! 40 ♗xf1 ♕xe4+ 41 ♗g2 ♘f3 42 ♗xf3 ♕xf3+ 43 ♔h2 hxg3+, with two extra pawns and the white king very exposed.

306) Foguelman – Cruz

Mar del Plata 1965

Reversing the move-order with **26...♖xc4!!** wins:

a) Now 27 ♘xc4 is answered by 27...♖f6+! 28 ♗f3 ♗xc4 29 ♕xc4 ♖xf3+ 30 ♔g2 ♖f2+! 31 ♗xf2 ♕h2+ 32 ♔f3 ♘e5+ 33 ♔e4 ♘xc4, with the plan of ...f5+. Black has a material advantage, two connected passed pawns and a strong attack.

b) 27 ♗f3 ♖c3 (or 27...♖f4) 28 ♕b1 ♘e3+ 29 ♗xe3 ♖xe3 followed by 30...g4, winning.

307) Rublevsky – Grishchuk

Candidates match (game 7), Elista 2007

29...♘xh4!

Black captures a vital pawn, so that in many lines the black h-pawn can become passed. The tactics favour Black, thanks in part to the activity of his rooks and the weak position of the white king.

30 ♖xb2

This makes it easy for Black. Let's examine some other lines:

a) 30 ♗xa3 ♖xb1+ 31 ♖xb1 ♖xb1+ 32 ♔xb1 ♘xg2 33 ♗c5 ♘xf4 34 ♔c2 h4 (this pawn is decisive; the white king is too far away and the bishop is helpless to stop it) 35 ♗f2 h3 36 ♗g3 ♘e2 37 ♗h2 ♘d4+ 38 ♔c3 ♘f3, queening.

b) 30 g3 ♘f5 31 ♗xa3 ♖xb1+ 32 ♖xb1 ♖xb1+ 33 ♔xb1 ♘xg3 34 ♗c5 h4 35 ♗f2 ♘f5 36 a4 h3 37 ♗g1 ♘d4 (or 37...♘h4) 38 a5 ♘f3 39 a6 ♘xg1 40 a7 h2 41 a8♕+ ♔h7, with an extra piece soon.

c) 30 ♖bg1 ♘xg2 31 ♖xh5 ♖e2! 32 ♖h2 (if 32 ♗d4 then 32...♘e1!) 32...♖bb2 33 ♗xa3 ♖xa2+ 34 ♔b1 ♖xa3 35 ♖gxg2 ♖xg2 36 ♖xg2 ♖xd3 37 ♖c2 ♖f3 38 ♖xc7 ♖xf4 39 ♖e7 ♖b4+ 40 ♔c2 ♖b6.

30...axb2+ 31 ♔b1 ♘xg2 32 f5 ♘f4 33 fxe6 ♘xd3 34 ♗a3 ♘xe5 35 ♔c2 ♘c4 36 ♗c5 ♘d2 37 a4 b1♕+ 38 ♖xb1 ♘xb1 39 a5 ♖b5 0-1

308) Bromberger – Kremenietsky

Gausdal 2008

20 ♖xf6!! ♔xf6

Now a storm hits the black king, but just accepting the loss of the pawn was not satisfactory either. After 20...♖hf8 there are several interesting lines, such as 21 ♖h6 or 21 ♕d3, but the simplest one also seems very good: 21 ♖xf8 ♖xf8 22 ♗g5+ ♔f7 and now after 23 ♕c1, with the plan of ♗h6, ♕f4+ and ♖f1, the attack looks very strong. Let's not forget that there are three somewhat useless black pieces on the queenside.

21 ♕f1+! ♔g7

21...♔e7 leads to mate with 22 ♗g5+ ♔e8 23 ♗h5+.

22 ♗h6+! ♔g8

22...♔xh6 23 ♕f6#.

23 ♕f6 ♗e4 24 ♖f1! 1-0

There is no satisfactory defence against 25 ♕f8+.

309) Kasimdzhanov – Gelfand

FIDE Grand Prix, Nalchik 2009

25...♖d8!

Suddenly White can't get out of the pin.

26 ♖f2

No better is 26 ♗xh6, to which the simplest reply is 26...♗xd5!. The simplification 26 ♗xe5 ♕xe5 does not help either. Finally, the resource 26 ♗g5 hxg5 27 ♕h5 leaves Black with only one move, but it is sufficient: 27...♕h6! 28 ♘e7+ ♔h8 and everything is defended.

26...c3!

Controlling the d2-square; not the immediate 26...♗xd5? on account of 27 ♖d2 and White hangs on.

27 ♖f3 ♗xd5 28 ♖d3 ♘xd3! 0-1

Black escapes from the pin with the threat of 29...♘f2+, retaining an overwhelming material advantage.

310) Radjabov – Cheparinov
FIDE Grand Prix, Sochi 2008

35 f3!!

The crucial element here is the passed pawn that will be created on a6, after a fresh sacrifice of material. Not 35 ♖xb6? axb6 36 a7 in view of 36...♕e4!, which is the move that 35 f3!! is designed to prevent.

35...♕h5 36 ♖xb6! ♕h1+ 37 ♘g1 ♖xd6 38 exd6 1-0

The pawn can't be stopped after 38...axb6 39 a7.

311) Lynch – Ju. Bolbochán
La Plata 1944

47...♖xc5! (the simplest, liquidating to a winning endgame) **48 ♕xc5 ♕c8+ 49 ♕xc8 ♖xc8 0-1**.

312) R. García – Averbakh
Mar del Plata 1965

26...♘b2! (with a double attack, winning an exchange) **27 ♖xb2** (if 27 ♘d6 then 27...♖8c6) **27...♗xb2**.

313) Cvetić – Andonov
Senta 2007

17...♘xe4!

Owing to the bad position of the white king and the lack of coordination between the white pieces, there are several favourable lines for Black, but this is definitely the best. The threat is mate in two with 18...♘f2+ or 18...♘g3+.

18 ♖xe4 ♕xe4 0-1

314) Nayer – Ulko
Moscow 2007

43 ♖g8+! ♖xg8 44 ♕xe5+ 1-0

44...♖g7 45 ♕b8+ leads to mate.

315) Grau – Guimard
Buenos Aires 1935

18 ♗xb5! ♕xb5 19 ♕xe6 ♕e8 20 ♕xa6 with an extra pawn and the better position.

316) Emma – Ja. Bolbochán
Mar del Plata 1959

29 ♖xe8+! ♖xe8 30 ♖a8 1-0

317) Wexler – Fischer
Mar del Plata 1960

One very well placed piece, such as the white knight on e4, is not enough to compensate for other defects in the position. With **26...♗g4!** Black gains the advantage: **27 fxg4** (27 ♘d2 allows the g7-bishop to become active after 27...♗h3 28 ♖fc1 and now 28...e4 or 28...♗f6 followed by 29...♗g5) **27...♖xf1+ 28 ♔g2 ♕g6 29 ♗f2 ♖a1** with advantage to Black.

318) Eliskases – Letelier
Mar del Plata 1960

31...b3!

Exploiting the passed pawn is more important than saving the bishop.

32 fxg6 hxg6 33 ♖xc4

33 ♖e1 b2 34 ♗e4 does not help, since Black can win by hounding the white rook: 34...♕b4 35 ♖d1 ♗b3! 36 ♖f1 ♗a2 37 ♗b1 ♗c4! 38 ♖d1 ♗e2.

33...b2 34 ♗e4 ♕xe3+ 0-1

319) Gheorghiu – Behrensen
Mar del Plata 1965

16 ♘d5! ♕xe1

If 16...♕c5 then 17 ♕f2.

17 ♘xe7+ ♔c7 18 ♗xe1 ♖de8 19 ♗b4 and White won.

320) Rubinetti – Uhlmann
Mar del Plata 1966

24...♗xf3! 25 ♗xf3 g5 and White loses a piece: **26 ♔h2 ♔h8 27 ♖g1 ♖g8**.

321) M. García García – Martín Gracia
Catalonian Ch 1982

20 ♖xg6!

Not the only way to win, but definitely the strongest.

20...♔xg6 21 ♗xf5+! ♕xf5 22 ♖g1+ 1-0

322) Züger – Estremera
European Ch, Dresden 2007

30...♖e7!

There is no adequate response to the threat of 31...♖e2+.

31 g3

31 ♖e1 is met by 31...♘d3+.

31...♖e2+ 32 ♕xe2 ♕d4+ 33 ♔f1 ♗xe2+ 34 ♖xe2 ♕d1+ 35 ♖e1 ♕d3+ 0-1

323) Gutman – Bakker
Leiden 2008

19 h4! (and there is no satisfactory defence against 20 h5) **19...♕c8 20 h5 f6 21 hxg6 fxe5 22 dxe5 ♘b5 23 ♕b3 ♘c7 24 ♗h3**.

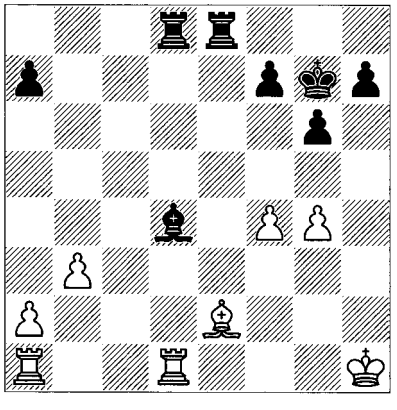
324) Karim – Paunović
Seville 2008
35...♗e4! 0-1
There is no defence against the threat of 36...g4; e.g., if 36 g4 then 36...f5 37 ♔g3 f4+ 38 ♔g2 h5 39 gxh5 g4.

325) Steingrimsson – Kritz
European Ch, Plovdiv 2008
34...♖c1+! 0-1
There are other ways to win, but this is the most convincing. The d7-pawn will never become a queen. There would follow 35 ♘xc1 (or 35 ♘g1 ♕xa4) 35...♕f1+ 36 ♗g1 ♕xg2#.

326) Ivanchuk – Kramnik
Dortmund 2008
49 ♖f4! 1-0
There is no way to defend f7, since if 49...f6 then 50 ♕d5+ wins.

327) Kariakin – Mamedyarov
FIDE World Cup, Khanty-Mansiisk 2009
50 f4! (White seeks to create some cover for the king, freeing his rook with lethal effects for Black's king) **50...♖f2** (after 50...gxf4 51 ♖e5! Black has no checks and there is no defence) **51 ♖d5+ ♔c8 52 ♔e7! 1-0**. Black is mated after 52...♖e2+ 53 ♖e5 ♖xe5+ 54 fxe5 g4 55 e6 g3 56 ♔f8 g2 57 e7 g1♕ 58 e8♕#.

328) Gaponenko – A. Graf
Kavala 2008
33...♖ee8!
Defending the rook on d8.
34 ♖ed1 ♗d4! *(D)*



35 ♗f3
Or 35 ♖ac1 ♖xe2 36 ♖c4 ♖e4.
35...♗xa1
Black has a decisive advantage.

329) Luther – Brunner
Chambéry 2008
47 ♕d4+! 1-0
Winning the exposed bishop after 47...♔b7 (or 47...♔b8 48 ♘xa6+) 48 ♕e4+.

330) D. Boros – A. Gupta
World Junior Ch, Gaziantep 2008
21...♖xd4! 22 ♖xd4 ♕xb2 23 ♖ad1 ♕xc3 with a decisive advantage.

331) I. Sokolov – Striković
León (rapid) 2008
30 ♘xe4!
Not 30 ♗e2? axb3 31 axb3 ♘xb3, nor 30 ♗d1? ♘d3.
30...♕xd2+ 31 ♘xd2 axb3 32 axb3 with an extra pawn.

332) Bareev – Timman
León (rapid) 2008
30 ♘g6+! 1-0
After 30...hxg6 31 ♕h3+ White forces mate next move.

333) Bareev – Granda
León (rapid) 2008
38 ♖d8+! 1-0
A decisive liquidation, forcing 38...♔h7 39 ♕d3+ ♕e4 40 ♕xe4+ ♗xe4 41 ♖d7 with a winning endgame.

334) Montiel – Lipiniks
Argentine Ch, Buenos Aires 1946
35...♗d3! (preparing 36...♕a1+, to which there is no good reply) **36 ♗xf7+ ♔g7 37 g3 ♕a1+ 38 ♔g2 c1♕ 39 ♕f3 ♕h1+ 0-1**.

335) Rossetto – R. Sanguineti
Mar del Plata 1962
28 ♖xg4!
The e6-bishop proves to be surprisingly overloaded.
28...f2
Not 28...♗xg4? 29 ♗b5+.
29 ♗xf2 ♖xh2 30 ♖g8+ ♔d7 31 ♕e3 1-0

336) Cruz – Palermo
Mar del Plata 1965
20...♗xb2!

This bishop is taboo because there is an unexpected mating-net.

21 ♗g5

21 ♖xb2? ♘c3+ 22 ♔e1 ♖d1#.

21...♘c3+

with a decisive material advantage.

337) Khalifman – Vaganian
Bazna 2007

19 ♕g3!

Threatening both to capture the e5-knight and to play 20 ♗g5.

19...♘ef3+

If 19...♘g4+ then 20 hxg4 g5 21 ♗xg5! ♕xg5 22 ♖e5 ♕f6 23 ♖ael (or 23 g5 ♕h8 24 ♔g1), with an extra pawn and a crushing position.

20 gxf3 ♘xf3+ 21 ♔g2 1-0

338) Milos – Sunye
São Paulo Zonal 2007

24 ♖xe6! 1-0

A possible line is 24...♖xe6 25 ♕xf5 ♖g6 26 ♗xd5+ ♗xd5 27 ♕xc8+ ♕f8 28 ♕xf8+ ♔xf8 29 ♖xd5, with a decisive material advantage.

339) Pogonina – Godena
Solin 2007

28 ♗a4! with the threat of 29 ♘b3 winning the exchange, against which there is no defence.

340) Tomashevsky – Svidler
Russian Ch, Moscow 2007

30 ♗a5! (exploiting the lack of an escape-square for the black king) **30...♘xa5 31 ♖xc7 1-0**.

341) Le Quang Liem – Nepomniashchy
Moscow 2008

63...♖b2+!

White will be unable to cope with two hostile passed pawns on the seventh rank and therefore Black will win material.

64 ♖xb2 cxb2 65 ♔c2 f2 66 ♖c7+ ♗xc7 67 h8♕ b1♕+! 68 ♔xb1 f1♕+ 0-1

342) Jepson – Hillarp Persson
Elsinore 2008

33 e5!

Did you spot the tactical weakness of the two black rooks? 33 ♘g5+ ♔g7 34 e5 was also good.

33...dxe5 34 ♘g5+ ♔g8 35 ♘e4 1-0

343) Almasi – Seyb
Mainz (rapid) 2008

42 ♖xf7+! 1-0

A striking combination of a pin, a knight fork and a double attack. If 42...♕xf7 then 43 ♘g5+.

344) Senador – Dzhumaev
Kuala Lumpur 2008

23...♕a1+! 24 ♔d2 ♕a5+ (winning a piece) **25 ♘c3 ♗xc3+ 26 bxc3 ♕xb5 0-1**.

345) Ki. Georgiev – Jobava
Barcelona 2008

59 ♖e8+! ♔f7 60 ♖gf8+ 1-0

Black resigned in view of 60...♔g7 61 ♖xf6 ♗xf2+ 62 ♔g5, with a decisive material advantage.

346) Guseinov – Ezat
Dresden Olympiad 2008

30 ♕e7+ ♔g8 31 ♕e8+! 1-0

31...♘f8 32 ♕xc6.

347) Ju. Bolbochán – Hounie Fleurquin
Mar del Plata 1947

32 ♕xb3! ♕f4

After 32...cxb3 33 ♖xc7 there is no defence against 34 ♖c8.

33 ♖xc4 ♖xc4 34 ♕xc4 1-0

348) Panno – Najdorf
Buenos Aires 1965

26 ♖xd6! 1-0

26...♗xd6 27 ♗xf6+ ♔g8 28 ♕h6 and White mates.

349) Revilla – M. García García
Catalonia Ch 1982

33...♘f3+!

Making good use of the passed pawn.

34 ♔xg2 ♖xc1 35 ♖xc1

If 35 ♗xc1 then 35...♘e1+.

35...♘xd2 0-1

350) Gelfand – Morozevich
World Ch, Mexico City 2007

29 ♗h3!

White will emerge the exchange up and with a passed h-pawn – a decisive advantage. Not 29 ♖xf6?? ♖xg4 and the g2-bishop is pinned.

29...♖xg4+ 30 ♗xg4+ ♔d8 31 ♖xf6 ♗xd5 32 a3 b5 33 h4

and White won. Even better was 33 ♖f4, pointed out by Gelfand.

351) M. García García – Marull

Catalonian Team Ch 2007

16 ♗xd6! exd6

16...a4 17 ♕b4 does not change the situation.

17 ♖xd6 ♕c7 18 ♖d7 1-0

18...♕xd7 is forced (18...♕c6 19 ♘d6+ ♔f8 20 ♖xd8+ ♖xd8 21 ♕xf7#) but after 19 ♗xd7+ ♔xd7 Black's king can't be defended owing to the passivity of his pieces, and he will suffer serious loss of material; e.g., after 20 ♖d1+ ♔e8 21 ♕b6 Black is practically in zugzwang.

352) Bente – Estremera

European Ch, Dresden 2007

24...♖xg3! 25 ♖xg3 ♗d6

This bishop dominates the position, and the main victim will be the white king.

26 ♖g1?!

The relatively best move, 26 ♖e3, is met by 26...♗f4 27 ♔e2 ♗xe3 28 ♔xe3 ♗xd3+ 29 ♔xd3 ♘c4 30 ♘g2 ♘b2+.

26...♗f4+ 27 ♔e2 ♗xd3++ 28 ♔f2

Or 28 ♔xd3 ♘c4!.

28...♗e2 29 ♖b1 ♗e3+

with a decisive material advantage.

353) Estremera – Galiana

Magaluf 2008

15 e5!

The position will be opened up and the black king will be unable to reach safety.

15...♗xf3 16 exd6 ♗d5 17 ♖e1+ ♗e6

After the miserable move 17...♔f8 White could play 18 ♗a3, followed by ♖e7.

18 ♕c6+ ♘d7 19 ♗g5! ♕c8 20 ♕e4 ♘c5 21 d7+! ♘xd7 22 ♖ac1

If Black could only castle, he would escape the worst, but this is not going to happen.

22...♕b8 23 ♗f4 ♕d8 24 ♗c7 ♕c8 25 ♗d6 ♕d8 26 ♗c7 ♕c8 27 ♗e5 ♕d8 28 ♗xg7 ♖g8 29 ♕xh7 ♔e7 30 ♖xe6+! fxe6 31 ♗e5+

with mate in five.

354) Sakaev – Timofeev

Russian Ch, Moscow 2007

15...♘b4!

This wins material, but in fact in just a few moves he will have to give up the exchange, although for tremendous compensation.

16 ♘d4 ♘xa2+ 17 ♔d2 0-0-0 18 ♔e1 ♖xd4! 19 ♖xd4 ♘b4

Threatening 20...♘c2+.

20 ♗d1 ♖e8

The three white pieces on the open e-file are too much of a weakness. After **21 ♖g1 ♗xc4 22 f4 ♘bd5 23 ♖xd5 ♘xd5** Black soon won.

355) Beliavsky – I. Khamrakulov

Pamplona 2007

27...♕xe4! 0-1

White resigned in view of 28 fxe4 ♖c1+ 29 ♔f2 ♖f1+.

356) Ignacz – Estremera

Pamplona 2007

19...♕b6!

Surprisingly, although White is the exchange up, he is unable to hold the position after this double attack on f2 and b2.

20 ♕c2

Or 20 ♔h2 ♕xb2 21 ♗d3 ♘c3.

20...♗xf2+ 21 ♖xf2 ♕xf2+ 22 ♔h2 ♗xh3

22...♕g3+ 23 ♔g1 ♘f2 is another way to win.

23 ♗d3 ♗xg2 24 ♕xf2

Or 24 ♗xe4 ♕xc2 25 ♗xc2 ♗xf3, with a decisive advantage.

24...♘xf2 25 ♖d2 ♗xf3 0-1

357) Butti – Kropff

Paraguayan Ch, Asunción 2008

11 ♗xe6!

This sacrifice is thematic; the e6-square needs to be well protected by Black, which is not the case here.

11...♗xg5

11...fxe6 loses to 12 ♘xe6 ♕a5 13 ♕d5.

12 ♗xf7+!

An attractive sacrifice to expose the king.

12...♖xf7?

12...♔xf7 is a slight improvement but after 13 ♘e6! (or 13 ♕h5+ ♔g8 14 ♗xg5, and White is a pawn up with an attack) 13...♔xe6 14 ♕d5+ ♔e7 15 ♗xg5+ ♘f6 16 ♕xa8 there is no defence.

13 ♘e6 ♗xe3?

If 13...♕a5 14 ♘xg5 ♖f6? then 15 ♕d5+ wins. Or 13...♕e7 14 ♘xg5 and the rook can't retreat because White has 15 ♕d5+.

14 ♘xd8 ♗xf2+ 15 ♔e2 ♘e5 16 ♘xf7 ♗g4+ 17 ♔xf2 1-0

358) Kononenko – Zhao Zong Yuan
Seville 2008

The game went **44 g4? c4 45 gxf5 h5!** and Black was able to defend.

44 ♖f3! is an improvement, threatening to capture the d3-bishop as well as to play 45 ♖g3+; then if 44...c4? White wins with 45 ♖g3+ ♔h6 46 ♕f4+ ♔h5 47 ♗f3#.

359) Kononenko – Korneev
Seville 2008

26...♘f4!

Not only is the white queen a long way from the centre, it is also a tactical weakness.

27 exf4

If 27 ♕g4 then 27...h5!, while on 27 ♕h1 comes 27...♘d3.

27...♕xd4+ 28 ♔f1 ♕xd2

with an extra pawn and the attack.

360) Golubev – Buchenau
Internet 2008

18 ♘f1!

The pin on the e-file wins.

18...♗c5

The alternative was 18...♕f4, but after 19 ♘xe3 d4 20 ♘c4! ♖xe1+ 21 ♖xe1 ♕xd2+ 22 ♘xd2! dxc3 23 ♖e8+ ♗f8 24 ♘e4! it will end quickly in mate.

19 ♘d1!

winning a piece.

361) Inants – Batsanin
Russian Team Ch, Dagomys 2008

22...♘d5! (exploiting two pins) **23 d4 ♕xd4 24 ♖4f3 ♖xe4! 0-1**.

362) Kariakin – Inarkiev
FIDE Grand Prix, Baku 2008

42 ♗xb5!

Better than 42 ♕xe5 f6 43 ♕g3 ♘e6, which allows Black a degree of activity.

42...♖d1

42...♗xb5 43 ♕xe5 f6 44 ♖xb5 is hopeless for Black.

43 ♘e3 1-0

363) Gladyszev – Naumkin
Cutro 2008

28...♕d2+!

After the exchange of queens, Black can invade the seventh rank and paralyse White.

29 ♕xd2 ♘b3+ 30 ♔b1 ♖xd2 31 ♗d1 ♗d3

31...♖xg2!? 32 e4 ♘d2+ is also good.

32 e4

Or 32 ♖g1 ♖f2 and White is almost in zugzwang.

32...♖xg2

and Black wins material while retaining a positional advantage.

364) Ivanchuk – Bu Xiangzhi
Sofia 2008

9 ♗xb5+! axb5 10 ♘xb5

And there is no satisfactory defence against 11 ♘c7+.

10...e6

Not 10...♘a6? 11 ♕c6+ ♘d7 12 ♘xd7.

11 ♘c7+ ♔e7 12 ♘xa8

with a decisive material advantage.

365) Strobel – Saltaev
Hamburg 2008

29...c5!

In contrast 29...♖xa7? 30 ♕c8+ ♔h7 31 ♕f5+ g6 32 ♕xf6 is nothing special, and 29...♕xa7? is inferior on account of 30 ♖e8+!.

30 ♕d7 ♗e6

This does not lose the whole of Black's advantage, but 30...cxb4 is better, as is 30...♗xf3! 31 gxf3 ♕a1+! (to defend the f6-bishop) 32 ♔g2 ♖xa7 33 ♖e8+ ♔h7 34 ♕f5+ g6.

31 ♖xe6 ♕xe6 32 ♕b7 ♕c8 33 ♕xc8+ ♖xc8

and Black won the endgame.

366) Rowson – Granda
Palau 2008

28 b4! 1-0

Now 28...♘d7?! loses to 29 ♖c8+ ♗d8 30 ♗xg6+ ♔e7 31 ♕h7+, mating. On the other hand, 28 ♗xg6+ is less convincing, although still better for White, after 28...♔d8 29 b4 ♘d7 30 ♖fc1.

367) Salguero – F. Peralta
Argentine Ch, Mendoza 2008

The game went **33...♘xf4+? 34 gxf4 ♕e6 35 d5** and the strong centre pawns provided good protection for the white king; White went on to win.

The tactical weakness arising from White's queen and king both being in range of a knight fork could have been exploited with **33...♕xb1!** 34 ♖xb1 ♘xd4+, or even in the reverse order **33...♘xd4+!** 34 ♖xd4 ♕xb1, with an overwhelming advantage for Black in both cases.

368) Flores Ríos – Zambrana
Santos 2008

28 ♘xe5!

Surprisingly, the d4-knight constitutes a tactical weakness.

28...♔xe5

There is no time for 28...♘b5 on account of 29 ♘ed3 ♘c3 30 ♘c5+!, while 28...♘xb3? 29 cxb3 ♔xe5 30 ♘d3+! costs Black material.

29 ♘d3+ ♔d6 30 e5+ ♔e6 31 ♘xb4 ♘xc2 32 ♘xa6 ♖xa6 33 exf6 1-0

369) Ikonnikov – Cherin
Conegliano 2008

19 ♘e7!

This simplification displaces the black knight and leads to a win, since White is now able to exploit his domination of the e-file and his ability to invade on e7.

19...♘d8 20 ♗xb7 ♘xb7 21 ♘d5 ♖f7

21...♖ac8 loses to 22 ♖e7 ♖f7 23 ♖xf7 ♕xf7 24 ♖e7 and 25 ♕d4+.

22 ♘xc7! ♖g8

If 22...♖xc7 then 23 ♖e8+.

23 ♘e8 1-0

370) N. Mamedov – Kovaliov
Sort 2008

34 ♖e7!!

Black's queen and bishop are overloaded.

34...♖g6 35 ♖xe6 ♖xg2 36 ♖xg2 d5 37 ♖e8 1-0

371) Rozentalis – Lalić
Paris 2008

29...♖xe6!

Winning a piece; if 30 ♕xe6 then 30...f5! and the e4-rook can't retreat in view of 31...♘f4+.

372) Ipatov – Cuartas
Barberá del Valles 2008

Black is almost paralysed; neither the rook nor the knight can move, so all White needs to do is attack them.

43 e4! dxe4+ 44 ♔xe4 gxf4 45 ♔e5

and White gains a decisive material advantage.

373) Miezis – Wells
Trefforst 2008

20 ♘xe6!

Opening the e-file and the h3-c8 diagonal, which will prove fatal.

20...♕xe6

If 20...♖xg4 then 21 ♘6xc5+ ♔c7 22 hxg4 bxc5 23 gxf5 ♗h4 24 f6! ♗xf6 25 ♕h5.

21 ♘xc5+ bxc5 22 ♖xe6 ♔xe6 23 ♕e2+ ♔d6 24 ♗xf5 1-0

374) E. Berg – Rozentalis
Najdorf Memorial, Warsaw 2008

38 ♕e5! 1-0

The threat of 39 ♕b8+ enables White to remain a rook up. Other moves such as 38 ♕g5 or 38 ♕d5 would also win in the long run, but are much less effective than the move in the game.

375) Euler – Almasi
Mainz (rapid) 2008

21...♘fe4! 0-1

Winning a piece, since if White plays 22 ♘xe4 or moves his knight away then 22...♘f3+ wins.

376) Ovetchkin – Pushkov
Sukhumi 2008

17...♖c4!

There is no good way to defend d4 because of problems with the white queen.

18 b3

Not 18 ♘f3? ♘c7 19 ♕b3 ♗c2.

18...♘c7 19 bxc4 ♘xb5 20 cxb5 ♕c7

with a winning position.

377) Laznicka – Hou Yifan
World Junior Ch, Gaziantep 2008

52...♕c3+!

With this precise manoeuvre, Black wins quickly. 52...♕c6 53 c8♕ ♕xc8 54 ♖bb7 is less clear.

53 ♔h4 ♕h8+ 0-1

It is mate after 54 ♔g5 ♕f6+ 55 ♔h6 g5+ 56 ♔h5 ♕g6#.

378) Nakamura – Altounian
Internet 2008

31 f5!

Decisively opening up the black king's defences.

31...exf5 32 ♕c4+ ♔g7

Now instead of the move played, **33 ♘e5**, which was quite good, even better is 33 ♘e7!, threatening to mate by 34 ♕g8+, and winning more quickly than in the game, since 33...♗xe7 is met by 34 ♖xe7+ ♔h8 35 ♕f7, mating.

379) Hou Yifan – Kosteniuk

Women's World Ch match (game 1), Nalchik 2008

37...♗xg4!

A beautiful blow which regains the piece, leaving Black ahead on material.

38 ♕f2 d1♕ 39 ♘xd1 ♗xd1 40 ♕e1 ♗f3+ 41 ♔g1 f5!

As well as the extra pawn, Black has an attack, and the rest was easy.

380) Arizmendi – I. Khamrakulov

Ceuta 2008

14 ♕e1!

Now the a7-pawn is lost.

14...♕xe1 15 ♖axe1 ♗d7

Not 15...a6? 16 ♘c7 ♖b8 17 ♗a7.

16 ♘xa7 ♖fb8 17 a4

White is a pawn up for nothing.

381) Nakamura – Vachier Lagrave

Cap d'Agde (rapid) 2008

24 ♖c8! f5?

24...f6 is more tenacious but after 25 ♗b4+ d6 26 ♖c7+ ♗d7 27 ♗xd7 ♘xd7 28 ♔f2, although Black has avoided loss of material, White's two passed pawns on the a- and b-files will be decisive.

If 24...♘f6 then 25 f4! ♘eg4 26 ♗b4+ d6 27 ♖c7+ ♗d7 28 ♗xd7 ♘xd7 29 0-0 (or 29 ♔d2), intending 30 ♖e1+, and 29...♔d8 is met by 30 ♗a5!.

25 ♗b4+ d6 26 ♖xf8

26 ♖e8+! ♔f7 27 ♖xf8+.

26...♔xf8 27 ♗xd6+ ♔f7 28 ♗xe5

and with two extra passed pawns, the rest was easy.

382) Godena – Akopian

Dresden Olympiad 2008

31...♗xg3+! 32 ♔g2

Not 32 ♔xg3? ♖xe3+!.

32...♕xc4 33 ♘xc4 ♗h4 34 ♖d6 ♖e4 35 ♘e3 ♖a4

and with an extra pawn, Black won.

383) Svetushkin – S. Kristjansson

Dresden Olympiad 2008

39 ♘d4!

A beautiful move.

39...♖xd4

39...♕e5 loses to 40 ♘c6+ ♔c7 41 ♕xe5+! ♗xe5 42 ♘xe5.

40 ♖xf6

Threatening deadly discovered checks.

40...♖d1+ 41 ♔h2 1-0

After 41...♕e7 42 ♕g8+ White wins with a deadly pin: 42...♔c7 43 ♖f7 or 42...♕e8 43 ♖f8.

384) Kveinys – Nisipeanu

Dresden Olympiad 2008

33...♕d1+! 34 ♕e1

Or 34 ♔g2 ♕d5+ and 35...♕xf7.

34...♕d3+ 35 ♕e2 ♕d5! 0-1

Attacking the rook as well as threatening mate on h1.

385) Topalov – Zhigalko

Dresden Olympiad 2008

39 ♖xd5!

A beautiful way to unblock the position.

39...exd5 40 e6 1-0

If 40...♖f8 then 41 ♗xc6+ ♕xc6 42 ♕e7+ wins. 40...♖f6 is no better; e.g., 41 ♗xc6+ ♕xc6 42 ♕e7+ ♔c8 43 ♗xf6 gxf6 44 ♕f8+ ♔b7 45 ♕f7+ ♔b8 46 e7.

386) Shulman – Baramidze

Dresden Olympiad 2008

32 ♖c2! 1-0

Exploiting the weakness of Black's back rank, White launches an attack which will either mate or gain a decisive material advantage. 32...♕b4 is met by 33 ♖c8+ ♖f8 34 ♖xf6, mating quickly; e.g., 34...♗xf6 35 ♕xf6 ♖xc8 36 ♗g6! ♖xe5 37 ♕f7+ ♔h8 38 ♕h7#.

387) Aleksandrov – J. Polgar

Dresden Olympiad 2008

30...♕g4!

Better than 30...♕xe4; in order to defend the e2-rook White has to clear the d-file, which proves fatal.

31 ♗e1 ♘f4! 32 exf4 ♖xd1 0-1

388) Zhao Xue – Hagarova

Dresden Women's Olympiad 2008

53 ♖b1?

The right way to try to penetrate with the rook was via the e-file with **53 ♕h4+!** ♔g7 54 ♖e1 when, in order to put a stop to the mating attack, Black has to exchange queens. After 54...♕f2 55 ♕xf2 ♗xf2 56 ♖a1 ♔f6 57 ♖xa3 the white king is a long way from the queenside, but since Black is unable to take advantage of this, the

white king has time to become centralized, after which the material advantage decides the game; e.g., 57...♔e6 58 g3 (58 ♖a2 ♗d4 59 ♔g3 and 58 g4 are the alternatives) 58...c4 59 ♔g2 ♗c5 60 ♖a6+ ♔d5 61 ♔f3 ♔d4 62 ♔e2 ♗b4 63 ♖b6 ♗a3 64 ♔d2.

53...♕e4 54 ♖f1

54 ♕h4+ ♔g7 55 ♖e1 is now answered with 55...♗e3!.

54...a2

This leads to a forced repetition of moves.

55 ♕f8+ ♗g7 56 ♕d8 ♗d4 57 ♕f8+ ♗g7 58 ♕d8 ½-½

389) Spraggett – Komljenović
Seville 2007

18 ♘b1!

Now the black queen can no longer defend d6.

18...♘c4 19 ♕f2!

And now White's queen makes a decisive invasion of the black camp, exploiting the awkward placing of Black's forces.

19...♕b2 20 ♕a7! ♖c7 21 ♕b8 1-0

390) Tahirov – J. Houska
Hastings 2007/8

32 ♖xc5! bxc5 33 ♗d3 cxd4

If 33...♕e8 the two bishops show their power with 34 ♘xg7! ♕d7 (or 34...♔xg7 35 ♘f5+ ♔h7 36 ♗xf6 with a mating attack) 35 ♘df5.

34 ♗xe4 dxe4 35 ♗xd4 1-0

391) Medina Carrasco – M. Röder
Seville 2008

36 ♖xg7+ ♔f8

Not 36...♔h8? on account of 37 ♖xe1 ♕xe1 38 ♖g8+, winning.

37 ♖g8+ ♔f7 38 ♖d7+!

Of course, the best that White can hope for now is a draw, and this he duly achieves.

38...♖8e7 39 ♖g7+! ♔f6 40 ♖dxe7 ♖xg1+ 41 ♔xg1 ♕h5 42 ♔g2 ♕c5 43 ♖gf7+ ♔g6 44 ♖g7+ ♔f6 45 ♖gf7+ ½-½

392) Naumkin – Codenotti
Conegliano 2008

29 c5!

With this unpinning move, White gains a decisive advantage. In contrast, 29 ♕xg4 ♖xf2 30 ♖xf2 ♕e3 does not work.

29...♖xf2

29...dxc5? loses to 30 ♖xf5.

30 cxb6! ♖xe2 31 ♖xf8+ ♗xf8 32 bxc7 ♖xe4 33 c8♕ 1-0

393) Short – Timman
Staunton Memorial, London 2008

White played **19 ♕b3?** and after **19...♕xb3 20 axb3 ♔c8 21 ♖xa7** was somewhat better, although he didn't win.

With **19 ♘d6!!** cxd6 (or 19...♕xd6 20 ♘f7+) 20 ♘xc6+ White can secure a decisive advantage.

394) A. Horvath – Erdos
Harkany 2008

27...♖f5!

Threatening to win with 28...♖h5.

28 ♕h3?!

28 ♔f1 was better, although after 28...♖h5 29 ♕g1 ♕b5+ 30 ♔e1 a3! 31 bxa3 ♕c4 32 ♗g3 ♕xc3 White is lost, since his king is exposed in the centre and his pieces are poorly coordinated. Black's centre pawns will decide the game.

28...♕f7 0-1

395) Najdorf – Luckis
Argentine Ch, Buenos Aires 1949

18 ♘f5!

Black is forced to capture this piece to prevent 19 ♘h6#.

18...gxf5

18...♗f6? fails to 19 ♗xf6 ♘xf6 20 ♘e7+.

19 ♕h5!

Taking advantage of this newly available square.

19...♘g7

Defending against 20 ♗xf5; it loses, but there was nothing better. 19...♕c6 fails to 20 ♕xf5 ♕h6 21 ♕d7, regaining the piece with a decisive advantage.

20 ♗xg7 ♔xg7 21 ♗xf5 ♕d8 22 ♕xh7+ ♔f6 23 ♕h6+!

It is forced mate.

23...♔xf5

If 23...♔e5, then amongst other things White has 24 ♘d4 ♗g5 25 f4+ ♗xf4 26 exf4#.

24 ♘d4+ ♔e4 25 ♕f4# (1-0)

396) Visser – Bosboom Lanchava
Staunton Memorial, London 2006

18...♖d8!!

Setting up a winning discovered attack. The order of moves definitely matters in this case:

18...♗xh3? 19 ♗xh3 ♖ad8 20 ♗d7 is still better for Black, but not so decisive.

19 ♕xd8

If 19 ♕c7 then 19...♖d2 20 ♖g1 ♗d4, mating quickly.

19...♗xh3 20 ♗xh3 ♖xd8

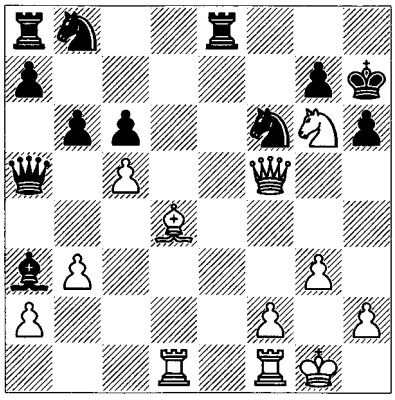
and Black won.

397) Van Wely – Yakovenko

Foros 2007

25 c5! *(D)*

B



Cutting off the black queen (and the bishop) from the defence.

25...♔g8 26 ♘e7+!

Another way is 26 ♗xf6 gxf6 27 ♘e7+! ♔f7 (or 27...♖xe7 28 ♕g6+ ♖g7 29 ♖d8#) 28 ♕h7+ ♔e6 29 ♖d6+ ♔e5 30 f4#.

26...♖xe7

Or 26...♔f7 27 ♗xf6 ♖xe7 28 ♗c3+.

27 ♗xf6 ♖d7

27...♕xc5 is met by 28 ♖d8+! ♔f7 29 ♗e5#.

28 ♕g6! 1-0

398) Shirov – Yakovenko

FIDE World Cup, Khanty-Mansiisk 2007

White has an extra piece, but problems with the coordination of his forces.

29 ♖ed1!

The correct choice of rook is important here: not 29 ♖ad1?! ♖de8 30 ♕xh3 ♖xe1+ 31 ♖xe1 ♕xd2.

29...♕xb2 30 ♕xh3 ♕xd4+

If 30...♖xd4 then 31 ♘f1 is possible.

31 ♔h1 ♖d5 32 ♕f1 ♖fd8 33 ♖ac1 ♕d3 34 ♕e1!

With this series of precise moves, White succeeds in unpinning and is able to exploit his extra piece.

34...h6 35 ♔g2! ♕a3 36 ♘b1

and White won.

399) Brkić – Stefanova

Solin 2007

26...♘xe4! 27 ♖f1

27 ♕xe4 is met by 27...♖xc3! 28 ♕xe6 fxe6, attacking the f5-rook and thus retaining the extra pawn.

27...d5 28 ♖xf7 ♗d6! 29 ♗h4

Or 29 ♗c1 ♘g3+.

29...♘d2

and Black won.

400) Movsziszian – León Hoyos

Salou 2008

21 ♖xd5! ♗xf4

After 21...exd5 22 ♗xd5+ ♗e6 23 ♕xe5 ♗xd5 24 ♕xd5+ White wins back the exchange and remains two pawns up; for example, 24...♔g7 25 ♖xe8 ♖xe8 26 ♕d7+ ♔f8? 27 ♗h6+.

22 ♖xd7 ♗h6 23 h5

With an extra pawn and an attack.

23...♗g7 24 hxg6 hxg6 25 ♗h3 ♖f7 26 ♗xe6 1-0

401) Ivanchuk – Anand

León (rapid) 2008

Here a previous game had gone 15 ♘xd5?! and after 15...♕xe2 16 ♘xf6+ gxf6 17 ♗xe2 White stood only a little better.

15 ♖d4!

Loose pieces require care. With this move White is exploiting the fact that the b4-bishop is unprotected, which, combined with the threat against the a8-rook, decides the game.

15...♕g6

15...♕xe2 16 ♗xe2 costs Black material.

16 ♘h4! 1-0

After 16...♕h5 17 ♕xh5 ♘xh5 18 ♗xd5 White wins a piece.

402) Truskavetsky – Shvyriov

Alushta 2008

White played **29 ♕e7?** and the game ended in a draw.

He missed a winning shot with **29 ♗d5+!** and if 29...cxd5 then 30 ♕xd4 (threatening 31 ♗c3) 30...♕g7 (30...♕xc4 is met by 31 ♕f6!) 31 ♖e5! (preparing 32 ♗c3 and 33 ♖e8+) 31...h5 32 ♗c3 ♕f8 (32...♖f8? fails to 33 ♖xf5! ♕xd4 34 ♖xf8+) 33 cxd5, with a decisive advantage, as

White threatens to mate by 34 ♖e8 ♖xe8 35 ♕h8+ ♔f7 36 ♕h7+.

403) Volokitin – Kariakin
Foros 2008

30 e5+!!

In contrast, 30 ♗xb3? cxb3 31 e5+ ♔d7! was nothing for Black to fear.

30...♔d7

Forced; if 30...♔xe5? then 31 ♗xb3 cxb3 32 ♘d3+, while 30...♔c7? loses to 31 ♗xb3.

31 ♗f3!

With a double threat.

31...♖xb2 32 ♗xb7 1-0

404) Lalić – Trent
British Ch, Liverpool 2008

21 ♕xc7!

Winning a pawn for nothing. At first sight it looks as if it loses the exchange, but White has seen a move further.

21...♖bc8?!

It was better to accept the loss of a pawn with 21...♘xe4 22 ♕xd7.

22 ♕xd7 ♖xc1 23 ♖xc1 ♕xc1+ 24 ♔h2

Winning the knight.

24...♕xb2 25 ♘xd6 ♖f8 26 ♘xb7 ♕f6 27 ♕c6 1-0

405) Akshayraj – Le Quang Liem
World Junior Ch, Gaziantep 2008

White found nothing better than perpetual check with **35 ♖f7+ ♔e5 36 ♖e7+ ½-½**.

Instead, **35 b4!**, breaking the coordination between the black rooks, even at the price of granting Black a pawn on the sixth rank, is very advantageous: 35...axb3 (35...♖c8? loses to 36 g7 ♖g8 37 ♖f7+ ♔e5 38 ♖f8) 36 ♖xe3 ♖c8 37 g7 ♖g8 38 ♖e7, with a big advantage.

406) M. Rodshtein – Lin Chen
World Junior Ch, Gaziantep 2008

24 e5!

This thematic break is stronger than usual because ...h5 has weakened Black's king's position.

24...dxe5 25 f5 ♘f6

If 25...♘e8 then 26 fxg6+ fxg6 27 ♘e4 ♗f6 28 ♖g1! ♔h8 29 ♘xf6 ♖xf6 30 ♘h4 ♘f8 31 ♖xe5 and White's domination of the position is crushing.

26 fxg6+ fxg6 27 ♘h4 e4 28 ♕g3 ♘ce8 29 ♕xg6+ ♔h8 30 ♘xe4 1-0

407) L'Ami – I. Sokolov
Staunton Memorial, London 2008

White played **26 ♕xa3?!** but after **26...♕xe4 27 ♖6d4?! ♕e5** he had achieved very little.

Instead White gains a decisive material advantage with **26 ♘f6+!** ♔e7 (26...♔f8 is met by the simple 27 ♕xa3) 27 ♘h5 and now 27...♘c4? fails to 28 ♕b7+ mating, while after 27...b4 28 ♕b7+ ♔e8 29 ♕d7+ ♔f8 30 ♕d8+ White forces mate.

408) Dreev – Galić
European Clubs Cup, Kallithea 2008

29 ♖xe6! ♔xe6 30 ♖e2+ ♔f7 31 ♖e7+ ♔g8

31...♔f8 is met by 32 ♘h4.

32 ♕e3

Even a rook down and with the g2-knight out of play for the moment, White is winning, because Black is almost completely paralysed.

32...♖h7 33 ♕e6+! ♔h8 34 ♘h4!

Now White's numerical superiority on the kingside is just too great.

34...♖g8 35 ♘xg6+ ♖xg6 36 ♖e8+ 1-0

409) B. Socko – Naiditsch
Dresden Olympiad 2008

Black didn't succeed in converting his advantage into anything tangible after **32...♗d4? 33 ♖xd2 ♗e5+ 34 ♔h4 exd2 35 ♖f1 g3 36 ♔g5! f4 37 ♔f5! f6 38 ♔e6**, when the white king was able to assist the defence and the game was drawn. Instead, **32...f4+!**, creating a tactical weakness based on a possible fork on d3, wins; e.g., 33 ♔xf4 (33 ♔h2 g3+ 34 ♔g1 ♘d3!) 33...♖xe2! 34 ♖xe2 ♘d3+ 35 ♔xg4 ♘xc1 36 ♖e1 ♘xa2.

410) Cmilyte – J. Houska
Dresden Women's Olympiad 2008

51...♖e3!

51...♖e4 is also good.

52 ♔d6

After 52 gxf4 Black wins with 52...♖d3+ 53 ♔c6 ♖c3+ 54 ♔d5 gxf4 55 ♔d4 ♖c1 as she emerges the exchange and a (passed) pawn up. The rook move has the idea of replying to 52 c8♕ with 52...♖d3+ 53 ♔c6 ♖c3+ 54 ♔d7 ♖xc8 55 ♔xc8 f3 56 ♗b6 a4 and a black pawn queens; 52 c8♘ f3 53 ♘d6+ ♔g6 is no good either.

52...♖c3 53 ♗xg5 f3 54 ♗e3 ♖d3+ 0-1

411) Landa – León Hoyos
Reggio Emilia 2008/9

30...♗c4! 31 ♕e3

31 ♖7xc4? loses to 31...♗e1+!.

31...♕xc7 32 axb4 ♕b8

with an extra exchange.

412) M.Rodshtein – T.L. Petrosian
Dresden Olympiad 2008

23 ♘xe4!

The priority is to open lines against the black king.

23...♕xd4+ 24 ♔h2 f6

If 24...dxe4 then 25 f6! wins; e.g., 25...♔h7 (or 25...♕xa1 26 ♖xg5+! ♔h8 27 ♖g8+ ♔xg8 28 ♕g4+ and mate next move) 26 hxg5 ♖g8 (26...♕xa1 27 g6+ ♔g8 28 ♕xh6 forcing mate) 27 ♗c4 ♕xa1 28 ♗xf7, threatening 29 g6+, is similar to what we have already seen.

24...♕xa1 also runs into mate: 25 ♖xg5+ ♔h7 26 f6 ♖g8 27 ♘c3+ ♖g6 28 ♖xg6 fxg6 29 ♕c7+.

25 hxg5 hxg5

25..fxg5 loses to 26 ♕d6! ♖f7 27 ♕xh6 ♕h8 28 ♖xg5+ ♖g7 29 ♖xg7+ ♕xg7 30 ♕e6+ ♔f8 31 ♘d6 ♕h8+ 32 ♔g3 ♕g7+ 33 ♔f3.

26 ♘xf6+ ♕xf6 27 ♖xg5+ ♔f7 28 ♕c7+ 1-0

413) Rossetto – Euwe
Buenos Aires 1947

25...♖g1+?!

It is tempting to win the queen, but in fact this dissipates a great deal of Black's advantage. It is much better to play **25...♕h3!**, threatening a quick mate with 26..♖xh2+ and 27...♕xc3+. Then:

a) Not 26 ♔e1? ♖g1+ 27 ♔d2 ♕xc3#.

b) 26 ♖xa5 ♖xh2+ 27 ♔e1 ♖h1+ 28 ♔d2 ♖xb1 leaves Black the exchange up and threatening 29...♖b2+. Now if 29 ♕e3 ♕f1 30 ♕f3 the simplest is 30...cxd6 31 exd6 ♖e8 with a decisive material advantage.

c) 26 ♗b4 ♖d8 and the white king can't escape.

26 ♔xg1 ♕xe2 27 ♖xa5 ♕g4+ 28 ♔f1 ♕c4+ 29 ♔g1 ♕g4+ 30 ♔f1 ♕e4! 31 ♖b4 ♕h1+ 32 ♔e2 cxd6??

The lack of an escape-square will lead to disaster. Black can retain the advantage with 32...h6! 33 ♖c5 ♖xb7 34 ♖xb7 ♕xb7 35 ♖xc7 ♕e4+ 36 ♔f1 f6.

33 ♖a8! 1-0

Black overlooked that 33...♖xa8 is met by 34 b8♕+ ♖xb8 35 ♖xb8#.

414) Franco – Sánchez Aller
Mondariz 2003

The game went **30...♕d6** and after **31 ♕e6!** White gained a winning passed pawn: **31...♕xe6 32 dxe6 ♘df6 33 ♖d7+! ♘xd7 34 exd7**.

In contrast, after **30...♖f8!!** the pressure on f2 allows Black to defend; e.g., 31 ♕xd7+ ♖f7 32 ♕xf7+ ♔xf7 33 d6 ♘f6 34 d7 ♘xd7 35 ♖xd7+ ♔g8 and the struggle goes on.

415) Haba – P. Nikolić
Bundesliga 2004/5

28 ♕xf6!!

A brilliant way to recover the sacrificed piece. 28 ♕e8+?! ♘xe8 29 ♖xe8+ is unclear: 29...♗f8 30 ♘h6+ ♔g7 31 ♘xf5+ gxf5 32 ♗e3 f6.

28...♘b7

28...♗xf6? allows mate by 29 ♖e8+ ♔g7 30 ♗h6#, while 28...♕xf6 is punished with 29 ♖e8+ ♗f8 30 ♘xf6+ ♔g7 31 ♘g4.

29 ♕e7

White is three pawns up with an attack, so the rest is easy.

29...h5 30 ♘h6+ ♗xh6 31 ♗xh6 ♖d8 32 ♖e5! 1-0

Forcing the black queen to give up control of f6; now if 32...♕c2 then 33 ♕f6 wins.

416) Kotronias – S. Grigoriants
European Ch, Budva 2009

The position is chaotic, with several white pieces attacked.

20 ♕b3!!

A brilliant proof that the most important factor here is the bad position of the black king. After this knockout blow, the result is never really in any doubt.

20...♗d6

The queen is immune, since 20...♗xb3? allows mate by 21 ♘c6+ ♔c7 22 d8♕++ ♔xc6 23 ♕d7#.

If 20...♘xg2 White executes one of several threats with 21 ♘e6+! ♗xe6 22 ♕xe6 ♗c5+ 23 ♘xc5 ♕xc5+ 24 ♔xg2, threatening 25 b4, and the black queen will soon be forced to give up control of b6 and e7; after both 24...♕c2+ and 24..♕xg5+ White plays 25 ♔h1 and Black is defenceless. 24...♖f8 is met by 25 ♖xf8+ ♕xf8 26 ♖f1 ♕c5 27 ♕e8+ ♔c7 28 ♕xa8.

The most convincing reply to 20...♗xf7 is 21 ♕xf7, threatening 22 ♘c6+ and 22 ♘e6#.

21 ♕xe3

Here there is more than one way to win; 21 ♖c1 is also sufficient.

21...♕xa4 22 ♘e6+

It is more convincing to bring the a1-rook into play with 22 ♖c1!, but the bad position of Black's king is irreparable in any case.

22...♗xe6 23 ♕b6+ ♗c7 24 ♕xe6 ♕d4+ 25 ♔h1 ♕e5 26 ♕h3

Black has avoided a snap checkmate, but has no way to improve his position substantially.

26...♖b8

26...♕xg5 offers White a wide choice of winning continuations, such as 27 ♗xe4 ♖b8 28 ♖af1, with an extra pawn and the attack.

27 ♖af1 ♗d6 28 g6 1-0

28 ♖c1 is more direct, but this move does not affect the outcome.

417) Kamsky – Ponomariov

Sofia 2006

36 e6!!

The queen transfers to the kingside with gain of tempo, and the defending forces find themselves badly outnumbered.

36...♕b1+ 37 ♔h2 fxe6 38 ♕h5!

Threatening both 39 ♕xe8+ and 39 ♕f7+.

38...♘d6

38...♖f8 loses to 39 ♕g4.

39 ♗xd4 ♗xf3 40 ♖xg7+ ♔f8 41 ♕h6 1-0

418) Movsesian – Short

Sarajevo 2007

27 ♕a1!

A move in the style of Réti, whose purpose here is to induce an important weakness in Black's kingside.

27...f6?!

Black is understandably reluctant to weaken the long diagonal with 27...g6, since after 28 ♗g4 Black has to open up his king's position even more with 28...f5 (28...♖6e7 loses a pawn after 29 ♗h8! f6 30 ♗xf6) 29 exf5 ♖xe2+ 30 ♗xe2 gxf5 31 ♗f3 (even better than 31 ♗h8 ♖e7 32 ♗f3, with advantage) 31...♖xe1 32 ♕xe1 ♘f6 33 ♕c3 with stifling pressure.

If 27...♘f6 then 28 f5! (28 ♔g2 is also interesting) and the best that Black can do is sacrifice the exchange by 28...♘e5 29 ♘xe5 ♖xe5 30 ♗xe5, with advantage to White.

28 e5!

There is no satisfactory defence against the threat of 29 ♗d5, winning material.

28...dxe5

Worse is 28...♔h8 29 exd6 ♖xe2+ 30 ♗xe2.

29 ♗d5 ♔h8 30 ♗xe6 ♖xe6

and White won.

419) Sachdev – B. Savchenko

Elsinore 2008

32...♘xd4!

After the disappearance of the pawns, the white king will be exposed to a very strong attack, which will prevent him from exploiting the passed h6-pawn.

33 cxd4?!

More complicated and more tenacious is 33 h7 ♘xe2 34 h8♕+ ♔a7 35 ♗xe2, although Black's attack is very strong after 35...e3! 36 ♖xe3 ♕a3!, threatening 37...♕c1+; e.g., 37 ♖ef3 ♕c1+ 38 ♔f2 ♖xf3+ 39 ♗xf3 ♕d2+ 40 ♗e2 ♖e4 41 ♕h5 ♕e3+ 42 ♔e1 ♖xa4, and Black wins.

33...♕b4+ 34 ♕d2

34 ♔d1 is answered with 34...♕b1+ 35 ♔d2 ♕b2+ 36 ♔d1 ♖xf1+ 37 ♕xf1 ♖g2, forcing 38 ♕xg2, when Black wins by 38...♕xg2 39 ♗e6 e3 40 ♖xe3 ♕h1+ and 41...♕xh6.

34...♕xc4 35 ♖fh1

Or 35 ♖xf4 ♖g1+ 36 ♔f2 ♕f1+ 37 ♔e3 ♕xh3+ 38 ♔xe4 ♖e1+ 39 ♕xe1 ♕e6+ 40 ♔f3 ♕xe1 41 ♔g4 ♕e7.

35...e3 36 ♖xe3 ♖xd4 37 ♕c3 ♕d5 0-1

420) Antunes – Flear

Pau 1988

24 ♕a8+! ♔f7 25 fxe6+

Not 25 ♘g5+? ♔e7 26 f6+ gxf6 27 exf6+ ♔d7 and Black wins.

25...♔e7

25...♔xe6? walks into mate: 26 ♕e8+ ♔f5 27 ♔xe3 f1♕ 28 ♕f7+ ♔g4 29 ♕f4+ ♔h3 30 ♕g3#.

26 ♔xe3 f1♕ 27 ♕g8! ♖e1+ 28 ♔f4! 1-0

After 28...♕c4+ (or 28...g5+ 29 ♔g3 and there is no adequate defence against 30 ♕f7+, mating) 29 ♔g3 ♕xe6 30 ♕xg7+, White has an extra piece.

5 Tests 1-5

This chapter contains the first set of five tests (there are five more tests in Chapter 8 and a further five in Chapter 10). Each test is of roughly equal difficulty, and contains 16 different puzzle positions. Of these positions, two are of level 1 difficulty, four are of level 2, six are of level 3, two are of level 4 and two are of level 5.

Your task is simply to find the best continuation. The number of points available varies from puzzle to puzzle, depending on the difficulty level. 1 point is the maximum for a level 1 puzzle, 2 points for a level 2 puzzle and so on until 5 points is the maximum for level 5. Therefore each test has a maximum number of 46 points on offer.

The number of points given for each puzzle depends on how much you have discovered. Generally if you are able to spot the first move of the solution then you will receive at least half the number of points available for that puzzle. However, more credit will be given if you have seen the key variations to the very end.

I have tried to minimize the number of alternative solutions and have endeavoured to point them out when they exist.

There is no specific time limit for these tests. You should continue until you are satisfied that any more thought will not be of any benefit. As a rough guide, I would say that each set of 16 puzzles should take between one and two hours. In order to obtain realistic test conditions, you should not, of course, move the pieces or use the help of a computer.

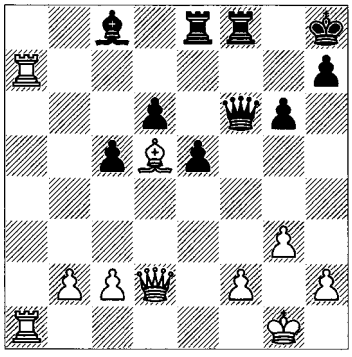
Below there is a points score to Elo rating conversion table. To obtain a fairer reflection of your performance, you may wish to take your average mark over a few tests.

Test Score to Elo Points Conversion Chart

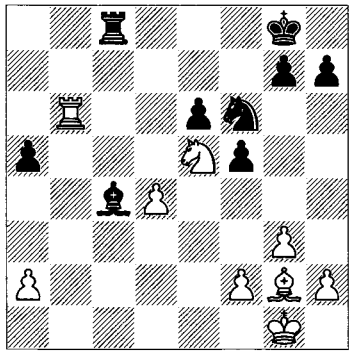
Score	Elo
0-3	1000 or below
4-6	1100
7-9	1200
10-12	1300
13-15	1400
16-18	1500
19-20	1600
21-22	1700
23-24	1800
25-26	1900
27-28	2000
29-31	2100
32-34	2200
35-37	2300
38-40	2400
41-43	2500
44-46	2600 or above

Test 1

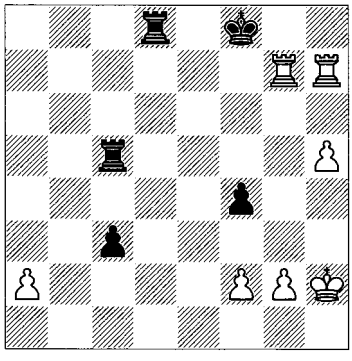
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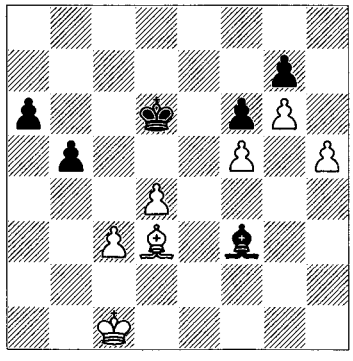
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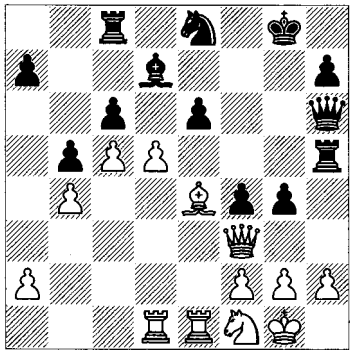
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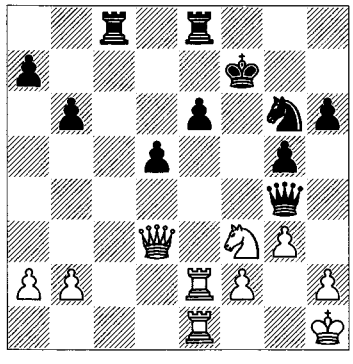
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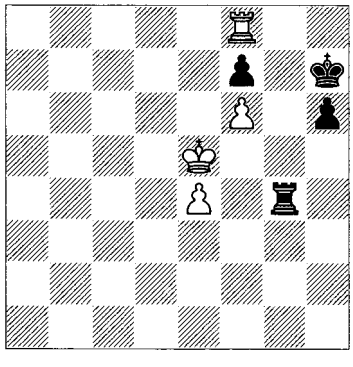
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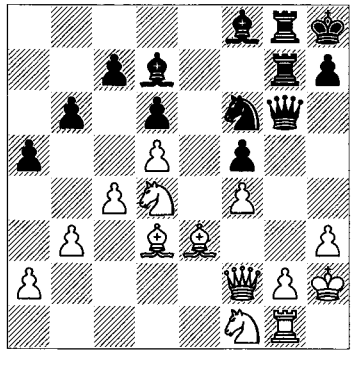
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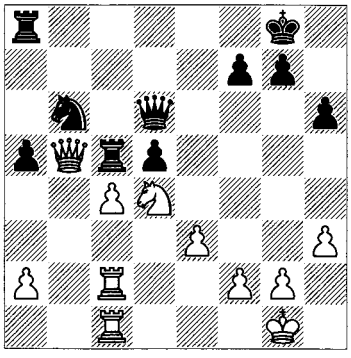
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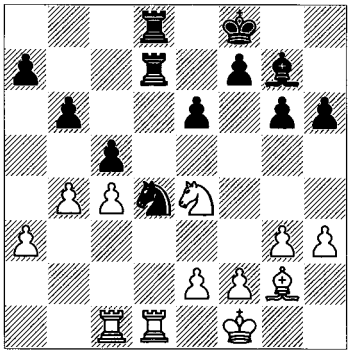
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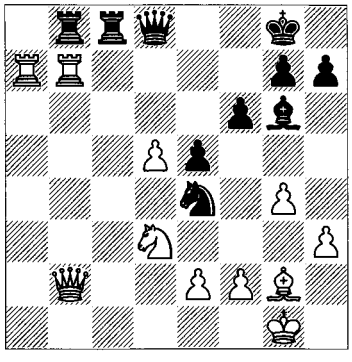
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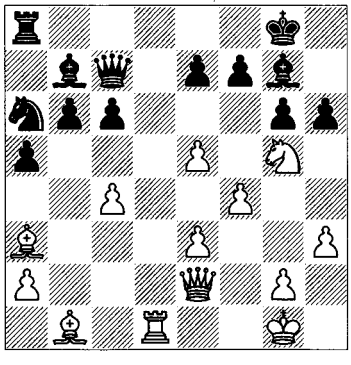
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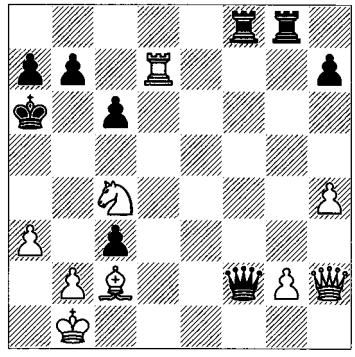
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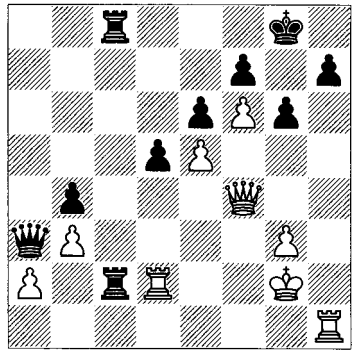
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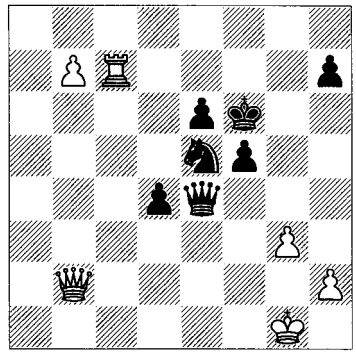
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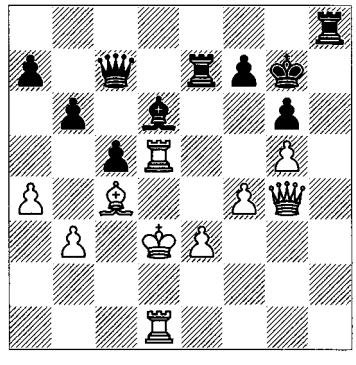
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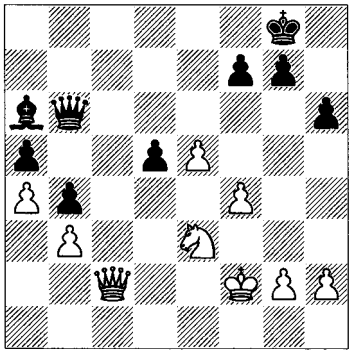


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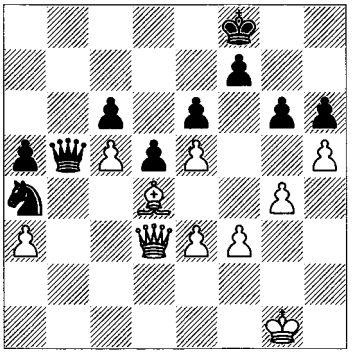


Test 2

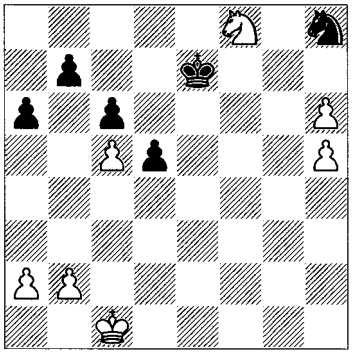
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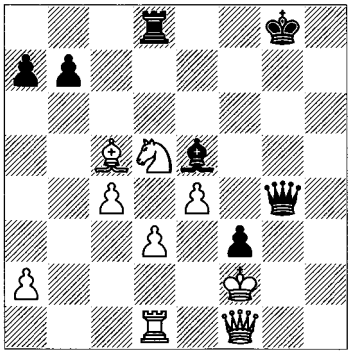
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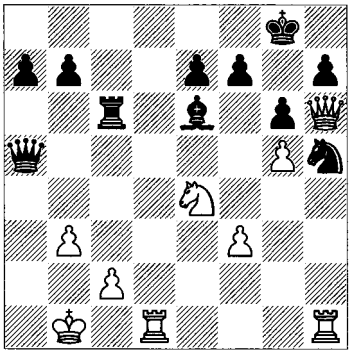
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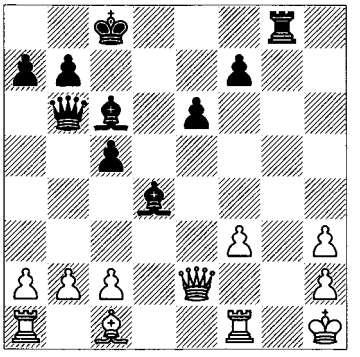
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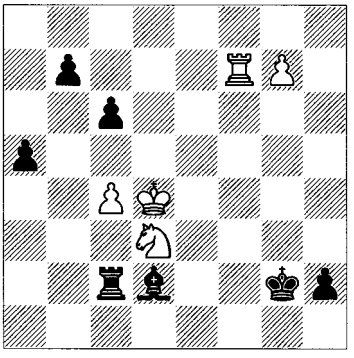
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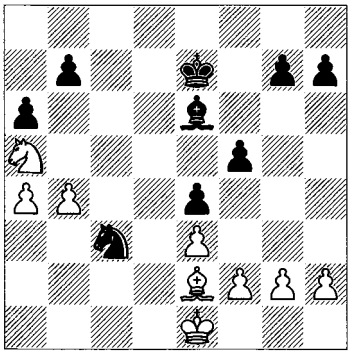
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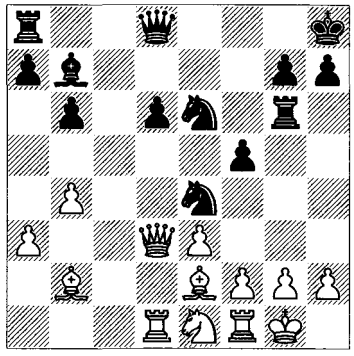
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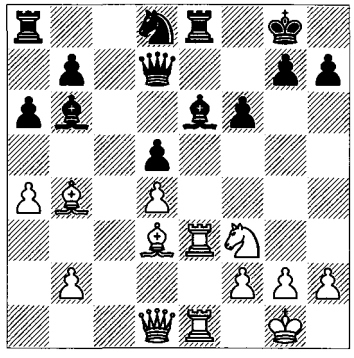
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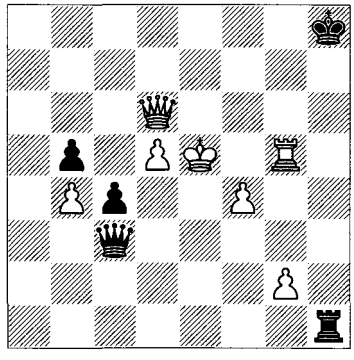
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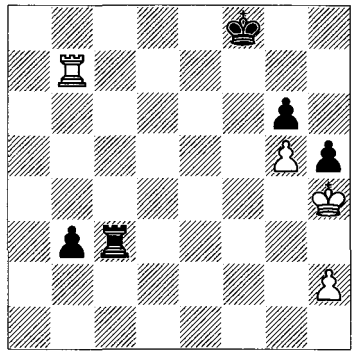
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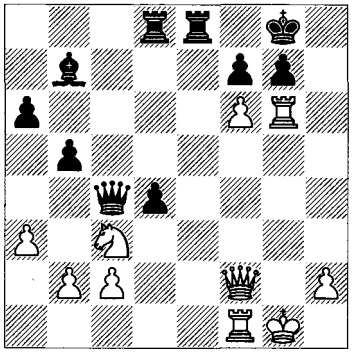
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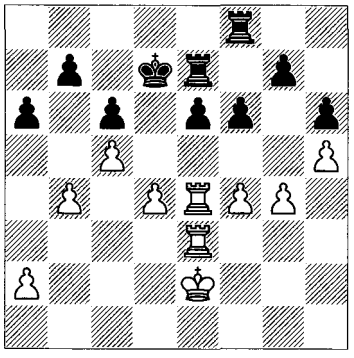
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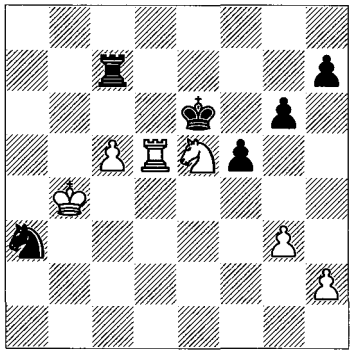
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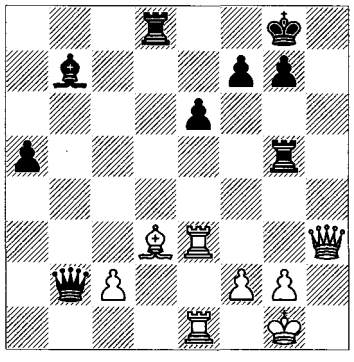
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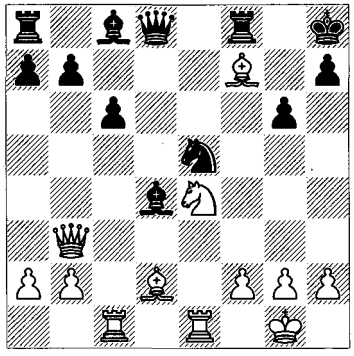


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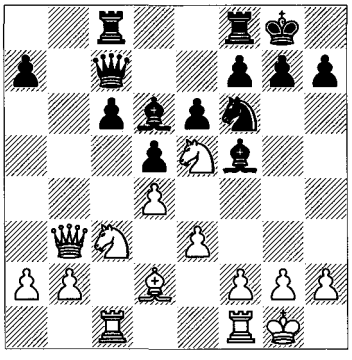


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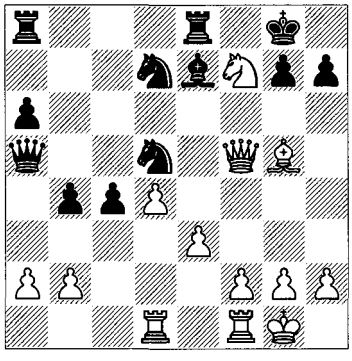
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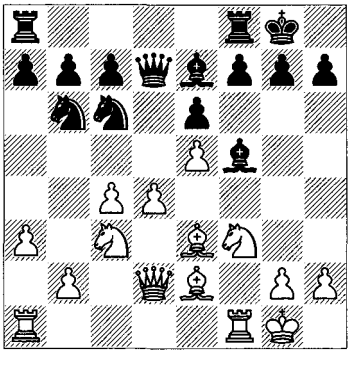
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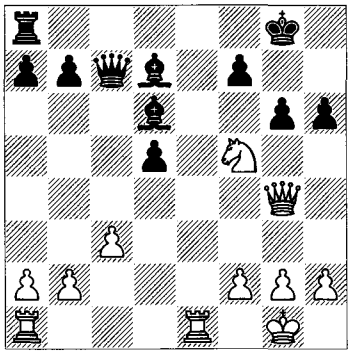
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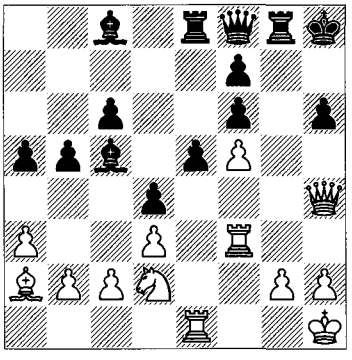
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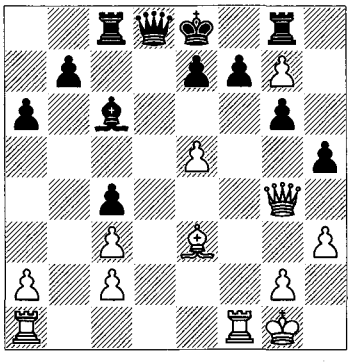
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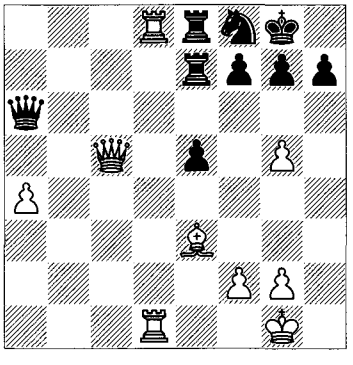
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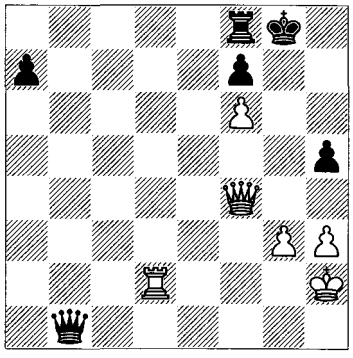
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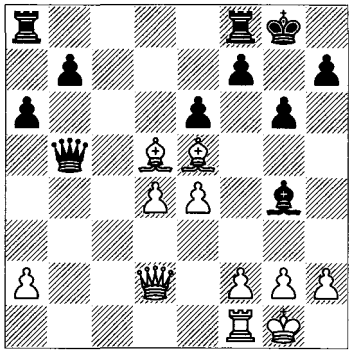
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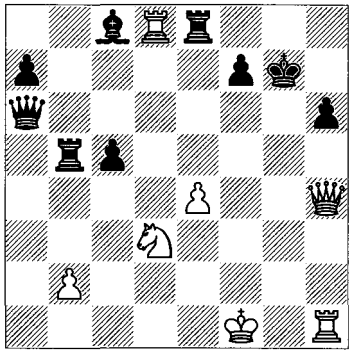
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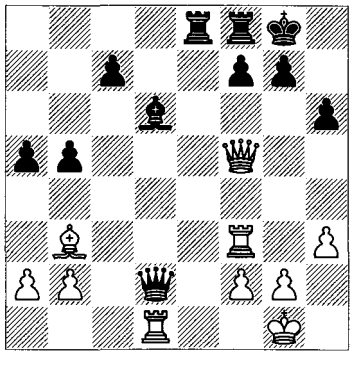
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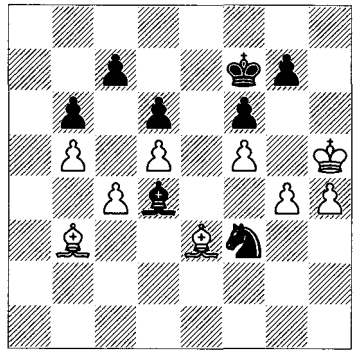
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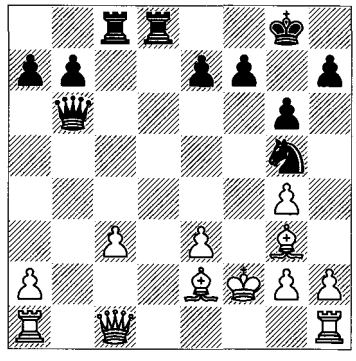
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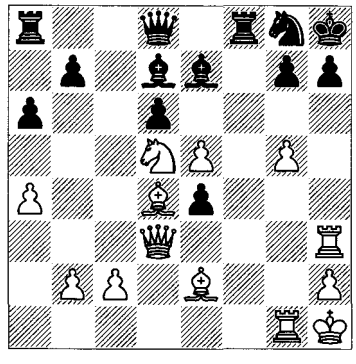
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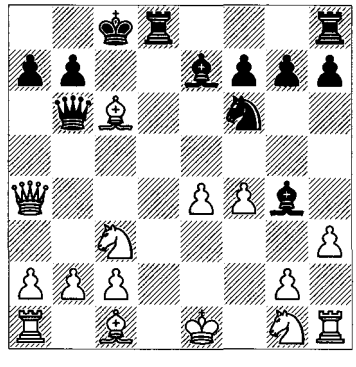
466
B



467
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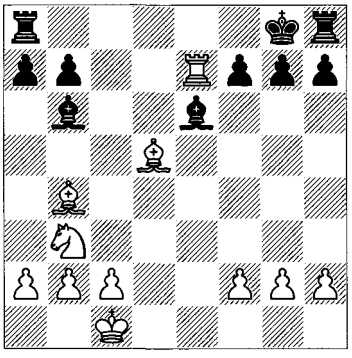


468
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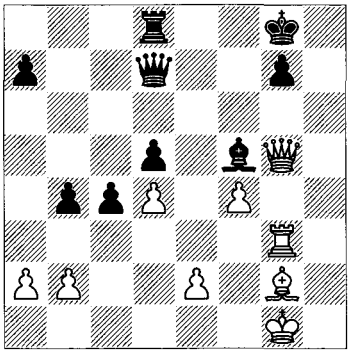


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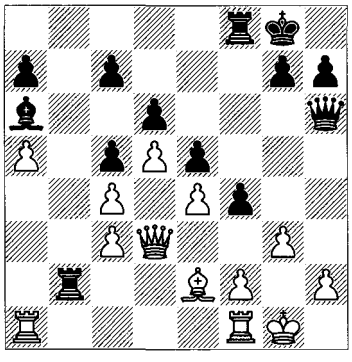
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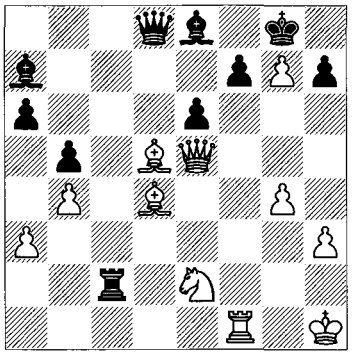
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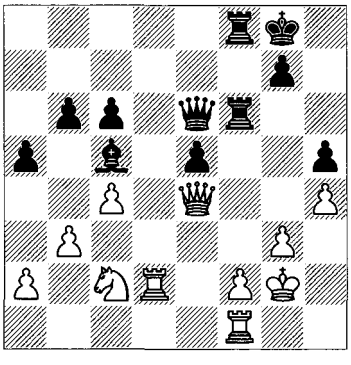
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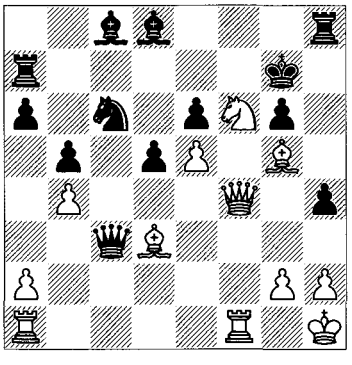
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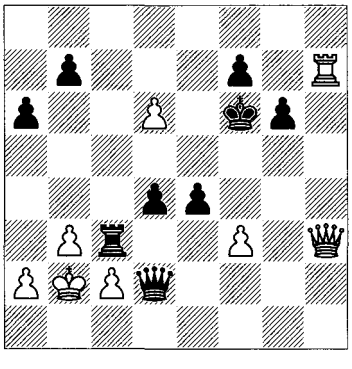
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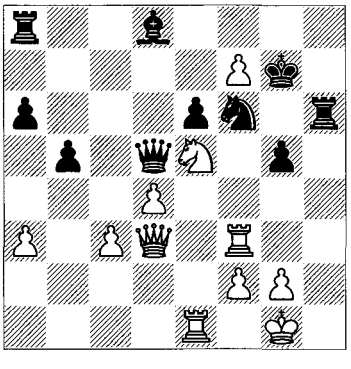
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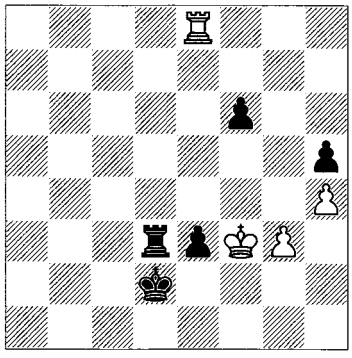
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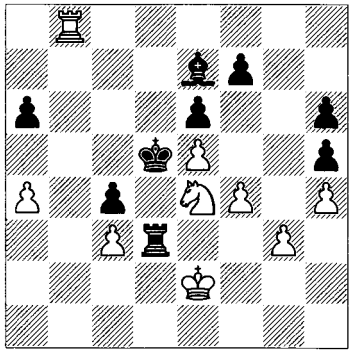
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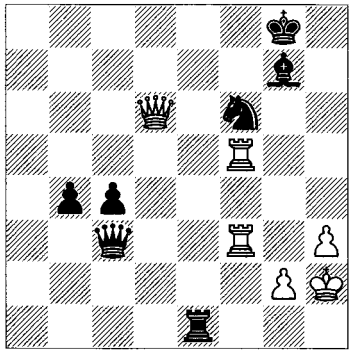
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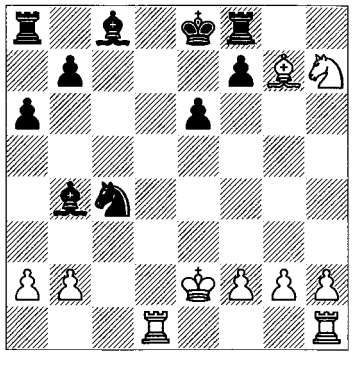
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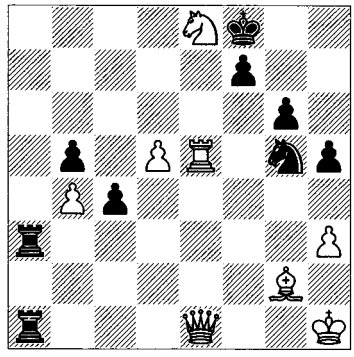
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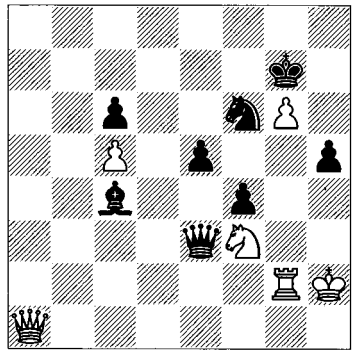
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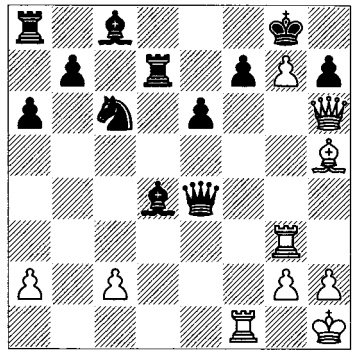
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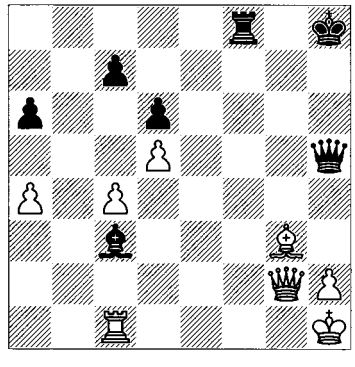
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483
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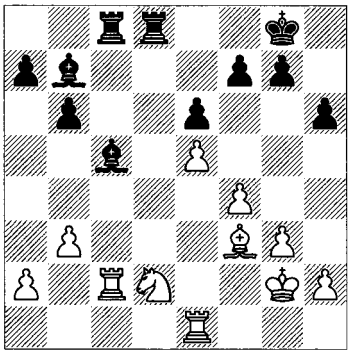


484
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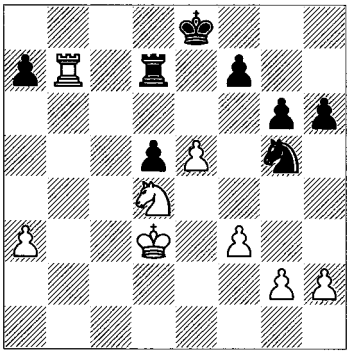


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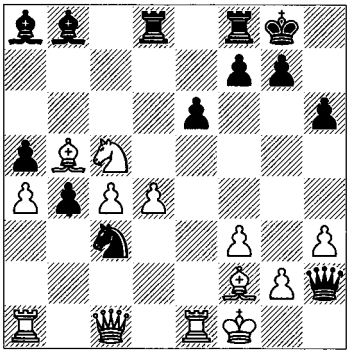
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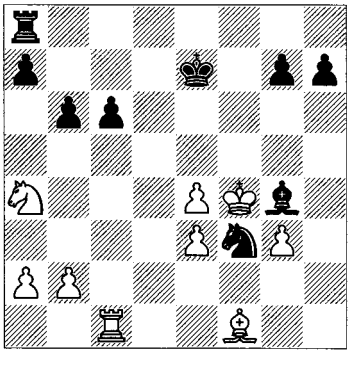
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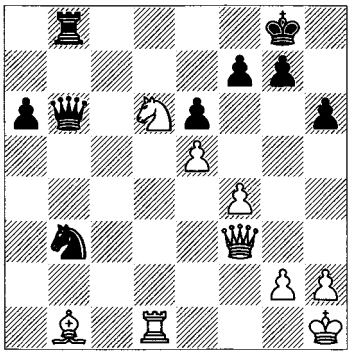
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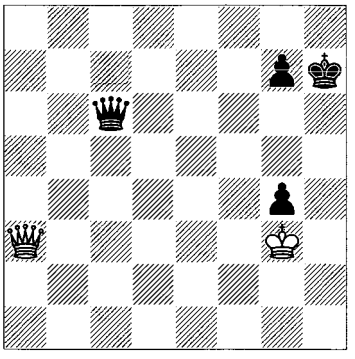
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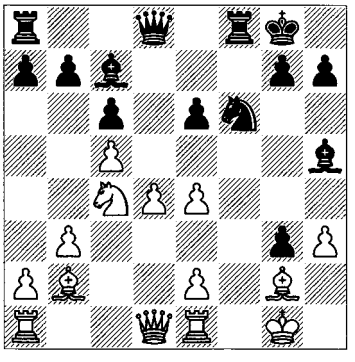
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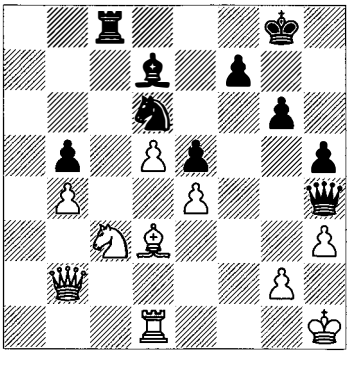
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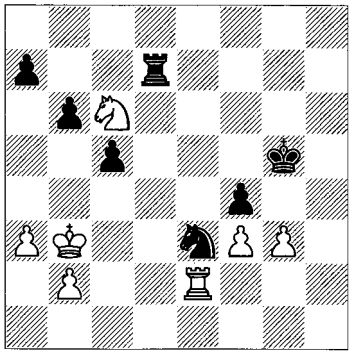
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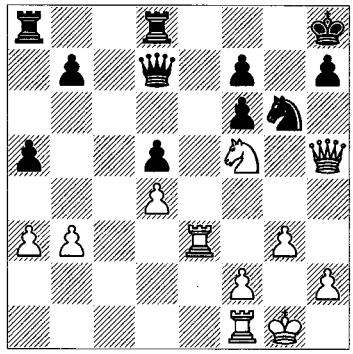
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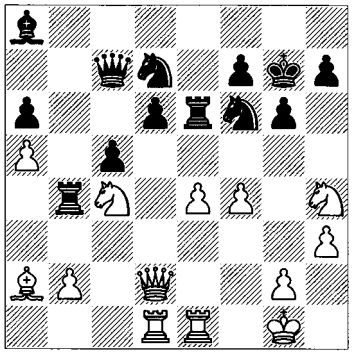
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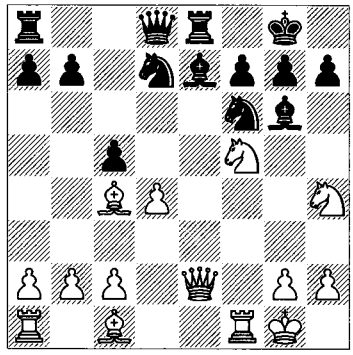
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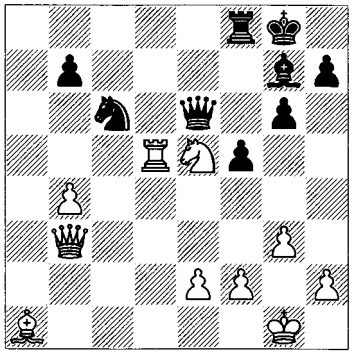
494
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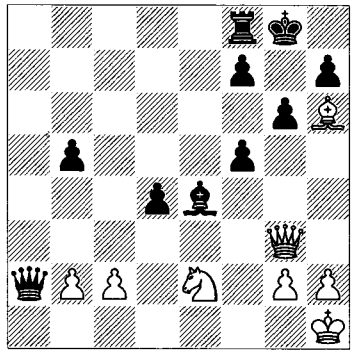
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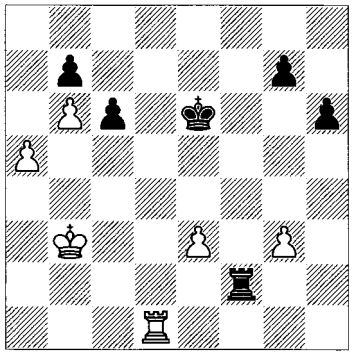
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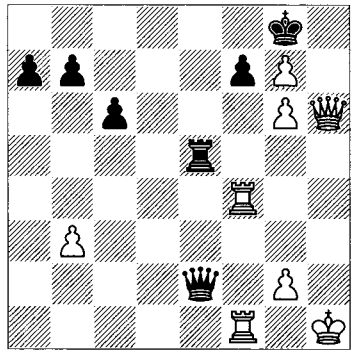
499
W



496
W



500
B



Answers for Chapter 5

Test 1 Answers

421) Ja. Bolbochán – Grau

Argentine Ch match (game 7), Buenos Aires 1936

33 ♕h6! 0-1

Unfortunately for White, just as he was making this winning move, he lost on time. 33...♖e7 is forced, when 34 ♖xe7 ♕xe7 35 ♖a7! wins.

1 point for 33 ♕h6!.

422) Piazzini – O'Donovan

Buenos Aires Olympiad 1939

48 ♖c7!

There are several winning moves, but this is the quickest. A player must never lower his guard; here the nonchalant 48 h6?? would walk into mate in two: 48...♖h5+ 49 ♔g1 ♖d1#.

48...♖xc7 49 ♖xc7 f3

Or 49...♖d5 50 ♖xc3 ♖xh5+ 51 ♖h3 ♖a5 52 ♖f3.

50 g4 ♖d2 51 ♔g3 ♖xa2 52 ♖xc3

and White won.

1 point for 48 ♖c7!.

423) Grau – Gudmundsson

Stockholm Olympiad 1937

35 ♕b3!

Continuing to dominate d5. 35 ♕xg4+? ♖g5 36 ♕f3 exd5 gives no advantage, but it is tempting to play 35 ♗xh7+ ♔f8 (35...♔xh7? 36 ♕e4+ ♖f5 37 dxe6 wins for White) 36 ♕xg4 ♘f6 37 ♕e2, which is also good for White, but not as strong as the move in the game.

35...exd5 36 ♗xd5+ ♔h8

After 36...cxd5 37 ♖xd5 ♔h8 (if 37...♗e6 one way to win is 38 ♖xh5 ♗xb3 39 ♖xh6) 38 ♕c3+ ♕g7 39 ♕xg7+ ♘xg7 40 ♖xd7 White is a pawn up with a winning position.

37 ♗f7

and White won.

2 points for 35 ♕b3!; if you chose 35 ♗xh7+, you receive 1 point.

424) Grau – Palau

Buenos Aires 1939

57...♖g5+!

Not 57...♔g6? 58 ♖g8+ ♔h5 59 ♖xg4 ♔xg4 60 ♔d6 h5 61 e5 h4 62 e6, and White queens first, with a winning endgame.

58 ♔d6 ♔g6?

White can't win after **58...♖a5!**; for example, 59 ♖xf7+ ♔g6 60 ♖f8 ♖a6+ 61 ♔e7 ♖a7+ 62 ♔e6 ♖a6+ 63 ♔e5 ♖a5+ 64 ♔f4 ♖a4!.

59 e5 ♖h5 60 ♖g8+ ♔f5 61 e6 ♔xf6 62 e7

and White won.

1 point for 57...♖g5+! and 1 point extra if you found 58...♖a5!.

425) Maderna – Rebizzo

Argentine Ch, Buenos Aires 1953

27 ♗b7!

Forcing the black rook to leave the back rank.

27...♖c7 28 ♗c6! 1-0

Now there is a double threat of back-rank mate and capturing the c4-bishop, so White wins.

1 point for 27 ♗b7! and 1 point for 28 ♗c6!.

426) Bronstein – Álvarez del Monte

Mar del Plata 1960

44 h6!

First White creates a passed pawn.

44...gxh6 45 c4!

And now he prevents the black bishop from coming back to defend; the threat is 46 g7.

45...♔e7

After 45...bxc4 46 ♗xc4 White can't be prevented from queening.

46 d5 ♔f8 47 d6 ♗c6 48 ♗e4! 1-0

If the bishop retreats, then White continues 49 c5, while after 48...♗xe4 49 d7 ♔e7 50 g7 the pawns can't be stopped.

1 point for 44 h6! and 1 point for 45 c4!.

427) Maderna – Luckis

Mar del Plata 1942

33 ♘e5+!

The queen infiltrates the black camp, and the missing white pawn becomes less important than the weakness of the black king.

33...♘xe5 34 ♕h7+ ♔f6 35 ♖xe5 ♕h5

35...♖h8 36 ♕xa7 ♖c6 (or 36...♖ce8 37 ♕xb6) 37 ♕d7 ♖hc8 38 ♕h7 ♕h5 39 f4 is no good either.

36 ♕xa7

and White won.

With 36 f4! White could have won more quickly; for example, 36...♕f7 (it is important that 36...♖e7? is refuted by 37 ♖f5+! exf5 38 ♕xe7+) 37 fxg5+ hxg5 38 ♖f1+.

3 points for 33 ♘e5+!.

428) L. Cámara – Najdorf

Buenos Aires 1948

29...♘g4+! 30 hxg4 ♕h6+ 31 ♔g3 ♖xg4+ 32 ♔f3 ♕h5!

and White is facing a great loss of material.

2 points for 29...♘g4+!, and 1 point for 32...♕h5!.

429) Maderna – Shocron

Mar del Plata 1953

36 ♘f5!

A strong zwischenzug which wins material. The black queen has to move to a square from which it still defends both the rook and the knight. Instead, if White 'routinely' retreats his queen with 36 ♕b1 or 36 ♕b2, then Black plays 36...dxc4, with equality.

36...♕c7

After 36...♖xb5 37 ♘xd6 ♖c5 38 cxd5 Black is a pawn down without compensation.

37 ♕b2!

The point of his previous move: as well as defending the c2-rook the queen attacks g7.

37...d4 38 ♘xd4

and White won.

2 points for 36 ♘f5! and 1 point for 37 ♕b2!.

430) Lundin – Ju. Bolbochán

Amsterdam Olympiad 1954

28...f5!

The white knight is a tactical weakness which does irreparable harm to White's cause.

29 e3

29 ♘c3 ♘b3 and Black wins material; e.g., 30 ♗c6 (30 ♖xd7 loses to 30...♖xd7 31 ♖b1 ♘d2+) 30...♖xd1+ 31 ♖xd1 ♘d2+.

29...♘b3 30 ♖xd7 ♖xd7 31 ♖b1 ♖d3!

Terminating all resistance.

32 bxc5 bxc5 33 ♔g1 fxe4 34 ♗xe4 ♖c3

and Black wins.

2 points for 28...f5! and 1 point for 31...♖d3!.

431) Panno – Spassky

Gothenburg Interzonal 1955

28 ♘xe5!

The distant white queen finds a way to join in the attack. Reversing the move-order with **28 ♗xe4!** and 29 ♘xe5! also works.

28...fxe5 29 ♗xe4! ♗xe4 30 ♖xg7+ ♔h8 31 ♖xh7+ ♔g8 32 ♖h8+! ♔xh8 33 ♕xe5+ 1-0

2 points for 28 ♘xe5! and 1 point for 29 ♗xe4; making the moves in the reverse order also receives 2 and 1 point(s) respectively.

432) Ju. Bolbochán – Miranda

Rio Hondo Zonal 1966

23 ♘xf7!

The most energetic way to take advantage of White's superior dynamism. The black king is very poorly protected, and this is not the only way through; another possibility, just as strong as the move in the game, is **23 e6!** and then, e.g., 23...hxg5 24 ♖d7 ♕c8 25 exf7+ ♔f8 26 ♗xe7+ ♔xf7 27 ♕d3.

23...♔xf7 24 e6+ ♔g8

Or 24...♔f8 25 ♕d3 ♘c5 26 ♗xc5! bxc5 27 ♕xg6 ♔g8 28 ♕h7+ ♔f8 29 ♗g6 followed by 30 ♗f7, with forced mate.

25 ♖d7 ♕c8 26 ♕d3 ♘c5 27 ♗xc5 bxc5 28 ♖xe7 1-0

3 points for 23 ♘xf7!. Also 3 points if you chose 23 e6!.

433) Spielmann – Mieses

Match (game 8), Regensburg 1910

32 ♕c7!!

Allowing a piece to be captured with check! White threatens to mate with 33 ♕a5# or 33 ♕xb7#.

32...♕f1+ 33 ♔a2 ♕xc4+ 34 b3 ♕b5 35 a4

Forcing the clearance of the f1-a6 diagonal.

35...♕b6 36 ♗d3+ ♔a5 37 ♕e5+ c5

If 37...♔b4 then 38 ♖d4+.

38 ♖xb7!

Deflecting the white queen once again, this time from the defence of c5.

38...♖xg2+

38...♖f2+ is similar.

39 ♔a3 ♖g4

39...c2 is hopeless; amongst other things White has 40 ♖xa7+ forcing mate: 40...♕xa7 41 b4+ ♔b6 42 ♕xc5+ ♔b7 43 ♗e4+ ♔b8 44 ♕xf8+ ♔c7 45 ♕e7+ ♔c8 46 ♗f5+ ♔b8 47 ♕d8+ ♔b7 48 ♗e4+ ♔a6 49 b5#.

40 ♖xb6 1-0

Winning material and soon mating: 40...axb6 41 ♕c7 ♖a8 42 ♕c6 and mate next move.

4 points for 32 ♕c7!!.

434) Grau – Teller

The Hague Olympiad 1928

39...d4?

It was essential to exchange with **39...♖xd2+!**, and after 40 ♕xd2 it is safe to play 40...♕a8!, since 41 ♕h6 can be met by 41...♖c2+ 42 ♔h3 (not 42 ♔g1? ♕a7+) 42...♕f8. If 41 ♔h3 then 41...♖c3, while 41 ♖h4 gives Black time to

counterattack by 41...d4+ 42 ♔h2 d3 43 ♕xd3 ♖c1, with advantage to Black.

40 ♕h6!

There is no way for Black to get his queen to f8.

40...♕a8+

After 40...♖xd2+ 41 ♔h3 Black can't prevent mate.

41 ♔g1 1-0

If 41...♖c1+ then 42 ♔f2! wins.

2 points for 39...♖xd2+! and 2 more points for 40...♕a8! (after 40 ♕xd2).

435) Grau – Bensadón

Argentine Ch, La Plata 1938

49 ♕c1!!

This is the only move that defends against perpetual check and yields a decisive advantage, since it prepares a winning attack. Queening the pawn does not win; after 49 b8♕? Black draws by 49...♕e1+ 50 ♔g2 ♕e4+ 51 ♔f1 ♕h1+ 52 ♔e2 ♕f3+ (or 52...♕g2+) 53 ♔e1 ♕h1+ 54 ♔d2 ♕g2+ 55 ♔d1 ♕f1+ 56 ♔c2 ♕d3+.

49...♘f3+

It was important to calculate the consequences of 49...d3; once again White has only one good continuation, 50 ♕h6+! (forcing the knight to retreat; not 50 b8♕? when White gets mated after 50...♘f3+ 51 ♔h1 ♘h4+) 50...♘g6 51 ♕d2! and if, e.g., 51...♕d4+ (after 51...♘e5 52 b8♕ ♘f3+ 53 ♔f2 White soon mates) 52 ♔f1 ♕b6 then 53 ♖xh7 (threatening 54 ♕xd3) 53...♕b5 54 ♖d7! wins; 54 h4 is also good.

50 ♔f2 ♘g5 51 b8♕ ♕f3+

51...♘h3+ loses to 52 ♔f1 ♕h1+ 53 ♔e2 ♕e4+ 54 ♔d2 ♕e3+ 55 ♔c2.

52 ♔e1 ♕e4+ 53 ♔d1 ♕h1+ 54 ♔c2 d3+ 55 ♔b1 1-0

3 points for 49 ♕c1!, and 1 point each for seeing 50 ♕h6+! and 51 ♕d2! in the line with 49...d3.

436) Shirov – Yakovenko

Foros 2008

41 ♕g2!!

Defending against a possible entry by the black rook, but it is also an attacking move, as we shall see. Objectively 41 ♔c2! is also favourable to White, but not as strong as the move in the game; Black has to play 41...b5 (41...♖h2+?! 42 ♖1d2 ♖xd2+ 43 ♖xd2 {threatening 44 ♕h4 and ♖h2} 43...♖e8 44 ♕d1! ♖d8 45 ♕a1+ ♔g8 46 ♖h2 leads to mate) 42 ♗xb5 ♖h2+ 43 ♖5d2 ♖xd2+ 44 ♔xd2, and Black can try to hold this position.

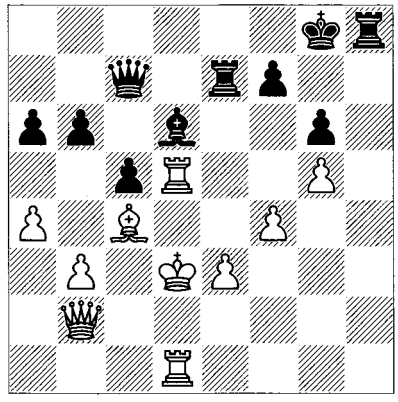
41...a6

There is no hope for Black after 41...♕c6 42 ♖h1 ♖xh1 43 ♕xh1 ♖e6 44 ♕h6+ ♔g8 45 f5 gxf5 46 g6 fxg6 (if 46...♖xg6 then 47 ♕xg6+ fxg6 48 ♖xd6+) 47 ♖d4 ♔f7 48 ♕h7+ ♔f6 49 ♕h8+ ♔e7 50 ♖h4, nor after 41...♖ee8 42 ♔c2 ♖d8 43 ♔b1, as Shirov pointed out.

42 ♕b2+!

This is one of the points of 41 ♕g2!!; the queen is very effective on the long diagonal.

42...♔g8 *(D)*



43 ♔c2!

A beautiful retreat, which completes the transfer of the king to a safe position, and threatens the d6-bishop.

43...♖h2+

Or 43...b5 44 ♖xd6 ♖h2+ 45 ♖6d2 ♖xd2+ 46 ♖xd2 bxc4 and now both 47 ♖h2! and 47 ♕f6! win; e.g., 47...cxb3+ 48 ♔b2 c4 49 ♖h2 c3+ 50 ♔b1 c2+ 51 ♔c1 b2+ 52 ♕xb2.

44 ♖5d2 ♖xd2+ 45 ♖xd2 b5 46 ♕f6! 1-0

5 points for 41 ♕g2!!. 3 points for the prosaic but effective 41 ♔c2!.

Test 2 Answers

437) Villegas – Grau

Mar del Plata 1928

52...d4! 0-1

Winning a piece, since on any move of the knight, 53...d3+ wins.

1 point for 52...d4!.

438) Grau – Balogh

The Hague Olympiad 1928

47 ♘g6+!

Not 47 ♘h7?, which would be a serious error on account of 47...♘f7 with equality.

47...♘xg6 48 hxg6 ♔f6 49 h7 ♔g7 50 ♔d2 1-0

Heading for e6, followed by h8♕+ and ♔f7.

1 point for 47 ♘g6+!.

439) Mecking – Jokšić (variation)
Vršac 1971

26 ♖xh5! (this typical sacrifice, followed by another one, wins) **26...gxh5 27 ♘f6+!**.

1 point for 26 ♖xh5! and 1 point for 27 ♘f6+!.

440) Bilek – Panno
Palma de Mallorca 1972

61...♗c3+! 62 ♔e3 ♗xg7!

The dangerous white pawn is eliminated, and the black h-pawn is decisive.

63 ♘e1+

63 ♖xg7+ loses to 63...♔f1 64 ♖h7 ♔g1 65 ♖g7+ ♖g2.

63...♔h3 64 ♖xg7 ♖xc4 65 ♘d3 ♖e4+! 66 ♔xe4

If 66 ♔d2 then one way to win is 66...♖g4! 67 ♘f2+ ♔g3 68 ♖xg4+ ♔xf2 and the h-pawn queens.

66...h1♕+ 67 ♔e3 ♕a1

and Black won.

1 point for finding 61...♗c3+! and 1 point for 62...♗xg7!.

441) Mecking – Timman
Bazna 2008

40 ♕xb5!

Creating a passed pawn on the queenside.

40...cxb5 41 c6 1-0

Black resigned since after 41...♔e8 42 g5! White creates another passed pawn on the kingside.

1 point for 40 ♕xb5! and 1 point for 42 g5!.

442) Galić – Minasian
European Clubs Cup, Kallithea 2008

34...♗g3+?

This move should lose; **34...♕g3+!** is essential and after 35 ♔e3 ♖xd5! 36 d4 f2+ (after 36...♗f4+ 37 ♔d3 f2+ 38 ♔c2 ♖g5 39 d5 White can defend) 37 ♔e2 ♕g4+ 38 ♔xf2 ♕f4+ 39 ♔e2 ♕xe4+ 40 ♔d2 ♗xd4, the game ends in a draw with 41 ♕f8+ ♔h7 42 ♕f7+.

35 ♔e3 ♕g5+ 36 ♘f4??

The capture 36 ♔xf3! wins; f8 is covered and if, e.g., 36...♗d6 then White has 37 ♕g1, among other things.

36...♕xf4# (0-1)

1 point for 34...♕g3+! and 1 point for 35...♖xd5!.

443) Zuckerman – Pomar
Malaga 1968

21...♕b5! 0-1

White is mated after 22 c4 ♕xc4! 23 ♕xc4 ♗xf3+! 24 ♖xf3 ♖g1#.

Both 21...♕b5! and 21...♕a6! receive 3 points.

444) Lautier – Illescas
Linares 1995

32...♘xe2! 33 ♔xe2 ♗d5!

The key move, complementing the previous one. The threat is 34...b6, and if 34 b5 axb5 35 axb5 ♔d6 36 ♔d2 b6 37 ♘c6 ♗xc6 38 bxc6 ♔xc6 Black wins easily.

0-1

2 points for 32...♘xe2! and 1 point for 33...♗d5!.

445) Gelfand – Illescas
Madrid 1996

18...♘6g5!

Beginning a fierce attack and threatening 19...♘h3+ and 20...♘exf2+.

19 ♔h1 ♘h3! 0-1

Black wins a lot of material.

2 points for 18...♘6g5! and 1 point for 19...♘h3!.

446) J.P. Gomez – Heberla
Calvia 2006

21 ♕b1!

Forcing a serious weakening.

21...h6

The alternative defence with 21...g6 is impossible on account of 22 ♗xg6! hxg6 23 ♕xg6+ ♔h8 and now, e.g., 24 ♘e5 fxe5 25 ♖xe5, with a decisive attack. 21...g5 does not lose material right away, but weakens the position irreparably, and White could then play 22 ♗f5 followed by h4.

22 ♗h7+ ♔h8 23 ♘h4!

Exploiting the hole created at g6.

23...g5

This loses, but there is nothing better.

24 ♘g6+ ♔g7 25 ♘f8!

Note the important role played by the b4-bishop.

25...♖xf8 26 ♕g6+ ♔h8 27 ♗xf8 ♕xh7 28 ♕xf6+

winning quickly.

2 points for 21 ♕b1! and 1 point extra if you saw 23 ♘h4!.

447) Magalashvili – Lajthajm

Kavala 2008

68 ♔f5?

After this move the game should end in a draw. Instead, **68 ♔e6!** wins; it is important that 68...♖h6+? loses to 69 ♔f7! ♕g7+ (69...♖xd6? 70 ♖h5+) 70 ♖xg7 ♖xd6 71 ♖g5. Also losing is 68...♕e3+ 69 ♕e5+ ♕xe5+ 70 ♖xe5 ♖h6+ 71 ♔d7 c3 72 d6, followed by 73 ♖c5.

68...♕d3+ 69 ♔e6?

69 ♔g4! ♕d1+ 70 ♔f5 draws.

0-1

White resigned without waiting for 69...♖h6+ 70 ♔d7 ♖xd6+ 71 ♔xd6 c3.

2 points for 68 ♔e6! and 1 point for 69 ♔f7!.

448) Navara – Svidler

FIDE Grand Prix, Sochi 2008

48 h3! (preparing the stalemate) **48...♔e8 49 ♖xb3! ♖xb3 ½-½.**

2 points for 48 h3! and 1 point for 49 ♖xb3!.

449) Villegas – Pulcherio

Mar del Plata 1928

29...dxc3?

Now White wins. Instead, **29...fxg6!** is an adequate defence: 30 f7+ ♔f8 31 fxe8♕++ ♔xe8 32 b3 ♕c7! (the only good way to protect f7, so it is important to have seen this) 33 ♕f8+ ♔d7 34 ♖f7+ ♔e6! 35 ♖xc7 ♖xf8 36 ♖xb7 dxc3 37 ♖xg7 (if 37 ♖c7 then 37...♖f3) 37...♖d8 38 ♖xg6+ ♔e5, and Black's active king, plus the threat of 39...♖d1+ followed by 40...♖d2+ or 40...♖a1, depending on White's next move, gives him good drawing chances.

30 ♖xg7+ ♔h8 31 ♖h7+! ♔xh7 32 ♕f5+ ♔h6 33 ♕h3+ ♔g6 34 ♕g3+ ♔h6 35 ♕g7+ 1-0

3 points for 29...fxg6! and 1 point extra for 32...♕c7!.

450) Bronstein – Bazán

Mar del Plata 1960

37 f5!

Forcing a winning pawn ending.

37...♖fe8 38 fxe6+ ♖xe6 39 ♖xe6 ♖xe6 40 ♔f3 ♖e7

After 40...♖xe3+ 41 ♔xe3 ♔e7 42 ♔e4 ♔e6 43 a4, followed by 44 d5, White is able to advance his king, and after playing b5 to deflect the black king, White's king can invade the kingside and capture the black pawns, as would have happened in the game had Black not resigned.

41 ♖xe7+ ♔xe7 42 ♔e4 ♔e6 43 a3 ♔f7 1-0

Let's look at a few lines to illustrate the above commentary: 44 d5 cxd5+ (or 44...♔e7 45 d6+ ♔e6 46 ♔f4 ♔f7 47 ♔f5 and 48 ♔g6) 45 ♔xd5 ♔e7 (45...g6 is met by 46 a4 f5 47 gxf5 gxh5 48 b5 h4 49 ♔e4) 46 a4 ♔d7 47 b5 axb5 48 axb5 ♔e7 49 c6.

4 points for 37 f5!.

451) Rossetto – Pilnik

Buenos Aires 1947

46 ♖d3! ♘c2+

46...♔xe5 is not a worry, since White can then play, for instance, 47 ♖xa3 ♔d4 48 ♖a5 g5 49 c6.

47 ♔b3?

Here **47 ♔c4!!** equalizes, as after 47...♔xe5 48 ♖c3! the knight can't escape: if 48...♘d4 or 48...♘e1 then 49 ♖e3+, while 48...♘a1 is met by 49 ♖a3.

47...♔xe5 48 ♔xc2 ♖xc5+ 0-1

White didn't want to defend the difficult ending a pawn down after 49 ♔b3 (49 ♔d2? ♖d5) 49...g5; with his king over on the queenside he has little hope.

3 points for 46 ♖d3! and 2 points for 47 ♔c4!!.

452) Foguelman – F. Olafsson

Mar del Plata 1960

The game continued **35 ♗h7+? ♔f8 36 ♖b3** and with **36...♗xg2!** Black gained a decisive advantage and went on to win.

Instead **35 ♖xe6!!** wins, stripping away the black king's defences; then 35...fxe6? loses to 36 ♕xe6+ ♔h8 37 ♕e8+, mating. And if 35...f5, then after 36 ♖e8+ ♔f7 (or 36...♖xe8 37 ♗c4+ ♖e6 38 ♗xe6+ ♔f8 39 ♕h8+ ♔e7 40 ♗xf5+ ♔d6 41 ♕d8+) 37 ♗c4+ ♗d5 38 ♗xd5+ ♖xd5 White has many winning moves, among which the most convincing is 39 ♖f8+! ♔g6 (39...♔xf8 loses more quickly: 40 ♕h8+ ♔f7 41 ♕e8+ ♔f6 42 ♖e6#) 40 ♖e6+ ♕f6 41 ♖exf6+ gxf6 42 ♖g8+.

5 points for 35 ♖xe6!!.

Test 3 Answers

453) Ju. Bolbochán – Iliesco
Mar del Plata 1941

19 ♗g5! ♘xf7
19...♕b6? loses to 20 ♗f6#.
20 ♗xd8
and White won.
1 point for 19 ♗g5!.

454) Maderna – Villegas
La Plata 1944

14 ♘b5! cxb5
Black is forced to give up his queen, since 14...♕b8 is met by 15 ♘xd6 ♕xd6 16 ♗b4.
15 ♖xc7
with a decisive material advantage.
1 point for 14 ♘b5!.

455) Reca – Palau
Buenos Aires 1921

18 ♕e6!
Since White is a piece down, 18 ♕xd7? ♔xf7 would be a bad deal.
18...h5
Not 18...♔f8? 19 ♘h6! gxh6 20 ♗xh6#.
19 ♘e5+ ♔h8 20 ♕xd7 ♗xg5 21 ♘f7+ ♔g8 22 ♘xg5
with two extra pawns and an attack.
2 points for 18 ♕e6!.

456) Da Cunha – Grau
Montevideo 1925

14...♘a5! 15 c5
15 ♘d5? ♘xd5 attacks the e3-bishop.
15...♘b3 16 ♕d1 ♘xa1 17 cxb6 ♘c2 18 ♗f2 axb6 19 ♗d3 ♗xd3 20 ♕xd3 ♘xa3 21 ♖a1 h6
with a material advantage; 21...b5! 22 bxa3 b4 was even stronger.
2 points for 14...♘a5!.

457) Rauch – F. Benko
Buenos Aires 1945

20 ♘e7+!
Not 20 ♘xh6+? ♔g7 21 ♕h4 ♖h8, with advantage to Black.
20...♔h7 21 ♕f3
and White soon won.
2 points for 20 ♘e7+!.

458) F. Benko – De Ronde
Buenos Aires 1945

22 ♗xf7!
The quickest; 22 ♖h3 and 22 ♕xf6+ are also good but not as strong as the move played.
22...♕xf7 23 ♕xh6+ ♕h7 24 ♕xf6+ ♖g7 25 ♖h3
and White won.
2 points for 22 ♗xf7!. 1 point for 22 ♖h3 or 22 ♕xf6+.

459) Najdorf – Frenkel
Lodz 1928

18 e6!
Threatening mate.
18...♖xg7?!
18...♗d5 offers more resistance, although after 19 exf7+ ♗xf7 20 ♕g5 ♖xg7 21 ♖ad1 ♕c7 22 ♕h6 ♖g8 23 ♕h7, the black king stranded in the centre will be hunted to death by the white pieces. 18...hxg4 loses to 19 exf7+ ♔d7 20 ♖ad1+, followed by 21 ♖xd8 and White queens.
19 ♖xf7! hxg4
If 19...♖xf7 then one way to win is 20 ♕xg6 ♕d6 21 ♖f1.
20 ♖xg7 ♔f8 21 ♖xg6 1-0
White mates after 21...♕b6 22 ♗xb6 ♗d5 23 ♖f1+.
3 points for 18 e6!.

460) Ju. Bolbochán – Villegas
Mar del Plata 1944

31 ♕xe7! 1-0
It is mate after 31...♖xe7 32 ♖xf8+ ♔xf8 33 ♖d8+ ♖e8 34 ♗c5+.
3 points for 31 ♕xe7!.

461) Ju. Bolbochán– R. Sanguinetti
La Plata 1945

41 ♕h6! 1-0
The f6-pawn is decisive; after 41...♕g6 42 ♕xf8+! White wins a rook.
2 points for 41 ♕h6! and 1 point extra if you saw 42 ♕xf8+!.

462) Beretta – Lipiniks
Argentine Ch, Buenos Aires 1946

23 ♗f6! 1-0
Not 23 ♕h6? on account of 23...f6. In contrast, now there is no defence against 24 ♕h6.
3 points for 23 ♗f6!.

463) Eliskases – Najdorf
Buenos Aires 1947

45...♖b6!!

The rook defends Black's third rank and threatens 46...♖f6+.

46 ♖g1+

46 ♖xe8? loses to 46...♕xd3+.

46...♔h7 47 ♔e2

47 ♔g2 ♖xd8 48 ♕xd8 ♖g6+ 49 ♔h2 ♖xg1 50 ♔xg1 ♗e6 leads to a winning endgame.

47...♖be6

and Black went on to won.

Better was **47...♖xb2+!** 48 ♔e3 ♖h2! 49 ♕g3 (49 ♕xh2 ♖xd8 is easy for Black) 49...♖xe4+! 50 ♔xe4 ♕c4+ 51 ♔e3 ♖h3, with a decisive advantage; e.g., 52 ♕xh3 ♗xh3 53 ♖dg8 ♕d4+ 54 ♔e2 c4.

3 points for 45...♖b6!!.

464) L. Cámara – Ståhlberg

Buenos Aires 1948

23 ♕xb5??

White has a big advantage after **23 ♗xf7+!** ♖xf7 (if 23...♔h8 then simply 24 ♕b1) 24 ♕xf7+ ♔h7 25 ♕f5+! ♔g8 26 ♕b1.

23...♖e1+ 24 ♖xe1 ♕xe1+ 0-1

25 ♕f1 ♗h2+ is winning for Black.

2 points for 23 ♗xf7+! and 1 point for 25 ♕f5+!.

465) Ju. Bolbochán – Reinhardt

Argentine Ch, Buenos Aires 1960

57 ♗xd4!

This exchange is the start of a winning manoeuvre to exploit the extra pawn.

57...♘xd4 58 ♗d1!

Zugzwang: Black has to move either the g-pawn or the king; in the latter case White plays 59 ♔g6 and g5, winning easily.

58...g6+ 59 ♔h6!

But not 59 fxg6+?? ♔g7 60 g5 f5, and now it is White who is in zugzwang; if 61 ♗a4? then 61...♘e2 and mate next move!

59...gxf5 60 g5!

The passed pawn wins.

60...fxg5 61 hxg5 f4 62 g6+ ♔f6

If 62...♔g8 then 63 ♗g4 f3 64 ♗e6+ ♘xe6 65 dxe6 f2 66 e7 f1♕ 67 e8♕+ ♕f8+ 68 ♕xf8+ ♔xf8 69 ♔h7.

63 ♗g4! f3 64 g7 f2 65 g8♕ ♘f5+ 66 ♗xf5 1-0

3 points for 57 ♗xd4! and 1 point for 58 ♗d1!.

466) Amado – Scanavino

Buenos Aires 1963

18...♖xc3!

White has an extra piece, but his king is very exposed. All Black's pieces are active, and there is a devastating finish.

19 ♕e1

19 ♕xc3 is met by 19...♘e4+.

19...♖xe3!

19...♕xe3+?! 20 ♔f1 is a less convincing continuation.

20 ♔f1 ♕f6+ 21 ♗f2 ♖xe2! 0-1

22 ♔xe2 ♕a6+ and mate.

2 points for 18...♖xc3! and 2 points for 19...♖xe3!.

467) Tukmakov – Panno

Buenos Aires 1970

21 e6!! 1-0

The uncomfortable position of Black's king and the aggressive deployment of the white pieces combine to produce this elegant finish. If 21...exd3 then 22 ♗xd3 ♘f6 23 gxf6 ♗xf6 24 ♖xh7+ ♔g8 25 ♖gxg7+! ♗xg7 26 ♖xg7+ ♔h8 27 ♖h7+ ♔g8 28 ♖h8#, while 21...♗xe6 is punished by 22 ♗xg7+! ♔xg7 23 ♕d4+ ♖f6 (worse is 23...♔f7 24 ♗h5#) 24 gxf6++ ♔f8 25 fxe7+, with a decisive material advantage and an attack.

Also winning was **21 ♖xh7+!** ♔xh7 22 ♕xe4+ ♗f5 23 ♕h4+ ♘h6 24 ♘xe7.

5 points for 21 e6!! and 4 points for 21 ♖xh7+!.

468) Fischer – García Palermo

Buenos Aires (simul) 1971

12...♘xe4!!

An amazing winning move; Black's deadly threats of 13...♕f2# and 13...♗h4+ are unanswerable.

13 ♗d7+

13 ♕xe4 allows 13...♗h4+ 14 g3 ♗xg3+ 15 ♔f1 ♕f2#, while if 13 ♗xb7+ there is only one move, but it wins: 13...♔b8!.

13...♖xd7 14 ♕xd7+ ♗xd7 15 ♘xe4 ♗c6 0-1

5 points for 12...♘xe4!!.

Test 4 Answers

469) Ju. Bolbochán– R. Sanguinetti

La Plata 1944

21 ♖xe6! 1-0

With a decisive material advantage.

1 point for 21 ♖xe6!.

470) Falcón – Guimard
Buenos Aires 1945

24...♖xe2! 25 ♕xe2 f3 0-1

26...♕h3 is coming next.

1 point for 24...♖xe2!.

471) Maderna – Najdorf
Buenos Aires 1945

28...♖f4! 29 ♕d3

The capture 29 gxf4 leads to a win for Black after 29...♕g4+ 30 ♔h2 ♕xh4+ 31 ♔g2 ♖xf4.

29..e4 30 ♕d7

30 ♘d4 offers more resistance but after 30...♗xd4 31 ♕xd4 e3! 32 gxf4 ♕g4+ 33 ♔h2 exd2 34 ♕xd2 ♕xh4+ 35 ♔g1 ♖xf4 Black has an extra pawn and an attack.

30...♕xd7 0-1

31 ♖xd7 is met by 31...♖xf2+.

2 points for 28...♖f4!.

472) Czerniak – Hand
Buenos Aires 1945

41 ♖xf7+? only draws.

41 ♕h4+! 1-0

White's attack is quicker: 41...♔e6 42 ♕e7+ ♔d5 43 fxe4+ ♔c5 44 ♕c7+ ♔b5 45 a4+ ♔b4 46 ♕b6#. No better is 41...♕g5 42 ♖xf7+, while if 41...g5 then 42 ♕xe4 threatens both 43 ♖h6+ and 43 ♕e7+, and now, for example, 42...♖e3 43 ♖h6+ ♔g7 44 ♕h7+ ♔f8 45 ♕h8#.

2 points for 41 ♕h4+!.

473) Maderna – Michel
Buenos Aires 1945

30 ♗xd5+!

Not only winning a centre pawn but also bringing another piece into the attack and opening lines against the black king.

30...♔f8 31 e4 c3

31...♗xe4 32 ♗xe4 ♕xd4+ 33 ♔f1 does not help, since g7 is still under attack, while 31...♗h7 is met by 32 ♕h4.

32 bxc3 bxc3 33 ♕h4 g6 34 ♕f6+ 1-0

2 points for 30 ♗xd5+!.

474) Ju. Bolbochán – Rossetto
Argentine Ch match (game 7), Buenos Aires 1948

35...♖xe2! gains a decisive material advantage: **36 ♕xe2 ♕xd5+ 37 ♕f3 ♕xf3+ 38 ♖xf3 ♗xd4 0-1**.

2 points for 35...♖xe2!.

475) Najdorf – Guimard
Argentine Ch, Buenos Aires 1949

31 ♘h5+!

It is forced mate; **31 ♘e8+!** also wins.

31...♖xh5

31...gxh5 is met by 32 ♗h6+ ♖xh6 33 ♕f8#, while if 31...♔h7 it is mate in seven, as Najdorf demonstrated after the game: 32 ♕f7+! ♖xf7 33 ♖xf7+ ♔g8 34 ♖g7+ ♔f8 35 ♖f1+ ♗f6 36 ♖xf6+ ♔e8 37 ♗xg6+ ♔d8 38 ♖f8#.

32 ♕f8+ ♔h7 33 ♖f7+ ♖xf7 34 ♕xf7+ ♔h8 35 ♕e8+ 1-0

It is mate after 35...♔g7 36 ♕xg6+ ♔f8 37 ♖f1+.

3 points for 31 ♘h5+!; also 3 points if you chose 31 ♘e8+!.

476) Najdorf – de Souza Mendes
Mar del Plata 1959

28 ♖h3!

With the elimination of Black's most effective defensive piece, all resistance is brought to an end.

28...♖xh3 29 ♕g6+ ♔f8 30 gxh3 ♘d7

Or 30...♗c7 31 ♕h6+ ♔e7 32 ♕g7 ♖f8 33 ♘g6+.

31 ♘xd7+ 1-0

3 points for 28 ♖h3!.

477) R. Sanguineti – Pachman
Mar del Plata 1959

68...♖d5!

Preparing to force the white king away; now 69 ♖xe3? loses to 69...♖f5+ 70 ♔e4 ♖e5+.

69 ♖a8 ♖f5+ 70 ♔g2 ♖f2+ 71 ♔g1 ♖f1+! 0-1

The quickest way.

3 points for 68...♖d5!.

478) Ju. Bolbochán – German
São Paulo Zonal 1960

37 ♖c8!

White seems to have problems, but with this move he begins a winning manoeuvre. If now 37...♔xe4 then 38 ♖xc4+ wins the exchange.

37...a5 38 ♖c7! ♗f8?

38...♗d8 loses to 39 ♖c5+! ♔xe4 40 ♖xc4+.

39 ♘f6# (1-0)

2 points for 37 ♖c8! and 1 point for 38 ♖c7!.

479) Van Ketel – Pavlović
Leiden 2008

35...♘g4+!

Much less appropriate is 35...♕a1? since after 36 ♕xb4! matters are far from clear, but **35...♕e5+!** is also good; e.g., 36 ♕xe5 ♖xe5 37 ♖xe5 (or 37 ♖xf6 ♗xf6 38 ♖xf6 ♖c5! and the black pawns are much more advanced and will prove decisive) 37...♘g4+ 38 hxg4 ♗xe5+ 39 g3 b3.

36 hxg4

If 36 ♔g3 then 36...♗e5+ 37 ♔xg4 ♕xf3+ 38 ♔xf3 ♗xd6, and Black wins.

36...♗e5+ 37 ♖xe5 ♕xe5+ 38 ♕xe5 ♖xe5 39 ♖f6 ♖c5 0-1

Once again the black pawns will have the final say.

3 points for 35...♘g4+!. Also 3 points if you chose 35...♕e5+!, which has a similar outcome via a different move-order.

480) Roktim – Vishnu

Indian Ch, Chennai 2008

19 ♖d4!

Black has an extra piece at the moment. However, this move threatens to win material and also prepares an attack on the black king, and it is not possible to parry both threats. **19 ♘f6+** ♔e7 20 ♖d4! is also good, but not as strong.

19...♗e7

If 19...b5 then 20 ♖hd1, winning at least a rook: 20...f6 (20...♗b7?? walks into a mate: 21 ♘f6+ ♔e7 22 ♖d7#) 21 ♗xf8 ♗xf8 22 ♖d8+ ♔f7 23 ♖xf8+ ♔g7 24 ♖dd8.

20 ♗xf8 ♗d7 21 ♗xe7 ♔xe7 22 ♖xc4

with a decisive advantage.

3 points for 19 ♖d4!. 2 points if you chose 19 ♘f6+ ♔e7 20 ♖d4!.

481) Najdorf – R. García

Mar del Plata 1965

39...♖xe1+?

There is no hurry to take the queen. Black can gain the advantage with **39...c3!**:

a) 40 ♘c7? is bad, because it puts the knight out of play. Therefore Black plays 40...c2 since now 41 ♗f1 does not threaten anything and Black continues 41...c1♕ 42 ♖e8+ ♔g7 43 ♕e5+ ♔h6!, when his mating attack strikes first.

b) 40 ♘d6 c2 (threatening to queen) 41 ♗f1 and now Black must take the queen, but the bishop is loose after 41...♖xe1 (this time 41...c1♕? walks into mate after 42 ♖e8+ ♔g7 43 ♕e5+ ♔h6 44 ♕h8+ ♘h7 45 ♘xf7#) 42 ♖xe1 ♖b3! 43 ♖c1 ♖b1 44 ♖xc2 ♖xf1+ 45 ♔g2 ♖f4, or 45...♖d1, and Black can play for a win.

40 ♖xe1 c3 41 ♘c7 c2 42 ♖c1 ♘xh3 43 ♖xc2

and White won.

4 points for 39...c3!.

482) Mecking – Kavalek

Sousse Interzonal 1967

52 ♕a7+!

It is the right moment to counterattack.

52...♔h6

If 52...♔g8 then 53 ♕b8+ ♔g7 54 ♕c7+ and Black has to play 54...♔h6, since 54...♔g8 55 ♕d8+ is winning for White; for example, 55...♔g7 56 ♕e7+ ♔g8 57 ♕xf6, with a mating attack.

53 ♕e7! 1-0

The knight can't be defended, and 53...♘g4+ loses to 54 ♖xg4!, in view of 54...hxg4? 55 ♕h7#.

2 points for 52 ♕a7+! and 2 points for 53 ♕e7!.

483) Mahía – Quinteros

Los Polvorines 1980

24 ♗g6!!

Two pieces down(!), White finds this brilliant move, which prevents the black queen from defending the h7-square. The continuation is forced.

24...♕xg6 25 ♖xg6

Threatening 26 ♕xh7+.

25...♘e7 26 ♖xf7!

Not the only way to win, but definitely the prettiest and the quickest.

26...♔xf7 27 g8♕+! ♘xg8 28 ♕xh7+ 1-0

It is mate in three.

4 points for 24 ♗g6!! and 1 point extra for 26 ♖xf7!.

484) Dreev – Mukhutdinov

St Petersburg 1993

39 ♖xc3!

At first sight this appears to lose; **39 ♗xd6!?** cxd6 40 ♖xc3 ♕d1+ 41 ♕g1 should also win, but Black can still fight.

39...♕d1+ 40 ♕g1 ♖f1 41 ♗e5+! 1-0

This is the point: White will mate with 42 ♖h3+.

4 points for 39 ♖xc3! and 1 point extra for 41 ♗e5+!. 3 points choosing 39 ♗xd6!?.

Test 5 Answers

485) Lynch – Michel
Buenos Aires 1945

25...♗b4!
This pin is decisive.
26 ♖xc8 ♗xc8 27 ♖d1 ♖xd2+ 0-1
1 point for 25...♗b4!.

486) Najdorf – Hand
Buenos Aires 1945

34 ♖b8+! ♖d8
Losing the a7-pawn, but there is no alternative; 34...♔e7? loses to 35 ♘c6+ ♔e6 36 ♖e8+ ♔f5 37 ♘d4+ ♔f4 38 g3#.
35 ♖xd8+ ♔xd8 36 ♘c6+ ♔c7 37 ♘xa7 ♘e6 38 g3 ♔b6 39 ♘c8+ ♔c7 40 ♘e7 1-0
1 point for 34 ♖b8+!.

487) Guimard – Najdorf
Buenos Aires 1948

41...♗xf3! 0-1
After 42 gxf3 ♕xh3+ 43 ♔g1 Black has the typical mate 43...♗h2+ 44 ♔h1 ♗g3+ 45 ♔g1 ♕h2+ 46 ♔f1 ♕xf2#.
2 points for 41...♗xf3!.

488) Iliesco – Guimard
Buenos Aires 1948

27...h5!
Threatening 28...♖f8#.
28 e5 ♖f8+ 29 ♔e4 ♘d2+ 30 ♔d3 ♘xf1 0-1
2 points for 27...h5!.

489) Maderna – García Vera
Santa Fe 1948

34 ♕d3!
There is no satisfactory defence against the queen invasion at h7.
34...♘d2
34...g6 loses to 35 ♘xf7! ♔xf7 36 ♕xg6+ ♔f8 37 ♖d7.
35 ♕h7+ ♔f8 36 ♕h8+ ♔e7 37 ♘c8+ ♖xc8 38 ♕xc8 1-0
2 points for 34 ♕d3!.

490) Agdestein – Aagaard
Dresden Olympiad 2008

76...♕f3+!
The pawn ending is won.
77 ♕xf3 gxf3 78 ♔xf3 ♔h6!
The only way to win.
79 ♔g4 ♔g6 0-1
1 point for finding 76...♕f3+! and 1 point for 78...♔h6!.

491) Panchanathan – Sundararajan
Badalona 2008

17...♘xe4!!
The most elegant and most convincing way. 17...♗g6!? is also strong, while 17...♘g4!? had been played successfully in an earlier game.
18 ♗xe4 ♕h4 19 ♗g2 ♗g4!
19...♖f2!, with the idea of 20...♗g4, was also strong.
20 d5 ♖f2 0-1
The threats of 21...♗xh3 and 21...♖xg2+, with a quick mate, are unanswerable.
3 points for 17...♘xe4!! and 2 points for 17...♗g6!? or 17...♘g4!?.

492) Dziuba – Onishchuk
Najdorf Memorial, Warsaw 2008

38...♗xh3!
This should win.
39 ♔g1
39 gxh3 loses to 39...♕xh3+ 40 ♔g1 ♖xc3 41 ♕xc3 ♕g4+.
39...♗g4?!
There is a win with **39...♗xg2!** 40 ♔xg2 ♕g4+ 41 ♔f2 ♖xc3 42 ♕xc3 ♕xd1.
40 ♖f1 ♕g3?!
Black's best at this point is 40...♗d7!.
41 ♘xb5
with complications.
2 points for 38...♗xh3! and 1 point for 39...♗xg2!.

493) Xiu Deshun – Laylo
Kuala Lumpur 2008

51...♖d3+!
Setting up the next move.
52 ♔a2 fxg3!
And the passed pawn decides.
53 ♘e5 ♖d1 54 ♖xe3 g2 55 ♖e4 g1♕ 56 ♖g4+ ♕xg4 57 fxg4 ♔f4
and White resigned a few moves later.
2 points for 51...♖d3+! and 1 point for 52...fxg3!.

494) Laylo – Sermek
Kuala Lumpur 2008

27 ♘xd6!
Winning material, but White has to see the follow-up.
27...♖d4

27...♖exe4 28 ♘xe4 ♗xe4 fails to 29 ♕c3! ♔g8 30 g3, with a decisive advantage.

28 ♘df5+! gxf5 29 ♘xf5+ ♔g8 30 ♘xd4 cxd4 31 ♗xe6

White has a big material advantage and Black's king is left weak.

2 points for 27 ♘xd6! and 1 point for 28 ♘df5+!.

495) Cmilyte – Borić

European Clubs Cup (women), Kallithea 2008

23 ♘xc6! bxc6

23...♗xa1 is met by 24 ♘d8!, planning a deadly discovery by the d5-rook.

24 ♖d7! 1-0

After this elegant move there is no defence; 24...♕xb3 leads to mate after 25 ♖xg7+ ♔h8 26 ♖xg6+.

2 points for 23 ♘xc6! and 1 point for 24 ♖d7!.

496) Janković – Trent

Harkany 2008

41 a6!

The first task is to create a passed pawn.

41...bxa6

After 41...♖f8 42 axb7 ♖b8 43 ♔c4 ♖xb7 44 ♔c5, the b6-pawn wins the game.

42 b7 ♖f8 43 ♔a4!

Now White needs to bring his king to the aid of the passed pawn; not 43 ♔c4? ♖b8 44 ♖b1 ♔d6! and White's king can't get through to support the pawn.

43...♖b8 44 ♖b1 ♔e5

Seeking to counterattack against the white pawns. Passive defence fails: after 44...♔d6 45 ♔a5 ♔c7 46 ♔xa6 ♖f8 (46...h5 47 ♖f1!) 47 ♔a7 ♖b8 and now one way to win is 48 ♖b6, threatening 49 ♖xc6+.

45 ♔a5 ♔e4 46 ♔xa6 ♔xe3 47 ♔a7 ♖f8 48 b8♕ ♖xb8 49 ♖xb8 ♔f3 50 ♖b3+ ♔g4 51 ♔b6 g5 52 ♔c5

The king arrives and White wins easily.

52...h5 53 ♔d4 c5+ 54 ♔e4 c4 55 ♖c3 h4 56 gxh4 gxh4 57 ♔e3 ♔g3 58 ♔e2+ ♔g2 59 ♖xc4 h3 60 ♖g4+ ♔h2 61 ♔f2 1-0

White mates after 61...♔h1 62 ♔g3 h2 63 ♖a4.

2 points for 41 a6! and 1 point for 43 ♔a4!.

497) Torán – O'Kelly

Palma de Mallorca 1967

24 g4!

Threatening 25 ♖h3 ♘f8 26 ♕h6, mating.

24...♖g8 25 ♕xh7+!!

This was another of the ideas behind 24 g4!.

25...♔xh7 26 ♖h3+ ♘h4 27 ♖xh4+ ♔g6 28 ♖h6+ ♔g5 29 f4+ 1-0

2 points for 24 g4! and 2 points for 25 ♕xh7+!!.

498) Puiggros – Pedrosa

Buenos Aires 1972

14 ♘xg6!

First it is necessary to weaken f7.

14...hxg6 15 ♗xf7+!

This is the idea.

15...♔xf7 16 ♕c4+ ♔f8 17 ♘h6! 1-0

And this is the final blow.

2 points for 14 ♘xg6!, 1 point for 15 ♗xf7+! and 1 point for 17 ♘h6!.

499) Gi. Hernández – Gulko

Torre Memorial, Yucatán 1999

24 ♕d6! ♗xg2+ 25 ♔g1!

This move prevents Black's queen from coming to the aid of the king by means of a check on d5. If 25 ♔xg2? then 25...♖e8 26 ♕f6 ♕d5+ 27 ♔g3 (27 ♔f2? loses to 27...♖xe2+! 28 ♔xe2 ♕g2+ and the h6-bishop is lost after 29 ♔d3 {or 29 ♔d1 ♕g1+ 30 ♔d2 ♕xh2+} 29...♕h3+ and 30...♕xh6) 27...♕e5+ 28 ♕xe5 ♖xe5 29 ♘xd4 f6, with advantage to Black.

25...♖e8 26 ♕f6 ♕a1+ 27 ♘c1! ♖e1+ 28 ♔f2! ♖f1+ 29 ♔e2 d3+ 30 cxd3 1-0

3 points for 24 ♕d6! and 2 points for 25 ♔g1!.

500) Zapata – de la Paz

Capablanca Memorial, Havana 2001

37...♖h5+!

Here 37...♕h5+? loses to 38 ♖h4, among other things.

38 ♔g1 ♕e3+??

Black achieves equal play with **38...f6!** and the white queen is trapped; a possible continuation is 39 ♖4f2 ♕xf2+ 40 ♖xf2 ♖xh6 41 ♖xf6, with an equal endgame; e.g., 41...a5 42 ♔f2 ♔xg7 43 ♖f7+ ♔xg6 44 ♖xb7 ♖h1. **38...f5!** is similar.

39 ♖4f2! 1-0

Black overlooked this move, after which 40 gxf7+ will win.

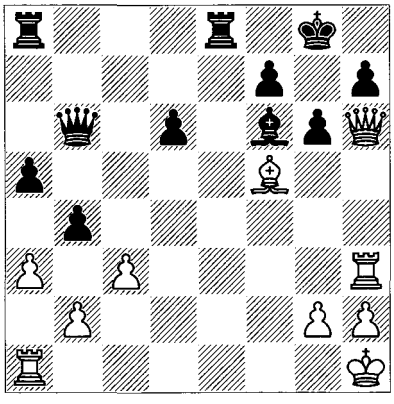
3 points for 37...♖h5+! and 2 points for 38...f5! or 38...f6!.

6 Defence and Counterattack

This chapter consists of 90 puzzles on the theme of defence and counterattack. The first 40 are supplied with hints.

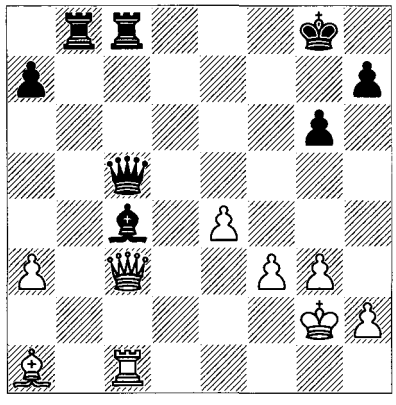
As in Chapter 3, the puzzles increase in difficulty from level 1 to level 4, dropping back to level 1 in Puzzle 541.

501
B



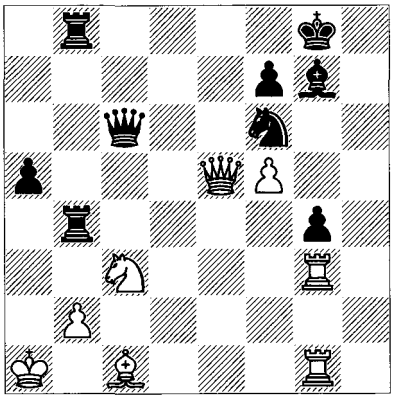
There is just one good move for Black, but it promises a winning counterattack.

503
B



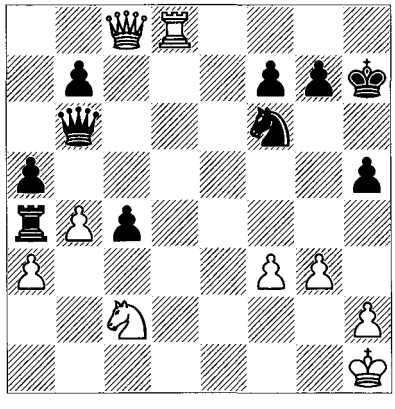
What is the best defence against the threats on the long diagonal?

502
B



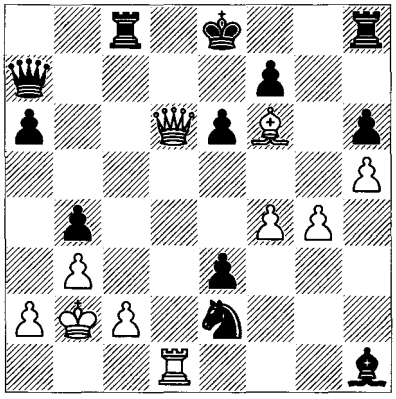
Black has several tactical ideas available; how can he end the struggle immediately?

504
B



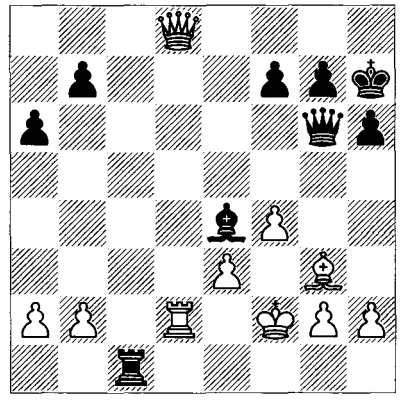
Does Black have to think about defending, or is it possible to counterattack successfully?

505
B



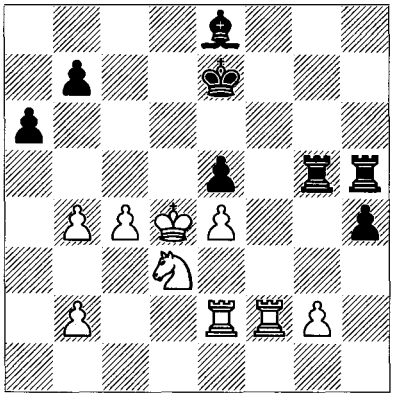
White has a strong and direct threat; what is the best defence?

508
B



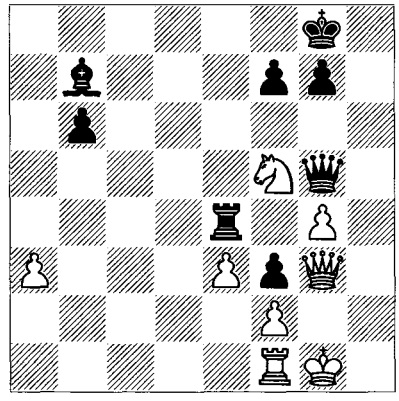
'Opposite bishops favour the attacker', especially considering the clumsy g3-bishop. How can Black take advantage?

506
W



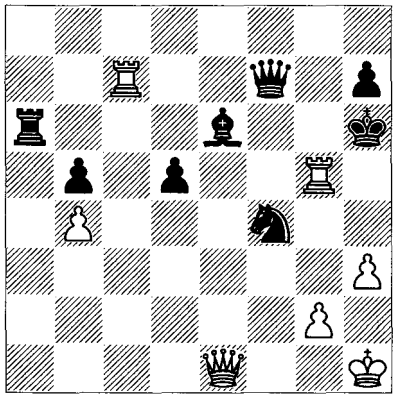
Is it the right moment for White to use his king aggressively, or is it preferable to retreat?

509
W



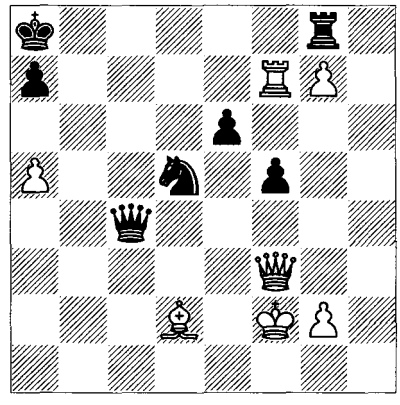
Can White play for a win?

507
B



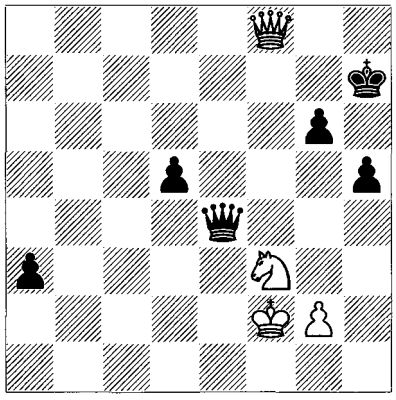
White's three pieces are all working with maximum energy; it is essential for Black to reduce White's attacking power.

510
B



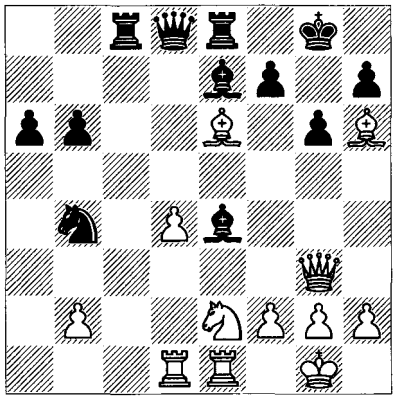
Black's position is on the verge of collapse; how can he save the game?

511
B



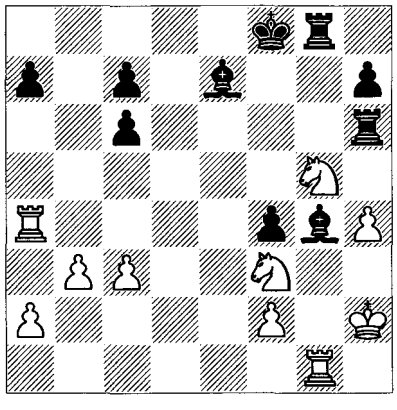
White is threatening 63 ♘g5#, but Black has three pawns for the piece and is close to a draw; how can he achieve this?

512
B



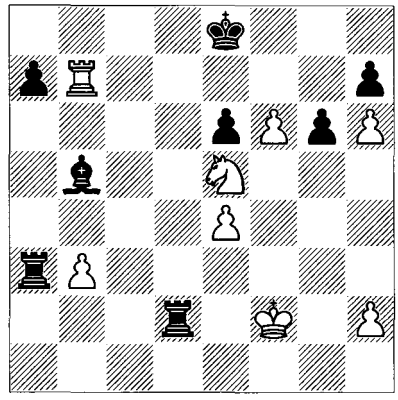
The black king is under attack from several white pieces, but discovering a key idea enables Black to repel the attack.

513
B



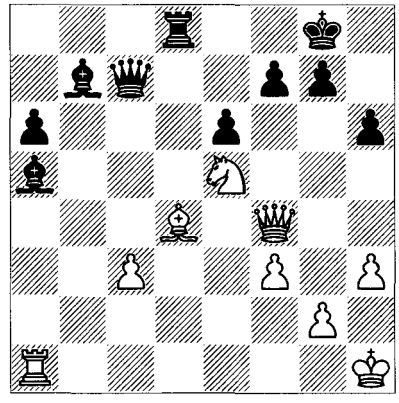
The white king is uncomfortable on the h-file; how can Black exploit this to win material?

514
W



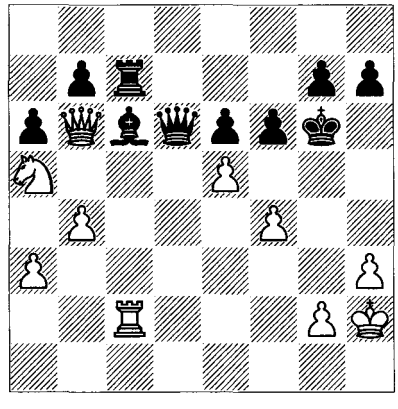
You need to be more cautious than the player with the white pieces was here; where does the king have to go?

515
B



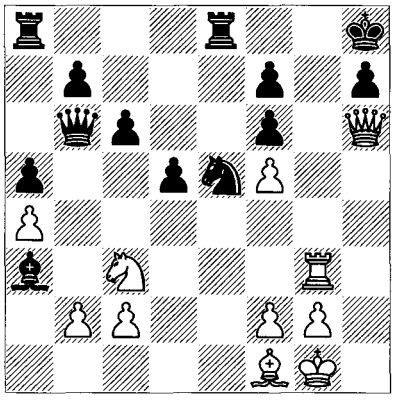
Black's a5-bishop is out of play, and White threatens 30 ♖xa5; is there anything better than 29...♖f8?

516
B



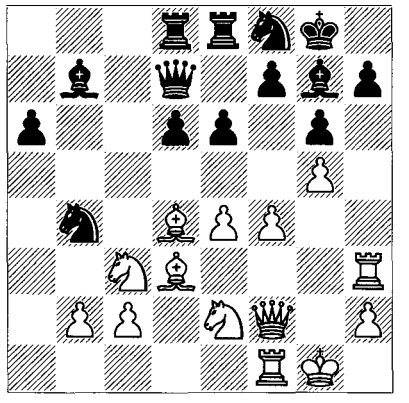
After 37...fxe5? 38 ♘c4! ♕e7 39 ♘xe5+ ♔h6 40 a4, Black was in difficulties. Find a better defence.

517
B



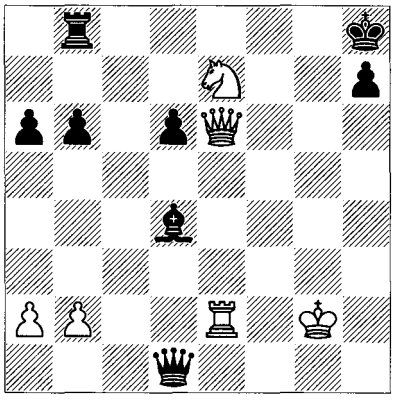
White's attack looks very strong, but what is wrong with his position?

520
B



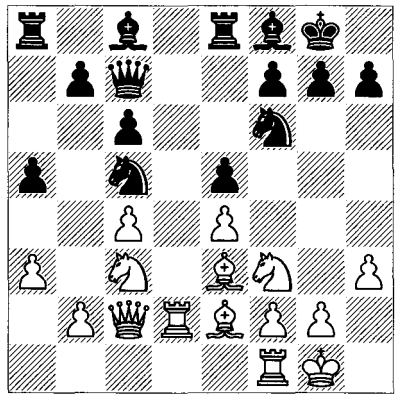
Is the counterblow 23...e5 correct?

518
W



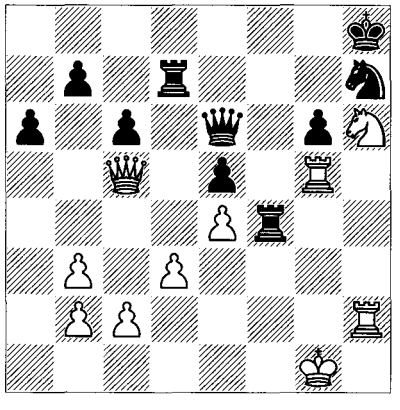
White chose 36 ♖e1 ?, allowing the black queen to protect her king following 36...♕d2+. Find a better defence for White.

521
B



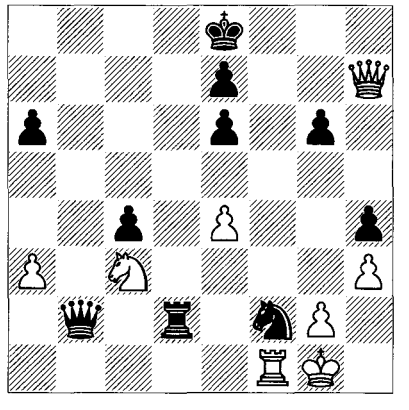
Does the combination 15...♘fxe4 work?

519
B



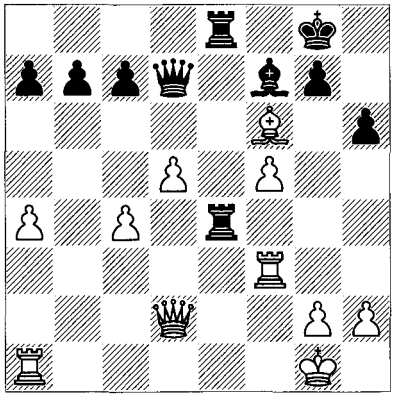
After 34...♖e7? 35 ♖g3 ♖e8 36 ♖hg2 Black lost quickly. What should Black play instead?

522
W



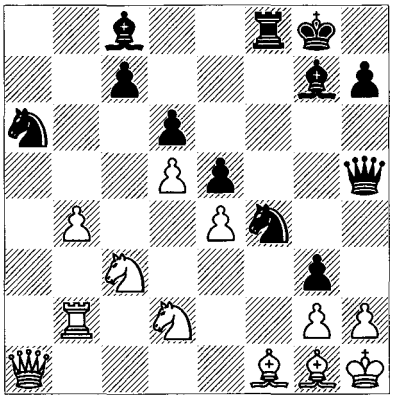
Black's pieces are active but his king is exposed. How can White exploit this to defend successfully?

523
B



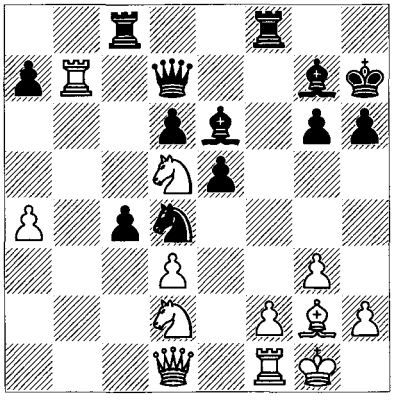
After 27...♕d6? 28 ♗d4 c5 29 ♗c3 ♖xc4 30 ♖g3 Black's position collapsed. How could he have defended better?

524
W



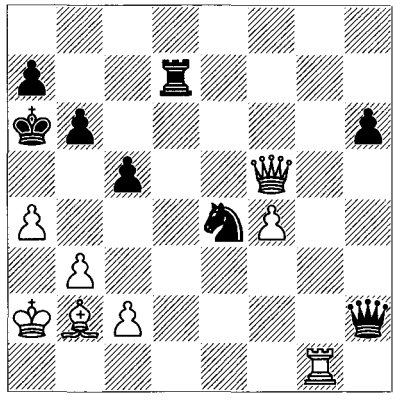
Is the capture 26 ♗xa6 advisable?

525
B



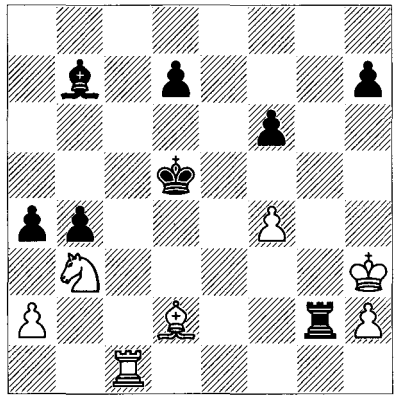
What is the best move for the black queen?

526
B



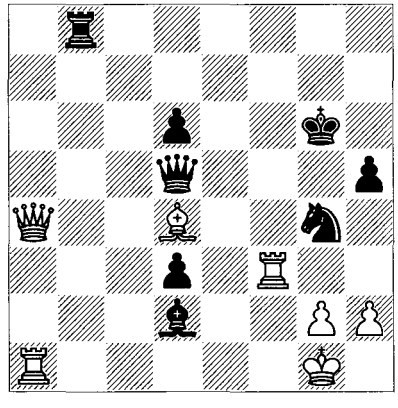
Should Black defend with 53...♖e7, exchange the rooks, or go over to the counterattack?

527
B



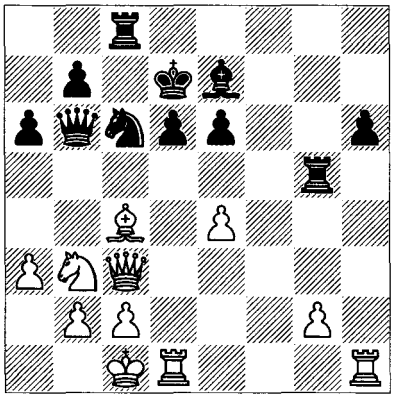
After 34...♔e6? 35 ♘c5+ ♔f7 36 ♗xb4 Black was lost and resigned. How could he have defended better?

528
B



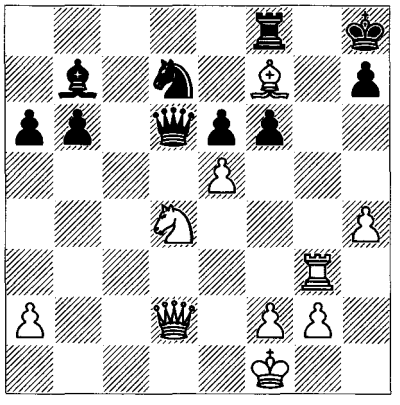
Black played 31...♗b4 and after 32 ♖xd3 ♕e4 33 ♕d1 he resigned. How can his defence be improved?

529
B



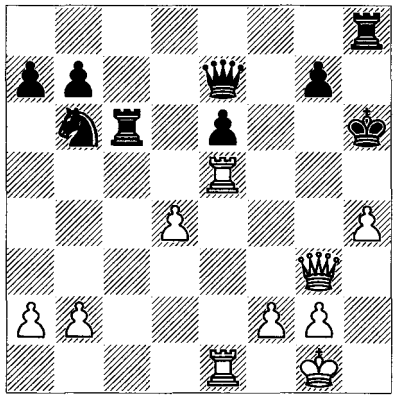
Should Black become active with 23...♕f2, or should he think about defence first?

530
B



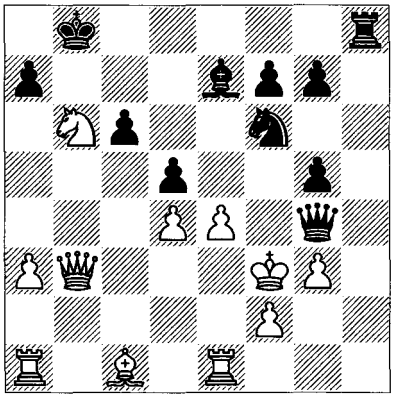
The game went 23...♘xe5? 24 ♗xe6 f5?! 25 ♖g7!! ♗e4 26 ♕h6 f4 27 ♕f6! 1-0. How could Black have improved his defence?

531
B



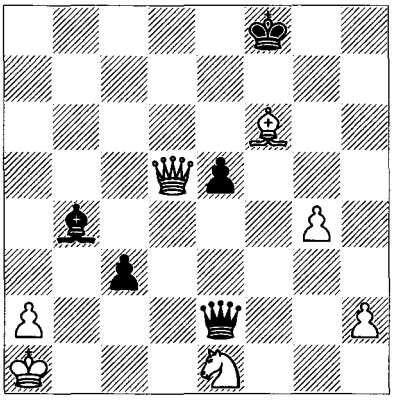
27...♕f6? ran into 28 ♕g4!, threatening both ♖xe6 and mate on h5. How can Black defend better?

532
W



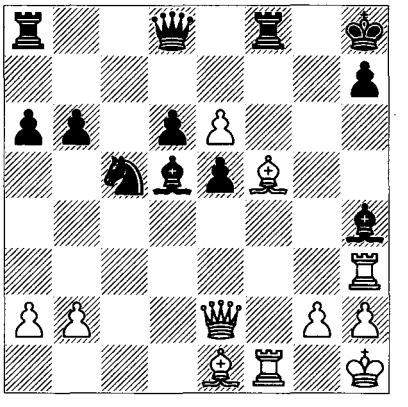
White is a rook up. Can he play for a win or does he have to content himself with a draw after 23 ♔g2 ♕h3+ 24 ♔f3?

533
W



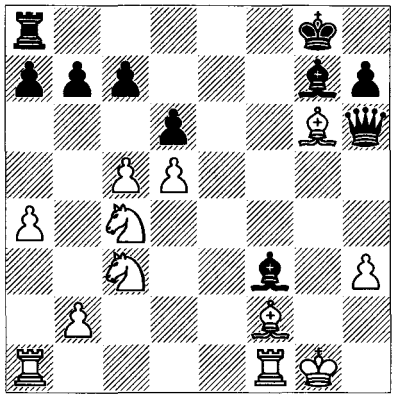
White gave perpetual check with 37 ♕d8+ ♔f7 38 ♕d5+ ♔f8 39 ♕a8+ ♔f7. What better continuation did he have?

534
B



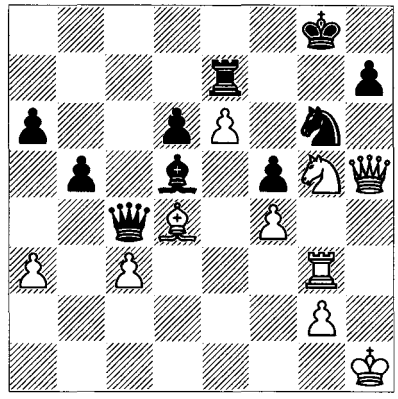
Black lost quickly after 23...♖g8? 24 ♗xh4! ♖xg2 25 ♕xg2 ♗xg2+ 26 ♔xg2. What should he have played?

535
W



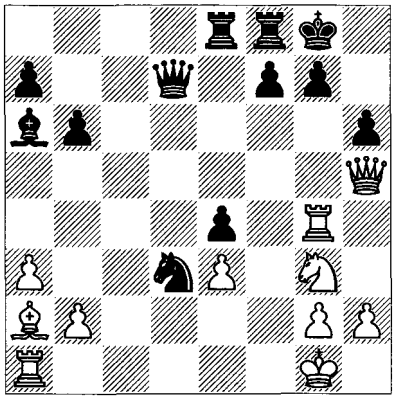
White's king position is very weak, but there is a way to escape unscathed; how?

538
B



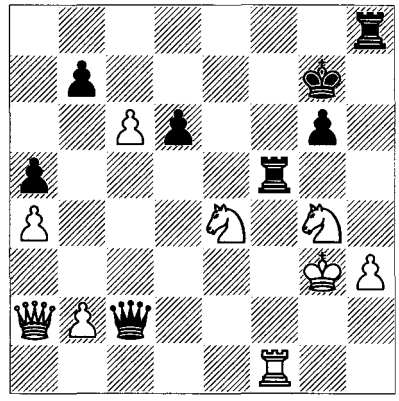
How can Black defend against the multiple threats against his king's position?

536
B



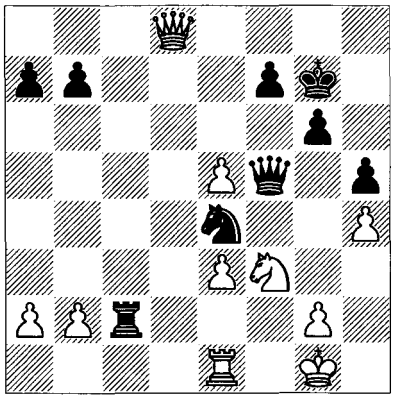
White exerts some pressure on the kingside, which was shown by 25...♖e5? 26 ♕g6! 1-0. How should Black defend?

539
W



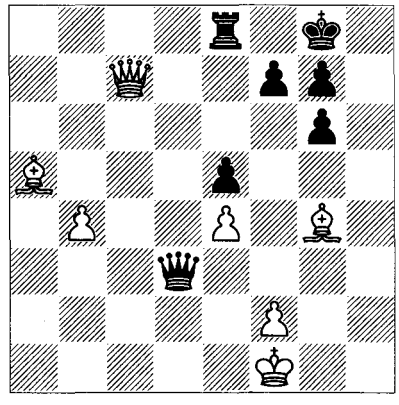
White has a material advantage but his king is exposed, and his queen is a long way away. How should White defend?

537
W



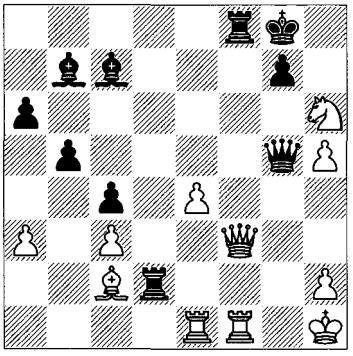
White is a pawn up, but the black pieces are very active and White's king position is weak. How should White defend?

540
W

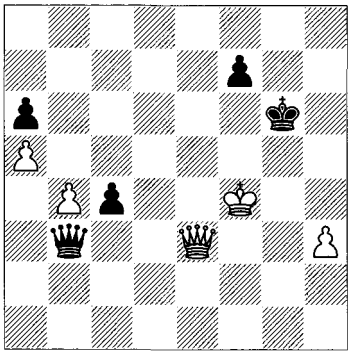


Your task here is to find a highly plausible but disastrous move for White, and show what is wrong with it.

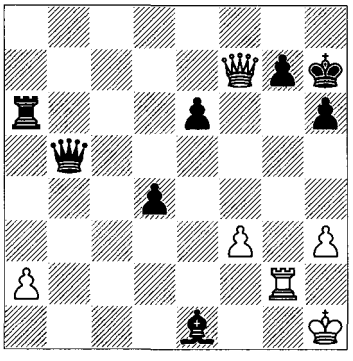
541
B



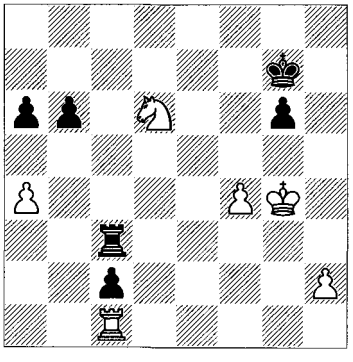
542
B



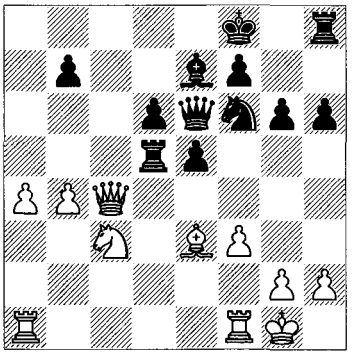
543
B



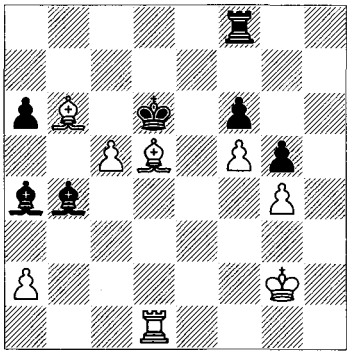
544
B



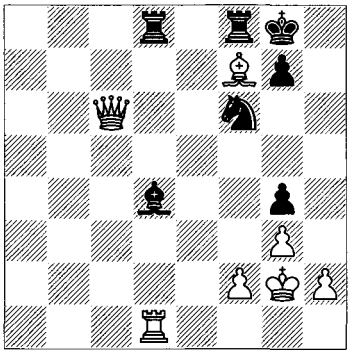
545
B



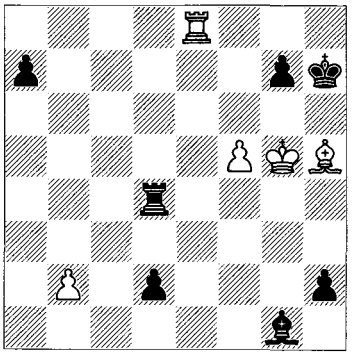
546
B



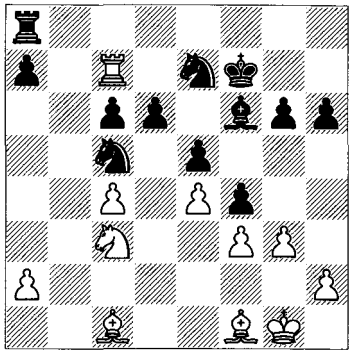
547
B



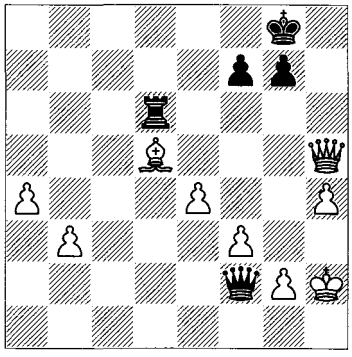
548
B



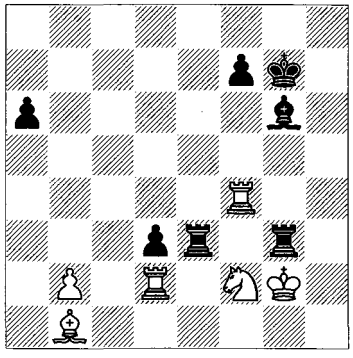
549
B



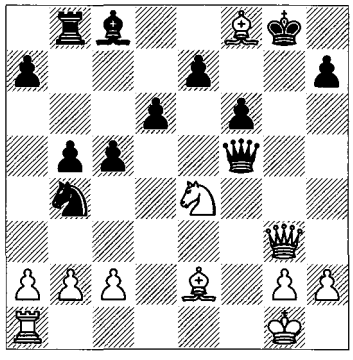
550
B



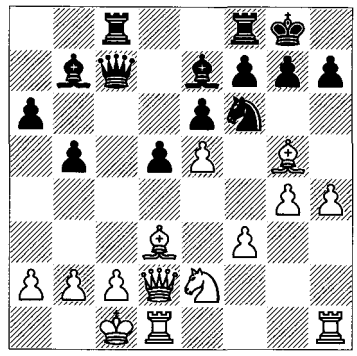
551
W



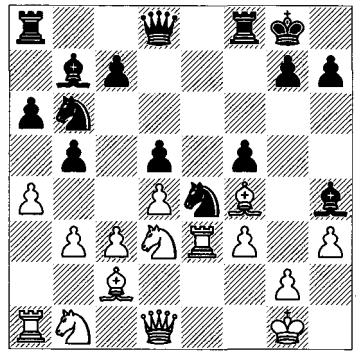
552
B



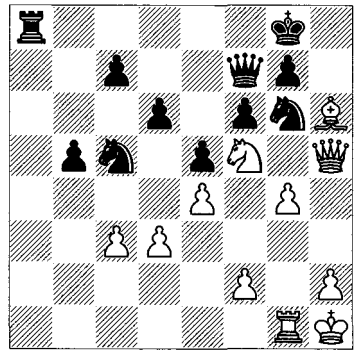
553
B



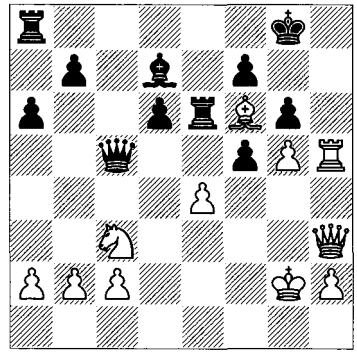
554
B



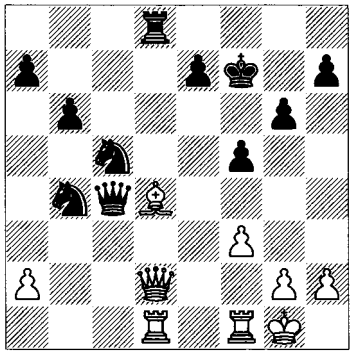
555
B



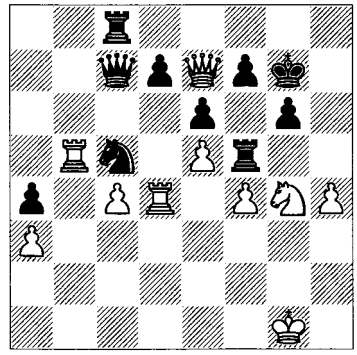
556
B



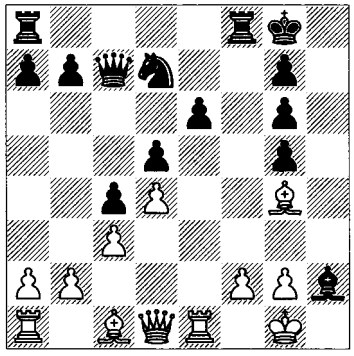
557
W



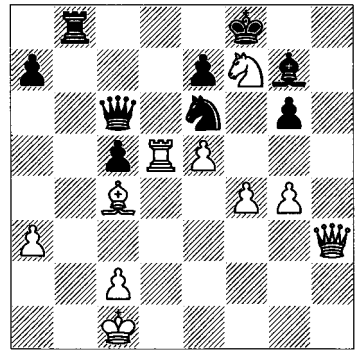
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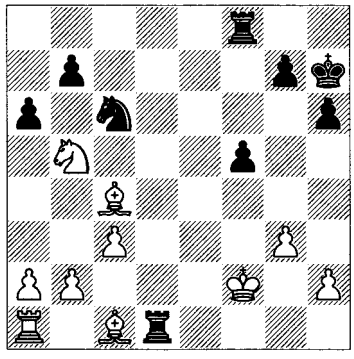
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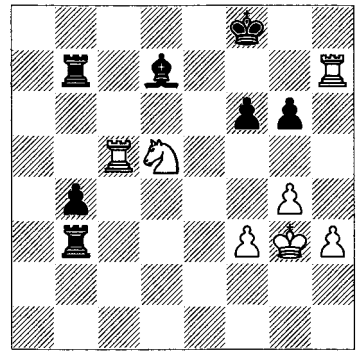
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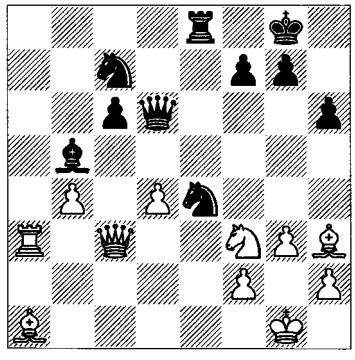
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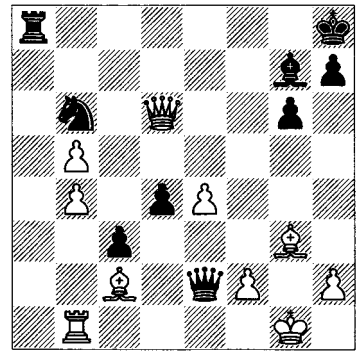
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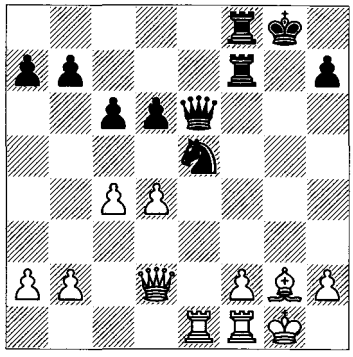
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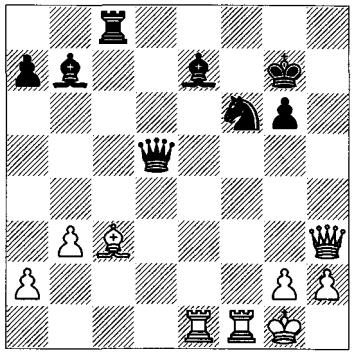
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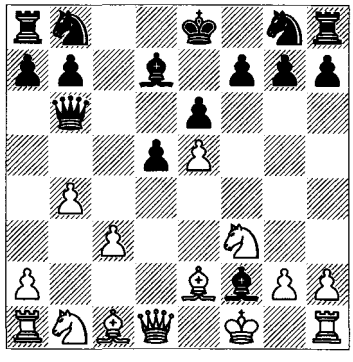
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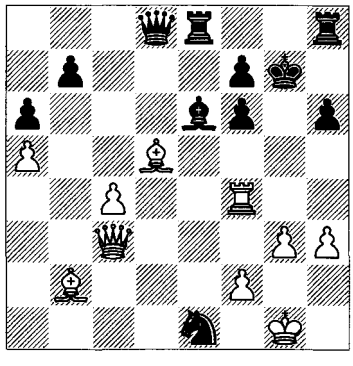
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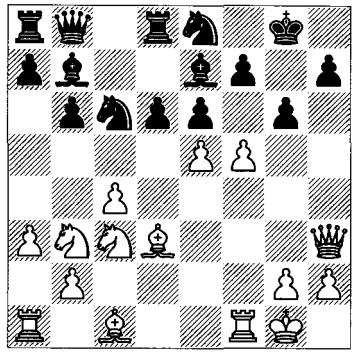
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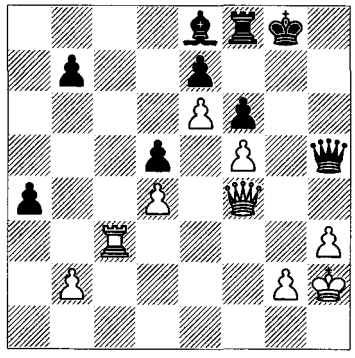
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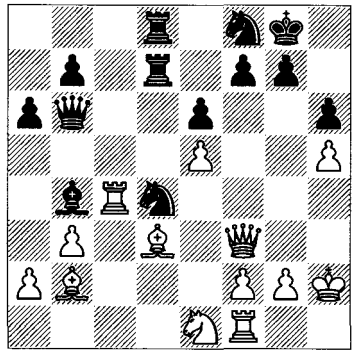
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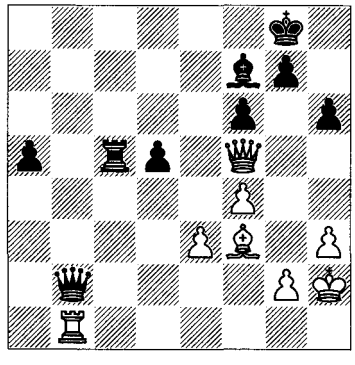
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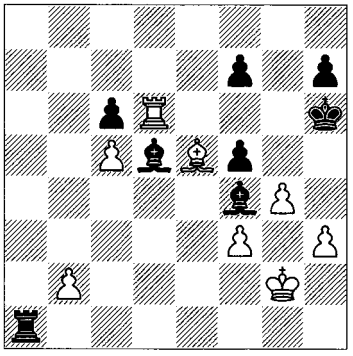
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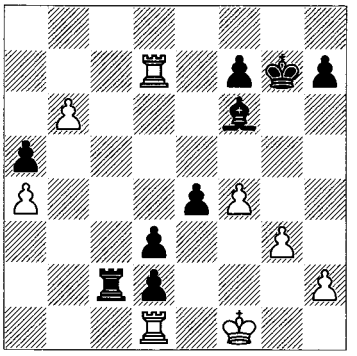
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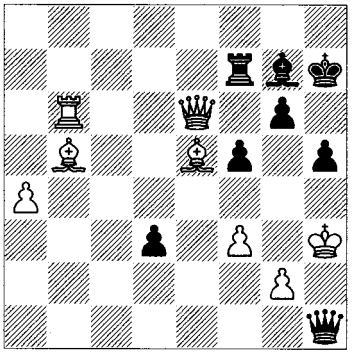
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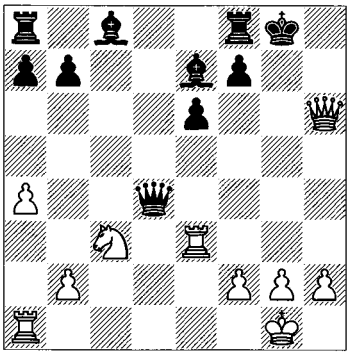
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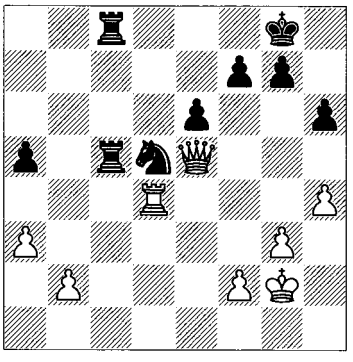
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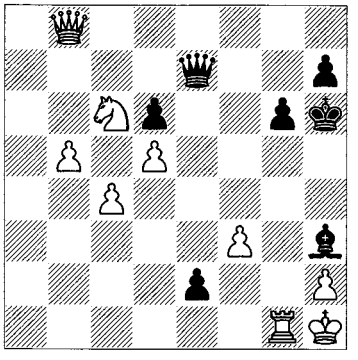
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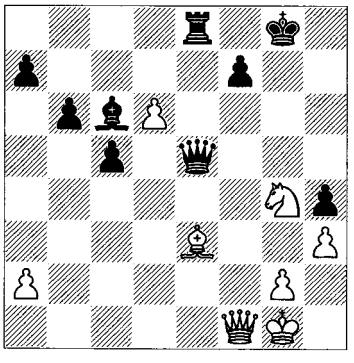
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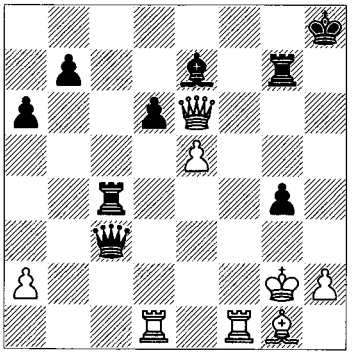
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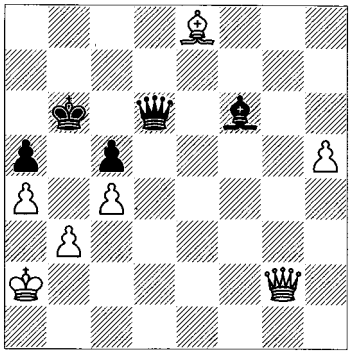
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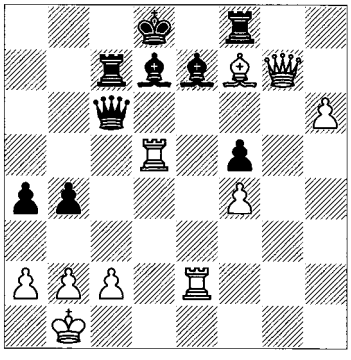
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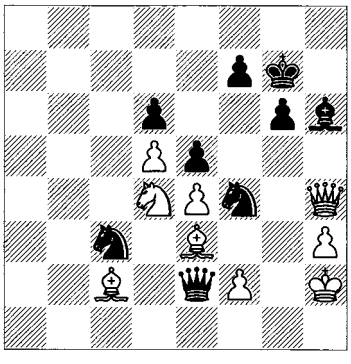
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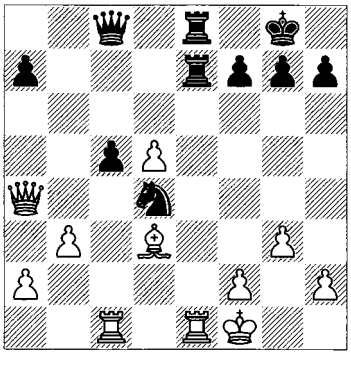
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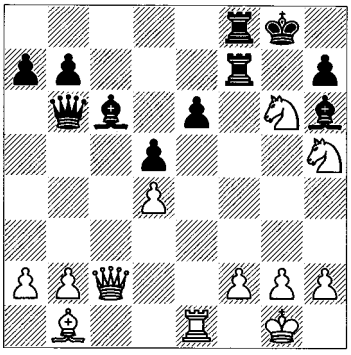
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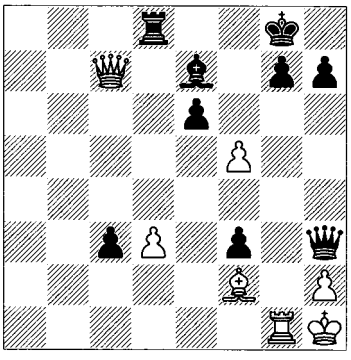
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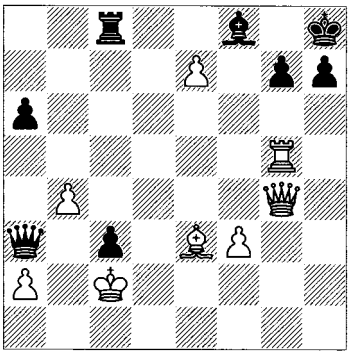
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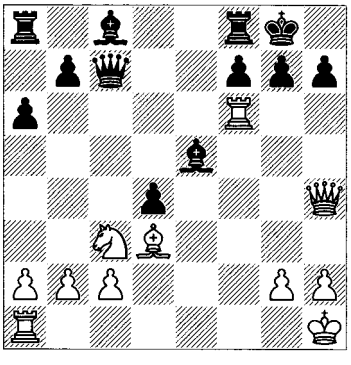
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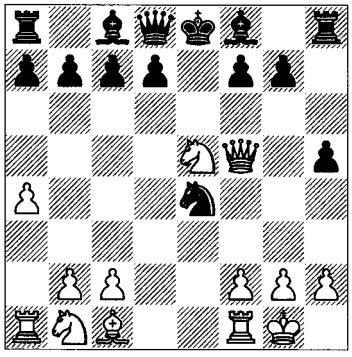
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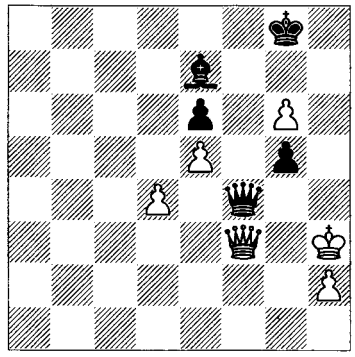
588
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589
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590
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Answers for Chapter 6

501) Álvarez del Monte – Spassky
Mar del Plata 1960

24...♕f2! 0-1

This threatens 25...♖e1+ as well as the f5-bishop, and if 25 g4 then, amongst other things, Black has 25...♖e1+ 26 ♖xe1 ♕xe1+ 27 ♔g2 bxc3 28 bxc3 ♖b8.

502) Naiditsch – Anand
Dortmund 2003

33...♖e8! 0-1

The queen has no escape.

503) Carlstedt – Bracker
Hamburg 2007

36...♗f1+! 37 ♔xf1 ♕b5+! 38 ♔g2 ♖xc3 0-1

504) Gómez – Lorenzo
Monforte de Lemos 2008

35...♕f2!

Counterattack! The black king does not need extra protection.

36 ♖h8+ ♔g6 37 ♕xc4 ♕xf3+ 38 ♔g1 ♘g4 39 ♕d4 axb4 40 ♖g8 f6 41 axb4 ♖a2

and Black won quickly.

505) Caruana – Sashikiran
Pamplona 2008

30...♗d5!

Dealing with the threat of 31 ♕d8+. Black's great advantage in material is now decisive.

31 ♖xd5

If 31 ♗xh8 Black can play 31...♕c5, simplifying.

31...exd5 32 ♕e5+ ♔f8 33 ♗xh8 ♕d4+ 0-1

506) Konguvel – Abbasov
La Fere 2008

62 ♔c5?

Walking into a mating-net. Necessary and satisfactory was **62 ♔c3!** ♗c6 63 ♖f5.

62...♖g6! 63 b5 a5! 64 ♖f5

Or 64 b6 ♖c6+ 65 ♔b5 ♖d6+ and 66...♖xd3.

64...♖d6! 0-1

507) Berczes – Ilinčić
Budapest 2008

42...♖a1!

42...♔xg5? loses to 43 ♖xf7 ♗xf7 44 ♕e5+.

43 ♕xa1 ♕xc7 44 ♕f6+ ♘g6 45 ♖xg6+ hxg6 46 ♕xe6 ♕c1+ 47 ♔h2 ♕f4+ 48 ♔h1 d4

with a slight advantage to Black.

508) Donaldson – Becerra
Internet 2008

32...♕c6!

Threatening not only to capture on g2 and then invade on f3, but also played with the idea of infiltrating via c4.

33 ♕d7

33 b3 ♖h1 34 ♕d4 loses to 34...b5! planning to take on g2 but first preventing ♕c4; this is better than 34...♗xg2 35 ♕d3+ g6 36 e4 ♗xe4 37 ♕c4.

33...♕c4 34 ♖e2 ♗d3 35 b3 ♕e4 0-1

509) Bahamonde – Corte
Argentine Ch, Buenos Aires 1946

Both sides should be content with a draw, but the game went **36 ♕b8+ ♔h7 37 ♕xb7? ♖xg4+ 38 ♘g3 ♖xg3+! 39 fxg3 ♕xg3+ 0-1**.

White should have played **37 ♕h2+**, when Black's best is to acquiesce to the draw with 37...♔g8 38 ♕b8+, but not 37...♔g6?, which allows White to defend and create a winning counterattack by 38 ♘h4+ ♔f6 39 ♕d6+ ♖e6 40 ♕d8+ ♖e7 41 ♕xb6+ ♖e6 42 ♕d4+ ♖e5 43 ♖b1.

510) Pachman – Pilnik
Mar del Plata 1962

55...♖xg7! 56 ♖xg7 ♕d4+ 57 ♔f1 ♕xg7

and after a long struggle the game ended in a draw.

511) Hector – Brynell
Swedish Ch, Växjö 2008

The game went:

62...♕f5?

Black can draw by perpetual check with **62...♕c2+!** 63 ♔g3 ♕c7+ 64 ♔h3 ♕d7+ 65 ♔h2 ♕c7+ 66 g3 ♕c2+, since 67 ♔h3?? loses to 67...♕f5+.

63 ♕xa3 ♕c2+ 64 ♔g1 ♕b1+ 65 ♔h2 ♕b8+ 66 g3 ♕d8 67 ♕a7+

and White was able to play for a win, which he achieved in the end.

512) Milov – Arnold
Philadelphia 2008

21...♗d6!

Preventing White's key move. 21...fxe6? 22 ♕e5 ♗f6 23 ♕xe4 achieves nothing tangible.

22 ♘f4 ♖xe6 23 ♘xe6 fxe6

with a material advantage.

513) Pap – Asís

Barberá del Valles 2008

29...♖xg5! 30 ♘xg5 ♖xh4+ 31 ♔g2 ♗xg5 with material superiority.

514) Inarkiev – Wang Hao

China vs Russia, Ningbo 2008

43 ♔g3?

Letting a whole point slip away. White wins with **43 ♔e3!** ♖e2+ 44 ♔d4 ♖d2+ 45 ♔c3, followed by 46 ♖b8+ or 46 ♖xh7.

43...♖xb3+ 44 ♔f4 ♖f2+ 45 ♘f3

If 45 ♔g5 then 45...♖g2+! 46 ♘g4 (or 46 ♔h4 g5+ 47 ♔h5 ♖h3#) 46...♖xg4+ 47 ♔xg4 ♗e2+.

45...♖fxf3+ 46 ♔e5 ♗d7 47 f7+ ♔e7 48 f8♕+ ♔xf8 49 ♖xd7 ♖f7 0-1

515) Huschenbeth – Albadri

Dresden Olympiad 2008

Yes, **29...f6!** wins a piece: **30 ♘g6 e5 31 ♘xe5 fxe5 32 ♗xe5 ♕c5 33 ♗d4 ♗c7 34 ♕g4 ♕g5**.

516) Hoang Thanh Trang – Le Thanh Tu

Dresden Women's Olympiad 2008

More tenacious was **37...♕d3!**, attacking the c2-rook, and after 38 ♖xc6 (38 ♕xc7 ♕xc2 39 ♘xc6 bxc6; 38 ♖c1? ♕d2!; or 38 ♕f2 ♕xa3) 38...♖xc6 39 ♘xc6 bxc6 40 ♕xc6 ♕f5 Black can still fight.

517) Pilnik – Guimard (variation)

Mar del Plata 1962

The problem is not 22...♘g6? 23 ♖h3 ♘f8 24 ♕xf6+ ♔g8, and now there is a choice between 25 ♕h6!, 25 bxa3! and 25 ♕g5+ ♘g6 26 ♕h6!, all of them winning. The snag is **22...♕xf2+!** 23 ♔xf2 ♗c5+ and Black regains the queen with a winning material advantage.

518) Striković – Franco

Cadiz 1991

There is a draw by **36 ♘g6+!** hxg6 37 ♕h3+ ♔g7 38 ♕d7+ and the king can't escape with 38...♔f6 in view of 39 ♕xd6+! ♔g5 40 ♕g3+ ♔h6 41 ♕h2+ ♔g7 42 ♕c7+ and White secures a draw.

519) Milos – Krush

Buenos Aires 2003

Black wins with **34...♘xg5!**. The double check is not to be feared, since after 35 ♘f7++ ♔g7 36 ♘xg5 Black wins with 36...♖g4+.

520) Putzbach – Kempinski

Hamburg 2007

23...e5! is correct; the gain of material gives Black the advantage, viz. **24 fxe5 ♕xh3 25 ♕xf7+ ♔h8 26 ♕xb7** (26 e6 is refuted by 26...♗xd4+ 27 ♘xd4 ♕e3+ 28 ♔h1 ♕xd4 29 e7 ♘d7 30 exd8♕ ♖xd8 31 ♕e7 ♘c6) **26...♘xd3 27 cxd3 dxe5** with a decisive material advantage.

521) Ignacz – Estremera

Pamplona 2007

No, there is not enough compensation after 15...♘fxe4? 16 ♘xe4 ♘xe4 17 ♕xe4 f5 18 ♕c2 f4 (if 18...e4 White can simply play 19 ♘e1) 19 ♘g5! g6 20 ♘e4! ♗f5 (20...fxe3 21 ♘f6+ ♔f7 22 fxe3!) 21 ♘f6+ ♔g7 22 ♘xe8+ ♖xe8 23 ♕c3, with a material advantage.

The game went **15...a4! 16 ♗xc5 ♗xc5 17 ♘xa4 ♖xa4! 18 ♕xa4 ♘xe4 19 ♖dd1 ♕b6!**, as we saw in Puzzle 356.

522) Zawadzka – Ushenina

Dresden Women's Olympiad 2008

The game went **32 ♕xg6+? ♔d7 33 ♕g7 ♘xe4 34 ♖f7 ♕b6+ 35 ♔h1 ♕d6 36 ♖f1 ♘g3+ 37 ♔g1 ♕b6+ 0-1**.

It is possible to defend with **32 ♖b1!** ♘xh3+ (not 32...♕xc3? 33 ♕g8+ ♔d7 34 ♖b7+ ♔d6 35 ♕d8+ ♔e5 36 ♕h8+ and White wins) 33 ♔h1! ♘f2+ 34 ♔g1 ♖d1+ 35 ♖xd1 ♘xd1 36 ♕h8+ ♔d7 37 ♕d4+ ♔e8 38 ♕h8+, drawing.

The move-order **32 ♕h8+!** ♔d7 33 ♖b1! also works.

523) Najdorf – Czerniak

Buenos Aires 1945

Not 27...gxf6? because of 28 ♕xh6, threatening 29 ♖g3+, and if 28...♖g4, then 29 ♖h3 wins.

27...♖e2! is very strong: 28 ♕f4 (staying on the c1-h6 diagonal; if 28 ♕c3 Black can defend with 28...gxf6! 29 ♕xf6 ♕d6 30 ♖g3+ ♔f8) 28...♖8e4! 29 ♕g3 ♗h5! (threatening the rook as well as 30...♖g4) 30 ♖f2 (if 30 ♔f1 one way to win is 30...♖g4! 31 ♕h3 ♕e8 32 ♗c3 ♖exg2, and Black gains a decisive material

advantage) 30...♖xf2 31 ♔xf2 ♕xf5+, winning.

524) Franco – Romero

Spanish Team Ch, Matalascañas 1993

Yes, in fact **26 ♗xa6!** is the best move; the game continued:

26...♘h3

After 26...♘xg2 27 ♘e2! gxh2 28 ♗xh2 ♗g4 29 ♘g3 White has enough defenders and an extra piece.

27 ♘f1!

Overprotecting h2.

27...♖xf1

If 27...♘f2+ then 28 ♗xf2 is playable.

28 ♕xf1 ♘xg1

28...♘f2+ 29 ♖xf2 is no better.

29 ♕xg1 ♗xa6 30 h3

with a decisive advantage.

525) Visier – Franco

Cañete 1994

21...♕xb7!

This sacrifice of queen for rook and piece is winning, since the passed c-pawn is very strong.

22 ♘f6+ ♗xf6 23 ♗xb7 ♖c7 24 ♗g2 c3 0-1

The c3-pawn costs White at least a piece.

526) Sandipan – Simutowe

Leiden 2008

Black lost after **53...♖d2? 54 ♕c8+ ♔a5 55 ♕c6 a6 56 ♕xe4**, although here 56 ♖g6! leads to a quick mate.

53...♕xg1? loses to 54 ♕xd7 (threatening 55 ♕d3+, amongst other things) 54...♕e3 55 f5 and Black can't both defend his king and prevent the advance of White's passed pawn; e.g., 55...♕f4 56 ♕c8+ ♔a5 57 ♕b7 a6 58 ♕xe4! ♕xe4 59 ♗c3+.

It is essential to defend the second rank with **53...♖e7!**, when White is better but Black can still fight; e.g., 54 ♕c8+ (54 ♖c1 is interesting) 54...♖b7 55 ♕e8 (not 55 ♖g7? ♘d6) 55...♘d6 56 ♕g6 ♕xf4!? 57 ♕e6 ♕d2 58 ♖g6 ♕xc2 59 ♕xd6 c4 60 ♖g3 cxb3+ 61 ♖xb3 ♖c7.

527) Hector – Lindberg

Swedish Ch, Växjö 2008

After **34...♖e2!** Black is even a little better; e.g., 35 ♖c5+ ♔e4 36 ♖c4+ ♔d3 37 ♖d4+ ♔c2 38 ♖c4+ (better than 38 ♘c5? ♖xd2 39 ♖c4+ ♔d1 40 ♖xb4 {40 ♘xb7? b3} 40...♗g2+ 41 ♔g3 a3) and instead of repeating moves Black can play 38...♔b1 39 ♖xb4 axb3 40 ♖xb3+ ♔xa2 41 ♖xb7 ♖xd2.

528) Tiviakov – Jepson

Elsinore 2008

Not with 31...♖b4?? 32 ♕e8+.

It is essential to defend the d3-pawn and control e8 with **31...♕e4!**, when Black has a good game; e.g., 32 ♖af1 (better than 32 h3?! ♖b4! 33 ♕a7 ♕xd4+ 34 ♕xd4 ♖xd4 35 hxg4 hxg4 36 ♖f8 ♗c3, with advantage to Black) 32...♗e3+ 33 ♖xe3 ♘xe3 34 ♖f6+ ♔g5 35 ♕a5+ ♘d5 36 ♕d2+ ♘f4 37 h4+ (not 37 ♖xf4? ♕xf4 38 h4+ {38 ♗e3?? ♖b1+} 38...♔f5 39 ♕xd3+ ♕e4, when Black wins) 37...♔g4 38 ♖xf4+ ♕xf4 39 ♕xd3, when the most probable result is a draw.

529) B. Savchenko – Aagaard

Elsinore 2008

Black played **23...♕f2?**, which walked into **24 ♗xe6+!**, with a decisive advantage to White: **24...♔xe6 25 ♕h3+ ♔e5 26 ♖d5+ ♔xe4** (no better is 26...♔f6 27 ♖xg5 ♕f4+ 28 ♘d2 ♕xg5 29 ♕xc8) **27 ♕d3+ ♔f4 28 ♖h4+ ♕xh4 29 ♕f3# (1-0)**.

Black needs to overprotect e6 with **23...♘d8!** 24 ♕d3 (24 ♖xh6 allows 24...♖gc5!, showing another virtue of 23...♘d8) and now one possible line is 24...♕f2!? 25 ♖d2 ♕g3 with a balanced game, since 26 ♖xh6?! can be answered with 26...♕xd3 27 ♗xd3 ♖g7!, followed by 28...♗g5, winning the exchange.

530) Werle – Wells

Staunton Memorial, London 2008

With **23...♕xe5!**:

a) If 24 ♗xe6 it is now possible to play 24...♘c5! and Black is not worse; e.g., 25 ♕h6 ♘xe6 26 ♘xe6 ♕a1+ 27 ♔e2 ♕xa2+ 28 ♔f1 ♖f7 (or 28...♕b1+) 29 ♖g7 ♕b1+ 30 ♔e2 ♕f5 (or 30...♗d5) 31 ♔f1 with a draw.

b) 24 ♗g6 ♗e4 25 ♗xe4 ♕xe4 26 ♖e3 ♕xh4 27 ♘xe6 ♖c8 28 ♕xd7 ♖c1+ 29 ♔e2 ♕g4+ 30 ♖f3 ♕c4+ 31 ♖d3 ♕e4+ with a draw.

531) Tkachev – Svidler

Blitz World Ch, Almaty 2008

Black can resist by expelling the e5-rook from its strong position and bringing the knight across to defend with **27...♘d7!**. After 28 ♖5e4 ♖b6! (not 28...♕f7?, which loses to 29 d5!

exd5 30 ♖e7) 29 h5 ♕f7 Black has no serious problems. Things are easier for Black if the white rook releases its pressure on e6; e.g., 28 ♖b5 ♖b6!? (or 28...♘f8) 29 h5 ♕f6 30 ♕e3+ ♔h7 31 ♖g5 ♖f8, or 28 ♖g5 ♕f7.

532) Buhmann – Shirov

Dresden Olympiad 2008

White should be content to draw. The game went **23 ♔e3?** and Black's attack won:

23...♕xe4+ 24 ♔d2 ♕xd4+ 25 ♔c2 ♕xf2+! 26 ♔d1

No better is 26 ♔d3 ♕f5+ 27 ♔c3 ♘e4+! 28 ♖xe4 ♗f6+ 29 ♖d4 ♕f3+ 30 ♔c2 ♕xb3+ 31 ♔xb3 ♗xd4; neither is 26 ♗d2 axb6! 27 ♖xe7? ♕c5+.

26...♕d4+ 27 ♗d2 axb6

Black has four pawns for the exchange and furthermore the white king is in difficulties.

28 ♖xe7 ♖h1+ 29 ♔c2 ♖xa1 30 ♕c3 ♖a2+ 31 ♔c1 ♖xd2 0-1

533) Fedorov – Wang Hao

Dresden Olympiad 2008

37 ♕b3! is practically winning:

a) After 37...♕xe1+ 38 ♕b1 the black queen is unable to protect the b4-bishop, and following 38...♕xb1+ 39 ♔xb1 e4 40 ♗d4 White will soon win another pawn, with a won ending.

b) It is more tenacious to play on a piece down, although after 37...♗c5 38 ♗h4! ♕xg4 39 ♕b8+ (or 39 ♗g3 ♗d4 40 ♔b1 ♕e2 41 a4 e4 42 ♘c2, when White should gradually be able to exploit his material advantage) 39...♔f7 40 ♕b7+! ♔g6 41 ♕g2 ♔h5 42 ♕xg4+ ♔xg4 43 ♗g3 e4 44 ♔b1 White should win.

534) Caruana – Kveinys

Dresden Olympiad 2008

Black should reduce White's attacking potential with **23...♗xe6!** and after 24 ♗xh4 ♕d7 25 ♗xe6 ♕xe6 26 ♖hf3 ♘d7! the greatest dangers have disappeared and Black is fine.

535) Halkias – Arakhamia

Dresden Olympiad 2008

White can defend successfully, retaining his material advantage, with **28 ♗f7+!** ♔xf7 29 ♗g3 ♕h5 30 ♘d2 ♗xc3 31 bxc3 ♕xd5 32 ♖xf3+ ♔g8 and now he has a choice between 33 ♖f2, 33 ♗f4 and 33 cxd6 ♕xd2 34 dxc7, which looks the most promising. Instead he lost after **28 ♗g3? ♖f8!**.

536) Ståhlberg – Guimard

Match (game 1), Buenos Aires 1945

25...♔h8? 26 ♖xg7! (or 26 ♘f5) 26...♔xg7 27 ♘f5+ is not the right way.

Instead Black can prevent ♘f5 and make life difficult for the attacker with **25...♗c8!**:

a) If 26 h3 Black can play 26...♔h8 27 ♖f1 (27 ♖xe4 ♖xe4 28 ♘xe4 is strongly met by 28...♕e7! 29 ♗d5 f5 30 ♘f2 ♕xe3) 27...♕d6! 28 ♖g5 ♕e7!, evicting the white rook from the kingside.

b) 26 ♖h4 ♕c6 27 ♖f1 ♗e6! (neutralizing the power of the a2-bishop) 28 ♘xe4 f5 29 ♗xe6+ ♕xe6 30 ♘f2 ♘xf2 31 ♖xf2 ♕xe3, with a big advantage to Black.

537) Palac – Agrest

Dresden Olympiad 2008

35 ♕d1? (bringing pieces to the defence is a good idea but it has to work tactically, and here the punishment is immediate) **35...♖xg2+! 36 ♔xg2 ♕g4+ 37 ♔f1 ♕h3+ 38 ♔e2 ♕g2+ 0-1**. If 39 ♔d3 then 39...♘f2+.

Instead White can play **35 ♖f1!** since this creates pressure on f7 which helps him defend successfully. If now 35...♘g3 then 36 e4!? is interesting, deflecting the black pieces; e.g., 36...♘xe4 (or 36...♕f4 37 ♖e1 ♖xb2 38 e6! fxe6?? 39 ♕d4+ ♕f6 40 e5, or 36...♕xe4 37 ♕f6+ ♔g8 38 ♕d8+ with a draw) 37 ♘d4 ♕c8 (37...♖xg2+ only draws) 38 ♕xc8 ♖xc8 39 ♖e1. Worse is 35...♕g4?! 36 ♘e1 ♖e2 37 ♕e7! ♕e6 38 ♕xe6 fxe6 39 ♘d3, with a good endgame for White.

538) Gajewski – Mazé

Dresden Olympiad 2008

37...♕f1+!

By counterattacking! Black exploits tactical weaknesses in White's attacking set-up, such as the potential fork on the white queen on h5 and king (after a future ♔xg2).

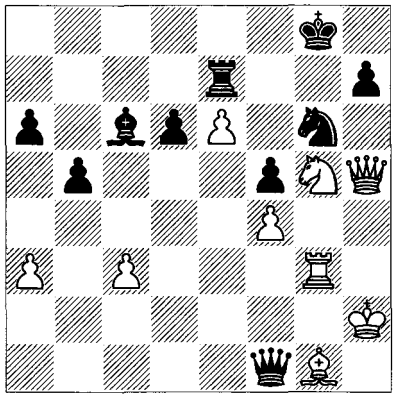
38 ♔h2 ♗xg2! 39 ♗g1

If 39 ♖xg2 then, as mentioned, Black has 39...♕xg2+ 40 ♔xg2 ♘xf4+ and this constitutes the main point of this exercise. Black had no better way to defend his position than by counterattacking, and now he has the advantage.

39...♗c6 *(D)*

39...♗d5! seems better, although at the board it would be almost impossible to grasp the difference. Let's examine a sample variation: 40

♘f7 ♖xe6 41 ♘h6+ ♔h8 42 ♗d4+ ♖e5 43 ♘f7+ ♔g7 44 ♗xe5+ dxe5 45 ♕h6+ ♔f6! 46 fxe5+ ♔e7 47 ♕g5+ ♔xf7 48 ♕f6+ ♔e8 and Black wins. But with the bishop on c6 this line would fail to 49 ♕xc6+.



40 ♘xh7?

40 ♘f7 gives White much better practical drawing chances. Although after 40...♖xe6 41 ♘h6+ ♔g7 42 ♗d4+ the move 42...♖f6! seems to favour Black to some degree, the variations are messy, and anything could have happened if this had arisen over the board.

40...♕e2+! 0-1

White resigned in view of 41 ♕xe2 ♖xh7+ 42 ♖h3 ♖xh3+ 43 ♔xh3 ♘xf4+.

539) Cámpora – Safin

Dresden Olympiad 2008

The game went **37 ♘ef2? ♕e2!** and White was lost – the mismatch of forces on the kingside is too great. **38 ♘h2** (38 ♕b3 ♕xf1 39 ♕xb7+ ♖f7 is no improvement for White) **38...♖hf8 39 ♕b3 ♖xf2 40 ♕c3+ ♔h7 0-1.**

With **37 ♕b1!** helping out the defence, White could hold on; e.g., 37...♕b3+ 38 ♘c3 ♕f7 39 ♖xf5 gxf5, and here it is reasonable to seek a draw with 40 ♕d1 (better than 40 ♕c1 ♕e7 41 ♘f2 bxc6, or 40 ♘f2 bxc6, and in both cases only Black can play for a win) 40...fxg4 41 ♕xg4+ ♔h7 (41...♕g6? loses to 42 c7! ♖c8 43 ♘d5 ♕xg4+ 44 ♔xg4 ♔f7 45 ♔f5) 42 ♕h4+.

540) McNab – Mastrovasilis

Dresden Olympiad 2008

The game went:

38 ♗e2?

Here 38 ♔g2 ♕xe4+ 39 ♗f3 ♕f5 40 b5, 38 ♔g1, or even 38 ♔e1, all lead to a balanced position, but not the move in the game, on account of...

38...♕h3+ 39 ♔g1

39 ♔e1 is met with the same response.

39...♖c8!

and Black wins.

541) Bielicki – Wexler

Mar del Plata 1960

37...♔h7! 0-1

Taking on h6 loses, but now there is no defence against 38...♖xh2#, among many other threats.

542) Bahamonde – Piro

Argentine Ch, Buenos Aires 1946

61...♕xb4??

A serious miscalculation; instead, the passed pawn is very strong after **61...c3**, and White should give perpetual check with, for example, 62 ♕g3+ ♔f6 63 ♕g5+ ♔e6 64 ♕f5+ ♔d6 65 ♕c5+ ♔d7 66 ♕a7+. Black can also simply retreat his king with a move such as **61...♔g7**, making ...♕xb4 a real threat. Then White may also have nothing better than giving perpetual check.

62 ♕b6+! ♕xb6 63 axb6 c3 64 ♔e3! ♔g5 65 b7 c2 66 ♔d2 1-0

543) Wilms – Fraas

Hamburg 2007

43...♗g3!

Defending against the mate threat and preparing a decisive counterattack.

44 ♖xg3 ♕f1+ 45 ♔h2 ♖xa2+ 0-1

544) Jacoby – Faika

Hamburg 2007

54...♖c6!

In order to advance the b-pawn quickly; the game continued:

55 ♘e4 b5 56 axb5 axb5 57 ♘d2 ♖c3 58 ♘e4 ♖c6 59 ♔f3 b4 60 ♘d2 b3 61 ♘xb3 ♖c3+ 62 ♔e4 ♖xb3

with an easily tenable endgame that ended in a draw.

545) Kuran – Estremera

Cesenatico 2007

21...♖d1!

Exchanging a pair of rooks reduces White's pressure.

22 ♕b5

White is a pawn down, so the endgame after 22 ♕xe6 ♖xf1+ 23 ♔xf1 fxe6 is worse for him.

22...♖xf1+ 23 ♔xf1

Or 23 ♖xf1 d5 mobilizing the centre pawns.

23...♔g7

Returning the pawn in order to go over to the counterattack.

24 ♕xb7 ♕c4+ 25 ♘e2 ♘d5 26 ♗d2 ♗g5 27 ♖c1 ♕d3 28 ♗xg5 hxg5 29 h3 ♖h4!

and Black's greater activity proved decisive.

546) D. Cramling – Mekhitarian

Santos 2008

42...♗xc5!

Equalizing the game; the discovered check is nothing to be afraid of. In contrast 42...♔e7? loses to, among other things, 43 ♖d4! a5 44 a3.

43 ♗b3+ ♔c6 44 ♗xc5 ♗xb3 45 ♗xf8 ♗xd1 46 ♔g3 ♔d7 ½-½

547) Azarov – Sharafiev

Nezhmetdinov Memorial, Kazan 2008

After **37...♔xf7? 38 ♕c4+ ♔g6 39 ♖xd4** it was White who had a big advantage.

Instead, **37...♖xf7!** is both necessary and good. After 38 ♕c4 ♗b6 39 ♖xd8+ ♗xd8 Black has a slight plus.

548) Banikas – Kosić

Dresden Olympiad 2008

61...♖g4+! 0-1

Preventing 62 ♗g6#. Now Black queens and wins after 62 ♗xg4 h1♕ or 62 ♔xg4 d1♕+.

549) R. García – Mecking

Rio Hondo Zonal 1966

27...♔e8!

The c7-rook is trapped.

28 ♗a3 ♔d8 29 ♗xc5 ♔xc7

and Black won.

550) Zelčić – Franco

Montecatini Terme 1998

40...♖g6! ½-½

The only way to save the game; after the forced move 41 ♕xg6 Black draws by perpetual check with 41...♕xh4+ 42 ♔g1 ♕e1+ 43 ♔h2 ♕h4+.

551) Franco – Amonatov

Turin Olympiad 2006

46 ♔h2!

'Playing to win' with 46 ♔f1?? walks into a surprise mate with 46...♖e1+! 47 ♔xe1 ♖g1#.

46...♖g5 47 ♗xd3 ♖h5+ 48 ♔g2 ♖g5+ 49 ♔h2 ♖h5+ 50 ♔g2 ♖g5+ 51 ♔h2 ½-½

552) Van der Weide – Engelbert

Hamburg 2007

In the game, **22...♕g6? 23 ♗xe7** gave Black no compensation for the piece, and he lost after **23...♕xg3 24 ♘xg3 1-0**.

Instead, **22...♔xf8!** was both necessary and good: 23 ♘xd6 ♕g6 24 ♕xg6 (24 ♕f4?! ♘xc2 sacrifices another pawn and if 25 ♘c4 ♖b7 26 ♘e5 then 26...♕g8!, followed by ...♘d4, is good for Black) 24...hxg6 25 ♘xc8 ♖xc8 with a slight advantage for Black.

553) Jaracz – Estremera

Porto San Giorgio 2006

16...♘e4!

Not 16...♘e8? 17 ♗xe7 ♕xe7 18 ♘d4 with advantage to White; the e8-knight stands badly.

17 fxe4 dxe4 18 ♗xe7 ♕xe7 19 ♖h3?! exd3 20 ♕xd3 ♖fd8 21 ♕e3 ♖xd1+ 22 ♔xd1 ♖d8+

with advantage to Black.

554) Huerga – Estremera

Melilla 2008

18...bxa4!

Retreating with 18...♘d6?! is better for White after 19 ♘c5!.

19 fxe4

19 bxa4 is met by 19...♘c4.

19...fxe4 20 ♖a3? exd3 21 ♕xd3 g6

Black has an extra pawn; furthermore the white pieces are badly coordinated.

555) Sega – Bachmann

Santos 2008

27...♘xd3!

The black knight's entrance into play refutes White's attack.

28 ♗e3

Intending to meet 28 ♗xg7? with 28...♘xf2+ 29 ♔g2 ♘f4+, while 28 ♘xg7 ♘xf2+ 29 ♔g2 ♖a2 is no better than the game.

28...♘df4 29 ♗xf4 ♘xf4 30 ♕h4 ♕c4 31 ♘g3 ♕d3 0-1

556) Coelho – Zambrana

São Paulo 2008

25...gxh5!

Forced, but winning.

26 ♕xh5 ♖xf6! 27 gxf6 ♕e3!
Controlling the vital squares g5 and h6.
28 ♘d5 ♕xe4+ 29 ♔f2 ♕d4+ 30 ♔e1 ♖e8+ 31 ♘e7+ ♖xe7+ 32 fxe7 ♕e3+ 0-1

557) Epishin – Cherin
Conegliano 2008
26 ♕h6!
This counterattack is decisive.
26...♖xd4
Also insufficient is 26...♔e8 27 ♕xh7! ♘cd3 (not 27...♖xd4? 28 ♕h8+) 28 ♕xg6+ ♕f7 29 ♕h6! and Black is the exchange down without any compensation and, with a weak king as well, his prospects are bleak.
27 ♕xh7+ ♔f6
Or 27...♔e6 28 ♕g8+ ♔f6 29 ♕h8+.
28 ♕h8+
White wins another exchange.

558) Santacaterina – Lavrić
Conegliano 2008
After **20 ♔f1? ♖xf2+!** White resigned in view of 21 ♔xf2 ♕g3+ 22 ♔f1 ♖f8+ 23 ♗f3 g4 24 ♖e3 ♕h4!, with ideas of 25...♗f4 or 25...♗g3.
20 ♔h1! is necessary, with good play after 20...♖ae8 21 ♗xe6+ ♖xe6 (not 21...♔h7? 22 ♕g4 ♘f6 23 ♕h3+ ♘h5 24 g4) 22 ♖xe6 ♖xf2 23 ♖e2.

559) S. Sokolov – Kharlov
Nezhmetdinov Memorial, Kazan 2008
The game featured **30 ♘d4? ♘xd4 31 cxd4 ♖c8!** followed by 32...b5, winning material.
30 ♘a3! is better for White, with the idea of ♘c2 and developing the c1-bishop; for example, 30...♘e5 31 ♗e2 ♘g4+ (31...♖h1 32 ♔g2 ♖e1 33 ♗f1 ♖d1 {33...♖d8 34 ♘c2} 34 ♘c2 g5 35 ♗e2 and the c1-bishop will be able to emerge) 32 ♔g2 ♖e1 33 ♗f3 ♘e5 34 ♘c2! ♘xf3 35 ♔xf3 ♖h1 36 ♔g2 ♖d1 37 ♗e3.
30 ♗e2! is also quite good for White.

560) Bogner – Wirig
Mulhouse 2008
27 ♕b2?
It was essential to protect the back rank by **27 ♕c1!**, with a playable position after 27...♕xb4 28 ♔g2.
27...♘g5! 0-1
Black wins after 28 ♘xg5 ♖e1+ 29 ♔g2 ♗f1+.

561) Kliuner – Gutman
Dortmund 2008
38...♘b3!
The c4-pawn is lost and White's position collapses.
39 ♖e4
Or: 39 ♕xd7 ♘xd4 40 ♕xd4 ♕xc4; 39 ♖xd7 ♕xc4 leads to mate.
39...♘d2 40 h5 ♘xe4 41 ♘f6 ♕xc4 0-1

562) Franco – Rossetto
Villa Gesell 1980
27...♕a4!
A winning zwischenzug, attacking the c4-bishop. In contrast, the immediate 27...♔xf7? allows White to seize the initiative with 28 f5.
28 ♕d3 ♔xf7 29 ♖d7
Now if 29 f5, Black has 29...♗h6+! 30 ♔d1 ♖b1+ 31 ♔e2 ♘f4+.
29...♔f8! 30 g5
30 ♗xe6 loses to 30...♕xf4+ 31 ♔d1 (worse is 31 ♕d2 ♕f1+ 32 ♕d1 ♗h6+) 31...♖b1+ with a decisive attack.
30...♘d4 1-0

563) Jonkman – Estremera
Cesenatico 2004
35...♗c6! ½-½
An elegant way to defuse the strong threat of 36 ♘xf6; a possible continuation is 36 ♘xf6 ♖xf3+ 37 ♔g2 ♖xf6+ 38 ♖xc6! ♖xc6 39 ♖xb7 ♖c4 with a drawn endgame.

564) Estremera – Tregubov
Gibraltar 2005
37 ♗e5!
This counterattack solves White's problems; in contrast, 37 ♕xb6? ♕xc2 38 ♖f1 ♕xe4 is better for Black.
37...♕xc2
37...♕g4+? 38 ♔f1! is better for White, who will win the b6-knight.
38 ♗xg7+ ♔xg7 39 ♕e7+
It's a draw by perpetual check.
39...♔g8 40 ♕e6+ ♔f8 41 ♕f6+ ♔e8 42 ♕e6+ ♔f8 ½-½

565) Franco – Miljanić
European Ch, Saint Vincent 2000
21...♖g7!
21...♘xc4? is bad because of 22 ♕c3 ♕g6 23 ♕xc4 d5 and now 24 ♕e2, intending to meet 24...♖g7? with 25 ♕e6+.

22 f4

22 dxe5 is met by 22...♖xg2+ 23 ♔xg2 ♕g4+ 24 ♔h1 ♕f3+ 25 ♔g1 ♕g4+.

22...♘xc4! 23 ♕c3 ♕f7

and Black is slightly worse, but he held out successfully.

566) Franco – Mateo

Capablanca Memorial, Havana 2001

29...♕c5+?

After **29...♖xc3!** the game ends in a draw by perpetual check; White has nothing better after 30 ♖xe7+ ♔f8 31 ♕h8+ ♔xe7 32 ♕xf6+ ♔d7 33 ♕g7+ ♔d6! 34 ♕f6+ ♔d7!.

30 ♔h1 ♖f8

If 30...♖c7 then one way to win is 31 ♗a1; e.g., 31...♕d6 32 ♖xe7+! ♖xe7 33 ♖xf6! ♕xf6 34 ♗xf6+ ♔xf6 35 ♕h4+ ♔f7 36 ♔g1.

31 ♕d7! ♗xg2+ 32 ♔xg2 ♕xc3 33 ♖xe7+ 1-0

567) Svidler – Shirov

León (rapid) 2004

10 ♕d2?

This allows Black to regroup. Instead, **10 c4!** (threatening 11 c5) is very strong, and Black then has to find the best way to give back some material; e.g., 10...♘c6 (10...dxc4? 11 ♘a3! a6 12 ♘xc4 ♕a7 13 ♘d6+ ♔e7 14 ♕d2; 10...♘h6 11 ♗xh6 gxh6 12 c5 ♕xb4 13 ♔xf2 and the piece outweighs the pawns) 11 c5 ♕xb4 12 ♔xf2 with advantage to White after 12...♘h6 13 ♗xh6 gxh6 14 g3.

10...♘h6! 11 ♗d3?

The position is still complicated after 11 a4!?, when 11...♘g4? loses to 12 a5 ♕c7 (12...♕e3 13 h3) 13 ♕g5!; similarly after 11 c4. But now White is lost.

11...♘g4! 12 ♕g5 ♗b5! 13 c4 ♗g3! 0-1

After 14 ♕d2 dxc4 15 hxg3 ♘c6 16 ♘c3 cxd3 White's position is in ruins.

568) Guerra – Franco

El Ferrol 2009

Black is a rook up, but the threats on f6 are so strong that he has to find a way to save the game.

35...♘d3?

This returns the material but does not enable Black to escape. Also insufficient is 35...♔f8? 36 ♕a3+! ♕e7 37 ♗xe6, when White has a strong initiative and soon regains all the sacrificed material with interest. The only satisfactory way is **35...♗xd5!** 36 ♖xf6 (36 cxd5? allows 36...♖e5) 36...♔f8! 37 ♖f4 (not 37 ♖g6?? ♘f3+ 38 ♔g2 ♘e5+) 37...♘f3+! 38 ♖xf3 ♗xf3 39 ♕xh8+ ♔e7 40 ♕f6+ ♔d7 41 ♕xf3 ♔c8 42 ♕xf7 ♖e1+ 43 ♔h2 ♕xa5, and the most probable result is a draw.

36 ♕xd3 ♗xd5 37 ♖g4+! ♔f8 38 ♗a3+ ♖e7 39 cxd5

The material is left equal, but the strong passed pawn and the bad placing of the black king make defence impossible.

39...♔e8 40 ♗xe7 ♔xe7 41 d6+ ♔f8 42 d7 1-0

569) Ivkov – A. Kovačević

Zlatibor 2008

18...exf5!

Not fearing ghosts!

19 ♘d5 dxe5!

The extra pawns form a wall, so White has to make further sacrifices.

20 ♖xf5

Or 20 ♗xf5 gxf5 21 ♕xf5 ♘d6 22 ♕h5 f5 23 ♗g5 ♖d7 24 ♗xe7 ♖xe7, and Black retains a material advantage.

20...♗c8! 21 ♗h6 ♗xf5 22 ♗xf5 gxf5 23 ♖f1 f4 24 ♘d2 ♕c8 25 ♕h5 ♕e6

and now White has no compensation.

570) Hebden – Høi

Oslo 2008

42...♗c6?

It is more important to contest the g-file and prevent White's following manoeuvre with **42...♔h8!** 43 ♖c7 (the idea is to answer 43 ♖g3? with 43...♖g8) 43...♕h7 44 ♖xb7 ♗c6 45 ♖b6 (45 ♖c7? ♗b5) 45...♖c8 46 ♕c1 ♗b7 47 ♕f4, with a possible draw.

43 ♖g3+ ♔h7 44 ♖g4 1-0

571) Brunello – Elianov

Elsinore 2008

28 ♕e4?

It is essential to restrain the strong d4-knight by pinning it with **28 ♕e3!**, and if 28...♗a5 then 29 ♗b1.

28...♗xe1! 29 ♖xe1

29 ♕xe1 is met by 29...♘xb3.

29...♘f5 30 ♗e2 ♕xf2

with an overwhelming advantage for Black.

572) Kariakin – Short

Rapid match (game 9), Kiev 2008

41...d4?

Black can stay in the game with **41...g6!** 42 ♕xg6+ ♗xg6 43 ♖xb2 a4 44 ♖b8+ ♔f7 45 ♖a8 ♗c2, and the struggle continues.

42 ♖xb2

The simplest; the artistic 42 ♗d5! also wins.

42...♖xf5 43 ♖b8+ ♔h7 44 ♗e4

and White wins.

573) Salgado – Camacho Collados

Padrón 2008

44...♗e6?

Almost equivalent to resigning; 44...♔g5? is no good either, since 45 h4+! ♔xh4 46 ♗xf4 threatens mate with 47 ♖h6#, but after 46...h5 47 gxh5 the passed pawn on h5 is decisive.

The best defence is **44...f6!**, solving the problem of the unsafe king, and after 45 ♗xf4+ ♔g7, followed by ...♖d1, Black has excellent defensive chances.

45 ♗xf4+ ♔g6 46 ♖xc6

White has two extra connected passed pawns; the rest was easy.

574) E. Lund – Tiviakov

Rønne 2008

The game ended **62 ♔g3? ♗xe5+ 63 ♕xe5 d2 64 ♕d5** (64 ♕e2 ♕e1+ 65 ♔h2 ♖e7! changes nothing) **64...f4+! 65 ♔f2 ♕e1# (0-1)**. White should play **62 ♗h2!** ♖f6 63 ♕e3, when Black can draw with 63...♖xb6 64 ♕xb6 d2 65 ♗e8 ♔h8 66 ♕b8 ♔h7 67 ♗xg6+ ♔xg6 68 ♕d6+ ♗f6 69 ♕xd2 ♗e5 70 f4 ♗f6 or 63...d2!? 64 ♖xf6! d1♕ 65 ♖xg6 ♔xg6 66 ♕e6+ ♗f6 67 ♗e8+ ♔h7 68 ♕f7+ ♗g7 69 ♕xf5+ ♔h8 70 ♕xh5+ ♔g8 71 ♗c6 ♕xh2+ 72 ♔xh2 ♕d6+.

575) Oleksienko – Margvelashvili

Kavala 2008

38...h5?

Missing a good chance: **38...♘f4+!** 39 ♕xf4 e5 40 ♕e3 exd4 41 ♕xd4 ♖c4 42 ♕d7 a4 and Black is not worse.

39 ♖d2

With a big material advantage to White.

576) Navara – Kamsky

FIDE Grand Prix, Sochi 2008

37...♕c3!

Putting pressure on the e3-bishop, which leaves White with little room to manoeuvre.

38 ♘h6+

38 ♕f2 ♖e6 39 ♔h2 is met by 39...♕g7, guarding for now all the squares to which the g4-knight might jump. Then after 40 ♕xh4 ♖xd6 (or 40...f5!?) White has insufficient compensation for exchange and pawn. Or if 38 ♘f6+ then 38...♔h8!.

38...♔h8! 39 ♘xf7+ ♔g7 40 ♗h6+

Or 40 ♗g5 ♗b5 41 ♕f4 ♖e1+ 42 ♔h2 ♕g3+ 43 ♕xg3 hxg3+ 44 ♔xg3 ♔xf7.

40...♔g6 0-1

There is no satisfactory defence against 41...♖e1.

577) Vehi – Muñoz Pantoja

Badalona 2008

41 b7?

'The king is a strong piece'; White must play **41 ♔f2!** ♖c1 42 ♖xd2 ♗c3 43 b7 ♖b1 44 ♖a2 ♔f6 45 ♖a3 and it is White who is playing for a win.

41...♖c1 42 b8♕ ♖xd1+ 43 ♔g2 ♖g1+! 44 ♔xg1 d1♕+ 45 ♔g2 ♕f3+ 46 ♔h3 h5 0-1

578) Sandipan – S. Ernst

Vlissingen 2008

18...♗h4?

Preventing 19 ♖g3+, but straying too far from the squares f6 and g7. It is possible to defend with **18...♗f6!** 19 ♖g3+ (not 19 ♘e4? ♗g7 20 ♖g3 f5 followed by 21...♗d7) 19...♗g7 20 ♖d1 ♕e5 21 ♖g5 f5 and the most probable result is a draw after, e.g., 22 f4 ♕c7 23 ♘b5 ♕e7 24 b4! ♗d7 25 ♖d3 ♖f6 26 ♖xd7 ♕xd7 27 ♕xf6 ♕d1+ and perpetual check.

19 ♘e4!

Threatening both to take the h4-bishop and to play 20 ♖g3+ ♗xg3 21 ♘f6+.

19...♖d8

After 19...f5 20 ♕xh4 fxe4? comes 21 ♕e7!, threatening 22 ♖g3+ ♔h8 23 ♖h3+ mating.

20 ♕xh4 ♕d1+ 21 ♖e1

With an extra pawn, an advantage in development and the black king exposed.

579) Dziuba – Deszczynski

Najdorf Memorial, Warsaw 2008

41...♕f6?

Instead, **41...♕e3!** is decisive, threatening both to queen and to play 42...♕xg1+, mating. If 42 ♕f8+ then 42...♔h5 43 ♖e1 ♕f2, while 42 ♖xg6+!? is met by 42...♔h5! 43 ♖h6+ ♕xh6! (and not 43...♔xh6? 44 ♕f8+ ♔h5 45 ♕f7+ with perpetual check) 44 ♕e8+ ♕g6, winning.

42 ♘d4! ♕xd4

Or42...♗f1 43 ♕e8! ♕xd4 44 ♕f8+ ♕g7 45 ♕f4+! g5 46 ♕xd6+ ♕g6 47 ♕e7 ♕f5 48 ♖g3, with the idea of ♔g1-f2.

43 ♕f8+ ♔h5 44 ♕e7! 1-0

580) Y. Vovk – Gritsak

Najdorf Memorial, Warsaw 2008

27 exd6?

White can draw with **27 ♕h6+!** ♔g8 28 ♕e6+ ♔h8 (after 28...♔h7?! the black king remains exposed, so 29 exd6! and now 29...♕h3+? 30 ♔h1 ♖c2 loses to 31 ♕e4+) and then 29 ♕h6+, but not 29 exd6? transposing to the game.

27...♕h3+ 28 ♔h1 ♖c2

Now White has no satisfactory way to meet the threat of 29...♕g2#.

29 ♗f2

29 ♖f2 loses to 29...♖xf2 30 ♗xf2 ♕f3+.

29...♕f3+ 30 ♔g1 ♖xf2! 31 ♖xf2 ♕xd1+ 32 ♔g2 ♕xd6

with an extra piece.

581) Tomczak – Ragger

World Junior Ch, Gaziantep 2008

62...♔a7!

Before moving his queen onto the long diagonal, Black evades a possible check on c6. Not 62...♕e5? right away in view of 63 ♕c6+ ♔a7 64 ♕d7+ ♔b8 65 ♕b5+, drawing.

63 ♗g6?

Black pays the price for his bishop being loose on e8 after 63 ♕c2 ♕e5 64 ♕c1 ♕xe8, with advantage to Black.

63...♕d4

Now it is forced mate.

64 b4 axb4 65 ♔b3 ♕c3+ 66 ♔a2 b3+ 67 ♔a3 ♕b4# (0-1)

582) Jobava – Hernández Carmenates

Barcelona 2008

34...♕f6??

It is necessary to move the king away with **34...♔c8!** and then if 35 h7 ♕f6! 36 ♕g8 Black can remind White that his own king is not safe either by playing 36...a3.

35 ♕xf8+! 1-0

583) A. Rasmussen – Postny

Dresden Olympiad 2008

51...♕f1!

A strong zwischenzug which deflects the white queen. After 51...exd4? the e3-bishop is activated and there is no more than a draw: 52 ♗xd4+ f6 (not 52...♔h7? 53 ♕f6) 53 ♕xf6+ ♔g8 54 ♕h8+ ♔f7 55 ♕h7+ ♔e8 56 ♕xh6 ♕f3 57 ♕h8+ ♔d7 58 ♕g7+, etc.

52 ♕g3

52 ♘f5+ is not dangerous either: 52...gxf5 53 ♕g3+ ♔f8, or even 53...♔f6, and White has no serious threats.

52...exd4

Now this is winning.

53 ♗xd4+

53 ♗xf4 ♗xf4 54 ♕xf4 also loses after 54...♘e2 55 ♕g4 ♕xf2+ 56 ♕g2 ♕f4+ 57 ♔h1 ♕c1+.

53...♔h7 54 ♗xc3 ♘e2 55 ♗d3 ♗f4 56 ♕xf4 ♕g1# (0-1)

584) Leko – Carlsen

Morelia/Linares 2007

28 g4!!

This surprising move prevents the check on h3, which is the priority. Even though it weakens White's king position (which is missing the d3-bishop) and looks inadvisable, it gives White the advantage, mainly thanks to Black's weak back rank, not forgetting that White is also a pawn up.

28...♖xe1+ 29 ♖xe1 ♖f8 30 h3

Now White must solidify his pawn-structure.

30...♕d8 31 ♗e4

The bishop returns to g2 to guard the king.

31...♕b6?! 32 ♗g2 g6 33 ♔g1 ♔g7 34 ♕d7!

and White combined his extra pawn with an attack on the king.

585) P. Carlsson – Timman

Malmö 2007

23...♕b4!!

A decisive counterattack, attacking the rook and covering the e7-square, so that he threatens 24...♖xf2. Now 24 ♘e7+? is no use because 24...♕xe7 defends h7. Instead, 23...hxg6?? leads to mate after 24 ♕xg6+ ♔h8 25 ♕xh6+ ♔g8 26 ♘f6+ ♖xf6 27 ♕h7#.

24 ♖xe6?

24 ♖e2 is better, with the possible continuation 24...♗b5! (but not 24...♖xf2? 25 ♘gf4! with advantage to White), winning material after 25 ♘xf8 ♗xe2 26 ♕xe2 ♗xf8.

24...♖xf2! 25 ♕d1

25 ♕xf2 ♖xf2 26 ♔xf2 ♕xb2+ costs White more material.

25...♖f1+! 26 ♕xf1 ♕xd4+ 0-1

586) Kogan – Babaev
Sort 2008

42...♔f8?

A losing blunder, whereas with **42...♗f6!** Black is better. After the forced line 43 ♖xg7+ ♗xg7 44 ♕xd8+ ♗f8 45 ♕g5+ he can play for a win with 45...♔f7 46 fxe6+ ♕xe6.

43 ♗c5! ♖e8 44 f6! f2 45 ♗xe7+ ♔g8 46 f7+! ♔xf7 47 ♗c5+ 1-0

587) Nijboer – Diamant
Vlissingen 2008

38...♕xa2+?

It is necessary to play **38...♕a4+!** to prevent the white king from escaping via d3 and e2: 39 ♔c1 (not 39 ♔d3? ♕d1+ 40 ♔e4 ♖e8! and Black wins) 39...♕a3+ 40 ♔c2 (40 ♔d1? c2+) 40...♕a4+ with a draw.

39 ♔d3 ♕b1+ 40 ♔e2 ♕c2+ 41 ♔e1 ♕b1+ 42 ♔f2 ♕b2+ 1-0

White plays 43 ♔g3 and there is no answer to the threat against the two black pieces.

588) Caprio – Tahirović
Conegliano 2008

17...h6?

The right move is **17...♖d8!**, preventing mate and defending the d5-square:

a) After 18 ♕xh7+ ♔f8 19 ♕h8+ ♔e7 Black is winning material and the sacrifice 20 ♖xf7+? ♔xf7 does not work; e.g., 21 ♖f1+ ♔e6 22 ♕h3+ ♔d6 23 ♘e4+ ♔c6.

b) 18 ♖e1 gxf6 19 ♕h6 is met by 19...f5!, threatening to complete his development. White cannot draw by 20 ♖xe5 ♕xe5 21 ♕g5+ ♔f8 22 ♕xd8+ in view of 22...♕e8! 23 ♕d6+ ♕e7 24 ♕xd4 ♕e1+, and Black wins.

18 ♘d5

The knight's entrance into the game is decisive.

18...♗xf6

18...♕d8 loses to 19 ♕e4 g6 20 ♕xe5.

19 ♕e4 ♗f5 20 ♕xf5 g6 21 ♕xf6 1-0

589) Recuero – Salgado
Padrón 2008

11...♕e7!

The natural 11...♘f6? loses to 12 ♘g6! fxg6 13 ♕xg6+ ♔e7 14 ♖e1+ ♔d6 15 ♕d3+ ♘d5 16 ♗f4+ ♔c5 17 ♕b5+ ♔d4 18 ♗e5#, while 11...♘d6?! leaves the black pieces very awkwardly placed after 12 ♕d3.

12 ♕xe4 d6 13 ♗f4 dxe5 14 ♗xe5 f6 15 ♕g6+ ♕f7 16 ♕xf7+ ♔xf7 17 ♗xc7 ♗f5 18 c3 g5

with good compensation for the pawn.

590) Morozevich – Kamsky
Tal Memorial, Moscow 2008

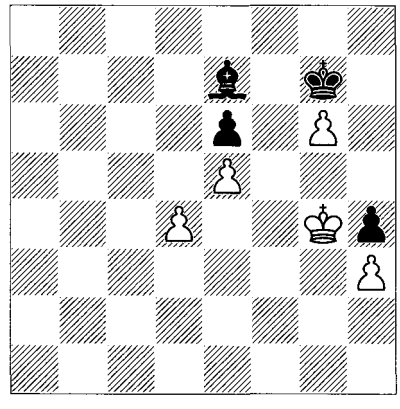
54 ♕h5?

White can draw by **54 ♕xf4!** gxf4 55 ♔g4 ♗g5 56 d5! f3 (56...exd5 57 ♔xg5! also leads to a draw: 57...f3 58 e6 ♔f8 59 ♔h6 f2 60 g7+ ♔e7 61 g8♕) 57 ♔xf3 exd5 58 ♔g4 ♗h6 59 ♔f5 ♔f8 60 e6 ♗g7 61 h4 ♔e7 62 h5 d4 (not 62...♔d6?? 63 h6! ♗xh6 64 ♔f6 and White wins) 63 ♔e4 ♔xe6 64 h6 ♗e5 65 g7 with a draw; the black king can make no progress.

54...♕h4+! 55 ♕xh4 gxh4 56 ♔g4 ♔g7 57 h3 *(D)*

The idea of exchanging pawns on d5 to reach the ending of bishop and 'wrong' rook's pawn does not work, since after 57 ♔f3 ♔xg6 58 ♔e4 ♔g5 59 d5 exd5+ 60 ♔xd5 ♔g4 the white king is unable to reach h1.

B



57...♗d8 58 ♔f4 ♗b6

58...♔xg6 59 ♔e4 ♔g5 60 d5 exd5+ 61 ♔xd5 ♔f4, as in the previous note, also wins.

59 ♔e4 ♗xd4!

Prettier than 59...♔xg6, which also wins.

60 ♔xd4 ♔xg6 61 ♔e4

Or 61 ♔c5 ♔g5! 62 ♔c6 ♔f4! 63 ♔d6 ♔f5.

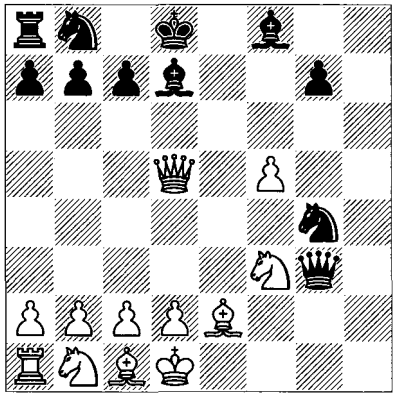
61...♔g5 62 ♔e3 ♔f5 63 ♔f3 ♔xe5 64 ♔g4 ♔e4! 65 ♔xh4 ♔f4! 66 ♔h5 e5 67 h4 e4 68 ♔g6 e3 69 h5 e2 0-1

7 Mundo Latino

This chapter consists of 90 puzzles which, following the pattern of Chapters 3 and 6, are of increasing difficulty, from levels 1 to 4. The first 40 have hints, and the difficulty level drops back to 1 at the start of the 50 puzzles where you are given no clues.

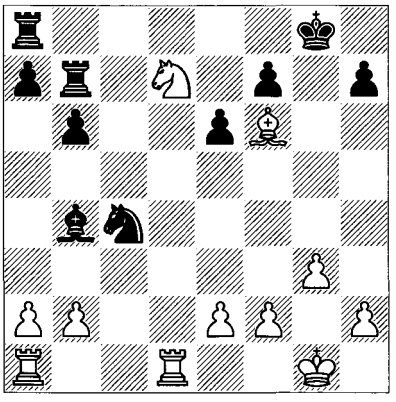
The winners (or at least the 'heroes') are all from Latin countries, whether European or American. Many of the games are from the early and middle decades of the 20th century, as during this period there were a lot of excellent players in South America whose games will not be familiar to many readers.

591
B



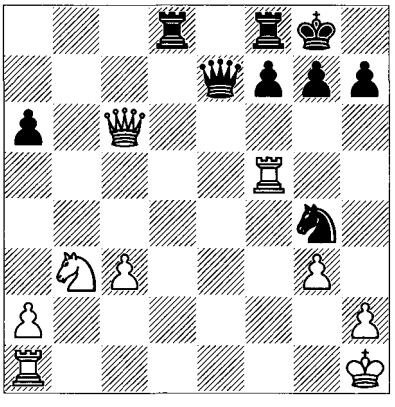
To begin, we have here a well-known tactical theme in the hands of its creator.

593
W



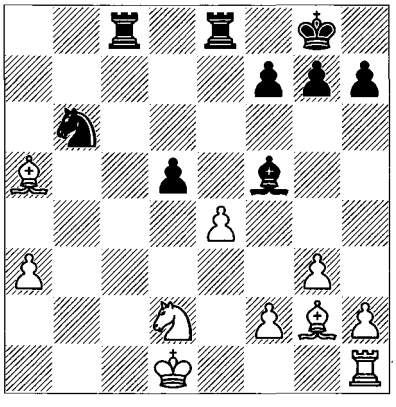
There are too many tactical weaknesses in Black's camp, don't you think? What is the clearest win?

592
B



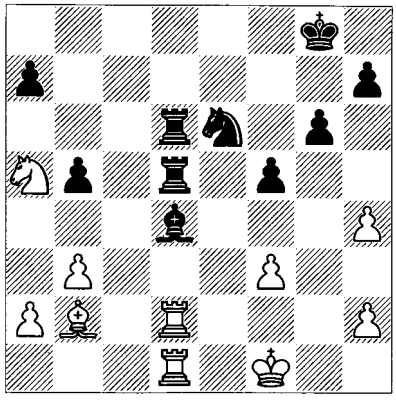
The white pieces are uncoordinated and his king is weak; what is the quickest way to win?

594
B



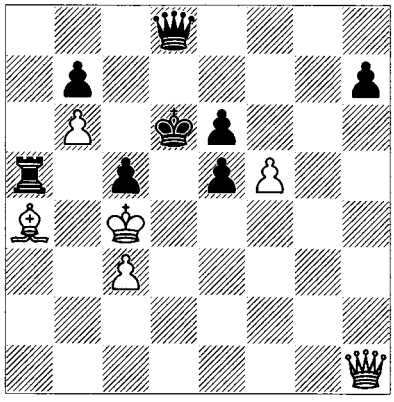
The position of the white king will help you to solve the problem of the two attacked black pieces.

595
W



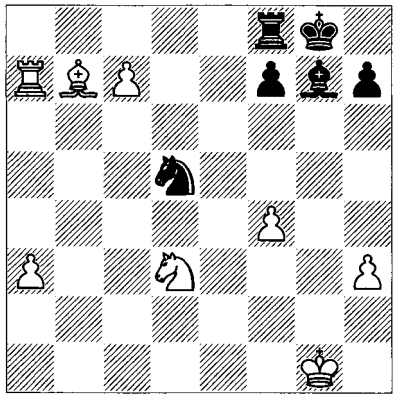
How can White take advantage of the pin on the d-file?

596
W



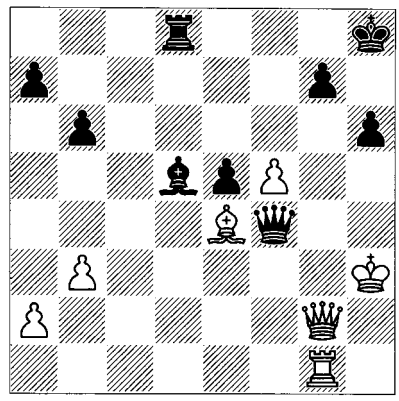
White is the exchange down, but has a quick way to win. How?

597
W



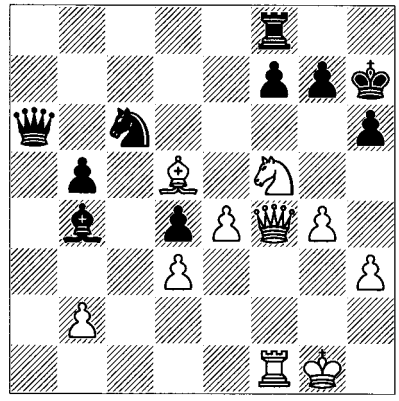
What is the quickest way for White to exploit his passed c-pawn?

598
B



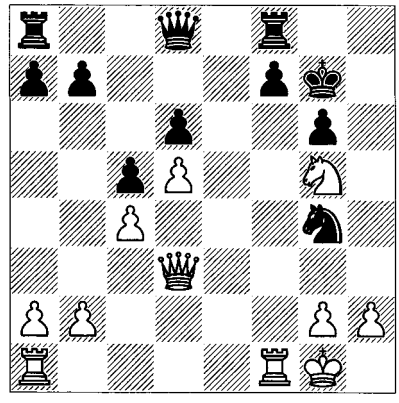
There are several satisfactory ways to defend against the mate on g7, but which is the best?

599
W



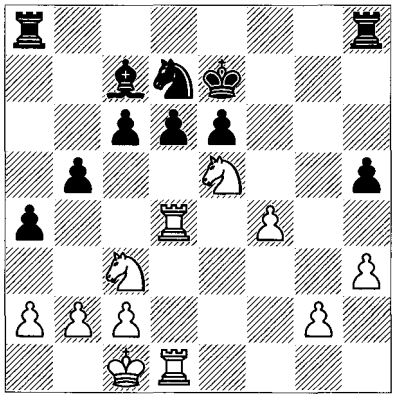
How can White crystallize the superiority of his forces on the kingside?

600
W



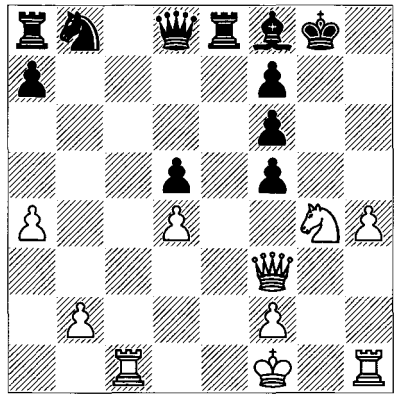
Can you see Black's tactical weakness?

601
B



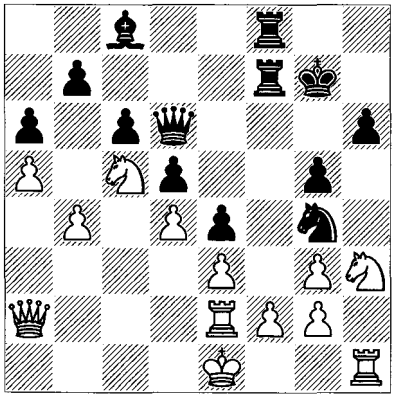
How can Black neutralize White's pressure on the d-file?

604
W



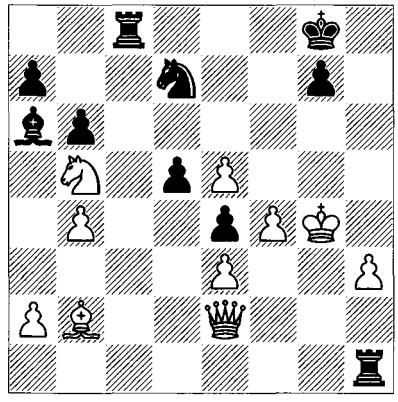
White is a piece down, but the black king is weak; which is the most effective way to attack?

602
B



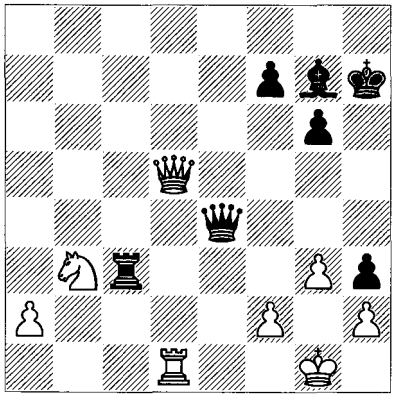
Black's pieces are more active and better coordinated, and his king is safer. Put these advantages to use.

605
B



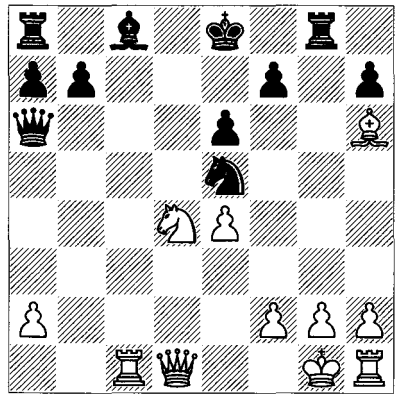
Black has two rooks for the queen, but there is a more important factor here; what is it?

603
B



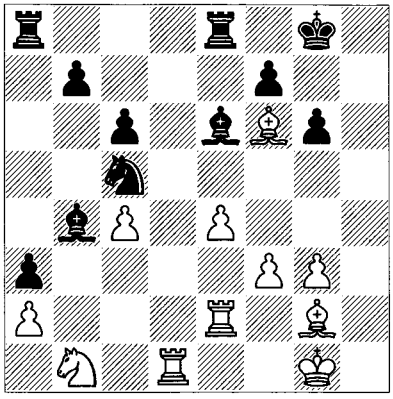
Mating patterns and overloaded pieces are the themes of this puzzle.

606
W



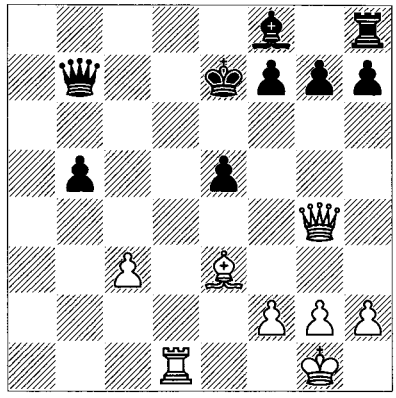
Both sides have a rook that is out of play, but the key factor is the black king in the centre. How can this be exploited?

607
W



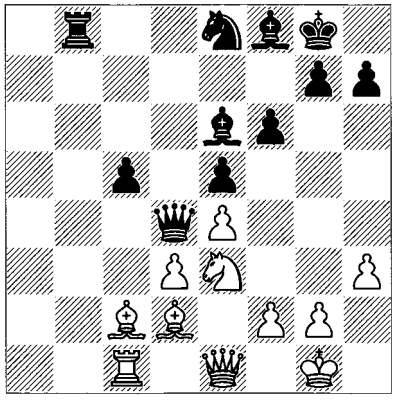
The b4-bishop is misplaced, don't you think?

610
W



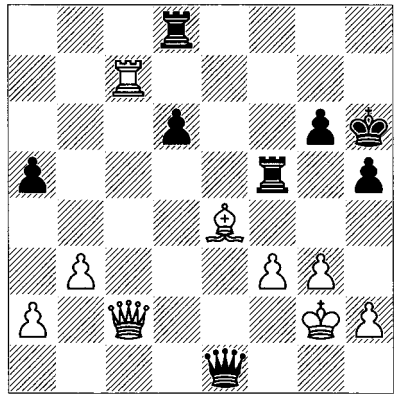
The black king will require many moves to reach a safe haven. How does White win?

608
W



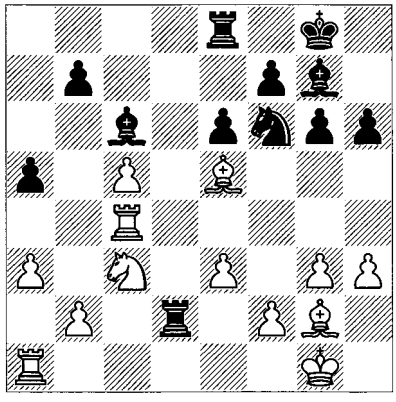
How can White demonstrate that one of the black pieces is badly placed?

611
B



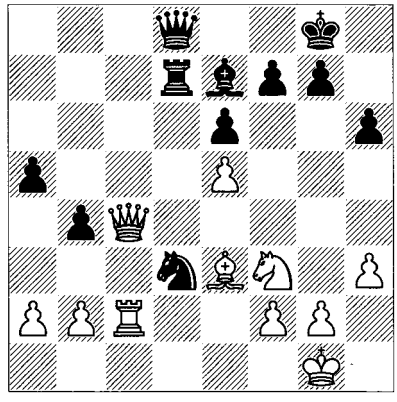
For the exchange White has a pawn and some kingside pressure, but one move changes everything.

609
W



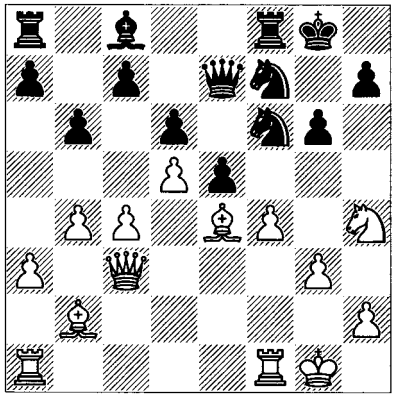
Find the tactical weakness in the black camp.

612
W



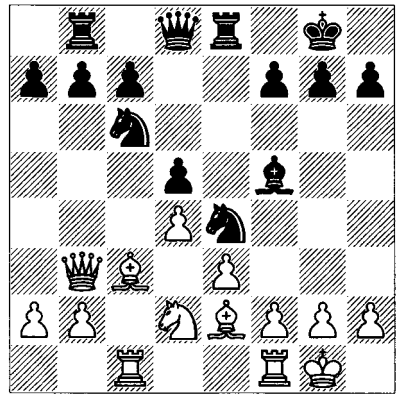
In the game White played 28 ♕a6?. How could Black have punished this careless move?

613
W



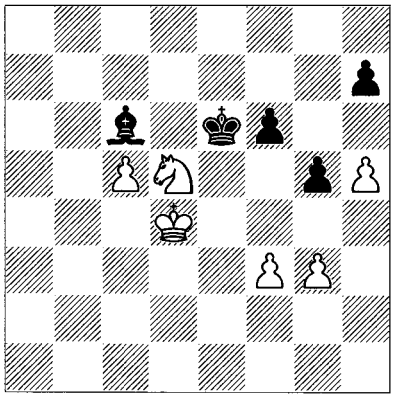
White's queen and b2-bishop are inactive at the moment; how can they be brought into play?

616
B



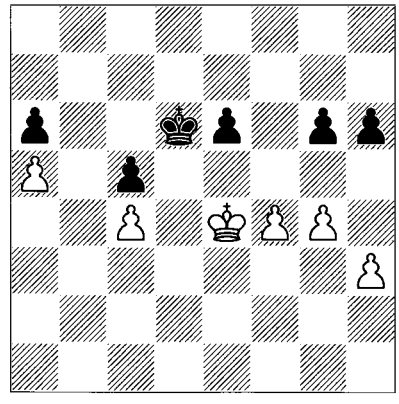
Is there an overloaded white piece?

614
W



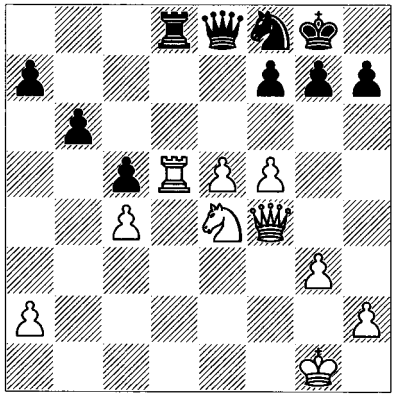
Can White create any winning chances?

617
W



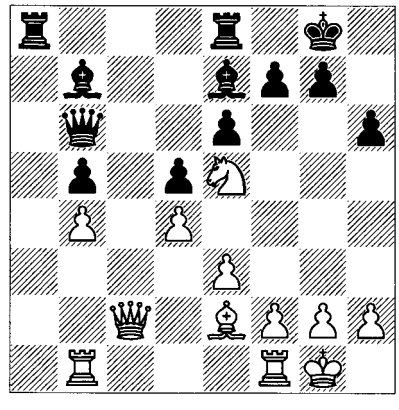
There is just one way to win, which is... ?

615
W



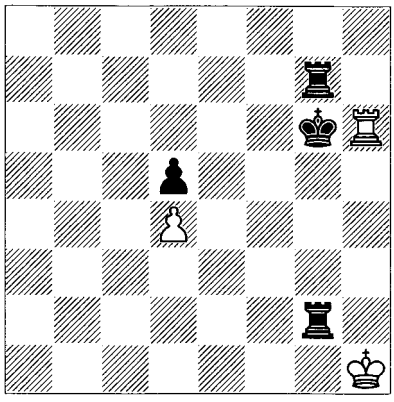
White's advantage is not in doubt, but what is the killer blow in this position?

618
W



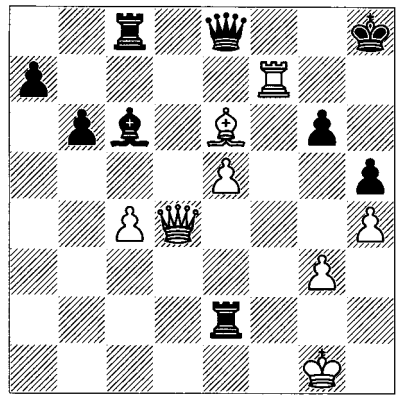
White wins material; how?

619
B



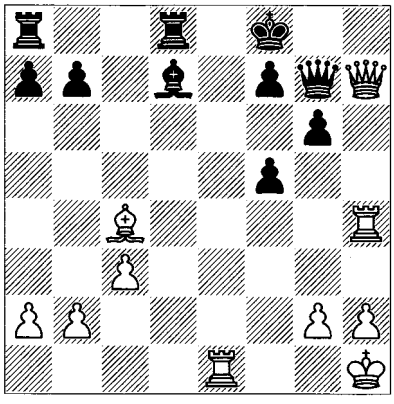
Has White's desperado rook saved the game?

622
W



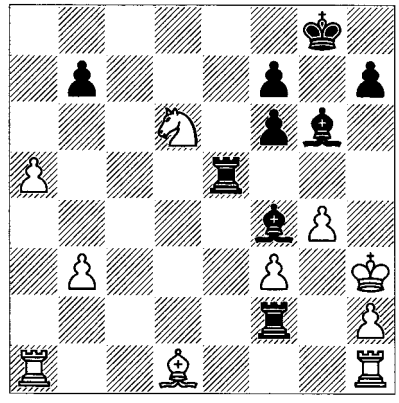
White is a rook down, his bishop is attacked, and his king is unsafe... so he must come up with something quickly!

620
W



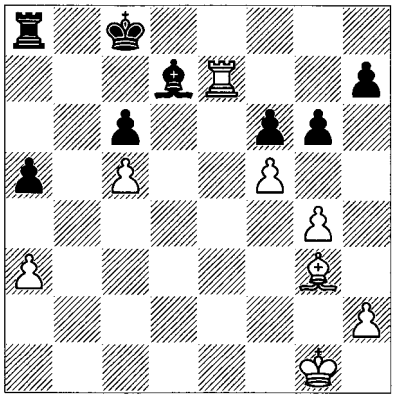
Demonstrate that White's attack has not yet come to an end.

623
B



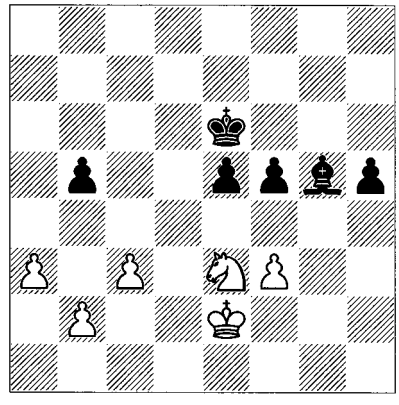
What is the quickest way to make something tangible of Black's advantage?

621
W



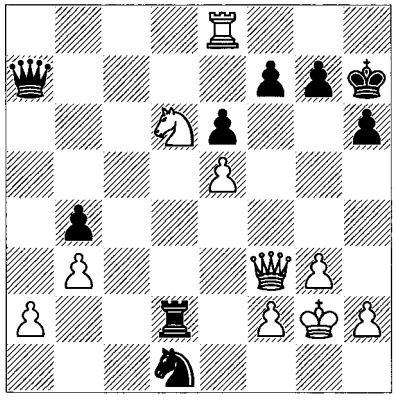
Is there anything better than 31 ♖xh7 gxf5 32 gxf5 ♗xf5 33 ♖f7, etc.?

624
B



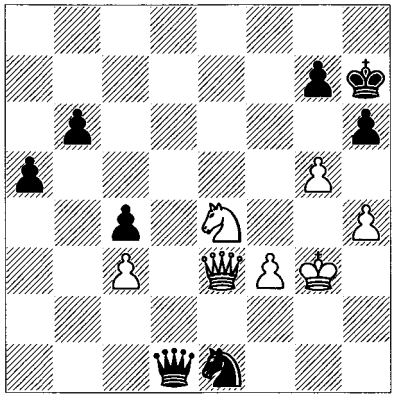
Is it appropriate to exchange on e3?

625
W



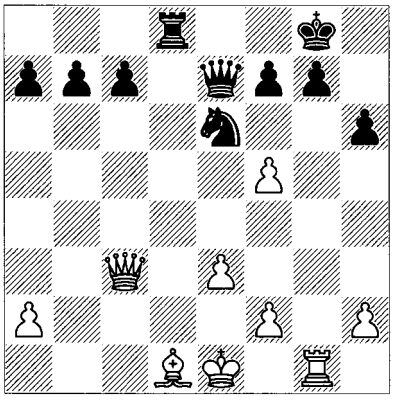
Black has strong threats, but it is White to move and he can transform the situation; how?

628
B



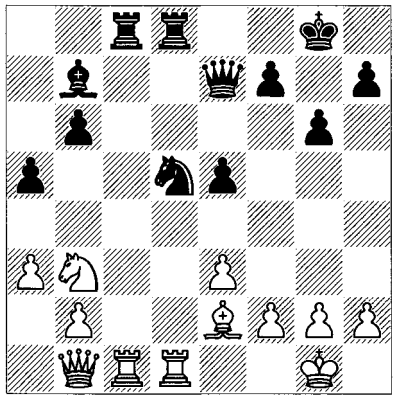
Black has a passed pawn; how can he exploit it?

626
B



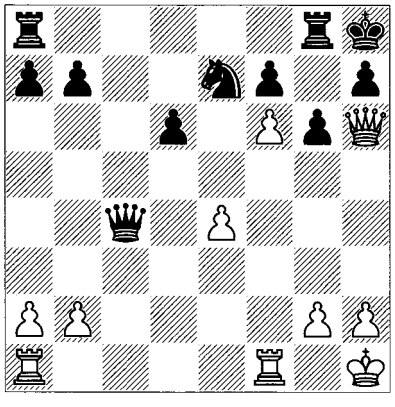
White is attacking, but Black can defend; what is his best course?

629
B



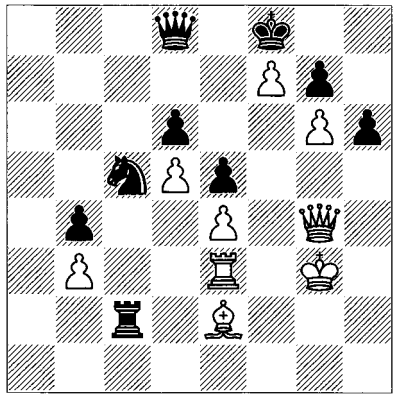
How can Black take advantage of his centralized pieces and the fact that White's queen and knight are out of play?

627
W



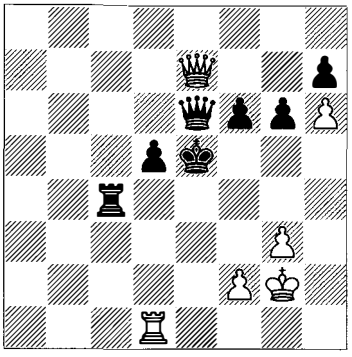
If there is nothing better than 23 fxe7, Black can hold his position without any problems; show how White can do better.

630
B

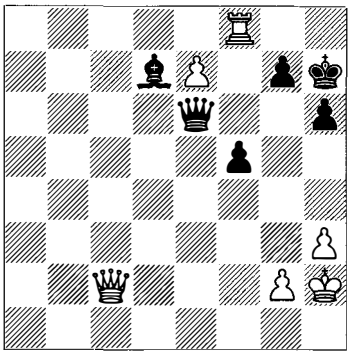


The position seems unclear, because the f7-pawn is very strong; how can Black clarify the situation in his favour?

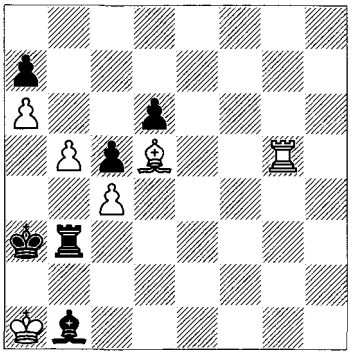
631
W



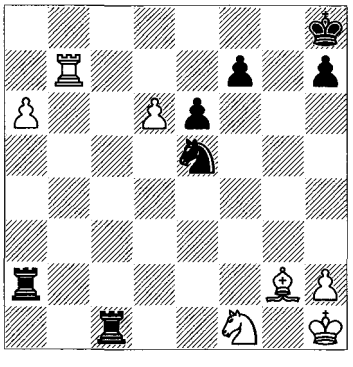
632
W



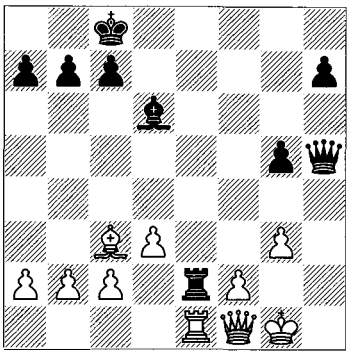
633
B



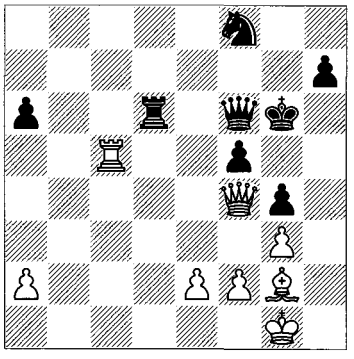
634
B



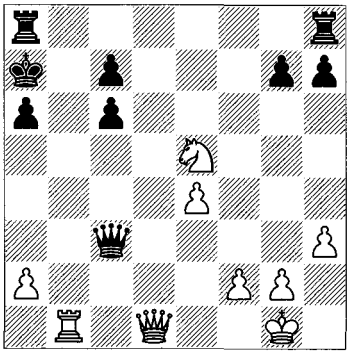
635
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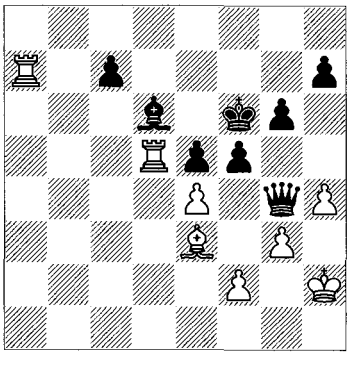
636
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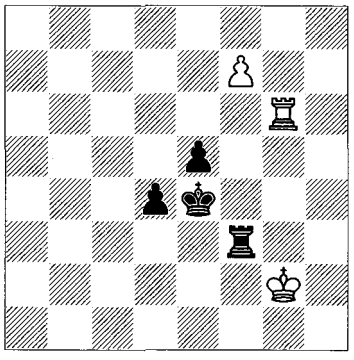
637
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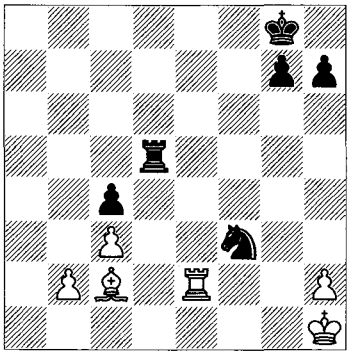
638
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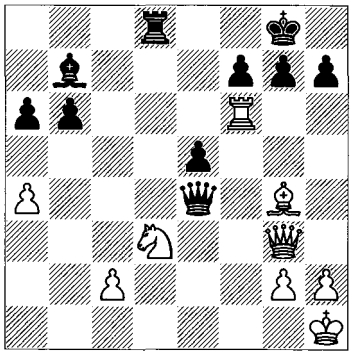
639
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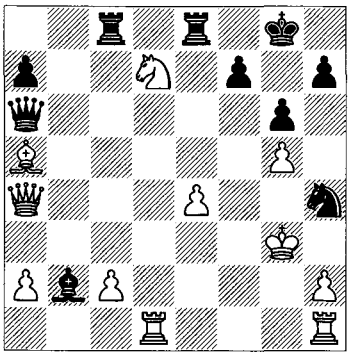
643
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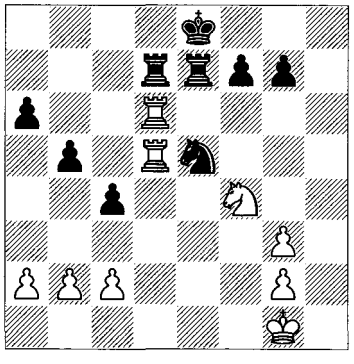
640
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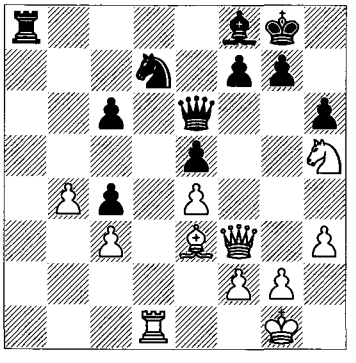
644
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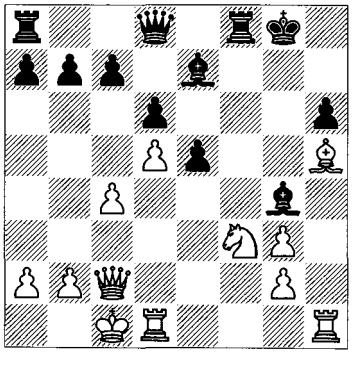
641
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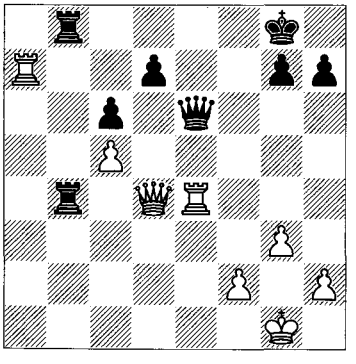
645
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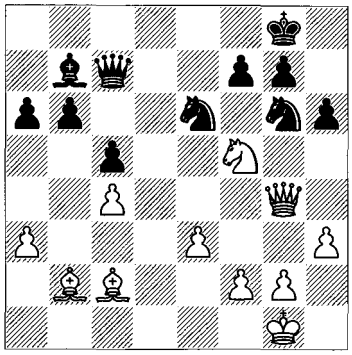
642
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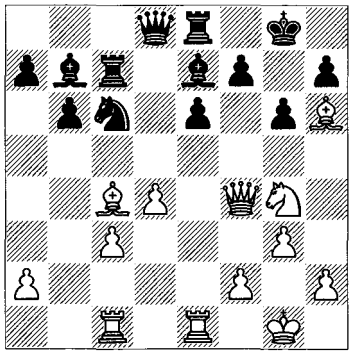
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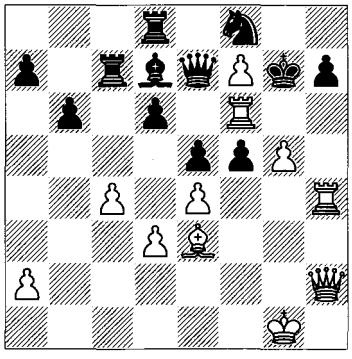
647
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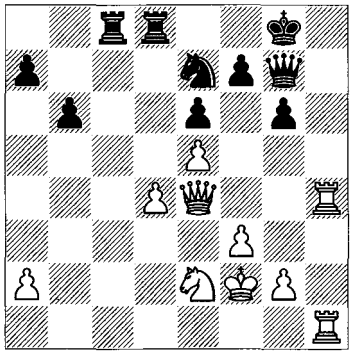
648
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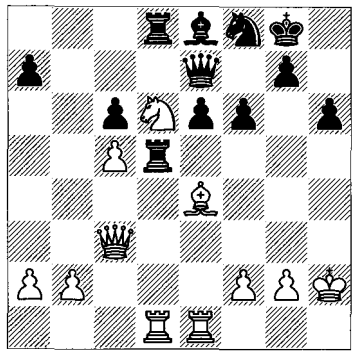
649
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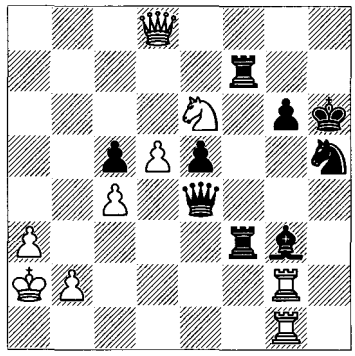
650
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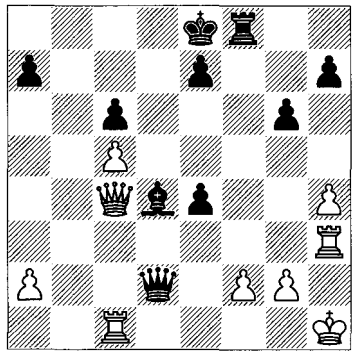
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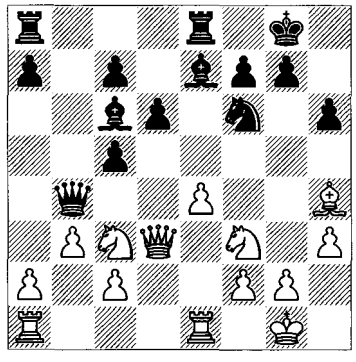
652
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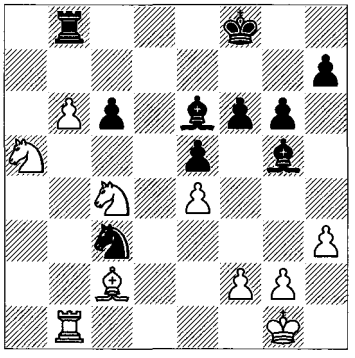
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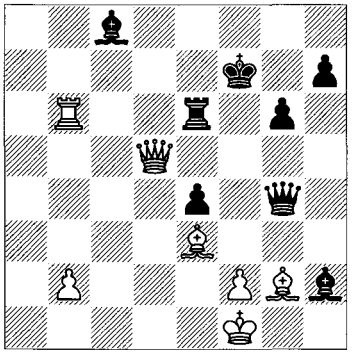
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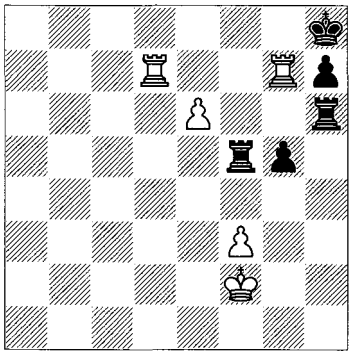
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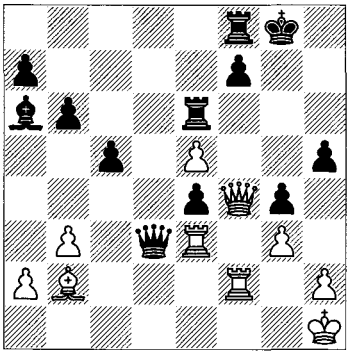
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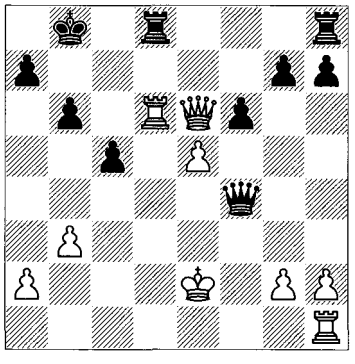
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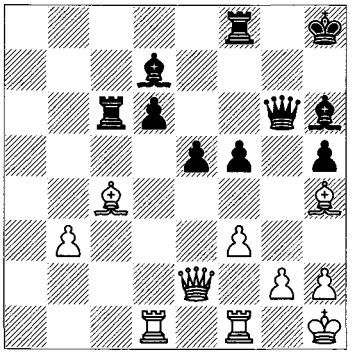
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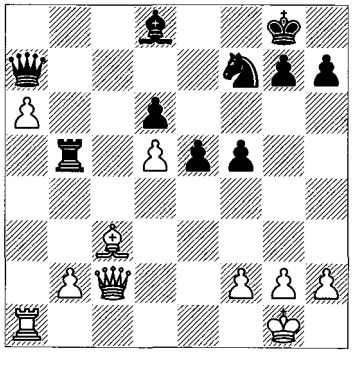
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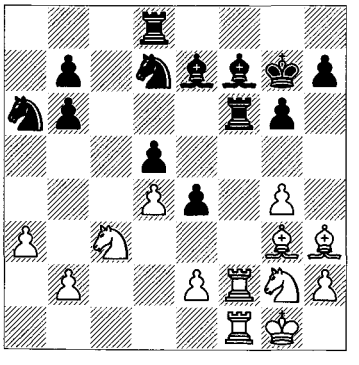
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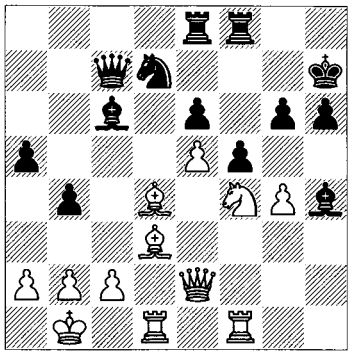
658
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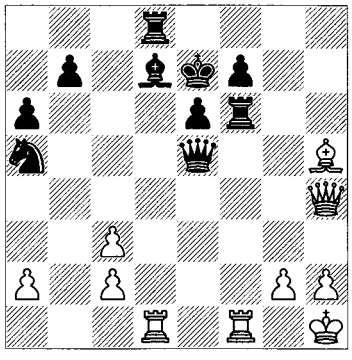
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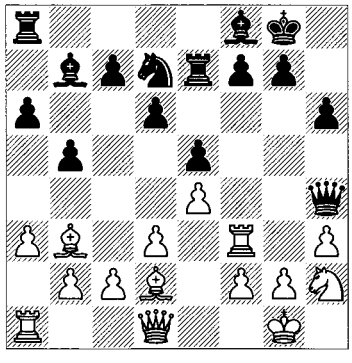
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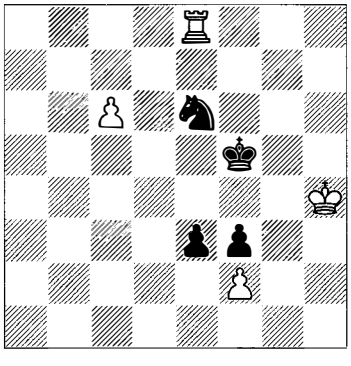
664
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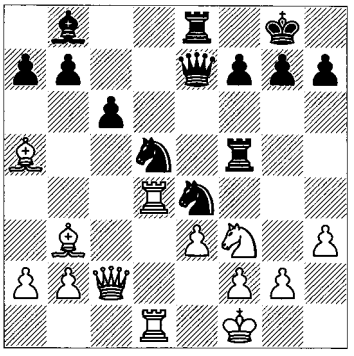
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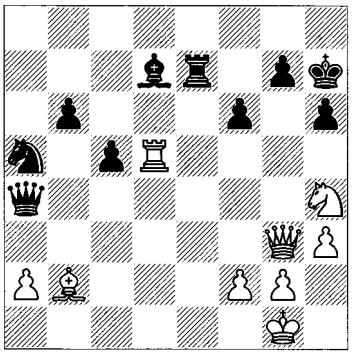
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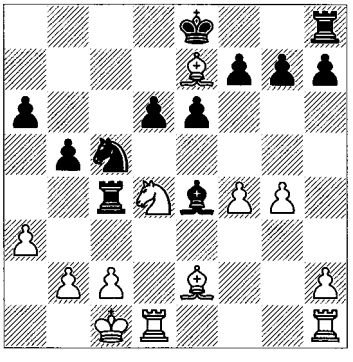
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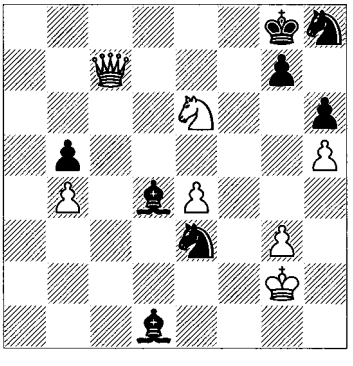
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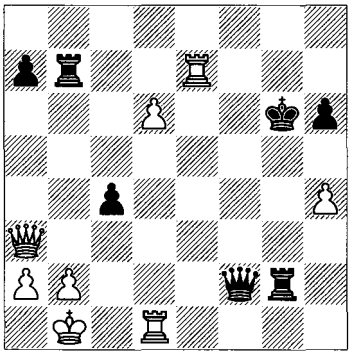
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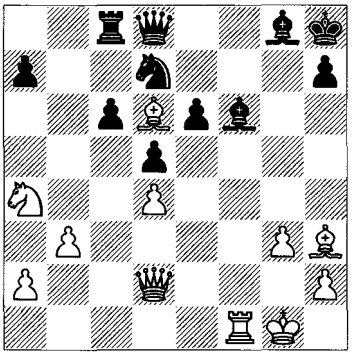
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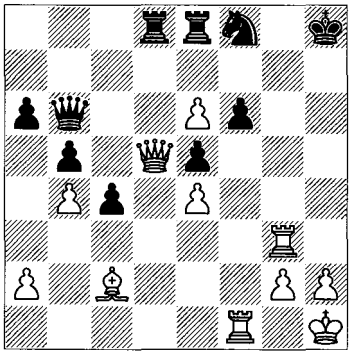
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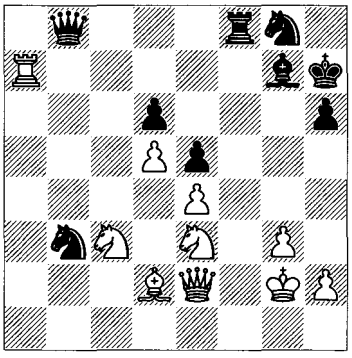
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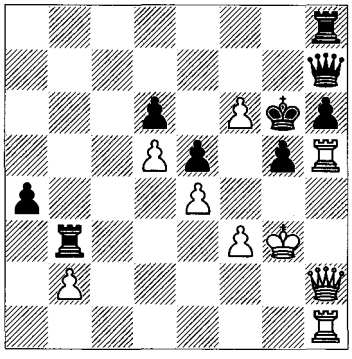
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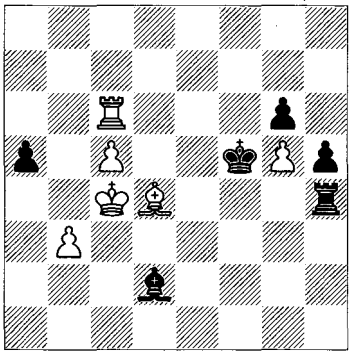
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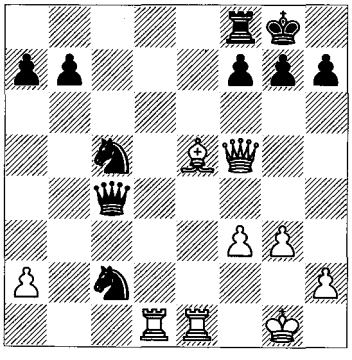
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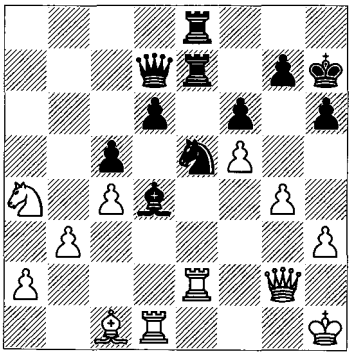
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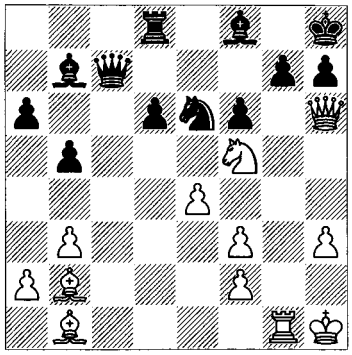
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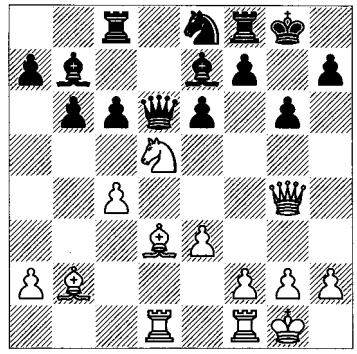
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679
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680
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Answers for Chapter 7

591) NN – Greco
1620
15...♘f2+ 16 ♔e1 ♘d3++ 17 ♔d1 ♕e1+! 18 ♘xe1 ♘f2# (0-1)

592) O'Hanlon – Grau
Paris Olympiad 1924
26...♕e2! 0-1
27 ♕g2 is forced and then 27...♕xg2+ 28 ♔xg2 ♘e3+ wins, while 27 ♖h5 allows mate: 27...♖d1+ 28 ♖xd1 ♕xd1+ 29 ♔g2 ♕e2+ 30 ♔g1 ♕f2+ 31 ♔h1 ♕f1#.

593) Grau – Szabo
Stockholm Olympiad 1937
19 ♖d4! 1-0

594) C. Poulsen – Grau
Stockholm Olympiad 1937
23...♘a4! 0-1
Since 24 exf5? allows 24...♘b2#.

595) Grau – Pilnik
Argentine Ch, La Plata 1938
34 b4! 1-0
There is no defence against 35 ♘b3.

596) Guimard – S. Graf
La Plata 1944
49 ♕d1+ ♔e7 50 f6+! 1-0

597) Foguelman – Keres
Buenos Aires 1964
51 ♗xd5! 1-0
After 51...♗d4+ 52 ♔g2 ♗xa7 comes 53 ♗b7.

598) Cherta – Guimard
Barcelona 1946
41...g5! 0-1
Threatening mate on h4, and after 42 fxg6 ♗e6+ the game is decided.

599) Rossetto – Ju. Bolbochán
Argentine Ch match (game 2), Buenos Aires 1948
32 ♘xg7!
Weakening the king's position and winning at least a pawn.
32...♔xg7
32...♗d2 33 ♕xd2 ♔xg7 34 ♕f4 changes nothing.
33 ♕f6+ ♔h7 34 ♗xc6 ♕a7 35 e5! ♗d2 36 ♗e4+ ♔g8 37 ♕f5 f6 38 exf6 ♕c7 39 ♔g2 1-0

600) Schweber – Teschner
Stockholm Interzonal 1962
20 ♖xf7+! ♖xf7 21 ♘e6+ ♔h7 22 ♘xd8
with a decisive material advantage.

601) Conway – Philidor
London (blindfold) 1790
21...♘xe5! 22 fxe5 d5
The file has been closed and now the e5-pawn will be indefensible.
23 ♖e1 ♖af8 24 ♖d3 ♖f5 25 b3
Not 25 ♖de3? d4.
25...axb3 26 axb3 ♖xe5
and Black won with his extra pawn.

602) Montalbán – Grau
Mar del Plata 1928
35...♘xf2! 36 ♘xf2 ♕xg3 37 ♖f1 ♕xg2
With the deadly threats of 38...♗h3 and 38...g4 followed by ...g3.
38 ♖d2
After 38 ♘b3 ♗h3 39 ♘d2 ♕g3 there is no defence against 40...♗g4 or 40...♖xf2, depending on White's reply.
38...♗h3 39 ♘e6+ ♔g8 0-1

603) Villegas – Portela
Buenos Aires 1929
41...♖d3! 0-1

604) Lynch – Falcón
Buenos Aires 1931
21 ♖g1!
The knight is taboo and there is a threat of mate in two moves. **21 ♘e3!** is another way, threatening 22 ♖g1+, and we already know the power of a knight on f5.
21...♗g7 22 ♘h6+ ♔f8 23 ♖xg7! ♔xg7 24 ♘xf5+
The above-mentioned deadly knight appears, and now it is mate in a few moves.
24...♔g6 25 ♕g4+ 1-0

605) Palau – Grau
Argentine Ch, La Plata 1938
The important factor is the bad position of the white king, which succumbs to a mating attack:

26...♖g1+! 27 ♔h4
27 ♔f5 is met with the same winning reply.
27...♖c6! 0-1

606) Maderna – Szabo
Mar del Plata 1948

16 ♕h5! ♕a5
Upon 16...♘g6, or indeed any other knight move, 17 ♘b5! is decisive.
17 ♗f4! ♘c4 18 ♕xh7 ♖g4
Or 18...♖f8 19 ♗h6 and White wins.
19 ♕h8+ ♔e7 20 ♗h6 e5 21 ♗f8+! ♔d7 22 ♘b3 ♕xa2 23 ♕f6 1-0

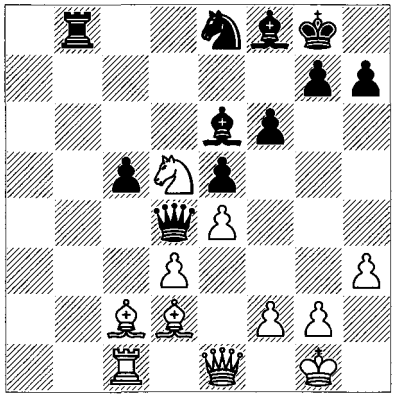
607) Maderna – Rossetto
Mar del Plata Zonal 1951

29 ♗f1! 1-0
Mate can only be prevented at great material loss; if 29...♘d7? then 30 ♖xd7 ♗xd7 31 ♖h2.

608) Pilnik – Pachman
Saltsjöbaden Interzonal 1952

26 ♘d5! *(D)*

B



Threatening 27 ♗c3, incarcerating the queen.
26...c4 27 ♗e3 ♕b2 28 ♖b1 ♕xc2 29 ♖xb8 ♗f7 30 dxc4
with a winning position.

609) Ju. Bolbochán – Cruz
Rio de Janeiro 1952

20 ♗xc6!
Or in reverse order: **20 ♗xf6!** ♗xf6 21 ♗xc6!.
20...bxc6 21 ♗xf6!
Two black pieces are in range of a knight fork.
21...♗xf6 22 ♘e4 ♗xb2 23 ♖b1 ♖ed8
If 23...♖e2 then 24 ♔f1.
24 ♘xd2
and White won.

610) Ju. Bolbochán – Evans
Helsinki Olympiad 1952

25 ♕f5! 1-0
There is no defence against the mating attack after 25...f6 (25...♕c7 loses to 26 ♗c5+! ♔e8 27 ♗b6!) 26 ♗c5+ ♔e8 27 ♕e6+ ♗e7 28 ♖a1!, with the idea of 29 ♖a8+ ♕xa8 30 ♕xe7#.

611) Geller – Cuéllar Gacharná
Stockholm Interzonal 1962

38...♖c5!
After the rooks are exchanged, Black's d8-rook comes into play and the game is over.
39 ♖xc5 dxc5 40 ♕xc5 ♖d2+ 41 ♔h3 ♕f1+ 42 ♔h4 ♖xh2# (0-1)

612) Karpov – Antunes
Tilburg 1994

Both sides missed **28...b3!!** 29 axb3 (if 29 ♖c8 then simply 29...bxa2 wins) 29...♘b4, with an extra exchange and a winning position.

613) Maderna – Molina
Buenos Aires 1935

20 ♗xg6! hxg6 21 ♘xg6 ♕d8 22 fxe5 dxe5 23 ♘xe5 ♘d6
After 23...♘xe5 24 ♕xe5 Black loses at least the f6-knight.
24 ♘c6 ♘de4 25 ♘xd8 ♘xc3 26 ♗xc3
and Black soon resigned.

614) Maderna – Luckis
Warsaw Olympiad 1935

Yes, White can gain very good winning chances:
42 f4! gxf4 43 gxf4 f5
The key is that 43...♗xd5? 44 f5+ ♔xf5 45 ♔xd5 is winning for White.
44 ♘b4 ♗e4 45 h6 ♗f3 46 ♘d3 ♗b7 47 ♘e5 ♗c8 48 ♘g6! ♗a6 49 ♘f8+ ♔f7 50 ♘xh7 ♔g6 51 ♘f8+ ♔xh6 52 ♔e5
and White won with his extra pawn.

615) Grau – Fine
Warsaw Olympiad 1935

32 ♕g5!
Attacking the d8-rook and threatening 33 ♘f6+.
32...♘d7 33 ♖xd7 1-0

616) E. Andersen – Grau
Warsaw Olympiad 1935

Yes, the c3-bishop is overloaded, although the position of the e8-rook on the half-open file helps exploit this: **13...♘xd4!** (13...♘xd2?! 14 ♗xd2 ♘xd4 15 exd4 ♖xe2 16 ♗f4 is much less strong) **14 exd4** (14 ♗xd4? ♘xd2) **14...♘xc3 15 ♕xc3 ♖xe2 16 ♘f3 c6** with a healthy extra pawn.

617) Grau – L. Steiner
Warsaw Olympiad 1935

55 h4! e5

Or:

a) 55...h5 56 gxh5 gxh5 also loses after 57 f5! e5 (57...exf5+ 58 ♔xf5 ♔e7 59 ♔g6 or 59 ♔e5) 58 f6 ♔e6 59 f7 ♔xf7 60 ♔xe5.

b) 55...♔d7 56 ♔e5 ♔e7 57 h5! and the white king infiltrates after 57...gxh5 58 gxh5 ♔f7 (or 58...♔d7 59 ♔f6) 59 ♔d6.

56 f5 1-0

Further resistance is impossible after 56...g5 57 h5 or 56...gxf5+ 57 ♔xf5.

618) Grau – Monticelli
Warsaw Olympiad 1935

20 ♗h5!

More or less forcing the rook to move in range of a fork.

20...♖f8

If 20...g6 then 21 ♘xf7! (or 21 ♗xg6!), when 21...gxh5? allows mate following 22 ♕g6+ ♔f8 23 ♘xh6.

21 ♘d7 ♕d6 22 ♘xf8

with a decisive material advantage.

619) Corte – Ju. Bolbochán
Argentine Ch, La Plata 1938

No, Black can win:

46...♔g5 47 ♖h5+ ♔f6 48 ♖f5+

48 ♖h6+ is met by 48...♖2g6, when there are no more stalemate possibilities.

48...♔e7 49 ♖e5+ ♔d7 50 ♖e7+

50 ♖xd5+ ♔e6 destroys the stalemate because now White's d-pawn can move.

50...♖xe7 0-1

620) Ju. Bolbochán – Fenoglio
Argentine Ch, La Plata 1938

26 ♗xf7! g5

If 26...♕xf7 then 27 ♕h8+! ♕g8 28 ♕f6+ ♕f7 29 ♖h8#, while 26...♔xf7 loses to 27 ♖e7+!.

27 ♖h5 ♕xh7 28 ♖xh7

with an extra pawn.

621) Ju. Bolbochán – Corte
Argentine Ch, Buenos Aires 1946

31 g5! 1-0

Creating a winning passed pawn; for example, 31...fxg5 32 f6 ♔d8 and now 33 ♖xh7 is one of several ways to win. Even after 31 ♖xh7 gxf5, White can still retain excellent chances by 32 h4!.

622) Marini – Rossetto
Argentine Ch, Buenos Aires 1946

34 ♕f4!

King safety overrides all other factors. The threat of mate forces Black to give up his queen.

34...♕xf7 35 ♗xf7

Black has two rooks for the queen but the black king is still poorly defended and the game is decided.

35...♖g2+

Or 35...♔h7 36 ♗xg6+! ♔xg6 37 ♕g5+ ♔f7 38 ♕xh5+ ♔e7 39 ♕xe2.

36 ♔f1 ♔h7 37 ♕g5

Somewhat stronger is 37 ♗xg6+! ♔xg6 38 ♕f6+ ♔h7 39 ♕f5+, as above.

37...♗e4 38 ♗xg6+ ♗xg6 39 ♔xg2

and White eventually won.

623) Liogky – Vallejo
French Team Ch 2003

29...♖e1! 0-1

30 ♖xe1 allows 30...♖xh2#.

624) Atwood – Philidor
London (blindfold) 1794

36...♗xe3!

Yes, this exchange brings about a winning pawn ending.

37 ♔xe3 h4 38 ♔f2 e4

One of the pawns will queen; the 'rule of the common square' states that if two passed pawns define a square that includes the eighth rank, the enemy king cannot hold them back.

39 ♔g2 e3 40 ♔h3 e2 0-1

625) Grau – Euwe
Paris Olympiad 1924

42 ♘e4! ♖d4

If 42...♖xa2 then naturally 43 ♕xd1.

43 ♘g5+!

43 ♘f6+! is also effective.

43...♔g6 44 ♘xe6! ♘e3+

After 44...fxe6 the quickest way is 45 ♖xe6+ ♔g5 46 ♖f6!.

45 fxe3 ♖d2+ 46 ♔h3 ♕d7 47 ♕g4+ 1-0

626) J. Martínez – Guimard

Argentine Ch, Buenos Aires 1948

21...♕d6!

This tremendous counterattacking move tips the struggle in Black's favour; 21...♘d4!? 22 f6 ♕e5 23 ♖xg7+ ♔h8 is also advantageous, but less so.

22 ♗h5

Or 22 ♗b3 ♕xh2 23 ♖g3 ♕h1+ 24 ♔e2 ♕h5+ 25 ♔f1 ♘g5 26 f6 ♘e4! 27 ♖xg7+ ♔h8 with unanswerable threats.

22...♕xh2 23 ♗xf7+ ♔h8! 24 ♖f1 ♘g5 25 ♕c4

There is no defence; e.g., if 25 ♗g6 then 25...♕h3! 26 ♕b4 c5! (better than 26...♘f3+ 27 ♔e2 ♖d2+ 28 ♕xd2 ♘xd2 29 ♖d1) 27 ♕b2 ♘f3+ 28 ♔e2 ♕g4 and Black wins.

25...♕d6 0-1

The threat of mate gains a decisive material advantage for Black after 26 ♕c2 ♘xf7.

627) Pomar – Geller

Stockholm Interzonal 1962

23 ♖f3!

Before taking on e7, White threatens 24 ♕xh7+, as well as 24 ♖h3, forcing Black to weaken his king's position even more.

23...g5 24 fxe7 ♖ae8 25 ♕f6+ ♖g7 26 e5! d5

Or 26...dxe5 27 ♖d1 and 28 ♖d8.

27 e6 fxe6 28 ♕e5 ♕c8 29 ♖f7 1-0

628) Eliskases – Pleci

Warsaw Olympiad 1935

36...♕xf3+!!

If Black plays 36...a4? right away then in addition to 37 ♘d2, when the black king can't escape perpetual check because there are no defensive pieces available, White has the immediate 37 ♘f6+! gxf6 38 ♕e4+ ♔g7 39 ♕e7+, drawing.

37 ♕xf3 ♘xf3 38 ♔xf3 a4 39 gxh6 a3! 0-1

Not 39...gxh6? 40 ♘f6+! followed by 41 ♘d5 and 42 ♘b4.

629) Balparda – Ja. Bolbochán

Buenos Aires 1936

19...♘xe3!

Black takes advantage of the white queen's absence to weaken the position of the white king and then attack it with irresistible force.

20 ♖xc8

20 fxe3 ♕g5 is similar.

20...♖xc8 21 fxe3 ♕g5 22 ♔f2

Or 22 e4 ♕e3+ 23 ♔f1 ♕xb3.

22...♕xg2+ 23 ♔e1 ♕g1+ 24 ♔d2 ♖d8+ 25 ♗d3

25 ♔c2 is met by 25...♗e4+ 26 ♗d3 ♖c8+ 27 ♔d2 ♕f2+.

25...♕f2+ 26 ♔c1 ♕xe3+ 27 ♖d2 ♕e1+ 28 ♖d1 ♖c8+ 29 ♗c2 ♕e3+ 30 ♘d2 ♗e4! 31 b3 ♖xc2+

and Black won.

630) Larsen – Quinteros

Mar del Plata 1982

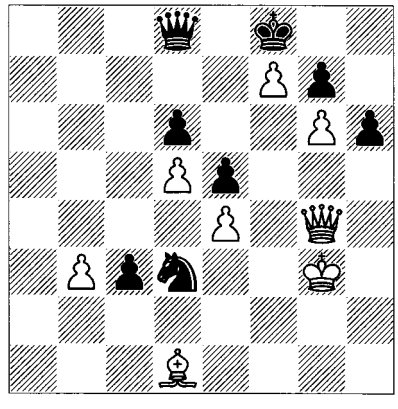
42...♖c3!

With the exchange of rooks, the passed pawn will deflect White's pieces, and Black's two remaining pieces will be able to combine with devastating force.

43 ♖xc3

If 43 ♔f2 then 43...♘xb3.

43...bxc3 44 ♗d1 ♘d3! *(D)*



45 ♕f3?!

Allowing the decisive entrance of the black queen, but the alternatives were not substantially better.

45...♕g5+ 46 ♔h2 ♕d2+ 47 ♔g3 c2 48 ♗xc2 ♕xc2 49 b4 ♘f4 0-1

631) Cuéllar Gacharná – Korchnoi

Stockholm Interzonal 1962

54 f4+! ♖xf4

54...♔f5 is met by 55 g4+.

55 gxf4+ ♔f5 56 ♕xe6+ 1-0

632) García Palermo – Karpov
Mar del Plata 1982
57 ♕xf5+! 1-0
57...♕xf5 58 ♖xf5 ♗xf5 59 e8♕.

633) Shabalov – Granda
Buenos Aires 2005
53...♗d3! 0-1
Shielding the third rank; if now 54 ♖g1 then 54...♖b2, followed by 55...♖a2#.

634) Euwe – Ju. Bolbochán
Mar del Plata 1947
33...♘f3! 0-1
There is no defence against 34...♖xf1+ 35 ♗xf1 ♖xh2#.

635) Foguelman – Mazzoleni
Buenos Aires 1959
22...♗xg3! 23 ♕g2
23 ♕xe2? allows mate in two: 23...♕h2+ 24 ♔f1 ♕h1#.
23...♗xf2+ 0-1

636) Ju. Bolbochán – Hoen
Havana Olympiad 1966
37 ♖xf5! 1-0
If 37...♕xf5 then 38 ♗e4.

637) Mecking – Rocha
Mar del Plata Zonal 1969
23 ♕d4+! ♕xd4 24 ♘xc6# (1-0)

638) Quinteros – Tukmakov
Leningrad Interzonal 1973
40 ♖xd6+! 1-0
40...cxd6 41 ♗g5+ ♔e6? 42 ♖e7#.

639) Quinteros – Adorjan
Wijk aan Zee 1973
68 ♖g4+! 1-0
68...♔e3 69 ♖g3.

640) Balashov – Sunye
Rio de Janeiro Interzonal 1979
27...♕xg2+! (eliminating White's pressure on the g-file) **28 ♕xg2 ♗xg2+ 29 ♔xg2 gxf6 0-1**.

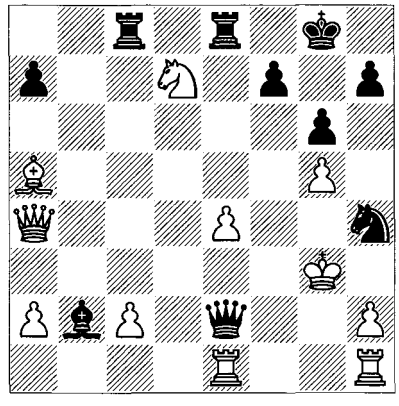
641) Miles – Bernat
Buenos Aires 1979
36...♘g4! 37 ♔f1 ♘e3+ 38 ♔f2 ♘xd5
Black has an extra exchange and duly won.

642) Polugaevsky – Quinteros
Biel Interzonal 1985
19...♗g5+!
Winning the exchange, since 20 ♔b1? fails to 20...♗f5, and if 20 ♘xg5 then 20...♕xg5+ 21 ♕d2 ♗xd1.
20 ♖d2 ♗f5 21 ♕c3 ♗xd2+ 22 ♕xd2 ♕f6 and Black won.

643) Kariakin – Vallejo
Cuernavaca 2006
34...♖g5! 0-1
Black wins after 35 ♖g2 ♖xg2 36 ♔xg2 ♘e1+.

644) Robson – Hernández Guerrero
Chicago 2008
32...♕e2! 33 ♖de1 *(D)*
If 33 ♔xh4 then 33...♖xe4+.

B



33...♘f5+! 0-1
It is mate after 34 exf5 ♖e3+ 35 ♔h4 (or 35 ♔f4 ♕f3#) 35...♕h5#.

645) Ju. Bolbochán– R. Sanguinetti
Argentine Ch, Buenos Aires 1946
32 ♗xh6! ♕xh6
32...gxh6 is also answered with 33 ♖xd7.
33 ♖xd7
White is a pawn up without compensation.

646) Ju. Bolbochán – Bauzá
Mar del Plata Zonal 1951
31 ♕xg7+! 1-0
If 31...♔xg7 then 32 ♖xe6 ♖8b7 33 ♖xb7 ♖xb7 34 ♖d6 ♖a7 35 h4, with a winning endgame. In contrast, 31 ♕xb4?! ♖xb4 32 ♖xe6 dxe6 33 ♖c7 ♖c4 34 ♖xc6 ♔f7 is also advantageous but less clearly so.

647) Ju. Bolbochán – Medina
Mar del Plata 1953
28 ♘xh6+! gxh6 29 ♗xg6 fxg6 30 ♕xe6+ 1-0
Winning at least another pawn while maintaining a strong attack.

648) Ju. Bolbochán – Pachman
Moscow Olympiad 1956
22 ♕xf7+! 1-0
22...♔xf7 23 ♗xe6#.

649) J. Ingolotti – O. Benítez
Pan American Team Ch, Tucumán 1971
32 ♖xh7+! ♘xh7 33 ♕h6+ ♔h8 34 g6 1-0

650) Brond – R. Sanguineti
Mar del Plata 1976
26 ♖h8+! 1-0
26...♕xh8 27 ♖xh8+ ♔xh8 28 ♕h4+ and 29 ♕xe7.

651) Bareev – Granda
Groningen (PCA qualifier) 1993
25...♖8xd6! 26 ♗xd5
26 cxd6 is met by 26...♕xd6+ and 27...♖xd1.
26...♖xd5 27 ♖xd5 cxd5 28 b4 ♕c7+ 29 ♔g1 ♗b5 30 ♕d4 ♕c6 31 f4 ♘g6 0-1

652) Vallejo – Radjabov
Spanish Team Ch, Sant Lluis 2005
56 ♕h8+! 1-0
56...♖h7 57 ♕xh7+! ♔xh7 58 ♘g5+.

653) Vallejo – Seel
Bundesliga 2005/6
25 ♖b1!
White's counterattack is decisive.
25...♖xf2 26 ♕g8+ ♖f8
Not 26...♔d7? 27 ♖b7#.
27 ♕e6! ♗b2 28 ♖b3! ♕f4 29 ♖3xb2 ♕xh4+ 30 ♔g1 1-0

654) Korneev – Cámpora
Deifontes (rapid) 2005
16...♘xe4! 17 ♘xe4 ♗xh4 18 c4
If 18 a3 then 18...♕b7.
18...♗e7
with an extra pawn.

655) Pilnik – Stein
Mar del Plata 1966
32 ♘xc6! ♖e8
White's passed pawn is unstoppable after 32...♘xb1 33 ♘xb8 ♘c3 34 b7.
33 ♘d6
The quickest way.
33...♘xb1
33...♗d7 loses to, amongst other things, 34 ♘xe8 ♗xc6 35 b7 ♗xb7 36 ♖xb7 ♔xe8 37 ♖xh7.
34 ♘xe8 1-0
White threatens 35 b7 and remains a piece up after 34...♗c8 35 ♘d6 ♗a6 36 ♗xb1.

656) Pilnik – Szabo
Amsterdam Candidates 1956
52 e7!
The task is not so simple after 52 ♖ge7 ♔g8.
52...♖e6 53 ♖xh7+! ♔g8 54 ♖g7+ ♔h8 55 ♖g6! ♖ee5
Or 55...♖fe5 56 ♖xe6 ♖xe6 57 ♖d8+ and 58 e8♕.
56 ♖c6! 1-0
Ending with a mating-net.

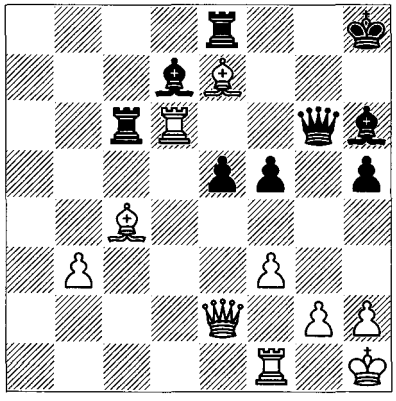
657) Razuvaev – García Palermo
Dortmund 1985
25...♕e4+!
Not 25...♖he8?? 26 ♖xb6+! drawing.
26 ♔f2 ♖he8 27 ♕c4 ♕f5+ 0-1

658) Cámpora – Portisch
Sarajevo 1986
28 ♕a4! 1-0
The rook can't move on account of 29 ♕e8#, and if the queen defends the rook, then simply 29 a7.

659) Milos – Fedorowicz
Buenos Aires 1991
37 ♖c6!
And surprisingly the c8-bishop is lost.
37...♔g7
37...♗b7 loses to 38 ♕d7+.
38 ♖xc8 ♖d6 39 ♖g8+ ♔f6 40 ♖f8+ 1-0

660) Kolev – Granda
Burgas 1993
31...♕b1+!
With a precise manoeuvre, Black eliminates the danger to his kingside and brings his queen to the defence.
32 ♔g2 ♗f1+! 33 ♖xf1 ♕xb2+ 0-1
After 34 ♖f2 ♕xe5 White is three pawns down without compensation.

661) Illescas – Gelfand
Wijk aan Zee 1993
30 ♗e7! ♖e8 31 ♖xd6! *(D)*



31...♕xd6
31...♖xd6 32 ♕xe5+ leaves Black two pawns down.
32 ♗xd6 ♖xd6 33 ♖d1
with a decisive material advantage.

662) Illescas – Lautier
Linares 1994
25 ♘f4!
Threatening the weak d5-pawn, amongst other things.
25...♖xf4
25...♘f8 loses to 26 g5 ♖c6 27 ♘h5+.
26 ♗xf4
and White won.

663) Illescas – Korchnoi
Madrid 1996
27 ♘xg6! 1-0
Black resigned in view of 27...♔xg6 28 gxf5+ ♔g7 (or 28...exf5 29 ♕g4+ ♗g5 30 ♖xf5) 29 ♕h5 ♗g5 30 ♕g6+ ♔h8 31 fxe6.

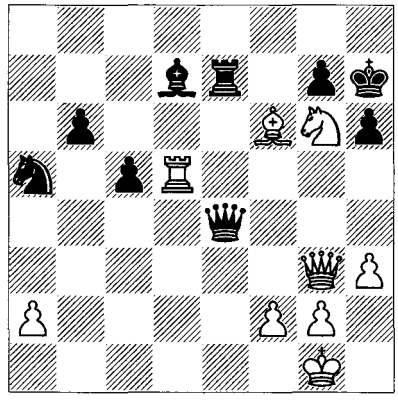
664) Milos – Murshed
FIDE Knockout, Groningen 1997
26 ♖de1! ♕xc3 27 ♖f3 ♕xe1+
After 27...♕b2 28 c3 the f6-rook can't be defended.
28 ♕xe1 ♖xf3 29 ♗xf3 ♘c6 30 ♕h4+ f6 31 ♕h7+ ♔d6 32 ♕g7 f5 33 h4 1-0

665) Calzetta – Jackova
European Team Ch (Women), Gothenburg 2005
18 ♖f5!
There is no satisfactory defence against 19 ♘f3, since the e7-rook has to defend f7.
18...♖e6
If 18...g5?! White can play 19 ♗xf7+ ♖xf7 20 ♖xf7 ♔xf7 21 ♘f3 ♕h5 22 ♘xe5+.
19 ♗xe6 fxe6 20 ♖f3
White went on to win.

666) An. Rodríguez – Shabalov
Buenos Aires 2005
66 c7! e2
White's task after 66...♘xc7 67 ♖xe3 ♔f4 68 ♖e7 ♘d5 69 ♖f7+ ♔e4 70 ♔g4 is simple, as it is also after 66...exf2 67 c8♕ f1♕ 68 ♕xe6+.
67 ♖xe6! 1-0
67...♔xe6 68 c8♕+ ♔d5 69 ♕c3.

667) Pavlović – Caruana
Moscow 2008
30...♘xe3+! 31 fxe3 ♘g3+ 32 ♔g1 ♕xe3+ 33 ♕f2 ♘e2+ 34 ♔f1 ♘g3+ 35 ♔g1 ♘e2+ 36 ♔f1 ♕xf2+ 37 ♔xf2 ♗g3+ 38 ♔f1 ♘xd4 0-1
If 39 ♖xd4 then 39...♖xa5.

668) Mariotti – Gligorić
Venice 1971
33 ♗xf6! ♕e4
33...gxf6 loses to 34 ♕g6+ ♔h8 35 ♕xh6+ ♔g8 36 ♕xf6 (threatening 37 ♖g5+) 36...♖g7 37 ♘f5! ♗xf5 38 ♖d8+ ♔h7 39 ♕xf5+ ♖g6 40 ♕f7+, mating quickly.
34 ♘g6!! *(D)*



34...♕xg6?!
More tenacious is 34...♕xd5! 35 ♘xe7 ♕f7 36 ♕d3+ ♔h8 37 ♗xg7+ ♔xg7 38 ♕xd7 with a great advantage to White, but not 34...♖f7? 35 ♘f8+ ♔g8 36 ♖xd7.
35 ♗xe7 ♗e6

35...♕xg3 36 fxg3 ♗e6 37 ♖d6 ♗xa2 38 ♖xb6 leads to a lost ending.

36 ♖d6 ♕f7 37 ♖xb6 ♘c4

37...♕xe7 38 ♕e3.

38 ♖b7

and White won.

669) Savon – Mecking

Petropolis Interzonal 1973

18...♘b3+! 19 ♔b1

19 ♘xb3 loses to 19...♖xc2+ 20 ♔b1 ♖xe2+ 21 ♔a1 ♗xh1.

19...♖xd4 20 ♗xd6 ♗xh1

Black has a decisive material advantage.

670) Maderna – Piazzini

Argentine Ch match (game 14), Buenos Aires 1940

47 ♔h2!

The only move to win, since 47 ♔h3? allows 47...♗g4+ 48 ♔h2 ♘f1+ 49 ♔g2 ♘e3+ 50 ♔h2 with a draw, while 47 ♔h1? ♗f3+ 48 ♔h2 (not 48 ♔g1?? ♘d5+) 48...♘g4+ 49 ♔h3 ♘f2+ 50 ♔h2 ♘g4+ is also a draw.

47...♗e5

47...♘g4+ loses to 48 ♔h3! ♘f2+ 49 ♔g2.

48 ♕c8+ ♔f7 49 ♘d8+ ♔g8

The h8-knight is lost after 49...♔e7 50 ♘c6+ ♔d6 51 ♘xe5.

50 ♘c6+ ♔h7 51 ♘xe5 ♗xh5 52 g4 ♗g6 53 ♕c5 1-0

671) Pilnik – Foguelman

Mar del Plata 1965

34 h5+! ♔xh5

Also losing is 34...♔g5 35 ♕a5+! ♔g4 36 ♖e4+ and the king can't survive the onslaught by the three white pieces; e.g., 36...♔h3 37 ♖h1+ ♖h2 38 ♕c3+ ♔g2 (or 38...♕g3 39 ♖xh2+ ♔xh2 40 ♖e2+ ♔h3 41 ♖e3) 39 ♖g4+! ♔xh1 40 ♕c1+ and mate.

35 ♕h3+ ♔g5 36 ♖d5+ ♔f6 37 ♕e6# (1-0)

672) Ju. Bolbochán – Foguelman

Mar del Plata 1965

32 ♖xf6!! ♖xd5

32...♕d4 loses to 33 ♖h6+ ♘h7 34 ♖xh7+! ♔xh7 35 ♕b7+.

33 exd5 ♘h7

The advanced pawns mean that the defence 33...♕b7 fails to 34 ♖h6+ ♘h7 35 ♖gh3 ♖e7 36 ♖xh7+! ♖xh7 37 ♖xh7+ ♕xh7 38 ♗xh7 ♔xh7 39 e7.

34 ♖f7 ♘f8 35 ♖h3+ ♔g8 36 ♖g3+ ♔h8 37 e7 ♕h6 38 ♖h3 ♕xh3 39 exf8♕+ 1-0

673) Mecking – Panno

Buenos Aires 1967

41 ♕h3!

The queen's entrance ends all resistance. Penetrating the queenside with the queen by 41 f7?! ♔xf7 42 ♕c2 ♕g6 43 ♕c7+ ♔e8 44 ♕c8+ ♔e7 achieves nothing.

41...♖xb2

Or 41...♔xf6 42 ♕e6+ ♔g7 43 ♕e7+ ♔g8 and there are many ways to win; e.g., 44 ♕f6 g4 45 ♖f5 ♖xf3+ 46 ♖xf3 gxf3 47 ♖g1!.

42 ♕e6 1-0

After 42...♖bb8 the quickest win is the unusual 43 ♔g4! threatening 44 ♖xg5+ hxg5 45 ♕f5+, against which there is no satisfactory defence.

674) Mariotti – Korchnoi

Rome 1982

26 ♗xg7! ♔xg7

If 26...♘xe1 White wins by 27 ♗xf8 ♘cd3 28 ♗c5!! ♕xc5+ 29 ♕xc5 ♘xf3+ 30 ♔g2 ♘xc5 31 ♔xf3.

27 ♕g5+ ♔h8 28 ♖d8 ♘d7 29 ♖ee8 ♕d4+ 30 ♔g2 ♕g7 31 ♕e7 ♔g8 32 ♕xd7 1-0

675) Granda – Oll

Groningen (PCA qualifier) 1993

27 ♖xf6! ♕xf6

White wins after 27...♘xf6 28 ♕g5! (or 28 ♕h6), followed by 29 ♗e5.

28 ♘c5! ♘xc5 29 ♗e5 ♕xe5 30 dxe5 1-0

676) Illescas – J. Polgar

Moscow Olympiad 1994

35 ♘b5!!

This looks like a blunder but is actually the start of a winning manoeuvre; it defends the a7-rook and prepares the subsequent blow.

35...♘xd2

If 35...♘d4 then White still plays 36 ♕g4, while after 35...♘f6 White wins with 36 ♘f5.

36 ♕g4! ♕xa7

The line 36...♘e7 37 ♖xe7 ♖g8 38 ♘f5 offers Black no hope.

37 ♘xa7 ♘f6 38 ♕f5+ ♔h8 39 ♕g6 ♘dxe4 40 ♘f5 ♖g8 41 ♘c8!

The final offensive, with all White's pieces in the attack, is unanswerable.

41...♘xd5

41...♗f8 42 ♕f7 followed by 43 ♘ce7 leaves Black defenceless.

42 ♘cxd6 1-0

677) Illescas – Karpov

Villarrobledo (rapid) 1997

37 ♖f6+! ♔xg5

If 37...♔e4 White wins by setting up two passed pawns: 38 ♖e6+ ♔f3 39 c6 ♗f4 40 ♖xg6 ♖g4 41 ♖f6 ♔e4 42 ♖e6+ ♔f5 (42...♔f3 43 g6) 43 ♔d5! followed by 44 ♗e5, or 44 g6, depending on what Black plays.

38 c6 ♗f4

Neither 38...♗e3 39 ♖d6 ♗xd4 40 ♖xd4 ♖h1 41 ♔b5! ♖c1 42 ♖c4 nor 38...♖h1 39 ♔d3! ♗f4 40 ♖xf4! ♔xf4 41 c7 is any better.

39 ♔d5!

Threatening 40 ♖xf4 ♖xf4 41 ♗e3, when the c-pawn queens.

39...♗c7

If 39...♗h2 then 40 ♖f2, while 39...♖h1 fails to halt the c-pawn after 40 ♖xf4 ♔xf4 41 c7 ♖c1 and now 42 ♗c5 wins.

40 ♖f7 ♗d8 41 c7 1-0

678) Salov – Milos

FIDE Knockout, Las Vegas 1999

35...♘d3! 36 ♘b6

After 36 ♖xe7 the black queen infiltrates decisively by 36...♕xe7 37 ♖f1 (or 37 ♖xd3 ♕e1+ 38 ♔h2 ♗e5+ and Black wins) 37...♘e1 38 ♕d5 ♕e2.

36...♖xe2 37 ♘xd7

37 ♕xe2 loses to 37...♖xe2 38 ♘xd7 ♘f2+.

37...♘f2+ 0-1

679) Vallejo – Nysret

European Clubs Cup, Izmir 2004

29 ♗xf6! ♖e8

29...gxf6 loses to 30 ♕xf6+ ♘g7 31 ♖xg7 ♗xg7 32 ♘xg7 ♕xg7 (32...♔g8 33 ♘f5) 33 ♕xd8+ ♕g8 34 ♕f6+ ♕g7 35 ♕xd6. The best defence is 29...♕f7! but White gains an overwhelming advantage thanks to his bishop-pair after 30 ♘xg7! ♗xg7 31 ♖xg7 ♘xg7 32 e5! ♗xf3+ 33 ♔h2 ♕g8 34 ♗xd8 dxe5 35 ♗f6 e4 36 ♗e5.

30 ♘xg7! ♗xg7 31 ♖xg7 ♘xg7 32 e5 1-0

There is no way to defend h7.

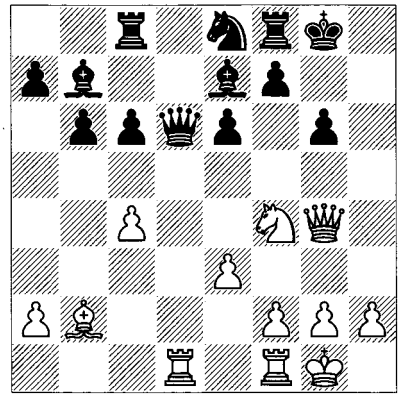
680) R. Sanguineti – Donoso

Fortaleza Zonal 1975

18 ♗xg6! hxg6!

If 18...exd5 then any discovery by the g6-bishop wins, such as 19 ♗e4+.

19 ♘f4 *(D)*



B

19...♕b4?

With 19...♕c5! Black can still fight on; the key is that his queen can now reach the kingside with ...♕g5. Then:

a) The tempting 20 ♘xg6?! yields no advantage for White after 20...♗f6! 21 ♘e7++ (21 ♘e5+ ♗g7 22 ♘d7 ♕e7! 23 ♘xf8 ♔xf8 24 ♗xg7+ ♘xg7 25 ♖d3 c5! 26 ♖fd1 ♗c6 is even less convincing) 21...♔h7 22 ♗xf6 ♘xf6 23 ♕h4+ ♔g7, and White has no more than a draw.

b) White retains the better chances after 20 ♖d7! ♕g5 (if 20...♖c7 then 21 ♘xg6! does now win; e.g., 21...♗f6 22 ♘xf8+ ♔xf8 23 ♖xc7 ♘xc7 24 ♗xf6) 21 ♕h3 (threatening 22 ♕h8#) 21...♘g7 22 ♖xb7, with advantage to White, but with everything still to play for.

20 ♘xg6! f5

If 20...♗f6 it is mate in a few moves with 21 ♘e7++ ♔h7 22 ♕h5+ ♔g7 23 ♕g5+ ♔h7 24 ♗xf6 ♘xf6 25 ♖d4!.

21 ♘xe7++ ♔f7 22 ♕g6+ ♔xe7 23 ♕g5+ 1-0

8 Tests 6-10

This chapter contains the second set of five tests (the final batch is in Chapter 10). Each test is of roughly equal difficulty, and contains 16 different puzzle positions. Of these positions, two are of level 1 difficulty (i.e. novices should have a good chance of solving them), four are level 2, six are level 3, two are level 4 and the final two feature our top difficulty rating, level 5, and are designed to prove taxing even for the very best players.

Your task is to find the best continuation. The number of points available varies from puzzle to puzzle, depending on the difficulty level. 1 point is the maximum for a level 1 puzzle, 2 points for a level 2 puzzle and so on until 5 points is the maximum for level 5. Therefore each test has a maximum number of 46 points on offer.

The number of points given for each puzzle depends on how much of the critical line(s) you have found. Identifying the correct initial move will grant you at least half the total number of points available for each puzzle, but additional credit will often be given for good supporting analysis.

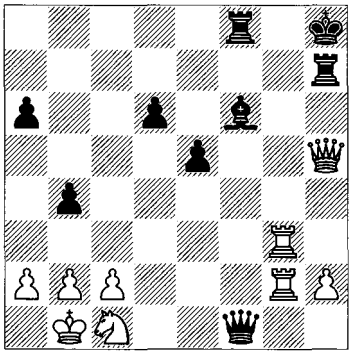
There is no specific time limit for these tests. You should tackle the positions as if you had to choose the next move in an important competitive game. In general, it is rare for additional reflection after the first 20 minutes to improve the quality of the decision, though of course in the level 5 mega-puzzles, you may need extra time to analyse the complications. Thus as a rough guide, each test of 16 puzzles should take between 1 and 2 hours. Remember that you should not move the pieces or use the help of a computer.

Test Score to Elo Points Conversion Chart

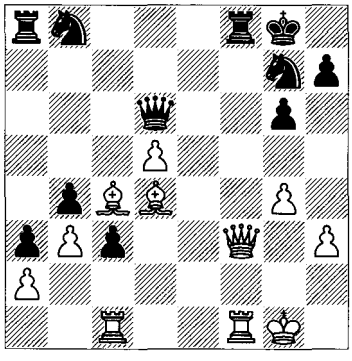
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4-6	1100
7-9	1200
10-12	1300
13-15	1400
16-18	1500
19-20	1600
21-22	1700
23-24	1800
25-26	1900
27-28	2000
29-31	2100
32-34	2200
35-37	2300
38-40	2400
41-43	2500
44-46	2600 or above

Test 6

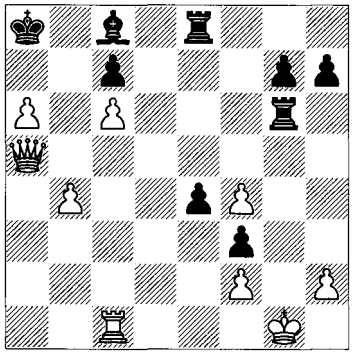
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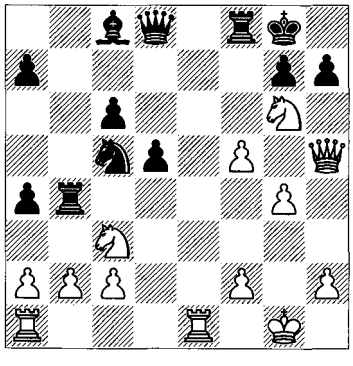
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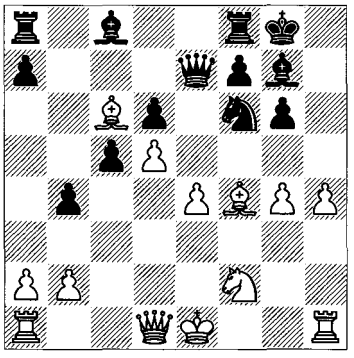
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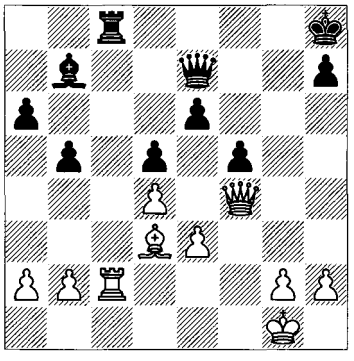
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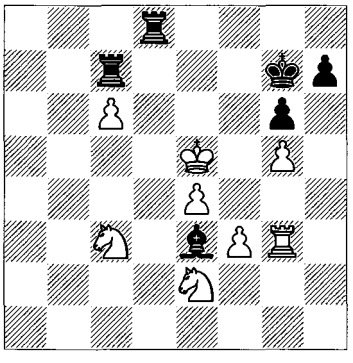
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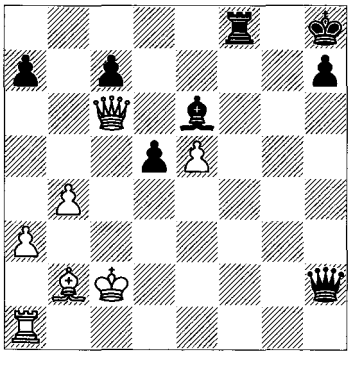
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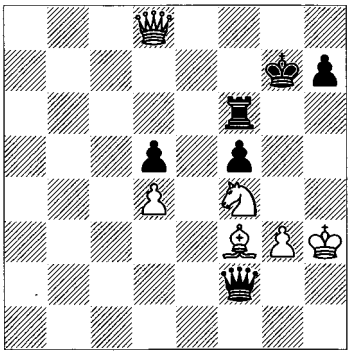
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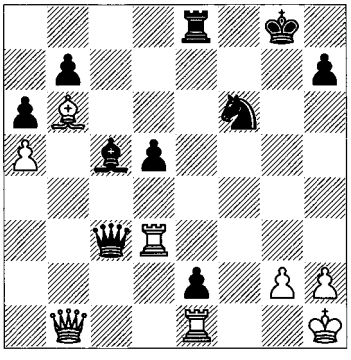
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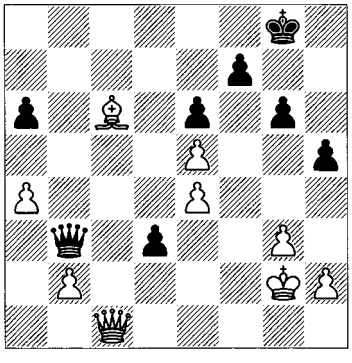
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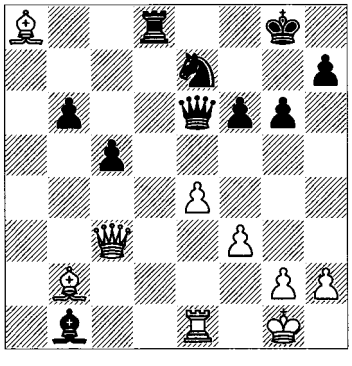
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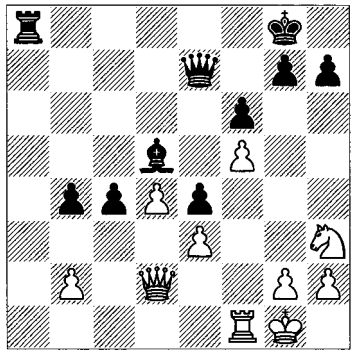
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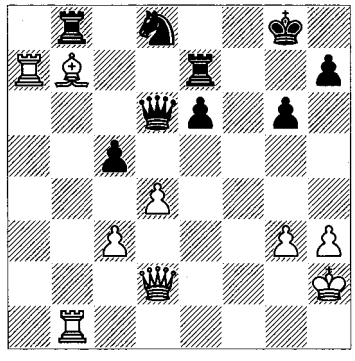
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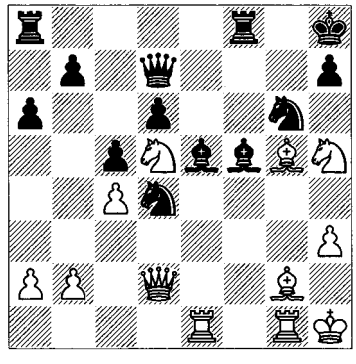
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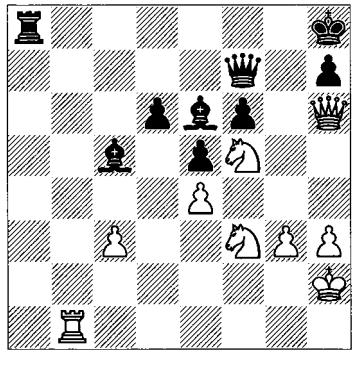
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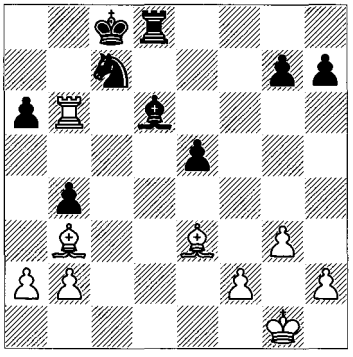


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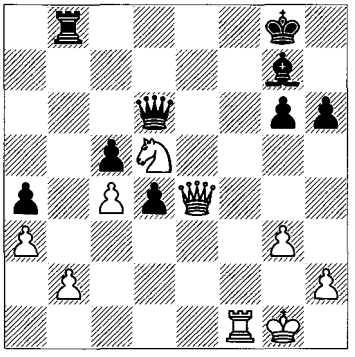


Test 7

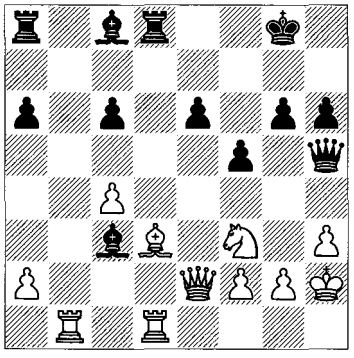
697
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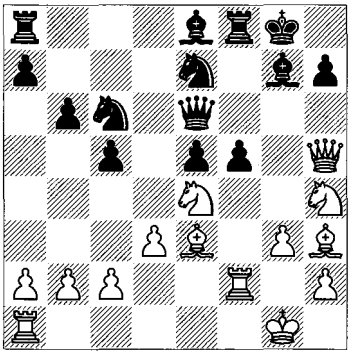
701
W



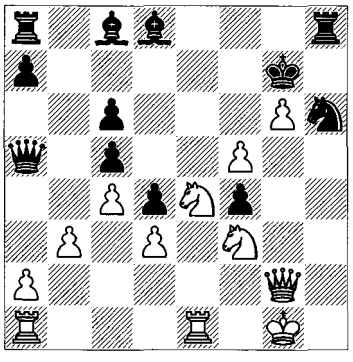
698
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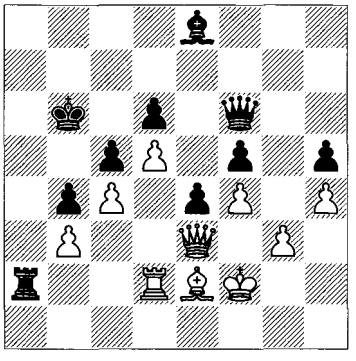
702
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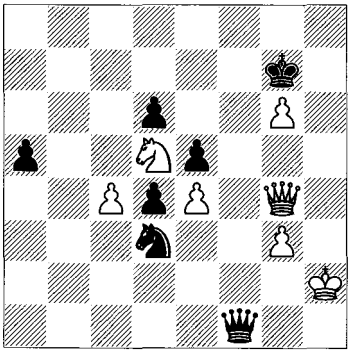
699
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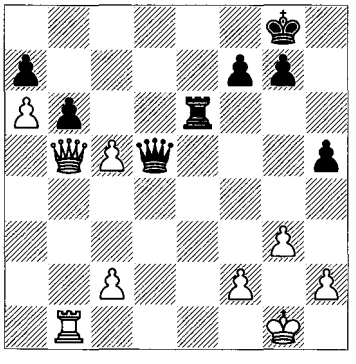
703
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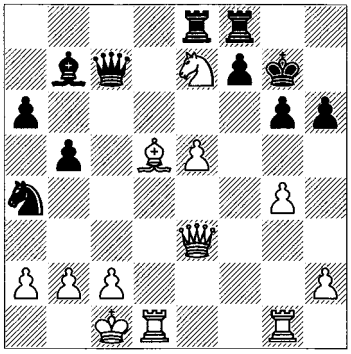
700
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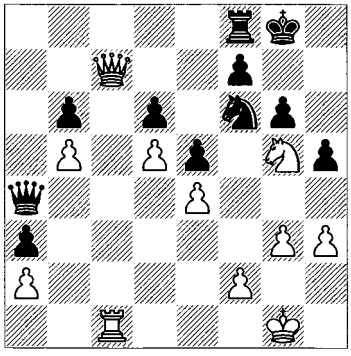
704
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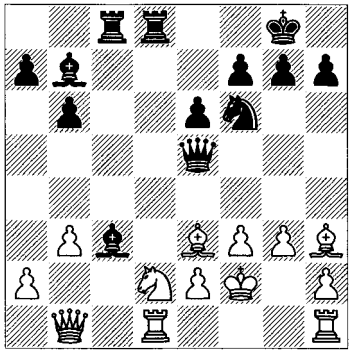
705
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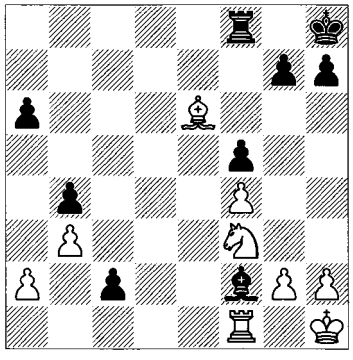
706
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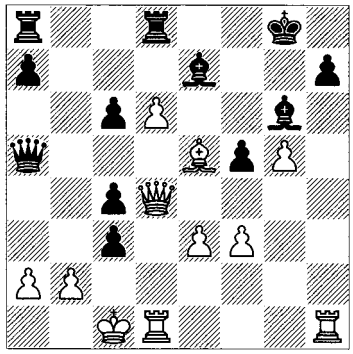
707
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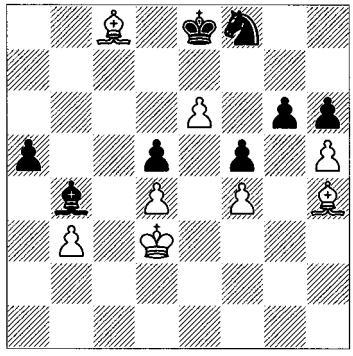
708
B



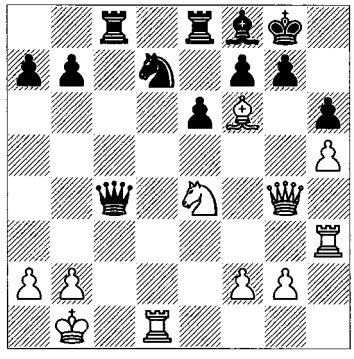
709
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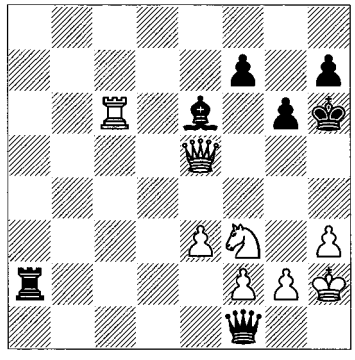
710
W



711
W

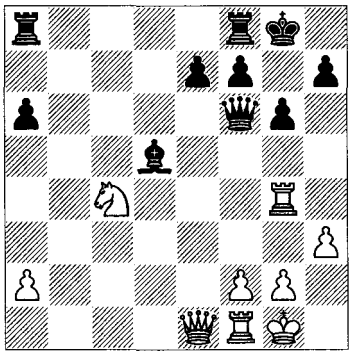


712
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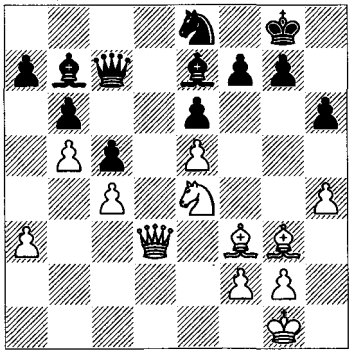


Test 8

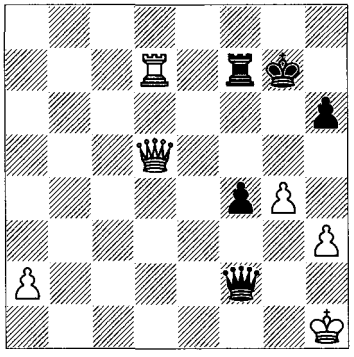
713
B



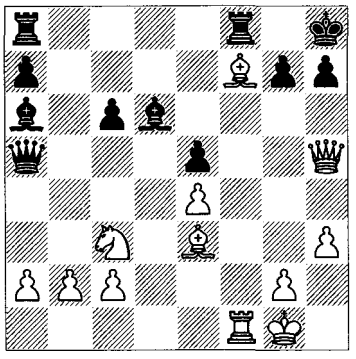
717
W



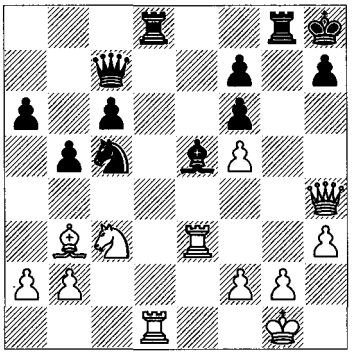
714
B



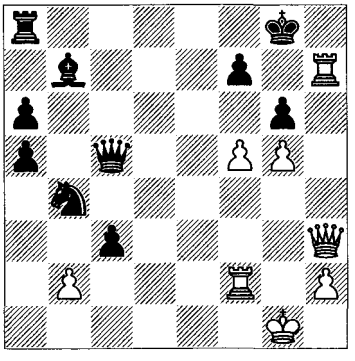
718
B



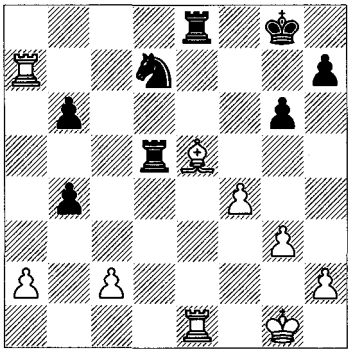
715
B



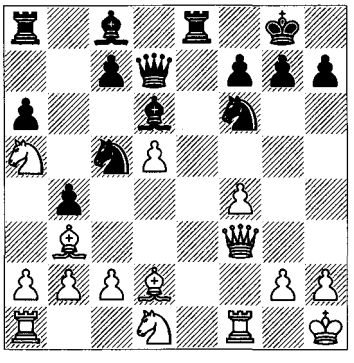
719
B



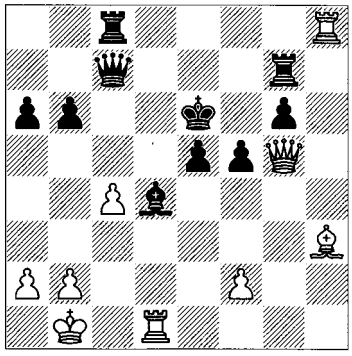
716
W



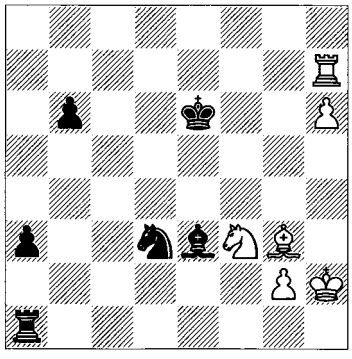
720
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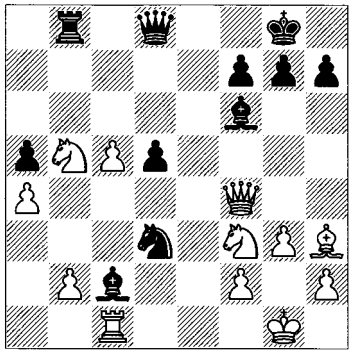
721
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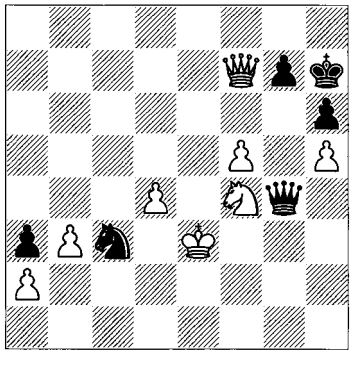
722
W



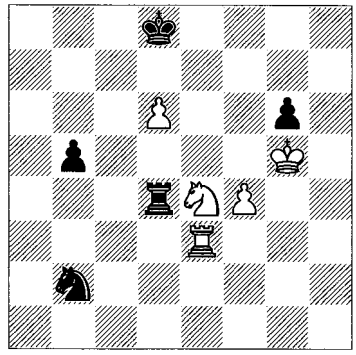
723
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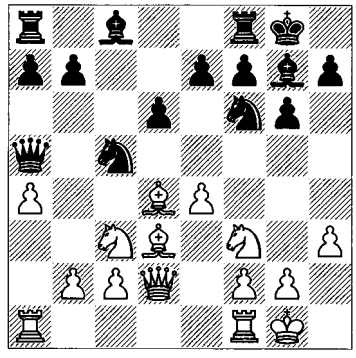
724
B



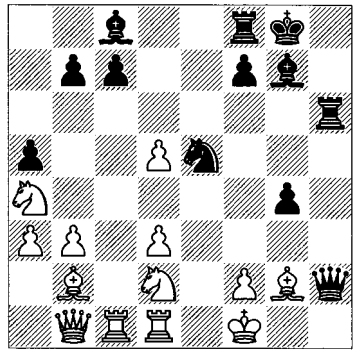
725
W



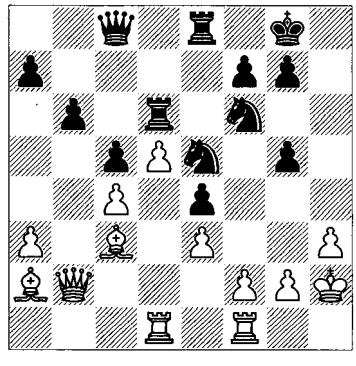
726
W



727
B

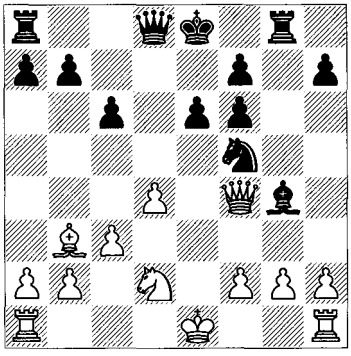


728
B

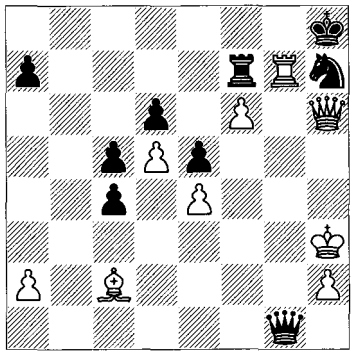


Test 9

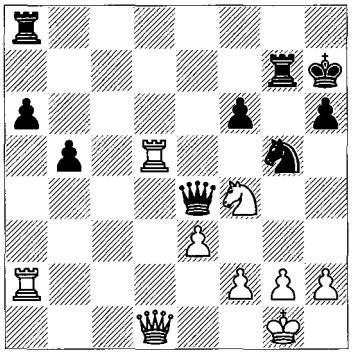
729
W



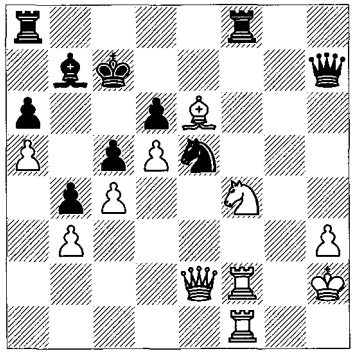
733
B



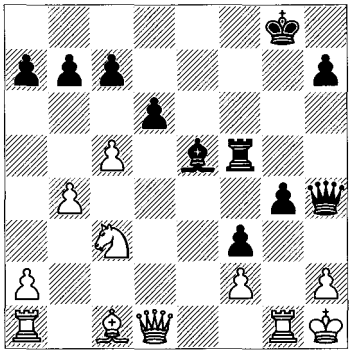
730
B



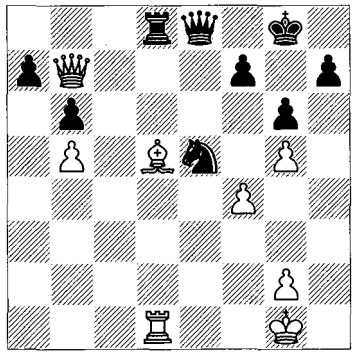
734
W



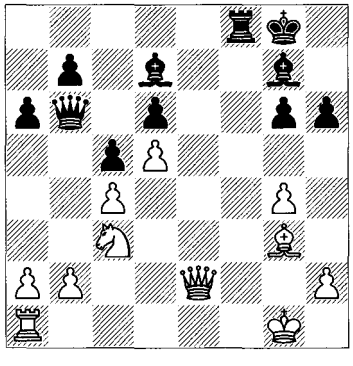
731
W



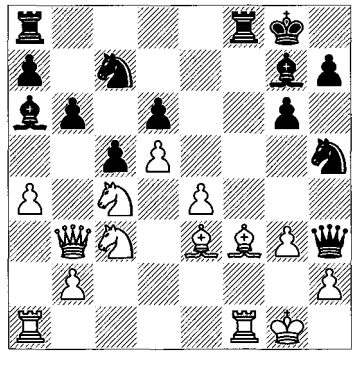
735
B



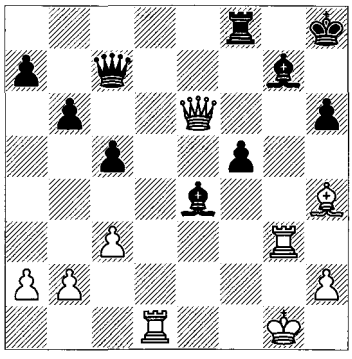
732
B



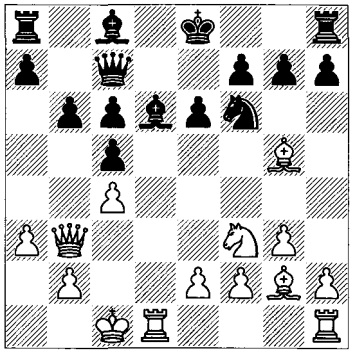
736
B



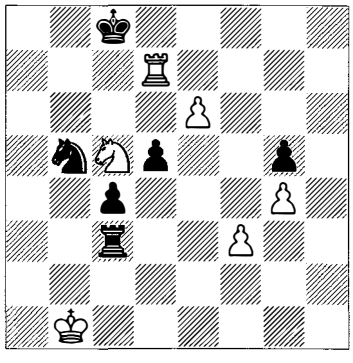
737
B



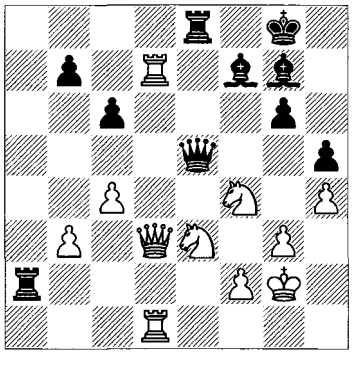
738
W



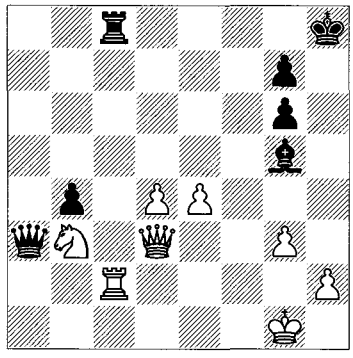
739
B



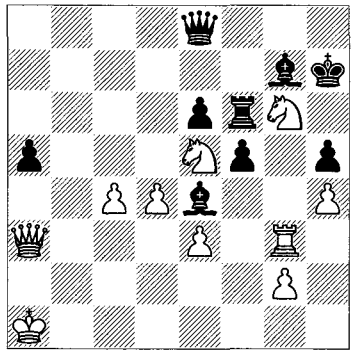
740
W



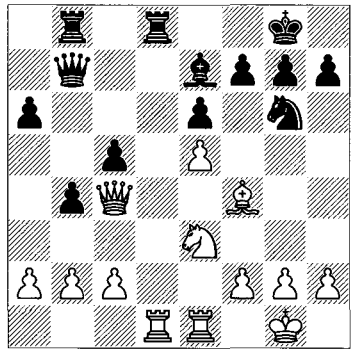
741
B



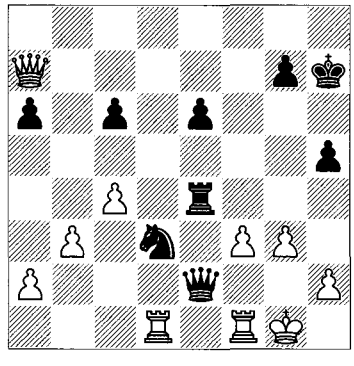
742
B



743
B

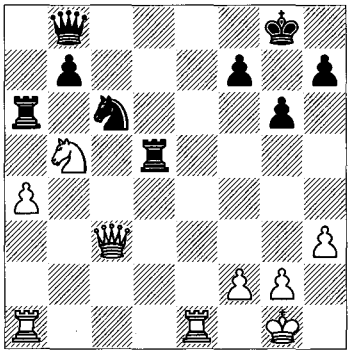


744
B

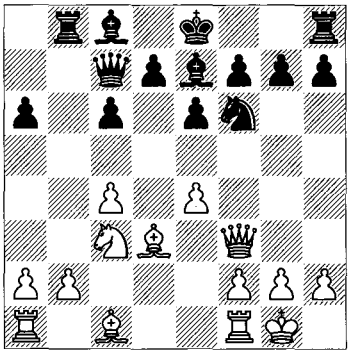


Test 10

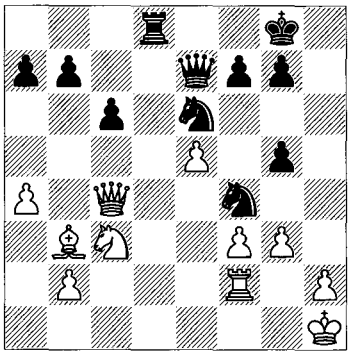
745
W



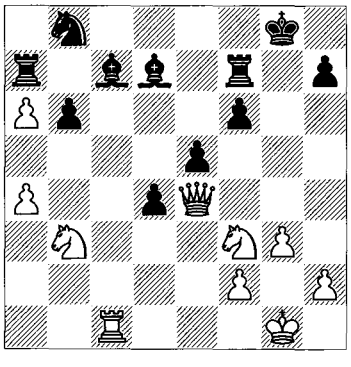
746
W



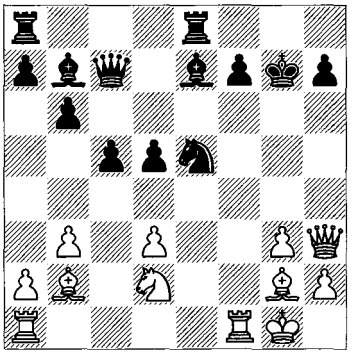
747
B



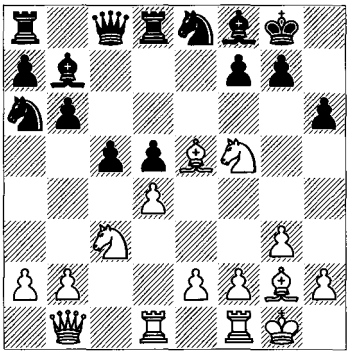
748
W



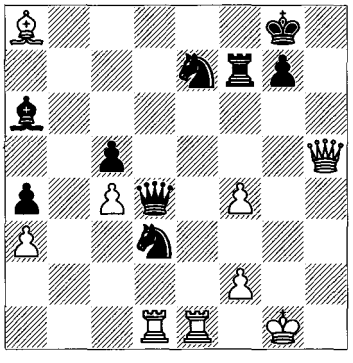
749
W



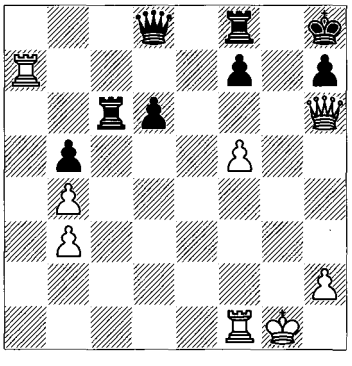
750
W



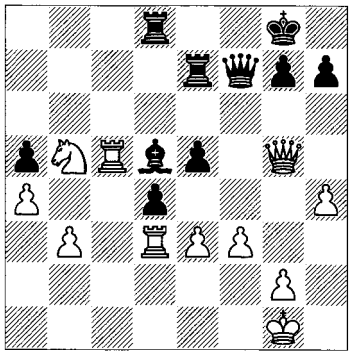
751
W



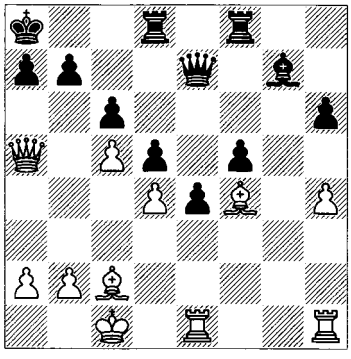
752
W



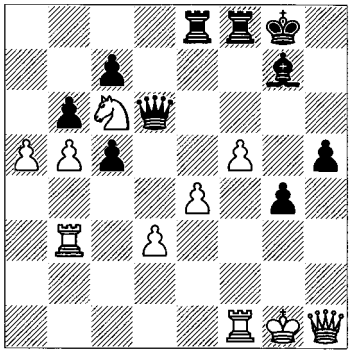
753
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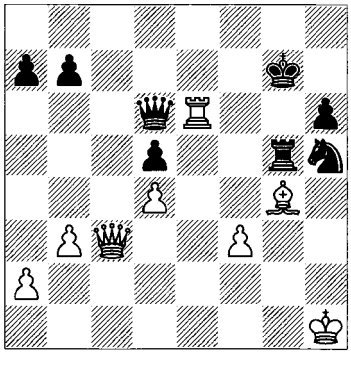
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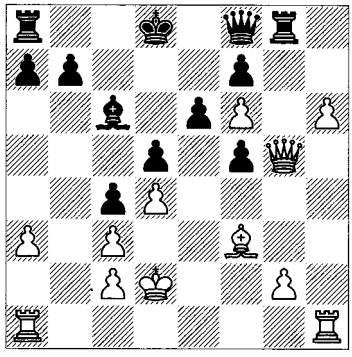
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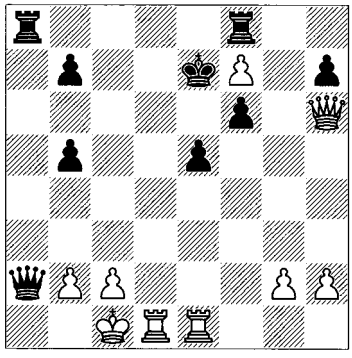
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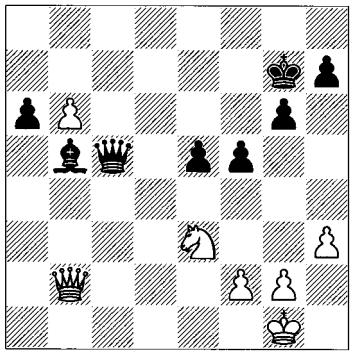
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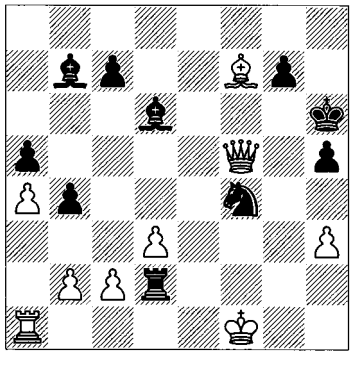
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Answers for Chapter 8

Test 6 Answers

681) Mecking – Najdorf
Mar del Plata 1971

37 ♕xh7+! ♔xh7 38 ♖h3+ 1-0

1 point for 37 ♕xh7+!.

682) Najdorf – de Ronde
Buenos Aires 1945

37 ♕xf8+! ♕xf8 38 d6+ 1-0

White is a rook up and mates in a few moves.

1 point for 37 ♕xf8+!.

683) Falcon – Rauch
Buenos Aires 1945

33 ♔f1?

This loses; **33 ♔h1!** is essential and after 33...♗h3 34 f5 ♖g5 35 ♕xc7 ♗g2+ 36 ♔g1 ♗h3+ Black has no more than a draw.

33...♗h3+ 34 ♔e1 ♖d8 35 ♕g5 ♖xg5

and Black won.

2 points for 33 ♔h1!.

684) F. Benko – Maderna
Buenos Aires 1945

17...hxg6! 18 fxg6 ♖xg4+ 19 ♔h1 ♕h4

Repelling the attack, and retaining an extra piece.

2 points for 17...hxg6!.

685) Schaefer – Lipiniks
corr. 1955-62

18...♗xg4! 19 ♗xd6?

This doesn't work, but there is hardly anything better; if 19 ♘xg4? ♕xe4+ White loses the house.

19...♕xd6 20 ♘xg4 ♕g3+! 21 ♘f2 ♘xe4 22 ♕e2 ♘xf2 23 ♕xf2 ♖ae8+ 0-1

24 ♗xe8 ♖xe8+ 25 ♔f1 ♕d3+ 26 ♔g2 ♖e2 is hopeless for White.

2 points for 18...♗xg4!.

686) Ju. Bolbochán– Perez Alcocer
São Paulo Zonal 1960

25 ♕e5+! ♕g7

No better is 25...♔g8 26 ♗xf5! ♖xc2 27 ♗xe6+! and Black must give up his queen, since 27...♔f8? allows 28 ♕h8#.

26 ♕xe6 1-0

2 points for 25 ♕e5+!.

687) Falcon – Lynch
Buenos Aires 1945

Going forward with 40 ♔e6? looks suicidal, and is; the quickest way for Black to win is 40...♔f8! 41 ♘d5 ♖xc6+ 42 ♔e5 ♖e8+. The game went **40 ♘f4? ♖e7+ 0-1**. It is mate after 41 ♘e6+ ♔f7 and ...♖xe6#.

40 ♘d5! is the only move to prevent mate, after which White should win; for example, 40...♖xc6 (or 40...♖e8+ 41 ♔d6 and White wins) 41 ♘xe3, with a decisive material advantage.

3 points for 40 ♘d5!.

688) Vidmar – Guimard
Staunton Memorial, Groningen 1946

30 ♔b1?

White can defend successfully with **30 ♔b3!**; e.g., 30...♕h3+ (after 30...♖f3+ 31 ♔a4 {or 31 ♔a2} 31...♕xb2 32 ♕xe6 ♕xa1 33 ♕c8+ ♔g7 34 ♕g4+, the exposure of Black's king guarantees the draw) 31 ♔a4! and now 31...♗d7? fails to 32 e6+!.

30...♕h3!

Ensuring that the bishop, as well as the rook, can take part in the attack.

31 ♕c5 ♖f1+ 32 ♔c2 ♗f5+ 0-1

It's mate after 33 ♔d2 ♕d3#.

3 points for 30 ♔b3!.

689) Maderna – Castillo
Mar del Plata 1948

44...♖h6+?

Black can achieve a draw with **44...♕xf3!**; e.g., 45 ♕e7+ ♔g8! (45...♖f7? leads to mate after 46 ♘e6+) 46 ♕e8+ ♔g7 (or 46...♖f8 47 ♕e6+ ♖f7) and there is nothing better than 47 ♕e7+, since 47 ♘h5+? loses to 47...♔h6 48 ♘xf6 ♕h1#.

45 ♗h5 ♕f1+ 46 ♔h4 ♕h1+ 47 ♔g5 ♖g6+ 48 ♗xg6 ♕h6+ 49 ♔xf5 hxg6+ 50 ♔e5 1-0

3 points for 44...♕xf3!.

690) Reinhardt – Ju. Bolbochán
Mar del Plata Zonal 1951

33...♕xe1+! 34 ♕xe1 ♗b4! 35 ♕g3+

Opting for the endgame with 35 ♖g3+ ♔f7 36 ♕xb4 e1♕+ 37 ♕xe1 ♖xe1+ 38 ♗g1 d4 39 h3 (if 39 ♖d3? then 39...♘e4!) 39...♖d1 is no better.

35...♔h8 0-1

White could have fought on, but he has a lost game; e.g., 36 ♗f2 e1♕+ 37 ♗xe1 ♖xe1+ 38

♕xe1 ♗xe1 39 ♖b3 d4 40 ♔g1 ♗xa5 41 ♖xb7 d3 42 ♔f1 ♘d5 43 ♖d7 ♘e3+ 44 ♔f2 ♘d1+ 45 ♔f1 ♘b2.

2 points for 33...♕xe1+! and 1 point for 34...♗b4!.

691) Salo – Ju. Bolbochán
Moscow Olympiad 1956

33 ♕f1?

White needs to head for perpetual check with ♕d8+ and ♕f6 by playing **33 ♕g5!**; e.g., 33...♕c2+ 34 ♔h3! d2 (or 34...♕xc6 35 ♕d8+ ♔h7 36 ♕xd3, with a probable draw) 35 ♕d8+ ♔h7 36 ♕f6 d1♕ 37 ♕xf7+ ♔h6 38 ♕f8+ ♔h7 39 ♕f7+. White could also reverse the move-order, starting with **33 ♔h3!**, meeting 33...♕c2 with 34 ♕g5 or 34 ♕f1.

33...d2 34 ♗e8 f5! 35 ♗d7 ♕c2

Not 35...d1♕?? 36 ♗xe6+! and White turns the tables.

36 ♗xe6+ ♔g7 37 ♗b3 ♕xb3 38 ♕xa6 d1♕ 39 ♕f6+ ♔g8 40 ♕xg6+ ♔f8 41 ♕xf5+ ♔e7 0-1

The black king escapes.

3 points for 33 ♕g5! and also 3 points for 33 ♔h3! with the idea of 34 ♕g5.

692) Panno – A. Martinez
Buenos Aires 1957

31 ♗d5! wins material by force: **31...♘xd5 32 exd5 ♕f5 33 g4! ♕c2 34 ♕xf6 1-0**.

2 points for 31 ♗d5! and 1 point for 33 g4!.

693) Portisch – R. Sanguineti
Biel Interzonal 1976

27...c3!

Black must act quickly, before the h3-knight comes into play.

28 bxc3 ♖a2 29 ♕c1 b3!

And the passed pawn is winning.

30 c4 ♖c2 31 ♕a1 ♗xc4 32 ♕a8+ ♕f8 33 ♕a4 ♕c8 34 ♖b1 ♔h8 35 ♘f4 ♗g8 36 ♖f1 ♕c3 0-1

3 points for 27...c3! and 1 point for 29...b3!.

694) Galego – Beliavsky
Bled Olympiad 2002

31 ♖a6!

The saving move, unpinning. Instead, after the passive 31 ♕g2? White remains paralysed by the pin; e.g., 31...cxd4 32 cxd4 ♖f7! and there is no satisfactory defence against 33...♕c7.

31...♕d7

Not 31...♕xa6? because after 32 ♗xa6 ♖xb1 33 dxc5 the passed pawn is strong.

32 ♗e4 ♖xb1 33 ♗xb1 ♕b7 34 ♗d3 cxd4 35 cxd4 ♖d7 36 ♖a4 ♖d6 37 ♗f1 ♖b6 38 ♖a2 ♖b3 39 ♗g2 ♕c7 ½-½

4 points for 31 ♖a6!.

695) Paunović – Dzhumaev
Orense 2005

27...♘f3!!

Black makes cunning use of his queen's potential attack on the h3-pawn.

28 ♗xf3

After 28 ♗f6+ ♗xf6 29 ♗xf3 (29 ♘hxf6 ♘xd2 30 ♘xd7 ♗xd7 is equally hopeless) 29...♗e5 30 ♗g4 ♗xg4 31 hxg4 ♖f3, Black's attack is irresistible.

28...♗e4!

Clearing the way.

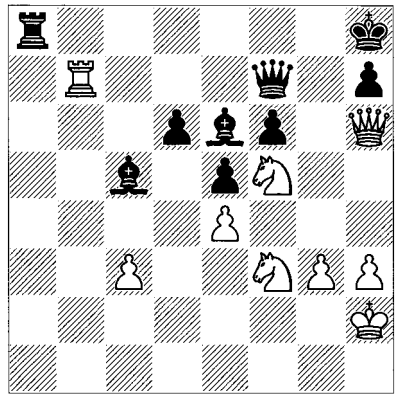
29 ♖g3 ♗xf3+ 30 ♖xf3 ♖xf3 31 ♘df4 ♖xh3+ 32 ♔g1 ♕g4+ 33 ♕g2 ♗d4+ 0-1

4 points for finding 27...♘f3!! and 1 point for 28...♗e4!.

696) Korbut – T. Kosintseva
Russian Women's Ch, Gorodets 2006

38 ♖b7!! *(D)*

B



'Charge!' Although the white king is left exposed, the black queen is too far away to exploit this and the fierce f3-knight is sufficient defence for his king.

38...♖a2+

38...♕g6 loses to 39 ♖xh7+! ♕xh7 40 ♕xf6+ ♔g8 41 ♕xe6+ ♔f8 42 ♘3h4!. Of course 38...♕xb7? allows mate in two with 39 ♕xf6+ ♔g8 40 ♘h6#, while if 38...♗d7 then 39 ♖xd7! ♖a2+ 40 ♔h1 ♖a1+ 41 ♔g2 ♖a2+ 42 ♘d2! ♖xd2+, and now 43 ♔f3 ♖f2+ 44 ♔g4 ♕g6+ 45

♕xg6 hxg6 46 ♘h4 g5 47 ♘f5, with the idea of ♔h5-g6.

39 ♔h1 ♖a1+ 40 ♔g2 ♖a2+ 41 ♔h1 ♖a1+ 42 ♘g1!!

This is the key: White prevents the perpetual check by allowing his knight to be captured with check, in order to displace the black rook; 42 ♘e1! also works.

42...♖xg1+ 43 ♔h2 ♕g6 44 ♖xh7+! ♕xh7 45 ♕f8+ 1-0

With mate after 46 ♕xf6+.

5 points for 38 ♖b7!!.

Test 7 Answers

697) Ju. Bolbochán – Najdorf

Argentine Ch match (game 3), Buenos Aires 1949

28 ♗g5!

The black rook can't maintain its defence of the d6-bishop.

28...♗c5

28...♖d7 loses to 29 ♗a4 ♘b5 30 ♖xa6.

29 ♖c6 ♗d4 30 ♗xd8

and White won.

1 point for 28 ♗g5!.

698) Ju. Bolbochán – de Souza Mendes

Mar del Plata Zonal 1951

22 ♗xf5! ♖xd1 23 ♗xe6+ ♔h7 24 ♖xd1 and White won.

1 point for 22 ♗xf5!.

699) Wexler – Saadi

Mar del Plata 1960

26 f6+!

White opens lines and all his pieces burst in on the unprotected black king.

26...♗xf6 27 ♘xf6 ♗g4

Declining the sacrifice, and even giving up a piece himself, but there is no defence. 27...♕d8 loses to 28 ♘h5+ ♔g8 29 g7 ♖h7 30 ♘f6+ and if 27...♔xf6, then 28 ♕g5+ ♔g7 29 ♖e7+ wins.

28 ♘xg4 ♘f5 29 ♘g5 ♘g3 30 ♖e7+ ♔xg6 31 ♕xc6+

and White mates quickly.

2 points for 26 f6+!.

700) Eliskases – Wexler

Mar del Plata 1960

42...♕h1+!

Simplifying to a knight ending in which Black's two passed pawns will be decisive.

43 ♔xh1 ♘f2+ 44 ♔g2 ♘xg4 45 ♔f3 ♘e3 46 ♘b6

46 ♘xe3 dxe3 47 ♔xe3 ♔xg6 wins for Black; while the white king is rounding up the a5-pawn, Black captures all the white pawns and retains his own e-pawn.

46...♔xg6 47 ♔e2 ♔g5 48 ♔d3 ♔g4 49 ♘a4 ♔xg3

and Black soon won.

2 points for 42...♕h1+!.

701) Eliskases – Bielicki

Mar del Plata 1962

28 ♘f6+! ♕xf6

White's attack is winning after 28...♗xf6 29 ♕xg6+ ♔h8 30 ♕xh6+ ♔g8 31 ♕g6+ ♔h8 32 ♖xf6; e.g., 32...♕e5 (or 32...♕e7 33 ♕h5+ ♕h7 34 ♖h6) 33 ♕h6+ ♔g8 34 ♖g6+ ♔f7 35 ♕h7+ with mate in three.

29 ♖xf6 ♗xf6 30 ♕xg6+ ♗g7 31 ♕d6 ♖xb2 32 ♕xc5

and White won.

2 points for 28 ♘f6+!.

702) R.Garcia – R. Sanguineti

Buenos Aires 1965

17 ♕xh7+! 1-0

Resignation is perhaps a little premature, but Black is lost after 17...♔xh7 18 ♘g5+ ♔g8 19 ♘xe6, with an extra pawn and the better position.

2 points for 17 ♕xh7+!.

703) Eliskases – Szabo

Mar del Plata 1962

51...♖a3!

Beginning a series of energetic moves to clinch victory.

52 ♗d1

52 ♖d1 is met by 52...♕b2, winning the b3-pawn.

52...♗a4! 53 ♗c2

If 53 ♖e2 Black wins with, amongst other things, 53...♕a1! 54 ♖e1 (neither 54 ♗c2 ♕h1 nor 54 ♖d2 ♗xb3 55 ♗xb3 ♕b1 56 ♗c2 ♕h1 is any better) 54...♗xb3 55 ♗xb3 ♕b2+.

53...♕c3 54 ♕xc3 bxc3 55 ♖d1 ♖a2! 56 bxa4 ♖xc2+ 57 ♔e3 ♖g2 0-1

2 points for finding 51...♖a3! and 1 point for 52...♗a4!.

704) Smyslov – Guimard

Mar del Plata 1962

28 cxb6!

'Falling for' the trap.

28...♖e1+

After 28...♕xb5 29 ♖xb5 axb6 White should play 30 ♔g2, followed by 31 a7, but not 30 a7? ♖e1+ 31 ♔g2 ♖a1.

29 ♖xe1! ♕xb5 30 bxa7 ♕c6 31 ♖b1 ♔h7 32 ♖b8 1-0

3 points for 28 cxb6!.

705) Klein – Marcussi

Argentine Ch, Buenos Aires 1963

23 ♘f5+! gxf5 24 gxf5+ ♔h7 25 ♕xh6+!

There are several other ways to win, such as 25 ♖d4, but this is the quickest and most elegant.

25...♔xh6 26 ♖d3 1-0

3 points for 23 ♘f5+!.

706) Illescas – Vallejo

Spanish Team Ch, Mondariz 2002

30 ♕e7!

Exploiting the absence of the black queen, White begins a fierce attack.

30...♘xe4

If 30...♘e8 then White wins with 31 ♘h7 or 31 ♖c8 ♕xb5 32 ♘h7, while 30...♔g7 fails to 31 ♘e6+.

31 ♖c8! 1-0

It is mate in a few moves.

2 points for 30 ♕e7! and 1 point for 31 ♖c8!.

707) Agdamus – Rubinetti

Buenos Aires 1970

18...♕xe3+!!

Here we have another beautiful example of 'extraction' of the king.

19 ♔xe3 ♗d4+ 20 ♔f4 e5+ 21 ♔f5 ♖c6

21...♖c5! forces mate, as your analysis engine will demonstrate.

22 ♘e4 ♗c8+ 23 ♔g5 h6+ 24 ♔h4 g5+ 25 ♘xg5 hxg5+ 26 ♔xg5 ♘h7+ 27 ♔h5 ♗xh3?

An error that takes some of the gloss off the triumph; amongst other things, 27...♔g7 wins, since 28 ♗xc8? allows 28...♖h6+ 29 ♔g4 ♘f6+ 30 ♔f5 ♖h5#.

28 e3?

After 28 g4! the struggle could continue.

28...♖dd6 0-1

3 points for 18...♕xe3+!!.

708) Trois – Amado

Mercedes 1975

34...♖d8!

Now there is no defence against 35...♖d1; 34...♗e3? is a mistake in view of 35 ♘e5! and White comes back to life.

35 ♘g5 ♖d1! 36 ♘f7+ ♔g8 0-1

3 points for 34...♖d8!.

709) Kogan – Arencibia

Capablanca Memorial, Havana 2002

25 ♕xc4+! ♗f7 26 ♕xf7+!! ♔xf7 27 ♖xh7+ ♔e8

If 27...♔f8 White wins with 28 dxe7+ ♔e8 29 exd8♕+ ♖xd8 30 ♖xd8+ ♔xd8 31 ♗c7+.

28 ♖xe7+ ♔f8 29 ♗g7+ ♔g8 30 ♖h1 1-0

2 points for 25 ♕xc4+! and 2 more points for 26 ♕xf7+!!.

710) Illescas – Nakamura

Pamplona 2003

54 ♗d7+!

To deflect the f8-knight.

54...♘xd7 55 hxg6! 1-0

This is the key; after 55...♗f8 56 exd7+ ♔xd7 57 ♗f6 h5 58 g7 ♗xg7 59 ♗xg7 h4 White's king can stop the pawn with 60 ♔e3. In contrast, 55 exd7+? ♔xd7 56 hxg6 ♔e6 does not win.

2 points for 54 ♗d7+! and 2 points for 55 hxg6!.

711) Xu Yuhua – Ushenina

FIDE Women's Knockout, Ekaterinburg 2006

24 ♖c3!

First White removes the dangers to her own king, threatening both the queen and the knight, so Black's reply is forced.

24...♕b5 25 ♖xd7!

And the key defender is eliminated.

25...♔h8

There is no defence. 25...♕xd7 loses to 26 ♗xg7! ♗xg7 27 ♘f6+, while 25...♖xc3 26 ♗xc3 is also insufficient for Black.

26 ♖xf7 1-0

Black resigned in view of 26...gxf6 27 ♖h7+! ♔xh7 28 ♘xf6+ ♔h8 29 ♕g8#.

3 points for 24 ♖c3! and 2 points for 25 ♖xd7!.

712) K. Berg – Jacoby

Hamburg 2007

28 ♖xe6?

This tempting sacrifice ought not to win. The correct move-order is **28 ♕f4+!** ♔g7 (forced)

29 ♕d4+! ♔h6 (if 29...♔g8 then 30 ♖xe6! is good, threatening mate on e8: 30...fxe6 31 ♕d8+ ♔g7 32 ♕e7+ ♔h6 33 ♕f8+ ♔h5 34 g4#) 30 ♕h4+! ♔g7 31 ♘g5! (31 ♖xe6 also wins) 31...♖xf2 32 ♕xh7+ ♔f6 33 ♘e4+ ♔e7 34 ♕h4+ and White wins.

28...fxe6?

After 28...♕xf2!, which White could have ruled out with the precise series of checks mentioned above, White is forced to give perpetual check with 29 ♕g5+ ♔g7 30 ♕f6+ (if 30 ♖e7 then 30...♕xf3, while 30 ♖f6 is answered by 30...h6!) 30...♔h6 31 ♕f4+ ♔g7 32 ♕d4+, etc.

29 ♕g5+ ♔g7 30 ♕e7+ ♔h6

After 30...♔g8 31 ♕xe6+ the black rook is lost.

31 ♕f8+ 1-0

3 points for 28 ♕f4+!, 1 point for 29 ♕d4+! and 1 point for 30 ♕h4+!.

Test 8 Answers

713) Madeira de Ley – Ju. Bolbochán

Rio de Janeiro 1952

23...h5! 0-1

Black wins an exchange after 24 ♘e3 hxg4.

1 point for 23...h5!.

714) García Toledo – Riego

Mar del Plata Zonal 1969

56...♕e1+! 57 ♔h2 ♕g3+ 58 ♔h1 ♕xh3+ 0-1

After 59 ♔g1 ♕xg4+ the d7-rook is lost.

1 point for 56...♕e1+!.

715) Pilnik – Panno

Mar del Plata 1965

23...♘xb3!

White's back rank is inadequately defended.

24 ♖de1

Or 24 ♖xd8 ♖xd8 25 axb3 (25 ♖xe5 is better but still losing) 25...♗xc3 threatening 26...♖d1+ and mate.

24...♘d4

White resigned a few moves later.

2 points for 23...♘xb3!.

716) Stein – Pilnik

Mar del Plata 1965

29 ♗c3!

This simplification enables White to keep his extra pawn, as well as better pieces and superior structure.

29...♖xe1+ 30 ♗xe1 ♖d1 31 ♔f2 ♘c5 32 ♗xb4 ♖c1 33 c3 ♖c2+ 34 ♔e3 ♖xh2 35 a4 ♖g2

If 35...♘b3 then 36 ♖a8+ ♔g7 37 ♖b8 ♖a2 (or 37...♖g2 38 ♖xb6 ♖xg3+ 39 ♔e4, with two passed pawns and a big advantage) 38 ♖xb6 ♖xa4 39 c4 and White is a (passed) pawn up.

36 ♔f3 ♖c2

36...♖a2 is met by 37 a5.

37 a5 ♘a4

37...bxa5 loses to 38 ♗xc5 ♖xc3+ 39 ♗e3.

38 a6 ♖a2 39 ♖b7 ♘xc3 40 a7 ♘d5 41 ♗d6 1-0

2 points for 29 ♗c3!.

717) Uhlmann – Ju. Bolbochán

Mar del Plata 1966

26 ♘d6! ♗xf3

After 26...♗xd6 27 exd6 ♕d7 28 ♗xb7 ♕xb7 29 d7 White wins.

27 ♘xe8 ♕b8

There is nothing better; 27...♕d8 loses to 28 ♕xd8 ♗xd8 29 gxf3, while if 27...♕c8 then 28 ♘d6! also wins a piece.

28 ♘f6+!

Even better than 28 ♕d7.

28...gxf6 29 exf6 ♕e8 30 ♕xf3

White has a winning position, thanks to his extra pawn on f6, which paralyses Black. Let's follow the game a little further.

30...♗f8 31 ♕g4+ ♔h8 32 ♗d6! ♕d8 33 ♗e7 ♕e8 34 h5 ♕a8 35 ♕g3 ♔h7 36 ♕d6! ♕e4 37 ♗xf8

and White won quickly.

2 points for 26 ♘d6!.

718) García Martínez – Ju. Bolbochán

Havana Olympiad 1966

18...♗c5!

The exchange of these bishops brings White's attack, and the game, to an end. Not 18...♗xf1? 19 ♗g6 h6 20 ♗xh6! and White wins.

19 ♖f3 ♗xe3+ 20 ♖xe3 ♕c5 21 ♘d1 ♖ad8 0-1

2 points for 18...♗c5!.

719) Franco – H. García

Piriapolis 1977

33...♕d4?

Black can defend, and win, with **33...♕e5!**; for example, 34 ♖xf7 (34 fxg6 ♕xg5+ forces 35 ♕g3, when 35...♕xg3+ 36 hxg3 c2 wins) 34...♔xf7! 35 ♕h7+ ♔e8 36 ♕xb7 ♖b8, followed by 37...c2, winning.

34 bxc3!

It is important that White is able to eliminate the dangerous pawn with tempo.

34...♕e5

34...♕d1+? loses to 35 ♖f1.

Now White played **35 fxg6?!**, but 35 ♖e2! ♕c5+ 36 ♖e3 wins more quickly: 36...♕xe3+ 37 ♕xe3 ♔xh7 is forced and now the quickest way is 38 ♕h3+ ♔g8 39 f6 ♖e8 40 cxb4!, but not 40 ♕h6?? ♖e1+ 41 ♔f2 ♘d3+ 42 ♔g3 ♖e3+ 43 ♔h4 ♖h3+!! 44 ♔xh3 ♘f4+ 45 ♔h4 ♘h5, and the a5-pawn queens.

3 points for 33...♕e5!.

720) Franco – Guimard
Villa Gesell 1980

18...♕b5!

White is a pawn up but his position is precarious; Black dominates the centre and the lack of coordination among the white pieces is plain to see.

19 ♘c4 ♗g4 20 ♕g3

Here Black played **20...♗e2** and eventually won. But even stronger is **20...♘ce4** 21 ♕e1 ♘xd5, when Black's activity is very dangerous; e.g., 22 ♘de3 ♘xd2! 23 ♕xd2 ♘xe3 24 ♘xe3 ♕e2!. Let's examine this a bit further: 25 ♘c4 ♕xd2 26 ♘xd2 ♗e2 27 ♖fe1 (or 27 ♖f2 ♗c5) 27...♗xf4 with an extra pawn and the bishop-pair.

3 points for 18...♕b5!.

721) Vera – Lebredo
Managua 1982

28 ♗xf5+! gxf5 29 ♖h6+! ♔f7 30 ♕f6+ ♔g8

30...♔e8 allows mate in three with 31 ♕e6+.

31 ♕e6+ 1-0

If 31...♕f7 then 32 ♕xc8+, while after 31...♖f7 32 ♖g1+ it is mate in two.

2 points for 28 ♗xf5+! and 1 point for 29 ♖h6+!.

722) Franco – Van Riemsdijk
Morón Zonal 1982

45 ♖e7+!

Winning a vital tempo in the race between the passed pawns.

45...♔xe7 46 h7 ♖d1 47 h8♕ ♗c5

47...a2 loses to, amongst other things, 48 ♕g7+ ♔e6 49 ♕g8+ and 50 ♕xa2.

48 ♘d4 1-0

3 points for 45 ♖e7+!.

723) Vera – Sisniega
Mexico City 1984

27 ♕xb8!

White wins only a rook and a piece for the queen, but he also gains a powerful passed pawn, giving him a big advantage.

27...♕xb8 28 ♖xc2 ♕e8

After 28...♗d8 29 c6 ♗c7 30 ♘xc7 ♕xc7 31 ♘d4 and 32 ♘b5 White wins.

29 c6!

The pawn's advance is decisive.

29...♘e5 30 ♘xe5 ♗xe5 31 c7 ♗xc7 32 ♖xc7 1-0

3 points for 27 ♕xb8!.

724) Sion – Franco
Seville 1989

58...♕g3+!

The white king will not escape.

59 ♔d2 ♘e4+! 60 ♔e2

Or 60 ♔c2 ♕c3+ mating.

60...♕f2+ 61 ♔d3 ♕f3+ 0-1

62 ♔c4 loses to 62...♘d6+.

2 points for finding 58...♕g3+! and 1 point for 59...♘e4+!.

725) Topalov – Leko
Morelia/Linares 2006

55 ♘f6!

This sacrifice of the dangerous pawn wins material, and is the only way to gain the advantage.

55...♖xd6 56 ♖e8+! ♔c7 57 ♖e2!

This is the key move, with the double threat of taking the b2-knight and playing 58 ♘e8+.

57...♖d1 58 ♖xb2

The game is decided, and although Black fought on, hoping for practical chances, Topalov didn't allow any miracle saves.

3 points for 55 ♘f6! and 1 point for 57 ♖e2!.

726) Kritz – Firman
Cappelle la Grande 2007

12 b4!

The start of a manoeuvre to trap the black queen.

12...♕xb4 13 a5!

And this is the move that complements White's last; the black queen now has no safe retreat.

13...♘xd3?!

13...e5 is preferable, with the possible continuation 14 ♖fb1 ♘fxe4 15 ♕e1 ♕xd4 16 ♘xd4

♘xc3 17 ♕xc3 exd4, but even then White's advantage is not in doubt.

14 cxd3 ♕b3 15 ♘g5!

Preventing the retreat ...♕e6.

15...♗h6

15...♕b4 is met by 16 ♖a4 ♕b3 17 ♖b1.

16 f4 e5

After 16...♗xg5 17 fxg5 ♘d7 the move 18 ♘d5 is crushing.

17 ♖fb1 ♕xb1+ 18 ♖xb1 exd4 19 ♘b5

and White won.

3 points for 12 b4!, and 1 point for 13 a5!.

727) Lindinger – J. Fries Nielsen

Hamburg 2007

24...g3!!

Clearing the g4-square for the e5-knight and, in particular, the c8-h3 diagonal for the c8-bishop.

25 ♗xe5 ♗h3!

And now there is no defence.

26 fxg3

26 ♗xg3 is answered with 26...♕xg2+ 27 ♔e1 ♗g4.

26...♕xg2+ 27 ♔e1 ♖g6

Winning quickly, even though after 27...♗g4! it is mate in three.

28 ♖c4 ♗h6 0-1

3 points for finding 24...g3!! and 2 points for 25...♗h3!.

728) Henrichs – Prusikin

German Ch, Königshofen 2007

23...♘fg4+!!

Quieter methods such as 23...♕f5 are ineffective; e.g., 24 f3 (or 24 ♗xe5 ♖xe5 25 f3, threatening 26 g4 and if 25...♖e8 then 26 ♗b1 with equality) 24...exf3 25 ♗b1 ♘e4 26 ♗xe5 ♕xe5+ 27 ♕xe5 ♖xe5 28 gxf3 ♘c3 29 ♖d3 ♘xb1 30 ♖xb1, with equality.

24 hxg4

After 24 ♔h1 Black already has one strong piece inside the white camp, and with 24...♘f3! he can plant another in White's kingside, after which the pressure becomes intolerable; e.g., 25 ♗xg7 (after 25 gxf3 ♘e5! Black mates quickly, with his queen and d6-rook combining in the attack) 25...♕f5 (threatening 26...f6; 25...♘ge5 is also very strong) and after 26 ♗c3? Black has 26...♖h6, threatening 27...♖xh3+ and mating quickly.

24 ♔g1 is also very strongly met by the same move: 24...♘f3+! 25 gxf3 ♘h2!! 26 fxe4 (or 26 ♔xh2 ♖h6 with mate in three) 26...♕xh3 27 f3 ♘xf3+ 28 ♖xf3 ♕xf3 29 ♖f1 ♕xe3+ 30 ♕f2 (if 30 ♖f2 then for instance 30...♖xe4 wins) 30...♕xc3 31 ♕xf7+ ♔h7 and Black wins, since the transfer of the d6-rook to the kingside will be decisive.

The move 24 ♔g3 is also perilous; for example, 24...♖h6 25 d6 f5! 26 ♗xe5 (26 d7 can be answered with 26...f4+! 27 exf4 gxf4+ 28 ♔xf4 ♖f8+ 29 ♔g3 ♕d8, mating) 26...♘xe5 27 ♔h2 ♘d3, and the d6-pawn is lost.

24...♖h6+ 25 ♔g1 ♘f3+! 26 gxf3 exf3 0-1

5 points for 23...♘fg4+!!.

Test 9 Answers

729) Grau – Subira del Rio

Buenos Aires 1923

17 h3! wins a piece for insufficient compensation: **17...♗h5 18 g4 ♘h4 19 ♕h6.**

1 point for 17 h3!.

730) Nikolić – Illescas

Dubai Olympiad 1986

34...♘h3+! 0-1

35 ♔h1 loses to 35...♘xf4.

1 point for 34...♘h3+!.

731) R. Sanguineti – Ju. Bolbochán

Buenos Aires 1971

Returning a portion of his extra material with **24 ♗f4!** would grant White some advantage: 24...♖xf4 (not 24...♗xf4? 25 ♖xg4+! ♕xg4 26 ♕b3+! ♔f8 27 ♖g1 and White wins) 25 ♖g3 ♖f5 26 cxd6 cxd6, and now, for example, 27 ♖xg4+ ♕xg4 28 ♕d5+ ♔h8 29 ♖g1 ♗xc3 30 ♕e6.

The game went **24 ♖g3?** and Black won with **24...♗xg3 25 fxg3 ♕h3 0-1**. 26 ♕g1 allows 26...f2.

2 points for 24 ♗f4!.

732) Panno – Mecking

São Paulo Zonal 1972

26...♗xg4!

The white queen is overloaded.

27 ♕xg4 ♕xb2

Gaining a material advantage.

28 ♖f1?! ♗d4+ 29 ♗f2 ♗xf2+ 30 ♔h1 ♕xc3

and White resigned as soon as the time-control was reached.

2 points for 26...♗xg4!.

733) Visier – Mecking
Las Palmas 1975

33...♖xg7! 34 fxg7+ ♔g8

Even better than 34...♕xg7, since it allows the black king to advance a little further.

35 ♕e6+ ♔xg7 36 ♕e7+

36 ♕xd6 loses to 36...♘g5+ 37 ♔h4 ♘f3+ 38 ♔h3 ♕xh2+ with mate in two, while after 36 ♕g4+ ♕xg4+ 37 ♔xg4 ♔g6 38 h4 ♘f6+ 39 ♔f3 Black can play 39...c3, with a winning endgame of good knight versus bad bishop.

36...♔h6! 37 ♕h4+ ♔g6

and White soon resigned.

2 points for 33...♖xg7!.

734) Mecking – Balinas
Manila 1975

38 ♗f5!

Vacating the e6-square with tempo and winning an exchange.

38...♖xf5 39 ♘e6+ ♔b8 40 ♖xf5 1-0

2 points for 38 ♗f5!.

735) Klinger – Franco
Novi Sad Olympiad 1990

31...♖d7! 0-1

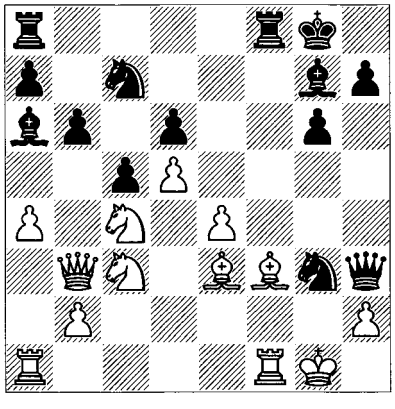
Defending the vital f7-square; after 32 ♕a6 Black plays 32...♘g4! (threatening 33...♕e3+) 33 ♕a3 ♖xd5! and wins.

2 points for finding 31...♖d7! and 1 point for 32...♘g4!.

736) Borges – Vera
Capablanca Memorial, Matanzas 1992

19...♘xg3! *(D)*

W



White's pieces are badly coordinated and his king is exposed, as this sacrifice highlights.

20 ♗g2

Or 20 hxg3 ♕xg3+ 21 ♗g2 ♗xc4.

20...♘e2+! 21 ♘xe2 ♗xc4 22 ♗xh3 ♗xb3

with an extra pawn and the better position.

3 points for 19...♘xg3!.

737) Morović – Franco
Asunción 1992

The game went **38...♕f7? 39 ♕xf7 ♖xf7 40 ♖d8+ ♔h7 41 ♔f2** with advantage to White.

Instead, with **38...f4!** Black can regain the exchange with a reasonable position; e.g., 39 ♕xe4 (or 39 ♖d7 ♕e5! 40 ♕xe5 ♗xe5 41 ♖g2 {if 41 ♖g4? or 41 ♖h3? then 41...♗f5} 41...♗xg2 42 ♔xg2 f3+) 39...fxg3 40 ♗xg3 ♕f7.

3 points for 38...f4!.

738) Seirawan – Zarnicki
Buenos Aires 1993

Black has an extra pawn, and if he manages to castle quickly his position will be very good.

13 ♖xd6! ♕xd6 14 ♖d1 ♕c7?

Black wants to keep his material advantage but he will be unable to withstand White's pressure. More tenacious was 14...♘d5, when the best way to win back the piece is 15 e4!.

15 ♗f4 ♕b7 16 ♘e5 ♗d7 17 ♖xd7! ♘xd7 18 ♗xc6 ♕a6 19 ♘xd7 ♕c8 20 ♗a4

Seirawan pointed out that 20 ♘b8+! is quicker, followed by capturing the a8-rook, but the move in the game is equally effective and very colourful, leading to a spectacular finale.

20...♔e7 21 ♕d3 f6 22 ♕d6+ ♔f7 23 ♘e5+! fxe5 24 ♗d7 ♕d8 25 ♕xe6+ ♔f8 26 ♗xe5 g6 27 ♗f6 1-0

3 points for 13 ♖xd6!.

739) Adla – Franco
Santa Cruz de la Palma 1995

53...♖e3!

Setting up a well-known drawing mechanism, based on perpetual check with a rook and a knight. Perhaps it is insufficient to draw here, but it is Black's only hope. There is no time for 53...♖xf3? on account of 54 e7 (threatening 55 ♖d8+, followed by queening) 54...♖b3+ 55 ♔c1 ♖c3+ 56 ♔d2 ♖d3+ 57 ♔e1 ♖e3+ 58 ♔f2 and White wins.

54 e7 ♖e1+ 55 ♔c2 ♖e2+ 56 ♔c1 ♘c3! 57 ♖d8+

Another promising line is 57 ♖a7! ♔b8 58 ♖a3! ♖xe7 (58...♘b5 59 ♘e4! ♘c7 60 ♔d1 ♖b2 61 ♘xg5 makes things easier for White) 59 ♖xc3.

57...♔c7 58 e8♕?!

It is still possible to play a win with 58 ♘e6+ ♖xe6 59 e8♕ ♖xe8 60 ♖xe8 ♔d6 61 ♖g8.

58...♘a2+ ½-½

3 points for 53...♖e3!.

740) Vera – Mellado

Terrassa 1995

30 ♖xf7!

Finishing the game with a mating attack.

30...♔xf7 31 ♕xg6+ ♔g8 32 ♘f5 ♔f8

Or 32...♖f8 33 ♘h6+ ♔h8 34 ♘f7+ ♖xf7 35 ♕xf7 and White wins.

33 ♘e6+! 1-0

It is mate after 33...♖xe6 34 ♖d8+ ♖e8 35 ♖xe8+ ♕xe8 36 ♕xg7#.

3 points for 30 ♖xf7!.

741) Matamoros – Urbina

Seville 2007

39...♗e3+!

Black exploits the exposed position of the white king to save the half-point.

40 ♔g2 ♖c3!

This is the key.

41 ♖xc3 bxc3 42 ♕xc3

42 ♕xe3? ♕xb3 is losing for White.

42...♕a2+ 43 ♔h3 ♕e2!

The draw is unavoidable.

44 d5 ♕h5+ 45 ♔g2 ♕e2+ 46 ♔h3 ♕h5+ ½-½

3 points for 39...♗e3+! and 1 point for 40...♖c3!.

742) Bologan – Yakovenko

Poikovsky 2007

35...♖xg6!

This sacrifice is based on the far from obvious idea of exploiting the fact that the white rook on g3 is loose!

36 ♘xg6

36 ♖xg6 loses to 36...♗xe5.

36...♕b8! 0-1

With the double threat of capturing the g3-rook and checkmate on b1.

3 points for finding 35...♖xg6! and 1 point for 36...♕b8!.

743) Andrés González – Avrukh

Spanish Team Ch, Burguillos 2007

20...♖d4!

The white queen has insoluble difficulties in defending the bishop.

21 ♖xd4 cxd4 22 ♕xd4 ♖d8 23 ♕c4 ♖c8! 24 ♕d4 ♗c5 0-1

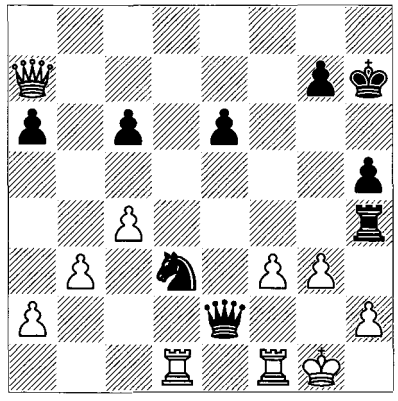
The f4-bishop is lost.

4 points for 20...♖d4! and 1 point for 23...♖c8!.

744) Volkov – Rublevsky

European Clubs Cup, Kemer 2007

29...♖h4!! *(D)*



Making extraordinarily good use of his available resources, Black, who is already the exchange down, sacrifices his remaining rook to gain access to the f4-square for his knight.

30 gxh4 ♘f4

There is no satisfactory defence against the threat of 31...♕g2#, thanks to the excellent coordination of the queen and the knight.

31 ♕f2

Or 31 ♖f2 ♕xd1+ 32 ♖f1 ♕c2 33 ♖f2 ♕g6+! 34 ♔h1 ♕b1+, mating.

31...♘h3+ 32 ♔g2 ♘xf2 33 ♖de1 ♕d2!

Thus Black retained an overwhelming material advantage, and won easily.

5 points for 29...♖h4!!.

Test 10 Answers

745) Granda – Rivas

Capablanca Memorial, Havana 1988

29 ♘c7! 1-0

Winning the exchange, since 29...♕xc7? allows 30 ♖e8#.

1 point for 29 ♘c7!.

746) Lipiniks – R. Gamarra

Paraguayan Ch, Asunción 1996

11 e5!

This forces the sad retreat of the knight to g8, with great advantage to White, since 11...♕xe5? loses to 12 ♗f4.

1 point for 11 e5!.

747) Dubín – Cámpora

Argentine Ch, Buenos Aires 1976

28...♘d3! 29 ♖d2 ♖d4! 0-1

1 point for finding 28...♘d3! and 1 point for 29...♖d4!.

748) Vera – Ro. Hernández

Bayamo 1981

41 ♖xc7! 1-0

41...♖xc7 42 ♕a8 ♖f8 43 a7 and White wins.

2 points for 41 ♖xc7!.

749) García García – Castells

Catalonian Ch, Santa Perpetua 1985

22 ♖xf7+! ♔xf7 23 ♕h5+ ♔g8 24 ♗xe5 ♕d8 25 ♖f1 1-0

Black is faced with a great loss of material.

2 points for 22 ♖xf7+!.

750) Vera – A. Hoffman

Pan American Team Ch, Junín 1987

16 ♗xg7! ♘xg7

If 16...♗xg7? then 17 ♘e7+.

17 ♘xh6+ ♔h8 18 ♘xf7+ ♔g8 19 ♘xd8 ♕xd8 20 dxc5 ♘xc5 21 ♘xd5

with a big material advantage.

2 points for 16 ♗xg7!.

751) Terán – Dgebuadze

León 1996

27 ♖xe7! ♗xc4

27...♖xe7 loses to 28 ♗d5+, since if 28...♔f8? then 29 ♕h8#, and inserting 27...♕xf2+ 28 ♔h1 does not improve matters.

28 ♖e8+ ♖f8 29 ♗e4! ♕d6 30 ♗h7+! 1-0

3 points for 27 ♖xe7!.

752) Vallejo – Danailov

León 1996

30 ♔h1!

Clearing the g-file proves decisive.

30...♖c2 31 ♖g1 ♖g8 32 ♖xg8+ ♔xg8

It is mate in three after 32...♕xg8 33 ♕f6+ ♕g7 34 ♖a8+.

33 f6 ♕f8 34 ♕xf8+ 1-0

3 points for 30 ♔h1!.

753) Franco – Blanco

Capablanca Memorial, Cienfuegos 1997

White played **33 exd4** and gained an advantage, although he didn't win the game.

Instead, **33 ♖c7!** is decisive; for example, 33...♖de8 (or 33...♔f8 34 exd4 exd4 35 ♖xd4, or 33...♖ed7 34 ♖xd7 ♖xd7 35 ♕xe5) 34 ♘d6 and White gains a decisive material advantage.

3 points for 33 ♖c7!.

754) Vallejo – Nikčević

Mondariz Balneario 1998

27 ♖h3! b6

This leads to the destruction of his queenside, but there is no defence; 27...♗xd4? allows the textbook mating combination that we have already encountered: 28 ♕xa7+! ♔xa7 29 ♖a3#.

28 cxb6 ♗xd4 29 ♗c7 ♗xb6 30 ♗xb6

and White won.

3 points for 27 ♖h3!.

755) Contín – An. Rodríguez

Buenos Aires 2006

32...c4!

Now the queen comes into the game, and all the pieces cooperate in the attack.

33 dxc4 ♕c5+ 34 ♖f2

If 34 ♔g2 then simply 34...♖xe4.

34...♖xf5!

The most convincing.

35 ♕g2 ♖xe4! 36 ♕xe4 ♕xf2+ 37 ♔h1 ♕f1+ 38 ♔h2 ♖f2+ 39 ♔g3 ♕g1+ 40 ♔h4 ♗f6+ 41 ♔xh5 ♕h2+ 0-1

2 points for finding 32...c4!, and 1 point for 34...♖xf5!.

756) Rosmann – Hebbinghaus

Hamburg 2007

43...♘g3+! 44 ♔g2

44 ♔h2 loses to 44...♘f1++! 45 ♔g1 ♕xe6.

44...♕xe6! 0-1

45 ♗xe6 ♘e2+.

3 points for 43...♘g3+!.

757) Motylev – Prusikin

European Ch, Dresden 2007

28 ♕g7!

The prettiest; the plainer **28 ♕f4!** was also strong, with the idea of 29 h7 and preparing g4 with 30 ♖ag1.

28...♔d7

28...♖xg7?! loses to 29 hxg7 ♕g8 30 ♖h8 ♔d7 31 ♖ah1, followed by 32 ♖xg8 and ♖h8.

29 ♕xf8 ♖gxf8 30 ♖ae1

The dark squares are under White's complete control and will be the means of winning the game.

30...♖h8 31 h7 ♔d6 32 ♖e5!

Preventing a possible ...e5.

32...♖af8 33 ♔e3

Preparing to penetrate to g7 with the king, via the dark squares.

33...♗a4 34 ♗d1 ♗c6 35 ♔f4 ♗a4 36 ♖h6

Later White finds the winning plan of doubling rooks on the g-file, followed by ♖g8.

36..♔c7 37 ♖e3 ♔d6 38 ♖g3 ♗e8 39 ♖g7 ♗a4 40 ♖h3 1-0

A possible continuation is 40...♗d7 41 ♖hg3 (or 41 ♗h5) 41...b6 42 ♖g8 ♖e8 43 ♖xh8 ♖xh8 44 ♖g7, intending 45 ♗h5, and if 44...♗e8 then 45 ♖g8 wins.

4 points for 28 ♕g7!; 3 points if you chose 28 ♕f4!.

758) Quezada – Pozo

Villa Clara 2008

23 ♖xe5+!!

This leads to forced mate, whereas 23 ♕xh7? ♕a1+ 24 ♔d2 ♕xb2 only brings difficulties.

23...fxe5 24 ♕h4+! ♔e6 25 ♕h3+ ♔xf7

Quicker is 25...♔f6 26 ♖d6+ ♔g5 27 ♕e3+ ♔f5 28 g4+ ♔xg4 29 h3+ ♔f5 30 ♕f3+ ♔g5 31 ♕g4#.

26 ♕xh7+ ♔e6 27 ♕d7+ ♔f6 28 ♖d6+! ♔g5 29 ♕g7+ ♔f5 30 ♕g6+ ♔f4 31 ♕g3+ ♔e4 32 ♕d3+ ♔f4 33 ♕f3+ ♔g5 34 ♕e3+ ♖f4

34...♔f5 35 g4+ is similar to the previous note.

35 ♕xe5+ ♖f5 36 ♕g3+ ♔h5 37 ♕g6+ ♔h4 38 ♖d4+ 1-0

4 points for 23 ♖xe5+!!.

759) Rublevsky – Bacrot

Spanish Team Ch, Calvia 2007

38 ♘c4!!

With this fine move the knight defends the b6-pawn, and the two pieces that can take the knight are overloaded, since they have to prevent the white pawn from queening.

38...♕xc4

Obviously after 38...♗xc4 39 b7 the pawn queens.

39 ♕xe5+ ♔h6 40 b7

The pawn can't be prevented from queening, but Black still has a resource.

40...♕f1+!? 41 ♔h2 ♗c6

Threatening both mate on g2 and the pawn on b7; how can White deal with both threats?

42 ♕e3+!

42 ♕f4+! ♔h5 43 f3 is also good.

42...♔h5

Or 42...♔g7 43 ♕c3+ and the bishop is lost.

43 f3! 1-0

With the threat of queening and the no less strong threat of mating in three, starting with 44 g4+.

5 points for 38 ♘c4!!.

760) Cheparinov – Navara

European Team Ch, Khersonisos 2007

The rook on a1 is out of the game, and White's attack lacks firepower. In fact, White's king is the one in serious danger, but he still has one move to save the game: **31 h4!**, controlling the g5-square, draws; e.g., 31...♗g2+ (31...♖h2 32 ♕g5+ ♔h7 33 ♕d8 forces Black to take the draw by 33...♖h1+ 34 ♔f2 ♖h2+ 35 ♔f1 – not 35 ♔e3?, which loses to 35...♘g2+) 32 ♔e1 ♖e2+ 33 ♔d1 ♗f3 34 ♕g5+ ♔h7 35 ♕f5+ with perpetual check.

The game followed a different course:

31 ♗g8? ♗g2+ 32 ♔e1 ♖e2+ 33 ♔d1 ♗f3! 34 ♕h7+

34 ♔c1 is met simply by 34...♖e1+ 35 ♔d2 ♖xa1, with a decisive material advantage.

34...♔g5

31 h4! would have prevented this escape; now Black forces mate.

35 ♖a2

There is nothing after 35 ♕xg7+ ♔h4.

35...♖h2+ 36 ♔e1

Or 36 ♔c1 ♘xd3+! 37 cxd3 (37 ♕xd3 ♗f4+ with mate) 37...♗f4+ 38 ♔b1 ♖h1+ and Black forces checkmate.

36...♘xd3+! 0-1

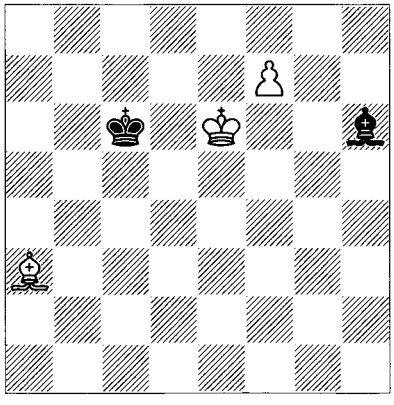
Again it is mate: 37 cxd3 ♗g3+ 38 ♔f1 ♖h1#.

5 points for 31 h4!.

9 The World of Endgames

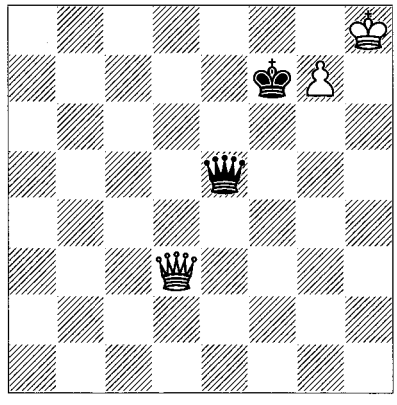
This chapter consists of 80 endgame puzzles, ranging in difficulty from level 1 to level 4. Hints are given for the first 30. As usual, the difficulty level rises gradually, only to drop down again to level 1 in Puzzle 791, after which it starts to rise once again.

761
W



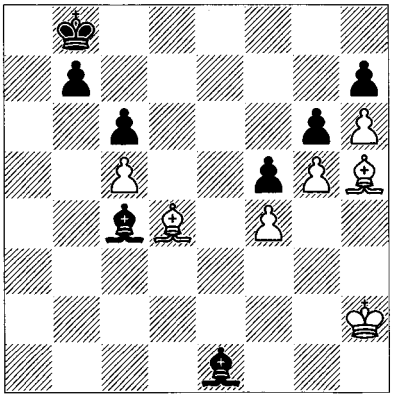
White wins with a well-known endgame resource; how?

763
W



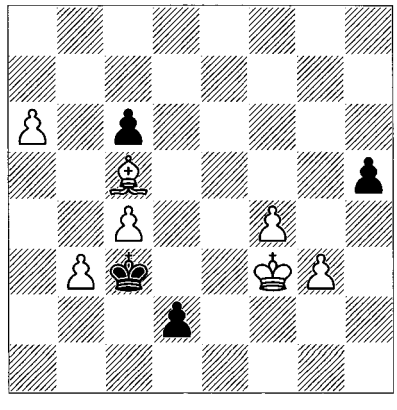
How can White simplify the difficult task of exploiting the extra pawn?

762
B



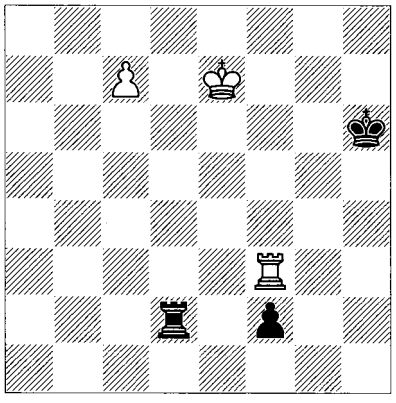
White has played a typical combination to create a passed pawn... or is there a snag?

764
W



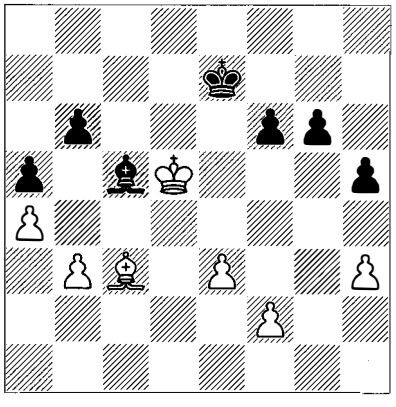
White has a winning position, but needs to find a key move to achieve victory.

765
B



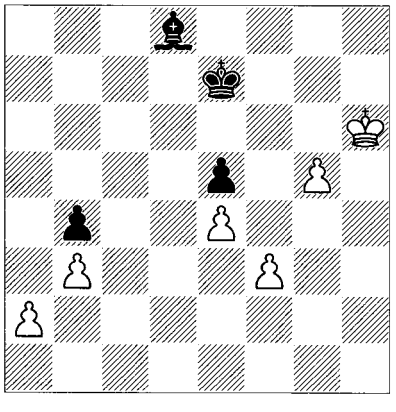
After 88...♖e2+ 89 ♔f6! Black resigned, as White threatens mate and promotion. How could Black have forced a draw?

766
W



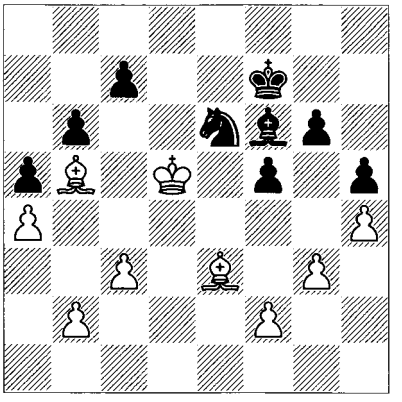
How can White win this apparently equal ending?

767
W



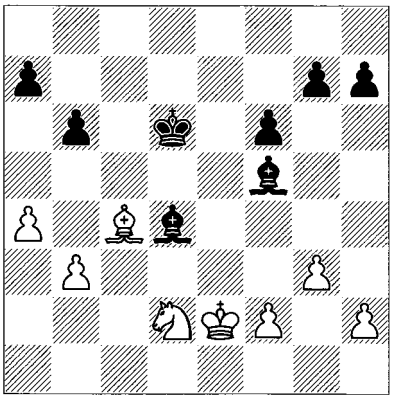
White has sacrificed a piece to create a winning passed pawn; how can he wrap things up?

768
W



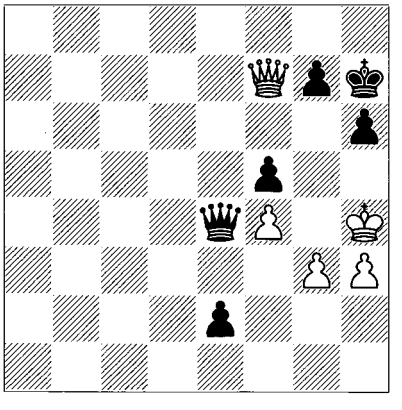
White has a big advantage; what is the quickest way to exploit it?

769
W



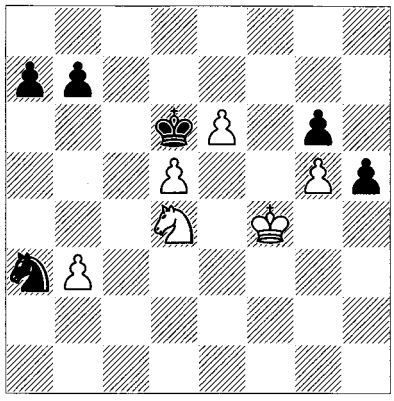
The struggle against the bishop-pair promises to be an unpleasant defensive task; how can White simplify matters?

770
B



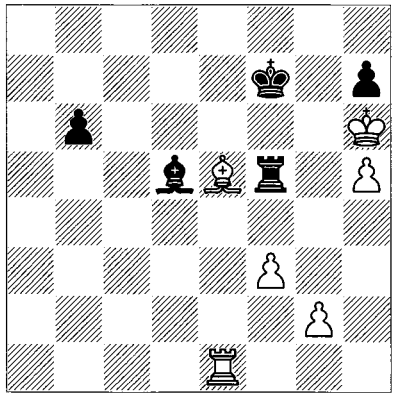
Black played 80...e1♘, which forced White to resign; why did Black not promote the pawn to a queen?

771
W



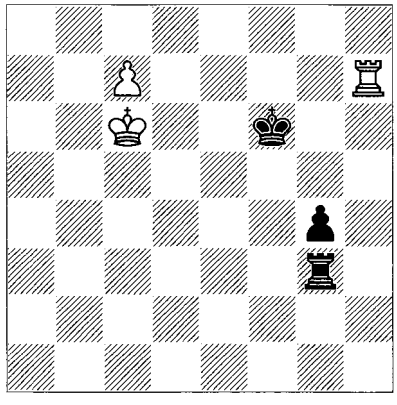
White's passed pawns are immobilized; how is it possible to get them moving?

772
W



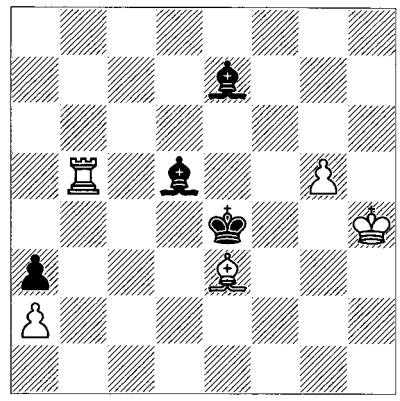
White needs to find something soon, so that his extra pawn can be converted into something more tangible. What is it?

773
W



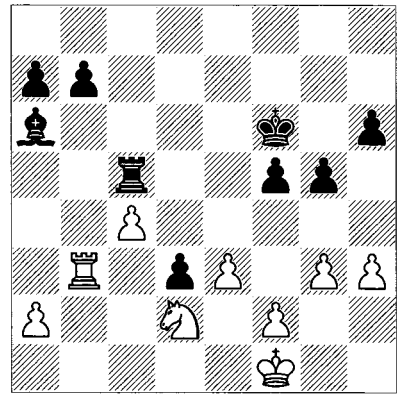
Demonstrate a typical winning method in endgames with passed pawns.

774
W



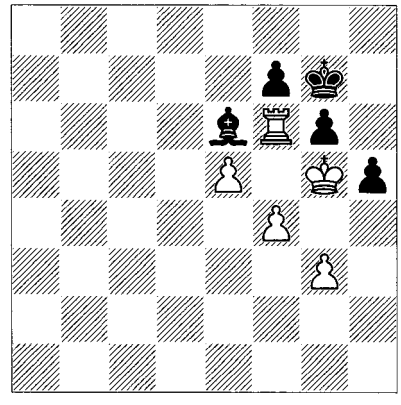
White returned the exchange with 56 ♖xd5 to reach a bishop ending with an extra pawn; was this a good decision?

775
B



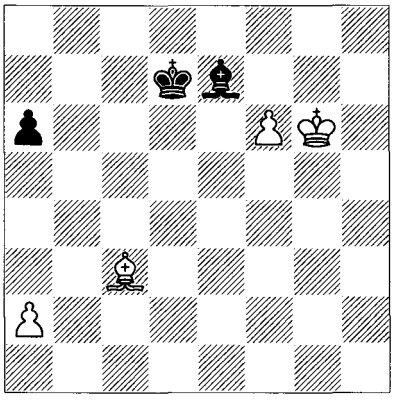
Black's powerful passed pawn is running out of energy; how can it be revitalized?

776
W



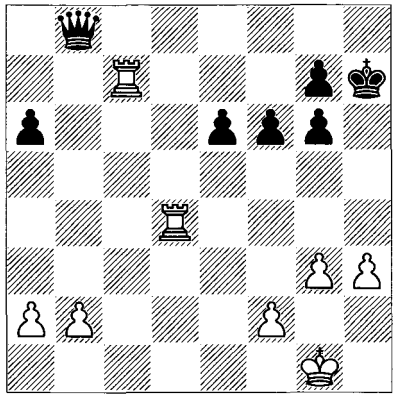
Demonstrate the typical winning manoeuvre in this type of endgame.

777
W



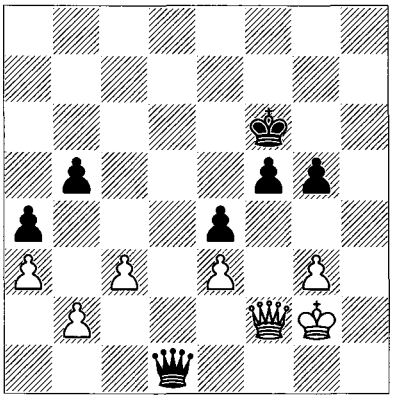
Demonstrate your technique and win with a typical manoeuvre.

780
W



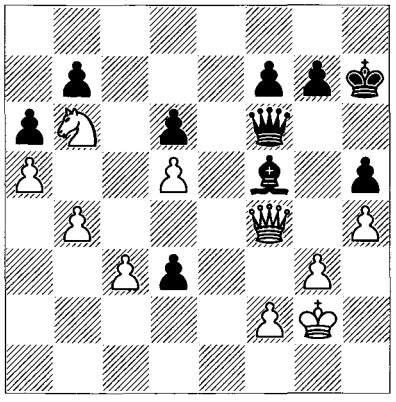
Choose: a) White is winning; b) White is better; c) the position is balanced. Support your choice with analysis.

778
B



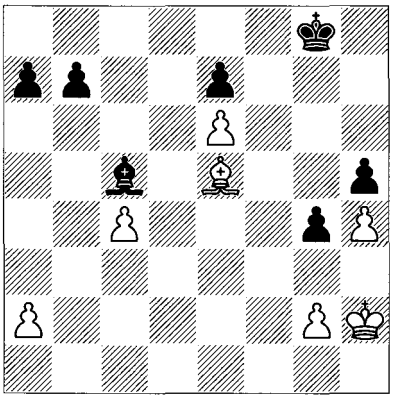
Material is equal, but Black has a space advantage and his pieces are more active; how can he increase his advantage?

781
B



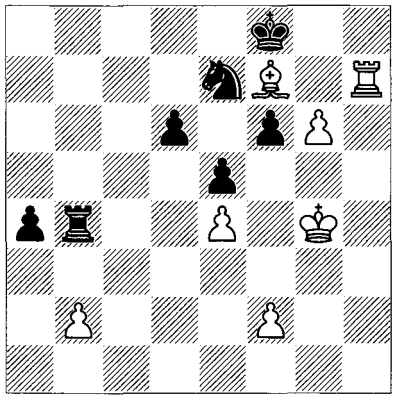
Black's passed pawn is going nowhere for now, and he must take action before White's knight rejoins the battle... but how?

779
B



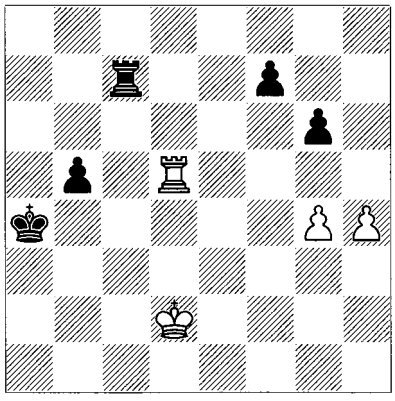
The material is equal; what other factor is decisive here?

782
W



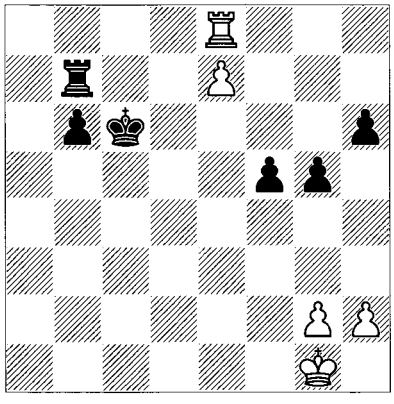
White played 42 f3, which led to a draw following 42...♖xb2. How can White improve his play and win?

783
B



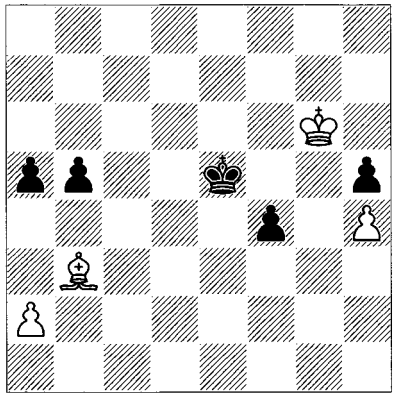
White has counterplay with the threat of h5, creating his own passed pawn; how can Black take the lead in the pawn race?

784
B



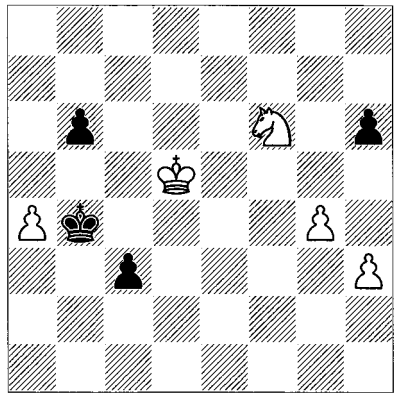
Black is a pawn up and White's e7-pawn is doomed, so it's an easy win, isn't it?

785
W



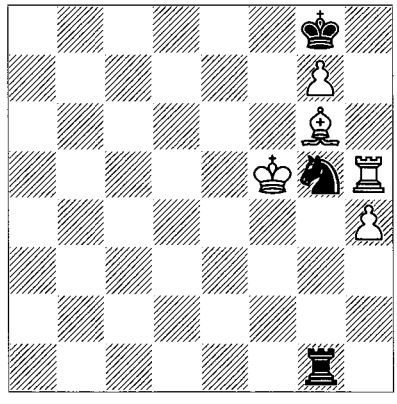
With reduced material there is a fine line between a win and a draw, so precise calculation is required. Demonstrate the win.

786
W



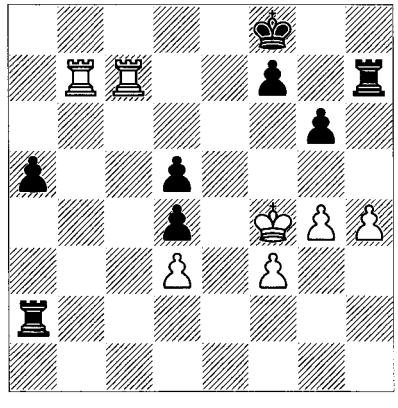
There is just one way, not only to save the game, but also to win; what is it?

787
B



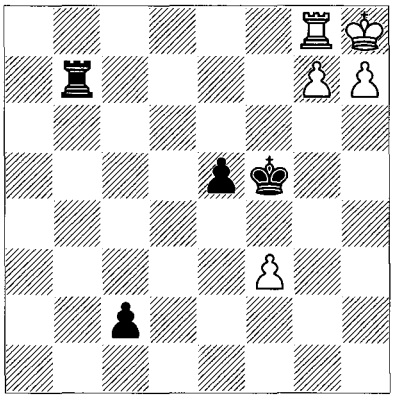
The game went 63...♘e6 64 ♗h7+ ♔xg7 65 ♔xe6, and White won. How can Black's defence be improved?

788
W



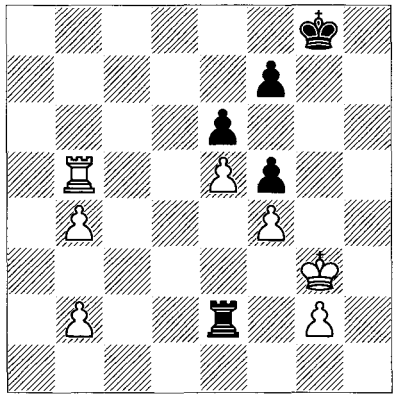
Black has a passed pawn and an active rook. White must introduce a new element or his advantage will fade away; what is it?

789
B



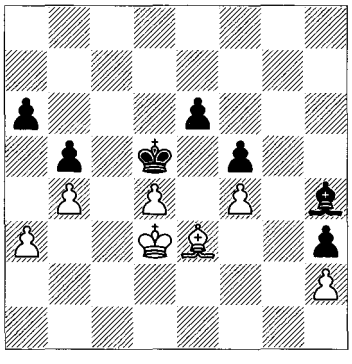
In this strange position, Black has only one correct way to play; what is it?

790
W

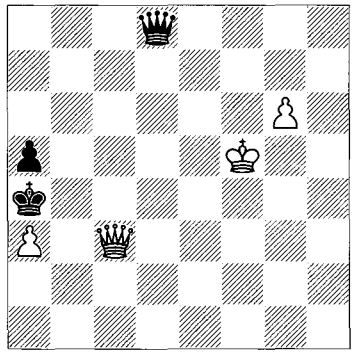


White is better, but has no clear path to victory. What is his best winning try?

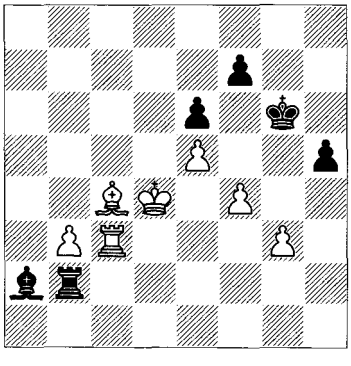
791
B



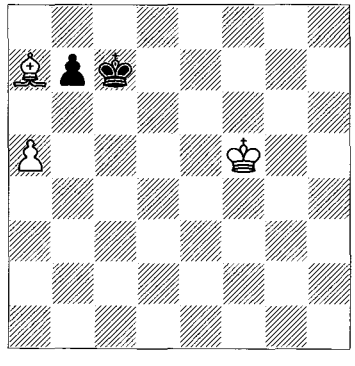
793
B



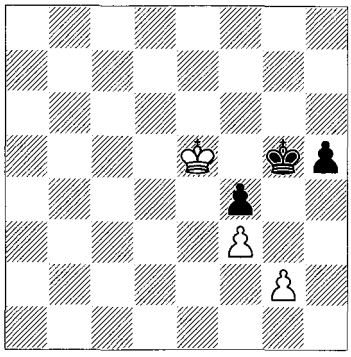
792
W



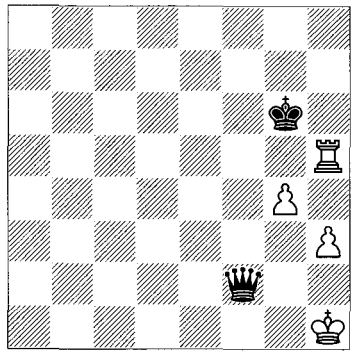
794
B



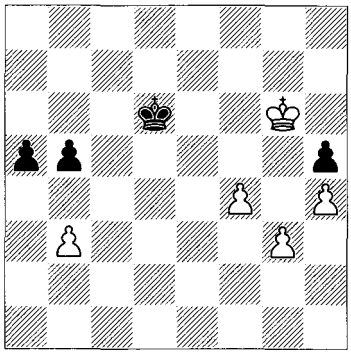
795
B



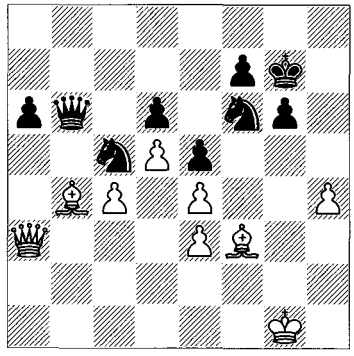
799
B



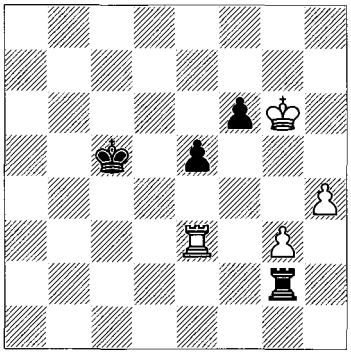
796
B



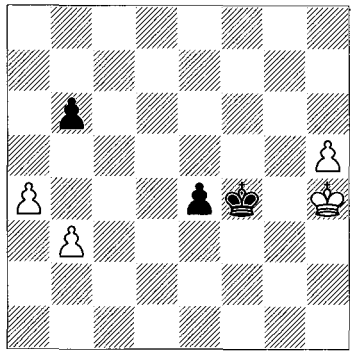
800
B



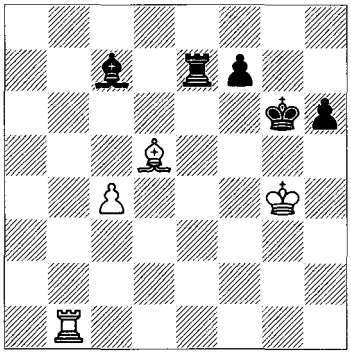
797
W



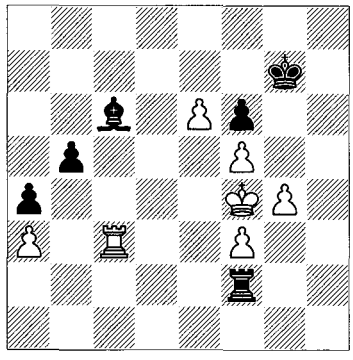
801
W



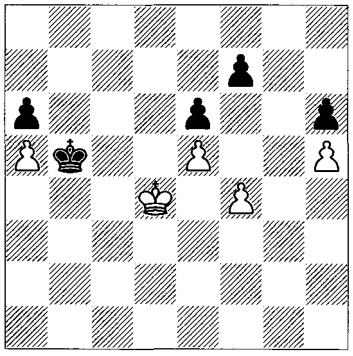
798
B



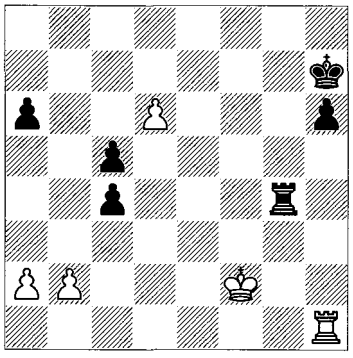
802
B



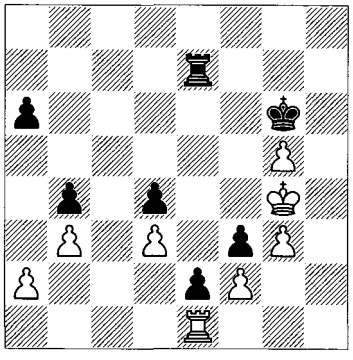
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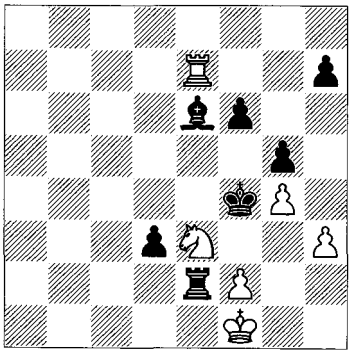
804
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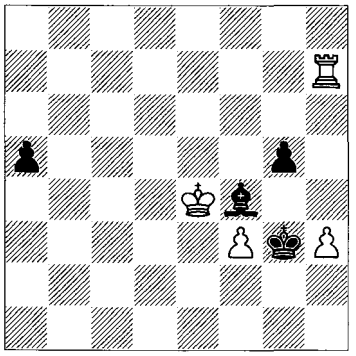
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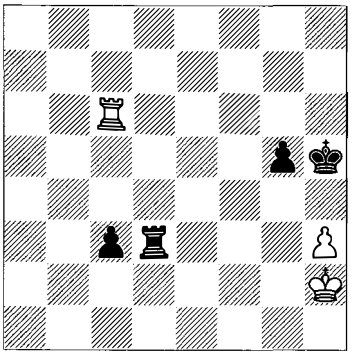
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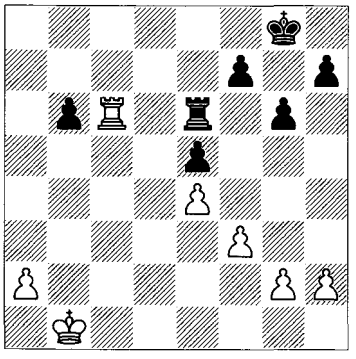
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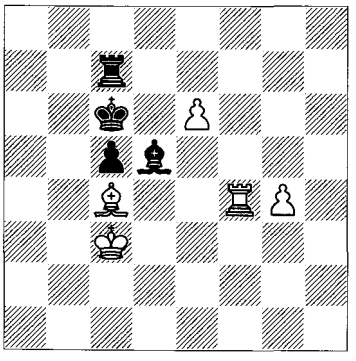
808
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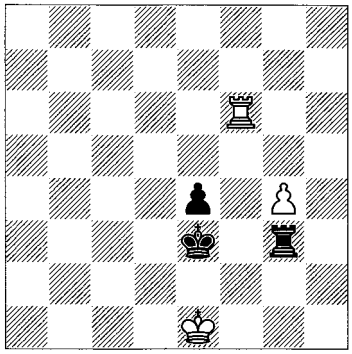
809
W



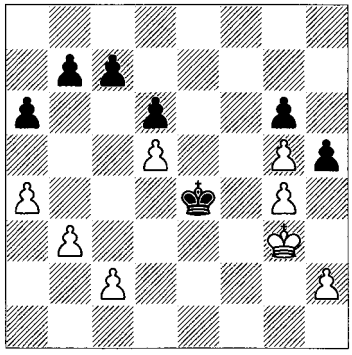
810
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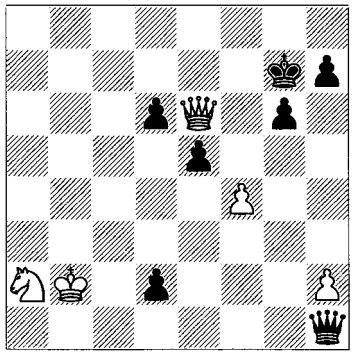
811
B



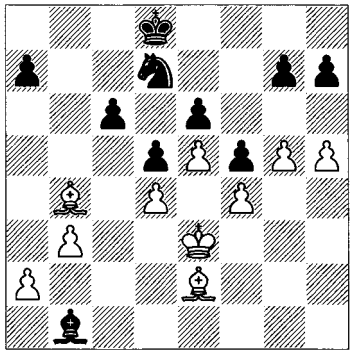
812
B



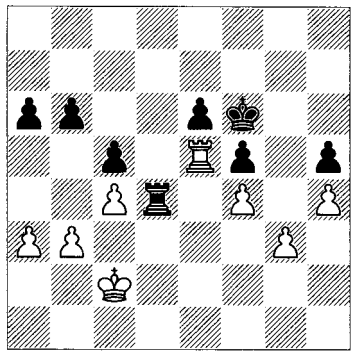
813
B



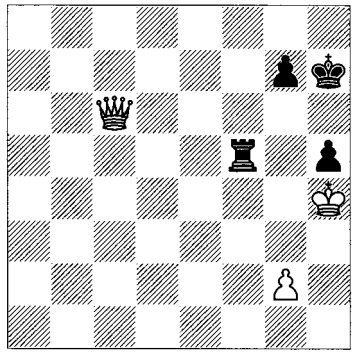
814
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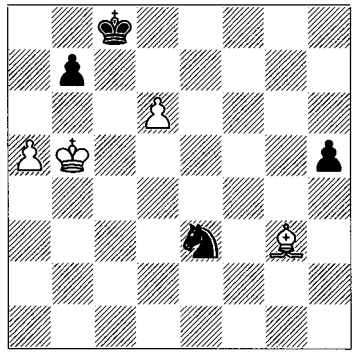
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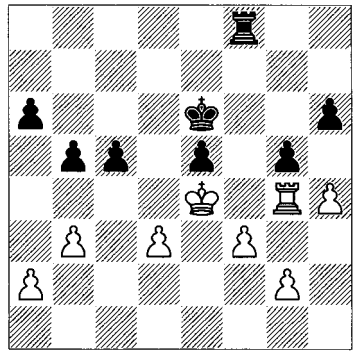
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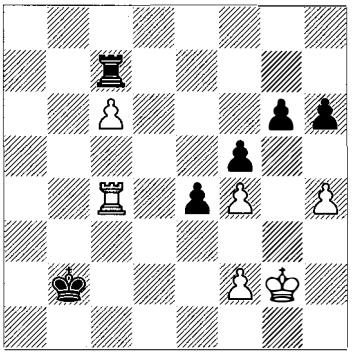
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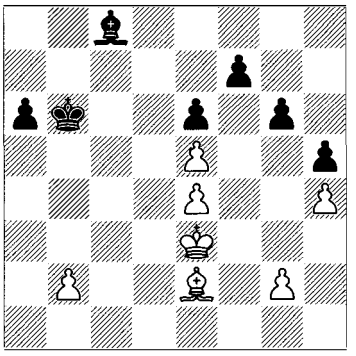
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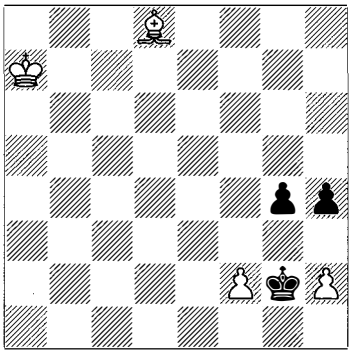
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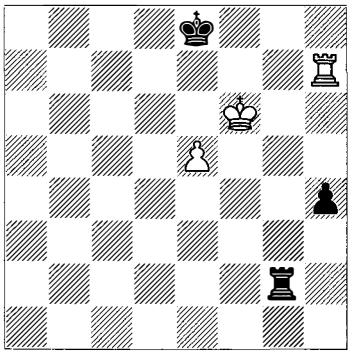
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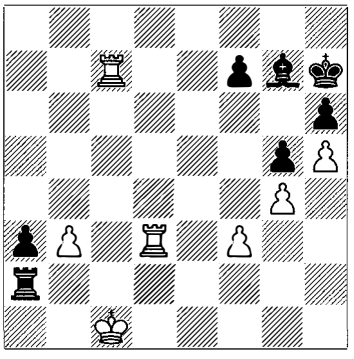
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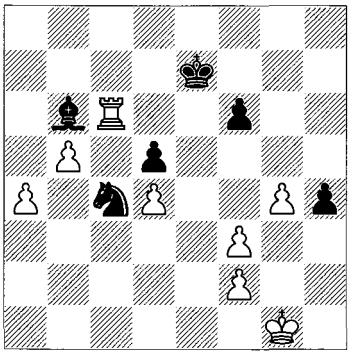
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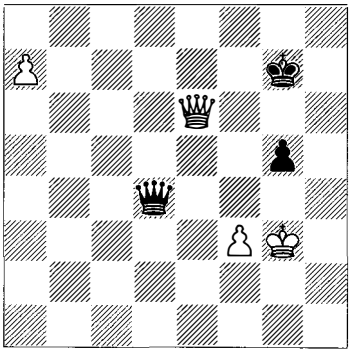
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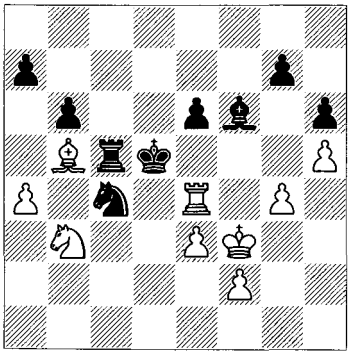
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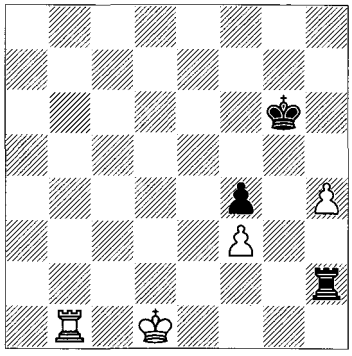
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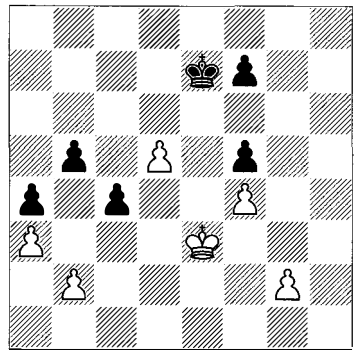
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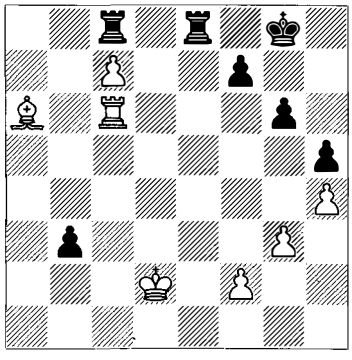
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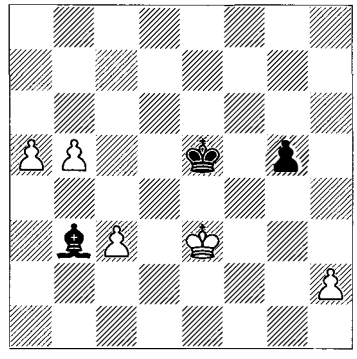
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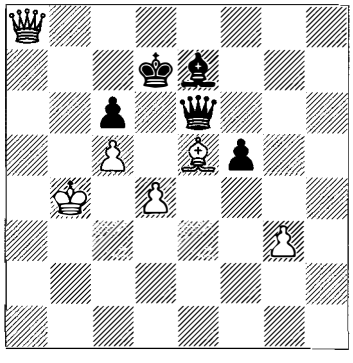
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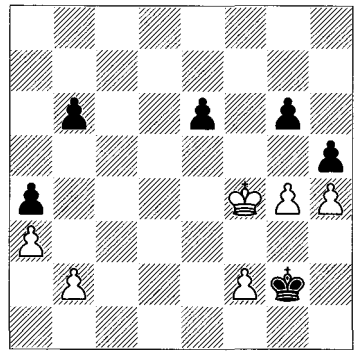
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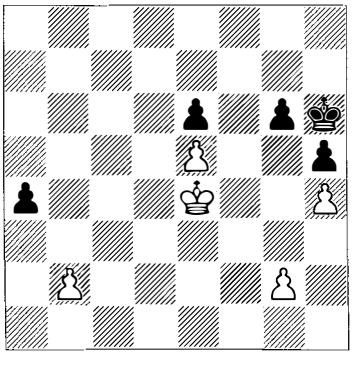
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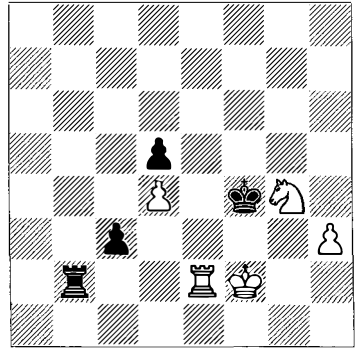
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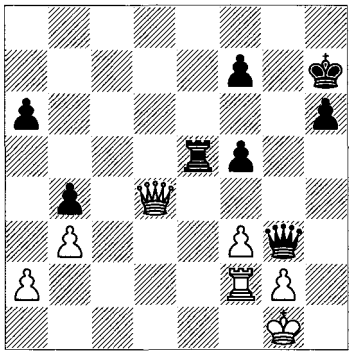
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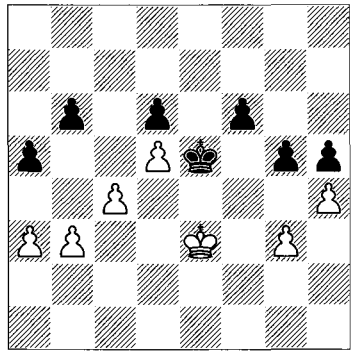
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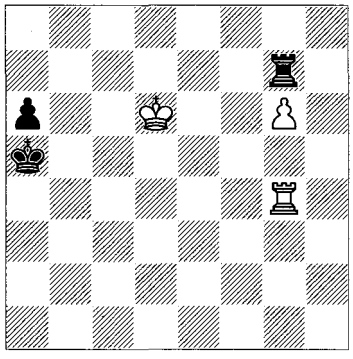
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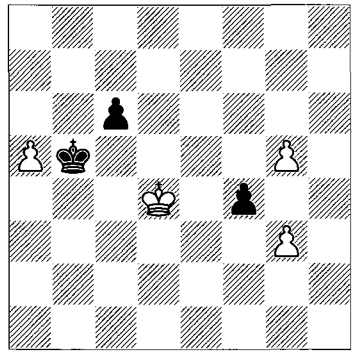
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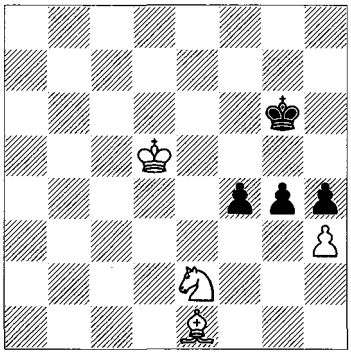
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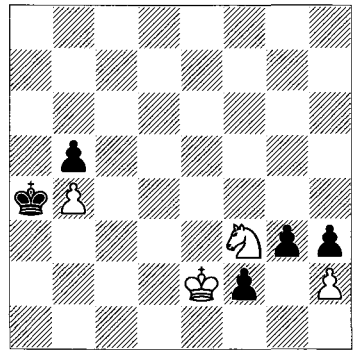
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Answers for Chapter 9

761) Dziuba – Protaziuk
Najdorf Memorial, Warsaw 2008
49 ♔f5!
49 ♔f6! is just as good, of course.
49...♔d7 50 ♔g6 ♔e6 51 ♗b4! 1-0
Zugzwang.

762) Jay. Gonzales – Kotronias
Dresden Olympiad 2008
Yes, there is a snag:
40...gxh5! 41 g6 ♗g8! 0-1

763) Estremera – Martínez González
Magaluf 2008
87 ♕d5+! 1-0

764) Vallejo – Núñez
Havana 1992
42 ♗b4+! 1-0
Thus Vallejo, then aged nine, stopped the black pawn. White wins easily after 42...♔xb4 43 ♔e2! ♔c3 44 ♔d1!, preventing 44...♔c2.

765) Hillarp Persson – Lindberg
Swedish Ch, Växjö 2008
Black draws by attacking the c-pawn with **88...♖c2!** and every time the white king supports the pawn, threatening both to queen and to play ♖xf2, Black just checks with the rook; e.g., 89 ♔d7 ♖d2+ 90 ♔c6 ♖c2+ 91 ♔b7 ♖b2+ 92 ♔a7 ♖c2 93 ♔b8 ♖b2+.

766) R. Sanguineti – Ja. Bolbochán
Buenos Aires 1958
45 ♗xa5! bxa5
If 45...♗xe3 White has the winning zwischenzug 46 ♗b4+!.
46 ♔xc5 g5 47 e4 1-0
There follows 48 b4, unless Black plays 47...h4. In that case, White must spare a thought for defence, and first prevent 48...g4 with 48 f3!.

767) Svidler – Yakovenko
FIDE Grand Prix, Sochi 2008
Not with 80 g6? ♔f8!, and the pawn can't queen, but with **80 ♔g7! 1-0**. There follows 81 g6 and ♔h7, winning easily.

768) Ju. Bolbochán– J.E. Martínez
Argentine Ch, Buenos Aires 1946
42 ♗e8+!
'The advantage of having two bishops is that at any moment you can exchange one of them' is a well-known dictum. Here White can use this resource to simplify to a winning bishop ending, based on the tremendous position of his king.
42...♔xe8
Not 42...♔e7? 43 ♗xg6.
43 ♔xe6 ♗e7 44 c4 1-0
After 45 ♗g5 White can't be prevented from breaking in with ♔f6.

769) Franco – Karpov
Spanish Team Ch, Mota del Cuervo 1995
31 ♗d3!
A single bishop is not so dangerous.
31...♗xd3+ 32 ♔xd3 ♔d5
The exchange of bishops relies on the fact that 32...♗xf2? loses to 33 ♘e4+.
33 f4 ♗g1 34 ♘f3 ♗c5 35 ♘d2 f5 36 ♘f3 a6 37 ♘g5 h6 38 ♘f3 ♗e7 39 ♘d4 g6 40 ♘f3 ♗f6 41 ♘h4 ♗xh4 42 gxh4 ½-½

770) Narciso – Krivoruchko
European Ch, Plovdiv 2008
80...e1♕?? runs into **81 ♕g6+!** ♔g8 82 ♕e8+! ♕xe8 stalemate.
We should note that Black had other ways to win apart from underpromotion, of which 80...♕xf4+! 81 gxf4 e1♕+, leading to mate with checks, is the most direct.

771) K. Lie – Bu Xiangzhi
Dresden Olympiad 2008
42 ♘f5+!
This elegantly breaks the blockade; after 42...gxf5 43 g6 the pawn is unstoppable.
42...♔c7 1-0
Black resigned without waiting for 43 d6+ ♔c6 44 e7 ♔d7 45 ♘g7.

772) Quezada – Onishchuk
Dresden Olympiad 2008
56 g4!
The exchange of the f3-pawn for the one on h7 leaves White with two connected passed pawns, which will win the game.
56...♖xf3 57 ♔xh7 ♖h3 58 ♔h6! ♖h1
58...♗f3 delays, but does not avoid, defeat; e.g., 59 ♔g5 ♔g8 60 ♗f6 b5 61 ♖e8+ ♔f7 62 ♖e7+ ♔g8 63 h6 ♗xg4 64 ♖g7+ ♔f8 65 h7.
59 ♖xh1 ♗xh1 60 g5 ♔e6 61 ♔g7 1-0

773) Onishchuk – C. Balogh
Dresden Olympiad 2008

The most important point is to avoid 73 c8♕? ♖c3+ 74 ♔d7 ♖xc8 75 ♔xc8 ♔f5 76 ♖g7 ♔f4 77 ♔d7 g3 78 ♔e6 ♔f3 79 ♔e5 g2 80 ♔d4 ♔f2, which is drawn.

73 ♖h5! 1-0

On the fifth rank the rook can shelter the white king from checks; **73 ♔d5!** ♖c3 74 ♖h6+ ♔e7 75 ♖c6 also works.

774) Agdestein – Van Wely
Wolvega 2008

56 ♖xd5? is a serious error. After **56...♔xd5 57 ♗c1 ♗xg5+!** the ending is a theoretical draw; the black king reaches a8 without any problems.

Instead White can win with **56 ♗c5!** ♗xc5 57 ♖xc5 ♗xa2 58 ♖c3 ♗f7 59 ♖xa3 ♔f5 60 ♖a6, and the rest is straightforward.

775) Ftačnik – Aleksandrov
Dresden Olympiad 2008

29...♖xc4! 30 ♘xc4 ♗xc4 31 ♔e1

31 ♖b1 loses to 31...d2+ 32 ♔g1 ♗e2.

31...♗xb3 32 axb3 ♔e5 33 f3

Preventing 33...♔e4.

33...a5

The first step in creating a second passed pawn.

34 ♔d2 g4! 0-1

A beautiful way to enable his king to support the d3-pawn, in order then to create another passed pawn with ...b5 and ...a4; e.g., after 35 hxg4 fxg4 36 f4+ (or 36 fxg4) 36...♔e4.

776) Eliskases – Rossetto
Buenos Aires 1947

43 f5!

White breaks up Black's defensive structure and reaches a winning endgame by returning the exchange at an appropriate moment.

43...♗xf5

Or 43...gxf5 44 ♔xh5 ♗d7 45 ♔g5 ♗e6 46 ♖xf5 and White wins.

44 ♖xf5 gxf5 45 ♔xh5 ♔f8 46 ♔g5 ♔e8 47 ♔f6 1-0

A possible continuation is 47...♔f8 48 e6 fxe6 49 ♔xe6 ♔g7 50 ♔xf5.

47 ♔xf5 ♔e7 48 g4 was also good enough: 48...♔e8 49 ♔f6 ♔f8 50 g5! (not 50 e6? fxe6 51 ♔xe6 ♔g7 52 ♔f5 ♔f7 with a draw) 50...♔e8 (50...♔g8 51 ♔e7 is similar) 51 ♔g7 ♔e7 52 ♔g8! ♔e8 53 e6! fxe6 54 g6 e5 55 g7 e4 56 ♔h7.

777) Ju. Bolbochán – Maderna
Match (game 7), Mar del Plata 1953

52 f7!

Of course 52 fxe7? ♔xe7 is a draw.

52...♔e6 53 ♔g7 ♗d6 54 a4

54 ♔g8 was quicker, but there is no hurry.

54...♗a3 55 ♔g8 ♗d6 56 ♗g7! ♗c5

Or 56...♔f5 57 ♗f8 ♗f4 58 ♗c5 ♗h6 59 ♗e3.

57 ♗f8 ♗e3

And now, with a manoeuvre that will be familiar to you, White shows that the h6-f8 diagonal is very short.

58 ♗b4 ♗h6 59 ♗c3! 1-0

778) Porreca – Ju. Bolbochán
Amsterdam Olympiad 1954

By seeking to infiltrate with the king via g4, after which there is no defence:

40...♔g6! 41 ♔h2 ♕f3 42 ♕e1

If 42 ♕xf3 exf3 43 ♔g1 ♔f6 44 ♔f2 g4 45 ♔e1 ♔e5 Black wins easily using the f3-pawn to deflect the white king and penetrate decisively with his own king, when necessary.

42...♔h5 43 ♔g1 ♔g4 44 ♔h2 f4 0-1

45 gxf4 gxf4 46 exf4 ♕xf4+ 47 ♔g2 ♕f3+ 48 ♔h2 ♕h3+ 49 ♔g1 ♕g3+.

779) Bielicki – Smyslov
Mar del Plata 1962

38...♗f2!

Incarcerating the white king, with the idea of 39...♔h7 and ...♔g6-f5. Black achieves nothing with 38...♔h7 39 ♔g3 ♔g6 40 ♔f4.

39 g3

Also losing is 39 ♗g3 ♗xg3+ 40 ♔xg3 ♔g7 41 ♔f4 ♔f6 42 c5 ♔xe6 43 ♔g5 ♔e5 44 ♔xh5 (44 a4 a5 45 g3 ♔e4 46 ♔xh5 does not change the situation) 44...♔f5! 45 ♔h6 e5 46 h5 e4 47 ♔g7 e3 48 h6 e2 49 h7 e1♕ 50 h8♕ ♕e7+ (or 50...♕e5+) 51 ♔g8 ♔g6!.

39...♗c5 40 ♔g2 ♔h7 0-1

There is no defence against the threat to take the e6-pawn.

780) Franco – Sequera
Bled Olympiad 2002

The game went **32 ♖c2??** and Black achieved equality by making his king safe with **32...♔h6 33 b3 e5 34 ♖d7 ♕b5 35 ♖cc7 ♕e2 ½-½.**

Black is able to infiltrate with his queen, and perpetual check is unavoidable.

Instead **32 ♖h4+!** wins, boxing in the black king, and the threats of mate are decisive after 32...♔g8 33 ♖hc4! ♔h7 (if 33...♕xb2 then 34 ♖c8+ ♔f7 35 ♖4c7#) 34 ♖c8, followed by 35 ♖h4+, winning.

781) Delgado – L. Domínguez

Capablanca Memorial, Havana 2005

34...♗h3+! 35 ♔f3

The pawn queens after 35 ♔xh3 ♕xf4 36 gxf4 d2.

35...♗g4+ 36 ♔e3 ♕xc3 37 ♕e4+

If 37 ♘a4 then 37...♕e1+ 38 ♔xd3 ♕d1+ and 39...♕xa4.

37...g6 38 ♕xd3 ♕e1+! 39 ♔d4 ♕e5+! 0-1

40 ♔c4 ♗e2 is winning for Black.

782) Rublevsky – Ivanchuk

Blitz World Ch, Almaty 2008

42 ♔h5! wins: 42...♖xb2 (42...♖xe4 is also met by 43 ♗e6) 43 ♗e6 (threatening 44 g7+ and 45 ♖h8+) 43...♘xg6 44 ♔xg6 ♖xf2, and now 45 ♗f5 is the most straightforward (but there are other ways to win, such as 45 ♗d7): 45...♔e8 46 ♔xf6 ♔d8 47 ♖d7+ ♔c8 48 ♖xd6+ ♔c7 49 ♖a6.

783) Lenić – Franco

Dresden Olympiad 2008

51...♖c4!

Forcing White to move his rook into a bad position, if he is not to lose another pawn.

52 ♖g5 b4 53 h5

This was the idea, but now the bad placing of the white rook allows...

53...b3! 54 ♖e5

After 54 hxg6 b2 55 gxf7 b1♕ 56 f8♕, the white king perishes; e.g., 56...♕a2+ 57 ♔e3 ♕b3+ 58 ♔f2 ♖c2+ 59 ♔g1 ♕e3+.

54...♖xg4

With the capture of another pawn, the rest is simple.

55 hxg6 fxg6 56 ♔c3 ♖g3+ 57 ♔b2 ♔b4 0-1

784) Gadía – Redolfi

Mar del Plata 1960

Black was over-confident and carelessly continued **38...♔d7??**, losing the game after **39 ♖h8!** (or 39 ♖g8) **39...♔xe7 40 ♖h7+ ♔d6 41 ♖xb7 ♔c5 42 ♖h7 b5 43 ♖xh6 1-0**.

Instead, after **38...♔d6!** 39 ♖h8 ♖xe7 40 ♖xh6+ ♔c5, the advantage lies with Black.

785) Corrales – Abergel

Harkany 2008

46 ♔xh5? is insufficient for a win: 46...f3 47 ♗d1 ♔f4! 48 ♗xf3! (worse is 48 ♔g6? f2 49 ♗e2 b4 50 h5 a4 51 h6 b3 52 axb3 axb3 53 h7 b2 54 h8♕ b1♕+ 55 ♔f7 ♕a2+, when it is also a theoretical draw, but it is White who must play accurately to secure it) 48...♔xf3 49 ♔g5 b4 50 h5 a4 51 h6 b3 52 h7! b2 53 h8♕ b1♕ 54 ♕h3+ ♔f2 55 ♕h2+ ♔f3 56 ♕f4+ ♔e2 57 ♕xa4 with an extra pawn, but it's a theoretical draw.

With **46 ♗d1!** White wins:

46...♔e4 47 ♔xh5 f3 48 ♔g4 f2 49 ♗e2 b4 50 h5 ♔e3

Or 50...♔e5 51 ♔g5 ♔e6 52 h6 ♔f7 53 ♗c4+ ♔f8 54 ♔g6 f1♕ 55 ♗xf1 ♔g8 56 ♗c4+ ♔h8 57 ♗b3, and White wins.

51 ♗f1 a4 52 h6 b3 53 h7 b2 54 h8♕ b1♕ 55 ♕c3+ 1-0

786) Eliskases – Fischer

Buenos Aires 1960

56 ♘h5!! ♔xa4

If 56...c2 then 57 ♘f4! wins by bringing about a knight ending where White's extra pawn on the kingside is decisive; e.g., 57...♔c3 58 ♔e4! c1♘ 59 h4 ♘b3 60 ♘d5+! ♔c4 61 ♘xb6+ ♔c5 62 g5! hxg5 63 h5 g4 64 h6 g3 65 ♔f3 ♘d4+ 66 ♔g2! ♘e6 67 h7 ♘f4+ 68 ♔xg3 ♘g6 69 ♔g4 (or 69 a5 ♔b5 70 ♘c4) 69...♔xb6 70 ♔g5 ♘e5 71 ♔f5 ♘f7 72 ♔f6 ♘h8 73 ♔g7.

57 ♘f4 b5 58 ♘e2 c2 1-0

The advance of the black pawns is easily contained; for instance, 59 h4 b4 60 ♔c4 b3 61 ♔c3 ♔a3 62 g5 c1♕+ 63 ♘xc1 b2 64 ♔c2!.

787) Istratescu – Amin

Dresden Olympiad 2008

The draw is very near after **63...♖f1+!** 64 ♔e5 (64 ♔xg5 ♖g1+ 65 ♔f5 ♖xg6! is an even easier draw) 64...♘f3+ 65 ♔e4 ♔xg7 66 ♗f5 ♔f6 and the extra white pawn is not enough to win.

788) Shirov – Topalov

Dresden Olympiad 2008

30 h5!

An elegant way to reinforce the attack with a pawn.

30...gxh5 31 g5!

The h7-rook is not only passive but is also a tactical weakness; the threat is 32 g6.

31...♖g2 32 ♔f5 ♖e2

32...♖f2 is met by 33 f4 ♖e2 34 ♖c8+ ♖e8 35 ♖xe8+ ♔xe8 36 ♔f6! a4 37 g6.

33 ♖c8+ ♖e8 34 ♖xe8+ ♔xe8 35 ♔f6!

With our well-known winning idea.

35...h4 36 g6! ♖h6 37 ♖xf7 1-0

37...h3 38 ♖h7! and White wins.

789) Van den Doel – Hellenberg

Leiden 2008

Obviously not 50...c1♕? since after 51 ♖f8+ the black king falls under a mating attack.

The game went **50...♖xg7? 51 ♔xg7 c1♕ 52 ♖f8+! ♔e6 53 ♖f6+ ♔d5 54 h8♕ ♕g5+** (or 54...♕g1+ 55 ♖g6 ♕a7+ 56 ♔h6 ♕e3+ 57 ♖g5) **55 ♔f7 1-0**.

Black can draw with **50...♔g6!!**; after 51 ♖c8 ♖xg7! 52 ♖c6+ ♔f7 53 ♖xc2 ♖g1, we reach an ending that is drawn without the pawns at f3 and e5, and even with these pawns the evaluation is unchanged; e.g., 54 ♖c7+ ♔f6 55 ♖c8 ♔f7 56 ♖g8 ♖a1 57 ♖g7+ ♔f6.

790) King – Speelman

British League (4NCL) 2007/8

The game concluded **49 ♖c5?** (the passed pawn will make no progress this way) **49...♖xb2 50 ♖c4 ♖b3+ 51 ♔h4 ♔g7 52 g4 ♔g6 53 ♖d4 ½-½**.

White's best chance lies in mobilizing his b-pawn by **49 ♖b8+!** ♔g7 50 b5 ♖xb2 51 b6. Now:

a) 51...f6 52 exf6+ ♔xf6 53 b7! ♔g7 and then:

a1) 54 ♔f3? is based on a typical idea: White intends to head for e7 with the plan of capturing the e6-pawn, after which Black will be in zugzwang. We shall see this idea in action later. However, this specific move runs into a problem: 54...♖b5! and after 55 ♔e3 e5! 56 fxe5? ♖xe5+ 57 ♔d4 ♖b5 the capture of the f5-pawn leads to a drawn ending.

a2) Therefore White needs to hang on to his own f-pawn. The best way to do this appears to be 54 ♔h4!, with the idea of playing g4 and exchanging pawns, thus ruling out the above defensive resource, and then returning to the route that we shall examine below.

b) 51...♖b3+ 52 ♔f2 ♖b2+ 53 ♔f3 and then:

b1) If 53...♔h7, White wins by 54 ♔e3 ♖xg2 55 ♖f8! ♖b2 56 ♖xf7+ ♔g8 (56...♔g6 57 ♖f6+) 57 ♖b7 ♖b4 58 ♔d3 and the king penetrates via c5 and d6.

b2) 53...♖b3+ 54 ♔e2 ♖b2+ 55 ♔d3 ♖xg2. Unlike 'normal' positions in which the attacker abandons his kingside, here the defender can't create a passed pawn, and is therefore lost: 56 ♔c4 ♖b2 57 ♔c5 f6 58 exf6+ ♔xf6 59 b7 ♔g7 60 ♔c6 ♖c2+ 61 ♔d6 ♖b2 62 ♔xe6 ♖b5, and now White wins the f5-pawn by means of the above-mentioned zugzwang: 63 ♔d6 ♖b2 64 ♔e5 ♖b5+ 65 ♔e6 ♔h7 66 ♔f6!.

791) Nogués – Grau

Buenos Aires 1926

41...♗g3! 0-1

792) Maderna – Lipiniks

Argentine Ch, Buenos Aires 1954

46 ♖c2!

With this move, all the pressure on the passed pawn is lifted. 46 ♗d3+ ♔g7 47 ♖c2 also works.

46...♖xc2 47 ♗d3+ 1-0

Furthermore the black bishop is trapped.

793) Najdorf – Redolfi

Mar del Plata 1959

67...♕d3+! ½-½

794) Liberzon – Franco

Haifa Olympiad 1976

56...b5!

It will still take some moves for the white king to be close enough (for instance on d4, d5 or c3) to prevent this resource from working, but... the sooner the better. 56...b6 and 56...♔d7 are the only other moves that don't lose.

57 axb6+

57 a6 is met by 57...b4, planning 58...♔c6 and ...♔b5, which a white king on one of the above-mentioned squares would prevent. After 58...♔c6, if White replies 59 ♗f2, to prevent ...♔b5, then Black plays 59...♔c7 and ...♔b8, reaching the safe squares.

57...♔b7

with a theoretical draw.

795) Novikov – Franco

Saint Vincent 1999

70...♔h4! ½-½

71 ♔xf4 is stalemate, and White can't hope to win by any other means.

796) Perera – Ruiz Jiménez
Benasque 2001

45...♔e7? allows the white f-pawn to threaten to advance with check after **46 ♔g7!** so Black must play **46...♔e6** (not 46...a4? 47 bxa4 bxa4 48 f5! and White wins) **47 ♔g6 ♔e7**, with a draw.

The immediate **45...a4!** wins easily; after 46 bxa4 b4 Black queens with check; or 46...bxa4 47 f5 a3 48 f6 a2 49 f7 ♔e7!, again queening with check.

797) Piazzini – Reshevsky
Stockholm Olympiad 1937

52 ♔xf6!

The right way; after 52 h5? ♔d4 53 ♖a3 e4 54 h6 e3 Black draws.

52...♔d4 53 ♖xe5 ♖xg3 54 h5

Black's king is cut off from the defence, so he loses:

54...♖f3+ 55 ♖f5 ♖h3 56 ♔g6 ♔e4 57 ♖g5 ♖a3 58 h6 ♖a6+ 59 ♔h5 ♖a7 60 ♖g8 ♔e5 61 ♔g6 ♖a6+ 62 ♔g5 ♖a7 63 ♖e8+ ♔d5 64 ♔g6 ♖a6+ 65 ♔g7 ♖a7+ 66 ♔g8 ♖a1 67 h7 ♖g1+ 68 ♔f7 ♖f1+ 69 ♔e7 1-0

798) Pelikan – Guimard
Buenos Aires 1945

56...♖e3!

Reversing the move-order does not work: 56...h5+? 57 ♔h4 ♖e3 58 ♗xf7+! ♔xf7 59 ♔xh5.

57 ♗xf7+

After 57 ♖g1 h5+ 58 ♔h4+ ♔h6 there is no satisfactory defence against 59...♗d8+; if 59 ♖g8 then 59...♗e5.

57...♔xf7 58 ♖b7 ♖e7

and Black pressed home his advantage.

799) Falcón – Iliesco
Argentine Ch, Buenos Aires 1946

49...♕g3! 0-1

Zugzwang forces the rook to move to an unprotected square, where it perishes; e.g., 50 ♖h8 ♕f3+ 51 ♔h2 ♕f4+ 52 ♔g2 ♕d2+ 53 ♔f1 ♕c1+ 54 ♔g2 ♕b2+.

800) Gligorić – Ju. Bolbochán
Mar del Plata 1953

41...♘d3!

Even better than the immediate capture on e4; Black wants to increase the activity of his pieces before capturing any pawns.

42 ♗d2

Retaining his worse bishop; White's defence is difficult after 42 ♕xd3 ♕xb4 43 ♔f2 a5.

42...♕b1+ 43 ♔g2 ♘c5

This is one of the few examples where the pair of knights is far superior to the pair of bishops; White's damaged structure is the main reason.

44 ♕b4 ♕c2 45 ♕c3 ♕a2

The e4-pawn is indefensible, and White can only choose between several evils. The rest is easy.

46 ♕a5 ♕xc4 47 h5 ♘b3 48 ♕d8 ♘xd2 0-1

801) Pilnik – F. Olafsson
Match (game 3), Reykjavik 1957

62 h6? doesn't work, since it is Black who wins after 62...e3 63 h7 e2 64 h8♕ e1♕+ 65 ♔h5 ♕h1+.

62 ♔h3! 1-0

The only move, but it wins; after 62...♔f3 63 h6 e3 64 h7 e2 65 h8♕ e1♕ 66 ♕f6+ ♔e2 67 ♕e5+, White exchanges queens and wins, while 62...e3 63 ♔g2 ♔e4 64 ♔f1! ♔d3 65 ♔e1 also gives Black no hope.

802) Fischer – Pachman
Mar del Plata 1959

55...♖xf3+! 56 ♖xf3 ♗xf3 0-1

After 57 ♔xf3, 57...b4 wins.

803) Ramírez – Franco
Haifa Olympiad 1976

46...♔b4!

46...♔xa5?? is bad on account of 47 ♔c5 ♔a4 48 ♔d6 a5 49 ♔e7 ♔b3 50 ♔xf7 a4 51 f5 exf5 52 e6 a3 53 e7 a2 54 e8♕ a1♕ 55 ♕b5+ ♔c2 56 ♕xf5+, with the better ending.

47 f5

White hopes that the black king will take the pawn, making way for the white king.

47...♔b5!

The simplest. 47...exf5 is also winning, but the pawn ending in that case requires considerable accuracy.

0-1

Only after 48 fxe6 fxe6 49 ♔d3 does Black play 49...♔xa5, winning.

804) Franco – Quinteros
Mar del Plata 1982

40 ♖d1!

Preventing ...♖d4.

40...♖g8 41 ♔f3 ♖d8

Black has to lose another tempo, as 41...♔g7? loses to 42 ♖g1+.

1-0

The game was adjourned, and Black resigned without resuming. A possible continuation is 42 ♔e4 ♔g7 43 ♔d5 ♔f6 44 ♔c6 h5 45 d7 ♔g5 46 ♔c7, with an easy win.

805) Spraggett – Franco

Mondariz 1998

51...♖e3! 0-1

806) Pons Sastre – Franco

Llucmajor 2000

46...♔f3! 47 ♖xe6 ♖xf2+ 48 ♔e1

48 ♔g1 ♖e2 is similar.

48...♖e2+ 49 ♔d1 ♖xe3 50 ♖xf6+ ♔g2 0-1

807) Franco – Quezada

Capablanca Memorial, Havana 2001

87 h4! 1-0

White creates a decisive passed pawn. Now 87...gxh4 88 ♖g7+ is winning for White.

808) Moreno Carnero – Matamoros

Dos Hermanas 2004

61...g4! 0-1

Black wins after 62 hxg4+ ♔xg4 63 ♔g2 ♖d2+ 64 ♔f1 c2.

809) Rustemov – Illescas

Dos Hermanas 2005

28 ♖xe6! fxe6 29 ♔c2 ♔f7 30 ♔c3 ♔e7 31 ♔c4 ♔d6 32 ♔b5 ♔c7 33 ♔a6 ♔c6 34 a4!

Up to here everything was forced; White's spare move now decides the game.

34...g5 35 g4 h6 36 h3 ♔c7 37 ♔a7 ♔c6 38 ♔b8! 1-0

After 38...♔c5 (38...♔d6 39 ♔b7 ♔c5 40 ♔c7 transposes) 39 ♔c7 ♔b4 40 ♔xb6 ♔xa4 41 ♔c5 White wins easily.

810) Franco – Lariño

Calvia 2005

62 e7! ♖xe7 63 ♖f6+ ♔c7 64 ♗xd5 with an extra piece.

811) Pajeken – Landa

Hamburg 2007

101...♖g1+!

101...♖xg4? allows White to save the game with 102 ♔f1 ♖g8 and now several moves draw, the simplest being to place the rook on the 'long side' with 103 ♖a6.

102 ♖f1 ♖xf1+ 0-1

103 ♔xf1 is met by 103...♔d2.

812) Ivanchuk – Wang Yue

Sofia 2009

47...h4+!!

Now White's king will be shut in at the edge of the board, and Black will force a win by zugzwang.

The pawn sacrifice is not just the only winning move; it is also the sole way to avoid loss. For example, 47...hxg4? 48 ♔xg4 ♔xd5 49 h4 ♔e6 50 h5 gxh5+ 51 ♔xh5 ♔f7 52 ♔h6 ♔g8 53 ♔g6 leads to a lost ending for Black.

48 ♔xh4

Otherwise Black can win as he pleases.

48...♔f3

Now Black is able to stalemate White's king, eventually forcing a losing pawn advance on the queenside.

49 b4

After 49 a5 Black also wins without any great trouble; for example, 49...b6 50 axb6 (50 b4 b5! is like the game) 50...cxb6 51 c4 a5 and White is fast running out of safe moves. 52 ♔h3 ♔f2 53 ♔h4 ♔g2 54 h3 ♔f3 55 c5 bxc5 56 b4 c4 and the game finishes with ...♕e1#.

49...b5 50 a5 ♔g2 51 h3 ♔h2 0-1

And mate in six more moves finishing with ...♕e1#.

813) Wang Yue – Cheparinov

FIDE World Cup, Khanty-Mansiisk 2007

40...d1♘+!

Not 40...d1♕?? 41 ♕e7+ with perpetual check.

41 ♔c2

After 41 ♔b3 ♕f3+ the queen comes to the king's defence.

41...♘e3+ 42 ♔d3 ♘f5

Now it is the knight that comes to the aid of the king, and Black is able to press home his material advantage.

43 fxe5 ♕f3+ 44 ♔d2 ♕f2+ 45 ♔d3 ♕d4+ 46 ♔c2 dxe5 47 ♘c3 ♕f2+ 48 ♔b1 ♕g1+ 49 ♔b2 ♕xh2+

and White resigned a few moves later.

814) Quezada – A. Graf

Mérida 2008

40 h6! gxh6

40...g6 is met by 41 ♗h5!.

41 gxh6 1-0

The threat is 42 ♗h5 followed by ♗g6. The only way to try to resist is by playing ...c5, so that the black king can go to the kingside, but it doesn't work; e.g., 41...c5 42 ♗xc5 (42 dxc5 is also good enough) 42...♘xc5 43 dxc5 ♗xa2 44 ♗h5 ♗xb3 45 ♗g6 ♔e7 46 ♗xh7 ♔f7 47 ♗xf5! exf5 48 e6+ ♔g6 49 ♔d4! and White queens a pawn.

815) Nuñez Campos – Frois

Monforte de Lemos 2008

41...♖e4!

After the exchange of rooks, Black gains the invasion square f5.

42 ♖xe4 fxe4 43 ♔d2 a5 44 ♔e3 ♔f5 45 a4 e5 46 fxe5 ♔xe5 47 ♔f2 ♔e6

47...♔f5, intending 48...♔g4, is also good enough.

48 ♔e3

Or 48 ♔e2 ♔f5 49 ♔e3 ♔g4 50 ♔xe4 ♔xg3.

48...♔f5 49 ♔f2 ♔g4! 50 ♔e3 ♔xg3 51 ♔xe4 ♔xh4 52 ♔f4 ♔h3 0-1

816) Otte – Wohl

Dieren 2008

56 g4? is a serious error since the ending after 56...hxg4 57 ♔xg4 ♖f6 is a theoretical draw.

56 ♕c2! 1-0

White forces a winning pawn ending; he wins both black pawns while keeping his king in a dominant position: 56...g6 (worse is 56...♔g6 57 g4 hxg4 58 ♔xg4) 57 ♕xf5! gxf5 58 ♔xh5, followed by 59 ♔g5 and ♔xf5. **56 ♕e4!** is equally good.

817) Sandipan – Slingerland

Leiden 2008

61 ♔c5??

White wins with **61 a6!** bxa6+ (or 61...♘f5 62 a7) 62 ♔c6!, and the pawn queens, supported by the king and the bishop.

61...♔d7

Already there is no way for White to exploit his passed pawn, and capturing the b7-pawn only leads to the loss of the d-pawn, after which Black can defend.

62 ♗f4 ♘f5 63 ♔d5 h4 64 ♔c5 ½-½

There is no time to create a passed pawn; Black's pawn goes to h3, and his knight retreats and then resumes the attack on the d6-pawn, with a draw.

818) Monokroussos – Yuan Yuanling

Chicago 2008

32...♖f4+! 33 ♖xf4

No better is 33 ♔e3 ♖xg4 34 fxg4 gxh4; e.g., 35 ♔e4 ♔d6 36 ♔f5 ♔d5 37 ♔g6 e4 38 dxe4+ ♔xe4 39 ♔xh6 c4.

33...gxf4!

White is in zugzwang.

34 a3

After 34 b4 cxb4 35 d4 a5 36 dxe5 a4 37 ♔d3 ♔xe5 the black king penetrates via d4 and either supports his queenside pawns or invades the kingside and captures all White's pawns.

34...a5 35 a4 bxa4 36 bxa4 h5! 0-1

819) Kamsky – Adams

FIDE Grand Prix, Baku 2008

58 h5!

Thanks to this temporary sacrifice, the white king is able to annihilate Black's kingside. The distance of White's king from the main field of battle is significant.

58...♔b3 59 ♖c1 gxh5 60 ♔h3 1-0

Black resigned in view of 60...♔b4 61 ♔h4 ♔b5 62 ♔xh5 ♖xc6 63 ♖xc6 ♔xc6 64 ♔xh6 ♔d6 65 ♔g5 ♔e6 66 ♔g6!.

820) Klimov – Hector

Horsholm (rapid) 2008

64...g3??

Black draws with **64...♔h3!**; e.g., 65 ♔b7 g3 66 hxg3 hxg3 67 f4 g2 68 ♗b6 ♔g4 69 ♗e3 g1♕.

65 fxg3 hxg3 66 h4!

Now the pawn is unstoppable.

66...♔f3 67 h5 g2 68 ♗b6 1-0

821) Vokarev – Azarov

Nezhmetdinov Memorial, Kazan 2008

42 ♖xf7?

This tempting capture lets victory slip away. White wins with **42 ♖dd7!**; e.g., 42...♖a1+ (42...♖f2 43 ♖xf7 doesn't work now) 43 ♔c2 a2 44 ♖a7 ♖f1 45 ♖xa2 ♖f2+ 46 ♖d2. On the other hand, 42 ♖a7 ♖f2 43 ♖d2 ♗b2+ 44 ♔c2 ♖xf3 45 b4 ♔g7 is not as clear.

42...♖a1+ 43 ♔c2 ♖a2+ 44 ♔d1 ♖a1+ 45 ♔c2

The reason for the repetition is that the white king can't move away; if 45 ♔e2 a2 46 ♖a7? then 46...♖h1!, but 46 ♖dd7 ♖e1+! 47 ♔xe1 a1♕+ would be a draw.

45...♖a2+ 46 ♔b1 ♖a1+ 47 ♔c2 ♖a2+ ½-½

822) Akhmadeev – Aleksandrov

Nezhmetdinov Memorial, Kazan 2008

The immediate 86 a8♕? doesn't lead to a win: 86...♕g1+ 87 ♔h3 ♕h1+ 88 ♔g3 (with the queen on e6, 88 ♔g4?? loses after 88...♕h4+ 89 ♔f5 ♕f4#) 88...♕g1+ and Black secures a draw.

The game went:

86 ♕a2??

This fails to prevent the threatened perpetual check. Instead White wins with **86 ♕e7+!** (eliminating the mating possibility with the queen on e6) 86...♔h6 (86...♔g6? loses to 87 ♕e4+) 87 a8♕! ♕g1+ 88 ♔h3 ♕h1+ 89 ♔g4 ♕h4+ 90 ♔f5 ♕f4+ 91 ♔e6 ♕e3+ 92 ♔f7 ♕b3+ 93 ♕e6+. Black's own pawn on g5 rules out any possible stalemates.

86...♕g1+ 87 ♔h3 ♕h1+ 88 ♔g3 ♕g1+ 89 ♔h3 ♕h1+ ½-½

823) T.L. Petrosian – Simonian

Armenian Team Ch, Erevan 2008

40 ♗xh5!

40 ♔f4 also appears to win, although more slowly: 40...♔c5 (or 40...♔c7 41 ♔g5 ♔d7 42 ♔f6 ♔e8 43 g4 hxg4 44 ♗xg4 ♗b7 45 ♗f3 ♗c6 46 h5 gxh5 47 ♗xh5 ♗xe4 48 ♗xf7+ ♔f8 49 ♗xe6) 41 ♔g5 ♔d4 42 ♔f6 ♔xe4 43 ♔xf7 ♔f5 (43...♔xe5 44 ♔xg6, obtaining two passed pawns, is simpler) 44 ♗d3+ ♔g4 45 ♗xg6 ♔xh4 46 ♔f6 ♔g3 (if 46...a5 White can play 47 ♗f7 ♗b7 48 g3+! ♔xg3 {or 48...♔g4? 49 ♔xe6} 49 ♗xh5 ♗d5 50 ♗f7 ♔f4 51 ♗xe6 ♗f3 52 ♗d7, winning) 47 ♗xh5 ♔xg2 48 ♗g4.

40...♔c7

After 40...gxh5? 41 g4 hxg4 42 h5, the pawn is unstoppable.

41 ♗e2 ♔d8 42 b4 ♔e7 43 ♔f4 ♗b7 44 g4 ♔f8 45 ♗d3 ♔e7 46 ♔g5 1-0

There is no defence; e.g., 46...♗c8 47 h5 gxh5 48 gxh5 ♔f8 49 ♔f6 ♔g8 50 h6 ♗b7 and now one of several ways to win is 51 ♗e2 (intending 52 ♗h5) 51...♗xe4 52 ♗xa6.

824) B. Savchenko – Carstensen

Elsinore 2008

53...♖g8??

The simplest is **53...♖e2!**, defending against White's threat to win with 54 ♖h8+ ♔d7 59 e6+; for instance, if 54 ♖xh4 then 54...♖e1 is sufficient to draw, while after 54 ♔e6 Black should play 54...♔f8, following the general rule of moving the king to the 'short side' (although in this case 54...♔d8 is also playable): 55 ♖xh4 ♖e1 56 ♖h8+ ♔g7 57 ♖a8 ♖e2 58 ♔d6 ♔f7! 59 ♖a7+ ♔e8.

Another possibility is **53...♖f2+!** 54 ♔e6 ♔f8! 55 ♖xh4 and there are several moves to draw, but the most logical is to hinder the advance of the white pawn with 55...♖e2, reaching a theoretically drawn position.

54 ♖a7

54 ♖xh4 also wins here, because Black can't put his rook on the third rank or get behind the pawn to hinder its advance.

54...♖g2 55 ♖a8+ ♔d7 56 e6+ ♔d6 57 ♖d8+ 1-0

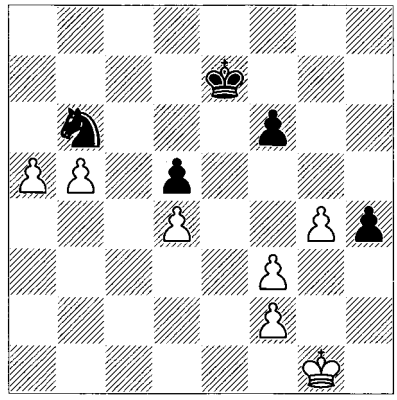
825) Vedmediuc – Ilinčić

Timisoara 2008

50 ♖xb6!

The clearest, simplifying to an ending with too many passed pawns on both wings.

50...♘xb6 51 a5 *(D)*



51...♘c8

There is no time to bring the king to the queenside after 51...♘c4 52 a6 ♘b6 53 a7 ♔d7 because White creates another passed pawn with 54 f4 ♔c7 55 g5 and then brings up his king: 55...fxg5 56 fxg5 ♔b7 57 g6 ♘c8 58 g7 ♘e7 59 b6!, followed by 60 ♔h2 and the capture of the h4-pawn.

52 b6 1-0

826) Krush – D. Schneider

Internet 2008

35...♖xb5!

Simplifying to an ending of bishop vs knight, where Black soon gains two connected passed pawns.

36 axb5 ♘e5+ 37 ♖xe5+

If 37 ♔f4 then 37...♗g5+ wins more easily.

37...♗xe5

Threatening 38...♔c4.

38 ♘d2 ♔c5 39 ♔e4 ♗c3 40 ♘b1 ♗b2 41 f4 ♔xb5

The rest is simple; the passed pawn that White creates is easy to stop, whereas Black's two passed pawns are unstoppable.

42 f5 exf5+ 43 ♔xf5 a5 44 e4 ♔c6 45 e5 a4 46 e6 ♔d6 47 ♘d2 b5 48 ♘e4+ ♔e7 0-1

827) Åkesson – Vallejo

European Ch, Dresden 2007

59...♖h1+ 60 ♔c2 ♖xb1 61 ♔xb1 ♔h5 62 ♔c2 ♔xh4 63 ♔d3 ♔h3! 0-1

With this typical manoeuvre, Black captures the f3-pawn and wins; e.g., 64 ♔d4 (or 64 ♔e2 ♔g2 65 ♔e1 ♔xf3) 64...♔g2! 65 ♔e4 ♔g3.

828) Sashikiran – Shirov

Foros 2007

36...b2! 37 ♔c2

Forced; now Black exploits the position of the white king on the c-file, where it is vulnerable to a check, and the fact that the bishop on a6 is loose.

37...♖e6! 38 ♖xe6 ♖xc7+ 39 ♔xb2 fxe6

Black is the exchange up and with the white king cut off, the result is no longer in doubt.

40 ♔b3 ♖c1 0-1

829) Adams – Carlsen

FIDE World Cup, Khanty-Mansiisk 2007

78...♗xc5+!

Black is under unpleasant pressure, but with this sacrifice he achieves a draw.

79 dxc5

79 ♔xc5 results in perpetual check after 79...♕d5+ 80 ♔b6 (not 80 ♔b4?? c5+!, winning the queen) 80...♕b3+ 81 ♔a7 ♕a2+ (or 81...♕a3+) 82 ♔b8 ♕g8+ 83 ♔b7 ♕b3+.

79...♕xe5 80 ♕b7+ ♕c7 81 ♕xc7+ ♔xc7 82 ♔c4 ♔d7 83 ♔d3 ½-½

830) Peralta – Almirón

Paraguayan Ch, Asunción 2009

It seems White has two ways to win, 55 ♔f4 and 55 ♔d4, but only one of them wins. Did you choose the correct one?

55 ♔f4?

This move should have lost half a point. **55 ♔d4!** leads to an easy win after 55...g5 (or 55...♔g7 56 ♔c5 ♔f8 57 ♔d6 ♔f7 58 ♔d7, with zugzwang) 56 ♔c5! ♔g6 (56...gxh4 is even worse: 57 ♔d6 ♔g5 58 ♔xe6) 57 ♔d6 ♔f5 58 hxg5 h4 59 g6.

55...♔h7?

The saving resource was 55...g5+!! 56 hxg5+ ♔g6, when the extra tempo g3 is not enough to win: 57 g3 ♔f7 58 ♔e4 ♔g6 and White's king must return to f4, as he even loses after 59 ♔d4?? ♔xg5 60 ♔c5 ♔g4 61 ♔d6 ♔f5! (but not 61...♔xg3? 62 ♔xe6, which is a draw).

56 ♔g5 ♔g7 1-0

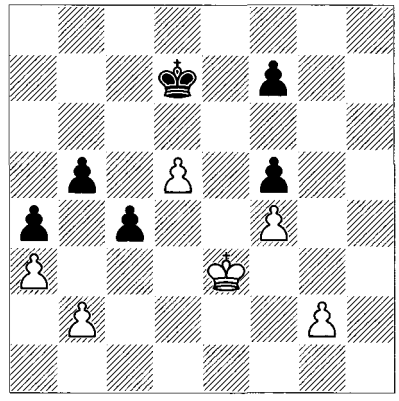
57 g3! leads to zugzwang.

831) Brítez – Pérez Ferloni

Ciudad del Este 2008

1...♔d7! *(D)*

Black wastes a tempo, placing White in zugzwang. 1...b4? 2 axb4 c3 is answered by 3 ♔d3! cxb2 4 ♔c2 a3 5 b5 ♔d6 6 b6 and the pawns, separated by a knight's move, in effect defend each other, so the position is a draw.



2 ♔d4

If 2 g3 Black plays another waiting move, such as 2...♔c7.

2...♔d6 3 ♔c3

In the case of 3 g3 it is important that Black has another waiting move with 3...f6!, and so wins.

3...♔xd5

with an easy win.

832) Souleidis – Mastrovasilis

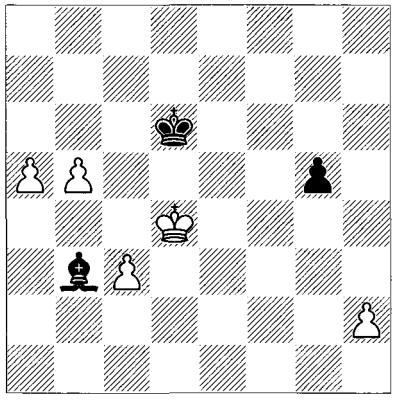
Kallithea (rapid) 2008

49...♔d6?

This underestimates the difficulties that arise from allowing White too much space. Instead, with **49...♗c4!** 50 b6 ♗a6 Black forces the white pawns to advance, after which they are

blockaded and their strength drains away; e.g., 51 ♔f3 ♗c8 52 ♔g3 ♔d5 53 a6 ♗xa6 54 ♔g4 ♔c5 55 ♔xg5 ♔xb6 56 h4 ♗e2, and Black has the two white pawns under control. **49...♔d5!** is also good enough; e.g., 50 a6 ♔c5 51 ♔e4 ♔b6 52 ♔f5 ♗c4 53 ♔xg5 ♗xb5 54 h4 ♗xa6 55 h5 ♔c5 56 h6 ♗d3.

50 ♔d4! *(D)*



Now the pawns can advance, supported by the king, and will win the game.

50...♗a4 51 c4 ♔c7 52 ♔c5 1-0

There are various ways for White to advance the pawns but he has play with some care; e.g., 52...♔b7 53 a6+ ♔c7 (53...♔a7 can be met by 54 ♔c6 ♗c2 55 ♔c7 ♗e4 56 c5 ♗f3 57 b6+ ♔xa6 58 c6) and here:

a) Let's look at an unsuccessful attempt: 54 ♔b4 ♗d1 55 c5 ♗f3 56 ♔a5 g4 and now 57 c6?? fails to 57...♗xc6! 58 bxc6 ♔xc6 with a draw.

b) 54 a7! is good: 54...♔b7 55 ♔d6! ♗d1 (if 55...♔xa7, 56 ♔c7 wins, since the b-pawn queens) 56 b6 ♗f3 57 c5 ♗e4 58 a8♕+ ♔xa8 59 ♔c7 g4 60 c6 ♗xc6 61 ♔xc6 ♔b8 62 b7.

833) Kogan – Golod

Rønne 2008

42...hxg4?

Black can win with **42...e5+!** 43 ♔xe5 (after 43 ♔g5 hxg4 44 ♔xg4 ♔xf2 the passed e-pawn gains a decisive tempo in the race) 43...hxg4 44 ♔f4 ♔h3! 45 ♔g5 b5! (zugzwang; if the pawn were already on b5, Black would be the one in zugzwang) 46 ♔xg6 ♔xh4 47 ♔f5 ♔h3 48 ♔f4 ♔g2 49 ♔xg4 (or 49 ♔e3 ♔f1! 50 ♔f4 ♔xf2 51 ♔xg4 ♔e3, winning easily) 49...♔xf2 50 ♔f4 ♔e2 51 ♔e4 ♔d2 52 ♔d4 ♔c2 53 ♔c5 ♔xb2 54 ♔xb5 ♔xa3 55 ♔c4 ♔b2, etc.

43 ♔xg4 e5 44 ♔g5 ♔xf2 45 ♔xg6 e4 46 h5 e3 47 h6 e2 48 h7 e1♕ 49 h8♕ ♕e4+ 50 ♔f7 ♔e2

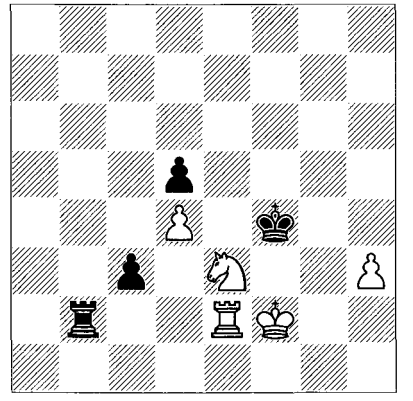
and White should have drawn without much difficulty.

834) S. Alonso – Lemos

Argentine Ch, La Plata 2008

62 ♘e3? *(D)*

This allows the black king to become active. Instead, **62 ♘e5!** wins; e.g., 62...c2 63 ♘d3+ ♔g5 64 ♔e3 ♔h4 65 ♖e1 ♖b8 66 ♔d2 and the c2-pawn will soon drop, whereas White will be able to hang on to his d4-pawn, with an easy win.



62...♔e4! 63 ♘d1+

63 ♘c2+ ♔d3 64 ♘e1+ ♔xd4 65 h4 was slightly more promising, but White has only one pawn left and the black pawns are well advanced; e.g., 65...♔c4 66 h5 d4 67 ♔f3 ♖b3 68 ♖e7 c2+ 69 ♔g4 ♖c3, and White must force a draw.

63...♖xe2+ 64 ♔xe2 ♔xd4 65 ♘f2 ♔e5 66 ♔f3 ♔f5 67 h4 d4 68 ♘d3 c2!

Reducing the mobility of the knight; now the white king can't support the advance of his pawn and it's a draw.

69 ♘c1 ♔e5 70 ♘d3+

Not 70 ♔g4?? ♔e4 71 h5 d3 72 ♘b3 c1♕ 73 ♘xc1 d2 and Black wins.

70...♔f5 71 ♘c1 ♔e5 72 ♘d3+ ♔f5 ½-½

835) Ashwin – Kravtsiv

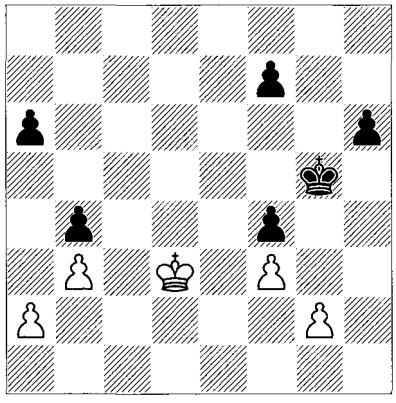
World Junior Ch, Gaziantep 2008

38...♖e1+! 39 ♖f1 ♖e2!

The clearest; Black simplifies to reach a winning pawn ending in which his extra doubled pawn will prove decisive.

40 ♖f2 ♕xf2+ 41 ♕xf2 ♖xf2 42 ♔xf2 f4! 43 ♔e2 ♔g6 44 ♔d3 ♔g5 *(D)*

W



45 ♔c4

White heads for the queenside. He can't just wait, because Black has a lot of tempo moves, enabling him to invade the kingside; e.g., 45 ♔e4 h5 46 ♔e5 f5 47 ♔e6 ♔h4 48 ♔xf5 ♔g3 49 ♔g5 h4 50 ♔f5 h3 51 gxh3 ♔xf3 52 h4 ♔e3 53 h5 f3.

45...♔h4 46 ♔xb4 ♔g3 47 ♔a5

Slightly better, although still hopeless, is 47 ♔c5 ♔xg2 48 b4 ♔xf3 49 a4 ♔g4 50 b5 axb5 51 axb5 f3 52 b6 f2 53 b7 f1♕, with two extra pawns in the queen ending.

47...♔xg2 48 ♔xa6 ♔xf3

Now the f4-pawn will queen with check.

49 b4 ♔e4 50 b5 f3 51 b6 f2 52 b7 f1♕+ 53 ♔a7 ♕f2+ 0-1

836) Li Shilong – Causo

Kuala Lumpur 2008

64 ♔c6!

The race with 64 ♔e6? ♔b5 65 ♔f6 ♖g8 66 g7 a5 67 ♔f7 ♖c8 68 g8♕ ♖xg8 69 ♖xg8 a4 70 ♔e6 a3 71 ♔d5 ♔b4! only leads to a draw.

64...♖g8 65 g7 ♖c8+ 66 ♔b7 ♖g8 67 ♖g5+! ♔b4 68 ♔xa6

And now the white king, helped by the rook on the fifth rank, reaches the critical squares on the kingside before the black king.

68...♔c4 69 ♔b6 ♔d4 70 ♔c6 ♔e4 71 ♔d6 1-0

The white king gets there first: 71...♔f4 72 ♖g1 ♔f5 73 ♔e7.

837) Eingorn – Franco

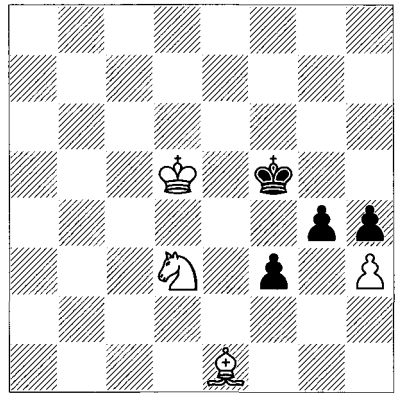
Pamplona 1991

64...f3?

Black draws with **64...gxh3!** 65 ♘xf4+ ♔f5 66 ♘xh3 ♔g4 67 ♘f2+ ♔f3 68 ♔d4 (or 68 ♔e5 ♔e2, while 68 ♘h3 ♔g4 repeats) 68...♔g2! 69 ♘d3 h3 70 ♘f4+ ♔f1 71 ♗g3 ♔g1!.

65 ♘f4+ ♔f5 66 ♘d3 *(D)*

B



66...f2

Now 66...gxh3 loses to 67 ♘f2! h2 (67...♔f4 is no better: 68 ♘xh3+ ♔g4 69 ♘f2+ ♔g3 {or 69...♔f4 70 ♔d4 and the pawns are soon lost} 70 ♘e4++ ♔g4 71 ♔d4 h3 72 ♔e3 h2 73 ♘g3) 68 ♗d2! (barring the way to the black king) 68...h3 69 ♔d4 h1♕ 70 ♘xh1 ♔g4 71 ♔e3 and White wins. 66...g3 loses to 67 ♔d4 f2 68 ♗xf2 gxf2 69 ♘xf2 ♔f4 70 ♘e4 ♔f3 71 ♔e5 ♔g2 72 ♘g5.

67 ♘xf2 gxh3 68 ♔d4 1-0

White easily keeps the black pawns under control; e.g., 68...♔f4 69 ♔d3 ♔f3 70 ♘xh3 ♔g2 71 ♘f4+ ♔f3 72 ♗d2 ♔g3 73 ♔e4 h3 74 ♗e1+ ♔h2 75 ♔f3 with mate in five, helped by the black pawn.

838) M. Muzychuk – Ju Wenjun

World Team Ch (women), Ningbo 2009

Black has the better king, but this factor is outweighed by White's ability to create passed pawns on both wings.

52 g4! hxg4

52...gxh4 53 gxh5 f5 54 h6 ♔f6 55 b4 is similar.

53 h5 f5 54 h6 f4+ 55 ♔f2 ♔f6

After 55...g3+ 56 ♔f3 g4+ 57 ♔g2 the black pawns cannot advance, and after 57...♔f6 58 b4 axb4 59 axb4 ♔g6 60 c5 White wins.

56 b4 axb4 57 axb4 ♔g6 58 c5

Black gets four passed pawns, but White's are quicker.

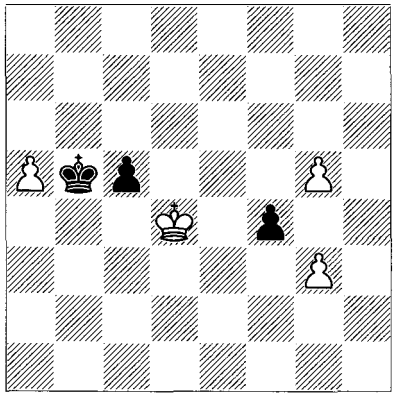
58...bxc5 59 bxc5 dxc5 60 d6 1-0

839) Illescas – Arizmendi

Spanish Ch, León 2006

48...c5+! *(D)*

This check wins a decisive tempo and prevents the white king from keeping both black passed pawns under control; if 48...fxg3? 49 ♔e3 White queens first and wins.



W

49 ♔d3

49 ♔e4 fxg3 50 ♔f3 c4 is similar.

49...fxg3 50 ♔e2 c4 51 g6 g2!

To deflect the white king from the c-pawn; after 51...c3?? 52 g7 c2 53 ♔d2, White wins.

52 ♔f2 c3 53 g7 g1♕+ 54 ♔xg1 c2 55 g8♕ c1♕+ 56 ♔g2 ♕d2+ ½-½

840) Korbut – Tairova

Russian Women's Ch, Moscow 2007

66...gxh2?

Gaining three passed pawns in this way does not win; nor does 66...g2? 67 ♔xf2 ♔xb4 68 ♘d4 ♔c4 69 ♘xb5! ♔xb5 70 ♔g1, with a theoretical draw. The winning idea is **66...♔xb4!** 67 hxg3 ♔c3 68 ♔xf2 b4, and the white knight can only stop the b-pawn from queening at the cost of allowing the h-pawn through: 69 ♔e2 b3 70 ♘d2 h2.

67 ♘xh2 ♔xb4 68 ♔xf2 ♔c3 69 ♘g4! b4 70 ♘e3 h2 71 ♔g2 b3 72 ♔xh2

It is a draw; inevitably the knight must sacrifice itself for the pawn.

72...♔d3 73 ♘d1 ♔c2 ½-½

10 Tests 11-15

This chapter contains the final set of five tests. By now you should be familiar with the format: each test is of roughly equal difficulty, and contains 16 puzzle positions (two are of level 1 difficulty, four of level 2, six of level 3, two of level 4 and the remaining two puzzles achieve our top difficulty rating, level 5).

Also as before, your task is simply to find the best continuation, with the total number of points available for each puzzle equal to its difficulty level. Thus you score just 1 point for correctly solving a novice-level puzzle, but a complete solution to an expert puzzle can get you a total of 5 points. But remember that in many cases, some of the points are awarded for seeing important moves in the supporting variations or later on in the main line. Intuition plays a major role in successful chess, so well done if you are able to guess the key move in each case. But if you want to play to your full potential, you need to support your 'sixth sense' with solid analysis, and this is the reason for awarding the points in this manner. Many of the more difficult puzzles feature surprising turns and tricky defences.

I suggest that you allow at least an hour or two for each test, but feel free to spend as long as you like thinking about each position – work until you consider that further thought will not improve your decision. But be sure to work under realistic test conditions, akin to those at the board in a competitive chess game: do not move the pieces or use the help of a computer. You may solve from the diagram if you like, but I would recommend setting up the position on a real chessboard.

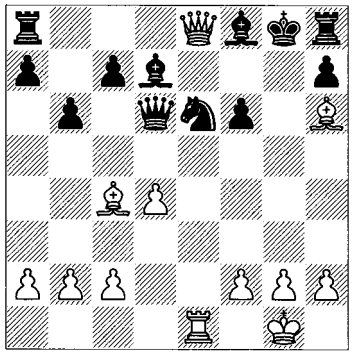
The points score to Elo rating conversion table below should be taken with a pinch of salt, especially as tactical skill is just one of the ingredients in successful chess, albeit a very important one. Nevertheless, when you have completed all 15 tests, your average score should give you a fair indication of your chess ability.

Test Score to Elo Points Conversion Chart

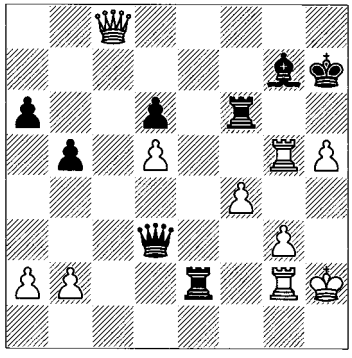
Score	Elo
0-3	1000 or below
4-6	1100
7-9	1200
10-12	1300
13-15	1400
16-18	1500
19-20	1600
21-22	1700
23-24	1800
25-26	1900
27-28	2000
29-31	2100
32-34	2200
35-37	2300
38-40	2400
41-43	2500
44-46	2600 or above

Test 11

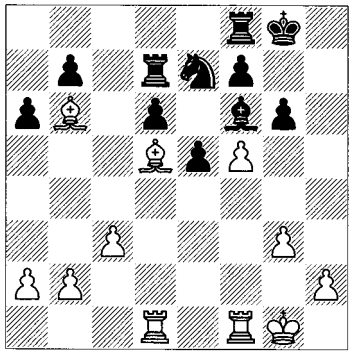
841
W



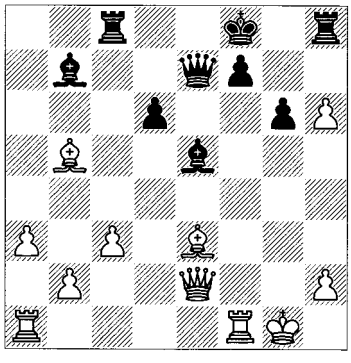
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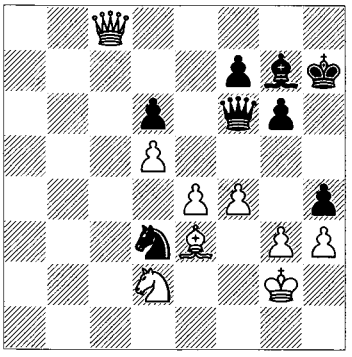
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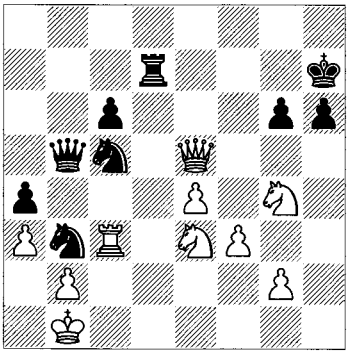
844
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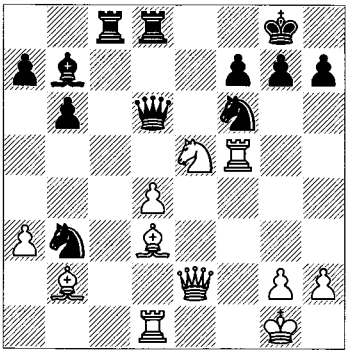
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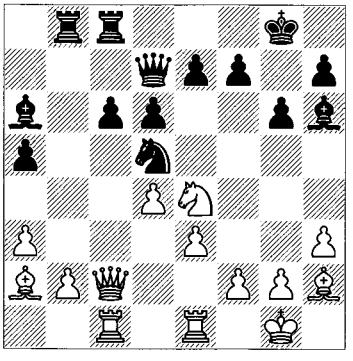
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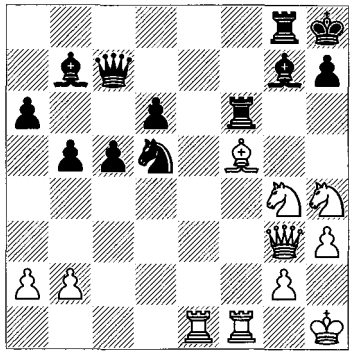
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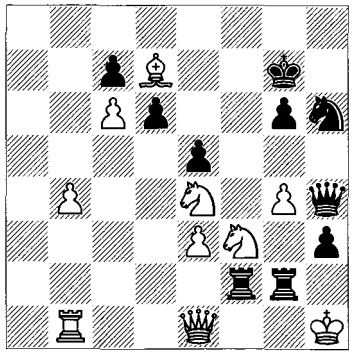
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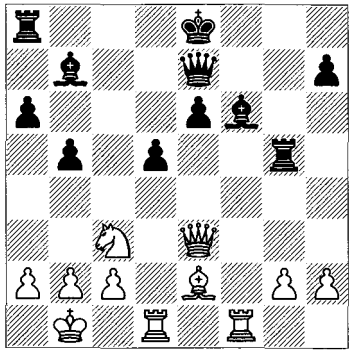
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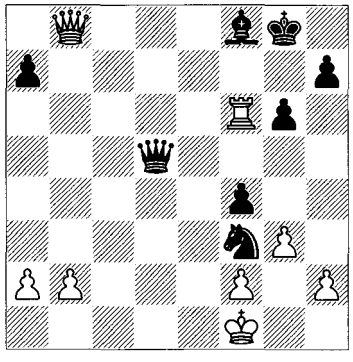
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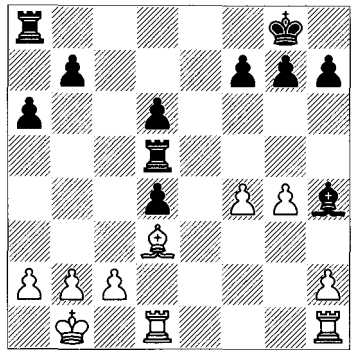
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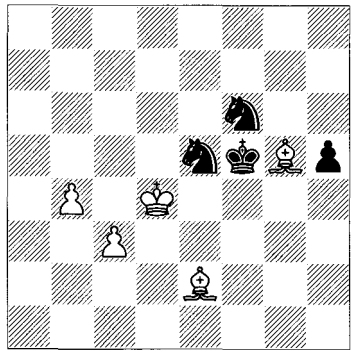
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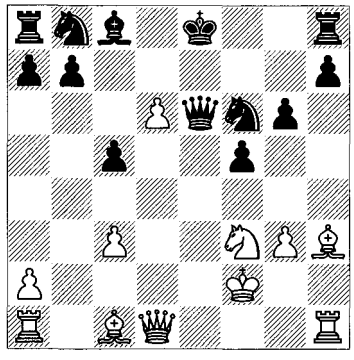
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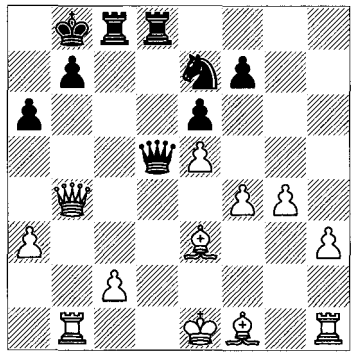
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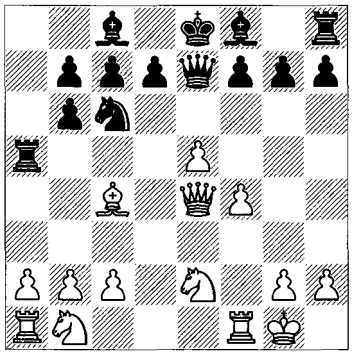


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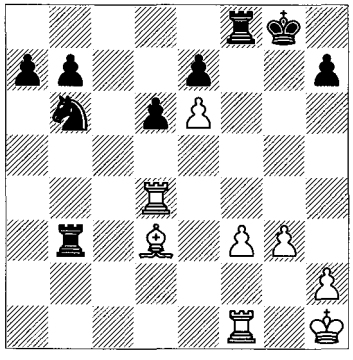


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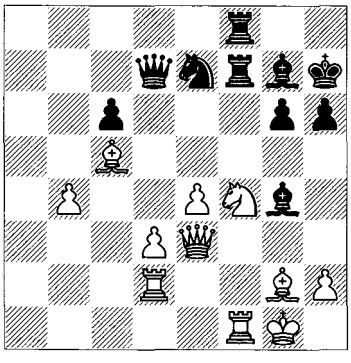
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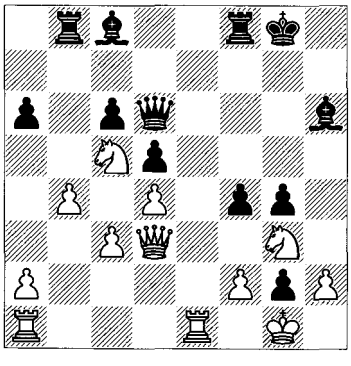
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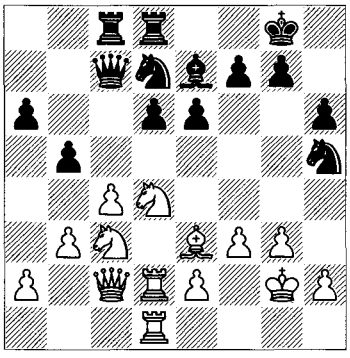
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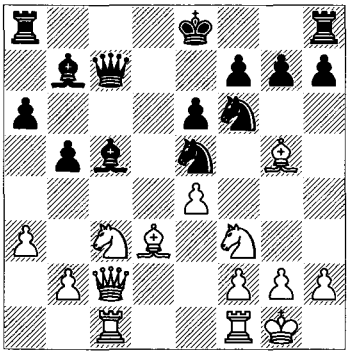
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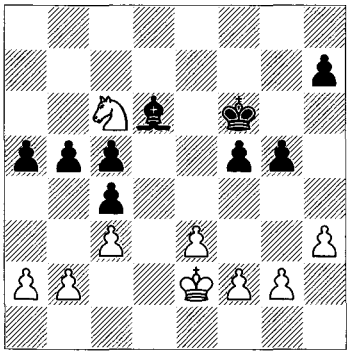
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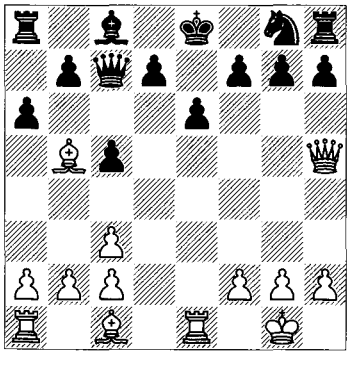
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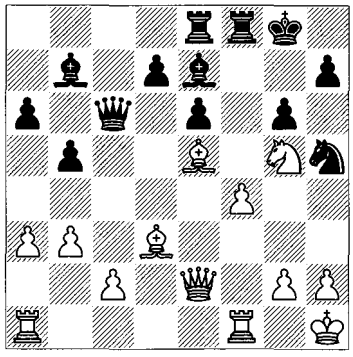
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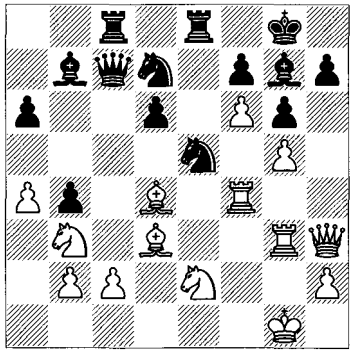
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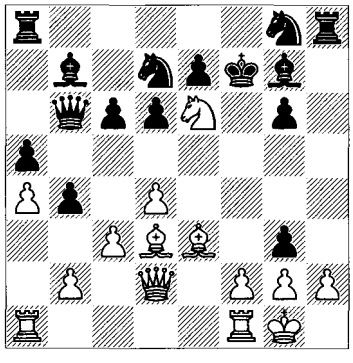
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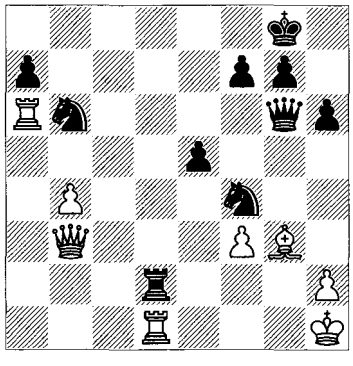
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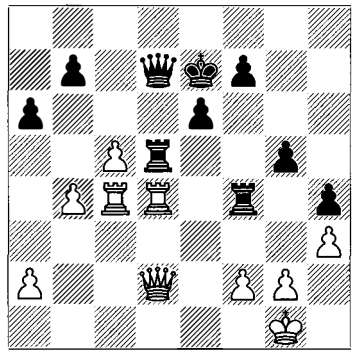
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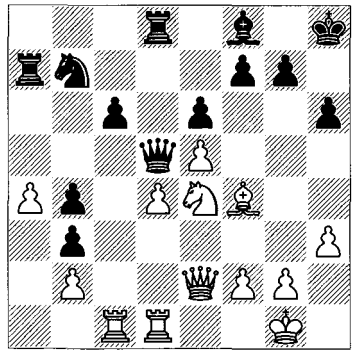
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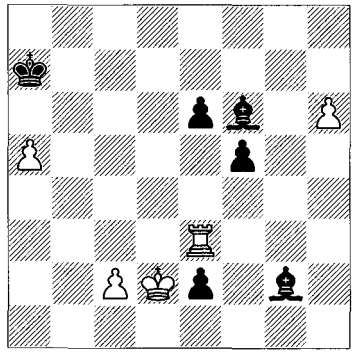
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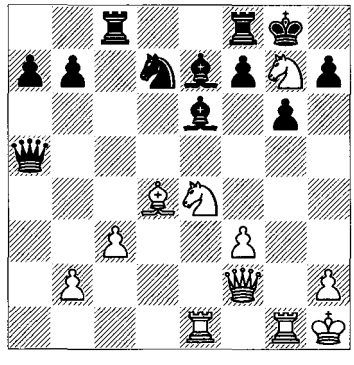
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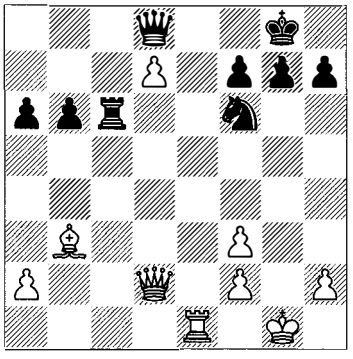


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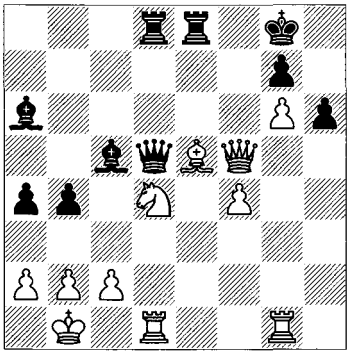


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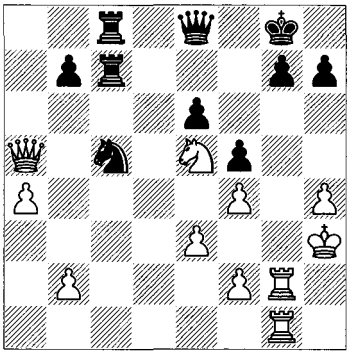
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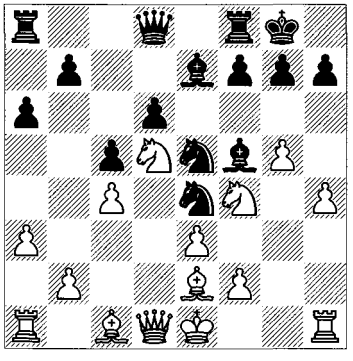
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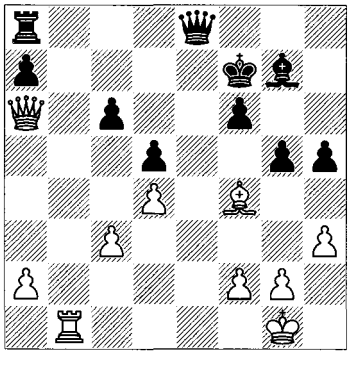
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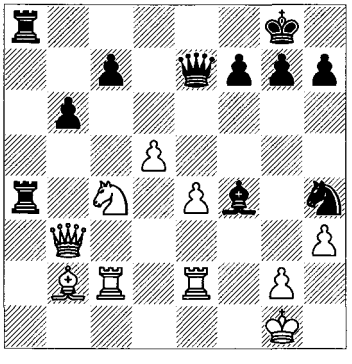
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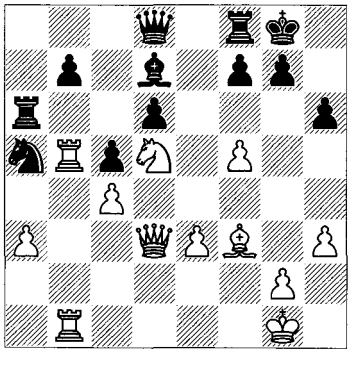
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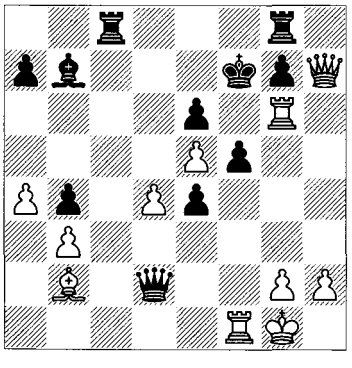
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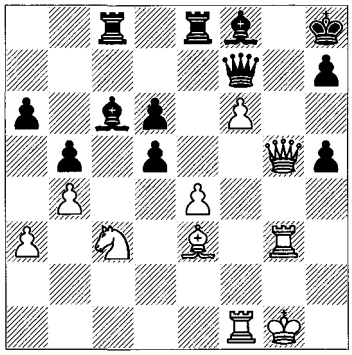
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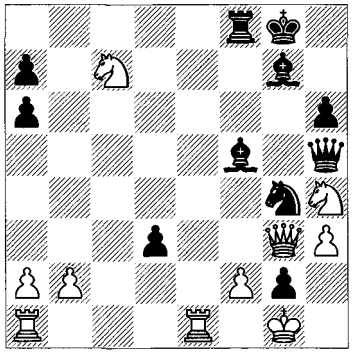
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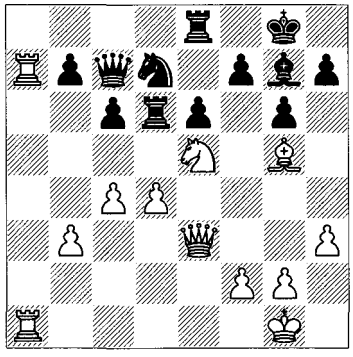
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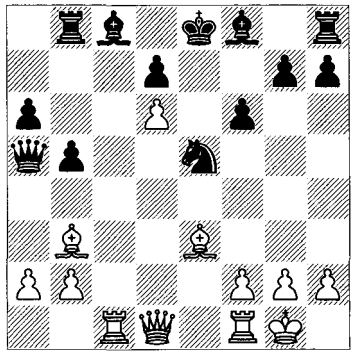
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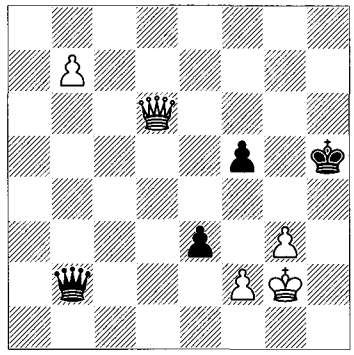
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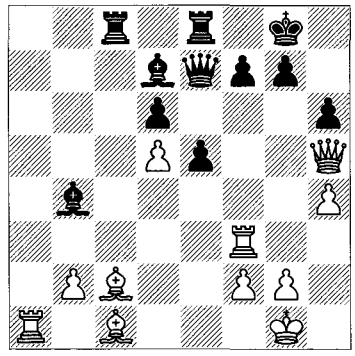
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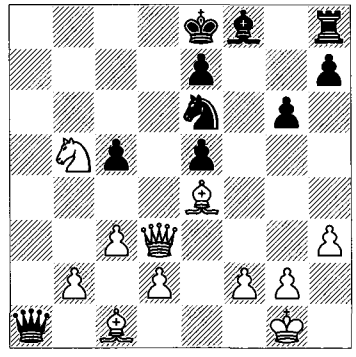
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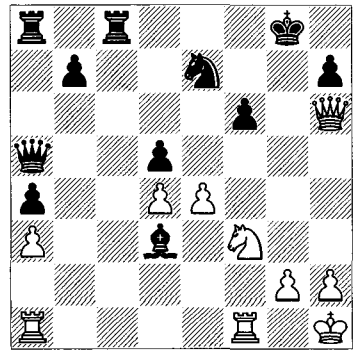
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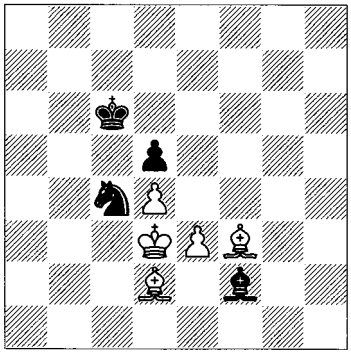


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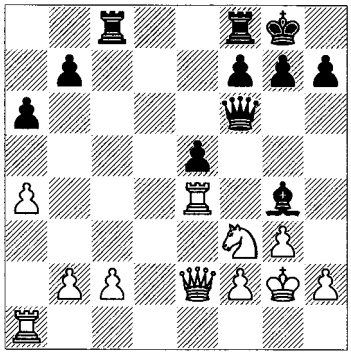


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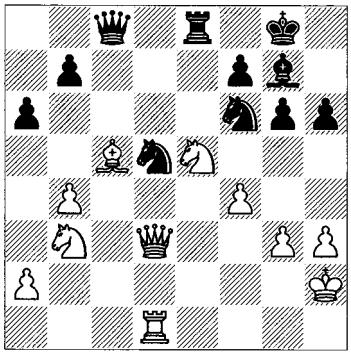
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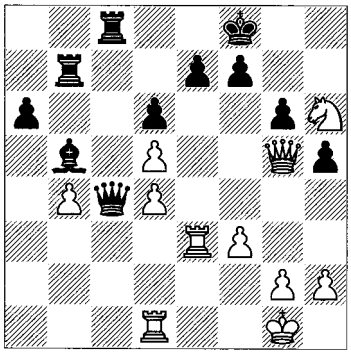
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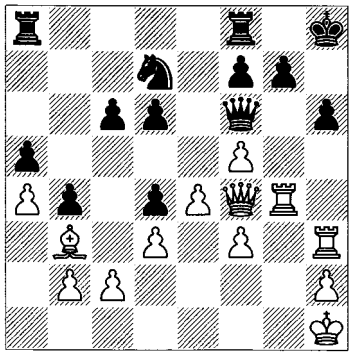
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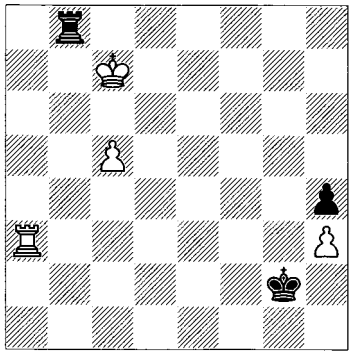
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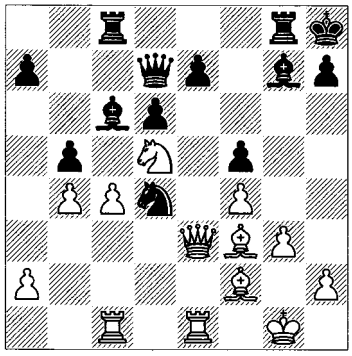
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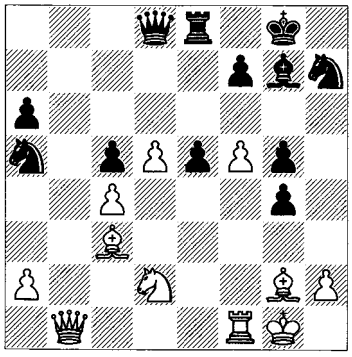
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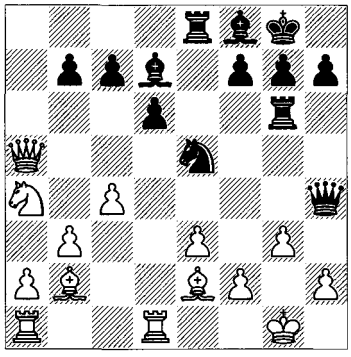
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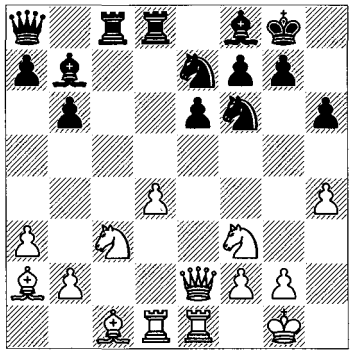
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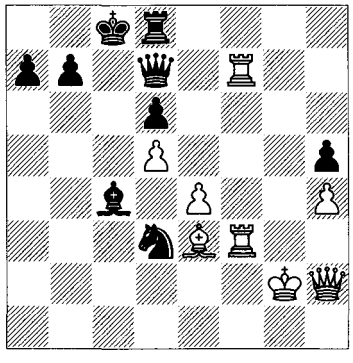
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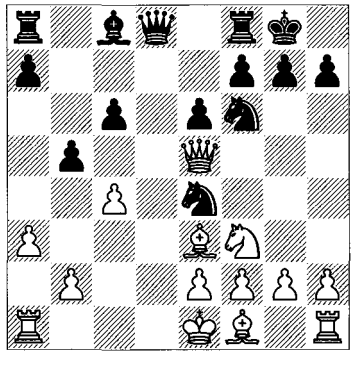
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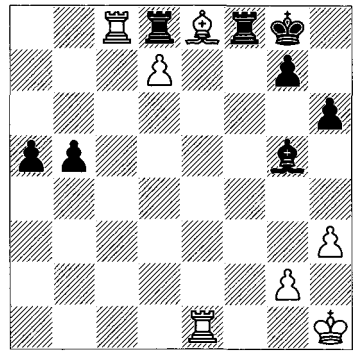
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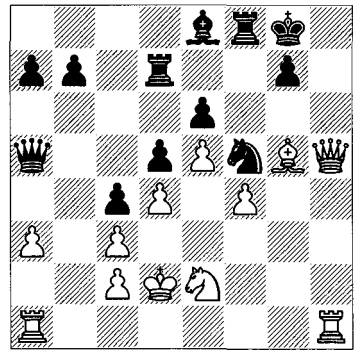
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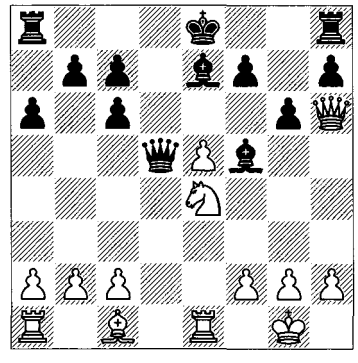
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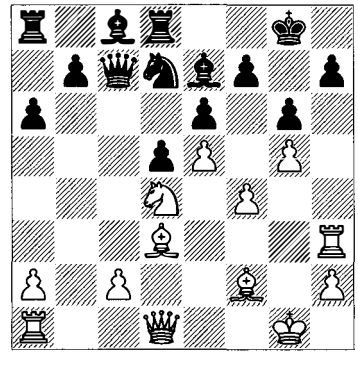
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903
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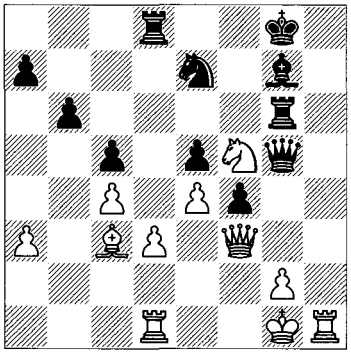


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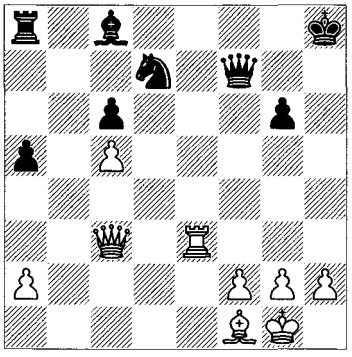


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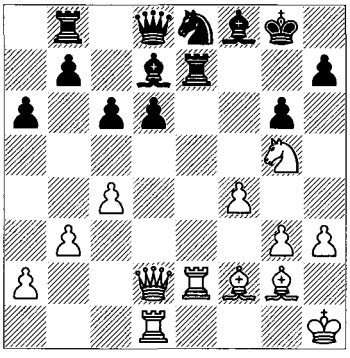
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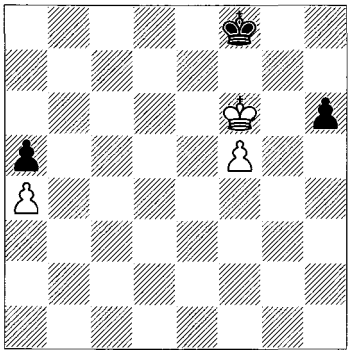
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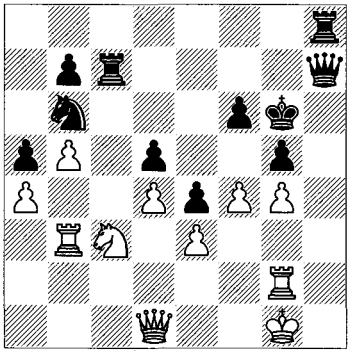
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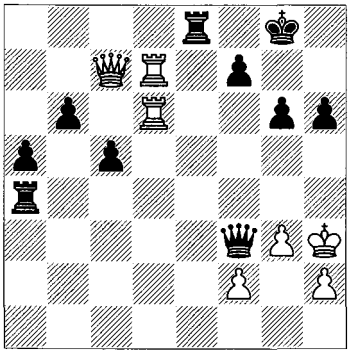
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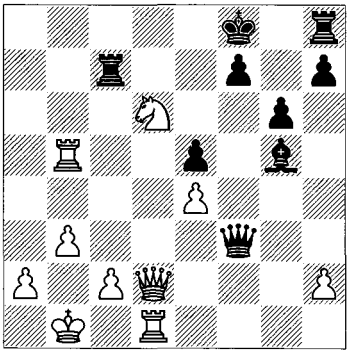
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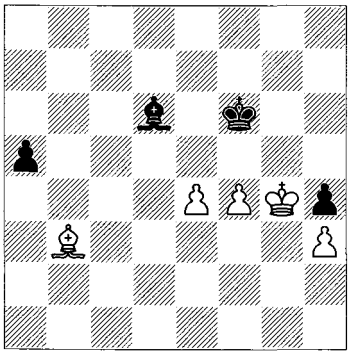
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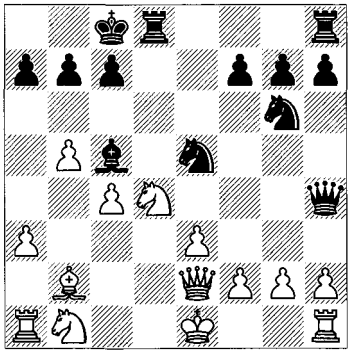
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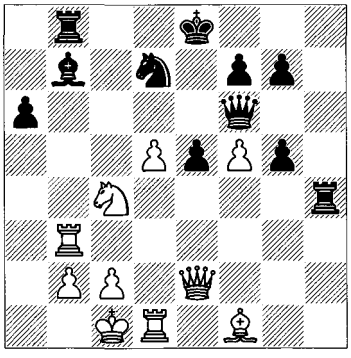
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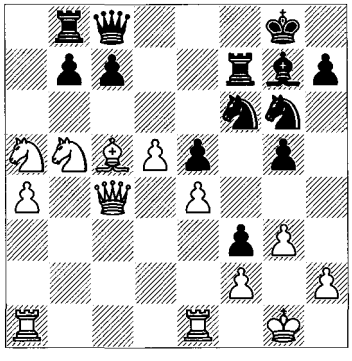
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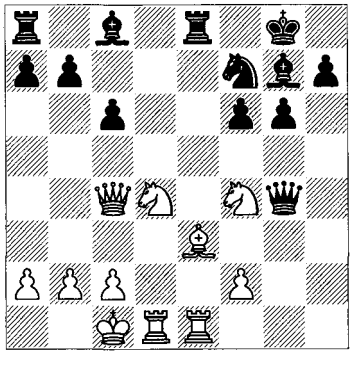
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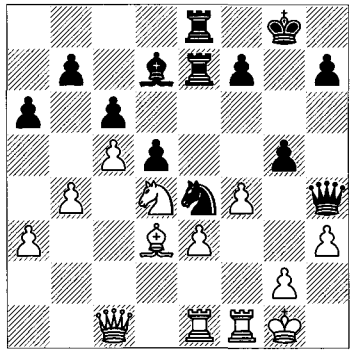
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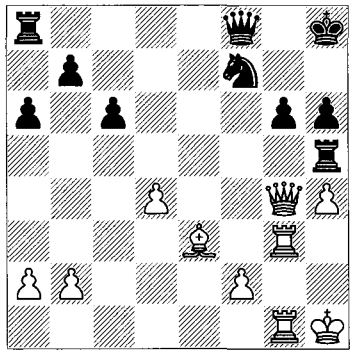
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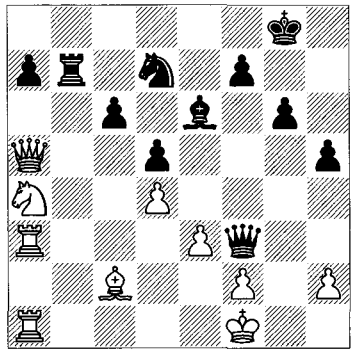
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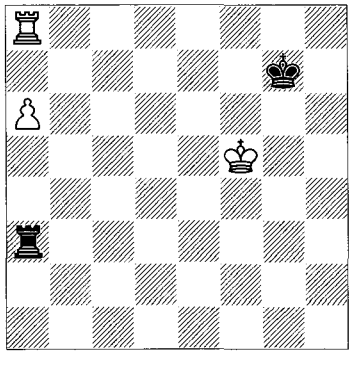
918
W



919
B



920
B



Answers for Chapter 10

Test 11 Answers

841) Najdorf – Szapiro
Lodz 1928

18 ♖xe6! ♖xe8 19 ♖xe8+ ♗e6 20 ♗xe6+ ♕xe6 21 ♖xf8# (1-0)
1 point for 18 ♖xe6!.

842) An. Rodriguez – Matsuura
Santos 2001

44 ♖xg7+! 1-0
The e2-rook is lost after 44...♔xg7 45 ♕g4+.
1 point for 44 ♖xg7+!.

843) Illescas – Bellón
Seville 1992

23 ♗e6!
Trapping the rook.
23...♘c8
Or 23...fxe6 24 fxe6 ♘c8 (24...♖dd8 25 ♗xd8 leaves the f8-rook overloaded) 25 exd7 ♘xb6 26 ♖xf6!.
24 ♗xd7 ♘xb6 25 fxg6 1-0
After 25...♘xd7 26 ♖xd6 Black is defenceless.
2 points for 23 ♗e6!.

844) Wahls – Vera
Capablanca Memorial, Cienfuegos 1996

22...♗xh2+!
22...♕h4? 23 ♖f2 leads to nothing concrete; after 23...♗g3 White gives up the exchange, with for instance 24 ♖e1, and gains more than adequate compensation.
23 ♕xh2
Worse is 23 ♔xh2 ♕h4+ 24 ♔g1 ♕g3+ and mate next move.
23...♕xe3+ 24 ♖f2
Or 24 ♕f2 ♕g5+ mating.
24...♖xh6 0-1
2 points for 22...♗xh2+!.

845) Anand – Illescas
Match (game 3), León 1997

38 e5!
This thematic break, clearing the e4-square, is winning.
38...dxe5
38...♕f5 39 ♕xf5 gxf5 40 exd6 is hopeless, because this pawn will cost Black a piece.
39 ♘e4 ♕f5 40 ♘g5+ ♔h6 41 ♕g8! ♘xf4+
Or 41...exf4 42 ♕h7+ ♔xg5 43 ♕xh4#.
42 gxf4 ♕c2+
If 42...exf4 then 43 ♘xf7+ and ♕h7+.
43 ♗f2 1-0
2 points for 38 e5!.

846) Ginzburg – Scalise
Vicente López 2000

42...♕f1+! 0-1
Mate is forced: 43 ♘xf1 ♖d1+ 44 ♔c2 ♖c1#.
2 points for 42...♕f1+!.

847) Schweber – Mecking
São Paulo 1966

Black is a pawn up but White has some of the typical trumps associated with an isolated queen's pawn, such as a strong knight on e5 and bishops aimed at Black's kingside, combined in this case with a half-open f-file. The b3-knight has strayed a dangerously long way and will become a tactical weakness.
22 ♘xf7!
The position is ripe for this sacrifice.
22...♔xf7 23 ♕h5+
A more precise move-order is 23 ♖xf6+! ♕xf6 24 ♖f1 ♕xf1+ 25 ♕xf1+ ♔g8 26 ♕f5 and White invades at h7 owing to the threat of 27 ♕e6+ and 28 ♕xb3.
23...♔f8 24 ♖xf6+! gxf6?
This creates new weaknesses which assist White's attack. The course of the game shows that it is essential to play 24...♕xf6 25 ♖f1 ♕xf1+ 26 ♗xf1, still with advantage to White.
25 ♕h6+! ♔e8 26 ♖e1+ ♔d7 27 ♕xh7+ ♔c6 28 a4!
Taking away the escape-square b5 and threatening 29 ♗e4+.
28...♖d7 29 ♗b5+ ♔c7 30 ♗xd7 ♖d8
If 30...♕xd7 then 31 ♖e7.
31 ♗e6+ ♔b8 32 ♗xb3
with a decisive advantage.
3 points for 22 ♘xf7!.

848) Morejón – Moreno Ruiz
Madrid 1998

20 ♗xd6!
Taking advantage of the tactical weakness arising from the positions of the black king and queen.
20...exd6 21 ♗xd5 ♕e7
21...cxd5 allows 22 ♘f6+, forking Black's king and queen.

22 ♗xc6 d5

Preventing the bishop from being cemented in place with 23 d5.

23 ♘c3 ♕d6

No better is 23...♖xc6 24 ♘xd5 ♕d8 25 ♕xc6 ♗b7 26 ♘f6+ ♔g7 27 ♕b5 ♕xf6 28 ♕xa5 with no less than a rook and four pawns for the two bishops.

24 ♗xd5 ♖xc3 25 ♗xf7+ ♔xf7 26 ♕xc3

with a decisive material advantage.

3 points for 20 ♗xd6!.

849) Vera – Sadvakasov

Saint Vincent 1999

29 ♘g6+! ♖xg6

White wins after 29...hxg6 30 ♕h4+ ♗h6 31 ♕xh6+ ♕h7 32 ♕xh7+ ♔xh7 33 ♘xf6+.

30 ♗xg6 ♗e5 31 ♖xe5!

This is an important move which wins for White, but in fact everything else loses.

31...♖xg6

31...dxe5 is met by 32 ♖f7.

32 ♖e8+ ♔g7 33 ♕f2 ♘f6 34 ♖e6 1-0

2 points for 29 ♘g6+! and 1 point for 31 ♖xe5!.

850) Franco – Safranska

Saint Vincent 2000

38...♘f5??

Black can draw with **38...♘xg4!** 39 ♘xh4 ♖h2+ 40 ♔gl ♖fg2+ 41 ♘xg2 ♖xg2+ 42 ♔h1 (not 42 ♔f1?? ♘h2#) 42...♖h2+.

39 ♘xh4 ♖h2+ 40 ♔g1 1-0

3 points for 38...♘xg4!.

851) Korneev – López Martínez

Elgóibar 2000

20 ♘e4!!

A beautiful way to leave Black's king stuck in the centre.

20...d4

20...dxe4 loses to 21 ♕xg5! ♗xg5 22 ♗h5+; no better is 20...♖g6 21 ♘xf6+ ♖xf6 22 ♖xf6 ♕xf6 23 ♕b6! and White wins.

21 ♘xf6+ ♕xf6 22 ♖xd4 ♕e5 23 ♕f2 ♖f5 24 ♗f3

Stranded in the centre, the black king can't survive with so many lines open.

24...♕f6 25 ♕e3 ♖c8 26 b3 ♗xf3 27 ♖xf3 ♔e7 28 ♕d3 ♖xf3 29 gxf3 ♔e8 30 ♖d6 ♕e5 31 f4 ♕e1+ 32 ♔b2 b4 33 ♖xa6 ♔f8 34 ♕d6+ ♔f7 35 ♕d7+ 1-0

3 points for 20 ♘e4!!.

852) Oddone – E. Peralta

Carlos Gamarra Memorial, Asunción 2009

1...♘xh2+?

This automatic move throws away the victory; it is curious that Black is better off leaving the h2-pawn on the board, since it deprives the white king of a vital escape-square in the winning line: **1...♕d1+!** 2 ♔g2 ♘e1+ 3 ♔f1 (not 3 ♔h3?? ♕h5#) 3...♘d3+ 4 ♔g2 f3+ 5 ♔h3 (5 ♖xf3 ♘e1+) 5...♘xf2+ 6 ♔h4 ♕d4+ 7 ♖f4 (7 ♕f4 loses to 7...g5+! 8 ♔xg5 ♘h3+) 7...g5+! 8 ♔xg5 and now, amongst other things, the simple 8...♘h3+ wins.

2 ♔g1 ♘f3+ 3 ♔f1 ♕d1+ 4 ♔g2 ♘e1+ 5 ♔f1 ♘c2+

and the game was later drawn; now 5...♘d3+ 6 ♔g2 f3+?? doesn't work, because White has 7 ♔h2!, winning.

3 points for 1...♕d1+!.

853) Radjabov – Shirov

Morelia/Linares 2008

21 b4!

Leaving Black's d5-rook without any flight-squares and thus threatening 22 ♗c4.

21...♖c8 22 a4!

The complement to the previous move, controlling b5; now there is no satisfactory defence against 23 ♗e4.

22...♖c3 23 ♔b2 f5 24 gxf5 ♖xd3 25 cxd3

and White won.

3 points for 21 b4! and 1 point for 22 a4!.

854) López Martínez – Narciso

Barcelona 2008

61...♘c6+!

After 61...♔xg5? 62 ♔xe5 the two white pawns win easily.

62 ♔c5 ♘e4+! 63 ♔xc6 ♘xc3!

Not 63...♔xg5? 64 b5, and White wins.

64 ♗h4

After 64 ♗xh5 ♔xg5 65 ♗f7 ♔f6 66 ♗d5 ♔e7 it's an easy draw.

64...♘xe2 65 ♗f2 ♔g4 66 ♔c5

66 b5 h4 67 b6 (or 67 ♗xh4 ♘d4+ and 68...♘xb5) 67...h3 68 b7 h2 69 b8♕ h1♕+ is also a draw.

66...h4 67 ♗xh4 ♔xh4 68 ♔c4

Or 68 b5 ♘c3 69 b6 ♘a4+.

68...♘f4 69 b5 ♘e6 70 b6 ♘d8 71 b7 ♘xb7 ½-½

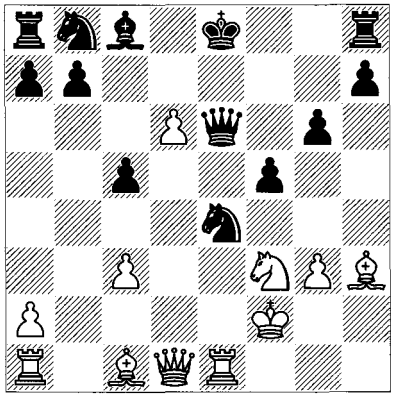
3 points for finding 61...♘c6+! and 1 point for 63...♘xc3!.

855) F. Peralta – Reinaldo
Barcelona 2008

16 ♖e1!

Can this really be a good idea? Forcing the move ...♘e4, with check?

16...♘e4+ *(D)*



17 ♖xe4!

This is the reason; the black queen will help the white pieces come into play and prevent the black king from finding a refuge.

17...♕xe4 18 ♘g5! ♕e5 19 ♗f4 ♕f6

19...♕xc3 loses to 20 ♕e2+ ♔d7 21 ♕e6+ ♔c6 22 d7+.

20 ♕d5 ♔f8 21 ♖e1

Absolutely all the white pieces are active, and the end is near.

21...h6

21...♘c6 loses to 22 d7 ♗xd7 23 ♕xd7 h6 24 ♖e6.

22 ♖e7! hxg5 23 ♗e5! ♗e6 24 ♖xe6 ♕f7 25 ♖f6 ♖h7 26 ♖xf7+ ♖xf7 27 ♗f1!

With this redeployment of the bishop, the game is over.

27...♘c6 28 ♗c4 ♘d8 29 ♗f6 1-0

4 points for 16 ♖e1! and 1 point for 17 ♖xe4!.

856) L. Domínguez – Stellwagen
Wijk aan Zee 2009

24...♕f3?

Black had to play **24...♕xh1!**, after which there is nothing decisive: after 25 c4 (25 ♕b6 ♖c7 achieves nothing, and 25 ♕xe7 ♕f3 26 ♗e2 ♕h1+ is a draw) 25...♘g6 26 ♕b6, the counterattack 26...♘h4! saves Black; e.g., 27 ♕a7+ ♔c7 28 ♗b6+ ♔c6 29 ♗xd8 ♕e4+ 30 ♔f2 ♕xf4+ 31 ♔g1 ♕g3+ 32 ♔h1 ♕f3+, with perpetual check.

25 ♕xb7+!

Now White's advantage is very clear; for the exchange he has three pawns which will soon begin to advance.

25...♕xb7 26 ♖xb7+ ♔xb7 27 ♗d3 ♘d5 28 ♗d2

and White won with good technique.

4 points for 24...♕xh1!, and 1 point extra if you saw 25 ♕xb7+!.

Test 12 Answers

857) Jodorcovsky – Ingolotti
Ciudad del Este 2003

11...d5! 0-1

12 ♗xd5 ♕c5+ and Black wins.

1 point for 11...d5!.

858) Estremera – Rogers
Gibraltar 2005

27 ♗xh7+!

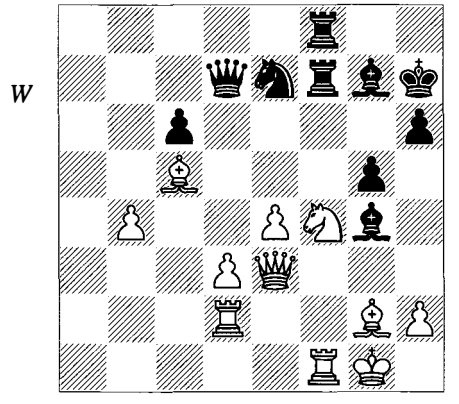
Saving an otherwise tricky position.

27...♔xh7 28 ♖h4+ ½-½

1 point for 27 ♗xh7+!.

859) Ramírez – Ju. Bolbochán
Villa Gesell 1970

27...g5! *(D)*



28 ♘h3

28 ♘e2 is similar.

28...♖xf1+ 29 ♗xf1 ♖f3 30 ♘xg5+

30 ♕e2 loses to 30...♗d4+ 31 ♗xd4 ♕xd4+ 32 ♘f2 ♖g3+.

30...hxg5 31 ♕e1

31 ♕xg5 ♗f6 is no better.

31...♗c3

Black wins.

2 points for 27...g5!.

860) García García – Guevara Pijuan
Badalona 2001

31 ♖e6!

31 ♘e6! is also good.

31...♗xe6 32 ♕g6+ ♗g7 33 ♘xe6 ♕d7 34 ♘h5

And the g7-bishop is lost, with a winning position for White.

34...♖b7

The strongest reply to 34...♕f7 is 35 ♕xg4.

35 ♘hxg7 ♖f7 36 ♘h5+ 1-0

2 points for 31 ♖e6! or 31 ♘e6!.

861) Almeida – Zarnicki
Capablanca Memorial, Havana 2002

20 ♘f5! ♗f8

20...exf5? loses to 21 ♘d5.

21 ♘xd6 ♗xd6 22 ♖xd6 bxc4 23 bxc4 ♘hf6

Not 23...♕xc4? 24 ♖xd7 ♖xd7 25 ♖xd7 ♕xc3? 26 ♖d8+!.

24 ♖6d4

with an extra pawn.

2 points for 20 ♘f5!.

862) Rustemov – Vera
Spanish Team Ch, Mondariz 2002

14...♘fg4!

An unexpectedly strong blow; there is no satisfactory defence against Black's threat of 15...♘xf3+.

15 ♗f4

The lesser of the evils, acquiescing to the deterioration of his king's defensive position and the loss of a pawn.

15...♘xf3+ 16 gxf3 ♕xf4 17 fxg4 ♕xg4+

with an extra pawn, for which White has no compensation.

2 points for 14...♘fg4!.

863) Bronstein – Foguelman
Mar del Plata 1960

34 a4!

Decisively weakening the c4-pawn; 34 ♘xa5 ♔e6 35 ♘c6 ♔d5 36 ♘a7 b4 37 ♘b5 ♗e5 is less clear.

34...♗c7?!

This loses, although after 34...bxa4 35 ♘xa5 ♗c7 36 ♘xc4 g4 37 ♘d2, followed by ♔d3, Black's position is untenable.

35 axb5

Now White has a passed pawn.

35...♔e6 36 g4!

Creating another passed pawn, as well as fixing a black pawn on a dark square, i.e. the g5-pawn.

36...fxg4 37 hxg4 a4 38 ♔f3 ♔d5 39 e4+ ♔d6 40 e5+ ♔d5 41 ♔e3 h6

Or 41...♗xe5 42 ♘xe5 ♔xe5 43 b6 ♔d6 44 ♔e4 ♔c6 45 ♔f5 and White wins.

42 f4 gxf4+ 43 ♔xf4 ♔e6 44 ♔g3 1-0

Heading for h5, and if Black defends the h6-pawn with his king he will be unable to stop both passed pawns, while if 44...♗xe5+ 45 ♘xe5 ♔xe5 46 ♔h4 White wins the pawn ending.

3 points for 34 a4!.

864) Franco – Adad
Buenos Aires 1973

The game went **11 ♕g5?! ♘e7** and White was only slightly better.

11 ♖xe6+! is very strong; after 11...♘e7 White brings his other rook into the game with 12 ♗h6! axb5 (not 12...gxh6? 13 ♖xe7+! ♔xe7 14 ♖e1+ mating) 13 ♖xe7+! ♔xe7 14 ♖e1+ ♔d8 (not 14...♔d6? 15 ♕f3, nor 14...♔f8 15 ♗xg7+ ♔xg7 16 ♕g5+ ♔f8 17 ♕h6+ ♔g8 18 ♖e8#) and now there is a wide choice: 15 ♗xg7, 15 ♕g5+ f6 16 ♕xg7 or 15 ♕xf7 ♕c6 16 ♗xg7 ♔c7 17 ♗xh8, in all cases regaining the rook with an attack and some extra pawns.

3 points for 11 ♖xe6+!. Only 1 point for 11 ♕g5?!.

865) Stefansson – Bruzón
Capablanca Memorial, Havana 2001

21 ♗e4!

An essential preparatory move, defending g2.

21...♕c8 22 ♕xh5! 1-0

2 points for 21 ♗e4! and 1 point for 22 ♕xh5!.

866) Pablo – Franco
Spanish Team Ch, Mondariz 2002

24...♘xd3!

Not 24...♗f8? 25 ♖h4 h5 26 ♖xh5!, mating quickly.

25 cxd3

25 fxg7 ♘xf4 26 ♘xf4 ♘e5 leaves White with no compensation.

25...♖xe2! 26 fxg7 ♘e5!

Not 26...♕c6? 27 ♕xh7+! mating.

27 ♗xe5

No better is 27 ♕f1 ♕c2 28 ♘a5 ♗d5 and White's position is riddled with holes on both

wings; Black threatens 29...♖xh2, and after 29 ♖f2 ♖xf2 30 ♗xf2 ♕xb2 there is no defence.

27...dxe5 28 ♖c4 ♕b6+ 0-1

2 points for finding 24...♘xd3! and 1 point for 25...♖xe2!.

867) Estremera – Barberi

Cesenatico 2005

18 ♗xg6+!

Now the black king is forced to take a walk.

18...♔xe6

If 18...♔xg6 Black is mated after 19 ♕d3+ ♔f7 20 ♘g5+ ♔e8 21 ♕g6+ ♔d8 22 ♘e6+ ♔c8 23 ♕e8+.

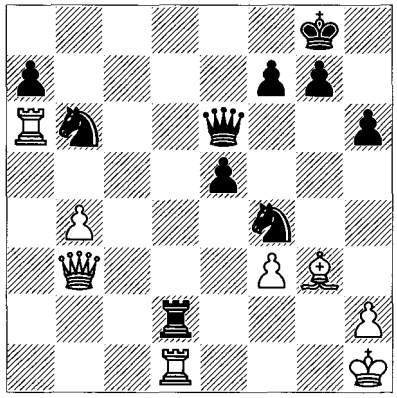
19 d5+ cxd5 20 ♗xb6 1-0

3 points for 18 ♗xg6+!.

868) Lazarev – Estremera

Villa San Giovanni 2005

32...♕e6! *(D)*



Thanks to the overload on the white queen, Black is able to centralize his own queen.

33 ♕b1 ♕d5! 34 ♖f1

34 ♖xd2? allows mate in two by 34...♕xf3+.

34...♕c4

And Black won, but 34...♘d3! is more precise; e.g., 35 ♖a5 ♕d7! (threatening 36...♕h3 37 ♖g1 ♖xh2+! 38 ♗xh2 ♘f2#) 36 ♖a2 ♘c4 37 ♗e1 ♘xe1 38 ♖xe1 ♕h3 39 ♖xd2 ♘xd2 40 ♕d1 ♘xf3 41 ♖e2 e4, with a winning position.

2 points for finding 32...♕e6! and 1 point for 33...♕d5!.

869) Motylev – Ding Liren

Chinese Team Ch, Wuxi 2008

37 ♖xd5!

The start of a simplification that leads to a winning pawn ending.

37...♕xd5 38 ♕xd5! exd5 39 ♖xf4 gxf4 40 g3!

Now White can't be prevented from creating two well-spaced passed pawns on the h- and c-files and, since he can stop Black's passed pawns, White wins.

40...fxg3 41 fxg3 hxg3 42 ♔g2 d4 43 ♔xg3 ♔e6 44 h4 ♔f5

Or 44...f5 45 ♔f4 ♔f6 (45...d3 46 ♔e3 is no help) 46 a4.

45 ♔f3 d3 46 a4 1-0

2 points for 37 ♖xd5!. Additionally, 1 point for 38 ♕xd5! and 1 point for 40 g3!.

870) A. David – Danielian

Kavala 2008

31 ♗xh6!

Black's king's position comes under heavy fire; White's pieces are able to reach the kingside very quickly.

31...f5

31...gxh6? 32 ♘f6 ♕a5 33 ♕e4 leads to mate.

32 ♗xg7+!

The culmination of White's idea.

32...♗xg7

Or 32...♔xg7 33 ♘f6 ♕a5?! 34 ♕h5, mating quickly.

33 ♕h5+ ♔g8 34 ♘g5 ♘a5

34...♖d7 is met by 35 ♕e8+ ♗f8 36 ♘xe6 ♖f7 37 ♘xf8 ♖xf8 38 ♕g6+ ♔h8 39 ♖xc6, followed by 40 ♕h6+ and 41 ♖g6+.

35 ♕h7+ ♔f8 36 ♕g6 ♔g8 37 ♕h7+ ♔f8 38 ♖c5 ♕d7 39 ♕g6 ♔g8 40 ♕h7+ ♔f8 41 ♕g6 ♔g8 42 ♘xe6 ♕e8 43 ♕xf5

With four pawns for the piece and a decisive initiative.

43...♖d5 44 ♖d3 ♖f7 45 ♕g4 ♕d7 46 ♖xd5 cxd5 47 f4 ♘c4 48 f5 ♘xb2 49 ♖xb3 ♕xa4 50 ♘c5 ♕a1+ 51 ♔h2 ♘a4 52 ♘e6 ♕e1 53 f6 ♕e4 54 ♘xg7 ♕xg4 55 hxg4 1-0

3 points for 31 ♗xh6! and 1 point for 32 ♗xg7+!.

871) Solodovnichenko – Efanov

Nezhmetdinov Memorial, Kazan 2008

46...♗g5?

There is only one, spectacular, winning sequence for Black: **46...f4!** 47 ♖xe6 (47 ♖xe2 f3 48 ♖f2 ♗g5+ 49 ♔d3 ♗xh6, followed by ...♗g5-h4, is simpler) 47...♗g5! 48 h7 (or 48 ♔xe2 f3+ 49 ♔f2 ♗h4+ 50 ♔g1 ♗h3! and Black wins) 48...f3+ 49 ♔d3 (if 49 ♔e1 then 49...♗h4+ 50 ♔d2 f2 wins) 49...e1♕!! (the

only move to win) 50 ♖xe1 f2 51 ♖d1 f1♕+ 52 ♖xf1 ♗xf1+ 53 ♔e4 ♗f6 54 ♔f5 ♗c3 55 ♔g6 ♗c4, and all White's pawns will fall.

47 ♔xe2 ♗xh6

Not 47...♗xe3? 48 ♔xe3 and the h-pawn queens.

48 ♖xe6 ♗c1 49 c4 ♗a3 50 ♖f6 ♗e4 51 ♔e3 ♗c5+ 52 ♔f4 ♗b4 ½-½

4 points for 46...f4! and 1 point for 47...♗g5!.

872) Short – Kariakin

Rapid match (game 4), Kiev 2008

25 ♕d2!

Heading for h6; **25 ♕e3!** is just as good, with the same idea.

25...♖c4

To eliminate White's powerful bishop; if it remains on the board the strength of White's idea can be seen after 25...♗c4 26 ♕h6 f6 27 ♘e6 (27 ♘g5 and 27 ♖xg6 also win) 27...♗xe6 28 ♖xg6+! hxg6 29 ♕xg6+ ♔h8 30 ♖g1 ♖f7 31 ♘xf6!!, a lovely sacrifice that breaks the coordination of Black's defence. All three of the black pieces that can take the knight are overloaded and meanwhile White threatens 32 ♕g8+; if 31...♘xf6, then 32 ♕h6+ ♖h7 33 ♗xf6+ ♗xf6 34 ♕xf6+ ♖g7 35 ♕xg7#.

26 ♕h6 ♖xd4 27 ♘xe6! fxe6

Or 27...♕e5 28 ♘xf8 ♗xf8 29 cxd4.

28 ♖xg6+! ♔f7

28...hxg6 allows mate after 29 ♕xg6+ ♔h8 30 ♖g1.

29 ♖g7+ ♔e8 30 ♕xe6 ♔d8 31 ♕xe7+ ♔c7 32 ♕xf8 1-0

4 points for 25 ♕d2! or 25 ♕e3!. 1 point extra for 28 ♖xg6+!.

Test 13 Answers

873) Illescas – López Martínez

Spanish Ch, Lorca 2005

22 ♖e7! 1-0

There is no satisfactory way to defend f7 and the black queen is overloaded; if 22...♕xe7, then 23 d8♕+.

1 point for 22 ♖e7!.

874) Shirov – Landa

Bundesliga 2008/9

31 ♕xc5! 1-0

31...♖xc5 32 ♖xg7+ ♔f8 (or 32...♔h8 33 ♘f7+) 33 ♘d7+ ♕xd7 34 ♖xd7 ♖5c7 35 ♖gg7.

1 point for 31 ♕xc5!.

875) Cámpora – Cifuentes

Calvia Olympiad 2004

25 ♗b8!

This powerful incarceration of the rook is possible thanks to the exposure of Black's king; **25 ♕b7+** ♔g6 26 ♗b8! is also good.

25...♔g6

If 25...♖xb8 then 26 ♕xa7+ wins.

26 ♕b7 ♕e4 27 ♖c1 1-0

2 points for 25 ♗b8!. Also 2 points if you chose the move-order 25 ♕b7+ and 26 ♗b8!.

876) Estremera – Gutiérrez Jiménez

Seville 2005

29 f6!

The weakness of Black's king's position is made more serious by the fact that some of his pieces are a long way away on the queenside.

29...♗xb5

29...g6 fails to solve the problem; White can put pressure on Black's king with 30 ♘e7+ ♔h7 31 ♗d5!, when 31...♗xb5? loses to 32 ♗xf7!.

30 cxb5 ♖a8 31 ♘e7+ ♔h8 32 fxg7+ ♔xg7 33 ♘f5+

This strong knight and the fact that its black counterpart is out of play on a5 are the decisive factors in the position; White wins easily.

33...♔h8 34 ♕c3+ f6 35 ♖d1 ♕e8 36 ♖xd6 ♕e5 37 ♕xe5 fxe5 38 ♖xh6+ 1-0

38...♔g8 is met by 39 ♗d5+.

2 points for 29 f6!.

877) Vallejo – Leitão

FIDE World Cup, Khanty-Mansiisk 2005

33 ♕f7+!

It is curious that the exchange of queens opens the way for a mating attack.

33...♕xf7 34 gxf7+ ♔xf7 35 ♖xg7+ ♔f8 36 ♘e6+ 1-0

White wins easily after 36...♖xe6 37 ♖xd8+ ♖e8 38 ♖xe8+ ♔xe8 39 ♖g6.

2 points for 33 ♕f7+!.

878) S. Weiss – Wilms

Hamburg 2007

15 ♖g1!

After protecting g3, White is threatening to win Black's trapped knight with f3.

15...♖e8?!

It is better to seek complications with 15...b5.

16 f3 ♗xg5 17 hxg5 ♘xg5 18 ♘h5

with an advantage; 18 e4! was even better.

2 points for 15 ♖g1!.

879) Kožul – Elianov
Sarajevo 2005

29...♖a1+!

This time the white king is the one 'taken out for a walk' and will be unable to defend itself; 29...♕g5 30 ♘d2 ♗d6 is also good, but less energetic.

30 ♗xa1 ♖xa1+ 31 ♔f2 ♕f6 32 ♘e3 ♗h2+ 33 ♘f5 ♘xf5

and wins, although 33...♗g1+ 34 ♔g3 ♕g5# is quicker.

3 points for 29...♖a1+!. 1 point for 29...♕g5.

880) Bruzón – Anand
Match (game 5), León 2006

25 ♖xe6!

White unleashes a fierce attack; **25 ♖f6+** ♔e7 26 ♖xe6+! is also good.

25...♔xe6 26 ♕xf5+ ♔e7 27 ♕f7+ ♔d8 28 e6! 1-0

3 points for 25 ♖xe6! and 3 points for 25 ♖f6+ and 26 ♖xe6+!.

881) E. Chevelevitch – Putzbach
Hamburg 2007

32 ♗d4!

With the threat of 33 ♕g8+ ♕xg8 34 ♖xg8+ ♔xg8 35 f7#.

32...h6 33 ♕f4 ♖e5

Not 33...dxe4? 34 ♖g7!, which leads to a quick mate.

34 exd5 ♗xd5 35 ♗xe5

With a big advantage; even better was 35 ♘xd5! ♕xd5 36 f7 ♔h7 37 ♗xe5 ♕xe5 38 ♕xe5 dxe5 39 ♖g8.

3 points for 32 ♗d4!.

882) Landa – Wendt
Hamburg 2007

24...♗d4?

Missing the direct **24...♘xf2!**; e.g., 25 ♕xf2 (25 ♔xf2 ♗xh3+ 26 ♔g1 transposes, while 25 ♘e8 ♘xh3+ 26 ♔h2 ♘g5 is also better for Black, who has more than enough compensation for the exchange in the form of his advanced pawns and the weak white king) 25...♗xh3 26 ♕g3 d2 27 ♕xh3 dxe1♕+ 28 ♖xe1 ♕c5+, and Black wins.

25 hxg4

Now it is White who has the advantage.

25...♗xg4 26 ♖e8! ♗xf2+ 27 ♕xf2 ♕xe8 28 ♘xe8 1-0

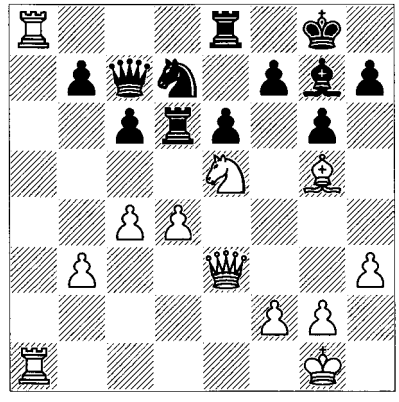
3 points for 24...♘xf2!.

883) Ardeleanu – Halasi
Senta 2007

27 ♖a8! *(D)*

The way to exploit the bad placing of the black rook on d6 is to open another front; if White can exchange Black's other rook and then occupy the eighth rank, there will be no defence. Not immediately 27 ♗f4?! on account of 27...♘xe5, and White has nothing.

B



27...♘b8

27...♖f8 is answered by 28 ♗e7, while after 27...♖b8 28 ♘xd7 ♖xd7, now 29 ♗f4 *is* good; in both cases White wins.

28 ♗f4

'The threat is stronger than its execution'; 28 ♘f3! is more precise, threatening 29 ♗f4.

28...♕d8?!

28...♖dd8 is better.

29 ♘f3 e5 30 dxe5 1-0

3 points for 27 ♖a8!.

884) M. Zelić – Martinović
Cvitanović Memorial, Split 2007

Black is so far behind in development that his extra piece is no help to his king.

16 ♗a7!

Forcing the rook to a worse square.

16...♖a8 17 ♕d5! ♘c6 18 ♖xc6! ♗b7 19 ♕f7+ ♔d8 20 ♗b6+ 1-0

2 points for 16 ♗a7! and 1 point for 17 ♕d5!.

885) M. Socko – Dziuba
Najdorf Memorial, Warsaw 2008

89 g4+!

Before promoting the b-pawn, White must attend to the defence of his king; this is the first step.

89...fxg4

The task is easier after 89...♔xg4? 90 ♕g3+.

90 ♕c5+?

After this it's a draw; the correct way is **90 ♕h2+!** ♔g5 91 b8♕! and there is no perpetual after 91...♕xf2+ 92 ♔h1 ♕f1+ 93 ♕g1 ♕h3+ (93...♕f3+ 94 ♕g2 ♕d1+ 95 ♔h2 is similar) 94 ♕bh2 ♕f3+ 95 ♕hg2.

90...♔h4 91 ♕e7+ ♔h5 92 ♕f7+ ♔h4 93 ♕e7+ ♔h5 94 ♕e8+ ♔h4 95 ♕d8+ ♔h5 96 ♕e8+ ♔h4 97 ♕e7+ ½-½

2 points for 89 g4+! and 2 points for 90 ♕h2+!.

886) D. Howell – Pruijssers

World Junior Ch, Gaziantep 2008

31 ♗xh6!

The c2-bishop is attacked, but White sacrifices his other bishop, and we'll have yet another demolition of the king's position, thanks, basically, to the numerical superiority of the attacking forces.

31...♖xc2

31...gxh6 32 ♕xh6 leads to mate.

32 ♗xg7!

Open lines!

32...f5

32...♔xg7 is met by 33 ♖g3+.

33 ♗h6 ♖c4

If 33...f4, to prevent 34 ♖g3+, then 34 ♕g6+ ♔h8 35 ♗g5!.

34 ♖g3+ ♖g4 35 ♖xg4+ fxg4 36 ♕g6+ ♔h8 37 ♗g5 1-0

3 points for 31 ♗xh6! and 1 point for 32 ♗xg7!.

887) Zhigalko – Siugirov

World Junior Ch, Gaziantep 2008

22 ♕d5! ♕xc1+

22...♗g7 is strongly met by 23 ♘d6+! (the only way to destroy the black king's defences; instead, 23 ♕xe6? ♕xc1+ 24 ♔h2 ♕xd2 yields no more than a draw) 23...exd6 24 ♕xe6+ ♔d8 25 ♕xd6+ ♔c8 26 ♕xc5+ ♔d7 27 ♗c6+ ♔e6 28 ♗d5+ ♔f6. Here the strongest move is 29 h4!, to deprive the black king of the g5-square. After 29...♕xc1+ 30 ♔h2, even with an extra rook there is no satisfactory defence against the threat of 31 ♕d6+ ♔f5 32 ♕e6+ and 33 g3#; e.g., 30...♗f8 31 ♕b6+ ♔g7 32 ♕a7+ ♔h6 (or 32...♗e7 33 ♕xe7+ ♔h6 34 ♕g5+ ♔g7 35 ♕xe5+ ♔h6 36 ♕xh8) 33 ♕e3+ ♔g7 34 ♕xe5+ ♔h6 35 ♕f4+ ♔g7 36 h5! mating quickly.

23 ♔h2 ♗h6

If 23...♕xb2 then 24 ♕xe6 ♕xb5 25 ♗c6+ with a decisive material advantage.

24 ♘d6+! exd6 25 ♕xe6+ ♔d8 26 ♗c6 ♗f4+ 27 g3 ♗xg3+ 28 ♔g2! 1-0

4 points for 22 ♕d5! and 1 point for 23 ♘d6+! in the line with 22...♗g7.

888) Krapivin – V. Popov

Vladimir 2008

23 ♘g5!!

A piece down, White must make haste with his attack.

23...♗xe4

23...fxg5 allows mate after 24 ♕e6+ ♔h8 25 ♖f7!.

24 ♕xf6 ♕d2

24...♖f8 is met by 25 ♕e6+ ♔h8 26 ♖xf8+ ♖xf8 27 ♕xe7 ♖f2 (if 27...♖a8 or 27...♕a8 then 28 ♘e6 with a quick mate) 28 ♕e5+ ♔g8 29 ♘xe4.

25 ♕e6+ ♔h8 26 ♘f7+! ♔g7

26...♔g8? 27 ♘h6++ ♔g7 28 ♕f6#.

27 ♕f6+ ♔f8 28 ♕h8+ ♘g8 29 ♘e5+ 1-0

After 29...♔e7 30 ♕g7+ White mates next move.

4 points for 23 ♘g5!! and 1 point for calculating 25 ♖f7! in the line with 23...fxg5.

Test 14 Answers

889) Morozevich – Smeets

Wijk aan Zee 2009

49 ♗xd5+! 1-0

After 49...♔xd5 50 e4+ White wins easily.

1 point for 49 ♗xd5+!.

890) de la Puerta – Paunović

Seville 2009

21...♖xc2! 22 ♕xc2?

This loses on the spot, although 22 ♕e3 ♗xf3+ 23 ♕xf3 ♖xb2 was not encouraging either.

22...♕xf3+ 0-1

If 23 ♔g1 then 23...♗h3 and mate next move.

1 point for 21...♖xc2!.

891) S. Weiss – P. Wiese

Hamburg 2007

43...b6!

Demonstrating that White is over-extended; the b4-pawn will be lost.

44 ♕c4?

It is necessary to accept the loss of the pawn with 44 ♗f2 ♘xb4, with advantage to Black; if 44 ♗d6 then 44...♕e6 and the bishop is trapped.

44...bxc5

White has insufficient compensation for the piece.

2 points for 43...b6!.

892) Kokol – Martinović

Nova Gorica 2007

32...♗a4!

Driving away the rook from the defence of d4.

33 ♖de1

33 ♖dd3 allows a winning attack: 33...♕c1+ 34 ♔f2 ♖c2+ 35 ♔g3 ♕g1 36 ♔h3 ♗d7+.

33...♕xd4 34 ♔h1 ♕f6!

Now there will be no escape for the white knight.

35 ♕g3 ♔g7 36 ♘xf7 ♕xf7 37 ♖e6 ♗c2

and Black won.

2 points for 32...♗a4!.

893) Rodríguez Vila – Soto

Callao 2007

24 ♖g6! 1-0

A knockout blow; if 24...fxg6 then 25 ♖xh6+ gxh6 26 ♕xh6#.

2 points for 24 ♖g6!.

894) Carlsen – Kamsky

Tal Memorial (blitz), Moscow 2008

87...♖g8!

There is still time to counterattack against h3.

88 c6 ♖g3! 89 ♖xg3+ hxg3 90 ♔b7 ♔h2 91 c7 g2 92 c8♕ g1♕ 93 h4 ♕b1+ 94 ♔c7 ♕h7+ ½-½

2 points for 87...♖g8!.

895) Ljubičić – M. Zelić

Cvitanović Memorial, Split 2007

23 ♕xd4!

White establishes overwhelming domination by giving up his queen for a reasonable amount of material: at least a rook, a minor piece and several pawns, one of them passed.

23...♗xd4 24 ♗xd4+ e5

If 24...♖g7 then 25 ♖xe7.

25 fxe5 ♖g7

After 25...dxe5 26 ♖xe5 ♕g7 27 ♗c3, the discovery by the e5-rook is decisive.

26 e6 ♕b7 27 cxb5 ♗e8

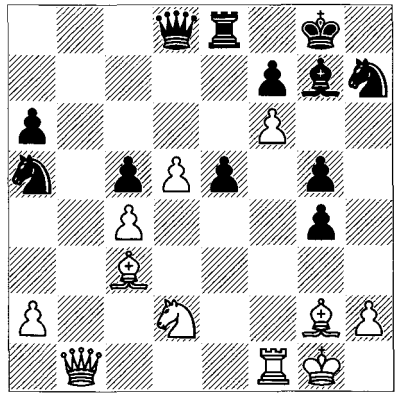
And now defending the f3-bishop with 28 ♔g2, followed by moving the knight somewhere, is devastating.

3 points for 23 ♕xd4!.

896) Dizdar – Van der Weide

Seville 2007

25 f6! *(D)*



B

With this elegant sacrifice White opens the f-file and the b1-h7 diagonal, which will have a decisive effect owing to the weaknesses in Black's kingside, the bad a5-knight and the overloaded black queen.

25...♘xf6

25...♗xf6 is met by 26 ♕f5 followed by 27 ♗e4; and the same after 25...♗h8 26 ♕f5.

26 ♕f5! ♘b7

This loses a piece, but there is no defence; if 26...♖f8, defending f7 so that the f6-knight can move, then 27 ♗xe5 ♘d7 28 ♗e4 mates quickly.

27 ♘e4 ♘d6 28 ♘xf6+ ♗xf6 29 ♕xf6 ♕xf6 30 ♖xf6 ♘xc4 31 ♖c6 1-0

3 points for 25 f6!.

897) Salgado – Huerga

San Sebastián 2008

18 ♗xe5!

This dangerous enemy has to be eliminated right away. Instead, 18 ♕xc7? ♗c6 19 ♗xe5? loses to 19...♕xh2+!.

18...♖xe5 19 ♕xc7 ♗c6 20 ♖d4!

A key move, preventing both 20...♕e4 and the threatened mate with 20...♕xh2+ 21 ♔xh2 ♖h6+, which can now be answered with 22 ♖h4.

20...♖e4 21 ♗d3 ♖xg3+?

21...♖xd4 22 ♗xg6 doesn't help a great deal.

22 fxg3!

Winning quickly, but not 22 hxg3?? ♕h1+! 23 ♔xh1 ♖h4++ 24 ♔g1 ♖h1#.

2 points for 18 ♗xe5! and 1 point for 20 ♖d4!.

898) Bruzón – Iturrizaga

Linares 2008

23 ♘e5!

With this strong unpinning move, the black queen is shown to be too far from the centre, for no good reason.

23...♗xg2?!

It is not easy to find a satisfactory defence. White's attack relies on several 'only moves', but they win the game; if 23...♘ed5 then 24 ♘xf7!.

24 ♘xf7! ♗h3

Defending e6 and threatening mate, so the f7-knight is lost. However, a surprise awaits Black.

25 ♘xh6+! ♔h8

25...gxh6 loses to 26 ♗xe6+ ♗xe6 27 ♕xe6+ ♔g7 28 ♗xh6+! ♔xh6 (no better is 28...♔g6 29 ♗xf8 ♖xf8 30 ♕xe7) 29 ♕xf6+ ♘g6 (or 29...♔h7 30 ♘e4) 30 ♖e6.

26 ♘f7+ ♔g8 27 ♘e4!

Once again this is the only move to win.

27...♘xe4

Or 27...♕xe4 28 ♕xe4 ♘xe4 29 ♘xd8.

28 ♘xd8

Now it is Black to move and he has several possible discoveries by his e4-knight to renew the threat of mate on g2, but none of them are any use.

28...♘c5

28...♘f6 loses to 29 ♗xe6+, while 28...♘g5 is refuted by 29 d5! ♘xd5 and now, amongst other things, 30 ♖xd5.

29 f3

Exploiting the fact that the c5-knight is attacked, White gains a decisive material advantage.

29...♖xd8 30 dxc5 ♘d5 31 ♗b1 ♕b8 32 ♕h2 ♗xc5+ 33 ♔h1 1-0

3 points for 23 ♘e5!.

899) García Castro – Franco

Monforte de Lemos 2008

31...♘e1+?!

Now Black regains the exchange with gain of tempo, but this is insufficient to win. It is more promising to play for the initiative by **31...♕g4+!** 32 ♕g3 ♕xe4 33 ♔h2 ♘e5 (or 33...♗xd5!?) 34 ♖3f4 ♕c2+ 35 ♖f2 ♕b1, or 35...♕d1, with two pawns for the exchange already, plus the initiative.

32 ♔h1 ♘xf3 33 ♖xd7 ♘xh2 34 ♖xd8+ ♔xd8 35 ♔xh2 b6 36 ♔g3 ♔c7 37 ♔f4 a5 38 ♗d2 ♗e2 39 ♔e3 ♗f1 40 ♔d4 ♔b7 41 ♗e1 ♗h3 ½-½

Supporting the connected passed pawns with 41...♔a6 doesn't create any winning chances, since White plays 42 ♗g3.

3 points for 31...♕g4+!.

900) Morozevich – Ponomariov

Tal Memorial, Moscow 2008

12 g4!!

A brilliant move that decides the game; Black has no satisfactory defence to the threat of 13 g5.

12...c5

12...♕d6 loses to 13 g5 ♕xe5 14 ♘xe5 ♘d7 (or 14...♘e8 15 ♗g2 f5 16 cxb5 cxb5 17 ♗c5!) 15 ♘xd7 ♗xd7 16 ♖d1 ♖fd8 17 f3, trapping the knight. 12...♘d6 is powerfully met by 13 0-0-0!, while if 12...h6 then 13 h4 is logical.

13 g5 ♕a5+ 14 b4! cxb4 15 gxf6

Black could resign here with a clear conscience; he is a piece down and has problems with his king.

15...♗b7

If 15...bxa3+ then White can play 16 ♗d2 ♘xd2 17 ♘xd2 ♖d8 18 ♕g5 g6 19 ♗g2 ♖b8 20 ♕h6, winning more material.

16 ♗d2 1-0

3 points for 12 g4!!.

901) Topalov – Ivanchuk

Bilbao 2008

41 g3!

The only defender of the d8-rook will have no safe square, and the game will be over.

41...a4 42 h4 ♗f6 43 ♖e6! 1-0

There is no defence against 44 ♖xf6.

3 points for 41 g3! and 1 point for 43 ♖e6!.

902) Bacrot – B. Socko

Dresden Olympiad 2008

27 ♕h7+!

There are several tempting continuations, but this is the clearest move-order; the king will be worse on f7.

27...♔f7 28 ♖h6!

With the threat of 29 ♖f6+; 28 ♖ag1, bringing another piece across, is good but less convincing.

28...♘xh6 29 ♗xh6 ♖g8 30 f5!

Opening the f-file is decisive.

30...♔f8

Or 30...♕b6 31 ♖f1!, winning.

31 fxe6 1-0

2 points for 27 ♕h7+! and 2 points for 28 ♖h6!.

903) L. Vajda – Ki. Georgiev

Montenegro Team Ch, Herceg Novi 2008

16 ♗g5!!

This is far more than just an offer to exchange pieces; it contains a beautiful idea. Instead, 16 ♘f6+? ♗xf6 17 exf6+ ♗e6, with the idea of 18...0-0-0, gives White no advantage.

16...♗xg5?!

Better, but still unsatisfactory, is 16...♗xe4 17 ♗xe7 ♔xe7 18 ♕h4+ ♔f8 (worse is 18...g5 19 ♕xg5+! ♔f8 20 ♖ad1; e.g., 20...♕c4 21 ♖d8+ ♖xd8 22 ♕xd8+ ♔g7 23 ♕f6+ ♔g8 24 ♖d1 ♗d5 25 ♖d3) 19 ♖xe4 and Black can't connect his rooks, while his king continues to disrupt his game.

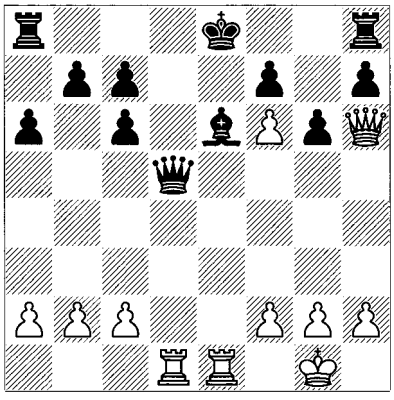
17 ♘f6+!!

It is understandable that Black overlooked this move.

17...♗xf6 18 exf6+

The difference between this line and the one resulting from 16 ♘f6+? is that here Black can be prevented from castling; it is amazing that White is better off simply with the c1-bishop removed from the board!

18...♗e6 19 ♖ad1! *(D)*



B

This is the advantage: the a1-rook comes into the game quickly.

19...♕f5

It is more tenacious to give up the queen with 19...0-0-0, but this is a hard decision to make.

20 ♕g7 ♖f8

Black is a piece up but is completely paralysed; the a8-rook can't come into play and the queen is tied down to defending against ♖xe6+ followed by ♕e7#.

21 h3!

Threatening 22 g4 and 23 ♖xe6+. Not 21 f4?? ♕c5+, defending the f8-rook, and after 22 ♔h1 ♖d8 Black wins.

21...h5 22 ♖d4

22 f4 is possible now, because 21...h5 has weakened g6, so after 22...♕c5+ 23 ♔h1 ♖d8 White has 24 ♖xe6+! fxe6 25 ♕xg6+ ♖f7 26 ♖xd8+ ♔xd8 27 ♕xf7, winning.

22...h4 23 f4! c5 24 ♖dd1 c4 25 ♖e5 ♕xe5 26 fxe5 c3 27 bxc3 ♗xa2 28 ♕h6 ♗e6 29 ♕d2 ♖h8 30 ♕d4 b6 31 ♕b4 c5 32 ♕xb6 1-0

3 points for 16 ♗g5!! and 2 points for 17 ♘f6+!!.

904) Ganguly – Hernández Carmenates

Spanish Team Ch, Sabadell 2008

18 ♘xe6!!

The start of a spectacular mating attack; if White begins with 18 ♖xh7? then Black can play 18...♘xe5 (not 18...♔xh7? 19 ♘xe6!) 19 fxe5 ♔xh7 20 ♕h5+ ♔g7 21 ♕h6+ ♔g8, and White has no more than a draw after 22 ♗xg6 fxg6 23 ♕xg6+.

18...fxe6 19 ♖xh7! ♘f8

19...♔xh7 allows mate with 20 ♕h5+ ♔g8 21 ♕xg6+ ♔f8 22 ♕h6+ ♔g8 23 ♕h7+ ♔f8 24 ♕h8+ ♔f7 25 g6#. The best defence is 19...♘xe5, although after 20 ♗d4! ♕c5 (the alternative 20...♔xh7 21 ♗xe5 ♕b6+?! leads to mate after 22 ♔g2 ♔g8 23 ♗xg6 ♕e3 24 ♕h5 ♕d2+ 25 ♔h1) 21 c3!! (on the other hand 21 ♗xc5? ♗xc5+ 22 ♔g2 ♘xd3 is ineffective) 21...♔xh7 22 ♕h5+ ♔g8 23 ♗xg6 ♘xg6 24 ♕xg6+ ♔f8 25 ♔g2 (25 ♖e1 is also strong) 25...♕xd4 26 cxd4, Black is doing fine in terms of material, but is lost owing to the situation of his king.

20 ♖h6 ♔g7 21 ♕g4!

The 'silent' transfer of the queen to the h-file is decisive.

21...♗c5

21...♗d7 is met by 22 ♕h3 ♗b5 23 ♗xg6!! ♘xg6 24 f5! (to deprive the black king of the f5-square) 24...exf5 25 ♖xg6+ ♔xg6 26 ♕h6+

♔f7 27 e6+ ♔g8 28 ♕g6+ ♔h8 29 ♗d4+ with mate in two.

22 ♕h4! ♗xf2+ 23 ♔xf2 b5

23...♕c5+ is punished by 24 ♔g2 ♔f7 25 ♖xg6! ♔e8 26 ♖g7 ♖d7 27 ♖g8 b6 28 ♕h6 ♖f7 29 g6.

24 ♖h8 ♕c5+ 25 ♔f3 ♔f7

After 25...♕c3 one way to win is 26 ♕h6+ ♔f7 27 ♔g4! (unpinning the bishop) 27...♕xa1? 28 ♗xg6+ ♘xg6 29 ♕h7#.

26 ♗xg6+! ♔e7

Or 26...♔xg6 27 ♕h5+ ♔g7 28 g6 and White forces mate.

27 ♖h7+ 1-0

4 points for 18 ♘xe6!! and 1 point for 19 ♖xh7!.

Test 15 Answers

905) Bosboom – Iturrizaga

Wijk aan Zee 2009

40 ♖h5!

The vital e5-pawn will be lost.

40...♕f6 41 ♘xg7 ♖g3

On any recapture, such as 41...♕xg7, 42 ♗xe5 wins.

42 ♗xe5 ♕g6

Black remains a piece down after 42...♖xf3 43 ♗xf6 ♖dxd3 44 gxf3.

43 ♘f5 1-0

There is no defence after 43...♘xf5 44 ♖h8+ ♔f7 45 exf5.

1 point for 40 ♖h5!.

906) Matamoros – Gil del Fresno

Seville 2009

28 ♗d5+! cxd5 29 ♕xd5+ ♔g7

Or 29...♔h8 30 ♗d4+ ♗g7 31 ♖xe7 ♕xe7 32 ♘f7+ ♔g8?! 33 ♘h6++ ♔h8 34 ♕g8#.

30 ♗d4+ ♔h6 31 ♖xe7 1-0

1 point for 28 ♗d5+!.

907) D. Johansen – Hernández Carmenates

Dresden Olympiad 2008

38...♖xc3! 0-1

White resigned, seeing 39 ♖xc3 ♕h1+ 40 ♔f2 ♕xd1.

2 points for 38...♖xc3!.

908) L. Domínguez – Morozevich

Wijk aan Zee 2009

35 ♘f5!

The most elegant way to win.

35...♖c8

35...♕xf5 loses to 36 ♕d6+ ♗e7 37 ♕xc7, while 35...gxf5 36 ♖b8+ leads to mate.

36 ♖b8! 1-0

If 36...♖xb8 White mates after 37 ♕d6+.

2 points for 35 ♘f5!.

909) A. Gupta – Bosboom

Wijk aan Zee 2009

30...♕f6?

Black had to play **30...♘f6!**, when White has compensation for the piece after 31 ♖f3 ♔g7 32 h3 ♗e6 33 g4 g5 34 ♕e5 ♗d5 35 ♖f5 ♖e8 36 ♖xg5+ ♔f8 37 ♕d6+ ♕e7, but Black also has chances.

31 ♖e8+ ♔g7 32 ♕h3! ♘f8

32...♔f7 loses to 33 ♖xc8!.

33 ♖xc8

White is two pawns up with the better position.

2 points for 30...♘f6!.

910) Harika Dronavalli – Holzke

Wijk aan Zee 2009

66...h5!

The only move (as 66...♔g8? loses to 67 ♔e7 and 66...♔e8? to 67 ♔g7), but good enough to draw. Incidentally, with the white pawn on a5 and the black pawn on a6, the position is a win for White – for the details, look up 'Bähr's Rule' in specialist endgame literature.

67 ♔g5 ♔f7 68 ♔xh5 ♔f6 69 ♔g4 ♔f7 70 ♔f4 ♔f6 71 ♔e4 ♔f7 72 ♔e5 ♔e7 73 ♔d5 ♔f6 74 ♔c5 ♔xf5 75 ♔b5 ♔e6 76 ♔xa5 ♔d7 ½-½

The king reaches c8 in time.

2 points for 66...h5!.

911) Morozevich – Svidler (variation)

Russian Ch, Moscow 2008

52 ♖xg6+! fxg6 53 ♖g7+ ♔f8 54 ♖g8+!

54 ♕d6+! ♔xg7 55 ♕xg6+! works just as well.

54...♔xg8 55 ♕g7+!

with a draw.

2 points for 52 ♖xg6+! and 1 point for seeing 54 ♖g8+! or 54 ♕d6+!.

912) Marin – Dreev

Reggio Emilia 2008/9

58 e5+! ♗xe5 59 fxe5+ ♔xe5 60 ♔g5!

Not 60 ♔xh4?? ♔f6 61 ♔h5 ♔g7 and the black king reaches the safe corner. Thanks to

zugzwang, White will capture the h4-pawn only when the black king can no longer reach h8.

60...a4 61 ♗a2

Not 61 ♗xa4?? ♔e6 with a draw.

61...a3 62 ♗b3 1-0

After 62...♔d6 White can finally play 63 ♔xh4, winning after 63...♔e7 64 ♔g5 ♔f8 65 ♔f6.

2 points for finding 58 e5+! and 1 point for 60 ♔g5!.

913) Gordon – E. Berg

Hastings 2008/9

13...♗xd4! 14 ♗xd4 ♖xd4! 15 exd4 ♕xd4 0-1

After 16 ♖a2 ♘f4 17 ♕c2 ♘ed3+ 18 ♔f1 ♕e4! there is no defence.

2 points for finding 13...♗xd4! and 1 point for 14...♖xd4!.

914) Stellwagen – Van Wely

Wijk aan Zee 2009

The game went **32 ♘a5?** but after **32...♘c5 33 ♖c3 ♘e4 34 ♖b3 ♘c5 35 ♖c3 ♘e4 36 ♖c7 ♘d6**, Black held the position.

Instead **32 ♕e3!** (threatening 33 ♕a7) is very strong and now 32...♗c8 loses to 33 ♖xb8 ♘xb8 34 ♕c5! ♗xf5 (or 34...♔d8 35 d6) 35 ♕c7.

32 ♕f2!, with the same idea, allows 32...♖d4, but this does not solve Black's problems, since White can play 33 ♖xd4 exd4 34 ♕h2!, threatening 35 ♘d6+ and 35 ♕c7, as well as 35 ♖xb7 followed by 36 ♘d6+.

3 points for 32 ♕e3!. You also get 3 points for 32 ♕f2!, as long as you saw 32...♖d4 and its refutation.

915) Werle – Vallejo

Wijk aan Zee 2009

It can't be good for so many white pieces to be so far away from their king...

27...♘f4!

27...♕h3? can be answered with 28 ♕f1.

28 ♖e3?!

28 ♔h1 ♕h3 29 ♕f1 ♘g4! also loses; best is 28 ♕f1 but Black still has a winning attack with 28...♕g4 29 ♘c3 ♘h3+ 30 ♔h1 ♕h5, followed by 31...♘g4, when the main threat is ...♘xh2!.

28...♕h3 29 ♕f1 ♘g4! 30 ♕xh3 ♘xh3+ 31 ♔f1 ♘hxf2 0-1

3 points for 27...♘f4!.

916) Hou Yifan – Vallejo

Wijk aan Zee 2009

20 ♖g1!

Forcing the black queen to move into the line of fire.

20...♕d7

After 20...♕h4 21 ♘f3 ♕h6 22 ♖h1 the black queen is lost.

21 ♘de6! ♕e7?!

21...b5 22 ♕c3 ♕xd1+ 23 ♖xd1 ♗xe6 24 ♕xc6 was the best option, but White's advantage is unquestionable.

22 ♘xg7 ♔xg7 23 ♘h5+ ♔h8

23...♔g8 loses to 24 ♕h4 g5 25 ♘xf6+! ♕xf6 26 ♗xg5 ♘xg5 27 ♖xg5+.

24 ♗c5! ♕e6

If 24...b5 then 25 ♕h4!.

25 ♖ge1!

Back to e1! The white queen is taboo on account of mate.

25...♕xe1

25...♘e5 loses to 26 ♕xe6! ♗xe6 27 ♘xf6, winning a lot of material; e.g., 27...♗g4 28 ♘xe8 ♖xe8 29 ♗d4 ♗xd1 30 ♖xe5.

26 ♕xf7 ♕xd1+

26...gxh5 is met by 27 ♕xf6+ ♔g8 28 ♖xe1 ♖xe1+ 29 ♔d2 ♖e8 30 ♗d4 and White forces mate.

27 ♔xd1 ♗g4+ 28 ♔d2 ♖ad8+ 29 ♔c3 ♗xh5 30 ♗d4!

The final crushing blow. Kavalek described the sequence of moves after 25 ♖ge1! as a series of "beautiful jabs", evoking the somewhat surprising similarities between chess and boxing.

30...♖xd4 31 ♕xe8+ 1-0

3 points for 20 ♖g1!.

917) Gundavaa – L.B. Hansen

Dresden Olympiad 2008

24...♗xh3! 25 gxh3?!

White thinks that Black has nothing more than a draw; it is better to resign himself to 25 ♕c2 ♗g4 and a difficult defence.

25...♕g3+ 26 ♔h1 ♕xh3+ 27 ♔g1 ♕g3+ 28 ♔h1 ♖e6!

This move is vital for the soundness of the sacrifice.

29 ♘xe6 ♖xe6 0-1

After 30 fxg5 Black can mate with 30...♕h4+ 31 ♔g2 ♕xg5+ 32 ♔f3 ♕h5+ 33 ♔g2 ♖g6#.

2 points for 24...♗xh3! and 2 points for 28...♖e6!.

918) Carlsen – Kariakin

Wijk aan Zee 2009

The game proceeded **35 d5?** (the power of White's bishop increases, but tactically it does not work, as we shall see...) **35...♘e5 36 ♗d4 ♕f6 37 ♗xe5 ♕xe5 38 dxc6 bxc6 39 ♖d1 ♖g8 40 ♕d4 ♕xd4 41 ♖xd4 g5** and Black drew the endgame.

Instead, **35 ♕xg6!** is very strong, after which the most tenacious line is 35...♖xh4+ 36 ♔g2 ♘d6 (defending against 37 ♕f6+ and ♕xh4). Only now is it the right time to play 37 d5!:

a) 37...cxd5 is answered by 38 ♖c1, with the threat of 39 ♖c7; e.g., 38...♖c8 (38...♘f5 does not prevent it, so 39 ♖c7! with mate in a few moves after 39...♘xe3+ 40 ♔g1!) 39 ♖xc8 ♘xc8 40 f4! followed by ♗d4+, winning.

b) 37...♘f5 38 ♗c5! ♕d8 (38...♕xc5 39 ♕f6+ ♔h7 40 ♕xf5+ ♔h8 41 ♕f6+ followed by mate next move) 39 ♕xf5 ♕xd5+ 40 ♕xd5 cxd5 gives White a choice of wins, such as 41 ♗e7.

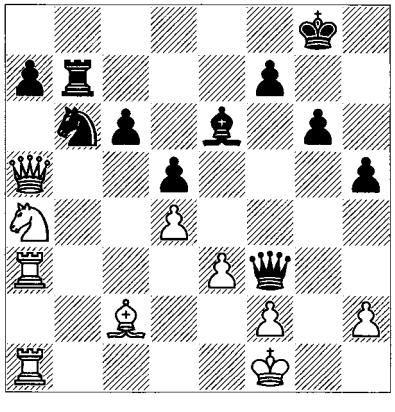
4 points for 35 ♕xg6!.

919) Stefansson – Akobian

Lubbock 2008

34...♘b6!! *(D)*

Intending to play 35...♗g4. The immediate 34...♗g4?, threatening 35...♕h1#, would fail to 35 ♕d8+! ♔g7 36 ♔g1! ♗h3 37 ♕g5!, winning.



W

35 ♔e1

After 35 ♘xb6 Black need not recapture and indeed now is the right moment for 35...♗g4!. The only move to prevent a quick mate is 36 ♗e4, which Black answers with 36...♕xe4 37 f3 ♕xf3+ 38 ♔g1 ♗h3 39 ♕d2 ♕g4+ 40 ♔h1 axb6, when Black has a material advantage and the white king is weak.

In reply to 35 ♗d3 Black has 35...♘xa4! 36 ♔g1 (after 36 ♖xa4? ♕h1+ 37 ♔e2 ♖b2+ Black mates quickly) 36...♕g4+ 37 ♔h1 ♘b2! 38 ♗f1 ♘c4, winning.

35...♘c4 36 ♕d8+ ♔g7 37 ♕g5

If 37 ♖3a2 then one way to win is 37...♘xe3! 38 fxe3? ♕xe3+ 39 ♔d1 ♗g4#.

37...♗g4 0-1

4 points for 34...♘b6!! and 1 point for 35...♗g4! in the line with 35 ♘xb6.

920) Bologan – E. Berg

Dresden Olympiad 2008

This position is a book draw, but it is not easy to remember everything and the constant time-pressure caused by the new time-limits makes it even harder. If the black rook can safely reach its third rank, it is a draw, since Black reaches the Vančura Position.

64...♖f3+?

The correct move is **64...♖a5+!**:

a) If 65 ♔e6, then 65...♖h5! 66 ♔d7 ♖h6 67 ♔c7 ♖f6 reaches the above-mentioned drawn position; after 68 ♖a7 both the logical 68...♖e6 and 68...♔g6 are playable.

b) 65 ♔e4 ♖c5! (Black is heading for the third rank) 66 ♖a7+ (66 ♔d4 ♖c6 is not dangerous) 66...♔g6 67 ♖b7 ♖a5 68 a7 (or 68 ♖b6+ ♔f7 69 ♔d4 ♔e7 70 ♔c4 ♔d7 71 ♔b4 ♖a1 drawing; e.g., 72 ♔b5 ♖b1+ 73 ♔c5 ♖c1+ 74 ♔d5 ♖a1) 68...♔f6 69 ♖h7 (if 69 ♔d4 Black can play 69...♔e6 70 ♔c4 ♔d6 71 ♔b4 and now 71...♖a1 or 71...♔c6!) 69...♔g6! (not 69...♔e6? 70 ♖h6+ ♔d7 71 ♖h8! winning) 70 ♖b7 ♔f6, repeating the position.

65 ♔e5! ♖h3

65...♖a3 is met by 66 ♔d5 ♔f7 67 ♔c6 ♔e7 and now, with the black king out of position, 68 a7! ♔f7 69 ♖h8 wins. The problem is that 65...♖f6? loses to 66 ♖g8+!.

66 ♖a7+ ♔g6 67 ♖c7 ♖a3 68 a7

Now the white king can't be prevented from reaching b7.

68...♖a6 69 ♔d5 ♔f5 70 ♔c5 ♔e5 71 ♔b5 ♖a1 72 ♔c6 ♔e6 73 ♔b7 ♔d6 74 ♖c6+ ♔d7 75 ♖b6 1-0

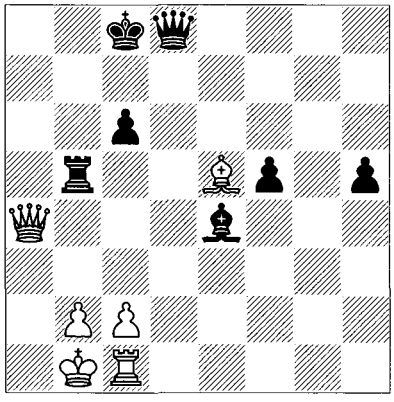
4 points for 64...♖a5+! and 1 point for 65...♖c5! in line 'b'.

11 The Ultimate Challenge

We have reached the last and most difficult chapter, which should pose a stern challenge to even the very best chess-players. There are 81 puzzles, all of level 5 or higher. There are hints for the first 30 of them.

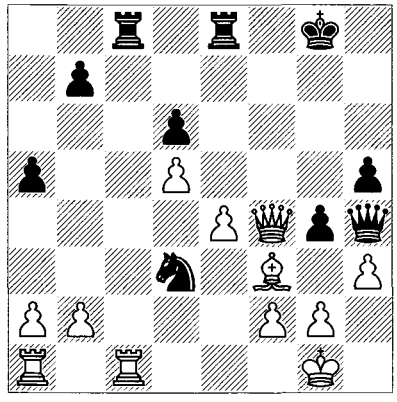
If you are a club-level player, then you should feel free to tackle these positions, but not be discouraged if you have problems with them. This is intended as a learning experience, and tackling difficult exercises will only benefit your calculating abilities and fire your chess imagination. You should be very pleased if you solve a puzzle completely, seeing all the key points. If you have seen the main idea, but missed a few finesses, then that is an encouraging sign that further work will take you to a higher level of chess mastery.

921
W



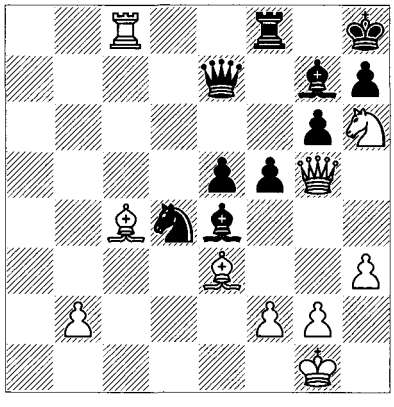
White can try to repeat moves with 59 ♕a8+ ♔d7 60 ♕a7+; is there any way he can try for more?

923
W



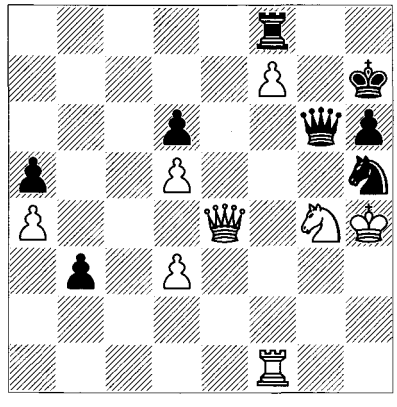
What is the logical result of the game, with best play for both sides?

922
B



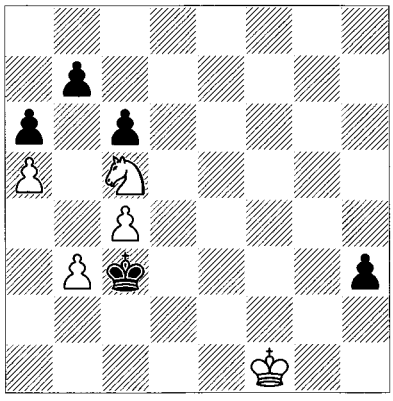
The game went 35...♗f6? 36 ♘f7+! ♔g8 37 ♘xe5+ ♘e6 38 ♘xg6! and White won. How could Black have defended better?

924
W



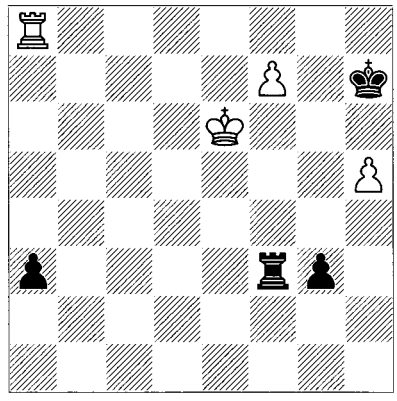
After 50 ♖f2? ♕xe4 51 dxe4 ♔g6 52 e5 ♖xf7 Black overcame his difficulties. How could White have played better?

925
B



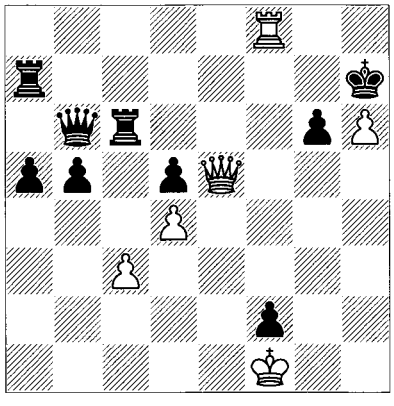
Black resigned here, although there was no need to do so; indicate why.

928
W



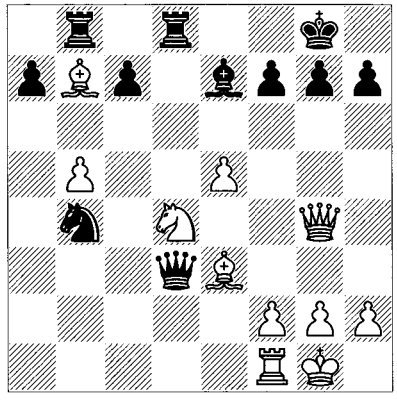
58 ♖xa3? led to a draw after 58...g2! 59 ♖xf3 (59 ♖a1 ♖f1) 59...g1♕ 60 f8♕ ♕e3+!. How can White win?

926
B



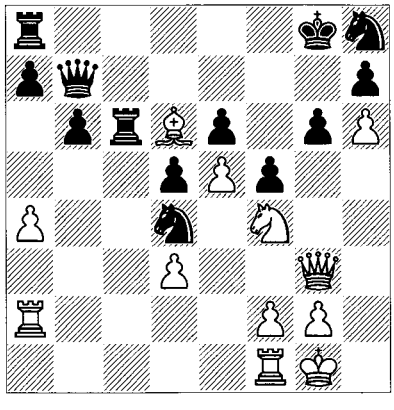
Black is on the verge of being mated; can you find the only way for Black to prevent mate and gain the advantage?

929
B



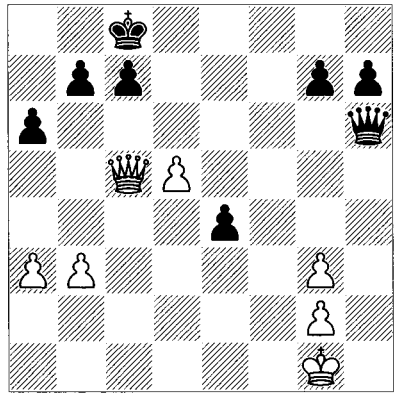
The game went 23...♖xb7 24 ♘f5 ♗f8 25 ♘h6+ ♔h8 26 ♘xf7+ ♔g8 27 ♕e6!, with advantage to White. Improve Black's play!

927
W



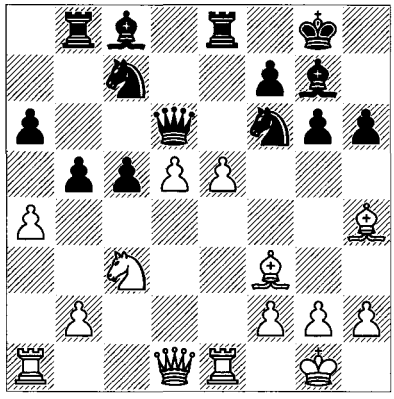
The d6-bishop exerts unpleasant pressure, and the h8-knight is passive. How can White exploit these factors?

930
B



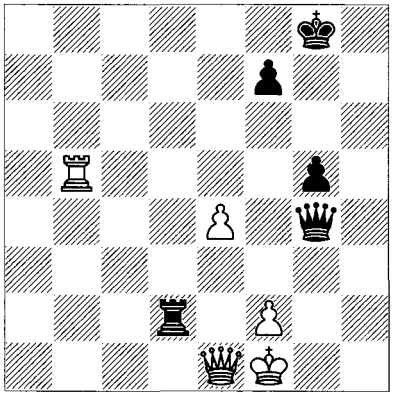
Black has an extra pawn, and played for simplification with 31...♕b6; was this decision correct?

931
B



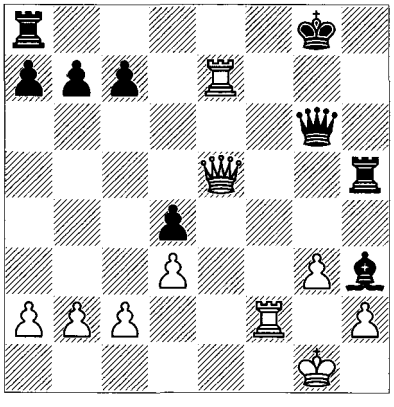
After 19...♕d8? 20 d6 ♘e6 21 exf6 ♗f8 22 ♗g3 White was winning. Black could have defended much better; how?

932
B



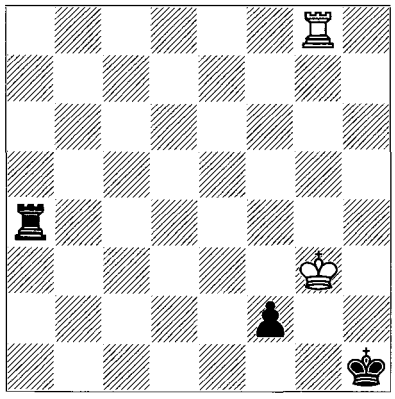
Now 45...♖d4 46 ♖d5! ♖xd5 47 exd5 ♕c4+ 48 ♔g1 ♕xd5 was insufficient for victory. How could Black have won?

933
W



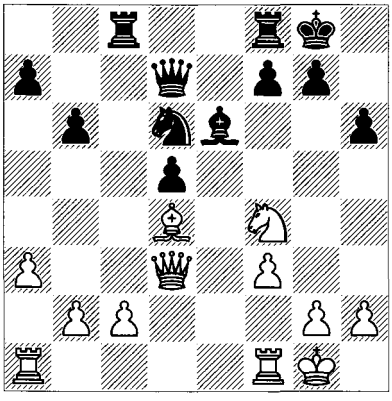
The game went 25 ♖f6 and Black resigned. Is there any way to defend?

934
B



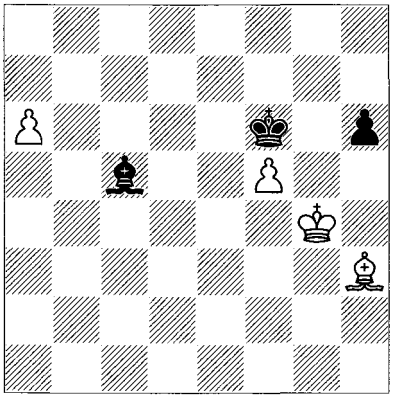
Now for an unusual question: from the *practical* point of view, what is the best move for Black, and why?

935
W



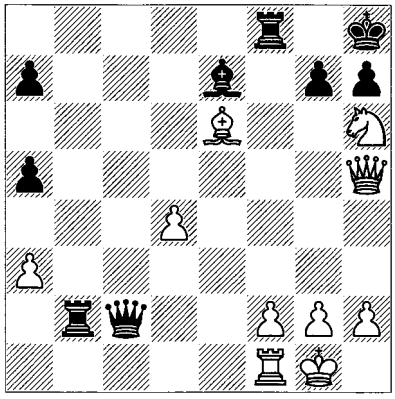
Is 20 ♗xg7 sound?

936
B



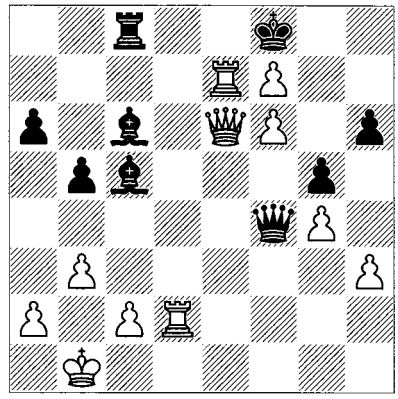
Black played 50...♗a7, and immediately resigned. Was this justifiable? Back up your answer with some variations.

937
W



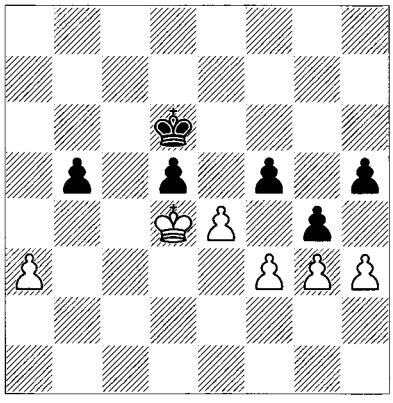
Is there anything more than a draw here with 31 ♘f7+ ♔g8 32 ♘h6++ ♔h8 33 ♘f7+?

940
B



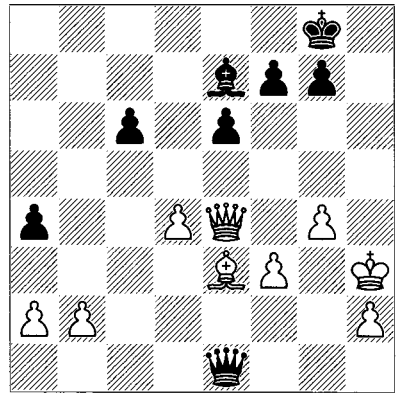
White has tremendous threats against Black's king, but it is Black to move. How does he strike first?

938
W



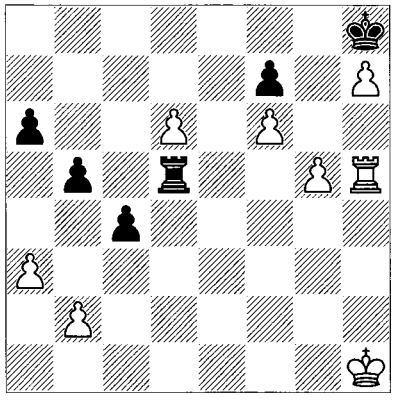
Black has just played 1...g4; what is the logical result of the game with best play for both sides?

941
B



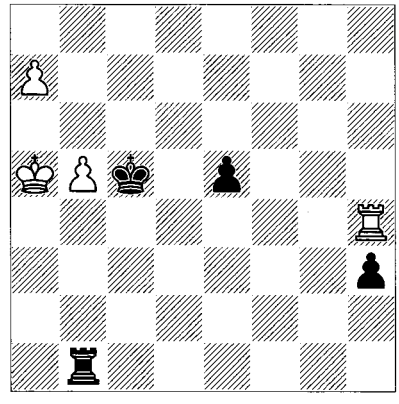
White is a pawn up, but his king is exposed and his queenside pawns are weak. How should Black exploit these factors?

939
W



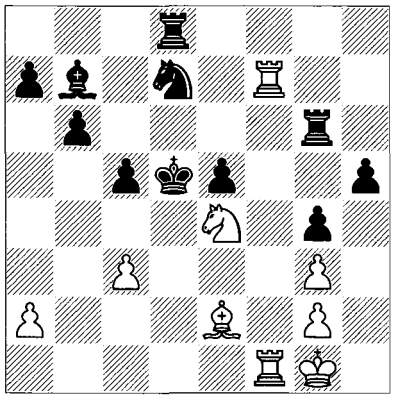
There is only one way to guarantee victory; what is it?

942
B



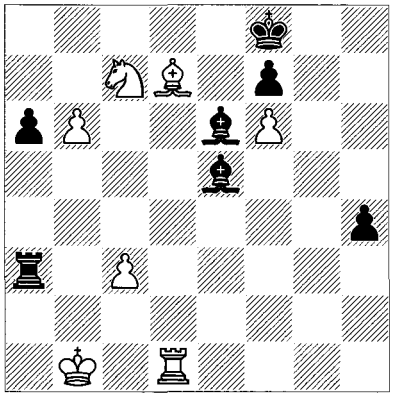
The game went 50...♖xb5+ 51 ♔a4 ♖b1 52 ♖xh3 1-0. Was there any way for Black to save the game?

943
W



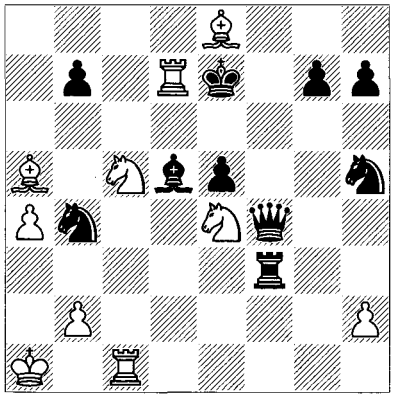
Black has two extra pawns, but his king is rather exposed. How can White exploit this?

944
W



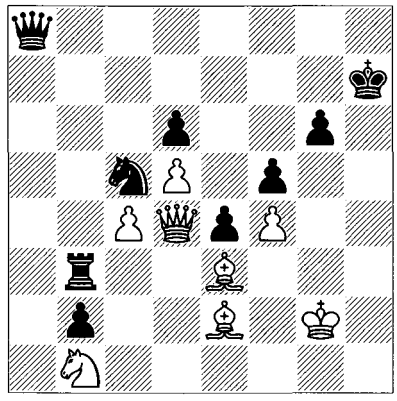
39 ♗xe6? fxe6 40 ♘xe6+ ♔f7 41 ♘c5 ♖xc3 led eventually to a draw. What great opportunity did White miss?

945
B



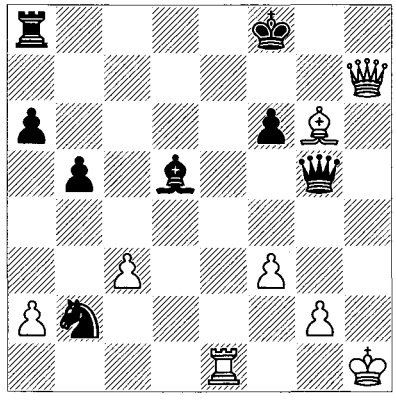
What is the logical result of this crazy position? Back up your answer with some variations.

946
W



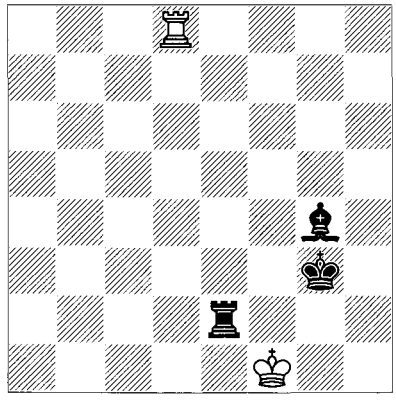
How can White save himself? The game went 41 ♔f2? ♕d8 42 ♔e1 ♕h4+ 43 ♔d1 ♖d3+ 44 ♗xd3 exd3 45 ♕xb2 ♕h1+ 0-1.

947
W



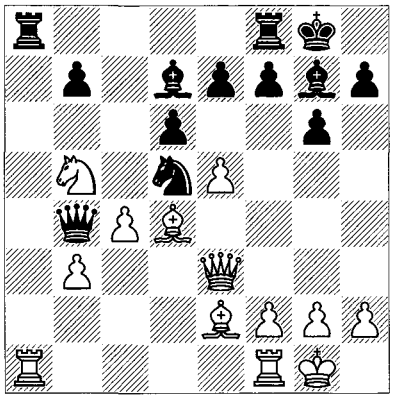
How should White continue with the attack before Black regroups?

948
B



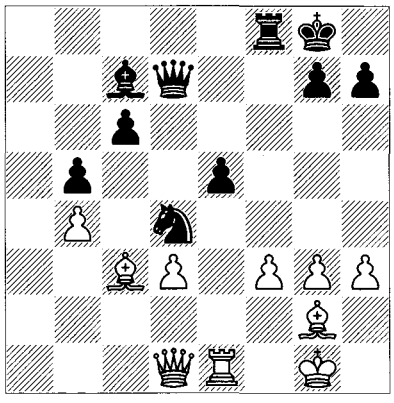
There is only one winning move; what is it?

949
W



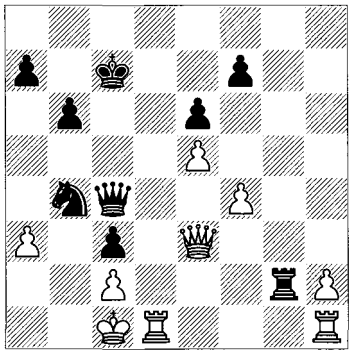
Black has just played 17...♘f6-d5. Is this combination sound?

950
B

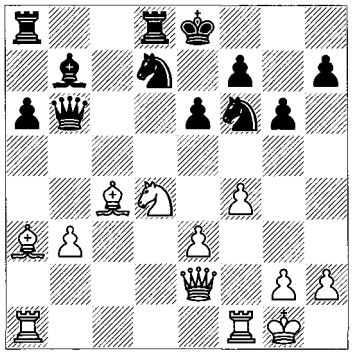


After 29...♘f5?! 30 ♔h2 ♕f7?! (30...e4!) 31 ♖e4 White was a shade better. How can Black's play be greatly improved?

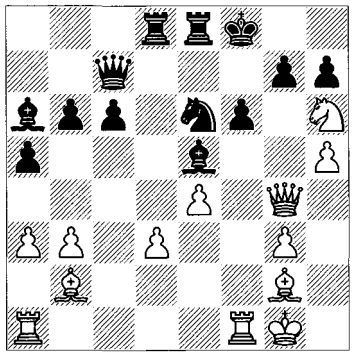
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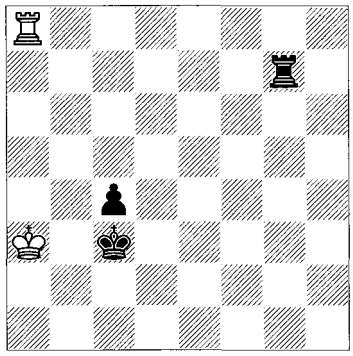
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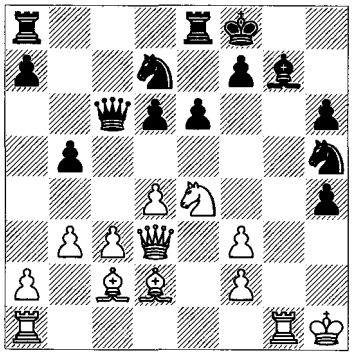
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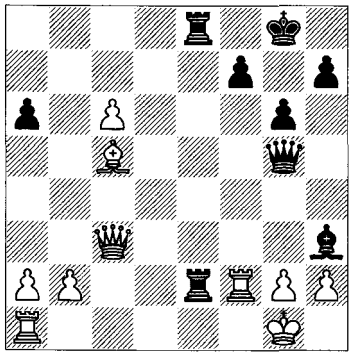
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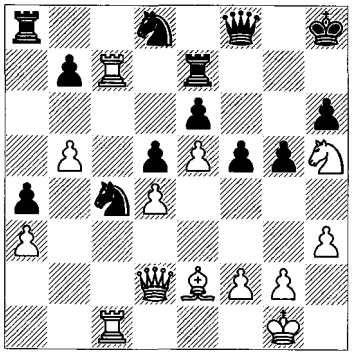
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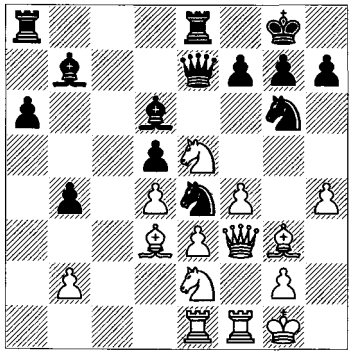
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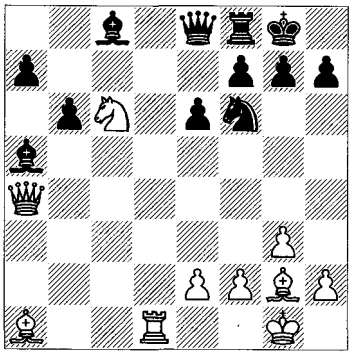
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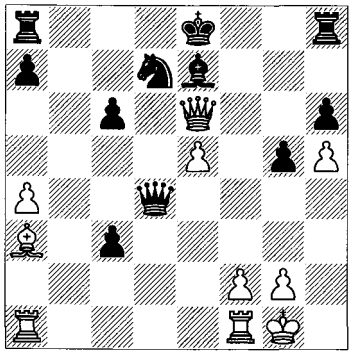
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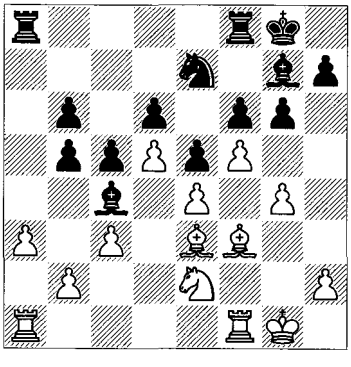
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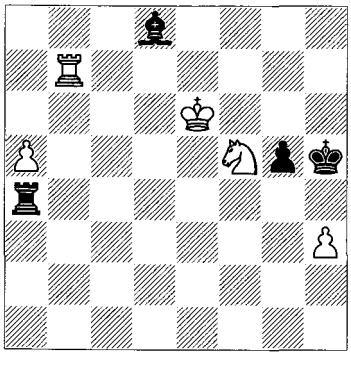
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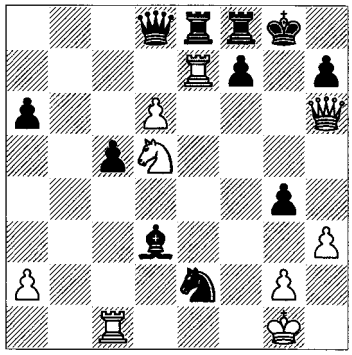
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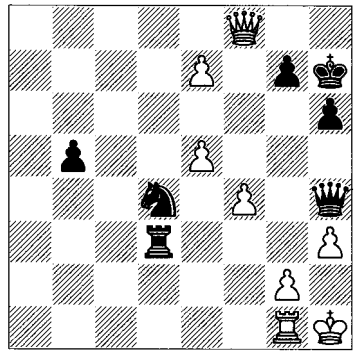
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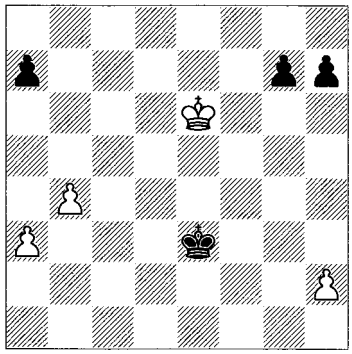
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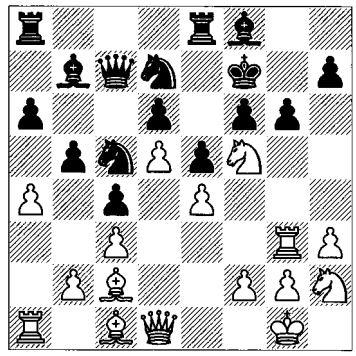
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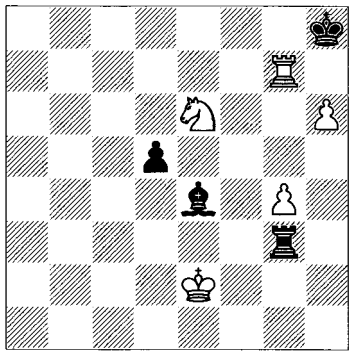
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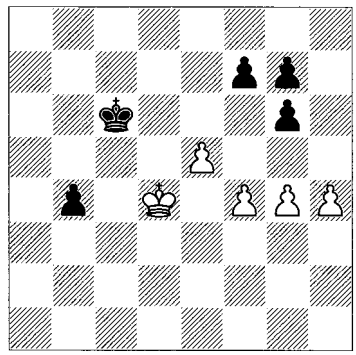
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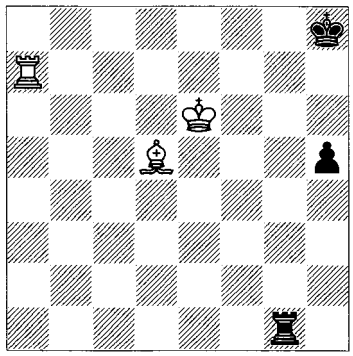
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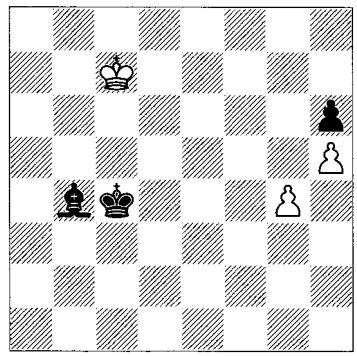
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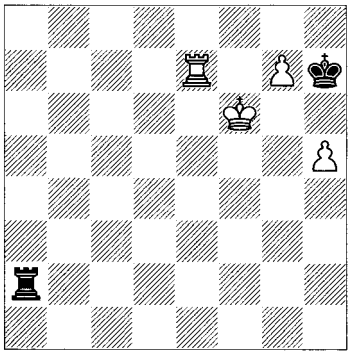
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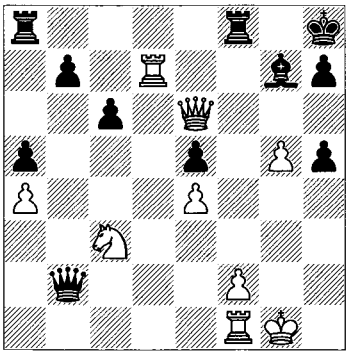
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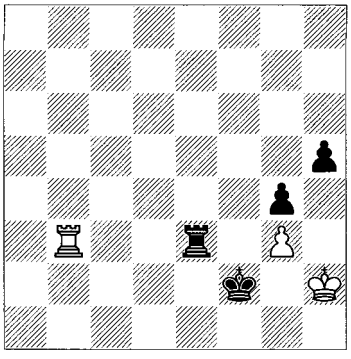
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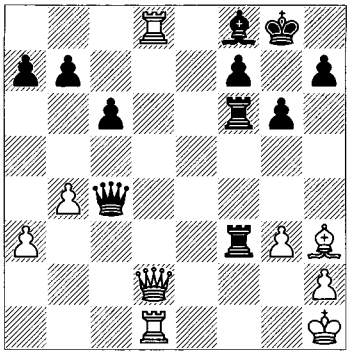
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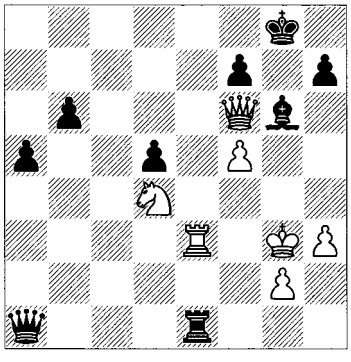
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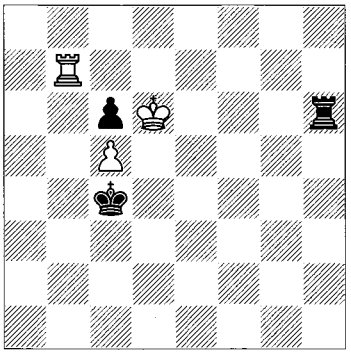
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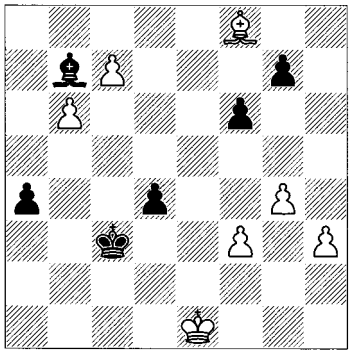
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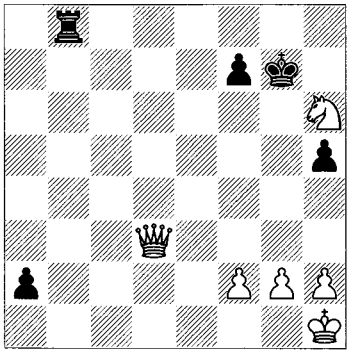
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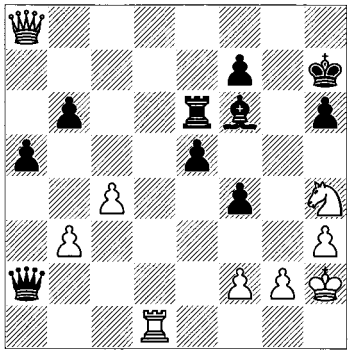
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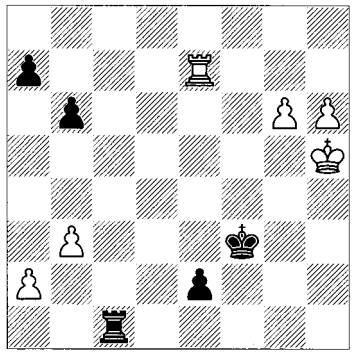
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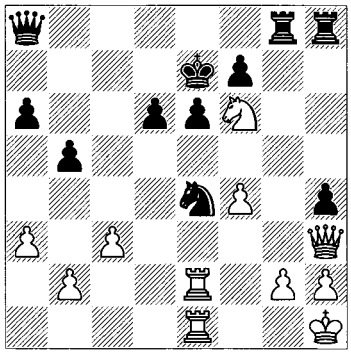
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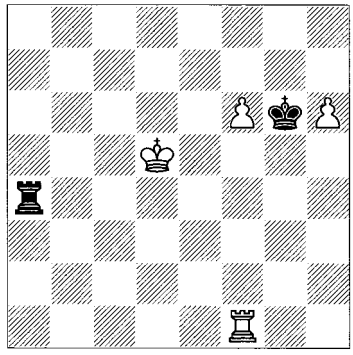
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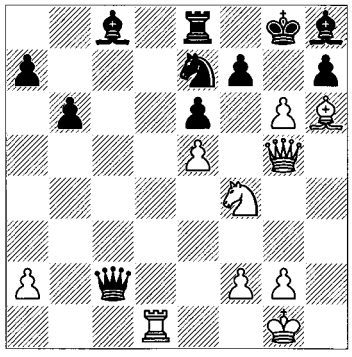
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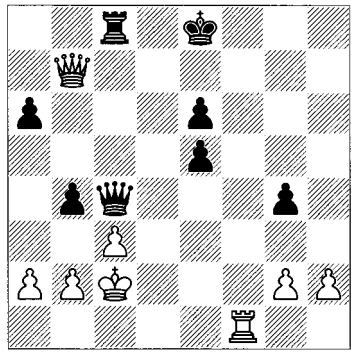
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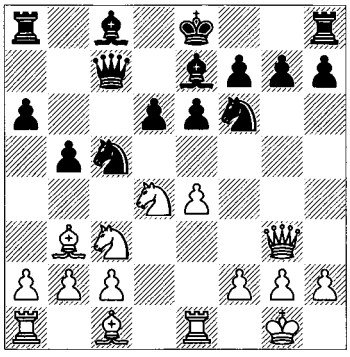
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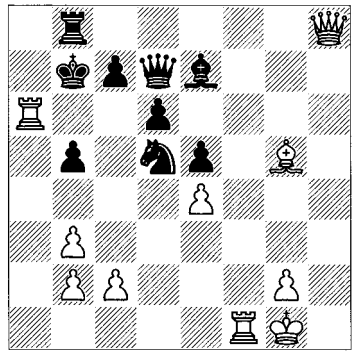
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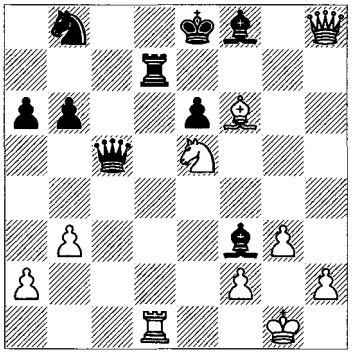
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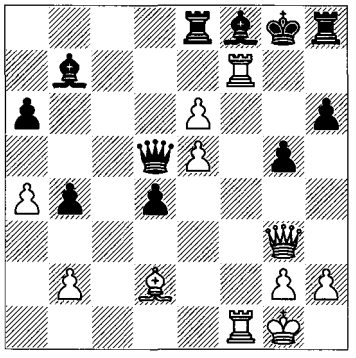
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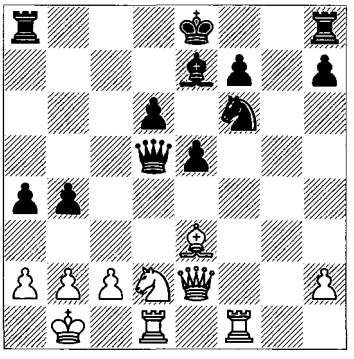
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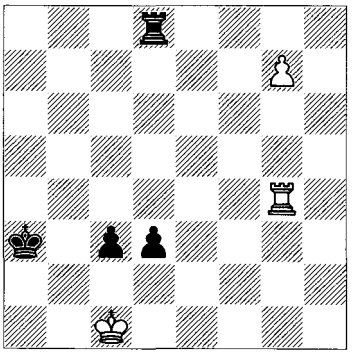
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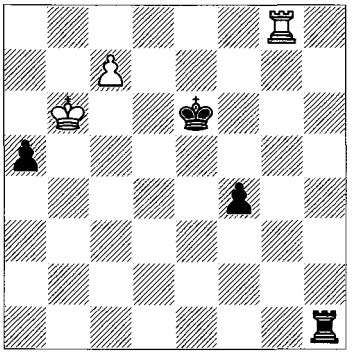
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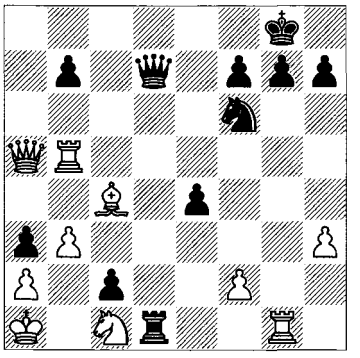
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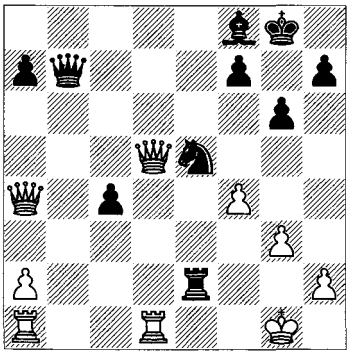
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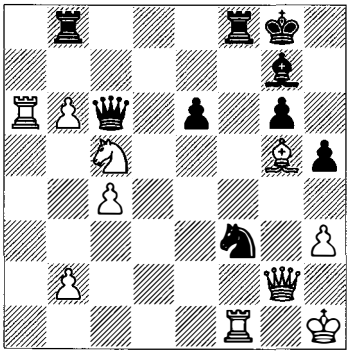
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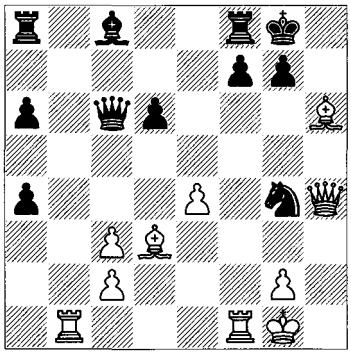
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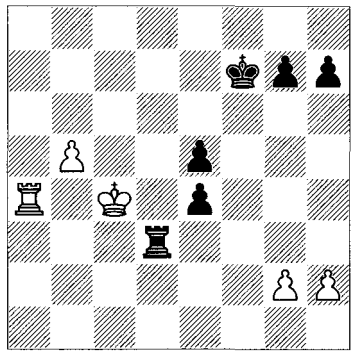
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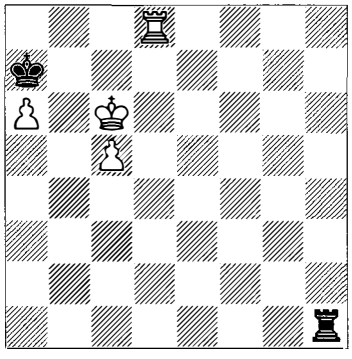
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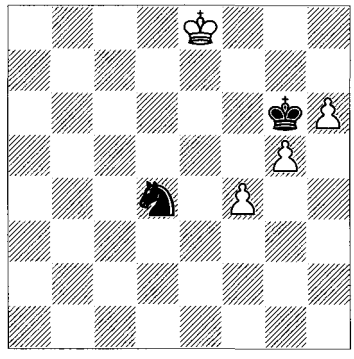
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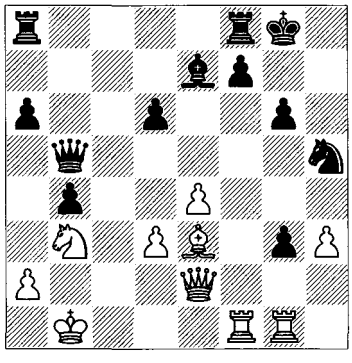
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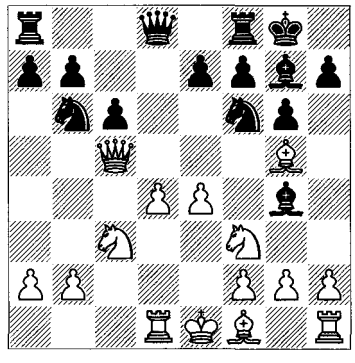
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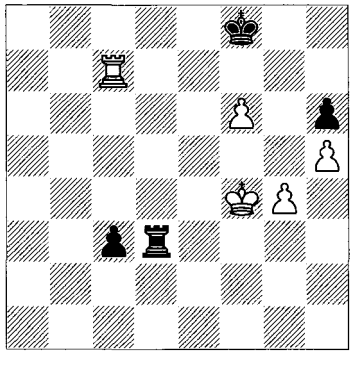
997
W



1001
B



998
B



Answers for Chapter 11

921) F. Olafsson – Letelier
Mar del Plata 1960

No, this is what he should have played. **59 ♕a8+** ♔d7 60 ♕a7+ and if 60...♔c8 (60...♔e8?! is dubious due to 61 ♖g1! and 60...♔e6?! 61 ♗c3 leaves the black king exposed), then 61 ♕a8+, etc., with a draw. The game went:

59 ♖g1? ♖xe5!

Although it looks in great danger, the black king will be safe and Black will win, because White is unable to coordinate his two major pieces in the attack.

60 ♖g8 ♖e8 61 ♕a8+ ♔d7 62 ♕a7+ ♔e6 63 ♖g6+ ♔d5!

Better than allowing checks with 63...♔e5 64 ♕c5+.

64 b4

Another try is 64 ♖g7 ♕b8 65 ♖d7+ ♔e6 66 ♖e7+ ♔f6 67 ♖f7+ ♔g5 and although for the moment the black king is straying a long way, his defence is more than adequate; for example, 68 ♖g7+ ♔f4! 69 ♕g1 ♔e5 70 ♕g3+ ♔e6 71 ♕g6+ ♔d5 72 ♖d7+ ♔c5 73 ♕g1+ ♔b5.

64...♕e7! 65 ♕a2+ ♔d4 66 ♕b2+

Or 66 ♕b3 f4 67 ♖g7 ♗xc2+! 68 ♔xc2 ♕e2+ 69 ♔c1 ♕e1+ 70 ♕d1+ ♕xd1+ 71 ♔xd1 f3.

66...♔c4! 0-1

922) Fischer – Incutto
Mar del Plata 1960

Not 35...♕xg5?, when White wins with 36 ♘f7+! ♔g8 37 ♘xg5+ ♔h8 38 ♘f7+ ♔g8 39 ♘xe5+, followed by 40 ♖xf8+ and 41 ♗xd4.

However, after **35...♘f3+!** 36 gxf3 ♕xg5+ 37 ♗xg5 ♖xc8 38 ♘f7+ ♔g8 39 ♗e6 ♖c6 40 ♘d8+ ♖xe6 41 ♘xe6 ♗xf3 Black is out of danger and has the better prospects.

923) R. Cruz – Stein
Mar del Plata 1965

It should be drawn.

30 ♕xd6! ♘xc1?

This loses. After **30...gxf3!** White is forced to give perpetual check with 31 ♕g6+ ♔f8 32 ♖xc8 ♕xf2+ 33 ♔h2 ♖xc8 34 ♕f6+ ♔e8 35 ♕e6+ ♔d8 36 ♕d6+. The line **30...♕xf2+** 31 ♔h1 ♖xc1+ 32 ♖xc1 ♘xc1 33 ♕g6+ is similar.

31 ♕g6+ ♔f8 32 ♕h6+!

Pinning the h5-pawn and thus allowing the bishop to come into play.

32...♔f7

Similar play occurs after 32...♔g8 33 ♗xg4 ♖c7 34 ♗e6+ ♖xe6 35 ♕xe6+ ♔h7 36 d6 ♖c2 37 ♕e7+ (or 37 ♕f5+ ♔g7 38 d7) 37...♕xe7 38 dxe7 ♖c8 39 e8♕ ♘e2+ 40 ♔f1 ♖xe8 41 ♔xe2 ♖xe4+, leaving White two pawns up.

33 ♗xg4! ♖h8

Also losing is 33...♕f6 34 ♗xh5+ ♔e7 35 ♕xf6+ ♔xf6 36 ♗xe8 ♘e2+ 37 ♔f1.

34 ♗e6+ ♔e7 35 ♕g7+ ♔d6 36 e5+ 1-0

One possible continuation is 36...♔c5 37 ♖xc1+ ♔b6 38 ♗xc8.

924) Behrensen – Rossetto
Mar del Plata 1965

50 ♖g1! is very strong, threatening 51 ♘f6+. Black has no way to prevent material loss: 50...♔g7 (or 50...♖xf7? 51 ♘f6+ ♖xf6 52 ♖xg6 ♖f4+ 53 ♔xh5; or 50...♕xe4 51 dxe4 ♘g7 52 ♘f6+ ♔h8 53 ♖g6! mating quickly) 51 ♕xg6+ ♔xg6 52 ♘e3+ ♔xf7 53 ♔xh5 ♔e7 54 ♖e1 and the rest is a matter of technique, as they say.

925) Cuasnicú – Rubinetti
Buenos Aires 1972

After **71...♔b4!** 72 ♘xb7 c5!! Black can draw; e.g., 73 ♔g1 ♔xb3 74 ♘xc5+ (74 ♘d6 ♔b4 is also a draw, as 75 ♔h2? loses to 75...♔xa5 76 ♔xh3 ♔b4) 74...♔xc4 75 ♘b7 ♔d5 76 ♔h2 ♔c6 77 ♘d8+ ♔b5.

926) Mariotti – Benko
Venice 1974

The game went **38...♔xh6?**, but this allowed a forced mate: **39 ♕h2+! ♔g5 40 ♕f4+ 1-0**. If 40...♔h5 then 41 ♖h8+.

The correct move is the surprising **38...♖f6!!** and after 39 ♖xf6 ♕d8! (better than 39...♕c7 40 ♕g5 ♕c4+ 41 ♔xf2 ♕d3 42 ♖f8) 40 ♕g5 (40 ♖e6? allows 40...♕h4! 41 ♖e8 ♕h3+ 42 ♔xf2 ♖f7+, with a winning attack) 40...♕g8 41 ♖xf2 a4 Black has the advantage.

927) Diez del Corral – Portisch
Buenos Aires Olympiad 1978

23 ♕e3!

Attacking the d4-knight, which is defending the vital e6-pawn.

23...♘c2 24 ♖xc2!

After this exchange sacrifice Black's position becomes difficult, owing to the loss of the base-pawn on e6.

24...♖xc2 25 ♘xe6 ♘f7 26 ♘d4 ♖a2

After 26...♘xd6 27 ♘xc2 the material is equal once more but Black's king is weak and White now has a strong passed pawn.

27 ♘xf5! ♘xd6

The capture 27...gxf5?? leads to mate after 28 ♕g3+ ♘g5 29 ♕xg5+ ♔h8 30 ♗e7.

28 exd6 gxf5

Black is a rook up but there is no defence. If 28...♕f7 then 29 ♘e7+ ♔f8 30 ♕e5 is decisive.

29 ♕g5+ ♔f8

Also losing is 29...♔h8 30 ♖e1! ♕f7 (not 30...♖g8?? 31 ♕f6+) 31 d7! ♕xd7 (31...♕f8 32 ♖e8! ♖xe8 33 dxe8♕ ♕xe8 34 ♕g7#) 32 ♕f6+ ♔g8 33 ♖e7, mating quickly.

30 ♖e1!

There is no defence against 31 ♖e7.

30...♕f7 31 ♖e7 1-0

After 31...♕g6 White wins with 32 ♕xg6 hxg6 33 h7.

928) Komljenović – Franco

Ponferrada 1991

White wins with **58 ♖a7!!** ♖xf7 (the point of interpolating 58 ♖a7 is that if 58...♔h6 White will queen on f8 with check, in contrast to what happened in the game, viz. 59 ♖xa3 g2 60 ♖xf3 g1♕ 61 f8♕+ and wins) 59 ♖xf7+ ♔h6 60 ♖f1 g2 61 ♖g1 a2 62 ♔f5 ♔h7 (or 62...♔xh5 63 ♖xg2!) 63 ♔g4, followed by ♔g3, capturing both black pawns without any difficulty.

929) Lipiniks – Cubas

Paraguayan Ch, Asunción 1996

Black should interpolate **23...h5!!**, ruling out the resource 27 ♕e6!. White's best now appears to be 24 ♕e4 but then Black has the spectacular 24...c5! (the continuation 24...♖xd4 25 ♗xd4 ♖xb7 {25...♕xb5!?} 26 ♕xb7 ♕xd4 is also advantageous, but less so) 25 ♘f5 ♗f8 with a decisive material advantage.

930) Riego – Lipiniks

Paraguayan Ch, Asunción 1997

No, it was not.

31...♕b6?

This is a blunder; it is better to centralize the king with **31...♔d7** and now 32...♕b6 is indeed a threat because after the exchange of queens Black would win the d5-pawn. After 32 ♕c3 ♕b6+ 33 ♔h2 ♕f6 34 ♕c4 e3 Black retains his great advantage. Another good move is **31...♕f6**, centralizing the queen. The game continued...

32 b4?

...returning the favour. After **32 ♕xb6!** cxb6 33 ♔f2 ♔d7 34 ♔e3 ♔d6 35 ♔xe4 White is virtually a pawn up and has a decisive advantage; e.g., 35...h5 36 ♔d4 b5 37 b4 b6 38 ♔e4, and White can just move his king back and forth between d4 and e4 until Black runs out of pawn moves and has to move his king, after which White wins with ♔e5 and d6.

32...♔d7 33 ♔f2 ♕xc5+ 34 bxc5 b6!

And Black won; he created an outside passed pawn that drew the white king across to the queenside, whereupon the black king invaded on the opposite flank.

931) Efimov – Franco

Saint Vincent 1998

Black is slightly better after **19...♖xe5!** 20 ♖xe5 ♘g4! (not 20...♕xe5? 21 ♗g3 ♕e8 22 ♗xc7 ♖b7 23 d6, with a crushing position) 21 ♗xg4 ♗xe5 22 ♗xc8 ♗xc3! 23 bxc3 ♖xc8 and the d5-pawn is lost.

932) Suba – Franco

Zaragoza 1999

45...♖d1? does not win on account of 46 ♖xg5+!, but Black can win by attacking on the h-file with **45...♖d3!** and there is no defence; e.g., 46 ♕e2? ♖d1+ or 46 ♖d5 ♖h3. **45...♖d6!** is also good, with a similar outcome.

933) Moreda – Slipak

Villa Ballester 2001

Yes, Black can defend with the spectacular **25...♕f7!!**, when White is forced to give perpetual check with 26 ♖fxf7 ♖xe5 27 ♖g7+ ♔f8! 28 ♖gf7+.

934) Slipak – Larsen

Pinamar 2002

The simplest is **67...f1♖!**, with an extra rook. Instead, the game went:

67...f1♕ 68 ♖h8+ ♔g1??

Even here Black could win with **68...♖h4!** 69 ♖xh4+ ♔g1 but this would have been slightly more difficult to win than if he had promoted the pawn to a rook.

69 ♖h1+! ½-½

935) Rodriguez Guerrero – Franco

Dos Hermanas 2004

No, the sacrifice is not good because it squanders a promising position and the most White can hope for then is a draw:

20 ♗xg7?! ♗f5!

Not 20...♔xg7?? 21 ♘h5+ ♔h8 22 ♘f6 ♗f5 23 ♕e3!, and wins.

21 ♕xd5!

White considered that his best chance now was to complicate the game rather than opt for the endgame by 21 ♕d4?! ♘b5 22 ♕f6 ♖c6 23 ♘h5 ♖xf6 24 ♘xf6+ ♔xg7 25 ♘xd7 ♗xd7, with advantage to Black.

21...♔xg7 22 ♖ad1 ♖cd8?!

22...♖c6!.

23 g4?

White's disadvantage is minimal after 23 ♕e5+ f6 24 ♘h5+ ♔g6 (or 24...♔h8 25 ♕f4 ♗h7 26 ♕xh6) 25 ♖xd6 ♕xd6 26 ♘f4+ ♔f7 27 ♕xf5 ♕c5+.

23...♗g6 24 ♕e5+ ♔h7 25 ♘d5 ♕e6

and Black won with his material advantage.

936) Aronian – Bacrot

FIDE World Cup, Khanty-Mansiisk 2005

Black resigned in a drawn position.

It does look as if Black is lost. White's bishop paralyses the black king, so the white king goes to b7, he advances his pawn and captures the black bishop, with an easy win. But there is a big hole in this description; after 51 ♔f4 h5 52 ♔e4 ♔e7 53 ♔d5, the black king is not actually paralysed at all, and after **53...♔d7!**, for the white king to reach b7 White has to advance his f-pawn, thus weakening it. Black can eventually capture the f-pawn and draw; e.g., 54 f6+ ♔e8 55 ♗e6 h4 56 ♔c6 h3! 57 ♔b7 (57 ♗xh3 is naturally a draw after 57...♔f7) 57...h2 58 ♗d5 ♗d4 59 a7 ♗xa7 60 ♔xa7 h1♕ 61 ♗xh1 ♔f7 and it's a draw.

937) Engelbert – Zierke

Hamburg 2007

No, there is no more than a draw. The game went:

31 ♘f7+ ♔g8

Now White should play 32 ♘h6++ with perpetual check. But he chose...

32 ♗f5?

which failed to...

32...g6! 33 ♕g4

If 33 ♗xc2, then 33...gxh5 34 ♘h6+ ♔h8, followed by 35...♗xa3, and Black wins.

33...♕c6

Even stronger is 33...♕e2!, but...

0-1

938) Morínigo – Mernes (variation)

Asunción 2007

The logical result is a draw, although it is complicated.

Not 2 fxg4?, which loses after 2...hxg4 3 e5+ (of course, 3 h4 fxe4 is a win for Black) 3...♔e6 4 h4 (or 4 hxg4 fxg4 5 ♔c5 ♔xe5 6 ♔xb5 d4 7 ♔c4 ♔e4 and Black wins easily) 4...f4 5 gxf4 g3 6 ♔e3 d4+! 7 ♔f3 d3, and the white king can't stop Black's passed pawns.

The 'rule of the common square' states that if the imaginary square formed by the two pawns, and extending towards the opponent's side of the board, reaches the eighth rank, the king can't prevent one of the pawns from queening, unless it is in a position to capture one of them immediately. When the square extends beyond the eighth rank, as in our case, it is already too late even to capture one of the pawns.

The correct move is:

2 hxg4

and after...

2...f4!

...the first impression is that White is lost, since the natural 3 gxf4? loses to 3...h4 4 g5 (if 4 ♔e3 then 4...d4+! 5 ♔f2 d3 6 g5 d2 7 ♔e2 h3, with an easy win) 4...dxe4! (4...h3? is bad on account of 5 g6 h2 {or 5...♔e7 6 exd5! h2 7 d6+ ♔xd6 8 g7 h1♕ 9 g8♕ ♕d1+ and Black has to fight for a draw} 6 g7 h1♕ 7 g8♕ ♕d1+ and once again Black has to try to draw) 5 fxe4 h3 6 g6 ♔e7!, and Black queens but White does not.

3 exd5!!

This brilliant resource, allowing Black two connected passed pawns on the sixth and seventh ranks, is sufficient to draw.

3...fxg3 4 ♔e3 h4 5 f4 h3 6 ♔f3 h2

6...g2 7 ♔f2 ♔xd5 8 g5 is similar.

7 ♔g2 ♔xd5 8 g5 ♔e6 9 g6 ♔f6 10 f5 ♔g7 11 ♔h1

And it's a draw, since there is no way to make progress. Sometimes in such positions the side with the more advanced pawns can even allow the opponent to queen, in order to rush his king forward in support of a mating attack with his pawns, but here White would queen on the g-file, which rules out this resource.

939) Narciso – Estremera

European Ch, Dresden 2007

50 g6!!

This sacrifice of a whole rook, with check, is the only way to win; the pawns are unstoppable.

50...♖xh5+ 51 ♔g2 fxg6

No better is 51...♖g5+ 52 ♔h3 ♖h5+ 53 ♔g4 fxg6 54 f7 ♖f5 55 d7.

52 f7 ♖f5 53 d7 ♖xf7 54 d8♕+ ♔xh7 55 ♕c8

Black's queenside pawns can't be defended, and White won quickly.

940) Movsesian – Ponomariov

San Sebastián 2009

39...♕f1+! 40 ♔b2 ♗a3+!!

White's king is dragged into the open.

41 ♔xa3 ♕c1+ 42 ♔b4 ♕xd2+ 43 c3

43 ♔a3 ♕c1+ 44 ♔b4 a5+! 45 ♔xa5 ♕d2+ 46 c3 is the same story.

43...a5+! 44 ♔xa5 ♕xc3+ 45 ♔a6 ♖a8+! 46 ♔b6 ♕d4+ 47 ♔c7

47 ♔xc6 loses to 47...♖a6+ 48 ♔c7 ♖xe6 49 ♖xe6 ♔xf7. The rest is easy.

47...♕d8+ 48 ♔xc6 ♖a6+ 49 ♔c5 ♖xe6 50 ♖xe6 ♕a5 51 ♖e7 ♕xa2 0-1

941) So – Ivanchuk

FIDE World Cup, Khanty-Mansiisk 2009

33...♕f1+?

This check helps the defence, while after **33...♕e2!!** Black can combine an attack on the white king with threats to the queenside pawns, with moves like ...♗d6 and ...g5; e.g.:

a) 34 g5 ♗d6 35 f4 ♕xb2 36 ♕xc6 ♕a3 37 ♔g4 ♗f8 38 ♔f3 ♕xa2 and the a4-pawn is too strong.

b) 34 ♗f4 ♕f1+ 35 ♔g3 g5! 36 ♗e3 (36 ♗e5 ♗b4!) 36...♗d6+ 37 f4 ♕e1+ 38 ♔h3 (or 38 ♔f3 ♕h1+) 38...♗xf4, winning.

c) 34 f4 g5 35 ♔g3 (35 fxg5? ♗d6) 35...♗d6 36 ♕f3 ♕xb2 37 ♕xc6 ♕a3! winning.

34 ♔g3 ♗d6+ 35 ♗f4 ♗b4 36 g5!

Now the king finally gets a safe place, and the game was later drawn.

942) Atalik – Skoberne

European Ch, Plovdiv 2008

Yes, practically by force Black can reach a slightly inferior, but theoretically drawn, queen ending with **50...h2!** 51 a8♕ ♖a1+ 52 ♖a4 h1♕ 53 ♕f8+ ♔d5 54 ♕f7+ ♔d6 55 ♕f6+ ♔d7 56 ♖xa1 ♕xa1+ 57 ♔b6 and here you may be surprised (as I was) to learn that it is a draw, not only after Atalik's suggestion of 57...♕c3!, but also after 57...♕g1+, 57...♕e1, 57...♕b2 and 57...♔c8, and that everything else, including 57...♕d4+?, loses (as confirmed by the 6-man tablebases).

943) Wang Yue – Yu Shaoteng

Chinese Team Ch, Wuxi 2008

29 ♗b5!!

Preventing the black king from retreating to c6, and threatening Black's knight, which can't move away since it is preventing 30 ♘f6+.

29...♔xe4?!

This loses a lot of material. After the best defence, 29...♗c6!, White also wins material, although it requires great accuracy to win after 30 ♖d1+ ♔xe4 31 ♗d3+ ♔d5 32 ♗xg6+ ♔c4 33 ♖d6 ♗a4 34 ♗xh5 ♔xc3 35 ♗xg4 ♖f8. White has several favourable continuations, such as 36 ♖f2 or 36 ♖f3+, but the best appears to be 36 ♖xf8 ♘xf8 37 ♗f5, followed by 38 g4.

The strongest reply to 29...♔e6 is 30 ♘g5+! ♖xg5 31 ♗xd7+ ♔d6 (31...♖xd7? 32 ♖1f6+) 32 ♖1f6+ ♔d5 33 ♗e6+ ♔e4 34 ♖xb7, with an extra piece and a big positional advantage.

30 ♖e1+ ♔d5 31 ♖d1+ 1-0

After 31...♔e4 (not 31...♔e6? 32 ♗c4+) 32 ♗d3+ ♔d5 (32...♔e3? is met by 33 ♖ff1!, forcing mate) 33 ♗xg6+ Black is unable to win the c-pawn and the pin on the d-file is decisive; e.g., 33...♔e6 34 ♗xh5 ♗c6 35 ♖g7 ♖h8 36 ♗xg4+ ♔f6 37 ♖gxd7.

944) Degraeve – Ninov

La Fere 2008

There are two good solutions:

a) **39 ♗a4!** (threatening 40 ♖d8#) wins in elegant fashion: 39...♔g8 (39...♗xc7 40 bxc7 ♔g8 41 ♗c2! with a quick mate) 40 ♖d8+ ♔h7 41 ♗c2+ ♔h6 42 ♘xe6 fxe6 43 f7 ♗g7 44 b7.

b) **39 ♘xe6+!** fxe6 40 ♗xe6 ♗xf6 41 ♖f1! ♔e7 42 ♖xf6!.

945) Dzhumaev – Li Shilong

Kuala Lumpur 2008

It should be a draw, although Black needs to play accurately.

31...♔f8!

Not 31...♔xe8? 32 ♘d6+ ♔f8 33 ♘e6+! ♔g8 (33...♗xe6 34 ♖c8#) 34 ♘xf4.

32 ♘e6+ ♗xe6 33 ♗xb4+ ♔xe8! 34 ♖e7+ ♔d8?

Now **34...♔f8!** is essential: 35 ♖xb7+ ♔e8 36 ♘d6+ (or 36 ♖e7+ ♔f8 37 ♖b7+, but not 37 ♖xe6+? ♔f7 38 ♖e7+ ♔g6 39 ♖g1+ ♘g3! 40 ♘xg3 ♕xb4, and Black wins) 36...♔f8, and none of the discovered checks by the knight yields more than a draw.

35 ♖d1+ ♔c8 36 ♘d6+ ♔b8 37 ♖e8+ ♔a7 38 ♘b5+ ♔a6 39 ♖a8+ 1-0

946) Zhang Xiaowen – Z. Rahman

Kuala Lumpur 2008

With the counterattack **41 ♕f6!** ♖xe3 42 ♕f7+ ♔h6 43 ♗h5! ♔xh5 (or 43...gxh5 44 ♕f6+ ♔h7 45 ♕f7+ ♔h8 46 ♕f6+ ♔g8 47 ♕g6+ ♔f8 48 ♕f6+ and now 48...♔g8, drawing, but not 48...♔e8? on account of 49 ♕h8+) 44 ♕h7+ ♔g4 45 ♕xg6+ ♔xf4 46 ♕h6+ ♔e5 47 ♕g7+ ♔f4 48 ♕h6+, White draws.

947) Kotronias – Estremera

European Union Ch, Liverpool 2008

White was unable to discover a way to keep his attack going.

39 ♔g1? ♘c4

Black now threatens, amongst other things, 40...♘e5, so White has to force a draw.

40 ♕e7+ ♔g8 41 ♕h7+ ♔f8 42 ♕e7+ ♔g8 43 ♕h7+ ½-½

The right method is **39 ♕h8+!** ♗g8 40 ♖e6!. This position is difficult to assess correctly, but the a8-rook and the b2-knight are both loose, and this means that White's combination is winning: 40...♕xg6 (forced, since 40...♕c1+ loses to 41 ♔h2 ♕f4+ 42 g3 ♕d2+ 43 ♔h3) 41 ♖xf6+ ♕xf6 42 ♕xf6+ ♗f7 43 ♕h8+ ♗g8 44 ♕h6+ and now by checking appropriately White captures one or other of Black's two loose pieces or else mates Black's king: 44...♔f7 (or 44...♔e7 45 ♕g5+ ♔d6 46 ♕d2+, winning the knight) 45 ♕f4+ ♔g7 46 ♕d4+ ♔h6 (46...♔f8 47 ♕b4+ again wins the knight) 47 ♕b6+ ♔g5 48 ♕c5+ ♔f4 49 ♕d4+ ♔g5 50 f4+! ♔h6 (50...♔g4 51 ♕e5 ♔g3 52 ♔g1 is similar) 51 ♕b6+ ♔h5 (51...♔g7 52 ♕b7+ wins the rook) 52 ♕f6! and mate next move.

948) Leko – Ivanchuk

Dresden Olympiad 2008

The only move to win is:

124...♖e3!!

By moving the rook back along the e-file, Black threatens 125...♗h3+ and 126...♖e1#, but by putting it specifically on e3 he prevents his king from being harassed by the white rook, which would happen for instance after 124...♖e7? 125 ♖d3+ ♗f3 126 ♖a3 ♖h7 127 ♔e1 ♖d7 128 ♖a1, with a draw.

125 ♖g8 ♖e7!

Forcing the rook to a worse square, thus preventing it from retreating to the first rank to rescue the king.

126 ♖g5

126 ♖g6 is met by 126...♖d7.

126...♖h7

It is too early for 126...♖d7 on account of 127 ♖e5.

127 ♔e1

After 127 ♔g1 ♖a7 White does not have the saving move ♖f5 available.

127...♖d7! 0-1

949) D. Fridman – Parligras

Dresden Olympiad 2008

The combination is unsound, but the reason is not obvious.

18 cxd5 ♖xa1

If 18...♗xb5 immediately then 19 ♗c3 ♕xb3 20 ♖ab1, winning material, so Black exchanges rooks first.

19 ♖xa1?

Now the game levels out. Instead, 19 ♗xa1! wins for White, since there is a hidden pin after 19...♗xb5 20 ♕b6!, which wins a piece.

19...♗xb5 20 ♗xb5 ♕xb5 21 exd6 ♗xd4 22 ♕xd4 exd6 23 b4 ♖c8 24 h3

and it ended in a draw.

950) Bosboom – Giri

Wijk aan Zee 2009

Black has the winning sacrifice **29...♘xf3+!** and after 30 ♗xf3 ♕xh3 the 'dormant' bishop on c7 becomes a tremendous attacking piece. Then:

a) 31 ♗g2 ♗b6+ 32 d4 ♕xg3 and with the twin threats of 33...♖f2 mating and 33...♕xc3 Black regains the sacrificed piece with interest.

b) 31 ♔f2 ♗b6+ 32 d4 ♕h2+! 33 ♔e3 (after 33 ♔f1 the strongest line is 33...e4! 34 ♖xe4 ♕h1+) 33...♕xg3, and there is no satisfactory defence against the threat of 34...♕f4+ winning the f3-bishop; e.g., 34 ♖f1 exd4+ 35 ♗xd4 ♖e8+ 36 ♔d3 ♗xd4 37 ♕b3+ ♔h8 and now 38 ♔xd4 loses to 38...♕d6+.

951) Corte – Rossetto

Argentine Ch, Buenos Aires 1946

In the game, White lost as follows: **26 ♖d4? ♖xc2+ 27 ♔d1 ♕b3 28 ♖xb4 ♖d2++ 29 ♔e1 ♕d1# (0-1)**.

Although it looks scary, **26 axb4!** is necessary and after 26...♕xb4 27 ♖d4! ♕b2+ 28 ♔d1, thanks to Black's exposed king, amazingly there is no more than a draw; e.g., 28...♖xc2 (Black has nothing after 28...♕xc2+ 29 ♔e1 either) 29 ♖d7+! ♔c8 30 ♖d8+ ♔c7 31 ♖d7+.

952) F. Olafsson – Eliskases
Mar del Plata 1960

24 ♖xf6+!! ♗xf6

If 24...gxf6 then White continues in similar fashion to the game: 25 ♕g8+ ♔e7 26 ♕f7+ ♔d6 27 ♘f5+ ♔c5 28 d4+ ♖xd4 (or 28...♘xd4? 29 ♖c1+, mating quickly, while 28...♗xd4+ is met by 29 ♗xd4+ ♖xd4 30 ♕xe8) 29 ♕xe8, gaining a decisive material advantage.

25 ♗xf6 gxf6

25...gxh6 is met by 26 ♖f1! with a decisive discovered check. 25...♗xd3 appears to be the most tenacious move, preventing ♖f1, but then White has 26 ♕f5! ♗xe4 (worse is 26...gxh6? 27 ♗xd8+ ♕f7 28 ♗xb6, with a crushing advantage) 27 ♗xe4 ♕xg3+ 28 ♔h1 g6 29 ♕g4 ♕xg4 30 ♘xg4, with more material and a considerable advantage.

26 ♕g8+ ♔e7 27 ♕xh7+ ♔d6

27...♔f8 is similar: 28 ♕g8+ ♔e7 29 ♕f7+ ♔d6 and the attack on the black king is winning; e.g., 30 e5+ ♔xe5 31 d4+ ♔xd4 32 ♕xf6+ ♔c5 33 ♖c1+ ♗c4 34 ♖xc4+ ♔b5 35 ♕f1, and White wins.

28 e5+! ♔xe5

If 28...fxe5 then 29 ♘f5+! ♔c5 30 ♖c1+ ♗c4 (or 30...♔b5 31 ♕xc7 ♘xc7 32 ♗xc6#) 31 ♖xc4+ ♔b5 32 ♗xc6+ ♔a6 (or 32...♕xc6 33 a4+) 33 ♗b5+ wins, while 28...♔c5 loses to 29 ♖c1+ ♗c4 30 ♖xc4+ ♔b5 31 ♗xc6+.

29 d4+! ♖xd4

After 29...♔xd4 30 ♖d1+ ♔c3 31 ♖c1+ White forces mate.

30 ♘f7+ ♕xf7 31 ♕xf7 ♖dd8 32 ♖e1+ ♔d6 33 ♕xf6 ♗c8 34 ♕e5+ ♔d7 35 ♗h3 1-0

953) Torán – Filip
Skopje Olympiad 1972

21 ♕e1!

The idea is to infiltrate via the weakened dark squares on the kingside, which Black is unable to defend satisfactorily, and then attack Black's king, which is more or less stuck in the centre.

21...♗d5 22 ♕h4 ♕b7

22...h5 fails to hold up the queen's progress: 23 ♕g5.

23 ♕h6! ♘g8

After 23...♗xg2 24 ♕g7! ♗xf1 25 ♕h8+ ♘f8 26 ♕xf8+ ♔d7 the quickest way to mate starts with 27 ♗xe6+ ♔c7 28 ♖c1+.

24 ♕xh7 ♘e7 25 ♘xe6! 1-0

If 25...♗xe6 (or 25...fxe6 26 ♕xe7#), 26 ♗xe6 soon forces mate.

954) Polugaevsky – Ree
Amsterdam 1981

70 ♔a2??

This is the decisive error. Now the king remains merely vulnerable, whereas on a3 the king at least had chances to defend actively with an eventual ♔b4 when Black moves his king. White draws with **70 ♖a6!** (or **70 ♖a5!**); e.g., 70...♔c2 71 ♖h6! (switching to defending with checks from the side) 71...♖g3+ 72 ♔b4 (72 ♔a2 is also good enough, and simpler) 72...c3, and now? The tablebase indicates that the only move to draw is 73 ♔a3!!; for example, 73...♖g2 74 ♔a2.

70...♔c2

Now the a8-rook can't move because of the mate, and the white king is unable to help the defence, so there is nothing to prevent Black from reaching the winning Lucena position.

71 ♔a1 c3 72 ♔a2 ♖b7 73 ♖a6 ♖d7 74 ♖a8 ♔d2 0-1

955) Høi – Gulko
Thessaloniki Olympiad 1988

25 ♖xg7!! ♔xg7

25...♘xg7 is met by 26 ♗xh6 f5 27 ♗xg7+ ♔xg7 28 ♖g1+ ♔f7 29 ♘g5+ ♔e7 30 ♘xe6!, with threats of 31 ♖e1, 31 ♖g7+ or 31 ♕xf5, with a winning attack.

26 ♗xh6+!

Better than 26 ♖g1+ ♔f8 27 ♗xh6+?! (27 ♕e3! is still better for White) 27...♔e7 and the king escapes.

26...♔xh6 27 ♖g1!

27 ♕e3+?! is inaccurate in view of 27...♔g7 28 ♕g5+ ♔f8.

27...f5

27...♘f4 loses to 28 ♘g5! f5 29 ♕e3.

28 ♕e3+ f4

Or 28...♔h7 29 ♕g5 ♘g3+ 30 fxg3 ♖g8 31 ♕h5+ ♔g7 32 gxh4+ with a decisive attack.

29 ♘xd6!! ♕xd6

Black gets mated after 29...fxe3? 30 ♘f7# or 29...♘g3+ 30 ♖xg3 fxe3 31 ♘f7+ ♔h5 32 ♖g5#.

30 ♕d3 ♘f8

30...♘g3+ loses to 31 ♖xg3 ♘f8 32 ♖g6+ ♔h5 33 ♖f6 ♕e7 34 ♖xf8 ♕g7 35 ♖xe8 ♖xe8 36 ♕xb5+ and 37 ♕xe8.

31 ♕h7+! 1-0

31...♘xh7 allows 32 ♖g6#. A brilliantly conducted attack, don't you think?

956) Illescas – Short

Linares 1995

30 ♖xe7!

30 ♕b4 is ineffective on account of 30...♘c6! 31 ♖xc6 bxc6 32 ♗xc4 dxc4 33 bxc6 ♖c7.

30...♕xe7

If 30...♘xd2 White plays 31 ♖cc7 ♘e4 32 f3, eliminating the defender of f6, and wins.

31 ♗xc4 dxc4 32 ♖xc4 ♕xa3 33 ♖c7

Material is now level, and Black will create a dangerous passed pawn, but White has a winning position because the enemy king is unprotected, and his only remaining task is to discover the most effective way of attacking it.

33...♕f8

After 33...♔g8 the white queen decisively joins the attack with 34 ♘f6+ ♔f8 35 ♘h7+ ♔g8 36 ♕d1!.

34 ♕a2

The tempting 34 ♕b4?? fails to 34...♕xb4 35 ♘f6 ♕b1+ 36 ♔h2 f4, and the queen controls h7.

34...a3

After 34...♕g8 there are many good lines, such as 35 ♕a3 ♘f7 36 ♕e7 ♖f8 37 ♕f6+ ♔h7 38 ♕xe6.

35 ♘f6 ♘f7 36 ♕xe6 a2 37 ♕xf7! 1-0

Mate is unstoppable.

957) Granda – Kamsky

Donner Memorial, Amsterdam 1996

23 ♕h4!

After this queen manoeuvre, the concentration of forces against Black's kingside is overwhelming and there is no defence.

23...e5

Trying to gain some activity by increasing the scope of the queen and the c8-bishop. If 23...♘d7 Granda pointed out the following finish: 24 ♖xd7! ♗xd7 25 ♘e7+ ♔h8 26 ♗xg7+ ♔xg7 27 ♕g5+ ♔h8 28 ♕f6#. 23...♗d7 is no better and is refuted with a standard manoeuvre: 24 ♗xf6 gxf6 25 ♕xf6 ♗xc6 26 ♖d4! h5 27 ♕g5+, mating quickly.

24 ♗xe5 ♗d7

After 24...♘g4 White has a different winning manoeuvre: 25 ♘e7+ ♔h8 26 ♗c6, while 24...♕e6 is met by 25 ♖d6 ♕g4 26 ♖xf6! ♕xh4 27 ♘e7+ ♔h8 28 gxh4 ♗b4 29 ♘xc8 gxf6 30 ♗xf6+ ♔g8 31 ♘xa7, with a decisive material advantage.

25 ♗xf6 gxf6 26 ♗e4 h6 27 ♖xd7! ♕xd7 28 ♕xh6 f5 29 ♗xf5! 1-0

958) P. Rodríguez – Franco

Capablanca Memorial, Cienfuegos 1997

19...♘xd5!

Black rids himself of his passive knight and occupies the e-file advantageously, in addition to leaving White's structure damaged, with several weak pawns.

20 exd5 e4 21 ♖fe1

21 ♗xe4 ♗xe2 22 ♖fe1 is also insufficient to equalize after 22...♖fe8 23 fxg6 (23 ♖xe2 ♖xe4 24 h3 {or 24 fxg6 ♖xg4+ 25 ♔f2 hxg6} 24...♖ae8 25 ♔f2 gxf5 26 gxf5 ♖4e5) 23...hxg6 24 ♗xg6 ♖xe3 25 ♔f2 ♗d3!, winning material in every case.

21...exf3 22 ♘f4 gxf5 23 gxf5 ♖fe8

Threatening 24...♖e5.

24 ♘e6 ♖a4! 25 ♖ad1 ♗e2 26 ♔f2

26 ♖d2 is met by 26...♖g4+! 27 ♔h1 ♖e4.

26...♗xd1

and Black won.

959) Michenka – Hagara

Trinec 1998

23 ♗f8!!

This spectacular move wins for White, who threatens mate on g7. After 23 ♖af1? Black draws with 23...♗xg2! and now the only move is 24 h4!, with a draw after 24...♕xh4 25 ♖xg2 ♖xg2+ 26 ♔xg2 ♕g5+ 27 ♔h2 ♕h5+.

23...♖2e5

Black is forced to reduce the pressure on g2; after 23...♕e5? White wins with 24 ♖xe2 ♕xc3 25 bxc3 ♖xe2 26 gxh3 ♔xf8 27 c7 ♖e8, and now both 28 ♖d1! and 28 ♖b1! win. 23...♖8e5? loses to 24 ♖xe2, and 23...♔xf8 to 24 ♕h8+ ♔e7 25 ♖xe2+, and finally 23...f6 to 24 ♕c4+.

24 ♗d6! ♖e3

Now White played **25 ♗f4?!** and went on to win, but a cleaner solution was **25 ♕d2**, defending the first and second ranks and threatening 26 ♗f4. White is then clearly winning.

960) Vallejo – Draško
Saint Vincent 1999

21 h5!

This exchange sacrifice gives White a very strong attack.

21...♘d2 22 ♕f2!

The apparently more direct 22 ♕g4?! fails to 22...♗c8!, and after 23 ♗f5 ♘xf1 24 ♖xf1 ♗xf5 25 ♕xf5 ♘f8 Black's king's position is solid and he has the advantage.

22...♘f8

If 22...♘xf1 23 hxg6 ♗xe5 24 fxe5 ♘xg3?! then 25 gxf7+ ♕xf7 26 ♗xh7+! ♔f8 27 ♕xg3, with a winning position for White on account of the situation of the black king.

22...♘h8 is likely to be a computer's choice, but 23 ♗h4 f6 24 ♘g3 ♘xf1 25 ♖xf1 ♕c7 26 ♘g4 gives White a strong attack. After 26...♘f7 27 ♘f5, intending ♕g3, the threats against the black king are highly potent.

23 ♗h4 f6 24 ♘g3! ♘xf1

After 24...♕c7 25 ♕xd2 fxe5 26 fxe5 ♗e7 27 ♗xe7 ♖xe7 28 ♘f5 White is easily winning, with a material advantage and the attack.

25 ♖xf1 ♕c7

25...♗c8, controlling f5, is met by 26 ♕f3 ♕b7 27 h6, with an attack that more than compensates for the sacrificed material.

26 ♘f5!

26 h6! fxe5 27 fxe5 is also possible.

26...fxe5 27 fxe5

For the moment Black is a whole rook up, but it is impossible to maintain it.

27...♗e7

If 27...♗xe5 28 dxe5 ♖xe5?! then 29 ♕g3 is devastating. For instance, 29...♖ae8 30 ♗f6!? ♖5e7 31 ♘xe7+ ♖xe7 32 ♗xe7! ♕xe7 33 ♕b8.

28 ♘h6+ ♔h8 29 ♕f7 ♘e6?

Almost out of time, Black allows a mate. After the forced 29...gxh6 30 ♗f6+ ♗xf6 31 ♕xc7 ♖e7 32 ♕d6 ♗g5 Black is worse but can still fight.

30 ♕g8+! 1-0

961) Castillo Gallego – Ruiz Jiménez
Mancha Real 2001

22...♘c5?

Black needs to keep a cool head and play **22...♕xe5!**, which opens lines but allows the queen to assist the defence; e.g., 23 ♕xc6 (or 23 ♕g6+ ♔d8! 24 ♖fe1 ♕xe1+! 25 ♖xe1 ♗xa3 and White, behind on material, has to fight for a draw, which can be achieved with 26 ♖d1 ♔c7 27 ♕d3 ♖hd8 28 ♕g3+! ♔b7 29 ♕xc3) 23...0-0! 24 ♕xd7 (or 24 ♖ae1 ♗xa3 25 ♖xe5 ♘xe5 26 ♕e6+ ♘f7 27 ♕g6+ ♔h8 28 ♕f6+ drawing) 24...♗xa3 25 ♖xa3 ♖ac8, and the passed pawn gives Black some advantage.

23 ♕xc6+

Another way is 23 ♗xc5 ♕xc5 24 ♖ad1!, threatening 25 ♕g6+ ♔f8 26 e6. Now 24...♕b4, with the idea of ...♕f4, loses to 25 f4!, amongst other things.

23...♔f7 24 ♗xc5 ♕xc5?

Now mate is forced, but 24...♗xc5 also loses, to 25 e6+ ♔f6 26 ♖ad1 ♕e5 27 e7+ ♕e6 28 ♕xc5.

25 ♕g6+ ♔f8 26 e6 1-0

962) J. González – Almagro
Mancha Real 2001

The black king is badly placed and White, a pawn up, is threatening mate, but with so little material left on the board Black has enough defensive resources...

69...g4?

...but not after this move, which results by force in a lost ending. Instead, **69...♖e4+!** allows Black to steer the game towards a draw. After 70 ♔d7 (if 70 ♔f7 then 70...♖f4 71 ♖b5 ♖a4 regains the pawn) 70...♖a4! 71 ♔xd8 ♖xa5 Black manages to exchange the remaining pawns, reaching a drawn endgame of rook and knight against rook; e.g., 72 ♘e3 ♖a8+ 73 ♔e7 ♔h4 or 72 ♘d6 ♖d5 (72...♖a3 73 ♘e4 g4 is also good) 73 ♔c7 ♖d3.

70 ♖h7+ ♔g5 71 ♖g7+ ♔h5 72 hxg4+ ♖xg4 73 ♖xg4 ♔xg4 74 a6 ♗b6 75 ♘d6 ♔f4 76 ♔d5 ♗a7 77 ♘c8 1-0

The pawn queens after 77...♗f2 78 ♔c6 ♔e5 79 ♘b6.

963) M. Gurevich – Vallejo
Spanish Team Ch, Mondariz 2002

With 30 ♔h1?! White can aspire to no more than equality: 30...♘g3+! 31 ♔g1 (31 ♔h2 ♘h5!) 31...♘e2+, while if 30 ♔h2?! Black can play 30...♗g6 31 ♘f6+ ♔h8 32 ♘xe8 ♖xe8, when 33 ♕g5? loses to 33...♕xd6+.

The game continued **30 ♖xe2? ♖xe2!** (not 30...♗xe2? 31 ♘f6+ ♕xf6 32 ♕xf6 ♖e6 33 ♕g5+ ♖g6 34 ♕xc5) **31 ♘f4 ♖e6 32 ♘xe6 fxe6 33 ♕xe6+ ♔h8 0-1**.

Instead, the unusual **30 ♔f2!!** gives White a big advantage, threatening 31 ♘f6+ ♔h8 32

♘xe8 ♖xe8 33 ♕f6+ ♔g8 34 ♕xf7+ ♔h8 35 ♕g7#. Then:

a) If 30...♘xc1? then 31 ♘f6+ ♔h8 32 ♘h5, mating.

b) 30...♗g6 31 ♘f6+ ♔h8 32 ♘xe8 ♖xe8 33 ♕g5 and now, in contrast to 30 ♔h2, 33...♕xd6? is not check.

c) 30...g3+ 31 ♔e3!! c4 32 ♖xc4! ♗g6 33 ♘f6+ ♔h8 34 ♘xe8 ♖xe8 35 ♔xe2 ♖xe7+ 36 dxe7 ♕xe7+ 37 ♔f3 and White wins.

d) 30...♔h8 is strongly met by 31 ♕f6+ ♔g8 32 ♖xc5; e.g., 32...♕b8 33 ♘c7 ♖xe7 34 dxe7 ♖c8 35 ♖g5+ ♗g6 36 ♖d5!.

964) Franco – L. Domínguez

Spanish Team Ch, Mondariz 2008

34...h5!!

Not 34...♔d4? on account of 35 ♔f7 g5 (moving the other pawn is no use either: 35...h5 36 ♔xg7 h4 37 ♔g6) 36 ♔g7 h5 37 ♔g6 ♔c4 38 ♔xh5 ♔b3 39 ♔xg5 ♔xa3 40 h4 and White wins.

35 ♔f5

If 35 ♔f7 then 35...h4! (not 35...g5?, which loses to 36 ♔g6) 36 ♔xg7 ♔f3 37 b5 ♔g2 38 a4 ♔xh2 39 a5 h3 40 b6 axb6 41 axb6 ♔g2, with a draw.

½-½

There are no winning chances; e.g., 35...♔d4 36 ♔g5 ♔c4 37 ♔xh5 ♔b3 38 ♔g6 ♔xa3 39 ♔xg7 ♔xb4 40 h4 a5 and the position of the white king on g7 prevents him from winning.

965) Estremera – Sedina

Genoa 2004

47...♖xg4!!

47...♗f3+? does not draw: 48 ♔f2 ♖xg4 (or 48...♖h3 49 ♖e7 ♗xg4 50 ♖e8+ ♔h7 51 ♘g5+ ♔xh6 52 ♘xh3 ♗xh3 53 ♖h8+) 49 ♔xf3 ♖h4 50 ♖g6 ♔h7 51 ♘f8+ ♔h8 52 h7.

48 ♖xg4 ♗f5 49 ♖a4 ♗xe6 50 ♔e3 d4+ 51 ♔f4 d3 52 ♔g5 d2 53 ♖d4 ♗a2 54 ♖d8+ ♔h7 55 ♖xd2

In order to win such an endgame of rook and rook's pawn vs bishop, the stronger side's pawn must not be as far advanced as it is here, so this position is a draw. A recent example is Mecking-Kasimdzhanov, Wijk aan Zee 2009.

55...♗b1 56 ♖d7+ ♔h8 57 h7 ♗xh7 58 ♔h6 ♗g8 59 ♖d8 ½-½

966) Kariakin – Felgaer

Dos Hermanas 2005

This ending is a draw, but Black's defence would be simpler if he didn't have his h-pawn, as we shall see.

81...♖g6+?

This check loses. Although it is hard to believe, the clearest way to draw is by **81...♖g7!** 82 ♖a8+ ♖g8 (if the black king emerges from its prison immediately with 82...♔h7?? it walks into a mate after 83 ♗e4+ ♔h6 84 ♔f6!) and now if, for instance, 83 ♖a4 ♖g4 84 ♗e4, then 84...♔g7 and the king escapes from its precarious position.

82 ♔f5 ♖d6

After this, Black's rook remains separated from its king and White wins easily, but by now the position is lost in any case: if 82...♖g7 then 83 ♗f7! keeps the king incarcerated; e.g., 83...♔h7 84 ♔f6 ♔h6 85 ♖a5 and the black pawn rules out the typical stalemate defence with 85...♖g6+.

83 ♗e6 ♖b6 84 ♔f6 ♖b1 1-0

967) Kožul – Bologan

Sarajevo 2005

43 ♖a1??

This logical move loses, as do 43 ♕c8? ♕xe7, 43 ♖c1? ♖xh3+ 44 gxh3 ♕xh3+ 45 ♔g1 ♕g4+ 46 ♔h1 ♘e2 and 43 ♖f1? ♖xh3+! 44 gxh3 ♕xh3+ 45 ♔g1 ♕g3+ 46 ♔h1 ♕h4+ 47 ♔g2 ♕g4+ 48 ♔h2 ♘e2! 49 ♖f3 and now the simplest win is 49...h5!, threatening 50...♕g1+ 51 ♔h3 ♕h1#.

The correct path for White is **43 ♔h2!!** ♕f2 44 ♔h1! and the game is drawn after 44...♕h4 or 44...♖xh3+ 45 gxh3 ♕f3+.

43...♖xh3+!! 44 gxh3 ♕xh3+

The cooperation between the queen and the knight is very powerful and there is no defence.

45 ♔g1 ♕g4+ 46 ♔h1

Or 46 ♔f2 ♕f3+ 47 ♔g1 ♘e2+ 48 ♔h2 ♕g3+ 49 ♔h1 ♕h3#.

46...♘f3 0-1

968) A. Zubarev – Lechtynsky

Pardubice 2006

22 ♕h5!!

With this wonderful move White is able to highlight the fact that the black king is poorly defended. The threat is 23 ♕xh7+.

22...gxh5

If 22...♔g8 then 23 ♖xg6+ hxg6 24 ♕xg6+ ♔h8 25 ♕h5+ ♔g8 26 ♘g4 and it will be mate

in a few moves; White is threatening, for instance, 27 ♘gh6+ ♗xh6 28 ♕g6+ with a forced checkmate.

23 ♗d1!

This is the key; the bishop fulfils the same function as the queen, thanks to the knight on f5 and the rook on g3. Once again mind triumphs over matter, something that does not happen often, but when it does, it fills the chessboard with its beauty.

23...♗xd5

There is no way out with 23...♗g7 24 ♖xg7+ ♔f8 on account of 25 ♗h6, threatening ♖g3+ and ♗xh5#.

24 exd5 1-0

Despite his great superiority material, Black is completely lost.

969) Mamedyarov – I. Sokolov

Hoogeveen 2006

49 ♔c4?

This logical-looking move throws away the win. The correct option is **49 f5!** gxf5 (or 49...♔d7 50 h5 with a final sequence similar to the main line) 50 gxf5 b3 51 ♔c3 ♔d5 and now the h-pawn is the one to queen after the manoeuvre 52 e6! fxe6 53 f6! gxf6 54 h5, and Black's pawns act as a barrier to their own king.

49...b3 50 ♔xb3 ♔d5 51 g5 ♔e6 52 ♔c4 ♔e7 53 ♔b5 f6?

The way to draw is with 53...♔e6! 54 ♔c5 ♔e7, and White is unable to create a passed pawn or infiltrate with his king.

54 gxf6+ gxf6 55 ♔c5

But now White has a passed pawn once again.

55...♔e6 56 ♔d4 ♔d7

Or 56...♔f5 57 ♔d5.

57 ♔d5 ♔e7 58 e6 ♔d8 59 ♔d6 ♔e8 60 e7 1-0

The finish might be 60...f5 61 ♔e6 g5 62 fxg5 f4 63 g6 f3 64 g7 f2 65 g8♕#.

970) Y. Vovk – Bobras

Cappelle la Grande 2007

Black has two possible ways to win: one is by capturing the white pawns, but since he has the 'wrong' bishop with respect to the queening square of the pawn, he has at the same time to prevent the white king from reaching h1.

The other way to win is to stalemate White's king, thus forcing him to play g5 whereupon Black's h-pawn turns into a g-pawn, while also releasing the stalemate. To illustrate this, let's imagine a position with the black king on c4, the bishop on b4, and the white king on a4. With White to play, White would be in zugzwang, but if it were Black's turn the game would be a draw.

One of the famous examples of successful defence in this type of endgame is Korchnoi-Karpov, World Ch match (game 5), Baguio City 1978.

85...♔c5!

The natural 85...♔d5? allows White to find a route to safety:

a) The above explanation becomes clearer if White errs with 86 ♔d7?, which loses after 86...♔e4 87 ♔e6 ♔f4 88 ♔d5 ♔xg4 89 ♔e4 ♗c5! (cutting off the white king's route to h1) 90 ♔d3 ♔xh5 91 ♔e2 ♔g4 92 ♔f1 ♔f3 and again the white king remains outside the drawing zone and so the h-pawn queens.

b) The correct path is 86 ♔b6! ♔e4 87 ♔b5 ♗d6 88 ♔c4 ♔f3 89 ♔d3 ♗c5 90 ♔d2 ♗e3+ 91 ♔d3 and White has made no progress, as the tablebases confirm.

86 ♔d7 ♔d5! 87 ♔c7 ♔e4 88 ♔c6 ♔f4 89 ♔d5 ♔xg4 90 ♔d4

If 90 ♔e4 then 90...♗c5! and the white king can't reach h1.

Returning to the game, now the immediate 90...♔xh5? allows the king to get back without any problems: 91 ♔e3 ♔g4 92 ♔f2, and draws.

90...♗c5+! 0-1

This pretty sacrifice prevents the white king from reaching the safe zone: 91 ♔xc5 (91 ♔e4 ♗b6! leaves the white king in zugzwang; e.g., 92 ♔d3 ♔xh5 93 ♔e2 ♔g4 94 ♔f1 ♔f3) 91...♔xh5 92 ♔d4 ♔g4 93 ♔e3 ♔g3 94 ♔e2 ♔g2, and Black wins.

971) Shomoev – Kurnosov

Russian Ch, Krasnoiarsk 2007

Black should have resigned many moves ago, but he kept playing, and White assumed, prematurely, that the point was in the bag. It is a relatively simple win in fact, but the position is not one where 'anything wins', as we shall see.

73 ♔f7??

The only way to win is **73 h6!**, with the possible continuation 73...♖f2+ 74 ♔e6 ♖e2+ 75 ♔d6 ♖d2+ (since White is threatening to win by moving his rook to the eighth rank, all Black can do is either keep checking or move his own rook to his back rank) 76 ♔c5 ♖d8 77 ♖f7 ♖c8+ (if 77...♔g8 then there is the nice shot 78

h7+! ♔xh7 79 ♖f8) 78 ♔d6 ♖d8+ 79 ♔c7, followed by 80 ♖f8, and White wins.

73...♖f2+ 74 ♔e8 ♔g8!

White was threatening to win with 75 ♖f7.

75 h6

75 ♔d7 ♖h2 is a draw.

75...♖f6 76 h7+ ♔xh7 77 ♖f7 ♖a6 ½-½

972) S. Novikov – Yakovenko

Moscow 2007

With correct defence by White, the game reaches a position analysed by Keres, one of reciprocal zugzwang. After an exhausting defence under enemy pressure, White succeeded admirably in finding the only moves to defend.

74 ♖b4!

The nervous check 74 ♖b2+? loses after 74...♔f3, followed by ...♖e2+.

74...h4!? 75 ♖f4+!

A vital zwischenzug. Here 75 ♖xg4? is bad on account of 75...hxg3+ 76 ♔h3 ♖f3!, and White loses, because now any rook move along the g-file is answered by ...♖f6 or ...♖f7, as appropriate; e.g., 77 ♖g8 ♖f7! and Black wins. Note that the attempted stalemate with 77 ♖f4 loses here to 77...g2+.

75...♖f3 76 ♖xg4 hxg3+ 77 ♔h3

We have reached the same position as at move 76 in the previous note, but this time with Black to move; as we shall see, this makes a big difference. Now Black tries a couple of waiting moves, before going back to the f-file.

77...♖e3 78 ♖g8 ♖d3 79 ♖g7 ♖f3 80 ♖g4!

The only move, bringing about the same position as at move 77.

80...♖f8

and here, thanks to 80 ♖g4, Black has...

81 ♖f4+!

Exactly according to Keres's analysis.

81...♖xf4 ½-½

973) Morozevich – Aronian

Morelia/Linares 2007

Black is two pawns up, but his pieces are dangerously distant from the kingside.

It is the eternal struggle between an enduring advantage, such as extra material, and a temporary advantage, such as an attack, which is ephemeral and has to be exploited right away.

38 ♖f3?!

White misses his first chance. He can win with a beautiful but well-hidden manoeuvre: **38 ♕d8+** ♔g7 39 f6+ ♔h6 40 ♔h4!! (by using the king as an attacking piece, White prevents the black king's escape via g5 or h5 and threatens 41 ♕f8#) 40...♕xd4+ 41 g4 ♕b4 (to prevent 42 ♕f8#, but...) 42 ♕f8+!! ♕xf8 43 g5#.

38...♖f1?! 39 fxg6?

There is not always a second chance, either in life or on the chessboard. White misses this one too. It is still possible to play 39 ♕d8+ ♔g7 40 f6+ ♔h6 and here the same idea, which possibly was what Morozevich overlooked: 41 ♔h4!! ♕e1+ 42 g3 ♕e4+ 43 g4 ♕e1+ 44 ♖g3 and there is no satisfactory defence against 45 ♕f8#.

39...♖xf3+ 40 ♕xf3

40 gxf3 hxg6 is similar to the game, in that the exposed position of the white king, and Black's three pawns for the piece, prevent any serious winning attempt.

40...♕e1+

Not 40...♕xd4?? 41 ♕xf7+ ♔h8 42 ♕xh7#.

41 ♔f4

41 ♔h2 ♕e5+ 42 g3 hxg6 is not very promising either.

41...hxg6 42 ♕xd5 ♕f2+ 43 ♘f3 ½-½

In view of 43...♕xg2, a draw was agreed. The same result is reached after 43 ♔e5 ♕g3+ 44 ♔f6 ♕h4+ with perpetual check, or 43 ♔g4 a4.

974) Franco – Sánchez Aller

Villagarcía 2007

White's position seems to be on the verge of defeat. His extra pawn matters less than Black's two passed pawns on a4 and d4. The threat is, amongst other things, 58...d3, followed by ...d2+, ...♗xf3+, etc., while 58 ♗xg7 loses to 58...a3 and the a-pawn is the one to queen.

58 ♔d1!

The only move to hold the position, found by elimination. It prevents the main threat of 58...♔c2!, after which one of the black pawns would queen, making any other consideration of secondary importance.

58...g6?

Black is reluctant to accept a draw, since this is a team competition and he has to win, but he can't see how and so he ends up losing. The obvious 58...d3! is the most dangerous try, but not enough to win after 59 c8♕+ ♗xc8 60 ♗xg7 d2 61 ♗h6! (not 61 ♗xf6+? ♔d3, when Black threatens both 62...♗b7 and to queen the a-pawn, and wins after 62 ♗g5 a3 63 ♗xd2 a2) 61...a3 62 ♗xd2+ ♔b3 63 ♗e3 ♔c3 and now

64 ♗d2+ is best, with a draw. Instead, 64 ♔c1? a2 65 ♗d4+ ♔xd4 66 ♔b2 provides losing chances only; e.g., 66...♔c5 67 h4 ♔xb6 68 g5 (or 68 h5 ♗e6 69 h6 ♗g8 70 f4 ♗h7! 71 g5 {71 f5 loses to 71...♔c7 72 g5 fxg5 73 f6 ♔d7, arriving just in time} 71...f5 and Black wins) 68...f5 69 h5 f4 70 g6 ♗f5 71 ♔xa2 ♔c5.

58...♔d3? does not work either: 59 ♗xg7 a3 60 ♔c1 a2 61 ♔b2 ♔e2 62 ♗xf6 d3 63 ♗g5 d2 64 ♗xd2 ♔xd2 65 g5, and White wins.

Finally, 58...♗xf3+? even leads to a win for White after 59 ♔c1 ♗b7 60 ♗xg7 a3 61 ♔b1 d3 62 ♗xf6+ ♔b3 63 ♗g5 ♔c3 64 h4.

59 ♗e7 f5?!

This makes White's task easier, but by now there is no defence.

60 gxf5 gxf5 61 f4 ♔d3

If 61...d3, 62 ♗f6+! wins.

62 h4 ♔e4 63 h5 1-0

975) J. Polgar – Bareev

Candidates match (game 5), Elista 2007

25 ♖xg7!

White exploits the fact that the black queen is a long way from the kingside to launch a quick mating attack. It is noteworthy that the knight on c3 takes no direct part in the struggle but does in fact contribute indirectly, both by obstructing the black queen's defence of e5 and also, as we shall see, by controlling the b1-square.

25...♔xg7 26 ♕h6+ ♔g8

After 26...♔f7 27 ♖b1 Black must give up his queen, a testament to the c3-knight's supporting role in the attack.

27 g6! hxg6 28 ♕xg6+ ♔h8 29 ♔h1!

This is the last important move that White needs to calculate; the knight can't attack, but bringing the rook into play proves decisive.

29...♖f4

29...♕d2 loses to 30 ♕xh5+ ♔g7 31 ♖g1+ ♔f6 32 ♕f5+ ♔e7 33 ♖g7+ ♔d6 34 ♖d7+ ♔c5 35 ♕xe5+.

30 ♕xh5+ ♔g8 31 ♖g1+ ♔f8 32 ♕h8+ ♔f7 33 ♕g7+ 1-0

If 33...♔e8 then 34 ♕xe5+ wins quickly.

976) Salinas – Fariña

Asunción 2007

1 ♖xf8+!

1 ♕h6? only leads to a draw: 1...♖f1+! 2 ♗xf1 ♖xf1+ 3 ♔g2 ♕e2+ 4 ♔h3 ♕e6+.

1...♔xf8

1...♔g7 prevents mate, but Black remains a piece down after 2 ♖e8.

2 ♕h6+ ♔e8

2...♔e7 is no better, since 3 ♖d7+ ♔e8 transposes to the next note.

3 ♖e1+?

White fails to find the win that is available with **3 ♖d8+!!** ♔xd8 (or 3...♔e7 4 ♕f8#) 4 ♕f8+ ♔c7 5 ♕e7+ ♔b6 (5...♔b8 6 ♕d8# is shorter) 6 ♕d8+ ♔b5 7 ♕a5#.

3...♖e6

and Black won quickly.

977) Ljubojević – Smeets

Amsterdam 2007

There are two moves which draw, and a 'normal' move which is in fact bad.

85 ♔e5?

White plays the 'normal' move, which is to approach with his king, but it loses. White can draw with **85 ♔d7!** and after 85...♔xc5 86 ♖b1! White prevents the black king from advancing; if now 86...♖h7+ 87 ♔e6 ♖h6+, White has to go back with 88 ♔d7!, and Black is unable to make progress. Similarly, **85 ♔c7!** also draws.

85...♔xc5 86 ♔e4

If now 86 ♖b1 Black cuts off the white king and shelters his king from checks with 86...♖h4! 87 ♖c1+ ♖c4 88 ♖b1 ♖b4 89 ♖c1+ ♔b5, etc. We can see clearly from this that the white king fulfils no positive function on e5, as it would on d7 or c7.

86...♔c4! 87 ♔e3 ♔c3

Another typical method is to cut off the defending king horizontally with 87...♖h2 88 ♖b1 ♖c2! followed by ...c5, but not 88...c5?? 89 ♖c1+ ♔b4 90 ♔d3, with a draw.

88 ♖c7 ♖e6+ 89 ♔f4 ♔c4! 90 ♔f5 ♖h6 91 ♔e4 c5 92 ♔e3 ♖d6 93 ♔e2 ♔b4 94 ♖b7+ ♔c3 95 ♖b1 ♔c2 96 ♖a1 ♖e6+ 97 ♔f3 c4 0-1

978) Illescas – Narciso

Barcelona 2007

In order to win, White must either win the a2-pawn, or capture the rook with check, which White manages to do with a series of precise moves.

46 ♕c3+! f6 47 ♘f5+!

But not 47 ♕g3+? ♔xh6 and White must give perpetual check with 48 ♕e3+ ♔g6 49 ♕d3+ ♔g7 50 ♕g3+.

47...♔g6

47...♔h7 only delays the outcome: 48 ♕c7+ (48 g4 is also good enough) 48...♔g6 49 ♘h4+ ♔h6 50 ♕f4+ ♔g7 51 ♕g3+ ♔f7 52 ♕c7+ ♔e6 53 ♕c4+ and 54 ♕xa2.

48 ♘h4+ ♔g7 49 ♕g3+ ♔h7

49...♔f7 is met by 50 ♕c7+ ♔e6 51 ♕c4+.

50 ♕g6+ ♔h8 51 ♕xf6+ 1-0

If 51...♔g8 then 52 ♕e6+ and 53 ♕xa2.

979) Ibarra – Illescas

Spanish Ch, Ceuta 2008

48 ♕f8?!

Although White is still better after this, he misses a clear win by **48 ♖d7!**, with three pieces in the attack, to which there is no defence:

a) If 48...♔g7 White wins with 49 ♘f5+ ♔g6 (49...♔h7 50 ♕f8) 50 ♕g8+ and the black king is caught in a mating-net; e.g., 50...♔xf5 51 ♕h7+ ♔g5 52 h4+ ♔h5 53 ♕xf7+ ♔xh4 54 ♖d3, soon mating.

b) 48...♗g7 49 ♘f5 (49 ♕e4+ and 49 ♖xf7 are also strong) 49...♕xf2 50 ♖xf7 ♖g6 51 ♕b7.

48...♗g7 49 ♕xf7 ♖f6 50 ♕d5 ♕xf2 51 ♕e4+ ♔g8 52 ♘f5 ♗f8 53 ♕xe5?

White can still play for a win with 53 ♖d3!.

53...f3! 54 ♖g1 ½-½

980) Velasco – Bachmann

Dresden Olympiad 2008

27...♖g3?

After 27...♘xf6? the sacrifice 28 ♖xe6+! is sufficient to draw: 28...fxe6 29 ♕xe6+ ♔d8 30 ♕xf6+ ♔c8 31 ♕e6+ ♔c7 32 ♕e7+ ♔c6 33 ♕e4+ ♔b6 34 ♕e3+! ♔b7 35 ♕e7+ with perpetual check.

Black's best course is to play **27...♔xf6!** and only after 28 ♖xe4 to sacrifice with 28...♖g3! 29 hxg3 (29 ♖xe6+ ♔g7! is winning for Black) 29...hxg3 30 ♔g1 ♖xh3 31 gxh3 ♔e7 (preventing 32 ♔g2? because of 32...f5) 32 f5 ♕d5, with a big advantage; if 33 fxe6 then 33...f5!.

27...♘g3+! is also better than the move in the game and after 28 hxg3 hxg3 29 ♘h7 ♔d8! 30 ♕h4+ (better than 30 ♕h6? ♕d5 31 ♔g1 ♔c7 32 ♖e3 ♕f5) 30...♔c8 31 ♔g1 ♖g7 32 ♖e3 ♕a7!, Black has the safer king.

28 hxg3 ♘xg3+?

Black should play 28...hxg3! 29 ♘xe4 ♖xh3+ 30 gxh3 f5 31 ♔g2 fxe4 32 ♖xe4 ♔d7, and although White has the advantage, Black can still fight on, with possibilities of success.

29 ♔h2 ♘xe2 30 ♕g4!!

This move refutes Black's idea.

30...♘xf4 31 ♕xf4

and White won.

981) Riazantsev – Yandemirov

Moscow 2008

25 ♖d8!!

A lovely move, designed to disrupt the defence and deflect the black rook to an unfavourable square. In order to discover this solution it is essential to delve deeply into the position. 25 g7? does not win: 25...♕xd1+ 26 ♔h2 ♘f5 (defending the g7-square) 27 gxh8♕++ (after 27 ♘h5? ♕xh5+ 28 ♕xh5 ♗xg7 Black has a big material advantage) 27...♔xh8 28 ♘h5 (28 ♕f6+ ♔g8 is not an improvement) and here there is only one saving move, viz. 28...f6!!. Then:

a) 29 exf6? is bad: 29...♕d6+ 30 g3 ♕c7 31 ♗g7+ ♔g8 and the discovered check is not only harmless, but it does not even save the position.

b) Also bad is 29 ♗g7+? ♔g8 30 ♘xf6+ ♔f7 and Black remains a piece up.

c) After 29 ♘xf6 Black can draw by 29...♕d8 30 ♘xe8 ♕xe8 31 ♕f6+ ♔g8 with perpetual check.

d) 29 ♕xf6+ is a forced draw after 29...♔g8 30 ♕g5+ ♔f7! 31 ♕f6+ ♔g8 32 ♕g5+, with perpetual check.

25...♖xd8 26 g7! ♖d1+?!

This places the rook out of harm's way but also weakens Black's back rank. 26...♕d1+ 27 ♔h2 ♘f5 is preferable, although now White wins by 28 gxh8♕++ ♔xh8 29 ♘h5 f6 30 ♗g7+ ♔g8 31 ♗xf6+ ♔f7 32 ♗xd8, with a strong attack; this shows one of the points of 25 ♖d8!!.

27 ♔h2 ♘f5 28 gxh8♕++ ♔xh8 29 ♘h5 f6 30 ♕xf6+ ♔g8 31 ♕f8# (1-0)

982) Groetz – Segers

Leiden 2008

12 ♘f5!

This is a typical sacrifice in the Sicilian, in this case designed to open both the diagonal of the b3-bishop and the e-file, where a white rook is already situated. The immediate 12 ♕xg7?! fails to 12...♖g8 13 ♕h6 b4 14 ♘a4 ♖g6 15 ♕h3 ♘cxe4, while after 12 ♗d5, another typical sacrifice, capturing with 12...exd5? is bad in view of 13 ♕xg7 ♖g8 14 ♘xd5!, winning

material, but after 12...♗b7 White has no good follow-up.

12...exf5?!

Perhaps 12...b4 is more tenacious, although after 13 e5! (to open the d-file) 13...dxe5 14 ♘xg7+ ♔d8 (14...♔f8 15 ♗h6) 15 ♘a4, White is clearly better, since the black king is in a bad way; alternatively 12...♘xb3 13 ♘xg7+ ♔d7 14 cxb3! is very unpleasant for Black.

13 ♕xg7 ♖f8 14 exf5 ♔d8

Or 14...♘xb3 15 axb3 ♔d8 16 ♘xb5 ♖g8 (if 16...♕d7 White wins with 17 ♗g5 ♖g8 18 ♕xf6! ♖xg5 19 ♕h8+ ♕e8 20 ♕xe8+ ♔xe8 21 ♘c7+, and 16...♕c6 17 ♗g5 ♖g8 is no better, since now 18 ♕xf7 is possible) 17 ♘xc7 ♖xg7 18 ♘xa8, and White wins.

15 ♗g5 ♖g8 16 ♕xf6! ♖xg5

Or 16...♗xf6 17 ♗xf6+ ♔d7 18 ♖e7+ ♔c6 19 ♗d5+ ♔b6 20 ♖xc7 ♔xc7 21 ♗xa8.

17 ♕h8+! ♔d7 18 ♘d5 1-0

983) An. Hernández – Patriarca

Paraguayan Ch, Ciudad del Este 2008

White appears to have a won game with his two unstoppable connected passed pawns, but there is a precedent, Keres-Eliskases, Noordwijk 1938, knowledge of which helped Black to achieve a draw:

45...♔f4! 46 g7

Insufficient to win is 46 ♖f7+ ♔e5 47 h7 ♖h1+ 48 ♔g5 ♖g1+ 49 ♔h5 ♖h1+.

46...♔f5

Preventing queening by threatening mate.

47 ♔h4 e1♕+!

Black can't continue in the same vein, since 47...♔f4? loses to 48 ♔h3 ♔f3 49 ♖f7+ and 50 g8♕.

48 ♖xe1 ♖xe1 49 h7

Not 49 ♔g3? ♔f6! and Black wins.

49...♔f4!

Now this works.

50 ♔h3 ♔f3 51 ♔h2 ♖e2+!

This check is vital for achieving the draw.

52 ♔h3 ♖e1 ½-½

984) Kramnik – Aronian

Wijk aan Zee 2008

103...♔f7?

Exhausted by having to conduct a lengthy defence, Black makes a decisive error. The immediate 103...♖a7? loses to 104 h7 ♖xh7 105 ♔e6. In order to draw Black needs to deflect the white king with **103...♖a5+!**, and after 104 ♔c6, only then 104...♖a7!, with the plan of ...♖f7 and ...♔xh6; if the white king moves to the centre, Black draws by checking from the side.

104 ♖h1! ♖a5+ 105 ♔c4 ♖a4+ 106 ♔b5 ♖a8 107 h7 ♖h8 108 ♖h6

Now Black can hardly move, so the white king is able to move across to support the f6-pawn, winning.

108...♖b8+ 109 ♔c6 ♖c8+ 110 ♔d6 1-0

985) Ivanchuk – Topalov

Sofia 2009

Black can draw by perpetual check with 40...♕e2+ 41 ♔b3 ♕c4+, but he found something much stronger:

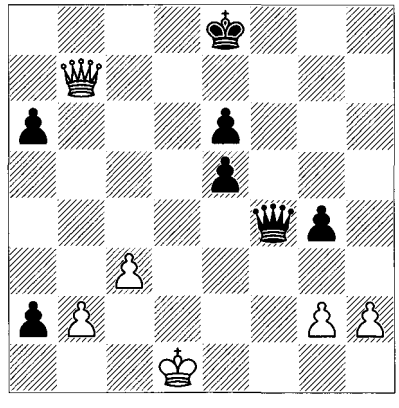
40...b3+!

Cutting off the white king's escape-route.

41 ♔d2

Or 41 axb3 ♕e2+ followed by ...♕xf1+.

41...♖d8+ 42 ♔e1 ♖d1+! 43 ♔xd1 ♕xf1+ 44 ♔d2 ♕f4+ 45 ♔d1 bxa2 *(D)*



This pawn gives Black a winning position. First he improves the position of the queen.

46 ♕c8+ ♔f7 47 ♕d7+ ♔f6

The black king will reach a safe position in the enemy camp.

48 ♕d8+ ♔f5 49 ♕f8+ ♔e4! 50 ♕a8+ ♔d3 51 ♕xa6+ ♕c4 52 ♕a7

After 52 ♕d6+ ♔e4 the checks run out.

52...g3 53 h3

53 hxg3 ♕g4+ 54 ♔c1 ♕g5+ leads to mate.

53...♕b3+ 54 ♔e1 ♔c2 0-1

986) Gashimov – Grishchuk

Grand Prix, Baku 2008

22 ♕h7!

The decisive move; it is important to control the h-file. For example, 22 ♕g7? fails to

22...♕g4! 23 exd5 ♕d4+, and now 24 ♔h1? loses to 24...♗xg5, while after 24 ♔h2? ♗xg5 25 ♕xg5 (25 ♖fa1?? ♕h4+ 26 ♔g1 ♗e3+ and mate next move) 25...♖h8+ 26 ♔g3 ♔xa6 White's king is in a very precarious position, so White has to take a draw with 24 ♖f2 ♕d1+ 25 ♖f1 ♕d4+.

22...♕g4 23 exd5 ♕d4+

23...♗xg5 is met by 24 ♖a7+! ♔xa7 25 ♕xc7+, when Black must give up his queen to prevent mate.

24 ♔h1 ♗xg5 25 ♖fa1 ♗e3 26 ♖a7+ ♕xa7 27 ♖xa7+ ♗xa7 28 g4 ♖f8 29 g5 ♖f2 30 ♕e4 ♖f1+ 31 ♔h2 ♖f4

Black's position is already lost, but this allows a neat finish. Black loses in similar fashion after 31...♖g1 32 g6 ♖g5 33 ♔h3 (intending 34 ♔h4) 33...♗f2 and now, for instance, 34 ♕g4.

32 ♕xf4! exf4 33 c3 1-0

987) Garcia Palermo – Naumann

Mitropa Cup, Olbia 2008

30 ♘xd7?!

This squanders White's advantage for very little reward. 30 ♖e1?! also achieves nothing after 30...♖d2!, forcing 31 ♖f1 ♖xf2! 32 ♖xf2 ♕c1+ 33 ♖f1 ♕e3+ with a draw, but there is a win with **30 ♖f1!!** (overprotecting f2) 30...♖f7 (30...♗d5?? allows mate with 31 ♕h5+) 31 ♘xf3 ♕f5. Now there are two white pieces attacked, but Black's pieces are also weak, and with the manoeuvre 32 ♗e5! ♘d7 (32...♕xf3 loses to 33 ♗xb8) 33 ♗f4, White keeps his material advantage while the black king remains very weak.

30...♘xd7 31 ♗d4 ♕f5 32 ♖e1 ♗d5 33 ♕h4?

It is better to simplify by 33 ♗g7!? ♕f3 34 ♔f1, with equality.

33...♕f3!

and Black won.

988) Wang Hao – Rublevsky

Poikovsky 2008

White sacrificed a piece to reach this attacking position, and we stand at a critical moment.

22 ♖xf8+?

This combination is unsound, and yields a draw at best. The strongest move was **22 ♖1f5!**, threatening 23 ♖xg5+. Then:

a) 22...♕xg2+?! 23 ♕xg2 ♗xg2 24 ♔xg2 ♗e7 (24...♗c5 25 ♖c7!) 25 ♔f3 and Black is paralysed.

b) 22...♗e7?! 23 ♗xg5! ♕xg2+ 24 ♕xg2 ♗xg2 25 ♗xe7 ♗d5 (25...♗h3 is similar) 26 ♖f8+ ♖xf8 27 ♖xf8+ ♔g7 28 ♖f7+ ♔g8 29 ♗xb4 ♗xe6 30 ♖f6 ♗c8 31 ♗c5 d3 32 ♔f2 ♔g7 33 ♔e3 ♖d8 34 ♗d6 and White emerges two pawns up.

c) Black does not seem have anything better than 22...♖h7 23 ♗xb4! ♗g7 (23...♗xb4? loses to 24 ♖xg5+ ♔h8 25 ♖gg7) 24 ♕f2!, and the threat of mate starting with 25 ♖f8+ forces Black to give back the piece, with advantage to White after 24...♕xe6 25 ♖xb7, although Black can continue to fight.

22...♖xf8 23 ♖xf8+ ♔xf8 24 ♕f2+ ♔e8 25 ♕f7+ ♔d8 26 e7+ ♔c8 27 ♕f8+?

It is still possible to seek a draw in the endgame after 27 e8♕+ ♖xe8 28 ♕xe8+ ♔c7 29 ♕e7+ ♔b6 30 ♕d6+ ♕xd6 31 exd6 a5 32 h4!.

27...♔c7 28 e8♘+ ♔b6 29 ♕d6+ ♕xd6 30 ♘xd6 a5 31 ♘f7 ♖e8 32 ♘d6 ♖e6 33 h4 ♗d5 34 hxg5 0-1

989) Salgado – A. Hernández

Padrón 2008

The game is in a critical phase: White has sacrificed two pawns for activity and to deprive the black king of a safe refuge anywhere on the board.

How should Black conduct the defence? There are two main possibilities, either to try to weather the storm or to try to counterattack, even though at the moment Black has fewer forces in play.

23...♕b7?

Black opts for retreat, although this gives a free hand to White, and now he will be unable to defend against White's offensive. 23...♖g8!? is worth considering; e.g., 24 ♖xf6 ♗xf6 25 ♘c4 ♖g2 26 ♘xd6+ ♔e7 27 ♕f1 ♕c6 and now 28 ♗c5! ♖xc2 29 ♘f5++ ♔e8 30 ♘d6+ ♔e7 31 ♘f5++ leads to a draw. However, it is more promising to insert **23...b3!** in order to open up the white king's defences; e.g., 24 axb3 (24 ♘xb3 sidetracks the knight and Black has good play after 24...♕e6 25 ♘d2 a3 26 b3 d5) and now 24...♖g8!, when the black pieces are very active; 25 ♖xf6? loses to 25...♗xf6 26 ♘c4 ♖g2! 27 ♕f1 (or 27 ♘xd6+ ♔e7 28 ♖xd5 ♖xe2) 27...axb3 28 cxb3 ♕e4+.

24 ♘c4

24 ♗g5!? may be even better. If 24...♘d5, threatening both 25...♗xg5 and 25...♘c3+, White has the strong reply 25 ♘c4!.

24...♘e4?! 25 ♘b6

Now White has a big advantage, since there are too many weaknesses in Black's camp.

25...♖a5 26 ♕c4 ♘g5 27 ♕xb4 ♕a6 28 ♗xg5 ♖b5 29 ♕c4 ♖xb2+ 30 ♔xb2 ♕xb6+ 31 ♔a1 ♗xg5 32 ♕xf7+ ♔d8 33 ♕g7 1-0

990) Jakubowski – V. Onishchuk

Najdorf Memorial, Warsaw 2008

71 ♖g3?

Now White's rook will remain passive and the black king will be able to come into play and win the game. Instead, White can draw with **71 ♖c4!** ♔b3 (after 71...d2+ 72 ♔d1 ♔b3 73 ♖c7 ♖a8 White defends by expelling the black king with 74 ♖b7+ ♔c4 75 ♖c7+ ♔d4 76 ♖d7+ ♔e4 77 ♔c2) 72 ♖c7 ♖e8 (Black gains nothing with 72...♖a8 73 ♖b7+ ♔c4 74 ♖a7! ♖e8 75 ♖e7! ♖g8 76 ♖c7+) 73 ♔d1! (now 73 ♖b7+? can be answered with 73...♔a4! 74 ♖a7+ ♔b5) 73...♔b4 74 ♖b7+ ♔c4 (74...♔a5 75 ♖c7) 75 ♖c7+ ♔b3 76 ♖e7 ♔b2!? 77 ♖b7+ ♔a3 78 ♖a7+ ♔b4 79 ♖b7+.

71...d2+ 72 ♔d1 ♔b2! 0-1

This is the big difference: Black's king comes into the game and decides the struggle.

991) Kramnik – Grachev

Tal Memorial (blitz), Moscow 2008

55...♖b1+?

An unnecessary check that leads to Black's defeat. Instead, there is a draw with **55...♖c1!** 56 c8♕+ ♖xc8 57 ♖xc8 ♔d5!, shouldering away the white king, and now Black has a draw by advancing his f-pawn; for example, 58 ♖f8 ♔e4 59 ♔c5 f3 60 ♔c4 ♔e3 61 ♔c3 f2 62 ♔c2 ♔e2.

56 ♔xa5 ♖a1+

Now 56...♖c1 fails to 57 c8♕+ ♖xc8 58 ♖xc8 ♔e5 59 ♖f8 ♔e4 60 ♔b4 (this is a very fast one) 60...f3 61 ♔c3 ♔e3 62 ♖e8+ ♔f2 63 ♔d2, and White wins.

57 ♔b4 ♖b1+ 58 ♔a3 ♖c1 59 c8♕+ ♖xc8 60 ♖xc8 ♔d5 61 ♔b3 ♔d4 62 ♔c2 ♔e3 63 ♔d1 ♔f2 64 ♖f8 f3 65 ♖f7 1-0

992) Ivanchuk – Shirov

Spanish Team Ch, Motril 2008

White is a rook and a piece up and it is even his move, but the path to victory is not a simple one. The position is very complicated and the white king is unsafe; there are many false trails and only one that leads to victory.

There is no advantage in 29 ♕xa3 ♖xg1 30 ♕a8+ ♘e8 31 ♖d5 (or 31 ♔b2 ♖xc1!, which can transpose) 31...♖xc1+ 32 ♔b2 ♖d1! 33 ♔xc2 ♖xd5 34 ♗xd5 g6 35 ♗xe4 (35 ♕xb7 ♕f5) 35...♔g7 36 ♕xb7 ♕d4, with enough counterplay to equalize.

29 ♕c3 ♖xg1 30 ♕xc2 also leads to nothing special after 30...g6, despite the fact that Black has only two pawns for the piece; the white king remains vulnerable and the black pieces are ready to attack.

29 ♖d5?

White can win with **29 ♕a8+!** ♘e8 30 ♕xa3 ♖xg1 and only now 31 ♖d5!; White doesn't lose his knight and remains with a winning position, albeit with 'only' one extra piece.

29...♖xg1 30 ♕a8+?

And this check even loses the game for White; 30 ♕xa3! is forced and after 30...♕e8 (30...♖xc1+ gives no advantage after 31 ♔b2 ♖d1 32 ♕a8+ ♕e8 33 ♕xe8+ ♘xe8 34 ♔xc2, etc.; White's bishop is very strong) 31 ♖a5 ♖xc1+ 32 ♕xc1 ♕d8 33 ♕xc2 ♕xa5 34 ♗d5! g6 35 ♗xb7, we reach an endgame that is difficult to assess.

30...♕e8! 31 ♕xa3

After 31 ♕xe8+ ♘xe8 White will be mated.

31...♘xd5 0-1

Black is threatening mate, starting with 32...♕e5+ *and* he is now the exchange up.

993) Barsov – Flores

Dresden Olympiad 2008

White's material advantage is huge, but his king is very weak. In serious time-pressure, Black overlooked the winning manoeuvre.

29...♕b6+?

Black wins by **29...♗c5+!!** 30 ♔h1 ♖e1+! (30...♕xd5+ 31 ♖xd5 ♘f3 32 ♕e8+! ♖xe8 33 ♔g2 ♗d4 34 ♖f1 ♘e1+ 35 ♖xe1 ♖xe1 36 ♖xd4 c3 37 ♖c4 ♖e2+ is another way) 31 ♔g2 ♖g1+! 32 ♔h3 ♕c8+ 33 ♕ad7 ♘xd7, with a decisive advantage.

30 ♖d4 ♖d2 31 ♕xe5?!

The final sequence contains several blunders caused by time-pressure; here 31 ♔h1 is better.

31...♖xd4 32 ♕aa5?! ♖d1++ 33 ♔g2 ♖d2+?

After 33...♕xa5! Black can still fight.

34 ♕xd2 1-0

994) H. Leyva – Al Hadarani

Dresden Olympiad 2008

30 b4??

Very logical, bolstering the c5-knight, but White's back rank is very poorly defended and this will be punished brilliantly. The correct move is **30 ♗e3!** with the same idea. Then White will make decisive material gains; note that 30...♘h4? fails in view of 31 ♖xf8+ ♖xf8 32 ♕xc6 ♖f1+ 33 ♗g1.

30...♘h4!! 31 ♖xf8+ ♖xf8 32 ♕xc6 ♖f1+ 0-1

After 33 ♔h2 ♗e5+ White is mated.

995) S. Haslinger – Savchenko (variation)

Palma de Mallorca 2008

GM Haslinger analysed this very interesting variation in *Jaque* magazine (January 2009).

21 ♗xg7! ♔xg7 22 ♕g5+ ♔h8 23 ♕h5+!

Placing the queen on its ideal square before playing e5. If 23 e5 then 23...♕c5+ 24 ♔h1, and now Black can use his queen to assist the defence by exploiting the placing of the white queen with 24...♕e3!. After 25 ♖f4 Black can play 25...♘f2+ 26 ♔h2 ♘g4+ 27 ♔h1 (or 27 ♖xg4 ♕xe5+ 28 ♕xe5+ dxe5 and Black has no problems) 27...♘f2+ with a draw. 23 ♕h4+? is not as strong, since it does not attack f7, and after 23...♔g7, 24 e5? fails to 24...♕c5+! 25 ♔h1 ♖h8, and Black wins.

23...♔g8

Now 23...♔g7? loses to 24 e5! f5 (the difference is that if 24...♕c5+ 25 ♔h1 ♖h8 then 26 ♖xf7+ ♔g8 27 ♗h7+ mates) 25 exf6+ ♖xf6 26 ♖xf6 ♔xf6 (26...♘xf6 loses to 27 ♕g6+) 27 ♖f1+ ♔e7 28 ♖f7+ with mate in a few moves.

24 e5! ♕c5+

24...f5 is met by 25 ♕g6+ ♔h8 26 ♖f3 ♕c5+ 27 ♔f1! ♘h2+ 28 ♔e2 ♕xe5+ (28...♘xf3 loses to 29 ♖h1+) 29 ♖e3 ♕g7 30 ♖h3+ ♔g8 31 ♗c4+, and White wins.

25 ♔h1 f5 26 ♕g6+!

Not 26 ♖f3? ♖a7! and Black wins, while 26 ♖b4 ♖a7 is inconclusive.

26...♔h8 27 ♖b4!

Threatening 28 ♖xg4, and better than 27 ♖f3 ♘f2+ 28 ♖xf2 ♖a7!, when Black can defend.

27...♖a7 28 ♖xg4!! ♖h7+ 29 ♕xh7+!! ♔xh7 30 ♖f3!

There is no satisfactory defence against the threat of 31 ♖h3#.

996) Grishchuk – Elianov

FIDE Grand Prix, Elista 2008

Jesús de la Villa writes about this ending as follows: "to defend this ending it is not enough to know that it is drawn; not even to know the best defensive set-ups, or the Rook + Pawn vs Rook endings that may arise on the board at any time. Of course, all this is necessary, but not enough. You will also need patience, tenacity and constant alertness." Here we have a perfect demonstration of this. Elianov has been defending this uncomfortable inferior ending precisely for many moves but here, even with his Elo rating of 2720, he tires and makes a decisive error.

67...♖h5??

The rook has to remain 'distant', so that it can check both from behind and from the side, as the situation demands. On h5, the rook is too close to prevent the decisive manoeuvre that follows in the game. Instead, **67...♖g1**, **67...♖h2** and **67...♖h3** all draw, according to the tablebase, but not 67...♖f1?, which brings the rook too close to the white king for checks from the side to be effective.

68 ♔b5!

Now Black is unable to check from a distance along the b-file, and White can reach a winning position, since both his pawns are able to reach the sixth rank.

68...♖h7 69 ♖d5

Necessary, in order to play c6.

69...♖h1 70 ♖d7+ ♔b8 71 c6

This is a known theoretical position; there is no defence.

71...♖b1+ 72 ♔c5 ♖c1+ 73 ♔b6 ♖b1+ 74 ♔c5 ♖c1+ 75 ♔d6 ♖d1+ 76 ♔e7 ♖c1 77 ♖d8+ ♔a7 78 ♔d7 ♖d1+ 79 ♔c8 1-0

Followed by 80 c7, and there is nothing to be done; White reaches the well-known 'Lucena Position'.

997) Caruana – Vallejo

Pamplona 2008

28 ♖f5!!

There is no time for 28 ♘d4? ♕d7 and now 29 ♖f5 is met simply by 29...♘g7.

28...gxf5 29 ♘d4!

But now the knight comes into the game with a gain of tempo.

29...♕e5 30 ♘c6!

Not 30 ♕xh5? allowing Black to defend with 30...♗f6 and the attack is repelled.

30...♘f4

Or 30...♕f6 31 ♕xh5 f4 (if 31...♖fc8 then one way to win is 32 ♘xe7+ ♔f8 33 ♘d5 ♕e5 34 ♗f4) 32 ♗d4.

31 ♗xf4 ♕xf4 32 ♘xe7+ ♔h7 33 ♘xf5!

Now White is threatening 34 ♕h5+, followed by 35 ♖xg3+.

33...♔g6 34 ♘e7+ ♔h7 35 ♘f5 ♔g6 36 ♖f1 ♕g5 37 h4!

The killer blow; the way is cleared for the white queen and there is no defence.

37...♕f6

Or 37...♕h5 38 ♘e7+ ♔h6 39 ♖f6+.

38 ♕g4+ ♔h7 39 ♕h5+ ♔g8 40 ♘h6+ 1-0

998) Ibrahimov – Ezat

Manama 2009

75...♖d5!

Forced, because it is essential to prevent 76 ♔f5. Even so, Black still seems to be losing, but in fact there is a key defensive resource.

76 ♖xc3 ♔f7 77 ♖c7+ ♔g8?

Missing his chance. As Golubev pointed out in *Chess Today*, Black has a beautiful saving manoeuvre available: **77...♔xf6!** 78 ♖h7 ♖d4+! 79 ♔g3 (no better is 79 ♔f3 ♔g5 80 ♖g7+ ♔h4) and now 79...♖d6!! 80 ♖xh6+ (80 ♔h4 ♔e5 is not promising either, since 81 ♖g7 ♖b6 82 ♖g6 ♖xg6! 83 hxg6 ♔f6 84 ♔h5 ♔g7 draws) 80...♔g5! 81 ♖xd6 stalemate.

78 ♖g7+ ♔h8 79 ♖g6 ♔h7 80 f7 ♖d7

After 80...♖d8 White must only avoid 81 ♖g8?? since Black can then save himself, thanks to the fact that his king is in a stalemate position, with 81...♖d4+! 82 ♔e5 ♖d5+!.

81 f8♘+ 1-0

999) Beliavsky – Kotronias

Gibraltar 2009

41 b6! ♖d8

The point of the previous move is that if 41...♖d4+ White wins with 42 ♔c5!! (not 42 ♔b5? ♖xa4 43 ♔xa4 e3 44 b7 e2 45 b8♕ e1♕, with advantage to Black) 42...♖xa4 43 b7 ♖a5+ and now a 'staircase' manoeuvre that is reminiscent of the famous 'Saavedra position' from 1895: 44 ♔c4! (not 44 ♔b4? ♖a1!) 44...♖a4+ 45 ♔c3 ♖a3+ 46 ♔b2.

42 ♔c5!

Now the b-pawn will cost Black his rook, and the black pawns will not be dangerous. White has several ways to win.

42...♖c8+ 43 ♔d6 ♖d8+ 44 ♔c7 ♖d2 45 ♖xe4 ♖xg2 46 ♖b4 ♖c2+ 47 ♔d6 ♖d2+ 48 ♔xe5 ♖e2+ 49 ♔d6 ♖d2+ 50 ♔c6 ♖c2+ 51 ♔b5 ♖c8 52 b7 ♖b8 53 ♔c6 1-0

1000) Speelman – Ripari

Gibraltar 2009

63...♘f5?

This natural move loses; 63...♘e6? also loses, to 64 f5+! ♔xf5 65 h7. The only way to draw is **63...♔h7!** 64 ♔f7 ♘f5 65 ♔f6 ♘h4 66 f5 ♘f3 and after 67 g6+ ♔xh6 68 g7 ♔h7 69 ♔f7 Black has 69...♘e5+! 70 ♔f8 ♘d7+.

64 ♔f8 ♔h7 65 ♔f7!

As Baburin pointed out in *Chess Today*, this is a position of reciprocal zugzwang.

65...♘h4 66 ♔f6 ♘g6

If 66...♘f3, 67 g6+ ♔xh6 68 ♔f7! now wins (but not 68 g7? ♔h7 69 ♔f7 in view of the surprising resource 69...♘g5+! with a draw by stalemate after 70 fxg5).

67 f5 ♘h4 68 g6+ 1-0

Now after 68...♔xh6 69 g7 ♔h7 70 ♔f7, compared to the note at move 63 Black is a tempo short to play the saving move ...♘e5+.

1001) D. Byrne – Fischer

Rosenwald Trophy, New York 1956

Probably you recognized this position, but having already worked through 1000 tricky puzzles, you may have been able to work out this spectacular combination on your own.

It is a marvellous work of art, created when he was only thirteen years old by possibly the best chess-player of all time, who died at the start of 2008.

You can find this game well annotated in numerous places, which is why the game is presented here without comment, up to the point where the combination leaves no doubt as to the result.

11...♘a4!! 12 ♕a3 ♘xc3 13 bxc3 ♘xe4! 14 ♗xe7 ♕b6 15 ♗c4 ♘xc3! 16 ♗c5 ♖fe8+ 17 ♔f1 ♗e6!! 18 ♗xb6 ♗xc4+ 19 ♔g1 ♘e2+ 20 ♔f1 ♘xd4+ 21 ♔g1 ♘e2+ 22 ♔f1 ♘c3+ 23 ♔g1 axb6 24 ♕b4 ♖a4 25 ♕xb6 ♘xd1

and Fischer mated on move 41.

Score-Chart

You may use the following score-chart to keep track of your performance in the fifteen tests in this book. For each test, fill in your score and the corresponding Elo rating, which can be derived using the conversion table reproduced on pages 117, 187 and 233. As a rough guide, a rating of 1600 represents an average club player, while a strong club player would be around 2000, and aspirations to an international title would be justified by a rating much over 2200. At a higher level, 2500 is roughly grandmaster strength and the world number one is normally over 2800.

Test	Score	Elo
1		
2		
3		
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8		
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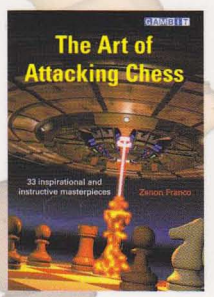
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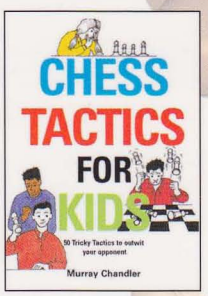
Tactical skills are paramount in chess. More than anything else, a player's ability to find tactical solutions determines how successful he is over-the-board. No endgame scheme, opening idea or strategic plan, however brilliant a concept it may be, is of any value unless it is accurately calculated and implemented.

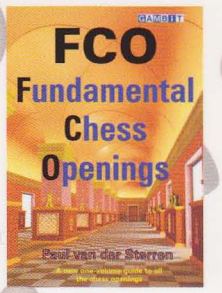
The best way to develop tactical skills is to practise them by tackling new and challenging positions. This book provides a wealth of chess puzzles to test just about every facet of your tactical ability. It is very unlikely that even those who have read many other chess puzzle books will recognize more than a handful of these positions. Franco has searched recent events and used powerful computers to seek out previously unpublished puzzles, and has also drawn extensively upon Latin American sources that he has been scouring for brilliant examples over the last three decades.

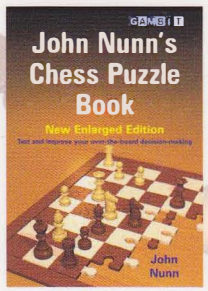
Following the pattern of Gambit's hugely successful *Ultimate Chess Puzzle Book* (by John Emms), the book begins with more than 100 relatively easy positions suitable for novices, and ends with a selection of extremely tough puzzles, which provide a mind-bending challenge even for grandmasters. There are 1001 puzzles in all, including themed sections and graded tests, all with detailed computer-verified solutions and verbal explanations of the main instructive points.

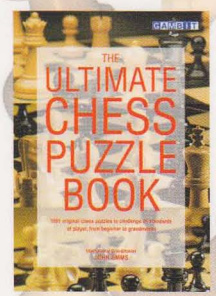
Zenon Franco is a grandmaster from Paraguay who now lives in Spain. He is an experienced chess trainer, his most notable pupil being Paco Vallejo, now one of the world's top grandmasters. He has written six previous books for Gambit, including *Chess Self-Improvement* and *Grandmaster Secrets: Counterattack!*.

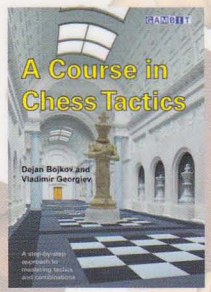












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